GRAMMAR · VOCABULARY · USAGE

English for Competitive Exams

BCS · Bank Jobs · University Admission
with SAT, GRE & GMAT concepts

Part A — Grammar (Chapters 01–44)
Part B — Vocabulary & Usage (Chapters 45–53)
Part C — Miscellaneous (Chapter 54)

How to read the boxes: **Rule** boxes state a rule; **Exam Tip** boxes show traps set in BCS, Bank and admission papers; **Note** boxes give exceptions; **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner** boxes connect the topic to international tests. In examples, ✘ marks an incorrect sentence and ✔ its correct form. In the word lists, ★ marks very frequent exam words and Bangla meanings are given in brackets.

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PART A

Grammar

Chapters 01 – 44

Parts of speech, sentence structure, tenses, agreement, voice, narration, transformation, error detection and punctuation — every rule with exam examples.

CHAPTER 01

Parts of Speech & Its Identification

Part A · Grammar

1.1 What Is a Part of Speech?

Every word in an English sentence does a particular **job**. Some words name things, some show action, some describe, some join, and some show relationships. The **job** a word does in a sentence is called its **part of speech**. Traditional grammar — the grammar followed in BCS, Bank and university admission question papers — divides English words into **eight parts of speech**:

No.	Part of Speech	Its Job	Examples
1	Noun	names a person, place, thing, idea	Rahim, Dhaka, book, honesty
2	Pronoun	stands in place of a noun	he, she, it, they, who, this
3	Adjective	describes / qualifies a noun or pronoun	good, tall, five, every, this
4	Verb	shows action, being or possession	run, write, is, have, seem
5	Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb	quickly, very, often, here
6	Preposition	shows relation of a noun/pronoun to another word	in, on, at, by, with, from
7	Conjunction	joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, or, because, though
8	Interjection	expresses sudden feeling	Alas! Hurrah! Oh! Bravo!

Modern grammars (and the SAT, GRE and GMAT) also treat **determiners** (*a, an, the, this, my, some, every*) as a separate class. Traditional grammar calls them *adjectives* (articles are called "demonstrative adjectives" or simply "articles"). In Bangladeshi exams, if an option list has no "determiner", choose **adjective** for words such as *this, every, some, my* when they come before a noun.

> **The Golden Rule of Identification:** A word has **no fixed part of speech**. What a word *is* depends on what it *does* in that particular sentence. *"We cannot tell what part of speech a word is until we see it in a sentence."* — this principle (stated by J. C. Nesfield and repeated in every standard grammar) is the key to the whole chapter.

- I bought a **round** table. (adjective — describes *table*)
- The boxer won the first **round**. (noun — names a thing)
- The ship will **round** the cape tomorrow. (verb — action)
- The earth moves **round** the sun. (preposition — relates *earth* and *sun*)
- The wheel turned **round**. (adverb — modifies *turned*)

1.1.1 Content Words and Function Words

It helps to divide the eight classes into two big groups:

- **Content words (open classes):** nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs. They carry the main meaning; new ones are created all the time (*selfie, google, unfriend*).
- **Function words (closed classes):** pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, determiners and auxiliary verbs. They build grammar; the list is almost fixed, and they are tested heavily in error-detection questions.

1.2 The Eight Parts of Speech in Detail

1.2.1 Noun

A **noun** is a word used as the **name** of a person, place, thing, animal, quality, action or idea.

- **Person:** Nazrul, teacher, farmer, girl
- **Place:** Sylhet, village, market, Asia
- **Thing:** pen, river, computer, rice
- **Animal:** tiger, cow, hilsa
- **Quality / Idea:** honesty, beauty, freedom, wisdom
- **Action / State:** arrival, laughter, sleep, childhood

A noun can work as the **subject** (*The **boy** runs*), the **object** of a verb (*I saw the **boy***), the **object of a preposition** (*Give it to the **boy***), the **complement** (*He is a **doctor***) or an **apposition** (*Rahim, the **captain**, scored*). Full details are in Chapter 02.

1.2.2 Pronoun

A **pronoun** is a word used **instead of a noun** to avoid repetition.

- Rina is a student. **She** reads in class ten. (*She* = Rina)
- The book is old, but **it** is useful.
- **Who** broke the glass? (interrogative pronoun)
- This is the man **who** helped me. (relative pronoun)
- **This** is my pen. (demonstrative pronoun — stands alone)

> **Pronoun or adjective?** *This, that, these, those, each, either, neither, some, any, many, few, all, both, one, what, which* are **pronouns** when they stand **alone** and **adjectives (determiners)** when they come **before a noun**. *This is good* (pronoun) / *This book is good* (adjective). *Each got a prize* (pronoun) / *Each boy got a prize* (adjective).

1.2.3 Adjective

An **adjective qualifies** (adds to the meaning of) a noun or pronoun. It answers *What kind? Which one? How many? How much?*

- She is a **clever** girl. (what kind — before the noun: *attributive* use)
- The girl is **clever**. (after a linking verb: *predicative* use)
- I have **three** pens. (how many)
- He has **little** money. (how much)
- **That** house is ours. (which one)

1.2.4 Verb

A **verb** says something about the subject: it shows **action** (*run, eat*), **state of being** (*be, seem, become*) or **possession** (*have, own*). Without a verb there is no sentence.

- The baby **cries**.
- He **is** honest.
- They **have** a car.
- She **seems** tired.

- The meeting **will be held** tomorrow. (verb phrase: auxiliaries + main verb)

1.2.5 Adverb

An **adverb** modifies (adds to the meaning of) a **verb**, an **adjective**, another **adverb**, a **preposition**, a **conjunction** or a **whole sentence**. It answers *How? When? Where? How often? How much?*

- He runs **fast**. (modifies the verb *runs*)
- She is **very** beautiful. (modifies the adjective *beautiful*)
- He ran **very** fast. (modifies the adverb *fast*)
- The bird flew **just** over the house. (modifies the preposition *over*)
- He came **only** because he was invited. (modifies the conjunction *because*)
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt. (modifies the whole sentence — sentence adverb)

1.2.6 Preposition

A **preposition** is placed **before** a noun or pronoun to show its relation to some other word in the sentence (place, time, direction, cause, manner etc.). The noun or pronoun after it is called its **object**.

- The cat is **under** the table.
- He was born **in** 1990.
- She went **to** school **by** bus.
- I am fond **of** music.
- He sat **between** you and me. (✘ between you and I — the object of a preposition must be in the objective case)

1.2.7 Conjunction

A **conjunction joins** words, phrases, clauses or sentences.

- Rahim **and** Karim are friends. (joins words)
- He is poor **but** honest.
- I stayed at home **because** it was raining. (joins clauses)
- **Though** he is rich, he is not happy.
- **Either** you **or** he is guilty. (correlative conjunction)

1.2.8 Interjection

An **interjection** is a word that expresses a **sudden feeling or emotion**. It has no grammatical connection with the rest of the sentence and is usually followed by an exclamation mark.

- **Alas!** He is dead. (grief)
- **Hurrah!** We have won. (joy)
- **Bravo!** Well done. (approval)
- **Oh!** I forgot my keys. (surprise)
- **Hush!** The baby is sleeping. (call for silence)

1.3 How to Identify Parts of Speech: Four Reliable Tests

Exam questions usually underline a word and ask *"What part of speech is the underlined word?"* Use these four tests one after another.

1.3.1 Test 1 — The Function Test (Most Important)

Ask what the word is **doing**:

1. Is it **naming** something? → Noun.
2. Is it standing **in place of** a noun? → Pronoun.
3. Is it **describing / limiting** a noun? → Adjective.
4. Is it saying what the subject **does or is**? → Verb.
5. Is it telling **how / when / where / how much** about a verb, adjective or adverb? → Adverb.
6. Does it have a **noun/pronoun object after it** and show a relation? → Preposition.
7. Does it **join** two clauses or words? → Conjunction.
8. Is it a **cry** of feeling? → Interjection.

1.3.2 Test 2 — The Position (Slot) Test

English has a fairly fixed word order, so the **position** of a word gives a strong clue.

Slot (frame sentence)	Part of speech that fits	Example
The ___ is/was good.	Noun	The **book** is good.
a/the very ___ person	Adjective	a very **kind** person
He/They will ___ (it).	Verb	They will **win**.
He did it ___.	Adverb	He did it **carefully**.
___ the table (shows place)	Preposition	**under** the table

Clue words: a word right after *a, an, the, my, his, this, some* is usually a **noun** or an **adjective + noun**. A word right after *to* (infinitive) or after a modal (*can, will, must*) is a **verb**. A word right after *very, too, so, quite, rather* is an **adjective or adverb**.

1.3.3 Test 3 — The Suffix (Word Ending) Test

Many words carry endings that signal their class. This test is helpful but **not perfect** (see the traps in 1.4).

Class	Typical suffixes	Examples
Noun	-tion, -sion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -ty, -ance, -ence, -ship, -hood, -dom, -ism, -ist, -er, -or, -ee, -age, -al, -th, -ure, -cy	information, decision, movement, kindness, ability, cruelty, importance, silence, friendship, childhood, freedom, heroism, scientist, teacher, actor, employee, marriage, arrival, growth, failure, privacy
Adjective	-ous, -ful, -less, -able, -ible, -al, -ic, -ical, -ive, -ish, -y, -ant, -ent, -ary, -ory, -some, -ly (from nouns)	famous, beautiful, careless, readable, visible, national, heroic, historical, active, childish, rainy, important, different, necessary, compulsory, troublesome, friendly
Verb	-ize/-ise, -ify, -en, -ate	modernise, beautify, strengthen, activate
Adverb	-ly (from adjectives), -ward(s), -wise	quickly, homeward(s), clockwise, otherwise

1.3.4 Test 4 — The Substitution Test

Replace the word with a word whose class you are sure of. If the sentence still works grammatically, the two words belong to the same class.

- He came **after** the meeting. → He came **before** / **during** the meeting. (both prepositions → *after* is a preposition)
- He came **after** we had left. → He came **when** we had left. (*when* is a conjunction → *after* is a conjunction)
- He came **after**. → He came **later**. (*later* is an adverb → *after* is an adverb)

1.4 The Same Word as Different Parts of Speech: Exam Favourites

These words are the most frequently tested in BCS and admission tests. Learn each pattern. (Chapter 42 gives a larger list.)

1.4.1 *That*

- **That** is my house. → **Demonstrative pronoun** (stands alone)
- **That** house is mine. → **Adjective/Determiner** (before a noun)
- This is the book **that** I bought. → **Relative pronoun** (refers to *book*, introduces an adjective clause)
- I know **that** he is honest. → **Conjunction** (introduces a noun clause)
- He was **that** tired that he slept at once. → **Adverb** (= so; informal)
- I am so tired **that** I cannot walk. → **Conjunction** (of result)

Exam Tip — Relative pronoun or conjunction? If *that* can be replaced by *which/who/whom*, it is a **relative pronoun**: *the book that (= which) I bought*. If it cannot, and the clause after it is complete in itself, it is a **conjunction**: *I know that he is honest* (✘ I know which he is honest).

1.4.2 *But*

- He is poor **but** honest. → **Conjunction**
- All **but** him were present. → **Preposition** (= except; note the objective *him*)
- He is **but** a child. → **Adverb** (= only)
- There is no one **but** loves his country. → **Relative pronoun** (= who … not; literary)
- No **buts**, please. / Ifs and **buts**. → **Noun**
- **But** me no buts. → **Verb** (archaic; rarely tested)

1.4.3 *Since, Before, After, Till/Until*

These four can be **prepositions** (followed by a noun/pronoun), **conjunctions** (followed by a clause with a subject and verb) or **adverbs** (followed by nothing).

- I have been here **since** Monday. → Preposition
- It is two years **since** he died. → Conjunction
- I have not seen him **since**. → Adverb
- **Since** you are tired, you may go. → Conjunction (= because)
- He came **before** me. → Preposition
- He came **before** I left. → Conjunction
- I have seen him **before**. → Adverb

1.4.4 *Like*

- I **like** mangoes. → Verb
- He runs **like** a deer. → Preposition
- We shall not see his **like** again. → Noun
- They are of **like** minds. → Adjective (= similar)
- He talks **like** he knows everything. → Conjunction (informal; formal English prefers *as if*)

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — *Like* vs *As*: In GMAT Sentence Correction, *like* is accepted only as a **preposition** (followed by a noun/pronoun) and *as* is used before a **clause**. ✘ *Like I said, the plan failed.* ✔ *As I said, the plan failed.* ✘ *She sings like her mother does.* ✔ *She sings as her mother does* / *She sings like her mother.* Also, *like* compares things (*Like Dhaka, Karachi is crowded*), while *such as* gives examples (*cities such as Dhaka and Karachi*).

1.4.5 *What*

- **What** do you want? → Interrogative pronoun
- **What** book is this? → Interrogative adjective
- I know **what** you mean. → Relative pronoun (= that which)
- **What**! You failed again? → Interjection
- **What** a beautiful scene! → Adjective (exclamatory)
- **What** with illness and **what** with poverty, he was ruined. → Adverb (= partly)

1.4.6 *Well*

- She sings **well**. → Adverb
- I am quite **well** now. → Adjective (= in good health)
- The village **well** has dried up. → Noun
- **Well**, what can I do for you? → Interjection
- Tears **welled** up in her eyes. → Verb

1.4.7 *Down, Up, In, Out, Near, Round, Off*

- He fell **down** the stairs. → Preposition
- Sit **down**. → Adverb
- the **down** train → Adjective
- He has had many ups and **downs**. → Noun
- They **downed** tools. → Verb
- The house is **near** the river. → Preposition
- The day is **near**. → Adjective
- Come **near**. → Adverb
- The ship **neared** the coast. → Verb

1.4.8 *Fast, Hard, Late, Early, High, Long, Straight, Daily*

These are both **adjectives** and **adverbs** with the same form.

- He is a **fast** runner. (adj) / He runs **fast**. (adv) / He **fasts** in Ramadan. (verb) / He broke his **fast**. (noun)
- This is a **hard** question. (adj) / He works **hard**. (adv)
- He came by a **late** train. (adj) / He came **late**. (adv)
- I take an **early** walk. (adj) / I get up **early**. (adv)
- *The Daily Star* is a **daily**. (noun) / a **daily** newspaper (adj) / It is published **daily**. (adv)

Do not confuse: *hard* (= with effort) ≠ *hardly* (= scarcely); *late* (= not on time) ≠ *lately* (= recently); *high* (= at a high level) ≠ *highly* (= very much); *near* (= close) ≠ *nearly* (= almost); *short* ≠ *shortly* (= soon); *free* (= without paying) ≠ *freely* (= without restriction); *deep* (= far down) ≠ *deeply* (= greatly). *He works **hard*** ✔ / *He hardly works* = he works very little.

1.4.9 Words Ending in *-ly* That Are NOT Adverbs

Many students think every *-ly* word is an adverb. The following are **adjectives** (formed from nouns + *-ly*):

friendly, lovely, lonely, lively, ugly, silly, costly, deadly, cowardly, manly, womanly, motherly, brotherly, scholarly, heavenly, holy, orderly, elderly, likely, unlikely, timely, homely, worldly, jolly, chilly, hilly, bodily, kingly, beastly, leisurely, sickly, surly, burly.

- She is a **friendly** girl. (adj) — We cannot say ✘ *She behaved friendly*. ✔ *She behaved **in a friendly manner/way***.
- He gave a **cowardly** reply. ✔ / He replied **in a cowardly way**.
- It was a **costly** mistake.
- *Daily, weekly, monthly, yearly, early, kindly, only, likely* can be both adjectives and adverbs: *a **kindly** old man* (adj) / *Kindly help me* (adv).

1.4.10 Nouns Used as Adjectives and Adjectives Used as Nouns

A **noun** placed before another noun to describe it works as an **adjective** (sometimes called a *noun adjunct*). Such a noun normally stays **singular**.

- a **gold** watch, a **village** school, a **cotton** shirt, a **college** student, a **ten-taka** note, a **five-year** plan, a **shoe** shop (✘ shoes shop), a **two-mile** walk (✘ two-miles walk)

An **adjective** preceded by *the* can work as a **plural noun** for a class of people: *the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the blind, the dead, the brave, the wise, the honest*. Such a phrase takes a **plural verb** and has **no -s**.

- **The rich are** not always happy. (✘ The rich is / ✘ The riches are)
- **The poor need** our help.
- **The brave deserve** the fair.
- *The unknown* / *the beautiful* (abstract idea) → singular: **The beautiful is** not always good.

1.4.11 *-ing* Words: Verb, Noun (Gerund) or Adjective (Participle)?

- He **is swimming** now. → **Verb** (part of the verb phrase *is swimming*)
- **Swimming** is a good exercise. → **Noun (Gerund)** — subject
- I like **swimming**. → **Noun (Gerund)** — object
- Look at the **swimming** fish. → **Adjective (Present Participle)** — describes *fish*
- a **swimming** pool → **Gerund** used as an adjective (= a pool *for* swimming, not a pool that swims)

> **Exam Tip — Gerund or participle before a noun?** Ask: *Is the noun itself doing the action?* A **sleeping** child = a child who is sleeping → **participle (adjective)**. A **sleeping** bag = a bag *for* sleeping → **gerund** (a noun used to form a compound). Similarly: *a walking stick, a dining table, a reading room, drinking water, a frying pan, a swimming pool* are gerunds; *a barking dog, a rising sun, a falling leaf, a running train* are participles.

1.4.12 Past Participle: Verb or Adjective?

- The window **was broken** by the boys. → **Verb** (passive)
- He looked at the **broken** window. → **Adjective** (describes *window*)
- I am **tired**. / She looks **worried**. → **Adjective** (after linking verbs)
- **Written** in simple English, the book is popular. → **Participle** (adjectival; describes *book*)

1.4.13 Words Whose Stress Changes the Class

Some two-syllable words are **nouns/adjectives** with stress on the **first** syllable and **verbs** with stress on the **second**:

Noun / Adjective (stress 1st)	Verb (stress 2nd)
REcord (a record)	re**CORD** (to record)
PREsent (a gift; now)	pre**SENT** (to give)
OBject (a thing)	ob**JECT** (to oppose)
CONduct (behaviour)	con**DUCT** (to lead)
PROduce (crops)	pro**DUCE** (to make)
PERmit (a licence)	per**MIT** (to allow)
CONtract (an agreement)	con**TRACT** (to shrink)
INsult / **PRO**test / **RE**bel / **CON**flict / **SUB**ject	in**SULT** / pro**TEST** / re**BEL** / con**FLICT** / sub**JECT**

1.4.14 Other Frequently Tested Words

- **Enough:** I have **enough** money (adj). / He is old **enough** (adv). / I have had **enough** (noun/pronoun).
- **Very:** He is **very** good (adv). / This is the **very** book I wanted (adj = exact).
- **Much: Much** water (adj). / He is **much** better (adv). / **Much** has been done (noun/pronoun).
- **Only:** He is an **only** child (adj). / He **only** smiled (adv). / I would go, **only** I am busy (conj = but).
- **Still:** The water is **still** (adj = calm). / He is **still** here (adv). / the **still** of the night (noun). / **Still**, I love her (conj/adv = nevertheless).
- **Yet:** He has not come **yet** (adv). / He is poor, **yet** he is honest (conj).
- **For:** He works **for** money (prep). / He was sad, **for** his son had died (conj = because).
- **As:** He is **as** tall **as** I (adv … conj). / **As** he was ill, he stayed home (conj). / He worked **as** a clerk (prep). / Such men **as** are honest (relative pronoun).
- **Either: Either** pen will do (adj). / **Either** of them will do (pronoun). / **Either** you or I (conj). / He does not like it **either** (adv).
- **Back:** My **back** aches (noun). / Come **back** (adv). / the **back** door (adj). / They **backed** the plan (verb).
- **Last:** the **last** boy (adj) / He came **last** (adv) / He was the **last** to leave (noun/pronoun) / The food will **last** a week (verb).
- **Over:** The plane flew **over** the city (prep). / The game is **over** (adj/adv). / an **over** in cricket (noun).
- **Off:** He fell **off** the horse (prep). / Switch **off** the light (adv/particle). / an **off** day (adj).
- **Before / After / Since** — see 1.4.3.
- **Love, Work, Name, Book, Water, Hand, Head, Face, Eye, Fish:** each can be noun or verb: *Please **book** two tickets. **Water** the plants. She **headed** the team. He **eyed** me suspiciously.*

1.5 Phrases and Clauses Can Also Act as Parts of Speech

A **group** of words can do the job of a single part of speech. This idea links Chapter 01 with Chapters 30 and 31.

- **To tell lies** is a sin. → noun phrase (= *Lying* is a sin)
- He is a man **of great wisdom**. → adjective phrase (= a *wise* man)
- He did the work **with great care**. → adverb phrase (= *carefully*)
- **What he said** is true. → noun clause
- This is the house **where I was born**. → adjective clause
- I will wait **till you return**. → adverb clause
- **In front of**, **on account of**, **in spite of**, **because of** → phrase prepositions
- **As soon as**, **as long as**, **so that**, **in order that**, **even if** → phrase conjunctions
- **Alas!**, **Good heavens!**, **Oh dear!** → interjection phrases

1.6 Worked Examples: Identify the Underlined Word

Read the explanation for each. This is exactly how BCS and admission questions are set.

1. He is **above** meanness. → *Preposition* (object: *meanness*).
2. The **above** statement is false. → *Adjective* (qualifies *statement*).
3. The sky is **above**. → *Adverb* (no object follows).
4. He **lives** in Dhaka. → *Verb*.
5. Many **lives** were lost. → *Noun* (plural of *life*).
6. She sang **sweetly**. → *Adverb* (modifies *sang*).
7. The rose smells **sweet**. → *Adjective* (after linking verb *smells*; it describes the rose, not the action). ✘ The rose smells sweetly.

8. **Each** of the boys got a prize. → *Pronoun*.
9. **Each** boy got a prize. → *Adjective/Determiner*.
10. **Walking** is good for health. → *Noun (Gerund)*.
11. I saw a **walking** doll. → *Adjective (Participle)*.
12. **Hush!** Don't make a noise. → *Interjection*.
13. He worked hard **lest** he should fail. → *Conjunction*.
14. Do you **mind** my smoking? → *Verb*; **smoking** → *Gerund*; **my** → *Possessive adjective/determiner*.
15. **Better** late than never. → *Adverb*.
16. He is **better** today. → *Adjective* (= in better health).
17. Our **betters** deserve respect. → *Noun* (= superiors).
18. He **bettered** his record. → *Verb*.
19. He gave me a **light**. → *Noun*.
20. This bag is **light**. → *Adjective*.
21. **Light** the lamp. → *Verb*.
22. He travels **light**. → *Adverb*.
23. **Rich** and poor alike came. → *Adjective used as noun* (= rich people).
24. He is a **man** of his word. → *Noun*.
25. **Man** the boats! → *Verb* (= put people on).
26. **Who** is there? → *Interrogative pronoun*.
27. I know the man **who** came here. → *Relative pronoun*.
28. **Whose** pen is this? → *Interrogative adjective* (before noun *pen*).
29. **Whatever** you do, do it well. → *Relative pronoun* (compound).
30. He has **no** money. → *Adjective/Determiner*. / **No**, I won't go. → *Adverb (sentence word)*. / He is **no** better. → *Adverb* (modifies *better*).
31. Wait a **little**. → *Noun/Pronoun*. / He is **little** known. → *Adverb*. / I have **little** time. → *Adjective*.
32. It is **quite** wrong. → *Adverb* (modifies adjective).
33. **Out** of sight, **out** of mind. → *Preposition* (*out of* = phrase preposition).
34. The truth will **out**. → *Verb* (= become known).
35. **Behind** the house there is a garden. → *Preposition*. / He stayed **behind**. → *Adverb*.
36. He is **a** cunning **fellow**. → *a*: article (adjective); *cunning*: adjective; *fellow*: noun.
37. **Indeed**, he is honest. → *Adverb* (sentence adverb).
38. **Notwithstanding** his efforts, he failed. → *Preposition* (= in spite of).
39. He failed; **notwithstanding**, he tried again. → *Adverb* (= nevertheless).
40. **Considering** his age, he did well. → *Preposition* (a participle used as preposition, like *regarding, concerning, pending, during, barring, excepting*).

> **Participle prepositions:** Some *-ing* or *-ed* words have become prepositions: *regarding, concerning, considering, during, pending, barring, excepting, including, notwithstanding, touching, owing to, given, provided*. *During the war* = preposition (✘ not a gerund or participle in this use).

1.7 Common Errors in the Use of Parts of Speech

1. ✘ He is a very good runner and runs very good. ✔ … runs very **well**. (*good* = adjective; *well* = adverb for manner)
2. ✘ She dresses beautiful. ✔ She dresses **beautifully**.
3. ✘ I feel badly about the matter. ✔ I feel **bad** about the matter. (*feel* is a linking verb here → adjective)
4. ✘ The food tastes deliciously. ✔ The food tastes **delicious**.
5. ✘ He behaved friendly with me. ✔ He behaved **in a friendly manner** with me.
6. ✘ He came lately to the class. ✔ He came **late** to the class.
7. ✘ He is enough strong to lift it. ✔ He is **strong enough** to lift it. (*enough* follows an adjective/adverb but precedes a noun: *enough money*)
8. ✘ The poors are suffering. ✔ **The poor are** suffering.
9. ✘ Between you and I, he is wrong. ✔ Between you and **me** …
10. ✘ He is more cleverer than his brother. ✔ He is **cleverer** than his brother.
11. ✘ He ran quick to the station. ✔ He ran **quickly** to the station.
12. ✘ She is real happy. ✔ She is **really** happy. (adverb needed to modify an adjective)
13. ✘ I can't hardly see. ✔ I can **hardly** see. (*hardly* is already negative)
14. ✘ This is a two-days programme. ✔ This is a **two-day** programme.
15. ✘ He is an university student. ✔ He is **a** university student. (sound, not spelling, decides *a/an*)

1.8 Connecting to the SAT, GRE and GMAT

International tests do not ask "Name the part of speech", but every verbal question assumes you can recognise it instantly:

- **SAT Writing & Language / Standard English Conventions:** questions on *adjective vs adverb* (*a remarkably* (✔) *clear explanation*), *pronoun case*, and *parallel structure* (verbs must be parallel with verbs, nouns with nouns).
- **GRE Text Completion & Sentence Equivalence:** the blank must be filled with a word of the right part of speech. If the blank is preceded by *a/an/the* and followed by a noun, an **adjective** is needed; if followed by an object, a **verb**. Eliminating options of the wrong class is the fastest first step.
- **GMAT Sentence Correction:** tests *modifier* placement (Chapter 29), *noun vs verb* forms (*the ability **to** do* ✔; *the ability **of** doing* ✘), and *like vs as* (1.4.4).

> **Final Advice:** Never memorise a word's class in isolation. Always ask **"What is this word doing here?"** If it names → noun; replaces a noun → pronoun; describes a noun → adjective; acts/is → verb; describes the action/quality → adverb; relates → preposition; joins → conjunction; exclaims → interjection. This single question solves almost every identification problem.

CHAPTER 02

Noun

Part A · Grammar

2.1 What Is a Noun?

A **noun** is a word used as the **name** of a person, place, thing, animal, quality, action, state or idea. The word comes from the Latin *nomen*, meaning "name". Anything we can see, touch, hear, think about or talk about has a name, and that name is a noun.

- **Kazi Nazrul Islam** was a great **poet**. (person)
- **Cox's Bazar** has the longest sea **beach** in the **world**. (place, thing)
- **Honesty** is the best **policy**. (quality, idea)
- His **arrival** caused great **joy**. (action, feeling)
- **Childhood** is the happiest **time** of **life**. (state)

2.2 Kinds of Noun

Traditional grammar (Nesfield, Wren & Martin), which is followed in our exams, divides nouns into **five** main kinds:

1. **Proper Noun**
2. **Common Noun**
3. **Collective Noun**
4. **Material Noun**
5. **Abstract Noun**

The first four are **concrete nouns** (they name things that exist physically); the fifth names things we can only think of. Modern grammar adds another very useful division: **countable** and **uncountable** nouns (see Chapter 03).

2.2.1 Proper Noun

A **proper noun** is the name of a **particular** person, place or thing. *Proper* means "one's own". A proper noun always begins with a **capital letter**.

- **People:** Sheikh Hasina, Rabindranath, Shakespeare, Newton
- **Places:** Dhaka, Bangladesh, the Padma, the Himalayas, Asia
- **Particular things/institutions:** the Quran, the Gita, *The Daily Star*, Dhaka University, Bangladesh Bank
- **Days, months, festivals:** Sunday, February, Eid-ul-Fitr, Pahela Baishakh (but **not** seasons: summer, winter)
- **Languages and nationalities:** Bangla, English, a Bangladeshi, the Japanese

Proper noun used as a common noun. When a proper noun is used to mean "a person *like* that famous person", it becomes a **common noun** and takes an article:

- He is **the Newton** of our age. (= a great scientist like Newton)
- Kalidasa is called **the Shakespeare** of India.
- Dhaka is **the Venice** of the East (historically said of Dhaka because of its canals).
- **A Daniel** come to judgement! (= a wise judge — from Shakespeare)
- He thinks he is **a Hitler**. (= a dictator)
- There are many **Mir Jafars** in our society. (= traitors)

2.2.2 Common Noun

A **common noun** is a name **shared by every** person, place or thing of the **same kind or class**. *Common* means "shared".

- boy, girl, teacher, city, country, river, book, bird, chair, doctor
- *Dhaka* is a proper noun, but *city* is a common noun; *Padma* is proper, *river* is common.

Common noun used as an abstract noun. With *the*, a common noun sometimes means the **quality** associated with it:

- **The mother** in her rose up. (= motherly love)
- **The judge** in him prevailed over **the father**. (= his sense of justice over his fatherly feeling)
- **The pen** is mightier than **the sword**. (= writing/ideas vs military force)
- **The beggar** in him was awakened.

2.2.3 Collective Noun

A **collective noun** is the name of a **group or collection** of persons or things taken together and spoken of **as one whole**.

- **class, team, army, family, crowd, committee, jury, audience, staff, government, parliament, crew, mob, flock, herd, fleet, bunch**

Verb with a collective noun. If the group acts **as a single unit**, use a **singular** verb; if the members act **as individuals** (often disagreeing), use a **plural** verb. (Detailed in Chapter 23.)

- The jury **has** given its verdict. (one unit)
- The jury **were** divided in their opinions. (individuals)
- Our team **is** the best. / The team **are** taking their seats.
- The committee **has** submitted its report.

> **Noun of multitude:** When a collective noun denotes the *individuals* of the group rather than the group as a whole, it is called a **noun of multitude** and takes a plural verb: *The crowd **were** throwing stones at one another.* Some words are **always plural** in sense even though they look singular: *people, police, cattle, poultry, gentry, clergy, vermin — The police **are** coming. Cattle **are** grazing.* (✘ cattles, ✘ polices, ✘ poultries)

Important Collective Expressions

Exams frequently ask "*a ___ of bees*" type questions. Learn this list.

Collective expression	Collective expression
a **flock** of sheep / birds / goats	a **herd** of cattle / elephants / deer
a **swarm** of bees / flies / locusts	a **pack** of wolves / hounds / cards
a **pride** of lions	a **troop** of monkeys / soldiers
a **school / shoal** of fish	a **pod** of whales / dolphins
a **gaggle** of geese	a **brood** of chickens / hens
a **litter** of puppies / kittens	a **colony** of ants / bats / artists
a **drove** of cattle (being driven)	a **caravan** of camels / travellers
a **team** of players / oxen / horses	a **crew** of sailors / an aircraft
a **gang** of thieves / robbers / labourers	a **band** of musicians / robbers
a **troupe** of dancers / actors	a **choir** of singers
a **mob** of rioters	a **crowd** of people

Collective expression	Collective expression
a **congregation** of worshippers	an **audience** of listeners
a **board** of directors	a **panel** of experts / judges
a **bench** of judges / magistrates	a **cabinet** of ministers
a **staff** of employees / teachers	a **regiment / battalion** of soldiers
a **fleet** of ships / cars / buses	a **convoy** of trucks / ships
a **galaxy** of stars / talents	a **constellation** of stars
a **bouquet** of flowers	a **bunch** of keys / grapes / bananas
a **cluster** of stars / houses / grapes	a **garland** of flowers
a **string** of pearls / beads / lies	a **chain** of mountains / events
a **range** of hills / mountains	a **suite** of rooms / furniture
a **flight** of stairs / steps / birds	a **set** of tools / china
a **sheaf** of corn / arrows / papers	a **stack** of hay / wood
a **heap** of stones / rubbish	a **pile** of books / bricks
a **bundle** of sticks / clothes	a **bale** of cotton / jute
a **grove** of trees	an **orchard** of fruit trees
a **tuft** of grass / hair	a **wad** of banknotes
a **library** of books	an **anthology** of poems
a **volley** of shots / abuse	a **round** of applause / talks
a **peal** of laughter / bells	a **burst** of applause
a **host** of angels / friends	a **bevy** of girls / beauties
a **posse** of policemen	a **party** of friends / tourists
a **den** of thieves	a **nest** of mice / rogues
a **clutch** of eggs	a **hive** of bees
a **catch** of fish	a **batch** of bread / students
a **fleet** of aeroplanes	a **squadron** of aircraft
a **deck** of cards (AmE)	a **pack** of cards (BrE)
a **murder** of crows	a **parliament** of owls
a **pair** of shoes / scissors	a **litany** of complaints

2.2.4 Material Noun

A **material noun** is the name of a **substance** or **material** out of which things are made. It is usually **uncountable** and has no plural form in its basic sense.

- **Metals:** gold, silver, iron, copper, brass, steel
- **Food/drink:** rice, wheat, milk, water, tea, sugar, salt, oil, butter
- **Others:** wood, cotton, wool, silk, paper, glass, stone, sand, cement, coal

Rules:

1. A material noun **does not take *a/an*** and usually no plural: *Gold is a precious metal* (✘ A gold is…). *Water is essential for life.*
2. It takes *the* when **particularised**: *The water of this pond is dirty. The gold in her ring is pure.*
3. To count it, use a **unit word**: *a piece of wood, a bar of gold, a loaf of bread, a cup of tea, a sheet of paper, a grain of rice, a lump of sugar, a drop of water, a bottle of milk.*
4. When a material noun names a **thing made of** that material, it becomes a **common noun** and can be counted:

Material noun	Common noun meaning
glass (material)	a glass (drinking vessel); glasses (spectacles)
iron	an iron (for pressing clothes); irons (fetters, chains)
paper	a paper (newspaper / exam paper / research article); papers (documents)
copper	coppers (copper coins; BrE slang: policemen)
tin	a tin (a can)
wood	a wood / the woods (a small forest)
stone	a stone (a pebble; also a unit of weight = 14 pounds)
silver	the silver (silverware); silver (coins)
cloth	a cloth (a piece for cleaning); clothes (garments)
rubber	a rubber (an eraser, BrE)

> **Material noun as an adjective:** *a **gold** watch, a **silk** saree, a **cotton** shirt, a **stone** wall.* Some materials have special adjective forms used **figuratively**: *golden* (*golden opportunity*, *golden days*), *silken* (*silken hair*), *wooden* (*wooden expression*), *leaden* (*leaden sky*), *woollen* (*woollen garments*), *earthen* (*earthen pot*), *brazen* (*brazen lie*), *wheaten* (*wheaten bread*), *flaxen* (*flaxen hair*). ✔ *a gold ring* (made of gold) vs *a golden opportunity* (excellent).

2.2.5 Abstract Noun

An **abstract noun** is the name of a **quality**, **action**, **state**, **feeling** or **idea** that we can only think about or feel, but cannot see or touch. *Abstract* means "drawn off" — the idea is drawn off from the object.

Type	Examples
Quality	goodness, honesty, beauty, wisdom, bravery, kindness, cruelty, humility
Action	laughter, theft, movement, judgement, arrival, flight, choice
State	childhood, boyhood, youth, slavery, poverty, sleep, sickness, death, freedom
Feeling	love, hatred, fear, anger, joy, sorrow, pity
Arts & sciences	grammar, music, chemistry, philosophy, mathematics

Abstract nouns are usually **uncountable** and take **no article** when used in a general sense: *Honesty is the best policy. Knowledge is power.* (✘ The honesty is …) But they take an article when **particularised**: *the honesty **of this man**, the wisdom **of Solomon**.*

Abstract noun used as a common noun: *She is **a beauty*** (= a beautiful woman). *He is **a youth*** (= a young man). *He is **an authority** on economics* (= an expert). *Our **acquaintances*** (= people we know). *He is **a success*** (= a successful person). *The **kindnesses** you have shown me* (= kind acts).

2.3 Formation of Abstract Nouns

This is one of the most frequently tested areas in BCS, Bank and admission tests ("*What is the noun form of …?*"). Abstract nouns are formed from **adjectives**, **verbs** and **common nouns**. Learn these tables carefully; note the spelling changes.

2.3.1 From Adjectives

Adjective	Noun	Adjective	Noun
able	ability	humble	humility
absent	absence	just	justice
accurate	accuracy	kind	kindness
active	activity	long	length

Adjective	Noun	Adjective	Noun
bitter	bitterness	loyal	loyalty
bold	boldness	mad	madness
brave	bravery	merry	merriment
brief	brevity	moist	moisture
broad	breadth	noble	nobility
calm	calmness	obscure	obscurity
certain	certainty	patient	patience
clear	clarity / clearness	poor	poverty
cruel	cruelty	prudent	prudence
curious	curiosity	proud	pride
dark	darkness	pure	purity
decent	decency	rare	rarity
deep	depth	safe	safety
difficult	difficulty	sane	sanity
dear	dearth / dearness	scarce	scarcity
equal	equality	short	shortage / shortness
false	falsehood / falsity	simple	simplicity
free	freedom	sincere	sincerity
generous	generosity	strong	strength
grand	grandeur	sweet	sweetness
grateful	gratitude	true	truth
great	greatness	vacant	vacancy
happy	happiness	vain	vanity
hard	hardship / hardness	warm	warmth
high	height	wide	width
honest	honesty	wise	wisdom
hot	heat	young	youth
human	humanity	zealous	zeal

2.3.2 From Verbs

Verb	Noun	Verb	Noun
advise	advice	judge	judgement (judgment)
agree	agreement	know	knowledge
allow	allowance	laugh	laughter
arrive	arrival	live	life
attend	attention / attendance	lose	loss
believe	belief	marry	marriage
choose	choice	move	movement / motion
conceive	conception / concept	obey	obedience
defend	defence	occur	occurrence
depart	departure	please	pleasure
deceive	deceit / deception	prove	proof
decide	decision	pursue	pursuit
deny	denial	refuse	refusal
die	death	relieve	relief
expand	expansion	remember	remembrance
fail	failure	resemble	resemblance
flatter	flattery	seize	seizure
fly	flight	serve	service
freeze	frost	see	sight
grieve	grief	sit	seat
grow	growth	speak	speech
hate	hatred	starve	starvation
heal	health	steal	theft
hinder	hindrance	succeed	success / succession
injure	injury	think	thought
invite	invitation	weigh	weight

> **Spelling traps:** *advise* (v) → *advice* (n); *practise* (v, BrE) → *practice* (n); *license* (v) → *licence* (n, BrE); *prophesy* (v) → *prophecy* (n); *devise* (v) → *device* (n). *Maintain* → *maintenance* (✘ maintainance); *pronounce* → *pronunciation* (✘ pronounciation); *explain* → *explanation* (✘ explaination); *exclaim* → *exclamation*; *proceed* → *procedure*; *repeat* → *repetition*; *describe* → *description*; *destroy* → *destruction*; *receive* → *receipt/reception*; *perceive* → *perception*; *apply* → *application*; *simplify* → *simplification*.

2.3.3 From Common Nouns

Common noun	Abstract noun	Common noun	Abstract noun
agent	agency	leader	leadership
bankrupt	bankruptcy	man	manhood
beggar	beggary	mother	motherhood
boy	boyhood	owner	ownership
captive	captivity	patriot	patriotism
child	childhood	pirate	piracy
coward	cowardice	priest	priesthood
friend	friendship	regent	regency
hero	heroism	rogue	roguery
infant	infancy	slave	slavery
king	kingship / kingdom	thief	theft
knave	knavery	woman	womanhood

2.4 Countable and Uncountable Nouns (Overview)

- **Countable nouns** can be counted and have singular and plural forms: *a book — two books; a child — three children*. In the singular they need a determiner (*a, the, my, this*): ✘ *I bought book.* ✔ *I bought **a** book.*
- **Uncountable nouns** cannot be counted and have only one form, which takes a **singular verb**: *water, rice, information, advice, furniture, luggage, news, knowledge*. ✘ *an advice*, ✘ *informations*. ✔ *a piece of advice*, ✔ *some information*.

The whole of Chapter 03 is devoted to the problems this distinction creates.

2.5 Compound Nouns

A **compound noun** is made of two or more words that together name one thing.

Pattern	Examples
Noun + Noun	classroom, bus stop, toothbrush, football, headmaster, sunrise
Adjective + Noun	blackboard, greenhouse, software, high school, full moon
Verb + Noun	pickpocket, breakwater, scarecrow
Gerund + Noun	swimming pool, dining room, walking stick, waiting room
Noun + Gerund	sightseeing, fruit-picking, horse-riding

Pattern	Examples
Noun + Preposition + Noun	mother-in-law, commander-in-chief, man-of-war
Verb + Adverb/Particle	passer-by, take-off, breakdown, draw-back, outbreak, setback
Noun + Adjective	court-martial, attorney-general, poet laureate

Compound nouns may be written as one word (*classroom*), with a hyphen (*mother-in-law*) or as separate words (*bus stop*). Their plurals are explained in Chapter 06 (*sons-in-law, passers-by, courts-martial, spoonfuls*).

2.6 Case of Nouns

Case is the form or position of a noun or pronoun that shows its **relation to other words** in the sentence. English nouns have three cases:

1. **Nominative (Subjective) Case** — the noun is the **subject** of a verb: ***Rahim*** *plays football.*
2. **Objective (Accusative) Case** — the noun is the **object** of a verb or a preposition: *I met* ***Rahim****. I gave it to* ***Rahim****.*
3. **Possessive (Genitive) Case** — the noun shows **ownership/relation**: ***Rahim's*** *pen.*

Nouns have the same form in the nominative and objective cases, so we identify the case only by **position**. (Pronouns change form: *he/him/his* — see Chapter 08.)

- **The boy** hit **the ball**. → *boy*: nominative; *ball*: objective
- **The ball** hit **the boy**. → *ball*: nominative; *boy*: objective
- He gave **the beggar a coin**. → *beggar*: indirect object (dative); *coin*: direct object
- **Karim**, come here. → *Karim*: nominative of address (vocative)
- **The sun** having set, we returned home. → nominative absolute

2.6.1 Forming the Possessive

Rule	Examples
Singular noun → add **'s**	the boy's book, the cat's tail, Rina's dress
Plural ending in **-s** → add only **'**	the boys' hostel, girls' school, the teachers' room
Plural not ending in -s → add **'s**	children's park, men's wear, women's rights, people's demand
Singular ending in -s → **'s** (usual) or **'** (classical names)	James's car / James' car; Keats's poems; *Moses', Jesus', Socrates'* (classical)
Compound noun → **'s** on the **last word**	my mother-in-law's house; the commander-in-chief's order; somebody else's book
Joint possession → **'s** on the **last** name only	Rahim and Karim's shop (one shop owned jointly)
Separate possession → **'s** on **each** name	Rahim's and Karim's shops (two shops)
Long phrase as possessor	the Prime Minister of Bangladesh's speech → better: *the speech of the Prime Minister of Bangladesh*

> **Sake phrases:** Before *sake*, a word ending in an **s**-sound drops the extra *s*: *for* ***goodness'*** *sake, for* ***conscience'*** *sake, for* ***justice'*** *sake*. Otherwise use *'s*: *for* ***God's*** *sake, for* ***heaven's*** *sake, for* ***mercy's*** *sake, for* ***pity's*** *sake.*

2.6.2 When to Use 's and When to Use *of*

1. **'s** is normally used with **living beings**: *the man's hat, the dog's tail, Hasan's house.*
2. With **lifeless things**, use ***of***: *the leg* ***of*** *the table* (✘ the table's leg), *the roof* ***of*** *the house, the cover* ***of*** *the book.*
3. **Exceptions** — the *'s* is also used with:
   - **Personified objects:** *Nature's law, Fortune's favourite, the moon's rays, the sun's heat, England's glory, Bangladesh's economy, the earth's surface, the ship's crew, the nation's pride.*
   - **Time, distance, weight, value:** *a day's journey, a week's holiday, an hour's walk, two years' imprisonment, a stone's throw, a mile's distance, a pound's weight, a hundred taka's worth, today's paper, tomorrow's meeting.*
   - **Fixed phrases:** *at his wits' end, at one's fingers' ends, at arm's length, to one's heart's content, in his mind's eye, for mercy's sake, a hair's breadth, out of harm's way, at death's door, journey's end, the water's edge.*
   - **Organisations and places:** *the government's policy, the company's profit, the university's decision, the city's traffic.*

2.6.3 The Double Possessive and the Elliptical Possessive

Double possessive — *of* + *'s* together — is used to mean "one of several": *He is* ***a friend of my father's*** (= one of my father's friends). *This is* ***a novel of Tagore's****.* With pronouns: *a friend* ***of mine/yours/his/ours****.* (✘ a friend of me)

Elliptical (implied) possessive — the noun after *'s* is understood and omitted: *I bought it at the* ***chemist's*** (= chemist's shop). *I am going to my* ***uncle's*** (= uncle's house). *We prayed at* ***St Paul's*** (= St Paul's Cathedral). *This book is* ***Rahim's****. My pen is better than* ***Karim's****.*

> **Possessive before a gerund (formal style, favoured by GMAT/SAT):** *I don't mind* ***your*** *coming late* (formal) / *I don't mind* ***you*** *coming late* (informal). *We were surprised at* ***Rahim's*** *winning the prize.* (✘ at Rahim winning — informal) In BCS-type error detection, the possessive form is the "correct" answer.

2.6.4 Apposition

A noun placed **beside** another noun to explain it is in **apposition** and is in the **same case**:

- **Mr. Rahman, our headmaster,** is ill. (*headmaster* in apposition to *Mr. Rahman* — nominative)
- I met **Rahim, the captain**. (objective)
- This is **Karim the doctor's** house. (the *'s* goes on the appositive, not on both)

2.7 Functions of a Noun in a Sentence

Function	Example
Subject of a verb	**Birds** fly.
Direct object	He wrote **a letter**.
Indirect object	He wrote **his mother** a letter.
Object of a preposition	He lives in **Khulna**.
Subjective complement	He became **a doctor**.
Objective complement	They made him **captain**. / They elected her **chairman**.
Apposition	Dhaka, **the capital**, is crowded.
Nominative of address	**Friends**, listen to me.
Adjective (noun adjunct)	a **village** road, a **cotton** mill

Function	Example
Adverb (adverbial object)	He walked **ten miles**. He waited **an hour**.

2.8 Common Errors with Nouns

Many of these errors are discussed in detail in Chapters 03 (uncountable nouns) and 06 (number); here are the most common ones made by Bangladeshi learners.

1. ✘ She gave me many advices. ✔ She gave me **much advice / many pieces of advice**.
2. ✘ The sceneries of Sylhet are charming. ✔ The **scenery** of Sylhet **is** charming.
3. ✘ He bought new furnitures. ✔ He bought new **furniture**.
4. ✘ I have many informations. ✔ I have **a lot of information**.
5. ✘ The cattles are grazing. ✔ The **cattle** are grazing.
6. ✘ The police has arrested the thief. ✔ The police **have** arrested the thief.
7. ✘ He is my cousin brother. ✔ He is my **cousin**.
8. ✘ She has two issues. (= children) ✔ She has two **children**. (*issue* = offspring is legal/formal; *issueless* is not standard English → use *childless*)
9. ✘ There was a pin-drop silence. ✔ There was **a silence in which one could hear a pin drop** / **complete silence**. (*pin-drop silence* is Indian/Bangladeshi English)
10. ✘ He gave me a ten-takas note. ✔ … a **ten-taka** note.
11. ✘ I had my hairs cut. ✔ I had my **hair** cut. (*hairs* = individual strands: *There are two grey hairs on his head.*)
12. ✘ The table’s leg is broken. ✔ The **leg of the table** is broken.
13. ✘ This is my brother-in-law’s car. — ✔ correct (the ’s goes on the last word).
14. ✘ He is a friend of me. ✔ He is a friend **of mine**.
15. ✘ He came with his family members. ✔ He came with **his family** (or *members of his family*).
16. ✘ The childrens are playing. ✔ The **children** are playing.
17. ✘ I need a good accommodation. ✔ I need good **accommodation** (BrE uncountable; AmE *accommodations*).
18. ✘ My all friends came. ✔ **All my** friends came.
19. ✘ He is an M.A. in English. — ✔ correct (*an* because “M” is pronounced “em”).
20. ✘ The boys’ hostel’s gate is closed. ✔ The **gate of the boys’ hostel** is closed. (avoid double ’s on things)

2.9 Nouns in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Nominalisation (wordiness). Turning verbs into nouns (*decide → make a decision, consider → give consideration to*) makes sentences heavy. SAT and GMAT prefer the **verb**: ✘ *The committee made a decision to give consideration to the proposal.* ✔ *The committee **decided** to **consider** the proposal.*

Action nouns vs *-ing* nouns (GMAT). When a proper noun form exists, GMAT prefers it to an *-ing* form with *the … of*: ✘ *the developing of new drugs* ✔ *the **development** of new drugs*; ✘ *the constructing of the bridge* ✔ *the **construction** of the bridge.*

Countable vs uncountable quantifiers. *fewer* (countable) vs *less* (uncountable); *number* (countable) vs *amount* (uncountable); *many* vs *much*. ✘ *less cars* ✔ ***fewer** cars*; ✘ *the amount of students* ✔ *the **number** of students.*

Pronoun-noun agreement. A collective noun like *company, team, government* is treated as **singular** in American English (the language of the SAT/GRE/GMAT): ✔ *The company announced **its** results* (✘ *their* results).

Exam Strategy: When asked to identify the *kind* of noun, ask in this order: (1) Is it the name of a **particular** one? → Proper. (2) Is it a **group** spoken of as one? → Collective. (3) Is it a **substance**? → Material. (4) Can it be **seen or touched**? If **not** → Abstract. (5) Otherwise → Common. Remember that **context changes the kind**: *glass* (material) vs *a glass* (common); *beauty* (abstract) vs *a beauty* (common); *Newton* (proper) vs *the Newton of our age* (common).

CHAPTER 03

Uncountable Problems

Part A · Grammar

3.1 Countable and Uncountable Nouns

English nouns fall into two grammatical groups:

- **Countable nouns** (count nouns) name things we can count one by one: *a book, two books; a boy, ten boys; an idea, many ideas*.
- **Uncountable nouns** (non-count or mass nouns) name things we think of as a **mass** or a **whole** that cannot be divided into separate units: *water, rice, sugar, information, advice, furniture, luggage, news*.

The trouble is that the division is **grammatical, not logical**. In Bangla we can say *anek tottho* ("many informations") or *ekta upodesh* ("an advice"), and in many languages *furniture* or *luggage* are countable. In English they are not. That is why examiners in BCS, Bank and admission tests set at least one question on uncountable nouns almost every year — the so-called **"uncountable problems"**.

3.2 The Five Grammar Rules of Uncountable Nouns

An uncountable noun:

1. **never takes *a* or *an***: ✘ *an advice*, ✘ *a furniture*, ✘ *a good news*;
2. **has no plural form**: ✘ *advices, furnitures, informations, luggages, sceneries*;
3. **always takes a singular verb**: *The news **is** good. The furniture **was** expensive.*;
4. is used with **singular pronouns**: *I got the information and passed **it** on* (✘ *them*);
5. takes quantifiers like ***much, little, a little, a great deal of, an amount of, less***, not *many, few, a few, a number of, fewer*.

- ✘ He gave me an advice. ✔ He gave me **some advice / a piece of advice**.
- ✘ The informations are correct. ✔ The **information is** correct.
- ✘ I have many works to do. ✔ I have **a lot of work** to do.
- ✘ How many luggages do you have? ✔ **How much luggage** do you have? / **How many pieces of luggage** …?
- ✘ The sceneries of Bangladesh are beautiful. ✔ The **scenery** of Bangladesh **is** beautiful.

3.3 Main Groups of Uncountable Nouns

Group	Examples
Liquids & gases	water, milk, oil, juice, blood, petrol, air, oxygen, smoke, steam
Solids & materials (mass)	rice, wheat, sugar, salt, sand, dust, flour, gold, iron, wood, paper, glass, cotton, cement, soap, chalk, bread, butter, cheese, meat
Abstract ideas	advice, information, knowledge, evidence, proof (of a fact), progress, research, help, fun, luck, news, work, homework, health, wealth, leisure, patience, courage, honesty, beauty, behaviour, permission, safety, violence, education
"Collective" mass nouns (a set of things seen as one)	furniture, luggage, baggage, equipment, machinery, scenery, poetry, jewellery, stationery, crockery, cutlery, clothing, hardware, software, mail, money, cash, change (coins), traffic, rubbish, garbage, litter, merchandise, produce, foliage, fruit (in general), food, vocabulary (as a mass)
Natural phenomena	weather, thunder, lightning, sunshine, rain, snow, fog, heat, cold, darkness, gravity
Subjects of study	mathematics, physics, economics, politics, statistics, linguistics, history, chemistry, grammar, music, art
Games	chess, cricket, football, billiards, darts, draughts
Diseases	measles, mumps, diabetes, influenza, rickets, malaria
Languages	Bangla, English, Arabic, Japanese

3.4 The Most Tested Uncountable Nouns and How to "Count" Them

To show a single unit or a specific quantity of an uncountable noun, we use a **partitive** (unit) expression: ***a piece of, an item of, a bit of, a slice of, a loaf of, a cup of, a drop of*** etc.

Uncountable noun	✘ Never say	✔ Say instead
advice	an advice, advices	a piece of advice, a word of advice, some advice
information	an information, informations	a piece / an item of information, some information
news	a news	a piece / an item of news, some news
furniture	a furniture, furnitures	a piece / an article / an item of furniture
luggage / baggage	a luggage, luggages	a piece of luggage; (bags / suitcases)
equipment	an equipment, equipments	a piece of equipment
machinery	a machinery, machineries	a machine, a piece of machinery
scenery	a scenery, sceneries	a scene, a view, a landscape, a sight
poetry	a poetry, poetries	a poem, a piece of poetry
jewellery	a jewellery, jewelleries	a piece of jewellery, a jewel
stationery	stationeries	an item of stationery
work	a work (= a task), works	a job, a task, a piece of work

Uncountable noun	✘ Never say	✔ Say instead
homework	a homework, home-works	a homework assignment, a piece of homework
money	a money, moneys	a note, a coin, a sum of money
evidence	an evidence, evidences	a piece of evidence
research	a research, researches (avoid)	a study, a research project, a piece of research
progress	a progress, progresses	some progress, a step forward
knowledge	knowledges	a piece of knowledge; *a good knowledge of* ✔ (see 3.6)
bread	a bread, breads	a loaf / slice / piece of bread
weather	a fine weather	fine weather; *What fine weather!*
travel	a travel (= a trip)	a journey, a trip, a tour, a voyage
accommodation	an accommodation (BrE)	a room, a flat, a place to stay
permission	a permission	permission; a permit (document)
traffic	a traffic, traffics	a vehicle; heavy traffic
behaviour	a behaviour, behaviours (general use)	behaviour; a way of behaving
lightning	a lightning	a flash of lightning
thunder	a thunder	a clap / peal of thunder
luck	a good luck	good luck; a stroke of luck
applause	an applause	a round of applause
grass	a grass, grasses (lawn)	a blade of grass
rain	a rain	a drop of rain, a shower
chess	a chess	a game of chess
music	a music	a piece of music, a song, a tune
clothing	a clothing	an article / item of clothing; a garment
soap	a soap	a bar / cake of soap
chalk	a chalk	a piece / stick of chalk
fun	a fun	some fun; *It was great fun* (✘ a great fun)
employment	an employment	a job
damage	a damage	some damage; *damages* = compensation money
vocabulary	vocabularies (for one person's words)	a word, a term; *a wide vocabulary* ✔
slang	a slang	a slang word / expression
mail / post	a mail	a letter, a parcel
garbage / rubbish	a rubbish	a piece of rubbish
hair (on head)	hairs (all hair on head)	hair; *a hair* = one strand ✔
wood (material)	a wood	a piece of wood; *a wood* = small forest ✔
toast	a toast (bread)	a slice / piece of toast; *a toast* = a drink to honour someone ✔
strength	—	*strengths* ✔ = strong points
health, wealth	a good health	good health (✘ a good health)

Exam Tip — The "big eleven": Learn these eleven as the most frequently tested in Bangladesh: ***advice, information, news, furniture, luggage/baggage, equipment, machinery, scenery, poetry, jewellery, stationery***. If any of them appears with *a/an*, a plural *-s*, *many*, *few*, *several* or a plural verb, the sentence is wrong. Also remember: ***alphabet*** is countable but means the whole set of letters: ✘ *There are 26 alphabets in English.* ✔ *There are 26* ***letters*** *in the English alphabet.*

3.5 Countable in One Sense, Uncountable in Another

Many nouns change their grammar when their meaning changes. These pairs are favourites of question-setters, because the "wrong-looking" form may actually be right.

Uncountable meaning	Countable meaning
experience = knowledge/skill from doing: *He has* ***a lot of experience*** *in banking.*	**an experience** = an event: *Visiting Sundarbans was* ***an*** *exciting* ***experience****.*
time = the dimension: *I have no* ***time****.*	**a time / times** = occasions; periods: *I have told you* ***three times****. We had* ***a*** *good* ***time****. In* ***ancient times****.*
paper = material: *a sheet of* ***paper***	**a paper** = newspaper, research article, exam paper: *He read* ***a paper*** *at the seminar.* **papers** = documents
glass = material	**a glass** = drinking vessel; **glasses** = spectacles
iron = metal	**an iron** = appliance for pressing clothes; **irons** = fetters
light = brightness: *There is not enough* ***light****.*	**a light** = a lamp: *Turn off* ***the lights****.*
hair = all hair on the head: *She has long black* ***hair****.*	**a hair / hairs** = individual strands: *There is* ***a hair*** *in my soup.*
business = trade in general: ***Business*** *is slow.*	**a business** = a company: *He runs* ***two businesses****.*
room = space: *Is there* ***room*** *for me?*	**a room** = a part of a house: *a house with* ***five rooms***
work = labour, a job: *He is at* ***work****.*	**a work / works** = creative product; factory: *the* ***works*** *of Tagore; a steel* ***works***
noise = general sound: *Don't make* ***noise****.*	**a noise** = a particular sound: *I heard* ***a*** *strange* ***noise****.*
coffee / tea = the drink	**a coffee / two teas** = a cup / cups of it (informal)
chicken / fish / lamb = meat	**a chicken / fish** = the animal; ***fishes*** = species of fish
stone = material	**a stone** = a pebble; a unit of weight
wood = material	**a wood / the woods** = small forest
language = human communication	**a language** = Bangla, English etc.
education = learning in general	**a good education** = a particular person's learning ✔
success / failure in general	**a success / a failure** = a successful/failed thing or person
crime = illegal activity in general	**a crime** = a particular illegal act
sound = what we hear in general	**a sound** = a particular sound
cake = the substance: *some* ***cake***	**a cake** = a whole cake
democracy = the system	**a democracy** = a democratic country
youth = the period of being young	**a youth** = a young man

Uncountable meaning	Countable meaning
beauty = the quality	**a beauty** = a beautiful woman/thing
kindness = the quality	**a kindness** = a kind act
lunch / dinner (general): *We had **lunch**.*	**a** good **lunch** (with adjective) ✔

3.6 *A / An* + Adjective + Abstract Noun

A special and tricky rule: some abstract uncountable nouns **can take *a/an*** when they are **qualified by an adjective** or followed by a defining phrase (*of …*) and refer to a particular **type or instance**.

- She has **a good knowledge of** English. ✔ (✘ She has good knowledges)
- He received **a** good **education** at Dhaka University. ✔
- We live **a** quiet **life**. ✔
- He has **a** great **love of** music. ✔
- She showed **a** remarkable **patience**. ✔ (acceptable; *remarkable patience* is also correct)
- They gave us **a** warm **welcome**. ✔
- There was **a** long **silence**. ✔
- He has **a** strong **dislike** of cats. ✔
- They have **a** high **standard of living**. ✔
- He fell into **a** deep **sleep**. ✔

> **But this rule does NOT apply to the "big eleven" and some others.** Even with an adjective, you cannot say ✘ *a good advice*, ✘ *a useful information*, ✘ *a good news*, ✘ *a heavy luggage*, ✘ *a fine weather*, ✘ *a great progress*, ✘ *a strong evidence*, ✘ *a valuable furniture*, ✘ *a good luck*, ✘ *a heavy traffic*, ✘ *a great fun*, ✘ *a good health*, ✘ *a bad behaviour*, ✘ *a hard work*, ✘ *a permission*. Use them without *a/an*: *good advice, useful information, good news, heavy luggage, fine weather, great progress.*

3.7 Nouns That Are Always Plural

The opposite problem: some nouns exist **only in the plural** and take a **plural verb**. They have no singular form in that meaning.

Type	Examples	Correct use
Two-part things (tools, clothes)	scissors, spectacles, glasses, trousers, pants, jeans, shorts, pyjamas, tights, pliers, tongs, binoculars, scales	*My scissors **are** blunt.* To count: ***a pair of** scissors, **two pairs of** trousers*
Plural-only nouns	goods, thanks, riches, premises, outskirts, surroundings, belongings, savings, earnings, wages, remains, contents, clothes, proceeds, congratulations, credentials, valuables, archives, annals, dregs, ashes (of the dead), arms (weapons), amends, alms, tidings, entrails, eaves	*The goods **have** arrived. My belongings **are** in the bag. Many thanks **are** due to you.*
Collective plurals without -s	people, police, cattle, poultry, vermin, gentry, clergy, peasantry	*The police **are** investigating. Cattle **are** grazing. People **are** waiting.*

- ✘ This scissor is sharp. ✔ These **scissors are** sharp. / This **pair of scissors is** sharp. (verb agrees with *pair*)
- ✘ He wears a spectacle. ✔ He wears **spectacles** / **a pair of spectacles**.
- ✘ The premise of the school is clean. ✔ The **premises** of the school **are** clean. (*premise* singular = a basic idea in an argument)
- ✘ The outskirt of the city ✔ the **outskirts** of the city
- ✘ He offered a thank. ✔ He offered **his thanks**. / ✔ **Thanks are** due to you.
- ✘ The cattles / polices / peoples are … ✔ The **cattle / police / people** are …

> **People vs peoples:** *people* = persons (plural): *Ten **people** were injured. A people / peoples* = a nation / nations: *the **peoples** of Asia* (= the different nations). Both are correct in the right meaning. **Arms** (weapons) is plural-only; **arm** (body part) is normal: *two arms*. **Means** is the same in singular and plural: *a means of transport / all possible means.*

3.8 Nouns That Look Plural but Are Singular (Uncountable)

These end in *-s* but take a **singular** verb (details in Chapters 06 and 23):

- **News:** *The news **is** good.* (✘ The news are …)
- **Subjects:** *mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, statistics, linguistics, phonetics, civics, electronics — Mathematics **is** my favourite subject.* (When they mean practical matters/qualities, they can be plural: *His politics **are** confusing. The statistics **show** a rise.*)
- **Diseases:** *measles, mumps, rickets, diabetes, shingles — Measles **is** infectious.*
- **Games:** *billiards, darts, draughts, dominoes — Billiards **is** played on a table.*
- **Others:** *innings, gallows, series, species, means, summons, works (factory), headquarters, crossroads — An innings **was** played. A summons **was** issued.*

3.9 Quantifiers: Countable vs Uncountable

This table is the heart of the chapter. Errors in *much/many, few/little, fewer/less, number/amount* appear in every type of exam.

With countable plurals	With uncountables	With both
many	much	some, any
few, a few, very few	little, a little, very little	a lot of, lots of, plenty of
fewer, fewest	less, least	enough, no, all, most
a number of, a large number of	an amount of, a large amount of, a great deal of, a good deal of	more, most
several, both, a couple of	a quantity of (also with plural)	half of, none of
each, every (+ singular)	a bit of, a piece of	the rest of
how many?	how much?	

- How **many** books? / How **much** money?
- **Many** students / **Much** effort
- **A number of** people **were** absent. / **A great deal of** time **was** wasted.
- **Fewer** accidents / **Less** pollution
- **Several** chairs / **A piece of** furniture

3.9.1 *Few, A Few, The Few / Little, A Little, The Little*

This trio is tested very often. The difference is in **attitude**:

Word	Meaning	Example
few (countable)	almost none — **negative**	***Few*** *people attended the meeting.* (= hardly anyone; disappointing)
a few (countable)	some, a small number — **positive**	*I have **a few** friends in Dhaka.* (= some friends; enough)
the few (countable)	the small number that exists — **all of them**	*I spent **the few** taka I had.* (= all the little money I had)
little (uncountable)	almost none — **negative**	*There is **little** hope of his recovery.* (= almost no hope)
a little (uncountable)	some, a small amount — **positive**	*There is **a little** milk in the jug.*
the little (uncountable)	the small amount that exists — **all of it**	*He spent **the little** money he had.*

- ✘ A little knowledge is a dangerous thing — ✔ correct proverb (some knowledge, but not enough, is dangerous).
- He has **few** friends, so he is lonely. (negative)
- He has **a few** friends, so he is not lonely. (positive)
- I gave him **the few** books I had. (all my books, though not many)
- **Little** water is left; we must save it. / There is **little** time left.
- ✘ He has a little friends. ✔ He has **a few** friends.
- ✘ There are few water in the bottle. ✔ There is **little** water in the bottle.

> **Exam Tip — Negative test:** *Few/little* can be replaced by *hardly any / not many / not much*: *Few came = Hardly anyone came*. *A few/a little* can be replaced by *some*: *A few came = Some came*. If the sentence has a **"but / so / therefore"** that shows disappointment, choose *few/little*: *He tried hard, but **few** listened.* If it shows something positive, choose *a few/a little*: *Don't worry — we still have **a little** time.*

3.9.2 *Fewer* vs *Less*; *Number* vs *Amount*

> ***Fewer*** and ***number*** are for **countable** nouns; ***less*** and ***amount*** are for **uncountable** nouns.

- ✘ Less people came this year. ✔ **Fewer** people came this year.
- ✔ There is **less** traffic on Fridays.
- ✘ The amount of students has increased. ✔ The **number** of students has increased.
- ✔ The **amount** of rainfall has decreased.
- ✘ He made less mistakes. ✔ He made **fewer** mistakes.
- Exception by convention: with **time, money, distance, weight** seen as one sum, *less* is used: ***less than** 10 kilometres; **less than** 500 taka; **less than** two hours.* Also *less than 5 per cent.*

3.9.3 *Much* and *Many* in Positive Sentences

In modern English, *much* and *many* are most natural in **questions** and **negatives**; in positive statements, *a lot of / lots of / plenty of / a great deal of* sounds more natural. *Much* in positive statements is formal: *Much has been written about the war. I owe him much.* But *very much, too much, so much, as much* are normal everywhere: *I like it **very much**.*

3.10 Agreement with Quantity Expressions

- **A number of** students **are** absent. (= many; plural verb)
- **The number of** students **is** increasing. (the number itself; singular verb)
- **A lot of** water **is** wasted. / **A lot of** people **are** waiting. (verb follows the noun after *of*)
- **Plenty of** food **is** available. / **Plenty of** chairs **are** available.
- **Some of** the money **was** stolen. / **Some of** the boys **were** late.
- **None of** the information **is** useful. / **None of** the students **is/are** present (formal: *is*).
- **Most of** the furniture **is** new. / **Most of** the chairs **are** new.
- **Half of** the cake **has** been eaten. / **Half of** the eggs **are** rotten.

3.11 Common Errors with Uncountable Nouns

1. ✘ He gave me a good advice. ✔ He gave me **good advice / a good piece of advice**.
2. ✘ We bought many furnitures. ✔ We bought **a lot of furniture / many pieces of furniture**.
3. ✘ The news are true. ✔ The news **is** true.
4. ✘ Informations are given below. ✔ **Information is** given below. / **Details are** given below.
5. ✘ Our luggages have been lost. ✔ Our **luggage has** been lost.
6. ✘ The sceneries of Rangamati are beautiful. ✔ The **scenery** of Rangamati **is** beautiful.
7. ✘ She bought many jewelleries. ✔ She bought **a lot of jewellery**.
8. ✘ He has written many poetries. ✔ He has written **many poems / a lot of poetry**.
9. ✘ The machineries are old. ✔ The **machinery is** old. / The **machines are** old.
10. ✘ I have no more works today. ✔ I have no more **work** today.
11. ✘ He has done many researches. ✔ He has done **a lot of research / many studies**.
12. ✘ We had a fine weather. ✔ We had **fine weather**.
13. ✘ She has long hairs. ✔ She has long **hair**.
14. ✘ He made a great progress. ✔ He made **great progress**.
15. ✘ The police has come. ✔ The police **have** come.
16. ✘ There are less students today. ✔ There are **fewer** students today.
17. ✘ The amount of cars is huge. ✔ The **number** of cars is huge.
18. ✘ I have a few money. ✔ I have **a little** money.
19. ✘ He did a lot of mischiefs. ✔ He did **a lot of mischief**.
20. ✘ I want an information. ✔ I want **some information / a piece of information**.
21. ✘ Give me a paper to write on. ✔ Give me **a sheet / piece of paper**.
22. ✘ We need equipments. ✔ We need **equipment**.
23. ✘ He bought two breads. ✔ He bought **two loaves of bread**.
24. ✘ This is a strong evidence. ✔ This is **strong evidence / a strong piece of evidence**.
25. ✘ My trouser is torn. ✔ My **trousers are** torn.
26. ✘ He has much friends. ✔ He has **many** friends.
27. ✘ I have lost my all moneys. ✔ I have lost **all my money**.
28. ✘ The stationeries are on the table. ✔ The **stationery is** on the table.
29. ✘ It was a great fun. ✔ It was **great fun**.
30. ✘ There are twenty six alphabets in English. ✔ There are twenty-six **letters** in the English alphabet.

3.12 Uncountable Nouns in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

GMAT Sentence Correction regularly tests **quantity words**: *fewer/less*, *number/amount*, *many/much*, and the use of *numbers* with uncountables. Typical traps:

- ✘ *The new law will result in less traffic accidents.* ✔ *… **fewer** traffic accidents* (accidents are countable).
- ✘ *An increasing amount of consumers prefer online shopping.* ✔ *An increasing **number** of consumers …*
- ✘ *The company has reduced the number of waste it produces.* ✔ *… the **amount** of waste …*
- *Increase / decrease* with numbers: *The **number** of accidents **increased*** ✔ (✘ *The accidents increased in number* is wordy but acceptable).
- **Data**: in formal American usage, *data* is often treated as **plural** (*The data **are** reliable*) though singular is now common. **Criteria** and **phenomena** are always plural (*these criteria*; singular: *criterion, phenomenon*). See Chapter 06.

In GRE Reading Comprehension, the difference between *few* (negative) and *a few* (positive) can decide the **author's attitude** — a frequent question type.

CHAPTER 04

Determiner

Part A · Grammar

4.1 What Is a Determiner?

A **determiner** is a word placed **before a noun** (and before any adjectives that describe the noun) to **limit or specify** it. It tells us *which* one, *whose*, *how many* or *how much*.

- **the** book, **a** pen, **an** apple (articles)
- **this** house, **those** trees (demonstratives)
- **my** father, **their** school (possessives)
- **some** water, **many** people, **every** student (quantifiers)
- **three** boys, **the first** day (numbers)
- **which** road? **whose** bag? (interrogatives)

Traditional grammar (the grammar followed in most Bangladeshi textbooks) calls these words **adjectives** — *demonstrative adjectives, possessive adjectives, adjectives of number, adjectives of quantity, distributive adjectives* and *interrogative adjectives*. Modern grammar (and international tests) places them in a separate class because they behave differently from true adjectives.

4.1.1 Determiner vs Adjective

Feature	Determiner	Adjective
Position	Comes **first** in the noun phrase	Comes **after** the determiner
Comparison	Cannot be compared (✘ *more this*)	Usually has degrees (*tall, taller, tallest*)
Very	Cannot take *very* (✘ *very my*)	Can take *very* (*very tall*)
Predicative use	Cannot follow *be* (✘ *The book is my*)	Can follow *be* (*The book is new*)
Number allowed	Usually only **one** central determiner (✘ *the my book*)	Many adjectives can be stacked (*a big old red bus*)

- **My** new red car ✔ (determiner + adjective + adjective + noun)
- ✘ The my car / ✘ My the car / ✘ A my friend → ✔ **my** car / ✔ **a friend of mine**
- ✘ This my book → ✔ **this book of mine**

4.2 Kinds of Determiners

Kind	Members
Articles	a, an, the
Demonstratives	this, that, these, those
Possessives	my, your, his, her, its, our, their, whose, one's; noun + 's (*Rahim's*)
Quantifiers	some, any, no, much, many, more, most, little, less, least, few, fewer, fewest, several, enough, all, both, half, a lot of, plenty of
Distributives	each, every, either, neither
Numbers	cardinals (*one, two, hundred*), ordinals (*first, second, last*)
Multiplicatives & fractions	double, twice, three times, half, one-third
Interrogatives	what, which, whose
Exclamatives	what (a), such (a)
Others	another, other, such, quite, rather

4.3 The Order of Determiners

When more than one determiner comes before a noun, they follow a fixed order:

1. **Pre-determiners:** *all, both, half, double, twice, three times, such, what, quite, rather*
2. **Central determiners:** *a, an, the, this, that, these, those, my, your, his, some, any, no, each, every, either, neither, whose, which*
3. **Post-determiners:** cardinal and ordinal numbers, *many, much, few, little, several, other, last, next, more*

- **all the** students (pre + central)
- **both my** parents (pre + central) — ✘ my both parents
- **half an** hour (pre + central) — ✘ a half an hour
- **twice the** price (pre + central)
- **such a** beautiful day (pre + central)
- **what a** pity!
- **quite a** few people / **rather a** long time
- **the first two** chapters (central + ordinal + cardinal) — ✘ the two first chapters
- **my last few** days (central + post + post)
- **these three** books / **all these three** books
- **the other** day / **every other** day (= on alternate days)

> **Exam Tip — "My all friends" is the most common determiner error in Bangladesh.** *All, both* and *half* come **before** *the / my / these*: ✔ ***All my*** *friends*, ✔ ***both the*** *boys*, ✔ ***half the*** *money*. Also correct: ***all of my*** *friends*, ***both of the*** *boys*, ***half of the*** *money*. With pronouns, *of* is required: ***all of us***, ***both of them*** (✘ *all us*), or place *all/both* after the pronoun: *We* ***all*** *went. They* ***both*** *came.*

4.4 Demonstratives: *This, That, These, Those*

	Near (here / now)	Far (there / then)
Singular & uncountable	this	that
Plural	these	those

- **This** pen is mine; **that** pen over there is yours.
- **These** mangoes are sweeter than **those** (mangoes).
- I remember **those** days. (past time = "far")
- **This** week / **this** morning (present time)

> ***That of / Those of* in comparisons:** To avoid repeating a noun in a comparison, use ***that of*** for a singular/uncountable noun and ***those of*** for a plural noun. ✘ *The climate of Sylhet is cooler than Dhaka.* ✔ *The climate of Sylhet is cooler than* ***that of*** *Dhaka.* ✘ *The houses of the rich are bigger than the poor.* ✔ *… bigger than* ***those of*** *the poor.*

> ***Kind / sort / type*:** *This kind of book* ✔ / *These kinds of books* ✔ / ✘ *These kind of books*. The demonstrative agrees with *kind*, not with the noun after *of*.

4.5 Possessive Determiners

My, your, his, her, its, our, their, whose (and a noun + ’s) show ownership. They agree with the **possessor**, not the thing possessed: *Rahim and **his** sister; Rina and **her** brother; the tree and **its** leaves; the students and **their** books.*

- ✘ The company announced it’s profits. ✔ The company announced **its** profits. (*it’s = it is / it has*)
- ✘ The students left there bags. ✔ … **their** bags. (*there* = in that place)
- ✘ Who’s book is this? ✔ **Whose** book is this? (*who’s = who is / who has*)
- **Each** of the girls brought **her** own lunch. (agrees with *each*, singular)

Possessive vs *the* with parts of the body. After a verb + object, English uses *the* (not a possessive) for the body part in expressions of hitting, touching, holding etc.: *He hit me **on the** head. She caught him **by the** arm. He looked me **in the** eye.* But: *I washed **my** face. He broke **his** leg.*

Own strengthens a possessive: *my **own** house* (✘ an own house), *a house of **my own**, on **my own*** (= alone).

4.6 *Some, Any, No, None*

Determiner	Typical use	Examples
some	positive sentences; offers and requests	*I have **some** money. Would you like **some** tea? Can I have **some** water?*
any	negatives and questions; *if*-clauses; = “it doesn’t matter which”	*I don’t have **any** money. Do you have **any** questions? If you need **any** help, call me. **Any** child can do this.*
no	= not any (before a noun)	*I have **no** money* (= I don’t have any money).
none	pronoun = not one / not any (stands alone or with *of*)	***None** of the students passed. I wanted some tea, but there was **none**.*

- ✘ I didn’t buy no books. ✔ I didn’t buy **any** books. / I bought **no** books. (avoid double negatives)
- ✘ I have none money. ✔ I have **no** money. (*none* is a pronoun; *no* is the determiner)
- *Hardly any, scarcely any, barely any*: ***Hardly any** students came.* (✘ hardly no)
- *Some* in questions expecting “yes”: *Did you buy **some** fruit?* (I think you did.)

4.7 Distributives: *Each, Every, Either, Neither*

Distributives take a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**.

4.7.1 *Each* vs *Every*

- ***Each*** is used for **two or more** things taken **one by one** (individually).
- ***Every*** is used for **three or more** things taken **as a group** (all of them, without exception).

- She had a ring on **each** hand. (two hands → *each*; ✘ every hand)
- **Every** student in the class passed. (all, as a group)
- **Each** student was given a separate question. (individually)
- **Each of** the boys has a bicycle. (✘ Every of the boys → ✔ **Every one of** the boys)
- *Every* + number: *The buses leave **every** ten minutes. I visit him **every** two weeks / **every other** week.*
- *Each and every* is emphatic and singular: ***Each and every** citizen **has** a duty.*

> **Everyone vs every one:** *Everyone* (one word) = everybody: ***Everyone** was happy. Every one* (two words) = each single one, usually with *of*: ***Every one of** the eggs was broken.* Similarly, *any one* (= any single one) vs *anyone* (= anybody).

4.7.2 *Either* vs *Neither*

Either (= one or the other of **two**) and ***neither*** (= not one and not the other of **two**) are used only for **two**. For more than two, use ***any*** and ***none / no***.

- You can take **either** road; both lead to the station.
- **Neither** answer **is** correct. (✘ are)
- **Either of** the two brothers **is** responsible.
- ✘ Either of these five roads leads to Dhaka. ✔ **Any** of these five roads leads to Dhaka.
- ✘ Neither of the ten students passed. ✔ **None** of the ten students passed.
- *Either* can mean “both” with *side, end, bank, hand*: *There are trees on **either side** of the road* (= on both sides).

4.8 *All, Both, Whole, Half*

- **All** + plural countable: ***All** boys like games.* / ***All the** boys of this class are present.*
- **All** + uncountable: ***All the** money was spent. **All** milk contains fat.*
- **Both** = the two together: ***Both** (the) brothers are doctors.* (✘ the both brothers)
- **Both … and** joins two items: ***Both** Rahim **and** Karim came.* (✘ Both Rahim as well as Karim)
- **The whole** + singular countable noun: ***the whole** city, **the whole** day, **the whole** world* = **all** the city / day.
- **Whole** is not used with uncountable nouns or plurals: ✘ *the whole money* → ✔ ***all the** money*; ✘ *the whole students* → ✔ ***all the** students*. (*whole* + plural = “complete, not partial”: *Whole villages were destroyed* ✔.)
- **Half:** ***half an** hour* (✘ a half an hour; ✔ *a half-hour* in AmE); ***half the** money*; ***one and a half** hours* (plural noun) / ***an hour and a half***.

4.9 *Another, Other, Others, The Other*

Word	Used with	Example
another (= an + other)	**singular** countable noun; “one more” or “a different one”	*Give me **another** cup of tea. Let’s meet **another** day.* (✘ another books)
another + number + plural	“an additional quantity”	*I need **another** five days / **another** 500 taka.* ✔
other	plural or uncountable nouns	***Other** students were absent. **Other** information is given below.*
the other	the remaining one(s) of a known set	*One of my brothers is a doctor; **the other** is an engineer. / **The other** students were sent home.*

Word	Used with	Example
others (pronoun)	stands alone, = other people/things	*Some people like tea; **others** like coffee.* (✘ others people)
the others	the remaining ones (pronoun)	*Rahim stayed; **the others** left.*
each other	two persons (traditional rule)	*Rahim and Karim love **each other**.*
one another	more than two (traditional rule)	*The students helped **one another**.*

> **Each other vs one another:** Traditional grammar (followed in BCS and admission tests) says *each other* for **two** and *one another* for **more than two**. Modern usage treats them as interchangeable, but in a Bangladeshi exam, follow the traditional rule.

4.10 *Much, Many, Few, Little, More, Most, Enough, Several*

The countable/uncountable choice is covered in Chapter 03. Some additional points:

- ***Most** people* ✔ (= people in general) / ***Most of the** people in this village* ✔ / ✘ *Most of people*.
- ***The most*** is the superlative of *much/many*: *Who has **the most** money?*
- ***Several*** = more than two but not many; countable plural only: ***several** times* (✘ several money).
- ***Enough*** comes **before** a noun and **after** an adjective/adverb: ***enough** money; old **enough**; fast **enough***. (✘ enough old)
- ***More*** + noun / ***more of*** + determiner: ***more** rice; **more of the** rice*. ***Many more** books* / ***much more** money* (✘ much more books).
- ***A lot of / lots of / plenty of*** work with both kinds: ***a lot of** time* / ***a lot of** friends.*

4.11 Numbers as Determiners

- **Cardinals:** *one, two, a hundred, two thousand — three boys, a hundred taka*.
- **Ordinals:** *first, second, third, last, next* — usually with *the*: ***the first** day, **the second** chapter*. Ordinals come before cardinals: ***the first three** chapters* (✘ the three first).
- **Hundred, thousand, million, dozen, score** have **no -s** after a number: ***two hundred** people, **three dozen** eggs, **five million** taka* (✘ two hundreds people). With *of* and no number they take *-s*: ***hundreds of** people, **dozens of** eggs, **millions of** dollars.*
- **Number + noun as an adjective** is singular and hyphenated: *a **five-year** plan, a **ten-taka** note, a **two-hour** journey*.
- ***One of the*** + plural noun: ***one of the** best **players*** (✘ one of the best player).

4.12 Multiplicatives and Fractions

- ***Twice / three times / double + the / my / his*** + noun: *He earns **twice my** salary. This box is **three times the** size of that one. Prices have risen to **double the** old level.*
- **Comparison with *as … as*:** *This road is **twice as long as** that one.* (✘ twice longer than — avoid in formal tests)
- **Fractions:** ***one-third of** the students, **three-quarters of** the land, **half of** the work*. The verb agrees with the noun after *of*: *Two-thirds of the land **is** cultivated; two-thirds of the farmers **are** poor.*

4.13 Interrogative and Exclamative Determiners

- ***What*** = from an open choice: ***What** book are you reading?*
- ***Which*** = from a limited choice: ***Which** book do you want — the red one or the blue one?*
- ***Whose*** = possession: ***Whose** car is this?*
- ***What a*** + singular countable: ***What a** beautiful day!* / ***What*** + uncountable or plural: ***What** fine weather! **What** lovely flowers!* (✘ What a fine weather!)
- ***Such a*** + adj + singular countable: *He is **such a** nice man.* / ***Such*** + uncountable/plural: ***such** lovely music, **such** good friends*.
- ***Quite a / rather a / a rather***: ***quite a** good film; **rather a** long time / **a rather** long time*.

4.14 Common Errors with Determiners

1. ✘ My all friends came. ✔ **All my** friends came.
2. ✘ The both brothers are doctors. ✔ **Both the** brothers / **Both** brothers are doctors.
3. ✘ Every students passed. ✔ **Every student** passed.
4. ✘ Each of the boys have a pen. ✔ Each of the boys **has** a pen.
5. ✘ Either of the three roads … ✔ **Any** of the three roads …
6. ✘ He gave me another books. ✔ He gave me **another book** / **other books**.
7. ✘ Some people like tea; other like coffee. ✔ … **others** like coffee.
8. ✘ These kind of mangoes are sweet. ✔ **This kind** of mango **is** sweet. / **These kinds** of mangoes are sweet.
9. ✘ The population of Dhaka is larger than Chattogram. ✔ … larger than **that of** Chattogram.
10. ✘ He spent the whole money. ✔ He spent **all the** money.
11. ✘ I waited for a half an hour. ✔ I waited for **half an hour**.
12. ✘ Two hundreds people were present. ✔ Two **hundred** people were present.
13. ✘ The two first chapters are easy. ✔ The **first two** chapters are easy.
14. ✘ She is one of the best singer. ✔ She is one of the best **singers**.
15. ✘ He is enough strong. ✔ He is **strong enough**.
16. ✘ Most of people are honest. ✔ **Most people** are honest.
17. ✘ I have not got no money. ✔ I have **no** money. / I have not got **any** money.
18. ✘ What a fine weather! ✔ **What fine weather!**
19. ✘ The dog wagged it's tail. ✔ The dog wagged **its** tail.
20. ✘ This is the my book. ✔ This is **my** book.
21. ✘ A my friend told me. ✔ **A friend of mine** told me.
22. ✘ Every one of the boys were present. ✔ Every one of the boys **was** present.
23. ✘ He hit me on my head. ✔ He hit me **on the** head.
24. ✘ Both Rahim as well as Karim came. ✔ **Both** Rahim **and** Karim came.
25. ✘ Neither of the two answers are correct. ✔ Neither of the two answers **is** correct.

4.15 Determiners in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Ambiguous *this / that / it*:** GMAT marks a sentence wrong if a demonstrative or pronoun could refer to two different nouns. ✘ *The manager told the clerk that **this** was a problem* (what was?). Make the reference clear: … *that **the delay** was a problem*.
- ***That of / those of*** is a standard GMAT fix for **illogical comparisons**: ✘ *The GDP of Bangladesh grew faster than Pakistan.* ✔ *… faster than **that of** Pakistan.*
- ***Each / every*** + singular verb and singular pronoun: ✔ *Each of the companies **has** submitted **its** report.*
- ***Number / amount, fewer / less*** (Chapter 03) and ***between / among*** (Chapter 17) are tested together with determiners.
- SAT Writing often tests **possessive determiners vs contractions**: *its/it's, their/they're/there, whose/who's, your/you're*.

CHAPTER 05

Article

Part A · Grammar

5.1 What Is an Article?

A, ***an*** and ***the*** are called **articles**. They are the most commonly used words in English, and they are really a kind of **determiner** (traditional grammar calls them *demonstrative adjectives*). They come before nouns and tell us whether the noun is **general** or **particular**.

- ***A / An*** — the **indefinite article**: it points to **any one** (not a particular one) person or thing. *Give me **a** pen* (any pen).
- ***The*** — the **definite article**: it points to a **particular** person or thing that both speaker and listener know. *Give me **the** pen* (the one we both know about).

Bangla has no articles in the English sense (we use *ṭa*, *ṭi*, *khana* or nothing), so Bangladeshi learners often omit articles or use them where English does not. Article questions appear in almost every BCS, Bank and admission test as fill-in-the-gaps and error-detection items.

5.2 *A* or *An*? — The Sound Rule

The choice between *a* and *an* depends on the **sound** of the next word, **not its spelling**. Use ***an*** before a word that begins with a **vowel sound** (*a, e, i, o, u* sounds), and ***a*** before a word that begins with a **consonant sound** — including the "y" sound (/j/) and the "w" sound (/w/).

5.2.1 Vowel Letters with Consonant Sounds → *A*

Word begins with …	Sound	Examples
u pronounced "you"	/j/	**a** university, **a** union, **a** uniform, **a** unique, **a** unit, **a** useful book, **a** usual, **a** utensil, **a** U-turn, **a** UN official, **a** US citizen
eu pronounced "you"	/j/	**a** European, **a** eulogy, **a** euphemism, **a** eunuch
ewe	/j/	**a** ewe (female sheep)
o pronounced "wa"	/w/	**a** one-eyed man, **a** one-taka coin, **a** one-way road, **a** once-famous actor

5.2.2 Consonant Letters with Vowel Sounds → *An*

Word begins with …	Sound	Examples
Silent *h*	vowel	**an** hour, **an** honest man, **an** honour, **an** honourable person, **an** heir, **an** heiress, **an** honorarium, **an** hourly bus
Letters *F, H, L, M, N, R, S, X* said as letters	"ef, aitch, el, em, en, ar, es, ex"	**an** M.A., **an** MBBS doctor, **an** MP, **an** SSC candidate, **an** HSC examinee, **an** LLB, **an** FIR, **an** X-ray, **an** NGO, **an** S.I., **an** L-shaped room, **an** honours student, **an** RAB officer (if spelled out as R-A-B)

5.2.3 Consonant Letters with Consonant Sounds → *A*

Example	Reason
a house, **a** horse, **a** hotel, **a** hospital, **a** hero, **a** historic event	*h* is pronounced (*an hotel / an historic* are old-fashioned British forms)
a B.A., **a** B.Sc., **a** BCS cadre, **a** CNG, **a** DC, **a** VIP, **a** JSC examinee	the letter names begin with consonant sounds ("bee, see, dee, vee, jay")
a NATO base, **a** UNESCO report	acronyms read as words begin with consonant sounds ("nay-toe", "you-nes-co")

- **An** honest man is respected everywhere.
- He is **an** M.A. in English and **a** B.A. in history.
- She is **a** university teacher.
- I waited for **an** hour.
- He is **a** one-eyed man.
- **An** NGO worker came to the village.
- It is **a** useful book. / It is **an** unusual book. / It is **an** umbrella.
- **A** European came to visit **an** Asian country.

Exam Tip: Say the word aloud. If your mouth starts with a vowel sound, use *an*; otherwise, *a*. The most tested items are: ***an hour, an honest, an heir, an honour, an M.A., an MP, an SSC, an X-ray, an FIR*** and ***a university, a European, a one-eyed, a union, a useful, a uniform, a U-turn***.

5.3 Uses of the Indefinite Article (*A / An*)

5.3.1 Main Rules

1. **Before a singular countable noun mentioned for the first time** or not identified: *I saw **a** tiger in the zoo. **The** tiger was sleeping.* (first mention → *a*; second mention → *the*)
2. **In the sense of "one":** ***a** dozen eggs, **a** hundred taka, **a** thousand people, **a** day or two, **a** week.* ✘ *Wait one minute* is acceptable; ✔ *Wait **a** minute* is more natural.
3. **To show profession, nationality, religion or class (as a complement):** *He is **a** doctor. She is **an** engineer. He is **a** Bangladeshi. He is **a** Muslim.* (✘ He is doctor.)
4. **In the sense of "per / each":** *Taka 60 **a** kilo; twice **a** day; 80 kilometres **an** hour; three times **a** week.*
5. **To represent a whole class (any one example):** ***A** cow is a useful animal* (= any cow). ***A** child needs love.*
6. **In exclamations with *what* and *such* + singular countable:** ***What a** lovely garden! He is **such a** fool!*
7. **Before a proper noun to mean "a certain" or "one like":** ***A** Mr. Karim came to see you* (= a man called Mr. Karim, unknown to me). *He is **a** second Hatem Tai* (= a generous man like Hatem Tai).
8. **With *many, quite, rather, half*:** ***Many a** man **has** done it* (singular noun and verb). *It was **quite a** good film. It was **rather a** long day. **Half an** hour.*
9. **With illnesses that are countable:** ***a** cold, **a** headache, **a** fever, **a** toothache, **a** stomachache, **a** heart attack, **a** sore throat.* (✘ I have headache.) Uncountable illnesses: *diabetes, cancer, malaria, measles* (no *a*).

10. **With an uncountable or abstract noun qualified by an adjective** (Chapter 03.6): ***a*** *good knowledge of,* ***a*** *sound education,* ***a*** *happy life,* ***a*** *warm welcome*.

5.3.2 Fixed Expressions with *A / An*

Learn these phrases; examiners often drop the article and ask you to supply it.

Phrase	Phrase	Phrase
a lot of	a great deal of	a great many
a few / a little	a couple of	a number of
in a hurry	at a loss	as a rule
in a nutshell	at a stretch	at a glance
all of a sudden	at a time	in a body
make a noise	make a mistake	make a fortune
take a seat	take a walk	take a bath
have a look	have a mind to	have a good time
catch a cold	tell a lie	keep a secret
a short while ago	a long time	It is a pity / a shame
come to an end	put an end to	a matter of time
to a great extent	on an average	in a way

> Some words in this list cannot be used without *a*: ✘ *in hurry*, ✘ *at loss*, ✘ *as rule*, ✘ *make noise* (acceptable informally, but *make* ***a*** *noise* is standard in exams), ✘ *catch cold* (BrE also accepts *catch cold*). And *on an average* is common in South Asia; standard British/American English says ***on average***.

5.4 When *A / An* Is NOT Used

1. **Before plural nouns:** ✘ *a books* → ✔ *books / some books*.
2. **Before uncountable nouns:** ✘ *an advice, a furniture, a good news* (Chapter 03).
3. **Before names of meals** (in general): *We have* ***breakfast*** *at 8. Lunch is ready.* But with an adjective: *We had* ***a*** *heavy* ***lunch***.
4. **After *kind of / sort of / type of*** (formal): *What kind of* ***man*** *is he?* (*What kind of* ***a*** *man* is informal.)
5. **Before titles and unique positions** after *elect, appoint, make, choose, become, crown, name*: *They elected him* ***chairman***. *He was appointed* ***headmaster***. *She became* ***Prime Minister***.
6. **Before *Mr, Mrs, Dr* + known name:** ✘ *a Dr Rahman* (unless meaning "a certain").
7. **In some fixed phrases:** *at first sight, by mistake, in fact, on foot, on purpose, at night, by heart*.

5.5 Uses of the Definite Article (*The*)

5.5.1 General Rules

1. **Particular or already mentioned:** *This is* ***the*** *book I told you about. I met a man.* ***The*** *man was blind.*
2. **When both speaker and listener know which one is meant (shared knowledge):** *Close* ***the*** *door. Where is* ***the*** *teacher? Did you feed* ***the*** *dog?*
3. **Before a noun made particular by a phrase or clause:** ***The*** *water of this well is pure.* ***The*** *history of Bangladesh.* ***The*** *boy who came yesterday is my cousin.*
4. **Before unique things (only one of its kind):** ***the*** *sun,* ***the*** *moon,* ***the*** *earth,* ***the*** *sky,* ***the*** *world,* ***the*** *universe,* ***the*** *equator,* ***the*** *North Pole,* ***the*** *horizon,* ***the*** *atmosphere*.
5. **With superlatives:** ***the*** *best,* ***the*** *tallest,* ***the*** *most beautiful*.
6. **With ordinal numbers and *only, same, very, main, last, next, whole, following*:** ***the*** *first,* ***the*** *second,* ***the*** *only child,* ***the*** *same mistake,* ***the*** *very man,* ***the*** *main road,* ***the*** *whole day,* ***the*** *following year*.
7. **With an adjective to denote a class of people (plural verb):** ***The*** *rich* ***are*** *not always happy.* ***The*** *poor* ***need*** *help.* ***The*** *blind,* ***the*** *deaf,* ***the*** *dead,* ***the*** *young,* ***the*** *old,* ***the*** *unemployed,* ***the*** *wounded.*
8. **With a singular noun to represent a whole class (formal, generic use):** ***The*** *cow is a domestic animal.* ***The*** *tiger is in danger of extinction.* ***The*** *rose is the sweetest of all flowers.* ***The*** *computer has changed our lives.*
9. **With nationalities ending in *-sh, -ch, -ese, -ss*:** ***the*** *English,* ***the*** *French,* ***the*** *Chinese,* ***the*** *Japanese,* ***the*** *Swiss*. (Others take plural -s: ***the*** *Bangladeshis,* ***the*** *Americans*.)
10. **With family names in the plural (whole family):** ***the*** *Khans,* ***the*** *Chowdhurys,* ***the*** *Tagores*.
11. **With comparatives in parallel structure:** ***The*** *more you read,* ***the*** *more you learn.* ***The*** *sooner,* ***the*** *better.* ***The*** *higher you go,* ***the*** *cooler it is.*
12. **With comparative + *of the two*:** *Rahim is* ***the*** *taller* ***of the two*** *brothers.*
13. **Before a proper noun qualified by an adjective or used as a common noun:** ***the*** *great Akbar,* ***the*** *immortal Nazrul,* ***the*** *Newton of our age,* ***the*** *Shakespeare of Bengal*. And as an epithet after a name: *Alexander* ***the*** *Great, Akbar* ***the*** *Great*.
14. **With body parts in a prepositional phrase after a verb + object:** *He struck me* ***on the*** *head. She pulled him* ***by the*** *ear.*
15. **For a measurement unit with *by*:** *Eggs are sold* ***by the*** *dozen. Cloth is sold* ***by the*** *metre. Workers are paid* ***by the*** *hour.*
16. **With decades and centuries:** *in* ***the*** *1970s, in* ***the*** *nineteenth century*.
17. **With inventions and musical instruments:** ***The*** *telephone was invented by Bell. She plays* ***the*** *violin /* ***the*** *harmonium /* ***the*** *tabla.* (but games: *He plays* ***football*** — no article)
18. **With *the* + adjective in abstract sense (singular):** ***The*** *good,* ***the*** *true,* ***the*** *beautiful*.
19. **With certain institutions and media:** ***the*** *government,* ***the*** *police,* ***the*** *army,* ***the*** *public,* ***the*** *press,* ***the*** *cinema,* ***the*** *theatre,* ***the*** *radio*. (but ***television*** usually without *the*: *watch television*)

5.5.2 *The* with Geographical and Other Proper Names

This is a high-frequency exam area. Learn the table with its exceptions.

Use *the*	Examples	Do NOT use *the*	Examples
Rivers	**the** Padma, **the** Meghna, **the** Jamuna, **the** Nile, **the** Thames	Single lakes	Lake Kaptai, Lake Victoria
Seas, oceans, gulfs, bays	**the** Bay of Bengal, **the** Red Sea, **the** Pacific, **the** Persian Gulf	Single mountains / peaks	Mount Everest, Keokradong, Mount Fuji
Canals	**the** Suez Canal, **the** Panama Canal	Single islands	Bhola, Sri Lanka, Sicily
Deserts	**the** Sahara, **the** Thar, **the** Gobi	Continents	Asia, Africa, Europe
Mountain ranges	**the** Himalayas, **the** Alps, **the** Andes	Most countries	Bangladesh, India, France, China

Use *the*	Examples	Do NOT use *the*	Examples
Groups of islands	**the** Maldives, **the** Andamans, **the** Philippines	Cities, towns, villages	Dhaka, Paris, London
Countries with *republic, kingdom, states, union* or plural names	**the** USA, **the** UK, **the** UAE, **the** Netherlands, **the** People's Republic of China	States, provinces, districts	Texas, Punjab, Sylhet
Holy books	**the** Quran, **the** Bible, **the** Gita, **the** Vedas, **the** Tripitaka	Streets, roads, squares (mostly)	Mirpur Road, Times Square
Famous buildings, monuments	**the** Taj Mahal, **the** Shaheed Minar, **the** Eiffel Tower, **the** Pyramids	Planets (as names)	Mars, Jupiter (but **the** earth/**the** Earth)
Newspapers & magazines	**The** Daily Star, **The** Times, **the** Prothom Alo	Universities named after places/people	Dhaka University, Harvard University (but **the** University of Dhaka)
Ships, trains, planes	**the** Titanic, **the** Subarna Express	Airports, stations, parks	Hazrat Shahjalal International Airport, Kamalapur Station, Ramna Park
Hotels, museums, cinemas, theatres	**the** Sonargaon Hotel, **the** National Museum, **the** Louvre	Acronyms read as words	NATO, UNESCO, UNICEF, OPEC
Organisations (initials read letter by letter)	**the** UN, **the** WHO, **the** EU, **the** BBC, **the** IMF	Magazines named after a person	—
Regions and directions	**the** Middle East, **the** Far East, **the** north of Bangladesh	Compass points after *in* + proper adjective	in northern Bangladesh, in South Asia

5.6 When *The* Is NOT Used

1. **Before most proper nouns** (persons, countries, cities, continents): ✘ *the Dhaka*, ✘ *the Rahim*, ✘ *the Asia*.
2. **Before material, abstract and uncountable nouns used in a general sense:** ***Gold*** *is costly.* ***Honesty*** *is the best policy.* ***Rice*** *is our staple food.* ***Life*** *is short.* But particularised: ***The*** *gold of this ring;* ***the*** *honesty of this man;* ***the*** *life of Nazrul.*
3. **Before plural nouns used in a general sense:** ***Books*** *are our best friends.* ***Dogs*** *are faithful.* But: ***The*** *books on the table are mine.*
4. **Before languages:** *She speaks* ***English*** *and* ***Bangla****.* But: ***the*** *English language,* ***the*** *Bangla language.*
5. **Before names of meals in general:** *We have* ***dinner*** *at nine.* But: ***The*** *dinner given by the Mayor was grand.*
6. **Before games and sports:** *They play* ***cricket****.* (✘ the cricket)
7. **Before most diseases:** *He suffers from* ***diabetes*** */* ***cancer*** */* ***malaria****.* (Optional with a few: *(the) flu, (the) measles.*)
8. **Before days, months and seasons in general:** *on* ***Friday****, in* ***March****, in* ***winter*** (*in* ***the*** *winter of 1971* — particular).
9. **Before *school, college, university, hospital, church, mosque, temple, prison, jail, court, bed, market, sea, work, class* when used for their primary purpose:**

- She goes to **school** every day. (as a student) / His father went to **the school** to meet the headmaster. (as a visitor)
- She is in **hospital**. (as a patient — BrE) / I went to **the hospital** to see her.
- He was sent to **prison**. (as a prisoner) / The lawyer went to **the prison**.
- We go to **bed** at ten. / He sat on **the bed**.
- He went to **sea** (became a sailor). / We went to **the sea** for a holiday.

10. **With *by* + means of transport and communication:** *by* ***bus****, by* ***train****, by* ***air****, by* ***sea****, by* ***post****, by* ***phone****, by* ***email*** (but *in* ***the*** *bus, on* ***the*** *train, in* ***my*** *car*).
11. **Before *man* (mankind) and *woman* in a general sense:** ***Man*** *is mortal.* ***Woman*** *is the better half of man.*
12. **Before *home*** in common phrases: *go* ***home****, at* ***home****, leave* ***home****.*
13. **Before *next* and *last* in time expressions measured from now:** ***next*** *week,* ***last*** *year,* ***next*** *Friday*. But measured from another time: *He arrived on Monday and left* ***the next*** *day.*
14. **Before titles used as complements or in apposition:** *He was elected* ***Chairman****. Dr Kamal,* ***Principal*** *of the college, gave a speech.*
15. **In pairs of nouns joined by a preposition or *and*:** *husband and wife, father and son, day and night, from head to foot, face to face, hand in hand, arm in arm, side by side, from door to door, from morning till evening.*
16. **Before *nature, society, space, life, history, television*** in general sense: *the beauty of* ***nature****;* ***Society*** *has changed; travel into* ***space****; I watched* ***television****.*
17. **Before *most* meaning "the majority":** ***Most*** *students passed* (✘ The most students …). But superlative: *She is* ***the most*** *intelligent.*
18. **In many fixed phrases:** *at night, at noon, at dawn, at sunset, by day, in time, on time, at present, at last, in fact, on foot, by heart, by chance, in debt, at sea, catch fire, lose heart, take place, set sail, give way, send word, take part, keep pace, in front of, on behalf of, in case of.*

5.7 Repeating the Article

The repetition (or not) of an article can change the **meaning** and therefore the **verb**.

- **A** black **and white** cow is grazing. (one cow, black-and-white)
- **A** black **and a** white cow **are** grazing. (two cows)
- **The** Secretary **and** Treasurer **has** come. (one person holding two posts)
- **The** Secretary **and the** Treasurer **have** come. (two persons)
- **The** poet **and** philosopher **is** dead. (one person — e.g. Iqbal)
- **The** poet **and the** philosopher **are** dead. (two persons)
- I have **a** red **and a** blue pen. (two pens) / I have **a** red **and** blue pen. (one pen with two colours)

5.8 The Position of the Article

Usually the article comes before the adjective (*a good boy*). But after certain words the article moves **after the adjective**:

Pattern	Examples
such */* ***what*** */* ***many*** */* ***half*** */* ***quite*** */* ***rather*** + **a** + (adj) + noun	*such* ***a*** *fool; what* ***a*** *pity; many* ***a*** *man; half* ***an*** *hour; quite* ***a*** *surprise; rather* ***a*** *cold day* (also *a rather cold day*)

Pattern	Examples
so / too / as / how / however + **adj** + **a** + noun	*so good **a** man (= such a good man); too heavy **a** load; as brave **a** soldier as any; how clever **a** boy; however hard **a** task*
all / both / double / twice + **the** + noun	*all **the** boys; both **the** brothers; double **the** price; twice **the** amount*

- It is **too difficult a** problem for me. (✘ a too difficult problem)
- He is **as honest a** man **as** his father.
- I have never seen **so beautiful a** place.
- **Many a** student **has** failed in this subject. (*many a* + singular noun + singular verb)

5.9 Articles with *Few* and *Little*

Few/little (= almost none, negative), *a few/a little* (= some, positive), *the few/the little* (= all of the small number/amount) — explained fully in Chapter 03.9.1.

- **Few** people can keep a secret. (negative)
- **A few** people came to the party. (positive)
- **The few** books that he has are all old. (all of his books)
- He has **little** knowledge of science. / He has **a little** knowledge of science.

5.10 Articles with Proper Nouns: Special Cases

- **The** Rahman you met yesterday is my uncle. (a particular Rahman, defined by a clause)
- I know three **Rahims** in my class. (proper noun used as common noun, plural)
- She is **a** Florence Nightingale. (= a devoted nurse)
- **The** Sundarbans is the largest mangrove forest in the world. (plural-form name)
- **The** Hague, **the** Vatican, **the** Gambia (fixed exceptions among names of places)
- He visited **Dhaka** and **the** Bay of Bengal.

5.11 Common Errors with Articles

1. ✘ He is honest man. ✔ He is **an** honest man.
2. ✘ She is an university student. ✔ She is **a** university student.
3. ✘ I waited for a hour. ✔ I waited for **an** hour.
4. ✘ He is a M.A. ✔ He is **an** M.A.
5. ✘ The honesty is the best policy. ✔ **Honesty** is the best policy.
6. ✘ Sun rises in east. ✔ **The** sun rises in **the** east.
7. ✘ Padma is a big river. ✔ **The** Padma is a big river.
8. ✘ He is best boy in the class. ✔ He is **the** best boy in the class.
9. ✘ The Mount Everest is the highest peak. ✔ **Mount** Everest is the highest peak.
10. ✘ He goes to the school every day (as a student). ✔ He goes to **school** every day.
11. ✘ He went by the bus. ✔ He went **by bus**.
12. ✘ I have headache. ✔ I have **a** headache.
13. ✘ He plays the football. ✔ He plays **football**.
14. ✘ She plays harmonium. ✔ She plays **the** harmonium.
15. ✘ The rich is not always happy. ✔ **The** rich **are** not always happy.
16. ✘ He was elected the Chairman. ✔ He was elected **Chairman**.
17. ✘ Quran is the holy book of Muslims. ✔ **The** Quran is the holy book of **the** Muslims / of Muslims.
18. ✘ What a fine weather! ✔ **What fine weather!**
19. ✘ He is a too good man to do this. ✔ He is **too good a** man to do this.
20. ✘ Many a students have failed. ✔ **Many a student has** failed.
21. ✘ I saw an one-eyed man. ✔ I saw **a** one-eyed man.
22. ✘ He gave me an useful advice. ✔ He gave me **useful advice / a useful piece of advice**.
23. ✘ The man is mortal. ✔ **Man** is mortal.
24. ✘ He came at the night. ✔ He came **at night**.
25. ✘ We had the breakfast at seven. ✔ We had **breakfast** at seven.
26. ✘ He is the Newton of age. ✔ He is **the** Newton of **our** age.
27. ✘ I bought the rice and the fish from market. ✔ I bought rice and fish from **the** market.
28. ✘ Taka 50 the kilo. ✔ Taka 50 **a** kilo.
29. ✘ The more you work, more you earn. ✔ **The** more you work, **the** more you earn.
30. ✘ He is the taller of three brothers. ✔ He is **the tallest** of **the** three brothers. (*taller* for two only)

5.12 Articles in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Articles are rarely the sole tested point in international tests, but they appear in **idioms** and **meaning**:

- ***A number of*** (= many, plural) vs ***the number of*** (= the count, singular).
- ***The*** + superlative or *only* signals uniqueness: GMAT may test logic such as ✘ *She is one of the only candidates* (illogical) → ✔ *She is one of the **few** candidates*.
- ***A*** before a countable singular noun is required in standard written English; omitted articles in answer choices are an easy elimination clue.
- In GRE Reading, ***the*** vs ***a*** can change the claim: *"**The** cause of the decline"* (the only cause) vs *"**a** cause of the decline"* (one of several causes). Questions on what the author "suggests" often turn on this difference.

A Three-Question Method for Any Article Blank: (1) Is the noun **countable singular**? — then it needs *a/an/the* or another determiner. (2) Is it **particular/known/unique** to both speaker and listener? — use *the*. (3) If it is **general** and **plural or uncountable**, use **no article**. Then check the special lists (geographical names, institutions, meals, games, instruments, fixed phrases) for exceptions.

CHAPTER 06

Number

Part A · Grammar

6.1 What Is Number?

Number is the form of a noun (or pronoun or verb) that shows whether we mean **one** or **more than one**.

- **Singular number** — one person or thing: *boy, book, child, mouse, crisis.*
- **Plural number** — more than one: *boys, books, children, mice, crises.*

Only **countable nouns** have both numbers. Uncountable nouns (Chapter 03) are grammatically singular. Pronouns (*I/we, he/they*) and present-tense verbs (*plays/play*) also show number, which is why number connects directly to subject-verb agreement (Chapter 23).

Plural formation is tested in BCS, Bank and admission tests in two ways: (1) "*What is the plural of …?*" — especially foreign words like *crisis, datum, criterion, phenomenon, memorandum*; and (2) error detection with words like *sheeps, informations, two dozens, sons-in-laws*.

6.2 Regular Plurals

6.2.1 Add *-s*

Most nouns form their plural by adding ***-s***: *book → books, girl → girls, tree → trees, house → houses, pen → pens.*

6.2.2 Add *-es* after *s, ss, sh, ch, x, z*

Ending	Examples
-s, -ss	bus → buses, gas → gases, class → classes, glass → glasses, kiss → kisses
-sh	brush → brushes, dish → dishes, bush → bushes
-ch (sounding "ch")	bench → benches, church → churches, match → matches, watch → watches
-x	box → boxes, fox → foxes, tax → taxes
-z	quiz → quizzes, buzz → buzzes, waltz → waltzes

> When *-ch* sounds like **"k"**, add only ***-s***: *stomach → stomachs, monarch → monarchs, epoch → epochs, patriarch → patriarchs, matriarch → matriarchs, eunuch → eunuchs.*

6.2.3 Nouns Ending in *-o*

Rule	Examples
Consonant + *o* → usually ***-es***	hero → heroes, potato → potatoes, tomato → tomatoes, echo → echoes, cargo → cargoes, mosquito → mosquitoes, buffalo → buffaloes, volcano → volcanoes, torpedo → torpedoes, veto → vetoes, mango → mangoes (also *mangos*), motto → mottoes (also *mottos*), embargo → embargoes
Vowel + *o* → ***-s***	radio → radios, studio → studios, ratio → ratios, zoo → zoos, bamboo → bamboos, kangaroo → kangaroos, video → videos, cuckoo → cuckoos, cameo → cameos, folio → folios, portfolio → portfolios
Short forms, musical and foreign words → ***-s***	photo → photos, kilo → kilos, piano → pianos, solo → solos, soprano → sopranos, canto → cantos, memo → memos, logo → logos, dynamo → dynamos, auto → autos, euro → euros, casino → casinos, ghetto → ghettos, Eskimo → Eskimos, commando → commandos

> **Memory line for *-oes*:** "**Heroes** ate **potatoes** and **tomatoes** while **mosquitoes** buzzed and **volcanoes** gave **echoes** to **buffaloes**." Most other *-o* words take *-s*.

6.2.4 Nouns Ending in *-y*

Rule	Examples
Consonant + *y* → change *y* to ***-ies***	city → cities, lady → ladies, baby → babies, army → armies, story → stories, fly → flies, country → countries, duty → duties, enemy → enemies, family → families
Vowel + *y* → add ***-s***	boy → boys, day → days, key → keys, monkey → monkeys, donkey → donkeys, valley → valleys, chimney → chimneys, toy → toys, journey → journeys, attorney → attorneys, alley → alleys, storey → storeys
Proper names → add ***-s***	the two Marys, the Kennedys, the Murphys

> Words ending in *-quy* follow the consonant rule because *u* is pronounced like *w*: *soliloquy → soliloquies, colloquy → colloquies. Money* has two plurals: *moneys* and *monies* (= sums of money, used in law and accounts).

6.2.5 Nouns Ending in *-f* or *-fe*

Rule	Examples
Change *f/fe* to ***-ves***	knife → knives, wife → wives, life → lives, leaf → leaves, loaf → loaves, half → halves, calf → calves, self → selves, shelf → shelves, thief → thieves, wolf → wolves, sheaf → sheaves, elf → elves
Add only ***-s***	roof → roofs, chief → chiefs, proof → proofs, belief → beliefs, grief → griefs, gulf → gulfs, cliff → cliffs, reef → reefs, safe → safes, chef → chefs, serf → serfs, brief → briefs, handkerchief → handkerchiefs, strife → strifes, fife → fifes, staff → staffs (groups of employees)
Both forms correct	scarf → scarfs / scarves, hoof → hoofs / hooves, wharf → wharfs / wharves, dwarf → dwarfs / dwarves

6.3 Irregular Plurals

6.3.1 Vowel Change (Mutation Plurals)

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
man	men	goose	geese
woman	women	mouse	mice
foot	feet	louse	lice
tooth	teeth	dormouse	dormice

Compounds follow the same pattern: *Englishman → Englishmen, policeman → policemen, fireman → firemen, chairman → chairmen*. But *German → Germans, Roman → Romans, human → humans, talisman → talismans, Mussulman → Mussulmans* (these are not compounds of *man*).

6.3.2 Plurals in *-en*

ox → oxen, child → children, brother → brethren (members of a religious community or society; otherwise *brothers*).

6.3.3 Same Form in Singular and Plural

Group	Examples
Animals (hunting/fishing tradition)	sheep, deer, swine, fish (usually), salmon, trout, cod, carp, grouse, bison, moose
Craft	aircraft, spacecraft, hovercraft, watercraft
Words in *-s*	series, species, means, headquarters, crossroads, barracks, gallows, works (factory), innings (cricket, BrE)
Nationalities in *-ese* / *-ss*	Chinese, Japanese, Portuguese, Vietnamese, Swiss
Numbers/measures after a number	dozen, score, hundred, thousand, million, gross, stone (weight), head (of cattle), pair (informally), yoke (of oxen)

- **One sheep is** grazing; **ten sheep are** grazing. (✘ sheeps)
- **A species** of bird **is** extinct. **Many species are** endangered.
- **This series** of lectures **is** useful. **Two series** of stamps **were** issued.
- *Fish* vs *fishes*: *I caught ten **fish*** (number of individual fish). *The aquarium has many **fishes*** (= many species of fish).
- ***Two dozen** eggs* (✘ two dozens eggs); ***five hundred** taka*; ***fifty head of** cattle*; but ***dozens of** eggs*, ***hundreds of** people*, ***millions of** dollars* (no number before them).

6.4 Plurals of Compound Nouns

In a compound noun, make the **principal (most important) word** plural. If no word is clearly the principal one, add the plural ending at the **end**.

Type	Singular → Plural
Noun + preposition phrase (first word plural)	son-in-law → **sons**-in-law; daughter-in-law → **daughters**-in-law; mother-in-law → **mothers**-in-law; father-in-law → **fathers**-in-law; brother-in-law → **brothers**-in-law; commander-in-chief → **commanders**-in-chief; man-of-war → **men**-of-war; coat of mail → **coats** of mail; editor-in-chief → **editors**-in-chief
Noun + adverb/particle (noun plural)	passer-by → **passers**-by; looker-on → **lookers**-on; hanger-on → **hangers**-on; runner-up → **runners**-up
Noun + adjective (noun plural)	court-martial → **courts**-martial; attorney-general → **attorneys**-general (also *attorney-generals*); poet laureate → **poets** laureate; notary public → **notaries** public; heir apparent → **heirs** apparent
Noun + noun (last word plural)	step-son → step-**sons**; maid-servant → maid-**servants**; bus stop → bus **stops**; schoolboy → school**boys**; toothbrush → tooth**brushes**
Man / *Woman* + noun (both plural)	**man**-servant → **men**-servants; **woman** doctor → **women** doctors; **woman** teacher → **women** teachers; **lady** doctor → **lady** doctors (only last)
No noun inside / verb-based (add -s at end)	forget-me-not → forget-me-**nots**; grown-up → grown-**ups**; go-between → go-**betweens**; drawback → draw**backs**; breakdown → break**downs**; take-off → take-**offs**; merry-go-round → merry-go-**rounds**; stand-by → stand-**bys**
Words in *-ful* (add -s at end)	spoonful → spoon**fuls**; handful → hand**fuls**; mouthful → mouth**fuls**; cupful → cup**fuls**; bucketful → bucket**fuls** (✘ spoonsful is old-fashioned)

6.5 Plurals of Foreign (Classical) Words

Many words from **Latin, Greek, French, Italian** and **Hebrew** keep their original plurals. These are the **most tested** plurals in Bangladesh and in GRE/GMAT reading passages. Some have a regular English plural as well; where both exist, the meanings may differ.

6.5.1 Latin *-us → -i*

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
alumnus	alumni	radius	radii
bacillus	bacilli	stimulus	stimuli
cactus	cacti / cactuses	syllabus	syllabi / syllabuses
focus	foci / focuses	terminus	termini / terminuses
fungus	fungi / funguses	locus	loci
nucleus	nuclei	magus	magi

Exceptions to *-us → -i*: *genus → genera, corpus → corpora, opus → opera, viscus → viscera*. And many *-us* words take the English plural only: *bonus → bonuses, campus → campuses, census → censuses, chorus → choruses, circus → circuses, virus → viruses, genius → geniuses, octopus → octopuses, prospectus → prospectuses, status → statuses, sinus → sinuses, apparatus → apparatus / apparatuses*.

6.5.2 Latin *-a → -ae*

alumna → alumnae, formula → formulae / formulas, larva → larvae, vertebra → vertebrae, antenna → antennae (insects) / antennas (radio), nebula → nebulae, minutia → minutiae, persona → personae. (But *area → areas, idea → ideas, arena → arenas, dilemma → dilemmas*.)

6.5.3 Latin *-um → -a*

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
datum	data	medium	media / mediums
bacterium	bacteria	memorandum	memoranda / memorandums

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
curriculum	curricula / curriculums	millennium	millennia / millenniums
erratum	errata	stratum	strata
addendum	addenda	symposium	symposia / symposiums
agendum	agenda	referendum	referenda / referendums
maximum	maxima / maximums	minimum	minima / minimums
quantum	quanta	spectrum	spectra
ovum	ova	stadium	stadia / stadiums
aquarium	aquaria / aquariums	consortium	consortia

> ***Agenda*** is now used as a **singular** noun in English (*The agenda **is** long; two agendas*). ***Data*** is plural in strict formal usage (*These data **are** reliable*) but is widely used as singular (*The data **is** reliable*); in GMAT/GRE contexts, treat *data* as plural. ***Media*** (newspapers, TV) is plural in strict usage: *The media **are** responsible* — singular use is common. ***Bacteria***, ***criteria***, ***phenomena*** are **always plural**: ✘ *a bacteria*, ✘ *this criteria* → ✔ *a bacterium*, ✔ *this criterion*.

6.5.4 Greek *-is* → *-es*

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
analysis	analyses	hypothesis	hypotheses
axis	axes	oasis	oases
basis	bases	parenthesis	parentheses
crisis	crises	synopsis	synopses
diagnosis	diagnoses	synthesis	syntheses
ellipsis	ellipses	thesis	theses
emphasis	emphases	neurosis	neuroses
prognosis	prognoses	metamorphosis	metamorphoses

6.5.5 Greek *-on* → *-a*

criterion → criteria, phenomenon → phenomena, automaton → automata / automatons, polyhedron → polyhedra. (But *electron → electrons, proton → protons, marathon → marathons*.)

6.5.6 Latin *-ex / -ix* → *-ices*

index → indices (mathematics) / indexes (of books), appendix → appendices (of books) / appendixes (anatomy), matrix → matrices, vertex → vertices, vortex → vortices, apex → apices / apexes, codex → codices, helix → helices.

6.5.7 Greek *-ma* → *-mata*

dogma → dogmata / dogmas, stigma → stigmata (religious) / stigmas, schema → schemata / schemas, stoma → stomata, lemma → lemmata / lemmas.

6.5.8 French, Italian and Hebrew Plurals

Origin	Singular → Plural
French *-eau → -eaux*	bureau → bureaux / bureaus, plateau → plateaux / plateaus, tableau → tableaux, chateau → chateaux, beau → beaux, portmanteau → portmanteaux
French others	madame → mesdames, monsieur → messieurs, corps → corps, chassis → chassis, rendezvous → rendezvous
Italian *-o → -i*	bandit → banditti / bandits, libretto → libretti, virtuoso → virtuosi, graffito → graffiti, dilettante → dilettanti, paparazzo → paparazzi, tempo → tempi / tempos
Hebrew *-im*	cherub → cherubim (angels) / cherubs (babies in art), seraph → seraphim, kibbutz → kibbutzim

6.6 Nouns with Two Plurals of Different Meaning

Singular	Plural 1	Plural 2
brother	**brothers** (sons of the same parents)	**brethren** (members of a society/community)
cloth	**cloths** (pieces/kinds of cloth)	**clothes** (garments)
die	**dies** (stamps for coining)	**dice** (small cubes for games)
genius	**geniuses** (persons of great talent)	**genii** (spirits)
index	**indexes** (lists in books)	**indices** (signs in algebra)
penny	**pennies** (individual coins)	**pence** (amount of money)
staff	**staffs** (groups of employees; sticks)	**staves** (sticks, poles; lines in music)
fish	**fish** (number of fish)	**fishes** (kinds of fish)
medium	**mediums** (persons in contact with spirits)	**media** (means of communication)
appendix	**appendixes** (body organ)	**appendices** (supplements in books)
antenna	**antennas** (aerials)	**antennae** (feelers of insects)
formula	**formulas** (general use)	**formulae** (mathematical/scientific)
shot	**shots** (discharges)	**shot** (lead pellets)
pea	**peas** (separate seeds)	**pease** (as a mass, archaic)

6.7 Nouns That Change Meaning in the Plural

A number of nouns acquire a **different meaning** when they are made plural. These are very useful for vocabulary and error detection.

Singular (meaning)	Plural (meaning)
advice (counsel)	advices (commercial notices)
air (atmosphere)	airs (proud manners: *put on airs*)
arm (part of the body)	arms (weapons)
colour (hue)	colours (flag of a regiment / ship)
compass (range; instrument for direction)	compasses (instrument for drawing circles)
content (satisfaction; amount contained)	contents (things contained; list of chapters)
custom (habit)	customs (duties on imports; the customs office)
damage (harm)	damages (compensation paid by order of court)
effect (result)	effects (property, belongings)
force (strength)	forces (army)
good (benefit)	goods (merchandise)
ground (earth)	grounds (reasons; land around a building; dregs)
iron (a metal)	irons (fetters)

Singular (meaning)	Plural (meaning)
letter (of the alphabet; a written message)	letters (literature, learning: *a man of letters*)
look (glance)	looks (appearance)
manner (method)	manners (polite behaviour)
minute (unit of time)	minutes (official record of a meeting)
moral (lesson of a story)	morals (conduct, character)
pain (suffering)	pains (efforts, trouble: *take pains*)
part (portion)	parts (abilities; regions: *a man of parts; in these parts*)
premise (a statement in logic)	premises (a building with its land)
quarter (one-fourth)	quarters (lodging, accommodation)
regard (attention, esteem)	regards (good wishes)
respect (esteem)	respects (polite greetings)
return (coming back)	returns (statistical or tax statements; profits)
sand (particles)	sands (sandy beach, desert)
spectacle (sight, show)	spectacles (eyeglasses)
spirit (soul)	spirits (mood; strong alcohol)
water (liquid)	waters (sea; territorial waters; mineral springs)
wood (material)	woods (forest)
work (labour)	works (factory; literary/artistic creations)

6.8 Plurals of Letters, Figures, Abbreviations and Names

- **Letters:** *Mind your **p's and q's**. Dot your **i's** and cross your **t's**.* (apostrophe used for clarity with small letters)
- **Figures:** *Write your **7s** clearly. In the **1990s**.* (*7's* and *1990's* are older forms; modern style prefers no apostrophe)
- **Abbreviations:** *two **MPs**, three **MAs**, several **NGOs**, many **CEOs*** (✘ NGO's for a plural in modern style)
- **Proper names:** *There are two **Rahims** in our class. **The Khans** live next door. Three **Marys** and two **Kennedys**.*
- **Titles:** *Mr → **Messrs** (Messrs Rahman & Co.); Mrs → **Mesdames**; Miss Rahman → **the Misses** Rahman* (formal) or *the Miss **Rahmans*** (informal); *Dr → Drs*.

6.9 Number of Nouns in Special Constructions

1. **Noun after a number used as an adjective stays singular:** *a **ten-taka** note, a **five-year** plan, a **two-mile** walk, a **three-day** holiday, a **six-month** course* (✘ a ten-takas note, ✘ a five-years plan).
2. **"One of the" + plural noun:** *He is **one of the best players*** (✘ best player).
3. **"More than one" + singular noun + singular verb:** ***More than one student was** absent.* (but *More students than one **were** absent*.)
4. **"One and a half" + plural noun:** ***one and a half hours*** (✘ hour) / ***an hour and a half***.
5. **"A pair of" / "a couple of":** *a pair of shoes **is** …* (verb with *pair*); *a couple of days*.
6. **Every / each + singular noun:** *every **student**, each **day***.
7. **Kind of / sort of:** *this kind of **book**; these kinds of **books***.
8. **Plural nouns used as adjectives keep the plural in some fixed expressions:** *a **sports** car, the **arms** race, a **customs** officer, a **savings** account, a **sales** manager, the **accounts** department, a **goods** train, a **clothes** shop, a **students'** union* — but ordinary nouns go singular: *a **shoe** shop, a **book** shop, a **flower** garden*.

6.10 Common Errors with Number

1. ✘ I saw many sheeps. ✔ I saw many **sheep**.
2. ✘ Two dozens eggs ✔ Two **dozen** eggs.
3. ✘ He has two sons-in-laws. ✔ He has two **sons-in-law**.
4. ✘ The passer-bys stopped. ✔ The **passers-by** stopped.
5. ✘ This is a five-years plan. ✔ This is a **five-year** plan.
6. ✘ The datas are correct. ✔ The **data are** correct. (formal)
7. ✘ This criteria is important. ✔ This **criterion** is important. / These **criteria are** important.
8. ✘ The phenomena is strange. ✔ The **phenomenon** is strange.
9. ✘ There are many crisis. ✔ There are many **crises**.
10. ✘ A bacteria causes this disease. ✔ A **bacterium** causes this disease. / **Bacteria** cause this disease.
11. ✘ The mouses ran away. ✔ The **mice** ran away.
12. ✘ He is one of the best student. ✔ … one of the best **students**.
13. ✘ More than one boys were absent. ✔ More than one **boy was** absent.
14. ✘ The roof of the houses are red. — Check: *The **roofs** of the houses **are** red.* ✔
15. ✘ I bought two spoonsful of sugar. ✔ two **spoonfuls** of sugar.
16. ✘ The chiefs's decision ✔ The **chief's** decision / the **chiefs'** decision.
17. ✘ My brother's-in-law house ✔ My **brother-in-law's** house.
18. ✘ Two womans doctor came. ✔ Two **women doctors** came.
19. ✘ The thiefs were caught. ✔ The **thieves** were caught.
20. ✘ He wrote three thesis. ✔ He wrote three **theses**.
21. ✘ I have read the Hamlet's two analysis. ✔ I have read two **analyses** of *Hamlet*.
22. ✘ All the ladys were present. ✔ All the **ladies** were present.
23. ✘ The monkies are playing. ✔ The **monkeys** are playing.
24. ✘ He bought three radioes. ✔ He bought three **radios**.
25. ✘ The heros were honoured. ✔ The **heroes** were honoured.

6.11 Number in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Latin and Greek plurals as subjects:** GMAT and SAT writers deliberately use *criteria, phenomena, data, media, strata, bacteria, alumni, theses* as subjects to test agreement: ✘ *The criteria for admission **has** changed.* ✔ *The criteria … **have** changed.* ✘ *This phenomena **is** rare.* ✔ *This **phenomenon** is rare.*
- **Logical number:** A noun must agree logically with what it refers to: ✘ *The students raised **their hand**.* ✔ *The students raised **their hands**.* ✘ *All the participants received **a certificate*** is acceptable if each received one; GMAT accepts *certificates* as clearer.
- **Pronoun number:** ✘ *Each of the scientists presented **their** findings* (formal tests prefer ***his or her*** or rewriting: *All the scientists presented their findings*).
- **GRE vocabulary:** words like *data, criteria, phenomena, strata, media, memoranda, millennia* appear constantly in reading passages; knowing they are plural prevents misreading the sentence structure.

CHAPTER 07

Gender

Part A · Grammar

7.1 What Is Gender?

In grammar, **gender** is the form of a noun or pronoun that shows whether it refers to a **male**, a **female**, **either sex**, or **neither sex**. English has **natural gender**: the gender of a word follows the real sex of what it names (unlike Arabic, French or Hindi, where even a table or a river has grammatical gender).

English nouns have **four genders**:

Gender	Meaning	Examples
Masculine	male	man, boy, father, king, lion, cock, bull
Feminine	female	woman, girl, mother, queen, lioness, hen, cow
Common	either male or female	parent, child, friend, teacher, student, cousin, baby, person, enemy, servant, orphan
Neuter	neither male nor female (things without life)	book, table, tree, house, river, stone, pen

In Bangladeshi exams, gender is usually tested as "*What is the feminine (or masculine) of …?*" and in pronoun reference (*his / her / its*).

7.2 Ways of Forming the Feminine

There are **three main ways** to show gender:

1. By using an **entirely different word**.
2. By adding a **suffix** (*-ess, -ine, -a, -trix, -ette*, etc.) to the masculine.
3. By adding a **word** before or after the noun (compound gender words).

7.2.1 Using a Different Word

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
bachelor	spinster / maid	lord	lady
boar	sow	man	woman
boy	girl	monk / friar	nun
brother	sister	nephew	niece
buck (deer, rabbit)	doe	papa	mama
bull / ox	cow	ram	ewe
bridegroom	bride	sir	madam / dame
cock	hen	son	daughter
colt	filly	stag	hind
dog	bitch	drone	bee
drake	duck	uncle	aunt
earl	countess	wizard	witch
father	mother	king	queen
fox	vixen	hart	roe
gander	goose	horse / stallion	mare
gentleman	lady	husband	wife
cob (swan)	pen	steer / bullock	heifer
beau	belle	sire	dam
grandfather	grandmother	lad	lass

Meaning notes: *colt/filly* = young male/female horse; *drake/duck* = male/female duck (the word *duck* is also common gender); *gander/goose* = male/female goose; *hart/roe* and *stag/hind* = male/female deer; *buck/doe* = male/female deer, rabbit, hare or goat; *boar/sow* = male/female pig; *ram/ewe* = male/female sheep; *steer* = young castrated bull; *heifer* = young cow that has not had a calf; *sire/dam* = father/mother of an animal; *drone* = male bee; *vixen* = female fox (also a quarrelsome woman).

7.2.2 Adding *-ess*

(a) Simply adding *-ess*:

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
author	authoress	lion	lioness
baron	baroness	manager	manageress
count	countess	mayor	mayoress
giant	giantess	patron	patroness
god	goddess	peer	peeress
heir	heiress	poet	poetess
host	hostess	priest	priestess
Jew	Jewess (offensive; avoid)	prophet	prophetess
shepherd	shepherdess	steward	stewardess
viscount	viscountess	deacon	deaconess

(b) Adding *-ess* after dropping a vowel of the masculine ending (*-er/-or* → *-ress*):

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
actor	actress	instructor	instructress
benefactor	benefactress	hunter	huntress
conductor	conductress	negotiator	negotiatress
director	directress	preceptor	preceptress
enchanter	enchantress	songster	songstress
founder	foundress	seamster	seamstress
tiger	tigress	traitor	traitress
waiter	waitress	votary	votaress

(c) Irregular *-ess* forms:

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
abbot	abbess	master	mistress
duke	duchess	murderer	murderess
emperor	empress	negro	negress (offensive; avoid)
governor	governess	sorcerer	sorceress
marquis / marquess	marchioness	adventurer	adventuress
prince	princess	lad	lass

7.2.3 Other Feminine Suffixes

Suffix	Masculine → Feminine
-ine	hero → heroine; Joseph → Josephine; Paul → Pauline; Augustus → Augustine (rare); landgrave → landgravine; margrave → margravine
-a	sultan → sultana; czar / tsar → czarina / tsarina; signor → signora; don → donna; Augustus → Augusta
-trix (law)	administrator → administratrix; executor → executrix; testator → testatrix; prosecutor → prosecutrix; aviator → aviatrix (old)
-ette	usher → usherette; suffragist → suffragette
-euse / -ée (French)	masseur → masseuse; chanteur → chanteuse; fiancé → fiancée; divorcé → divorcée; protégé → protégée
-ina	czar → czarina; Georgius → Georgina
-en / others	fox → vixen; bridegroom → bride (the masculine was formed from the feminine)

> **Masculine formed from feminine:** In a few pairs the *masculine* is derived from the feminine: *bride → bridegroom*, *widow → widower*, *goose → gander*, *duck → drake* (historically). *Widower* is a common exam item: the masculine of *widow* is **widower**.

7.2.4 Compound Words Showing Gender

Masculine	Feminine
he-goat / billy-goat	she-goat / nanny-goat
he-bear	she-bear
cock-sparrow	hen-sparrow
peacock	peahen
tom-cat	tabby-cat / queen
jack-ass	jenny-ass
bull-calf	cow-calf
bull-elephant	cow-elephant
buck-rabbit	doe-rabbit
man-servant	maid-servant
landlord	landlady
milkman	milkmaid
washerman	washerwoman
salesman	saleswoman
policeman	policewoman
headmaster	headmistress
schoolmaster	schoolmistress
grandfather	grandmother
step-father	step-mother
great-uncle	great-aunt
boyfriend	girlfriend
male-child	female-child
Mr Rahman	Mrs Rahman / Ms Rahman

7.3 Common Gender

A noun that can refer to **either a male or a female** is of **common gender**:

parent, child, baby, infant, friend, enemy, relative, relation, cousin, spouse, orphan, person, people, pupil, student, teacher, doctor, lawyer, servant, guardian, neighbour, citizen, leader, worker, clerk, cook, thief, monarch, sovereign, owner, singer, writer, artist, musician, author (modern use), deer, sheep, bird, cat, dog (in general use), fish, calf, foal, cub.

- My **cousin** is coming tomorrow. (male or female unknown)
- The **teacher** gave **his/her** opinion. → In formal writing: *The teacher gave **his or her** opinion*, or use the plural: *The teachers gave **their** opinions.*
- Every **student** must bring **his or her** own book. / All **students** must bring **their** own books.

7.4 Neuter Gender and Personification

Lifeless things are **neuter** and take the pronoun ***it***: *The tree has lost **its** leaves.*

When lifeless things or ideas are **personified** (spoken of as if they were persons) — mainly in poetry and literary prose — they are given a gender:

> **Rule of personification:** Things that suggest **strength, power, violence, greatness or terror** are treated as **masculine**; things that suggest **beauty, gentleness, grace, fertility or weakness** are treated as **feminine**.

Masculine (*he*)	Feminine (*she*)
the Sun	the Moon
Death	the Earth
Time	Nature
War	Peace
Winter / Summer	Spring
Anger	Mercy
Love (in classical poetry)	Hope, Faith, Charity
Fear, Despair	Liberty, Justice, Fortune
Thunder, the Ocean (sometimes)	Religion, Virtue, Fame
Mountain (sometimes)	a ship, a country, a city, a university, a boat, a car (by owners)

- The **sun** sheds **his** light on all.
- The **moon** has hidden **her** face behind a cloud.
- **Death** lays **his** icy hand on kings.
- **Spring** has spread **her** beauty over the land.
- The **ship** lost all **her** crew. / **Bangladesh** is proud of **her** freedom fighters.
- **Nature** is kind to those who love **her**.
- **Time** and tide wait for no man.

7.5 Gender of Animals and Babies

- Animals are normally ***it***: *The cat drank **its** milk.* But when we know the sex or feel close to an animal (pets, horses, cattle), we use ***he/she***: *Our cow has lost **her** calf.*
- Small animals and insects are usually treated as *it*, but by tradition: *the ant — **she**; the spider — **she**; the bee — **she**; the elephant/horse/dog — **he** (when sex unknown, in older usage).*
- **Baby / child / infant** can be *it* when sex is unknown or unimportant: *The baby cried for **its** mother*; otherwise *he* or *she*.

7.6 Modern Gender-Neutral Usage

International English (and SAT/GRE/GMAT writing) increasingly avoids unnecessary gender marking. Many *-ess* words are now old-fashioned, and gender-neutral terms are preferred in formal writing:

Old / gendered	Modern / neutral
chairman / chairwoman	chairperson, chair
spokesman	spokesperson
policeman / policewoman	police officer
fireman	firefighter
air hostess / steward(ess)	flight attendant, cabin crew
salesman / saleswoman	salesperson, sales representative
mankind	humanity, humankind, people
man-made	artificial, synthetic
poetess / authoress / manageress	poet / author / manager (for both)
actress	actor (increasingly used for both)
headmaster / headmistress	head teacher
businessman	businessperson, executive
cameraman	camera operator
workman	worker

Singular *they*: Modern English often uses *they/their* for a person of unknown or unspecified gender: *Someone left **their** umbrella.* This is now accepted by major dictionaries and style guides, but **traditional Bangladeshi exams and GMAT-style formal grammar** still prefer *his or her* after singular words like *everyone, each, anyone, a person*: *Everyone must do **his or her** duty.* (Older texts use *his* alone: *Everyone must do **his** duty.*)

7.7 Common Errors with Gender

1. ✘ The feminine of *widow* is … ✔ *Widow* is feminine; its masculine is **widower**.
2. ✘ The feminine of *fox* is *foxess*. ✔ **vixen**.
3. ✘ The feminine of *drake* is *drakess*. ✔ **duck**.
4. ✘ The feminine of *bachelor* is *bachelorette*. ✔ **spinster** / **maid** (*bachelorette* is informal American).
5. ✘ The feminine of *hero* is *heroess*. ✔ **heroine** (don't confuse with *heroin*, the drug).
6. ✘ The feminine of *sultan* is *sultaness*. ✔ **sultana**.
7. ✘ The feminine of *executor* is *executress*. ✔ **executrix**.
8. ✘ The masculine of *nun* is *nunner*. ✔ **monk** / **friar**.
9. ✘ The feminine of *stag* is *doe*. ✔ **hind** (*doe* is the female of *buck*).
10. ✘ The feminine of *colt* is *mare*. ✔ **filly** (*mare* is the female of *horse/stallion*).
11. ✘ The tree has lost it's leaves. ✔ The tree has lost **its** leaves.
12. ✘ Everybody should love their country. (traditional exam answer) ✔ Everybody should love **his** country / **his or her** country.
13. ✘ The ship sank with all its crew (in literary style). ✔ The ship sank with all **her** crew. (both accepted; literary tradition uses *her*)
14. ✘ My cousin sister came. ✔ My **cousin** came. (*cousin* is common gender)
15. ✘ The feminine of *wizard* is *wizardess*. ✔ **witch**.

7.8 Gender in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Pronoun agreement in gender and number** is tested through antecedents: ✘ *The company and its founder celebrated **its** anniversary* (ambiguous). Make the antecedent clear.
- ***His or her*** vs ***their***: In GMAT Sentence Correction, a singular antecedent (*each, every, a person, the applicant*) needs a singular pronoun: ✘ *Each applicant must submit **their** form.* ✔ *Each applicant must submit **his or her** form*, or better: *All applicants must submit **their** forms.*
- **GRE vocabulary** includes gender-linked words such as *matriarch / patriarch, matrilineal / patrilineal, misogynist* (hater of women), *misandrist* (hater of men), *philogynist, uxorious* (excessively fond of one's wife), *avuncular* (like an uncle; kind), *matronly, virile, effeminate, androgynous*.

CHAPTER 08

Pronoun

Part A · Grammar

8.1 What Is a Pronoun?

A **pronoun** is a word used **in place of a noun** (*pro* = for, instead of). It saves us from repeating the same noun again and again.

- ✘ Rahim is a good student. Rahim reads attentively. Rahim's teachers love Rahim.
- ✔ Rahim is a good student. **He** reads attentively. **His** teachers love **him**.

The noun that a pronoun refers to is called its **antecedent** (*ante* = before). In the example above, *Rahim* is the antecedent of *he*, *his* and *him*. A pronoun must agree with its antecedent in **number, gender and person**, and the reference must be **clear** — two points tested heavily in BCS, Bank, admission tests and especially in GMAT Sentence Correction.

8.2 Kinds of Pronoun

Kind	Members	Example
Personal	I, we, you, he, she, it, they (and their object forms)	**She** loves **them**.
Possessive	mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs	This book is **mine**.
Reflexive	myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself, themselves	He hurt **himself**.
Emphatic	(same forms as reflexive, used for emphasis)	I **myself** saw it.
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those, such, the same	**This** is my house.
Indefinite	one, none, some, any, all, many, few, somebody, anyone, everything, nothing, others	**Somebody** called you.
Distributive	each, either, neither	**Each** of them got a prize.
Reciprocal	each other, one another	They love **each other**.
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that, what, as, but	This is the man **who** helped me.
Interrogative	who, whom, whose, which, what	**Who** is there?

8.3 Personal Pronouns

8.3.1 Person, Number and Case

Person	Number	Subjective (Nominative)	Objective	Possessive determiner	Possessive pronoun
1st	Singular	I	me	my	mine
1st	Plural	we	us	our	ours
2nd	Sing./Plural	you	you	your	yours
3rd	Sing. masculine	he	him	his	his
3rd	Sing. feminine	she	her	her	hers
3rd	Sing. neuter	it	it	its	(its)
3rd	Plural	they	them	their	theirs

- The **subjective** form is used as the **subject** of a verb and as the **complement** after *be* (formal).
- The **objective** form is used as the **object** of a verb or of a **preposition**.

8.3.2 Case Rules — Most Tested Points

Rule 1 — After a preposition, use the objective case.

- ✘ Between you and I ✔ Between you and **me**.
- ✘ This is for he and I. ✔ This is for **him and me**.
- ✘ Everyone except she came. ✔ Everyone except **her** came.
- ✘ All but he were present. ✔ All but **him** were present. (*but* = except, a preposition)
- ✘ Let you and I go. ✔ Let you and **me** go. (*let* takes an object)
- ✘ He gave it to my brother and I. ✔ … to my brother and **me**.

> **Exam Tip — The "remove the other person" test:** In a compound like *my brother and I/me*, remove the other person and listen: *He gave it to ~~my brother and~~ **me*** ✔ (✘ *He gave it to I*). *~~Rahim and~~ **I** went home* ✔ (✘ *Me went home*).

Rule 2 — After *than* and *as … as*, the case depends on the understood verb.

- He is taller than **I** (am). ✔ (✘ taller than me — informal; in exams choose *I*)
- She is as clever as **he** (is).
- I love you more than **he** (loves you). — meaning: he loves you less than I do.
- I love you more than (I love) **him**. — meaning: I love him less than I love you.

Rule 3 — After the verb *be*, formal English uses the subjective case.

- It is **I**. (formal) / It's **me**. (informal, everyday)
- It was **he** who broke the glass.
- If I were **he**, I would apologise.
- ✘ It is them who are responsible. ✔ It is **they** who are responsible.

Rule 4 — With an infinitive *to be*, the pronoun takes the same case as the word before *to be*.

- I took him to be **me**. (*him* is objective, so *me*)
- I was taken to be **he**. (*I* is subjective, so *he*)

Rule 5 — In apposition, the pronoun takes the case of the noun it explains.

- **We** students are protesting. (✘ Us students) → *We are protesting.*
- They punished **us** boys. (✘ we boys) → *They punished us.*

8.3.3 Order of Personal Pronouns (The 231 / 123 Rule)

When pronouns of different persons come together:

- For **good or neutral** things, use the order **2 → 3 → 1** (*you, he, I*) — out of politeness the speaker puts himself last: ***You, he and I*** *will go together.* ***You and I*** *are friends.*
- For **confessing a fault or guilt**, use **1 → 2 → 3** (*I, you, he*) — the speaker accepts blame first: ***I, you and he*** *are to blame.* ***I and he*** *broke the vase.*
- In the **plural**, the order is **1 → 2 → 3**: ***We, you and they*** *must work together.*

› ✘ I and you will go. ✔ **You and I** will go.

› ✘ He, you and I are guilty. ✔ **I, you and he** are guilty.

8.3.4 Agreement of Pronoun with Antecedent

> A pronoun must agree with its antecedent in **number**, **gender** and **person**.

1. Two antecedents joined by ***and*** → plural pronoun: *Rahim* ***and*** *Karim did* ***their*** *duty.*
2. But if the two nouns refer to **one** person/thing, or are preceded by ***each / every***, use singular: *The secretary and treasurer has given* ***his*** *report.* ***Every*** *man and woman must do* ***his or her*** *duty.*
3. Antecedents joined by ***or, nor, either…or, neither…nor*** → the pronoun agrees with the **nearer** one: *Neither the teacher nor the* ***students*** *have finished* ***their*** *work. Either the boys or* ***Rina*** *has lost* ***her*** *book.*
4. **Collective noun** as a unit → singular; as individuals → plural: *The* ***jury*** *gave* ***its*** *verdict. The* ***jury*** *were divided in* ***their*** *opinions.*
5. ***Each, every, either, neither, everyone, everybody, anyone, someone, no one, nobody*** → singular pronoun: ***Each*** *of the boys must bring* ***his*** *own pen.* ***Everyone*** *should love* ***his*** *country.*
6. ***One*** → ***one's / oneself*** (British formal): ***One*** *should do* ***one's*** *duty.* ***One*** *must not praise* ***oneself***. (✘ *One should do his duty* — American usage accepts *his*; in Bangladeshi exams choose ***one's***.)

8.3.5 Special Uses of *It*

Use	Example
For things, animals, babies (sex unknown)	*The baby is crying for* ***its*** *mother.*
Impersonal subject (weather, time, distance)	***It*** *is raining.* ***It*** *is 10 o'clock.* ***It*** *is five kilometres to the station.*
Introductory (anticipatory) subject for an infinitive / clause	***It*** *is easy to learn English.* ***It*** *is certain that he will come.*
Introductory object	*I find* ***it*** *difficult to believe him.*
Emphasis (cleft sentence)	***It*** *was Rahim who broke the glass.* ***It*** *is you that I want.*
For a previously mentioned statement	*He is honest; everybody knows* ***it****.*
Identifying a person	*Who is at the door? —* ***It*** *is the postman.*

8.4 Possessive Pronouns

Mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs stand **alone** (they replace *possessive determiner + noun*).

› This pen is **mine** (= my pen). / ✘ This is mine pen. ✔ This is **my** pen.

› Your house is bigger than **ours**.

› The fault is **theirs**, not **yours**.

› A friend of **mine** (✘ a friend of me / ✘ a friend of my).

> **No apostrophe in possessive pronouns:** ✘ *your's, her's, our's, their's, it's* (as possessive). ✔ ***yours, hers, ours, theirs, its***. *It's* always means *it is* or *it has*.

8.5 Reflexive and Emphatic Pronouns

The *-self / -selves* forms: ***myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, oneself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves***. (✘ *hisself, theirselves, ourself* — not standard.)

8.5.1 Reflexive Use

A **reflexive pronoun** is used as the **object** when the action of the verb **turns back on the subject** (subject and object are the same person).

› He hurt **himself**.

› She looked at **herself** in the mirror.

› We enjoyed **ourselves** at the party.

› They prided **themselves** on their success.

Some verbs **must** be followed by a reflexive pronoun (or an object) in standard English:

absent oneself (from), avail oneself (of), pride oneself (on), enjoy oneself, acquit oneself (well), betake oneself (to), revenge oneself (on), resign oneself (to), apply oneself (to), exert oneself, oversleep (no reflexive), behave oneself, help oneself (to), excuse oneself.

› ✘ He absented from the class. ✔ He absented **himself** from the class.

› ✘ You should avail of this opportunity. ✔ You should avail **yourself** of this opportunity.

› ✘ We enjoyed very much. ✔ We enjoyed **ourselves** very much. / We enjoyed **the party** very much.

› ✘ He prides on his wealth. ✔ He prides **himself** on his wealth.

Conversely, some verbs **do not take** a reflexive pronoun in normal English:

keep, hide, qualify, rest, stop, turn, bathe, feel, relax, meet, concentrate, wake up, get up, sit down, move, open, shave, dress, wash (when the meaning is clear).

› ✘ He kept himself away. ✔ He **kept away**.

› ✘ Turn yourself to the right. ✔ **Turn** to the right.

› ✘ Please concentrate yourself on your studies. ✔ Please **concentrate** on your studies.

› ✘ I feel myself better. ✔ I **feel** better.

› ✘ Qualify yourself for the post. ✔ **Qualify** for the post.

8.5.2 Emphatic Use

The same forms are **emphatic** when they are placed next to a noun or pronoun to **emphasise** it. They can be removed without changing the grammar.

› I **myself** saw the accident. / I saw the accident **myself**.

› The Prime Minister **herself** inaugurated the bridge.

› You **yourself** said so.

> **A *-self* pronoun cannot be the subject by itself.** ✘ *Myself and Rahim went there.* ✔ ***Rahim and I*** *went there.* ✘ *The tickets were bought by Karim and myself.* ✔ *… by Karim and* ***me***. ✘ *Myself is Rina.* ✔ ***I am*** *Rina /* ***My name is*** *Rina.*

8.6 Demonstrative Pronouns

This, that, these, those (and sometimes ***such, the same***) are **demonstrative pronouns** when they stand alone and point to something.

- **This** is my bag; **that** is yours.
- **These** are fresh; **those** are stale.
- The climate of Sylhet is better than **that** of Dhaka. (*that* = the climate)
- The roads of Dhaka are wider than **those** of Old Dhaka.
- He is a fool and must be treated as **such**.
- I bought a pen and gave **the same** to my brother. (commercial style; better: *gave **it***)

8.7 Indefinite Pronouns

Indefinite pronouns refer to persons or things **in a general way**, not to anyone in particular.

Always singular	Always plural	Singular or plural (depends on *of*-noun)
one, each, either, neither, anybody, anyone, anything, everybody, everyone, everything, nobody, no one, nothing, somebody, someone, something, another, much, little	both, few, many, several, others	all, any, none, some, most, more, half, plenty, a lot

- **Everybody is** happy. (✘ are)
- **Nobody knows** the answer.
- **Something is** wrong.
- **Many were** invited, but **few came**.
- **Both are** guilty.
- **All** of the money **is** gone. / **All** of the books **are** gone.
- **Some** of the milk **was** spilt. / **Some** of the students **were** late.
- **None** of the information **is** useful. / **None** of the boys **is** (formal) / **are** (common) here.

> ***None*** literally means *not one*, so traditional grammar prefers a singular verb: ***None** of them **is** present.* Modern usage commonly accepts a plural verb with a plural noun. In Bangladeshi exams, if one option uses *is* and the other *are*, the traditional answer is ***is***. With an uncountable noun, *none* is always singular: ***None** of the work **has** been done.*

8.8 Distributive and Reciprocal Pronouns

Distributive pronouns (*each, either, neither*) refer to persons or things **one at a time**. They take a **singular** verb and pronoun.

- **Each** of the players **has** received **his** medal.
- **Either** of the two roads **leads** to the market. (two only)
- **Neither** of my parents **is** at home. (two only)
- ✘ Either of the three boys … ✔ **Any** of the three boys … / ✘ Neither of the five … ✔ **None** of the five …

Reciprocal pronouns show a **mutual** relationship: ***each other*** (traditionally for **two**) and ***one another*** (traditionally for **more than two**).

- The husband and wife love **each other**.
- The members of the team help **one another**.
- They looked at **each other's** faces. (possessive form)

8.9 Relative Pronouns

A **relative pronoun** does two jobs: (1) it **refers back** to a noun (its antecedent), and (2) it **joins** two clauses — so it works as both a pronoun and a conjunction. The clause it introduces is an **adjective (relative) clause**.

- This is the boy. He won the prize. → This is the boy **who** won the prize.
- I found the book. I had lost it. → I found the book **which** I had lost.

8.9.1 *Who, Whom, Whose, Which, That, What*

Relative	Used for	Function	Example
who	persons	subject	*The man **who** came here is my uncle.*
whom	persons	object	*The man **whom** you met is my uncle.*
whose	persons (and things)	possession	*The boy **whose** father is a doctor is my friend. The house **whose** roof is red …*
which	things, animals	subject / object	*The book **which** you gave me is useful.*
that	persons and things	subject / object (defining clauses only)	*The boy **that** won / the book **that** I read*
what	things	= *the thing(s) which* (no antecedent)	***What** he said is true.*

8.9.2 *Who* or *Whom*? — The *he/him* Test

Turn the relative clause into a separate sentence. If ***he/she/they*** fits, use ***who***; if ***him/her/them*** fits, use ***whom***.

- This is the man ___ I think is honest. → *I think **he** is honest* → ***who*** ✔ (✘ whom — a classic GMAT/GRE trap)
- This is the man ___ we elected. → *We elected **him*** → ***whom*** ✔
- ___ do you want to see? → *You want to see **him*** → ***Whom*** (formal) / *Who* (informal)
- Give it to ___ needs it most. → ***whoever*** (*he* needs it) ✔ (✘ whomever)
- Give it to ___ you like. → ***whomever*** (*you like him*) ✔

8.9.3 When Only *That* Can Be Used

Use ***that*** (not *who/which*) after:

1. **Superlatives:** *He is the **best** man **that** I have ever met.*
2. ***all, any, none, nothing, everything, anything, something, much, little, only, the same, the very, the first, the last*: *All **that** glitters is not gold. This is **the same** book **that** I lost. He is **the only** man **that** can help us. **Nothing that** he said was true.*
3. **Interrogative *who / what*: *Who **that** has common sense will believe it? **What** is there **that** I cannot do?***
4. **Two antecedents, one a person and one a thing/animal:** *The man **and his dog that** passed by were wet.*
5. **Emphatic *It is/was … that*:** *It is the teacher **that** we respect.*

8.9.4 When *That* Cannot Be Used

1. **After a preposition:** ✘ *the house **in that** he lives* → ✔ *the house **in which** he lives* / ✔ *the house **that** he lives **in**.*

2. **In a non-defining clause (after a comma):** ✘ *My father, that is a doctor, … → ✔ My father, **who** is a doctor, …*

8.9.5 Defining and Non-Defining Relative Clauses

- A **defining (restrictive)** clause tells us **which one** is meant; it is essential and has **no commas**: *The students **who studied hard** passed.* (only those students)
- A **non-defining (non-restrictive)** clause gives **extra information** about an already identified noun; it is set off by **commas**: *The students, **who studied hard**, passed.* (all the students studied hard and passed)

› My brother **who lives in London** is a doctor. (I have more than one brother.)
› My brother, **who lives in London**, is a doctor. (I have only one brother.)
› Dhaka, **which is the capital of Bangladesh**, is very crowded. (non-defining — commas required)

8.9.6 Omission of the Relative Pronoun

In a **defining** clause, an **object** relative pronoun can be omitted: *The book (**that/which**) I bought is good. The man (**whom**) you met is my uncle.* A **subject** relative cannot be omitted: ✘ *The man helped me is my uncle.* ✔ *The man **who** helped me …*

8.9.7 *As* and *But* as Relative Pronouns

- ***As*** after ***such*** and ***the same***: *Such boys **as** are lazy will fail. This is **the same** pen **as** mine.* (✘ such boys who …)
- ***But*** = *who … not* after a negative: *There is no one **but** loves his country* (= who does not love). *There is no rose **but** has thorns.*

8.9.8 Agreement of the Verb after a Relative Pronoun

> The verb in a relative clause agrees with the **antecedent** of the relative pronoun in **number and person**.

› **I**, who **am** your friend, will help you. (✘ who is)
› **You**, who **are** my friend, should help me.
› It is **I** who **am** to blame. / It is **you** who **are** to blame.
› He is one of **the boys who have** passed. (*who* refers to *boys*, plural)
› He is **the only one** of the boys **who has** passed. (*who* refers to *the only one*, singular)

8.9.9 Position of the Relative Pronoun

Place the relative pronoun **as near as possible** to its antecedent, or the sentence becomes absurd:

› ✘ I have a cow for my brother which gives good milk. ✔ For my brother I have a cow **which** gives good milk.
› ✘ He bought a horse from a dealer that was lame. ✔ He bought from a dealer a horse **that** was lame.

8.9.10 Common Mistakes with *What*

What contains its own antecedent (= *that which*), so it cannot follow a noun or *all*:

› ✘ All what he said is true. ✔ **All that** he said is true.
› ✘ The thing what I want … ✔ The thing **that/which** I want … / ✔ **What** I want …
› ✘ This is the book what I bought. ✔ … the book **that/which** I bought.

8.10 Interrogative Pronouns

Who, whom, whose, which, what are **interrogative pronouns** when they ask questions.

› **Who** is knocking? (subject)
› **Whom** did you invite? (object — formal) / **Who** did you invite? (informal)
› **Whose** is this umbrella? (pronoun) / **Whose** umbrella is this? (determiner)
› **Which** of these is yours? (limited choice)
› **What** do you want? (open choice)
› ✘ Who are you speaking to? (informal) ✔ **To whom** are you speaking? (formal)

8.11 Common Errors with Pronouns

1. ✘ Between you and I, he is a liar. ✔ Between you and **me**, …
2. ✘ He is taller than me. (in exam) ✔ He is taller than **I** (am).
3. ✘ It is me who am responsible. ✔ It is **I** who **am** responsible.
4. ✘ Myself and my wife will attend. ✔ **My wife and I** will attend.
5. ✘ I and you will go. ✔ **You and I** will go.
6. ✘ Each of the girls have done their work. ✔ Each of the girls **has** done **her** work.
7. ✘ Everyone must bring their own lunch. (traditional) ✔ Everyone must bring **his or her** own lunch.
8. ✘ One should respect his parents. ✔ One should respect **one's** parents.
9. ✘ Is this book your's? ✔ Is this book **yours**?
10. ✘ The dog wagged it's tail. ✔ The dog wagged **its** tail.
11. ✘ He availed of the chance. ✔ He availed **himself** of the chance.
12. ✘ We enjoyed during the holidays. ✔ We enjoyed **ourselves** during the holidays.
13. ✘ Please keep yourself quiet. ✔ Please **keep quiet**.
14. ✘ They hurt theirselves. ✔ They hurt **themselves**.
15. ✘ The man whom I think is guilty has fled. ✔ The man **who** I think is guilty has fled.
16. ✘ Whom do you think will win? ✔ **Who** do you think will win?
17. ✘ This is the pen what I bought. ✔ This is the pen **that** I bought.
18. ✘ All what glitters is not gold. ✔ **All that** glitters is not gold.
19. ✘ He is the best man who I know. ✔ He is the best man **that** I know.
20. ✘ My mother, that is a teacher, … ✔ My mother, **who** is a teacher, …
21. ✘ The house in that he lives is old. ✔ The house **in which** he lives is old.
22. ✘ Such boys who are lazy fail. ✔ Such boys **as** are lazy fail.
23. ✘ He is one of the best players who has ever played. ✔ … **who have** ever played.
24. ✘ Neither of the five candidates was selected. ✔ **None** of the five candidates was selected.
25. ✘ The jury gave their verdict. ✔ The jury gave **its** verdict. (acting as one body)
26. ✘ Let he and I go. ✔ Let **him and me** go.
27. ✘ Us Bangladeshis are hospitable. ✔ **We** Bangladeshis are hospitable.
28. ✘ The teacher punished we boys. ✔ The teacher punished **us** boys.
29. ✘ Whom is there? ✔ **Who** is there?
30. ✘ The climate of Cox's Bazar is better than Dhaka. ✔ … better than **that of** Dhaka.
31. ✘ He and myself are friends. ✔ **He and I** are friends.

32. ✘ The students, who's results were good, were praised. ✔ The students, **whose** results were good, were praised.
33. ✘ Rahim told Karim that he would win. (ambiguous) ✔ Rahim told Karim, "**You** will win" / "**I** will win".
34. ✘ Anybody can do it if they try. (traditional exam) ✔ Anybody can do it if **he** tries.
35. ✘ He, you and I are to blame. ✔ **I, you and he** are to blame.

8.12 Pronouns in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Pronoun questions are among the most common in GMAT Sentence Correction and SAT Writing. Check every pronoun for these four problems:

1. **Ambiguous reference** — the pronoun could refer to two nouns: ✘ *When the manager met the clerk, **he** was angry.* (Who was angry?) Replace the pronoun with the noun.
2. **No antecedent / possessive antecedent** — a pronoun should refer to a noun actually present in the sentence, not to a possessive or an implied idea: ✘ *In **Tagore's** poems, **he** celebrates nature* (GMAT strict rule: *he* cannot refer to the possessive *Tagore's*). ✔ *In **his** poems, Tagore celebrates nature.* ✘ *Although she studied medicine, **it** never interested her* (*it* = medicine? studying?).
3. **Number disagreement** — singular *company, country, team, government, each, every* need *it/its*, not *they/their*: ✘ *The company increased **their** profits.* ✔ ***its** profits.*
4. **Wrong case** — ✘ *between you and I,* ✘ *the person whom I believe is guilty.*

GMAT *which* rule: In GMAT, ***which*** (after a comma) must refer to the **noun immediately before it**, never to a whole clause: ✘ *The prices rose sharply, **which** angered consumers.* ✔ *The prices rose sharply, **a rise that** angered consumers* / … ***angering** consumers.*

SAT/American English: *that* introduces **restrictive** clauses (no commas); ***which*** introduces **non-restrictive** clauses (with commas): *The car **that** I bought is red* / *My car, **which** is red, is fast.*

CHAPTER 09

Adjective

Part A · Grammar

9.1 What Is an Adjective?

An **adjective** is a word that **qualifies** a noun or a pronoun — that is, it **adds something to its meaning** by describing it, limiting it, or telling its number or quantity. The word comes from Latin *adject-ivum*, "something added".

- a **brave** soldier (what kind?)
- **five** apples (how many?)
- **much** water (how much?)
- **this** book (which one?)
- She is **intelligent**. (describes the pronoun *she*)

9.1.1 Three Positions of the Adjective

1. **Attributive** — before the noun: *a **red** rose, an **old** man*.
2. **Predicative** — after a linking verb (*be, seem, look, feel, become, grow, appear, remain, smell, taste, sound, turn*): *The rose is **red**. The man looks **old**. The milk turned **sour**.*
3. **Postpositive** — immediately after the noun (special cases, see 9.5.2): *something **new**, the people **concerned**, the President **elect**.*

9.2 Kinds of Adjectives

Kind	What it tells	Examples
Adjective of Quality (Descriptive)	what kind	good, bad, honest, large, beautiful, wise, Bangladeshi
Proper Adjective	quality derived from a proper noun	Bangladeshi, English, Shakespearean, Victorian
Adjective of Quantity	how much (uncountables)	some, much, little, enough, whole, all, no, half, sufficient
Adjective of Number (Numeral)	how many / in what order	one, two, first, second, many, few, several, all, some
Demonstrative Adjective	which one	this, that, these, those, such, the same, the other
Distributive Adjective	each one separately	each, every, either, neither
Interrogative Adjective	asks a question (+ noun)	what, which, whose
Possessive Adjective	ownership	my, our, your, his, her, its, their
Emphasising Adjective	emphasis	own, very (*my **own** house; the **very** man*)
Exclamatory Adjective	surprise	what (***What** a genius!*)

Most demonstrative, distributive, interrogative and possessive adjectives are **determiners** (Chapter 04) in modern grammar.

9.2.1 Adjectives of Number

- **Definite numeral adjectives** — an exact number:
  - **Cardinal**: *one, two, ten, hundred*;
  - **Ordinal**: *first, second, tenth, hundredth, last*;
  - **Multiplicative**: *single, double, triple, twofold, threefold*.
- **Indefinite numeral adjectives** — no exact number: *many, few, a few, several, all, some, any, no, numerous, sundry, certain*.
- **Distributive numeral adjectives**: *each, every, either, neither*.

9.2.2 Same Word, Quantity or Number?

Some, any, enough, all, no, more, most can be adjectives of **quantity** (with uncountables) or **number** (with countable plurals):

- I want **some** milk. (quantity) / **Some** boys came. (number)
- Have you **any** money? (quantity) / Are there **any** mangoes? (number)
- We have **enough** rice. (quantity) / We have **enough** chairs. (number)
- **All** the milk was spilt. (quantity) / **All** the boys were present. (number)

9.3 Proper Adjectives

Proper adjectives are formed from **proper nouns** and begin with a **capital letter**. Questions such as "*The adjective of Holland is …*" are common.

9.3.1 Countries and Nationalities

Country	Adjective / Language	Country	Adjective / Language
Bangladesh	Bangladeshi	Holland / the Netherlands	Dutch
Bengal	Bengali / Bangla	Switzerland	Swiss
India	Indian	Wales	Welsh
Pakistan	Pakistani	Ireland	Irish
Nepal	Nepalese / Nepali	Scotland	Scottish (Scotch: whisky)
Bhutan	Bhutanese	Spain	Spanish
Sri Lanka	Sri Lankan	Portugal	Portuguese
Myanmar	Myanmar / Burmese	Greece	Greek
Afghanistan	Afghan	Turkey	Turkish
China	Chinese	Denmark	Danish
Japan	Japanese	Sweden	Swedish
Thailand	Thai	Norway	Norwegian
Philippines	Filipino / Philippine	Finland	Finnish
Iraq	Iraqi	Poland	Polish
Iran	Iranian	Belgium	Belgian
Kuwait	Kuwaiti	France	French
Saudi Arabia	Saudi	Germany	German
Israel	Israeli	Cyprus	Cypriot
Yemen	Yemeni	Peru	Peruvian
Egypt	Egyptian	Congo	Congolese
Sudan	Sudanese	Malta	Maltese
Vietnam	Vietnamese	Monaco	Monegasque

> ***Arab / Arabian / Arabic:*** *Arab* refers to people and their countries (*the Arab world, an Arab leader*); *Arabian* refers to the geographical region (*the Arabian Peninsula, the Arabian Sea, The Arabian Nights*); *Arabic* refers to the language and script (*Arabic numerals, the Arabic language*).

9.3.2 Adjectives from Names of Persons (Eponymous Adjectives)

These are especially important for GRE/SAT vocabulary.

Person / Source	Adjective	Meaning
Christ	Christian	following Christ
Shakespeare	Shakespearean	of Shakespeare's style
Victoria	Victorian	of Queen Victoria's age; prudish
Elizabeth I	Elizabethan	of the age of Elizabeth I
Plato	Platonic	spiritual, non-physical (*platonic love*)
Socrates	Socratic	by question and answer
Homer	Homeric	heroic, epic
Machiavelli	Machiavellian	cunning, unscrupulous
Darwin	Darwinian	of evolution
Marx	Marxist / Marxian	of Marx's theory
Gandhi	Gandhian	non-violent
Napoleon	Napoleonic	of Napoleon
Milton / Byron	Miltonic / Byronic	grand / gloomy and passionate
Kafka	Kafkaesque	nightmarishly complex, absurd
Orwell	Orwellian	totalitarian, deceptive
Freud	Freudian	of the subconscious
Newton / Euclid	Newtonian / Euclidean	of Newton / Euclid
Hercules	Herculean	requiring great strength
Don Quixote	quixotic	idealistic and impractical
Draco	draconian	excessively harsh (laws)
Procrustes	Procrustean	forcing conformity
Prometheus	Promethean	daringly creative
Pyrrhus	Pyrrhic	won at too great a cost (*a Pyrrhic victory*)
Sparta	Spartan	simple, austere
Utopia	utopian	ideal but impractical
Epicurus	epicurean	devoted to pleasure, fine food
Stoics	stoic(al)	bearing pain without complaint
Mercury	mercurial	changeable, unpredictable
Jove (Jupiter)	jovial	cheerful
Saturn	saturnine	gloomy
Narcissus	narcissistic	excessively self-loving
Titan	titanic	huge

9.4 Adjectives of Quantity and Number: Correct Use

- **Much** time / **many** books (Chapter 03)
- **Little** water / **few** boys; **a little** / **a few**; **less** / **fewer**
- **Some** (positive) / **any** (negative, question)
- **Each** (two or more, separately) / **every** (more than two, collectively)
- **Either / neither** (two only)
- ***Whole*** with singular countable (*the whole class*); ***all*** with plurals and uncountables (*all the boys; all the money*)
- ***Enough*** before a noun, after an adjective: *enough money; strong enough*

9.5 Position of Adjectives

9.5.1 Attributive and Predicative

Most adjectives can be used in both positions: *a **happy** child / The child is **happy**.* But some adjectives are restricted.

Adjectives used only predicatively (after a verb) — mostly beginning with *a-*:

afraid, alike, alive, alone, asleep, awake, aware, ashamed, afloat, ablaze, aghast, akin, averse, content, glad, ill (= sick, BrE), well (= healthy), unable, sorry (= regretful).

- ✘ an asleep child ✔ a **sleeping** child / The child is **asleep**.
- ✘ an alive fish ✔ a **live / living** fish / The fish is **alive**.
- ✘ an afraid boy ✔ a **frightened** boy / The boy is **afraid**.
- ✘ two alike brothers ✔ two **similar** brothers / The two brothers are **alike**.
- ✘ an alone woman ✔ a **lonely / solitary** woman / She lives **alone**.
- ✘ an ill man (BrE) ✔ a **sick** man / The man is **ill**.

Adjectives used only attributively (before a noun):

chief, main, principal, mere, sheer, utter, only, very (= exact), elder, eldest, former, latter, inner, outer, upper, utmost, live (= living), drunken, lone, sole, entire, total, outright, maiden (voyage), woollen, wooden.

- the **chief** guest (✘ The guest is chief.)
- a **mere** child; **sheer** luck; **utter** nonsense
- my **elder** brother (✘ My brother is elder than me → ✔ **older** than me)
- the **main** road; the **former** president

9.5.2 Postpositive Adjectives (Adjective after Noun)

1. **After *something, anything, nothing, everything, someone, anybody* etc.:** *something **new**, nothing **important**, anyone **intelligent**, somewhere **quiet**.* (✘ new something)
2. **In fixed (often legal or French-influenced) phrases:** *heir **apparent**, Poet **Laureate**, Governor **General**, Attorney **General**, Secretary **General**, Prince **Royal**, court **martial**, notary **public**, body **politic**, sum **total**, time **immemorial**, God **Almighty**, the President **elect**, things **Bangladeshi**, letters **patent**, blood **royal**.*
3. **With *concerned, involved, present, responsible, available, possible*** (often with a different meaning): *the people **concerned*** (= affected) vs *a **concerned** mother* (= worried); *the members **present*** (= in attendance) vs *the **present** members* (= current); *the person **responsible*** vs *a **responsible** person*; *the best route **possible**; tickets **available**.*
4. **When the adjective has a complement or modifier:** *a man **eager to learn**; a box **full of toys**; a student **proud of his success**.*
5. **Measurement expressions:** *ten feet **tall**, five years **old**, two metres **wide**, a mile **long**.*
6. **For emphasis or in poetry, two or more adjectives together:** *a man, **tall and handsome**; a lady **young and beautiful**; the sky **blue and bright**.*

9.5.3 The Order of Several Adjectives

When several adjectives come before a noun, native speakers follow a natural order. A useful memory aid is **OSASCOMP**:

Order	Category	Examples
(Determiner)	article, demonstrative, possessive, number	a, the, this, my, two
1. **O**pinion	judgement	beautiful, nice, ugly, delicious, useful
2. **S**ize	big/small	big, small, tall, long, huge
3. **A**ge	old/new	old, new, young, ancient, modern
4. **S**hape	form	round, square, flat, triangular
5. **C**olour	colour	red, black, green, golden
6. **O**rigin	nationality, place	Bangladeshi, Chinese, Italian
7. **M**aterial	what it is made of	silk, wooden, cotton, steel
8. **P**urpose	what it is for (often a gerund/noun)	wedding, sleeping, running, dining
(Noun)		saree, bag, shoes, table

- a **beautiful old red** car (opinion–age–colour)
- a **big round wooden** table (size–shape–material)
- a **lovely small new Bangladeshi silk wedding** saree
- ✘ a red big ball ✔ a **big red** ball
- ✘ a cotton white shirt ✔ a **white cotton** shirt
- ✘ an old nice house ✔ a **nice old** house
- ✘ the three first chapters ✔ **the first three** chapters (ordinal before cardinal)

9.5.4 Commas between Adjectives

Coordinate adjectives (of the same category, each modifying the noun equally) are separated by a comma or *and*: *a **long, boring** speech; a **kind and generous** man*. Test: if you can reverse them or put *and* between them, use a comma. **Cumulative adjectives** (of different categories, following OSASCOMP) take **no comma**: *a **big red** ball* (✘ a big, red ball).

9.6 Adjectives After Linking Verbs (Not Adverbs!)

After **linking (copular) verbs**, we use an **adjective**, because it describes the **subject**, not the action. Linking verbs: *be, seem, appear, look, feel, smell, taste, sound, become, grow, get, turn, go, remain, keep, stay, prove*.

- The rose smells **sweet**. (✘ sweetly)
- The food tastes **delicious**. (✘ deliciously)
- She looks **beautiful**. (✘ beautifully)
- I feel **bad** about it. (✘ badly)
- The milk has turned **sour**.
- Keep **quiet**. / Stay **calm**. / He remained **silent**.
- The plan proved **useful**.

> **Same verb, two uses:** Some of these verbs can also be **action verbs**; then they take an **adverb**. *She **looked** angrily at me* (action of looking → adverb) vs *She **looked** angry* (her appearance → adjective). *He **felt** the cloth carefully* (action → adverb) vs *He **felt** sad* (state → adjective). *The dog **smelt** the bone eagerly* vs *The bone **smelt** bad*.

Adjectives as object complements — after verbs like *make, keep, find, consider, paint, leave, drive, set*: *The news made her **sad**. Keep the room **clean**. They painted the door **green**. I found the book **interesting**. The noise drove him **mad**.*

9.7 Participial Adjectives: *-ing* vs *-ed*

This is one of the most tested adjective points in admission tests and SAT/GMAT.

> ***-ing*** adjectives describe the **thing or person that causes** a feeling (*the cause*). ***-ed*** adjectives describe the **person who has** the feeling (*the effect*).

Cause (*-ing*)	Feeling (*-ed*)	Example
boring	bored	*The lecture was **boring**, so the students were **bored**.*
interesting	interested	*The book is **interesting**; I am **interested** in it.*
exciting	excited	*It was an **exciting** match; the fans were **excited**.*
tiring	tired	*The journey was **tiring**; we were **tired**.*
confusing	confused	*The question was **confusing**; I was **confused**.*
frightening	frightened	*a **frightening** film; a **frightened** child*
surprising	surprised	*a **surprising** result; a **surprised** look*
disappointing	disappointed	*His result was **disappointing**; his parents were **disappointed**.*
amazing	amazed	*an **amazing** performance; an **amazed** audience*
satisfying	satisfied	*a **satisfying** meal; a **satisfied** customer*
embarrassing	embarrassed	*an **embarrassing** question; an **embarrassed** boy*
shocking	shocked	***shocking** news; **shocked** relatives*
annoying	annoyed	*an **annoying** noise; an **annoyed** neighbour*
worrying	worried	*a **worrying** situation; **worried** parents*
exhausting	exhausted	*an **exhausting** day; an **exhausted** worker*
depressing	depressed	***depressing** weather; a **depressed** patient*
fascinating	fascinated	*a **fascinating** story; **fascinated** listeners*
pleasing	pleased	*a **pleasing** manner; a **pleased** teacher*
terrifying	terrified	*a **terrifying** storm; **terrified** villagers*
inspiring	inspired	*an **inspiring** speech; an **inspired** youth*

- ✘ I am very boring in the class. (= I make others bored!) ✔ I am very **bored** in the class.
- ✘ The film was very interested. ✔ The film was very **interesting**.
- ✘ He felt exciting about the trip. ✔ He felt **excited** about the trip.

9.8 Compound Adjectives

A **compound adjective** is formed from two or more words joined by a **hyphen** when it comes **before** a noun.

Pattern	Examples
Number + noun (noun stays singular)	a **five-year** plan, a **ten-taka** note, a **two-hour** journey, a **three-storeyed** building, a **ten-year-old** boy (✘ ten-years-old)
Adjective + noun + -ed	**blue-eyed**, **left-handed**, **kind-hearted**, **long-legged**, **absent-minded**, **narrow-minded**
Noun + present participle	**heart-breaking**, **time-consuming**, **record-breaking**, **peace-loving**, **mouth-watering**
Noun/adverb + past participle	**hand-made**, **home-made**, **well-known**, **well-educated**, **sun-dried**, **man-made**, **tongue-tied**
Adjective + present participle	**good-looking**, **easy-going**, **long-lasting**, **far-reaching**
Noun + adjective	**world-famous**, **sugar-free**, **duty-free**, **ice-cold**, **sky-blue**, **knee-deep**

> **No hyphen after the noun:** *a **well-known** writer* but *The writer is **well known**. A **ten-year-old** boy* but *The boy is **ten years old**.*

9.9 Adjectives Used as Nouns

1. ***The* + adjective = a class of people (plural verb):** *the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the blind, the deaf, the dumb, the wounded, the unemployed, the homeless, the dead, the brave, the wise, the righteous, the wicked — **The poor are** suffering.*
2. ***The* + adjective = abstract quality (singular):** *the good, the true, the beautiful, the sublime, the unknown, the supernatural — **The beautiful is** not always good.*
3. **Some adjectives have become full nouns:** *a **native**, a **savage**, a **criminal**, an **intellectual**, the **accused**, the **deceased**, the **elders**, the **ancients**, **valuables**, **sweets**, **greens**, **eatables**, **drinkables**, the **innocents**, the **Blacks/Whites** (careful usage), **liberals**, **conservatives**.*
4. **Fixed phrases with adjective as noun:** *in **short**, in **general**, in **particular**, at **best**, at **worst**, for **good** (= permanently), in **public**, in **private**, from **bad to worse**, through **thick and thin**, **right or wrong**.*

9.10 Correct Use of Some Adjectives (Frequently Confused)

Pair	Rule	Examples
elder / older	*elder* = for persons of the same family, attributive only, followed by *to* is wrong; *older* = general, used with *than*	*my **elder** brother; He is **older than** I* (✘ elder than)
eldest / oldest	*eldest* = within a family; *oldest* = general	*my **eldest** son; the **oldest** building in Dhaka*
later / latter	*later* = time; *latter* = second of two (order)	*I'll come **later**. Of Rahim and Karim, the **latter** is taller.*
latest / last	*latest* = newest; *last* = final	*the **latest** news; the **last** chapter*
farther / further	*farther* = physical distance; *further* = additional (and also distance)	*He walked **farther**. Do you need any **further** information?*
nearest / next	*nearest* = distance; *next* = order	*the **nearest** hospital; the **next** bus*
former / latter	for **two** items only (for more, use *first / last*)	*Tea and coffee are both drinks; the **former** is cheaper.*
little / small	*little* often adds emotion; *small* is neutral size	*a **little** girl (affection); a **small** room*
verbal / oral	*verbal* = in words (spoken or written); *oral* = spoken	*an **oral** test; a **verbal** agreement*
healthy / healthful	*healthy* = in good health; *healthful* = good for health	*a **healthy** child; **healthful** food* (now *healthy food* is common)
economic / economical	*economic* = of the economy; *economical* = thrifty	***economic** growth; an **economical** car*
historic / historical	*historic* = important in history; *historical* = related to history	*a **historic** speech (7th March); a **historical** novel*
childish / childlike	*childish* = silly (−); *childlike* = innocent (+)	***childish** behaviour; **childlike** simplicity*
industrial / industrious	*industrial* = of industry; *industrious* = hard-working	***industrial** area; an **industrious** student*
respectable / respectful / respective	worthy of respect / showing respect / each one's own	*a **respectable** family; **respectful** to elders; went to their **respective** homes*
sensible / sensitive	wise / easily affected	*a **sensible** decision; **sensitive** skin*
continual / continuous	repeated with breaks / without a break	***continual** interruptions; **continuous** rain*
imaginary / imaginative	unreal / creative	*an **imaginary** story; an **imaginative** writer*
luxurious / luxuriant	expensive and comfortable / growing thickly	*a **luxurious** hotel; **luxuriant** vegetation*
credible / creditable / credulous	believable / praiseworthy / too ready to believe	*a **credible** witness; a **creditable** result; a **credulous** villager*
politic / political	wise, prudent / of politics	*a **politic** decision; a **political** party*
momentary / momentous	brief / very important	*a **momentary** pause; a **momentous** decision*

Chapter 52 gives a much larger list of commonly confused words.

9.10.1 *Very* or *Much* before Adjectives and Participles

- ***Very*** modifies **positive adjectives**, **present participles** and past participles used as pure adjectives: *very **good**, very **interesting**, very **tired**, very **pleased**, very **worried**.*
- ***Much*** modifies **comparatives** and **past participles in a passive (verbal) sense**: *much **better**, much **taller**, much **obliged**, much **admired**, much **talked about**.*

› ✘ He is very better today. ✔ He is **much better** today.
› ✘ I am much tired. ✔ I am **very tired**.
› ✔ I am **much obliged** to you. / ✔ He is **much respected** by all.
› ✔ **Very much** + comparative for extra emphasis: *very much better* ✔

9.10.2 Absolute Adjectives

Some adjectives already express the **highest degree** or an **all-or-nothing** quality and normally cannot be compared or intensified: ***unique, perfect, complete, entire, round, square, empty, full, dead, ideal, infinite, eternal, universal, supreme, extreme, chief, matchless, impossible, final, total, absolute***. ✘ *more unique*, ✘ *most perfect*, ✘ *very unique* → ✔ *unique*, ✔ *almost perfect*, ✔ *nearly complete*. (See Chapter 24.)

9.11 Common Errors with Adjectives

1. ✘ He is elder than me. ✔ He is **older than** I.
2. ✘ The rose smells sweetly. ✔ The rose smells **sweet**.
3. ✘ I am very boring with this film. ✔ I am very **bored** with this film.
4. ✘ He is a ten-years-old boy. ✔ He is a **ten-year-old** boy.
5. ✘ She is more cleverer than her sister. ✔ She is **cleverer** than her sister.
6. ✘ He is very better now. ✔ He is **much better** now.
7. ✘ I have a red big car. ✔ I have a **big red** car.
8. ✘ This is the most unique design. ✔ This is a **unique** design.
9. ✘ Don't wake the asleep child. ✔ Don't wake the **sleeping** child.
10. ✘ He is an alive example of honesty. ✔ He is a **living** example of honesty.
11. ✘ Give me something to eat good. ✔ Give me something **good** to eat.
12. ✘ The poors are suffering. ✔ **The poor are** suffering.
13. ✘ He is a Swedish. ✔ He is **a Swede** / He is **Swedish**. (*Swedish* is the adjective; *a Swede* is the person)
14. ✘ He is enough intelligent. ✔ He is **intelligent enough**.
15. ✘ The final chapter is the latter. (of five) ✔ The final chapter is the **last**.
16. ✘ What is the last news? ✔ What is the **latest** news?
17. ✘ He walked further than me. (traditional, distance) ✔ He walked **farther** than I.
18. ✘ My cousin is an industrial student. ✔ My cousin is an **industrious** student.
19. ✘ She is respectful lady. ✔ She is a **respectable** lady.
20. ✘ He was childlike in his anger. ✔ He was **childish** in his anger.
21. ✘ It was a historical moment when Bangladesh won independence. ✔ It was a **historic** moment …
22. ✘ I feel badly. ✔ I feel **bad**.
23. ✘ She looks beautifully in that dress. ✔ She looks **beautiful** in that dress.
24. ✘ The more stronger team won. ✔ The **stronger** team won.
25. ✘ Tulips are a Hollandish flower. ✔ Tulips are a **Dutch** flower. (*Holland / the Netherlands → Dutch*)

9.12 Adjectives in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Adjective vs adverb (SAT/GMAT):** ✘ *The surprising large crowd …* ✔ *The **surprisingly** large crowd …* (adverb modifies the adjective *large*). ✘ *a remarkable fast runner* ✔ *a **remarkably** fast runner*.
- **Linking verbs:** ✘ *The proposal seems reasonably* ✔ *seems **reasonable***.
- **Participial adjectives:** SAT passages contrast *-ed* and *-ing*: *a **confusing** argument* vs *a **confused** audience*.
- **GRE Text Completion and Sentence Equivalence** test hundreds of adjectives, especially **eponymous** ones (*quixotic, draconian, Machiavellian, Pyrrhic, mercurial, saturnine, jovial, stoic, spartan, Procrustean*) and **tone** adjectives (*laconic, verbose, sardonic, acerbic, effusive, diffident, sanguine, phlegmatic*). Learn them with Chapter 45.
- **Absolute adjectives:** GMAT does not accept *more unique* or *very unique*.

CHAPTER 10

Latin Adjective

Part A · Grammar

10.1 What Are Latin Adjectives?

English has borrowed thousands of words from **Latin**. Among them is a small but very important group of adjectives that were **comparative-degree forms in Latin** — they already contain the meaning of "more" or "less". In grammar books of Bangladesh these are called **Latin Adjectives** or **Latin Comparatives**. They end in ***-or*** (and one, *preferable*, in *-able*).

Latin adjective	Meaning	Opposite
superior	higher in rank, quality or ability; better	inferior
inferior	lower in rank, quality or ability; worse	superior
senior	older in age; higher in rank or service	junior
junior	younger in age; lower in rank or service	senior
prior	earlier in time or order	posterior
anterior	situated before / in front; earlier	posterior
posterior	situated behind; later	anterior / prior
major	greater, more important	minor
minor	lesser, less important	major
exterior	outer	interior
interior	inner	exterior
ulterior	lying beyond; hidden (motive)	—
preferable	more desirable	—

10.2 The Golden Rule: *To*, Not *Than*

The Latin comparatives ***superior, inferior, senior, junior, prior, anterior, posterior*** and ***preferable*** (and the verb ***prefer***) are followed by ***to***, **not *than***. Because they are already comparative in meaning, they are **never** used with ***more*** or ***most***.

- He is **superior to** me in intelligence. (✘ superior than)
- This cloth is **inferior to** that. (✘ inferior than)
- Rahim is **senior to** Karim by three years. (✘ senior than)
- She is **junior to** me in service. (✘ junior than)
- He had left the office **prior to** my arrival. (✘ prior than)
- Death is **preferable to** dishonour. (✘ preferable than; ✘ more preferable)
- I **prefer** tea **to** coffee. (✘ prefer tea than coffee)
- The events of chapter 3 are **anterior to** those of chapter 4.

Exam Tip — Double comparison trap: ✘ *more superior*, ✘ *more preferable*, ✘ *most superior*, ✘ *more senior than* are all wrong in a Bangladeshi exam. To strengthen them, use ***much, far, by far, greatly, considerably***: *This model is **far superior to** the old one. Walking is **much preferable to** sitting all day.*

10.3 Each Latin Adjective in Detail

10.3.1 *Superior* and *Inferior*

- Our team is **superior to** theirs in every respect.
- Local products are not always **inferior to** foreign ones.
- He thinks himself **superior to** others. (arrogant)
- **Superior** and **inferior** can be used without comparison: *a **superior** officer* (= of higher rank), *goods of **inferior** quality*, *the Mother **Superior*** (head of a convent), *an **inferiority** complex*.
- As nouns: *He is my **superior** in office. He treats his **inferiors** kindly.*

10.3.2 *Senior* and *Junior*

- He is **senior to** me by five years. / He is five years **senior to** me. / He is **my senior by** five years.
- Rina is **junior to** Mina in service.
- As adjectives without comparison: *a **senior** officer, a **junior** clerk, **senior** citizens, a **junior** school*.
- As nouns: *He is **my senior**. The **juniors** respect the **seniors**.*
- After names: *Martin Luther King **Jr.** (Junior), John Smith **Sr.** (Senior).*

***Elder / older* vs *senior*:** *He is **older than** I* / *He is **senior to** me* (age or rank). ✘ *He is elder than me.* — *Elder* is not followed by *than* (Chapter 09).

10.3.3 *Prior*, *Anterior* and *Posterior*

- **Prior to** the meeting, the chairman met the press. (= before; formal)
- Applications must be submitted **prior to** 30 June.
- A **prior** engagement prevented him from coming. (= earlier; no comparison)
- The **anterior** part of the brain controls speech. (= front)
- The **posterior** legs of a frog are longer. (= hind)
- A **posterior** event is one that comes after another.

10.3.4 *Major* and *Minor*

Major and *minor* are Latin comparatives in origin, but in modern English they are used as **ordinary (positive) adjectives** meaning *important / unimportant* or *greater / lesser*. They are **not followed by *to* or *than***.

- Unemployment is a **major** problem in Bangladesh.
- It was only a **minor** mistake.
- the **major** part of the population; **minor** injuries
- As nouns: *He is a **minor*** (= under 18, not legally adult). *She is a history **major*** (AmE: main subject of study). *a **major** in the army* (rank).
- ✘ This problem is major than that. ✔ This problem is **more serious than** that / **greater than** that.

10.3.5 *Exterior*, *Interior* and *Ulterior*

These also are used as **positive adjectives**, not followed by *to*:

- The **exterior** walls need painting. / the **interior** of the country / **interior** decoration
- He has an **ulterior** motive. (= a hidden, usually selfish, reason)
- As nouns: *The **exterior** of the house is old, but the **interior** is modern.*

10.3.6 *Preferable* and *Prefer*

Preferable (adjective) and ***prefer*** (verb) take ***to***:

- Poverty with honour is **preferable to** wealth with dishonour.
- I **prefer** walking **to** cycling. (*prefer* + gerund + *to* + gerund)
- I **prefer** milk **to** tea.
- With infinitives, use ***rather than***: *I **prefer to walk rather than** (to) cycle.* (✘ I prefer to walk than cycle)
- ✘ I prefer tea than coffee. ✔ I prefer tea **to** coffee.
- ✘ This is more preferable. ✔ This is **preferable**.

10.4 Other Comparatives and Expressions That Take *To*

Apart from the Latin adjectives, the following words also take ***to*** in comparison:

Word	Example
prefer	*I prefer rice **to** bread.*
preference	*He showed a **preference for** rice **to** bread / **over** bread.*
compare	*Life is often **compared to** a journey* (likeness). *Compare this copy **with** the original* (examining differences).
similar	*Your pen is **similar to** mine.* (✘ similar with)
equal	*Two plus two is **equal to** four.*
identical	*This copy is **identical to / with** the original.*
opposite	*His house is **opposite (to)** mine.*
contrary	*His actions are **contrary to** his words.*
previous	*He had resigned **previous to** the election.* (formal)
subsequent	***Subsequent to** the war, prices rose.* (formal)
owing / due	*The delay was **due to** heavy rain.*

> ***Different from / than / to:*** British English uses *different **from*** (also *different **to*** informally); American English uses *different **from*** and *different **than***. In Bangladeshi exams and formal writing, ***different from*** is always safe: *This book is **different from** that one.*

10.5 Comparing with Latin Adjectives — Model Sentences

- Gold is **superior to** silver in value.
- This medicine is **inferior to** that in effect.
- My father is **senior to** my uncle by two years.
- The new clerk is **junior to** all of us.
- Prayer is **preferable to** sleep. (from the call to *Fajr* prayer)
- The visa must be obtained **prior to** departure.
- Health is **preferable to** wealth.
- The Mughal period was **posterior to** the Sultanate period.
- Our tea is **far superior to** imported tea.
- He is **much senior to** me in experience.

10.6 Latin-Derived Descriptive Adjectives (Vocabulary)

Besides the comparatives, English uses many **Latin-derived adjectives** where everyday English has a simple noun. They are tested as vocabulary in BCS, Bank and admission tests ("*The adjective related to the dog is …*") and are constantly used in GRE/SAT reading passages.

10.6.1 Adjectives Related to Animals

Animal	Adjective	Animal	Adjective
dog	**canine**	eagle	**aquiline** (*an aquiline nose*)
cat	**feline**	snake	**serpentine**
cow, cattle	**bovine**	fish	**piscine**
horse	**equine**	bird	**avian**
sheep	**ovine**	ass, donkey	**asinine** (= stupid)
pig	**porcine**	goat	**caprine / hircine**
lion	**leonine**	deer	**cervine**
wolf	**lupine**	ape, monkey	**simian**
fox	**vulpine**	bull	**taurine**
bear	**ursine**	elephant	**elephantine** (= huge, clumsy)
goose	**anserine**	bee	**apian**
crow	**corvine**	dove	**columbine**
mouse, rat	**murine**	sparrow	**passerine**
frog	**ranine**	worm	**vermicular / vermiform**

10.6.2 Adjectives Related to the Body

Part	Adjective	Part	Adjective
tooth	**dental**	heart	**cardiac**
hand	**manual**	brain	**cerebral**
mouth	**oral**	kidney	**renal**
nose	**nasal**	liver	**hepatic**
eye	**ocular / optic**	lung	**pulmonary**
ear	**aural**	stomach	**gastric**
skin	**cutaneous / dermal**	finger	**digital**
foot	**pedal**	blood	**sanguine / haemal**
bone	**osseous**	tongue	**lingual**
lip	**labial**	neck	**cervical**
arm	**brachial**	throat	**guttural**
muscle	**muscular**	nerve	**neural**

10.6.3 Adjectives Related to Family and Marriage

Relation	Adjective	Relation	Adjective
father	**paternal**	husband & wife (marriage)	**conjugal / marital / matrimonial**
mother	**maternal**	wedding	**nuptial**
brother	**fraternal**	wife	**uxorial** (*uxorious* = too fond of one's wife)
sister	**sororal**	uncle	**avuncular** (= kind like an uncle)
son / daughter	**filial** (*filial duty*)	ancestors	**ancestral**
child	**puerile** (= childish)	old age	**senile**

10.6.4 Adjectives Related to Time, Seasons and Places

Idea	Adjective	Idea	Adjective
day (daytime)	**diurnal**	spring	**vernal**
night	**nocturnal**	summer	**aestival / estival**
daily, everyday	**quotidian**	autumn	**autumnal**
year	**annual**	winter	**hibernal**
every two years	**biennial**	town, city	**urban**
twice a year	**biannual**	village, country	**rural / rustic**

Idea	Adjective	Idea	Adjective
lasting for ever	**perennial**	sea	**marine / maritime**
hundred years	**centennial**	sea shore	**littoral**
moon	**lunar**	river bank	**riparian**
sun	**solar**	earth, land	**terrestrial**
star	**stellar / sidereal**	heaven, sky	**celestial**
world	**mundane** (= ordinary)	island	**insular** (= narrow-minded)

10.6.5 Adjectives Related to Other Ideas

Idea	Adjective	Idea	Adjective
king	**regal / royal**	law	**legal / judicial**
queen	**reginal**	church	**ecclesiastical**
war	**martial / bellicose**	sleep	**somnolent / dormant**
peace	**pacific**	death	**mortal / lethal**
fire	**igneous**	water	**aquatic / aqueous**
iron	**ferrous**	gold	**aureate**
silver	**argent**	glass	**vitreous**
wood	**ligneous**	tree	**arboreal**
letter	**literal**	word	**verbal**
speech, talk	**loquacious / eloquent**	sight	**visual**
touch	**tactile**	taste	**gustatory**
smell	**olfactory**	hearing	**auditory**
heat	**thermal**	light	**luminous**
belly	**ventral**	back	**dorsal**
house	**domestic**	city state, citizen	**civic**

10.7 Common Errors with Latin Adjectives

1. ✘ He is senior than me. ✔ He is **senior to** me.
2. ✘ This pen is superior than that. ✔ This pen is **superior to** that.
3. ✘ Death is more preferable than dishonour. ✔ Death is **preferable to** dishonour.
4. ✘ I prefer tea than coffee. ✔ I prefer tea **to** coffee.
5. ✘ He came prior than me. ✔ He came **before** me. / He arrived **prior to** my arrival.
6. ✘ My brother is junior than me. ✔ My brother is **junior to** me.
7. ✘ She is more superior to her classmates. ✔ She is **far / much superior to** her classmates.
8. ✘ He is inferior than his brother in mathematics. ✔ He is **inferior to** his brother in mathematics.
9. ✘ I prefer to read than to play. ✔ I prefer **reading to playing**. / I prefer **to read rather than play**.
10. ✘ This is the most superior quality. ✔ This is of **superior** / the **highest** quality.
11. ✘ His motive was ulterior than his words. ✔ He had an **ulterior** motive.
12. ✘ My house is similar with yours. ✔ My house is **similar to** yours.
13. ✘ He is senior from me by two years. ✔ He is **senior to** me by two years.
14. ✘ This plan is major than that one. ✔ This plan is **more important than** that one.
15. ✘ He is two years senior than his wife. ✔ He is two years **senior to** his wife.

10.8 Latin Adjectives in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **GMAT idioms:** *prefer A **to** B*; *preferable **to***; *superior **to***; *prior **to*** (often replaced by *before* for concision). GMAT also tests ***rather than*** with parallel forms: *She prefers **to walk rather than to drive*** ✔.
- **Redundancy (GMAT/SAT):** *more superior, more preferable, more senior than* are both ungrammatical and redundant.
- **GRE vocabulary:** the descriptive Latin adjectives in 10.6 (*aquiline, leonine, bovine, asinine, avuncular, uxorious, puerile, senile, quotidian, vernal, insular, mundane, sanguine, bellicose, pacific, somnolent, loquacious*) appear regularly in GRE Text Completion and Reading. *Sanguine* is a classic trap: literally “of blood”, it now means **optimistic**.

CHAPTER 11

Verb

Part A · Grammar

11.1 What Is a Verb?

A **verb** is a word that tells us what a person or thing **does**, **is**, or **has** — it shows **action**, **state of being** or **possession**. The word comes from Latin *verbum*, "word", because the verb is *the* word of a sentence: without it there is no sentence.

- The baby **sleeps**. (action)
- Rahim **is** a student. (state of being)
- She **has** two brothers. (possession)
- The flowers **seem** fresh. (state)
- The bridge **was built** in 2022. (action, passive)

A sentence is a **subject** + a **predicate**, and the **verb** is the heart of the predicate. One test for a verb: a verb changes form to show **tense** (*go – went*) and **agreement** (*go – goes*), and it can follow *to* (*to go*) or a modal (*can go*).

11.2 Classification of Verbs: An Overview

Verbs can be classified in several ways. Each classification answers a different question:

Basis	Kinds
Does the verb need an object?	**Transitive** / **Intransitive**
Is it a main verb or a helping verb?	**Principal (Main)** / **Auxiliary** (primary: *be, have, do*; modal: *can, may, will* …)
Does it show tense and agree with the subject?	**Finite** / **Non-finite** (infinitive, gerund, participle)
How is the past formed?	**Regular** (*-ed*) / **Irregular**
Does it link the subject to a description?	**Linking (Copular)** / **Action**
Is it a verb + particle unit?	**Phrasal** / **Prepositional verbs** (Chapter 47)
Does the subject act or receive?	**Active** / **Passive** voice (Chapter 26)
Does the verb express a fact, command or wish?	**Mood**: Indicative / Imperative / Subjunctive
Does the verb express a continuing action?	**Dynamic** (*run, eat*) / **Stative** (*know, love, own*)

11.3 Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

11.3.1 Transitive Verbs

A **transitive verb** is one whose action **passes over** (*trans* = across) from the subject to an **object**. Without an object, its meaning is incomplete. Ask "*what?*" or "*whom?*" after the verb — the answer is the object.

- The boy **kicked** the ball. (kicked what? → the ball)
- She **loves** her mother. (loves whom? → her mother)
- I **bought** a pen.
- He **told** a lie.

11.3.2 Intransitive Verbs

An **intransitive verb** does not need an object; the action stays with the subject.

- The baby **cried**.
- The sun **rises** in the east.
- Birds **fly**.
- He **sleeps** soundly. (*soundly* is an adverb, not an object)
- She **went** to school. (*to school* is a prepositional phrase, not an object)

11.3.3 Verbs Used Both Ways

Many verbs can be transitive in one sentence and intransitive in another.

Intransitive	Transitive
The bell **rang**.	He **rang** the bell.
The ship **sank**.	The enemy **sank** the ship.
The horse **walked**.	He **walked** the horse. (= made it walk)
The baby **is sleeping**.	—
Birds **fly**.	The boys **fly** kites.
He **runs** fast.	He **runs** a business.
The door **opened**.	She **opened** the door.
The glass **broke**.	Who **broke** the glass?
He **stopped**.	He **stopped** the car.
The fire **burns**.	He **burnt** the papers.

> **Causative use:** Some intransitive verbs become transitive with the meaning "*cause to do*": *The horse **ran**.* → *He **ran** the horse.* / *The kite **flew**.* → *He **flew** the kite.* / *The child **sat** on the chair.* → *She **sat** the child on the chair.*

11.3.4 Verbs with Two Objects

Some transitive verbs take **two objects**: an **indirect object** (usually a person — *to/for whom*) and a **direct object** (usually a thing — *what*). Such verbs include *give, send, show, tell, teach, buy, bring, lend, offer, pay, promise, write, ask, sell, hand, owe, make, cook, read*.

- He **gave me a book**. → *me* = indirect object; *a book* = direct object
- He gave a book **to me**. (the indirect object becomes a prepositional phrase)
- She **bought her son a shirt**. → She bought a shirt **for** her son.
- The teacher **asked him a question**.

> **Verbs that do NOT take an indirect object before the direct object:** *explain, describe, suggest, say, announce, introduce, propose, report, mention, deliver*. ✘ *Explain me the rule.* ✔ *Explain the rule **to me**.* ✘ *Describe me the scene.* ✔ *Describe the scene **to me**.* ✘ *He said me that …* ✔ *He **told** me that …* / ✔ *He **said to** me that …* / ✘ *Suggest me a book* ✔ *Suggest a book **to me**.*

11.3.5 Cognate Object

An intransitive verb sometimes takes an object **similar in meaning** to itself. This is called a **cognate object**.

- He **lived** a happy **life**.
- She **sang** a sweet **song**.
- They **fought** a hard **fight / battle**.

- He **died** a heroic **death**.
- I **dreamt** a strange **dream**.
- He **ran** a **race**. / She **slept** a sound **sleep**. / He **laughed** a hearty **laugh**.

11.3.6 Reflexive Object

Some verbs normally take a reflexive pronoun as object (Chapter 08): *absent oneself, avail oneself, pride oneself, enjoy oneself, acquit oneself, revenge oneself.*

11.4 Verbs of Incomplete Predication and Complements

Some verbs do not make complete sense alone and need a **complement** (a word or phrase that *completes* the predicate). They are called **verbs of incomplete predication**.

(a) Intransitive verbs with a subjective complement (linking verbs):

- He **is** *a doctor*. / She **became** *famous*. / They **seem** *happy*.
- The milk **turned** *sour*. / He **looks** *tired*. / The plan **proved** *useless*.

The complement describes the **subject**, so it is called a **subjective complement**. It is a noun or an adjective (Chapter 09.6), not an adverb.

(b) Transitive verbs with an objective complement:

- They **made** him *captain*. (*him* = object; *captain* = objective complement)
- We **elected** her *chairman*.
- The news **made** her *sad*.
- I **found** the book *interesting*.
- They **called** him *a liar*.
- She **painted** the room *blue*.

11.4.1 Linking (Copular) Verbs

Group	Verbs
Being	be, seem, appear, look
Sensing	feel, smell, taste, sound, look
Becoming	become, get, grow, turn, go, come, fall, run (*run dry*), wear (*wear thin*)
Remaining	remain, stay, keep, continue, rest
Proving	prove, turn out

11.5 Principal and Auxiliary Verbs

A **principal (main) verb** carries the main meaning. An **auxiliary (helping) verb** helps the main verb to form **tense, voice, mood, questions and negatives**.

- He **is writing** a letter. (*is* = auxiliary; *writing* = main verb)
- They **have finished** the work.
- **Do** you **know** him?
- You **must obey** the rules.
- The letter **was written** by him.

11.5.1 Primary Auxiliaries: *Be, Have, Do*

These three can be **both main verbs and auxiliaries**.

Verb	As auxiliary	As main verb
be (*am, is, are, was, were, been, being*)	Continuous tenses: *He **is** reading.* Passive: *The work **was** done.*	*He **is** a teacher. They **were** at home.*
have (*has, have, had*)	Perfect tenses: *She **has** gone.*	*I **have** a car. We **had** lunch.*
do (*does, do, did*)	Questions/negatives in simple tenses: ***Do** you smoke? He **did** not come.* Emphasis: *I **do** love you.*	*He **does** his homework. I **did** the work.*

> **Uses of *be* + infinitive:** *be to* expresses plan, arrangement, order or destiny: *The PM **is to** visit Japan next week. You **are to** report at nine. He **was** never **to** see his home again.* **Uses of *have to*** for obligation: *I **have to** go now.* (Chapter 13)

11.5.2 Modal Auxiliaries

Can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought (to), need, dare, used (to) are **modal auxiliaries**. They express ability, permission, possibility, obligation, advice and so on, and never change for the subject. Chapter 13 is devoted to them.

11.6 Finite and Non-Finite Verbs

A **finite verb** is limited (*finite* = limited) by the **subject's person and number** and by **tense**. It changes when the subject or tense changes. Every independent sentence must have at least one finite verb.

- He **writes**. / They **write**. / He **wrote**. → *writes, write, wrote* are finite.

A **non-finite verb** is not limited by person, number or tense. It cannot be the main verb of a sentence by itself. There are three non-finites:

Non-finite	Form	Example
Infinitive	(*to*) + base form	*I want **to go**. He made me **laugh**.*
Gerund	base + *-ing*, used as a noun	***Swimming** is good exercise.*
Participle	present (*-ing*), past (*-ed/-en*), perfect (*having + V3*)	*a **running** train; a **broken** cup; **Having finished**, he left.*

- I want **to go**. / He wants **to go**. / They wanted **to go**. → *want, wants, wanted* change (finite); *to go* does not change (non-finite).
- ✘ *Rahim going to school.* → not a sentence (no finite verb). ✔ *Rahim **is** going to school.*
- ✘ *The boy, having finished his work.* → fragment. ✔ *The boy, having finished his work, **went** out.*

Chapter 14 deals with gerunds, participles and infinitives in detail.

11.7 Regular and Irregular Verbs

- **Regular verbs** form their past tense (V2) and past participle (V3) by adding ***-ed* / *-d***: *walk – walked – walked; love – loved – loved*.
- **Irregular verbs** form them in other ways: *go – went – gone; write – wrote – written; put – put – put*.

Spelling rules for *-ed*, and the full list of irregular verbs, are in Chapter 12.

11.8 Mood

Mood is the form of a verb that shows the **manner** in which the action is expressed — as a fact, a command, or a wish/imagination.

11.8.1 Indicative Mood

States a **fact** or asks a **question**: *The sun **rises** in the east. **Does** he live here? If it **rains**, we shall stay at home* (a real possibility).

11.8.2 Imperative Mood

Expresses a **command, request, advice, warning or prayer**. The subject *you* is usually understood.

- **Shut** the door. (command)
- Please **help** me. (request)
- **Take** care of your health. (advice)
- **Don't** touch the wire. (warning/prohibition)
- **Let** us go. / **Let** him come. (proposal/permission)
- **Forgive** us our sins. (prayer)

11.8.3 Subjunctive Mood

The **subjunctive** expresses a **wish, supposition, doubt, condition contrary to fact, purpose, or a demand/suggestion**. Its forms are special: the **base form** for all persons in the present subjunctive (*he go, she be*) and ***were*** for all persons in the past subjunctive.

(a) Present subjunctive (base form):

- **Long live** Bangladesh! (✘ Long lives)
- **God bless** you! (✘ God blesses you — as a prayer)
- **God save** the King!
- **Heaven help** us!
- **Be** that as it may, … / **Come** what may, …
- After verbs of demand, suggestion, proposal, recommendation, insistence, order, request: *I **suggest** that he **go** home. The doctor **recommended** that she **take** rest. The court **ordered** that the man **be** released. It is **essential** that every citizen **pay** tax.* (British English also uses *should*: *that he **should go**.*)

(b) Past subjunctive (*were* for all persons):

- **If I were** a bird, I would fly. (✘ If I was — informal)
- **I wish I were** rich. (✘ I wish I was — in exams)
- He talks **as if he were** the king.
- **Suppose** she **were** here, what would you say?
- **It is time** we **went** home. (*It is time + past* = it is already late)
- **I would rather** you **came** tomorrow.

(c) Past perfect subjunctive (unreal past):

- **If I had known**, I would have helped you.
- **I wish I had studied** harder.
- He looked **as if he had seen** a ghost.

> **Exam Tip — The *suggest/insist* trap:** After *suggest, propose, recommend, insist, demand, order, request, urge, move, ask (formal)* and adjectives *essential, necessary, vital, important, imperative + that*, use the **base form** (or *should* + base), never the *-s* form or past form: ✘ *He insisted that she goes.* ✔ *He insisted that she **go** / **should go***. This is a top GMAT idiom too.

11.9 Stative and Dynamic Verbs

Dynamic (action) verbs describe actions that can be in progress: *run, write, eat, play, build*. They can be used in **continuous** tenses.

Stative verbs describe **states** (mental states, feelings, senses, possession, relations). They are normally **not used in continuous tenses**.

Group	Stative verbs
Mental states	know, believe, understand, think (= believe), suppose, remember, forget, realise, recognise, doubt, imagine, mean, mind
Feelings	love, like, hate, dislike, prefer, want, wish, desire, need, care, fear, adore, detest
Senses / perception	see, hear, smell, taste, feel, notice, perceive (when involuntary)
Possession & relations	have (= own), own, possess, belong, contain, consist, include, owe, depend, matter, deserve, lack
Being / appearance	be, seem, appear, look (= seem), resemble, cost, weigh, measure, equal, differ

- ✘ I am knowing him. ✔ I **know** him.
- ✘ She is having a car. ✔ She **has** a car.
- ✘ This book is belonging to me. ✔ This book **belongs** to me.
- ✘ I am understanding the problem. ✔ I **understand** the problem.
- ✘ Are you hearing me? ✔ **Can** you **hear** me? / **Do** you **hear** me?

> **Some stative verbs have dynamic meanings too**, and then the continuous is correct: *I **think** he is honest* (opinion) vs *I **am thinking** about the problem* (mental activity). *She **has** a car* (possession) vs *She **is having** lunch / a bath / a good time* (activity). *The soup **tastes** good* vs *The cook **is tasting** the soup. I **see** a bird* vs *I **am seeing** the doctor tomorrow* (meeting). *He **is** foolish* (character) vs *He **is being** foolish* (behaviour now). *I **love** music* vs *I'm **loving** it* (informal advertising — avoid in exams).

11.10 Some Verbs Often Confused

Verb pair	Correct use
lie – lay – lain (intransitive: recline) vs **lay – laid – laid** (transitive: put down)	*He **lies** on the bed. He **lay** there yesterday. / She **lays** the table. The hen **laid** an egg.*
lie – lied – lied (tell a lie)	*He **lied** to me.*
rise – rose – risen (intr.) vs **raise – raised – raised** (tr.)	*Prices **rise**. The sun **rose**. / They **raised** the price. **Raise** your hand.*
sit – sat – sat (intr.) vs **set – set – set** (tr.)	***Sit** down. / **Set** the vase on the table.*
fall – fell – fallen vs **fell – felled – felled** (cut down)	*The tree **fell**. / They **felled** the tree.*
hang – hung – hung (objects) vs **hang – hanged – hanged** (execute)	*He **hung** the picture. / The murderer was **hanged**.*
find – found – found vs **found – founded – founded** (establish)	*I **found** my pen. / He **founded** a school.*
wind – wound – wound (turn) vs **wound – wounded – wounded** (injure)	*He **wound** the clock. / He was **wounded** in war.*
bear – bore – borne (carry/endure) vs **born** (birth, passive)	*She has **borne** much pain. She has **borne** three children. / He was **born** in 2000.*
beat – beat – beaten vs **bit/bitten** (bite)	*He was **beaten**. / He was **bitten** by a dog.*
flee – fled – fled (run away) vs **fly – flew – flown**	*The thief **fled**. / The bird **flew** away.*
flow – flowed – flowed vs **fly – flew – flown**	*The river **flowed**.* (✘ flew)
borrow (take) vs **lend** (give)	*May I **borrow** your pen? Can you **lend** me your pen?* (✘ lend me = borrow from me)

Verb pair	Correct use
learn vs **teach**	*I **learn** English. He **teaches** me English.* (✘ He learns me)
rob (a person/place) vs **steal** (a thing)	*They **robbed** the bank / him. / They **stole** his money.*
say vs **tell**	*He **said** (to me) that … / He **told** me that …* (✘ He said me)
bring vs **take**	***Bring** it here. **Take** it there.*
hear vs **listen**	*I **heard** a noise. **Listen** to me.*
see vs **look** vs **watch**	*I **saw** him. **Look** at the board. **Watch** the match.*

11.11 Common Errors with Verbs

1. ✘ Explain me this sentence. ✔ Explain this sentence **to me**.
2. ✘ He said me to go. ✔ He **told** me to go.
3. ✘ I am knowing the answer. ✔ I **know** the answer.
4. ✘ The book is lying on the table since morning. ✔ The book **has been lying** on the table since morning.
5. ✘ He laid on the bed. ✔ He **lay** on the bed.
6. ✘ The hen has lain an egg. ✔ The hen has **laid** an egg.
7. ✘ The murderer was hung. ✔ The murderer was **hanged**.
8. ✘ The price of rice has raised. ✔ The price of rice has **risen**.
9. ✘ He rose the question. ✔ He **raised** the question.
10. ✘ Please lend your book from me. ✔ Please **lend** me your book. / May I **borrow** your book?
11. ✘ He learnt me English. ✔ He **taught** me English.
12. ✘ They stole the bank. ✔ They **robbed** the bank.
13. ✘ If I was a king, I would help the poor. ✔ If I **were** a king, …
14. ✘ I suggest that he goes at once. ✔ I suggest that he **go / should go** at once.
15. ✘ Long lives our President! ✔ Long **live** our President!
16. ✘ He absented from the meeting. ✔ He absented **himself** from the meeting.
17. ✘ It is time we go home. ✔ It is time we **went** home.
18. ✘ He was born at 1990. ✔ He was born **in** 1990. (verb fine; preposition error)
19. ✘ The river flew into the sea. ✔ The river **flowed** into the sea.
20. ✘ The robber flew away. ✔ The robber **fled**.
21. ✘ She has borne in Dhaka. ✔ She was **born** in Dhaka.
22. ✘ Describe me the accident. ✔ Describe the accident **to me**.
23. ✘ This house is belonging to my uncle. ✔ This house **belongs** to my uncle.
24. ✘ He set on the chair. ✔ He **sat** on the chair.
25. ✘ I wish I was a doctor. ✔ I wish I **were** a doctor.

11.12 Verbs in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **The subjunctive** is a classic GMAT idiom: *require/demand/insist/recommend **that** + base verb* — ✘ *The law requires that each employer **provides** insurance.* ✔ … *that each employer **provide** insurance.* Also ✘ *requires … **should** provide* is marked wordy in GMAT.
- **Verb vs noun (concision):** GMAT prefers strong verbs: ✘ *made an announcement of* → ✔ *announced*.
- **Sentence fragments (SAT):** every sentence needs a **finite** verb. A participle or infinitive alone is not enough: ✘ *The committee, having reviewed all the proposals carefully.* ✔ *The committee, having reviewed all the proposals carefully, **chose** the cheapest one.*
- **Transitive verb idioms:** ✘ *discuss about*, ✘ *emphasize on*, ✘ *stress on*, ✘ *request for*, ✘ *order for*, ✘ *comprise of* → ✔ ***discuss** the matter*, ***emphasize** the point*, ***request** help*, ***comprise** five parts* / ***is composed of** five parts*.
- **GRE vocabulary** includes many precise verbs: *abate, abjure, abrogate, castigate, corroborate, debunk, disparage, eschew, exacerbate, extol, foment, impugn, mitigate, obviate, placate, repudiate, stymie, undermine, vacillate, vilify*.

CHAPTER 12

Conjugation of Verb

Part A · Grammar

12.1 What Is Conjugation?

Conjugation means the **systematic arrangement of all the forms of a verb** — in all tenses, persons, numbers, moods and voices. When we "conjugate" a verb we list how it changes: *I write, he writes, I wrote, I have written, I am writing, it is written …*

Every English verb (except modals) has **five principal forms**:

Form	Name	*write*	*play*	*go*	*be*
V1	Base form (present / infinitive)	write	play	go	be (am, is, are)
V1 + s	Third-person singular present	writes	plays	goes	is
V2	Past tense	wrote	played	went	was / were
V3	Past participle	written	played	gone	been
V + ing	Present participle / gerund	writing	playing	going	being

The past and past participle of **regular verbs** end in *-ed* and are identical (*played – played*). **Irregular verbs** form them in various ways (*write – wrote – written*). Knowing V2 and V3 accurately is essential for tense, voice, conditionals and right-form-of-verb questions.

12.2 Spelling Rules

12.2.1 Adding *-s / -es* (Third-Person Singular)

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: add ***-s***	play → plays, read → reads, write → writes
After *s, ss, sh, ch, x, z, o*: add ***-es***	pass → passes, wash → washes, watch → watches, fix → fixes, buzz → buzzes, go → goes, do → does
Consonant + *y*: change *y* to ***-ies***	try → tries, cry → cries, study → studies, fly → flies
Vowel + *y*: add ***-s***	play → plays, say → says, obey → obeys, enjoy → enjoys
Irregular	have → has, be → is

12.2.2 Adding *-ing*

Rule	Examples
Drop silent final ***-e***	make → making, write → writing, come → coming, take → taking
But keep *-e* in *-ee, -ye, -oe* and a few others	see → seeing, agree → agreeing, flee → fleeing, dye → dyeing (colour), hoe → hoeing, singe → singeing (burn), be → being
Change ***-ie*** to ***-y***	die → dying, lie → lying, tie → tying, vie → vying
Double the final consonant after a single short stressed vowel	run → running, sit → sitting, swim → swimming, stop → stopping, begin → beginning, prefer → preferring, refer → referring, occur → occurring, admit → admitting, forget → forgetting
Do **not** double when the last syllable is unstressed	visit → visiting, open → opening, enter → entering, happen → happening, offer → offering, listen → listening, benefit → benefiting
Final ***-l*** after a short vowel doubles in **British** English (not American)	travel → travelling (AmE *traveling*), cancel → cancelling, quarrel → quarrelling, label → labelling, level → levelling
Final ***-c*** becomes ***-ck***	panic → panicking, picnic → picnicking, mimic → mimicking, traffic → trafficking
Never double *w, x, y*	show → showing, fix → fixing, play → playing

> ***Dying*** / ***dyeing*** and ***singing*** / ***singeing*** are favourite spelling traps: *The patient is* ***dying*** (*die*) vs *She is* ***dyeing*** *her hair* (*dye*); *He is* ***singing*** *a song* (*sing*) vs *The iron is* ***singeing*** *the cloth* (*singe* = burn slightly).

12.2.3 Adding *-ed*

The same doubling rules apply: *stop → stopped, plan → planned, prefer → preferred, occur → occurred, admit → admitted*; but *visit → visited, open → opened, offer → offered*. Final *-e*: add only *-d* (*love → loved, agree → agreed*). Consonant + *y* → *-ied* (*try → tried, study → studied, carry → carried*); vowel + *y* → *-ed* (*play → played, obey → obeyed*; but *pay → paid, lay → laid, say → said*). *-c → -cked* (*panic → panicked, picnic → picnicked*). British *-l* doubling: *travelled, cancelled, quarrelled*.

12.2.4 Pronunciation of *-ed* and *-s*

Ending	Sound	When	Examples
-ed	/ɪd/	after /t/ and /d/	wanted, needed, decided, visited
-ed	/t/	after voiceless sounds /p, k, f, s, ʃ, tʃ/	stopped, looked, laughed, missed, washed, watched
-ed	/d/	after voiced sounds and vowels	played, lived, called, opened, cried
-s / -es	/ɪz/	after /s, z, ʃ, tʃ, dʒ/	passes, buzzes, washes, watches, judges
-s	/s/	after voiceless /p, t, k, f/	stops, writes, looks, laughs
-s	/z/	after voiced sounds and vowels	plays, reads, sings, goes

12.3 Conjugation of *Be*, *Have* and *Do*

	Present	Past	Past participle	-ing
be	I **am**; he/she/it **is**; we/you/they **are**	I/he/she/it **was**; we/you/they **were**	**been**	**being**
have	I/we/you/they **have**; he/she/it **has**	**had** (all persons)	**had**	**having**
do	I/we/you/they **do**; he/she/it **does**	**did** (all persons)	**done**	**doing**

12.4 Full Conjugation of a Verb in All Tenses

The verb ***write*** conjugated in the **active voice** (*I, he/she/it, we/you/they*):

Tense	I	He / She / It	We / You / They
Present Indefinite	write	writes	write
Present Continuous	am writing	is writing	are writing
Present Perfect	have written	has written	have written
Present Perfect Continuous	have been writing	has been writing	have been writing
Past Indefinite	wrote	wrote	wrote
Past Continuous	was writing	was writing	were writing
Past Perfect	had written	had written	had written
Past Perfect Continuous	had been writing	had been writing	had been writing
Future Indefinite	shall/will write	will write	will write (we: shall/will)
Future Continuous	shall/will be writing	will be writing	will be writing
Future Perfect	shall/will have written	will have written	will have written
Future Perfect Continuous	shall/will have been writing	will have been writing	will have been writing

The same verb in the **passive voice** (*a letter / letters*):

Tense	Singular subject	Plural subject
Present Indefinite	is written	are written
Present Continuous	is being written	are being written
Present Perfect	has been written	have been written
Past Indefinite	was written	were written
Past Continuous	was being written	were being written
Past Perfect	had been written	had been written
Future Indefinite	will be written	will be written
Future Perfect	will have been written	will have been written
With modals	can / may / must / should be written	can / may / must / should be written

> The perfect continuous tenses and the future continuous have no passive forms in normal use (✘ *has been being written*). See Chapter 26.

12.4.1 Conjugation in Other Moods and Non-Finite Forms

Form	Active	Passive
Imperative	Write. / Don't write. / Let him write.	Let it be written.
Present subjunctive	(that) he write	(that) it be written
Past subjunctive	if he wrote / if I were writing	if it were written
Infinitive (present)	to write	to be written
Infinitive (continuous)	to be writing	—
Infinitive (perfect)	to have written	to have been written
Gerund / present participle	writing	being written
Perfect participle	having written	having been written
Past participle	—	written

12.5 Irregular Verbs

Irregular verbs fall into four patterns. Learning them in groups is easier than learning one long list.

12.5.1 Pattern A–A–A (All Three Forms the Same)

bet, bid (offer), broadcast, burst, cast, cost, cut, forecast, hit, hurt, let, put, quit, read (pronounced /ri:d/ – /red/ – /red/), rid, set, shed, shut, slit, split, spread, thrust, upset, wet

› He **cut** his finger yesterday. / The price **has cost** us a lot. / The news **spread** quickly. / I **have read** the book.

12.5.2 Pattern A–B–B (Past = Past Participle)

V1	V2 / V3	V1	V2 / V3
bend	bent	lead	led
bind	bound	leave	left
bleed	bled	lend	lent
breed	bred	light	lit / lighted
bring	brought	lose	lost
build	built	make	made
burn	burnt / burned	mean	meant
buy	bought	meet	met
catch	caught	pay	paid
cling	clung	say	said
creep	crept	seek	sought
deal	dealt	sell	sold
dig	dug	send	sent
dream	dreamt / dreamed	shine	shone (*shined* = polished)
dwell	dwelt	shoot	shot
feed	fed	sit	sat
feel	felt	sleep	slept
fight	fought	slide	slid
find	found	sling	slung
flee	fled	smell	smelt / smelled
fling	flung	speed	sped
get	got (AmE V3: gotten)	spend	spent
grind	ground	spill	spilt / spilled
hang	hung (*hanged* = executed)	spin	spun
have	had	spit	spat

V1	V2 / V3	V1	V2 / V3
hear	heard	stand	stood
hold	held	stick	stuck
keep	kept	sting	stung
kneel	knelt	strike	struck
lay	laid	string	strung
lean	leant / leaned	sweep	swept
leap	leapt / leaped	swing	swung
learn	learnt / learned	teach	taught
tell	told	think	thought
under-stand	understood	weep	wept
win	won	wind (turn)	wound
withhold	withheld	wring	wrung
abide	abode / abided	behold	beheld
beseech	besought	spell	spelt / spelled
spoil	spoilt / spoiled	shoe	shod

12.5.3 Pattern A–B–A (Base = Past Participle)

V1	V2	V3
come	came	come
become	became	become
overcome	overcame	overcome
run	ran	run

› He **has come**. (✘ has came) / The river **has overrun** its banks. / She **has become** a doctor.

12.5.4 Pattern A–B–C (All Three Different)

V1	V2	V3	V1	V2	V3
arise	arose	arisen	lie (re-cline)	lay	lain
awake	awoke	awoken	mistake	mistook	mistaken
bear	bore	borne / born	ride	rode	ridden
beat	beat	beaten	ring	rang	rung
begin	began	begun	rise	rose	risen
bite	bit	bitten	see	saw	seen
blow	blew	blown	sew	sewed	sewn / sewed
break	broke	broken	shake	shook	shaken
choose	chose	chosen	shear	sheared	shorn
do	did	done	show	showed	shown
draw	drew	drawn	shrink	shrank	shrunk
drink	drank	drunk	sing	sang	sung
drive	drove	driven	sink	sank	sunk
eat	ate	eaten	slay	slew	slain
fall	fell	fallen	smite	smote	smitten
fly	flew	flown	sow	sowed	sown
forbid	forbade	forbidden	speak	spoke	spoken
forget	forgot	forgotten	spring	sprang	sprung
forgive	forgave	forgiven	steal	stole	stolen
forsake	forsook	forsaken	stride	strode	stridden
freeze	froze	frozen	strive	strove	striven
give	gave	given	swear	swore	sworn
go	went	gone	swell	swelled	swollen

V1	V2	V3	V1	V2	V3
grow	grew	grown	swim	swam	swum
hide	hid	hidden	take	took	taken
know	knew	known	tear	tore	torn
mow	mowed	mown	throw	threw	thrown
hew	hewed	hewn	thrive	throve / thrived	thriven / thrived
beget	begot	begotten	tread	trod	trodden
bid (com-mand)	bade	bidden	wake	woke	woken
undergo	under-went	undergone	wear	wore	worn
undertake	under-took	undertaken	weave	wove	woven
withdraw	withdrew	withdrawn	write	wrote	written
foresee	foresaw	foreseen	outgrow	outgrew	outgrown
forgo	forwent	forgone	overtake	overtook	overtaken
prove	proved	proved / proven	stink	stank	stunk

Exam Tip — The most commonly misused V2/V3 pairs: *begin – began – **begun***; *drink – drank – **drunk***; *ring – rang – **rung***; *sing – sang – **sung***; *swim – swam – **swum***; *sink – sank – **sunk***; *shrink – shrank – **shrunk***; *spring – sprang – **sprung***. In each, **V2 has *a*** and **V3 has *u***. ✘ *He has swam* → ✔ *He has **swum**.* ✘ *The bell has rang* → ✔ *The bell has **rung**.* ✘ *I have drank* → ✔ *I have **drunk**.*

12.6 Verbs with Two Forms of Different Meaning

Verb	Forms	Meaning	Example
hang	hung – hung	suspend (a thing)	*She **hung** the picture on the wall.*
hang	hanged – hanged	execute by hanging	*The murderer **was hanged**.*
lie	lay – lain	rest, recline	*He **lay** in bed all day.*
lie	lied – lied	tell a lie	*He **lied** about his age.*
lay	laid – laid	put down; produce eggs	*She **laid** the baby on the bed.*
bid	bade – bidden	command; say (greeting)	*He **bade** me farewell.*
bid	bid – bid	offer a price	*He **bid** ten lakh taka for the land.*
shine	shone – shone	give light	*The sun **shone** brightly.*
shine	shined – shined	polish	*He **shined** his shoes.*
bear	bore – borne	carry; endure; give birth (active)	*She **has borne** three children. He **has borne** the pain.*
bear	(be) born	come into life (passive only)	*He **was born** in 1971.*
strike	struck – struck	hit	*The clock **struck** twelve.*
strike	struck – stricken	afflicted (adjective)	*a **grief-stricken** family; **stricken** with fever*
wind (/waɪnd/)	wound – wound	turn, coil	*He **wound** the watch.*

Verb	Forms	Meaning	Example
wound (/wu:nd/)	wounded – wounded	injure	*He was **wounded** in the war.*
find	found – found	discover	*I **found** the key.*
found	founded – founded	establish	*Dhaka University **was founded** in 1921.*
fall	fell – fallen	drop down (intr.)	*The tree **fell**.*
fell	felled – felled	cut down (tr.)	*They **felled** the tree.*
fly	flew – flown	move through air	*The bird **flew** away.*
flow	flowed – flowed	move like water	*The river **flowed** gently.*
flee	fled – fled	run away	*The thief **fled**.*
raise	raised – raised	lift (tr.)	*He **raised** his hand.*
rise	rose – risen	go up (intr.)	*The sun has **risen**.*
set	set – set	place (tr.)	*She **set** the table.*
sit	sat – sat	be seated (intr.)	*He **sat** on the bench.*
sew	sewed – sewn	stitch	*She has **sewn** a dress.*
sow	sowed – sown	plant seeds	*The farmer has **sown** paddy.*
saw	sawed – sawn	cut with a saw	*He **sawed** the log.*
see	saw – seen	look	*I **saw** a tiger.*

12.7 Old Past Participles Used as Adjectives

Some verbs have an old participle form that survives **only as an adjective** before a noun:

Verb	Normal V3	Adjective form	Example
drink	drunk	**drunken**	*a **drunken** man* (but *He was **drunk***)
melt	melted	**molten**	***molten** lava, **molten** iron*
shave	shaved	**shaven**	*a clean-**shaven** face*
sink	sunk	**sunken**	*a **sunken** ship, **sunken** eyes*
shrink	shrunk	**shrunken**	*a **shrunken** head*
swell	swelled	**swollen**	*a **swollen** river / ankle*
strike	struck	**stricken**	***panic-stricken**, **poverty-stricken***
rot	rotted	**rotten**	***rotten** eggs*
bind	bound	**bounden**	*my **bounden** duty*
cleave	cleft	**cloven**	*a **cloven** hoof*
work	worked	**wrought**	***wrought** iron*
load	loaded	**laden**	*a tree **laden** with fruit*
hew	hewed	**hewn**	*rough-**hewn** stone*
grave (old)	—	**graven**	*a **graven** image*
prove	proved	**proven**	*a **proven** method*
learn	learned	**learned** (/ˈlɜːnɪd/)	*a **learned** man* (= scholarly)
bless	blessed	**blessed** (/ˈblesɪd/)	*a **blessed** day*
age	aged	**aged** (/ˈeɪdʒɪd/)	*an **aged** man* (= very old)

12.8 Common Errors in Verb Forms

1. ✘ He has went home. ✔ He has **gone** home.
2. ✘ I have broke the glass. ✔ I have **broken** the glass.
3. ✘ He swimmed across the river. ✔ He **swam** across the river.
4. ✘ The child was drownded. ✔ The child was **drowned**.
5. ✘ The bell has rang. ✔ The bell has **rung**.
6. ✘ She has sang a song. ✔ She has **sung** a song.
7. ✘ The ship was sank. ✔ The ship **sank** / **was sunk**.
8. ✘ He has drank the milk. ✔ He has **drunk** the milk.
9. ✘ I have wrote a letter. ✔ I have **written** a letter.
10. ✘ He had came before I left. ✔ He had **come** before I left.
11. ✘ The sun has shined all day. ✔ The sun has **shone** all day.
12. ✘ He was hung for murder. ✔ He was **hanged** for murder.
13. ✘ She has lain the book on the table. ✔ She has **laid** the book on the table.
14. ✘ The farmer has sowed the seeds. (acceptable) ✔ The farmer has **sown** the seeds. (preferred)
15. ✘ He beated the dog. ✔ He **beat** the dog.
16. ✘ The thief was catched. ✔ The thief was **caught**.
17. ✘ He has forbade me. ✔ He has **forbidden** me.
18. ✘ The water has froze. ✔ The water has **frozen**.
19. ✘ I seeked his help. ✔ I **sought** his help.
20. ✘ He striked the ball. ✔ He **struck** the ball.
21. ✘ The cloth has shrinked. ✔ The cloth has **shrunk**.
22. ✘ She weeped bitterly. ✔ She **wept** bitterly.
23. ✘ He has strove hard. ✔ He has **striven** hard.
24. ✘ The bird has flew away. ✔ The bird has **flown** away.
25. ✘ He layed down to rest. ✔ He **lay** down to rest.
26. ✘ He is dieing. ✔ He is **dying**.
27. ✘ She is writting a letter. ✔ She is **writing** a letter.
28. ✘ They are begining the work. ✔ They are **beginning** the work.
29. ✘ He has spended all his money. ✔ He has **spent** all his money.
30. ✘ He was drunken last night. ✔ He was **drunk** last night. (*drunken* only before a noun)

12.9 Verb Forms in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Wrong past participle** is an easy SAT/GMAT error: ✘ *had went, had ran, had began, has swam, has drank, has rang*.
- ***Lie* / *lay*** is a perennial SAT item: ✘ *The documents were laying on the desk.* ✔ *… were **lying** on the desk.* ✘ *He lay the book down.* ✔ *He **laid** the book down.*
- ***Rise* / *raise*, *sit* / *set*** follow the same intransitive/transitive logic.
- **Consistency of tense** within a sentence (Chapter 21) depends on choosing the correct V2/V3.
- **GRE vocabulary** contains old participles used as adjectives: *wrought, laden, stricken, sodden, cloven, graven, molten, hewn*.

CHAPTER 13

Modal Auxiliary

Part A · Grammar

13.1 What Are Modal Auxiliaries?

Modal auxiliaries (or simply **modals**) are helping verbs that express the speaker's **attitude** toward an action — whether it is possible, necessary, permitted, advisable, certain, or desired. The word *modal* comes from *mode* (manner).

The **core modals** are: ***can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to***. The **semi-modals** are: ***need, dare, used to*** (which can also act as ordinary verbs) and expressions like ***have to, be able to, had better, would rather, be to, be supposed to***.

13.1.1 Special Features of Modals

1. **No *-s* in the third person:** *He **can** swim.* (✘ He cans swim)
2. **Followed by the bare infinitive** (base form without *to*) — except *ought to, used to, have to*: *She **must go**.* (✘ must to go, ✘ must goes, ✘ must going)
3. **No infinitive, *-ing* or past participle forms:** ✘ *to can*, ✘ *canning*, ✘ *have could*. Use substitutes: *to be able to, having to*.
4. **Negatives with *not* directly:** *cannot (can't), could not, may not, might not, shall not (shan't), should not, will not (won't), would not, must not, ought not to, need not, dare not*.
5. **Questions by inversion:** ***Can** you help me? **May** I come in? **Should** we wait?*
6. **Two modals cannot come together:** ✘ *He will can come.* ✔ *He will **be able to** come.* ✘ *You must can swim.* ✔ *You must **be able to** swim.*
7. **Modals are used with all three time references**, and their "past" forms (*could, might, should, would*) often express **politeness or tentativeness**, not past time.

13.2 *Can*

Use	Example
Ability (present)	*He **can** speak four languages. A cat **can** see in the dark.*
Permission (informal)	*You **can** go now. **Can** I use your phone?*
Possibility (general/theoretical)	*Smoking **can** cause cancer. Even good students **can** make mistakes.*
Request (informal)	***Can** you pass the salt?*
Impossibility / negative deduction (*can't*)	*It **can't** be true. He **can't** be hungry — he has just eaten.*
Offer	***Can** I help you?*

> ***Cannot*** is written as **one word** (*can not* is used only for special emphasis). The contraction is ***can't***. The future of *can* is ***will be able to***: *He **will be able to** walk next week.* (✘ will can)

13.3 *Could*

Use	Example
Past ability (general)	*He **could** swim when he was six.*
Polite request	***Could** you help me, please? **Could** I see the manager?*
Possibility (present/future, less certain)	*It **could** rain later. He **could** be at home now.*
Conditional (unreal)	*If I had money, I **could** buy a car.*
Suggestion	*You **could** try asking the teacher.*
Past of *can* in reported speech	*He said that he **could** swim.*
***Could have* + V3** — past possibility or ability not used	*You **could have** won if you had tried. (but you didn't) He **could have** taken the wrong bus.*

> ***Could* vs *was able to*:** For a **general ability** in the past, both are correct: *He **could / was able to** run fast.* For **one specific achievement** (= *managed to*), use ***was able to*** in positive sentences: ✘ *The fire was big, but everybody could escape.* ✔ *… everybody **was able to** escape / **managed to** escape.* In negatives, *couldn't* is fine: *He **couldn't** escape.*

13.4 *May*

Use	Example
Permission (formal)	***May** I come in, sir? You **may** go now. Students **may not** use phones in the exam hall* (prohibition).
Possibility (about 50%)	*He **may** come today. It **may** rain tonight. The news **may** be true.*
Wish / prayer / blessing	***May** you live long! **May** Allah bless you! **May** our country prosper!*
Purpose (with *so that / that / in order that*)	*He works hard **so that** he **may** succeed.*
Concession	*He **may** be rich, but he is not happy. Try as he **may**, he cannot win.*
***May have* + V3** — possibility in the past	*He **may have** missed the train.*

13.5 *Might*

Use	Example
Past of *may* in reported speech	*He said that he **might** come.*
Weaker possibility than *may*	*It **might** rain, but I doubt it.*
Polite suggestion / request	*You **might** call him first. **Might** I ask a question?* (very formal)
Purpose (after a past verb)	*He worked hard so that he **might** succeed.*
Unreal condition	*If you asked him, he **might** help you.*
***Might have* + V3**	*You **might have** been killed! (but you weren't) He **might have** forgotten.*
Mild reproach	*You **might have** told me earlier!*

13.6 *Shall*

Use	Example
Simple future with *I/we* (traditional British)	*I **shall** be twenty next year. We **shall** reach Sylhet by noon.*
Offer / suggestion (questions with *I/we*)	***Shall** I open the window? **Shall** we go for a walk?*

Use	Example
Command, promise, threat, determination with *you / he / they*	*You **shall** be punished. He **shall** have a prize. They **shall not** pass!*
Legal / formal obligation	*The tenant **shall** pay the rent by the 5th of each month. Every citizen **shall** have the right to vote.*
Asking for instructions	*What **shall** I do now?*

13.6.1 The Traditional *Shall / Will* Rule

Traditional grammar (still used in Bangladeshi exam answers) gives this rule:

Meaning	1st person (*I, we*)	2nd & 3rd persons (*you, he, she, it, they*)
Simple future (no special feeling)	**shall**	**will**
Determination, promise, command, threat, willingness	**will**	**shall**

- I **shall** go tomorrow. (simple future)
- I **will** go, whatever happens. (determination)
- He **will** come tomorrow. (simple future)
- He **shall** come, whether he likes it or not. (my determination/command)
- You **shall** get your reward. (promise)

> **Modern usage:** In modern English (especially American, and on the SAT/GRE/GMAT), ***will*** is used for **all persons** in the simple future, and ***shall*** is mainly used in **offers/suggestions** (*Shall I …? Shall we …?*) and in **legal documents**. But in BCS-type exam questions on "shall/will", apply the traditional rule above.

13.7 *Will*

Use	Example
Future (all persons in modern English)	*He **will** come tomorrow. It **will** rain.*
Willingness / volition	*I **will** help you. He **won't** listen to me.* (refusal)
Determination / promise (1st person)	*I **will** pass this time. I **will** never forget you.*
Request / invitation	***Will** you open the door, please? **Will** you have some tea?*
Habit / characteristic behaviour	*Boys **will** be boys. He **will** sit for hours reading. Oil **will** float on water.*
Assumption / deduction	*That **will** be the postman. (= I'm sure it's the postman.)*
Instant decision	*The phone is ringing — I'**ll** get it.*

13.8 *Should*

Use	Example
Duty / obligation (moral)	*We **should** obey our parents. You **should** respect your teachers.*
Advice / recommendation	*You **should** see a doctor. You **shouldn't** smoke.*
Probability / expectation	*He left at 8; he **should** be here by 10. The exam **should** be easy.*
After *lest* (always *should*, never *not*)	*Walk carefully **lest** you **should** fall.* (✘ lest you should not fall; ✘ lest you will fall)
Rare / doubtful condition	*If it **should** rain, the match will be cancelled. **Should** you need help, call me.*
Past of *shall* in reported speech	*I said that I **should** go.*
After *suggest, insist, recommend, propose, demand* (BrE)	*I suggest that he **should** go.* (also: *that he go*)
After *It is necessary / important / essential / strange / surprising that*	*It is necessary that he **should** be present. It is strange that she **should** say so.*
Polite form with *I/we* (formal BrE)	*I **should** like to meet him.* (= I would like)
***Should have* + V3** — past duty not done	*You **should have** come earlier. (but you didn't) I **shouldn't have** said that.*
Emotional reaction ("putative should")	*Why **should** I help him? Who **should** come in but the headmaster!*

13.9 *Would*

Use	Example
Past of *will* in reported speech	*He said that he **would** come.*
Polite request	***Would** you mind closing the door? **Would** you please help me?*
Conditional (unreal)	*If I were rich, I **would** help the poor. If he had come, I **would have** met him.*
Past habit (repeated action)	*When we were children, we **would** swim in the pond every day.*
Past willingness / refusal	*He **would not** listen to me. The car **wouldn't** start.*
Wish (with *wish*)	*I wish you **would** stop talking.*
Would like / would love (polite *want*)	*I **would like** a cup of tea. **Would** you **like** to come?*
Would rather (preference)	*I **would rather** walk than take a rickshaw. I **would rather** you **stayed** here.*
Probability / assumption about the past	*That **would** be his brother, I suppose.*
***Would have* + V3** — unreal past	*I **would have** helped you if you had asked.*

> **Do not use *would* in the *if*-clause** of a conditional (in standard and exam English): ✘ *If he would come, I would be happy.* ✔ *If he **came**, I would be happy.* ✘ *If I would have known* ✔ *If I **had known**.* (*Would* in an *if*-clause is acceptable only when it means "be willing": *If you would wait a moment, I'll call him.*)

13.10 *Must*

Use	Example
Necessity / strong obligation (from the speaker)	*I **must** finish this today. You **must** work hard to succeed.*
Rules and laws	*Passengers **must** wear seat belts. All candidates **must** bring their admit cards.*
Prohibition (*must not / mustn't*)	*You **mustn't** smoke here. Students **must not** cheat.*
Strong deduction / certainty (present)	*He **must** be tired after the long journey. She **must** be at home — the lights are on.*
Strong recommendation	*You **must** visit Cox's Bazar. You **must** see this film.*
***Must have* + V3** — certain deduction about the past	*The ground is wet; it **must have** rained last night. He **must have** forgotten.*

13.10.1 *Must* vs *Have to*

- ***Must*** — obligation from the **speaker** (internal, personal feeling): *I **must** stop smoking* (I feel it is necessary).
- ***Have to*** — obligation from **outside** (rules, circumstances): *I **have to** wear a uniform at work* (it's the rule).
- *Must* has no past or future form; use ***had to*** and ***will have to***: *I **had to** walk home yesterday. You **will have to** wait.*

13.10.2 *Mustn't* vs *Don't Have To / Needn't*

This difference is tested frequently:

Form	Meaning	Example
must not / mustn't	It is **forbidden** — don't do it	*You **mustn't** park here.* (It is not allowed.)
don't have to / needn't	It is **not necessary** — you can if you want	*You **don't have to / needn't** come tomorrow; it's a holiday.*

13.11 *Ought to*

Ought is always followed by ***to***. It expresses **moral duty**, **advice** or **probability**, and is very close to *should* (slightly stronger and more formal).

- We **ought to** love our country. (moral duty)
- You **ought to** apologise to her. (advice)
- He **ought to** pass easily; he has worked hard. (probability)
- You **ought not to** waste money. (negative: *ought not to*, ✘ ought to not)
- **Ought** we **to** go? (question — formal)
- You **ought to have** helped him. (past duty not done)
- ✘ You ought respect your elders. ✔ You **ought to** respect your elders.

13.12 *Need*

Need can be a **modal** (in negatives and questions, without *to*, no *-s*) or a **main verb** (with *to*, with *-s*, in all sentence types).

- **Modal:** *He **needn't** go. **Need** he go? You **need not** worry.*
- **Main verb:** *He **needs to** go. Does he **need to** go? He **doesn't need to** go.*
- ✘ He needs not go. ✔ He **need not** go / He **doesn't need to** go.
- ✘ He need to go. ✔ He **needs to** go. (positive statement → main verb)
- **Noun:** *There is no **need** to hurry.*

> ***Needn't have* + V3** vs ***didn't need to***: *I **needn't have** bought the bread* = I bought it, but it was unnecessary (wasted effort). *I **didn't need to** buy bread* = it was not necessary (and probably I didn't buy any).

13.13 *Dare*

Like *need*, ***dare*** is a **modal** in negatives and questions and a **main verb** elsewhere.

- **Modal:** *He **dare not** oppose his boss. **How dare** you speak to me like that? **Dare** he deny it?*
- **Main verb:** *He **dares to** speak the truth. He **doesn't dare (to)** open the door. Nobody **dared to** speak.*
- ***I dare say*** = I suppose: *I **dare say** you are tired.*
- ***Dare*** + object = challenge: *I **dare** you **to** jump.*
- ✘ He dares not go. ✔ He **dare not** go / He **does not dare to** go.

13.14 *Used to*

Used to + base form expresses a **past habit or state** that is **no longer true**.

- I **used to** smoke, but I gave it up.
- There **used to** be a big pond here.
- He **didn't use to** like vegetables. (✘ didn't used to — in careful writing)
- **Did** you **use to** play cricket?

> **Three structures not to confuse:**
>
> 1. ***used to* + base form** = past habit: *I **used to get up** early.* (but not now)
> 2. ***be used to* + -ing / noun** = be accustomed to: *I **am used to getting up** early.* (it is normal for me) / *He **is used to** hard work.*
> 3. ***get used to* + -ing / noun** = become accustomed to: *You will soon **get used to living** in Dhaka.*
>
> ✘ *I am used to get up early.* ✔ *I am used to **getting** up early.*

***Would* vs *used to* for past habits:** *Would* can express repeated past **actions** but not past **states**: *When I was a child, I **would / used to** play in the field* ✔. *I **used to** have a dog* ✔ (state — ✘ *I would have a dog*).

13.15 Other Modal Expressions

Expression	Meaning	Example
***had better* + base**	strong advice (with warning)	*You **had better** go now, or you'll miss the bus. You **had better not** tell him.* (✘ had better to go; ✘ had better not to)
***would rather* + base**	preference	*I **would rather** stay at home.*
***would rather* + subject + past**	preference about another's action	*I **would rather** you **went** now.*
would sooner	= would rather	*I **would sooner** die than surrender.*
be able to	ability (all tenses)	*She **will be able to** come. I **have been able to** save money.*
have to / have got to	external obligation	*I **have (got) to** leave now.*
be to	plan, order, destiny	*The President **is to** visit Rajshahi tomorrow. You **are to** wait here.*
be supposed to	expectation, duty	*You **are supposed to** be here at 9. The film **is supposed to** be good.*
be bound to	certainty	*He **is bound to** pass.*
be likely to	probability	*It **is likely to** rain.*

13.16 Modal + Perfect Infinitive (*have* + V3): Talking about the Past

Form	Meaning	Example
must have + V3	certainty about the past (deduction)	*He **must have** left already.*
can't / couldn't have + V3	impossibility in the past	*She **can't have** seen me — I was hiding.*
may / might have + V3	possibility in the past	*They **may have** lost the way.*

Form	Meaning	Example
could have + V3	past ability not used / past possibility	*You **could have** asked me for help.*
should / ought to have + V3	past duty not done (regret, criticism)	*You **should have** studied harder.*
shouldn't have + V3	a wrong action was done	*You **shouldn't have** shouted at him.*
needn't have + V3	unnecessary action that was done	*You **needn't have** brought an umbrella; it didn't rain.*
would have + V3	unreal past result (3rd conditional)	*I **would have** come if you had invited me.*

13.17 Modals in Reported Speech

When the reporting verb is in the past tense, modals change as follows (Chapter 27):

Direct	Indirect
can	could
may	might
shall	should (or *would*, depending on person)
will	would
must	must / had to
could, might, should, would, ought to, used to	no change

- He said, "I **can** swim." → He said that he **could** swim.
- She said, "I **may** go." → She said that she **might** go.
- He said, "I **will** help you." → He said that he **would** help me.
- The teacher said, "You **must** work hard." → The teacher said that we **must / had to** work hard.

13.18 Common Errors with Modals

1. ✘ He cans swim. ✔ He **can** swim.
2. ✘ She must goes now. ✔ She must **go** now.
3. ✘ You should to respect elders. ✔ You **should respect** elders.
4. ✘ You ought respect your teachers. ✔ You **ought to** respect your teachers.
5. ✘ He will can come tomorrow. ✔ He will **be able to** come tomorrow.
6. ✘ Walk fast lest you will miss the train. ✔ Walk fast **lest you should** miss the train.
7. ✘ Walk carefully lest you should not fall. ✔ Walk carefully **lest you should fall**.
8. ✘ You had better to go now. ✔ You **had better go** now.
9. ✘ I would rather to stay home. ✔ I **would rather stay** home.
10. ✘ He needs not come. ✔ He **need not** come / He **doesn't need to** come.
11. ✘ He dares not speak. ✔ He **dare not** speak.
12. ✘ I am used to get up early. ✔ I am used to **getting** up early.
13. ✘ He used to playing cricket. ✔ He used to **play** cricket.
14. ✘ If I would be rich, I would help you. ✔ If I **were** rich, I would help you.
15. ✘ May you lives long! ✔ May you **live** long!
16. ✘ He must have went home. ✔ He must have **gone** home.
17. ✘ You mustn't come tomorrow; it's a holiday. (= not necessary) ✔ You **needn't / don't have to** come tomorrow.
18. ✘ Everybody could escape from the burning house. ✔ Everybody **was able to / managed to** escape.
19. ✘ Can I come in, sir? (formal exam answer) ✔ **May** I come in, sir?
20. ✘ He should had come. ✔ He should **have come**.
21. ✘ You could have help me. ✔ You could have **helped** me.
22. ✘ I didn't used to like tea. ✔ I didn't **use** to like tea.
23. ✘ Shall you help me? (request) ✔ **Will** you help me?
24. ✘ He said that he will come. (past reporting) ✔ He said that he **would** come.
25. ✘ He might came today. ✔ He might **come** today.

13.19 Modals in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Conditional sequence (GMAT):** *If* + present → *will*; *If* + past → *would*; *If* + past perfect → *would have*. ✘ *If the company would invest more, profits would rise.* ✔ *If the company **invested** more, …*. ✘ *If he had known, he will come.* ✔ *… he **would have come**.*
- **Subjunctive and *should*:** GMAT prefers the bare subjunctive: *It is essential that he **be** present* (not *should be*) — both are grammatical, but GMAT often marks *should* as wordy.
- ***May / might / could* nuance in GRE Reading:** the author's degree of certainty is shown through modals — *must* (certain), *may/might/could* (possible), *should* (expected). Inference questions often turn on this.
- **Logical certainty words** like *must, cannot, necessarily, possibly* appear in **GMAT Critical Reasoning** answer choices; an answer saying something *must* happen is stronger (and riskier) than one saying it *may* happen.

CHAPTER 14

Gerund & Participle

Part A · Grammar

14.1 The Non-Finite Verbs (Verbals)

A **non-finite verb** (also called a **verbal**) is a form of a verb that is **not limited by person, number or tense** and cannot by itself be the main verb of a sentence. English has three:

Verbal	Form	Works as	Example
Infinitive	*to* + V1 (or bare V1)	noun, adjective, adverb	*I want **to learn**.*
Gerund	V1 + *-ing*	noun	***Learning** is a lifelong process.*
Participle	V1 + *-ing* (present), V3 (past), *having* + V3 (perfect)	adjective; part of verb phrases	*a **learning** child; a **learned** man; **Having learnt** the rule, he …*

Because the gerund and the present participle have the same form (*-ing*), and because the choice between gerund and infinitive after a verb is unpredictable, this chapter is among the most important for error detection, sentence completion and GMAT idioms. Since the infinitive is inseparable from the topic, it is treated here too.

14.2 The Infinitive

14.2.1 Forms of the Infinitive

Form	Active	Passive
Present (simple)	to write	to be written
Continuous	to be writing	—
Perfect	to have written	to have been written
Perfect continuous	to have been writing	—
Negative	not to write	not to be written

- I want **to write** a letter.
- He seems **to be writing** something.
- He is said **to have written** fifty books. (earlier action)
- The letter is **to be written** today.
- I told him **not to go**. (✘ to not go — avoid in exams)

14.2.2 Uses of the Infinitive

(a) As a noun:

- **To err** is human. (subject) → more natural: *It is human **to err**.*
- I want **to go** home. (object)
- His aim is **to become** a doctor. (complement)
- He has no choice but **to resign**. (object of preposition *but*)
- I don't know **what to do / how to solve** this. (question word + infinitive)

(b) As an adjective (qualifying a noun):

- Give me some water **to drink**.
- He has a family **to support**.
- This is not the time **to play**.
- She was the first **to arrive** / the last **to leave** / the only one **to pass**.
- I have nothing **to say**.

(c) As an adverb:

- **Purpose:** *He came **to see** me. We eat **to live**.* (also *in order to / so as to*)
- **After adjectives:** *I am glad **to meet** you. The book is easy **to read**. He is sure **to come**.*
- **Result:** *He lived **to see** his grandchildren. He woke up **to find** himself famous.*
- **With *too* and *enough*:** *He is **too** weak **to walk**. She is old **enough to vote**.* (✘ too weak that he cannot walk)

14.2.3 The Bare Infinitive (Without *to*)

The infinitive is used **without *to*** after:

1. **Modal auxiliaries:** *can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must* (but *ought to, used to, have to* keep *to*): *You must **go**.*
2. **Need** and **dare** used as modals: *You needn't **worry**. How dare you **say** so?*
3. ***Let, make, bid, have*** (= cause) + object: *Let him **go**. She made me **laugh**. I had him **repair** the fan.* (✘ made me to laugh)
4. **Verbs of perception** — *see, hear, feel, watch, notice, observe, behold* + object (for a **complete** action): *I saw him **cross** the road. I heard her **sing**.*
5. ***Had better, would rather, would sooner, rather than, cannot but, do nothing but, but, except, than***: *You had better **leave**. I would rather **die** than **beg**. I cannot but **laugh**. He did nothing but **cry**.*
6. ***Help*** — with or without *to*: *Help me **(to) carry** this box.*
7. ***Why / why not***: *Why **worry**? Why not **try** again?*

> **In the passive, *to* comes back:** *They made him work. → He **was made to** work. I saw him enter. → He **was seen to** enter. Let* has no direct passive: *Let him go → He **was allowed to** go.*

14.2.4 Verbs Followed by the Infinitive

Verbs + *to*-infinitive
afford, agree, aim, appear, arrange, ask, attempt, beg, care, choose, claim, consent, dare, decide, decline, demand, deserve, determine, endeavour, expect, fail, guarantee, happen, hesitate, hope, intend, learn, long, manage, mean (= intend), need, neglect, offer, plan, prepare, pretend, proceed, promise, prove, refuse, resolve, seek, seem, strive, swear, tend, threaten, undertake, venture, volunteer, vow, wait, want, wish, yearn

- He **decided to** resign. (✘ decided resigning)
- They **refused to** pay. / She **promised to** help. / I **hope to** see you soon.
- He **pretended to** be ill. / We **can't afford to** buy a car.

Verb + object + *to*-infinitive: *advise, allow, ask, beg, cause, challenge, command, compel, enable, encourage, expect, force, forbid, get, hire, instruct, invite, lead, oblige, order, permit, persuade, remind, request, require, teach, tell, tempt, urge, want, warn, would like.*

- The teacher **advised us to** read newspapers.
- My father **allowed me to** go.
- The rain **forced us to** stay at home.
- This scholarship **enabled her to** study abroad.
- ✘ He suggested me to go. ✔ He **suggested that I (should) go** / He **suggested going**. (*suggest* does not take object + infinitive)

14.2.5 *To* as a Preposition: The Great Trap

In many expressions ***to*** is a **preposition**, not part of an infinitive. A preposition must be followed by a **noun or gerund**, so these expressions take **V + *-ing***.

Expression (+ *-ing*)	Example
look forward to	*I **look forward to hearing** from you.* (✘ to hear)
be used to / get used to / be accustomed to	*He **is used to working** at night.*
object to / have an objection to	*I **object to being** treated like this.*
with a view to	*He went to London **with a view to studying** law.*
in addition to	***In addition to teaching**, she writes novels.*
be committed / dedicated / devoted to	*She **is devoted to helping** the poor.*
confess to / admit to	*He **confessed to stealing** the money.*
be addicted to / be given to	*He **is addicted to smoking**.*
be opposed to / be averse to	*I **am opposed to cutting** trees.*
prefer … to	*I **prefer walking to cycling**.*
take to (= start a habit)	*He **has taken to drinking**.*
contribute to / lead to	*Hard work **leads to succeeding**.* (more natural: *leads to success*)
the key to / an approach to	*the **key to solving** the problem*
when it comes to	***When it comes to cooking**, she is the best.*
resort to	*They **resorted to using** force.*
be equal to / be close to	*He is not **equal to doing** the job.*
what do you say to	*What do you say **to going** for a walk?*

Exam Tip — The *to*-test: If you can put a **noun** after the *to* (e.g. *I look forward to **the holiday***), then *to* is a preposition, and a verb after it must be in the **-ing** form (*I look forward to **seeing** you*). If only a verb fits (*I want to **go***), it is an infinitive.

14.2.6 The Split Infinitive

A **split infinitive** puts an adverb between *to* and the verb: *to **boldly** go, to **fully** understand*. Traditional grammar (and Bangladeshi exams) treats it as an error; modern grammar accepts it when it avoids awkwardness. In exams, prefer: *to understand **fully** / **fully** to understand*.

14.3 The Gerund

14.3.1 What Is a Gerund?

A **gerund** is the ***-ing*** form of a verb used as a **noun**. It is half verb, half noun — hence it is also called a **verbal noun** in some books.

- **As a verb,** it can take an **object** and be modified by an **adverb**: ***Reading** books **regularly** improves vocabulary.*
- **As a noun,** it can be a **subject, object, complement** or **object of a preposition**, and can be preceded by a possessive: ***His** reading is fluent.*

14.3.2 Uses of the Gerund

Function	Example
Subject	***Swimming** is good exercise. **Smoking** is injurious to health.*
Object of a verb	*I enjoy **swimming**. He gave up **smoking**.*
Complement	*My hobby is **gardening**. Seeing is **believing**.*
Object of a preposition	*He is fond of **reading**. She left without **saying** goodbye.*
Apposition	*His hobby, **collecting stamps**, is expensive.*
In compound nouns	*a **swimming** pool, a **walking** stick, a **dining** table, **drinking** water*
After *no* (prohibition)	***No smoking. No parking.***

14.3.3 Forms of the Gerund

Form	Active	Passive
Simple	writing	being written
Perfect	having written	having been written

- He hates **being disturbed**. (passive)
- He denied **having stolen** the money. (earlier action)
- She was proud of **having been chosen**.

14.3.4 Verbs Followed by the Gerund

Verbs + gerund (V-*ing*)
admit, anticipate, appreciate, avoid, can't help, can't stand, complete, consider, defer, delay, deny, detest, discuss, dislike, endure, enjoy, escape, excuse, fancy, finish, forgive, give up, imagine, involve, keep (on), mention, mind, miss, pardon, postpone, practise, prevent, put off, quit, recall, recollect, recommend, report, resent, resist, risk, stop, suggest, tolerate, understand

- He **avoided meeting** me. (✘ avoided to meet)
- I **enjoy reading** detective novels. (✘ enjoy to read)
- Would you **mind opening** the window? (✘ mind to open)
- She **finished writing** the report.
- He **denied taking** the money.
- I **can't help laughing** at his jokes. (✘ can't help to laugh)
- They **postponed holding** the meeting.
- Have you **considered changing** your job?
- He **suggested going** by train.
- **Keep trying** — you will succeed.

Expressions followed by the gerund:

it's no use, it's no good, it's (not) worth, there's no point (in), have difficulty / trouble (in), be busy, spend / waste (time / money), feel like, can't bear, be worth, be fond of, be good at, be interested in, be tired of, be afraid of, be capable of, be accustomed to, be used to, look forward to, insist on, succeed in, prevent from, refrain from, abstain from, think of, dream of, apologise for, thank for, accuse of, suspect of, approve of, depend on, instead of, in spite of, without, besides, after, before, on.

- **It's no use crying** over spilt milk.
- This book **is worth reading**.
- **There is no point in arguing** with him.
- I **had difficulty (in) finding** the house.
- He **spends** a lot of time **playing** games.
- I **don't feel like eating**.
- He **succeeded in passing** the exam. (✘ succeeded to pass)
- He **insisted on paying** the bill. (✘ insisted to pay)
- She is **capable of doing** it. (✘ capable to do)
- He was accused **of stealing**.
- **On hearing** the news, she fainted.
- **Before leaving**, he locked the door.

14.3.5 Possessive before the Gerund

In formal English, a noun or pronoun **before a gerund** takes the **possessive** form, because the gerund is a noun.

- I don't like **his** coming late. (formal) / I don't like **him** coming late. (informal)
- Please excuse **my** being late. (✘ excuse me being late — exam answer)
- We were surprised at **Rahim's** winning the prize.
- Do you mind **my** smoking?

14.3.6 Gerund vs Verbal Noun

When an *-ing* word is preceded by ***the*** and followed by ***of***, it is a pure **noun** (sometimes called a *verbal noun*), not a gerund, and cannot take a direct object:

- **Writing** letters is his job. (gerund — takes object *letters*)
- **The writing of** letters is his job. (verbal noun — *of* needed)
- ✘ The writing letters is his job. ✘ Writing of letters is his job.

14.4 Gerund or Infinitive? Verbs That Change Meaning

Some verbs take **both** structures, sometimes with **no change** of meaning and sometimes with a **big change**.

14.4.1 Little or No Change in Meaning

begin, start, continue, intend, attempt, love, like, hate, prefer, can't bear, can't stand: *It began **to rain** / began **raining**. I like **to swim** / like **swimming**.* (*Like + -ing* = enjoy; *like + to* = think it is a good idea: *I like **to visit** the dentist twice a year* — I don't enjoy it.)

14.4.2 Important Change in Meaning

Verb	+ *to*-infinitive	+ gerund (*-ing*)
remember	remember a **duty** before doing it: *Remember **to post** the letter.*	remember a **past** action: *I remember **posting** the letter.*
forget	forget a duty: *I forgot **to lock** the door.* (didn't lock)	forget a past event: *I'll never forget **meeting** the President.*
stop	stop **in order to** do something: *He stopped **to smoke**.* (he started smoking)	**end** an action: *He stopped **smoking**.* (gave up)
try	**make an effort**: *Try **to lift** this box.*	**experiment**: *Try **adding** some salt — it may taste better.*
regret	regret to **announce/inform** (now): *I regret **to inform** you that you failed.*	regret a **past** action: *I regret **telling** him the secret.*
go on	change to a new activity: *After the speech, he went on **to sing** a song.*	continue the same activity: *He went on **talking** for an hour.*
mean	**intend**: *I meant **to call** you.*	**involve**: *This job means **travelling** a lot.*
need	active: *I need **to clean** the room.*	passive meaning: *The room needs **cleaning*** (= needs to be cleaned).
allow / permit / advise / recommend / forbid	with an object: *They allow **us to smoke**.*	without an object: *They allow **smoking** here.*
see / hear / watch / feel + object	bare infinitive = **complete** action: *I saw him **cross** the road.*	*-ing* = action **in progress**: *I saw him **crossing** the road.*
afraid	afraid **to** do = unwilling because of fear: *She is afraid **to go** out at night.*	afraid **of** doing = fear that something will happen: *She is afraid **of falling**.*
sorry	sorry **to** = for a present situation: *Sorry **to disturb** you.*	sorry **for** = for a past action: *I'm sorry **for shouting** at you.*

14.5 The Participle

A **participle** is a verb form that works partly as a **verb** and partly as an **adjective** (it *participates* in both).

Participle	Form	Example
Present participle	V + *-ing* (active, continuing)	*a **running** stream; the **rising** sun*
Past participle	V3 (passive / completed)	*a **broken** chair; **fallen** leaves; a **written** test*
Perfect participle	*having* + V3 (completed before another action)	***Having finished** the work, he went out.*
Perfect passive participle	*having been* + V3	***Having been warned**, he was careful.*

14.5.1 Uses of Participles

(a) As adjectives: *a **sleeping** baby, a **barking** dog, a **lost** child, **boiled** eggs, the **wounded** soldier, an **interesting** book.*

(b) In forming tenses and the passive: *He **is reading**. They **have finished**. The thief **was caught**.*

(c) In participial phrases (to shorten adverb or adjective clauses):

- **Walking** along the road, I met an old friend. (= *While I was walking …* — time)
- **Being** ill, he could not attend the meeting. (= *As he was ill …* — reason)
- **Turning** to the left, you will find the post office. (= *If you turn …* — condition)
- **Having finished** his work, he went to bed. (= *After he had finished …*)
- **Written** in simple English, the book is easy to read. (= *As it is written …*)
- The man **standing** at the gate is my uncle. (= *who is standing* — adjective clause)
- The goods **ordered** last week have arrived. (= *which were ordered*)

(d) After verbs of perception and *keep, leave, find, catch, have, get*:

- I saw him **running**. / I heard her **singing**.
- He kept me **waiting** for an hour.
- They left the door **open** / the work **unfinished**.
- I found him **sleeping**. / The police caught him **stealing**.
- I **had** my hair **cut**. / She **got** her watch **repaired**. (causative — someone else does it)

14.5.2 The Absolute Participle (Nominative Absolute)

When a participle has **its own subject** (different from the subject of the main verb), the phrase is called an **absolute phrase** or **nominative absolute**. It is grammatically independent of the rest of the sentence.

- **The sun having set**, we returned home.
- **The weather being fine**, we went for a picnic.
- **God willing**, we shall meet again.
- **Weather permitting**, the match will be held tomorrow.

- **All things considered**, it was a good result.
- **The work done**, they went home.
- **Time permitting**, I shall visit you.

> **Absolute phrase vs dangling participle:** In an absolute phrase the participle has **its own subject** (*The sun having set*). If the participle has **no subject of its own**, it automatically refers to the **subject of the main clause** — and if that makes no sense, the participle is **dangling** (Chapter 29): ✘ ***Having set**, we returned home.* (Did *we* set?) ✔ ***The sun having set**, we returned home.*

14.5.3 Fixed Participle Expressions (Accepted Without a Subject)

Some participle phrases are so common that they are accepted even though they have no subject: *generally speaking, strictly speaking, judging from/by, considering, taking everything into account, provided (that), supposing, granting (that), roughly speaking, talking of.*

- **Generally speaking**, Bangladeshis are hospitable.
- **Judging by** his accent, he is from Chattogram.
- **Considering** his age, he did very well.

14.6 How to Tell a Gerund from a Participle

Both end in *-ing*. Ask what the *-ing* word is **doing**:

Test	Gerund	Present participle
Function	noun (subject, object, after a preposition)	adjective (describes a noun) or part of a verb
Meaning of *-ing* + noun	noun is **for** the action	noun **does** the action
Example	***Swimming** is healthy. a **swimming** pool (pool for swimming)*	*a **swimming** fish (fish that swims); He is **swimming**.*
Replace with a noun	✔ ***Exercise** is healthy.*	✘ — replace with an adjective: *a **dead** fish*

- **Dancing** is her passion. → gerund (subject)
- The **dancing** girl smiled. → participle (girl who dances)
- I like **dancing**. → gerund (object)
- She is **dancing**. → participle (part of the verb *is dancing*)
- a **dancing** hall → gerund (hall for dancing)
- a **sleeping** pill → gerund; a **sleeping** dog → participle

14.7 Common Errors with Gerunds, Infinitives and Participles

1. ✘ I look forward to hear from you. ✔ I look forward to **hearing** from you.
2. ✘ He is used to work hard. ✔ He is used to **working** hard.
3. ✘ I avoided to meet him. ✔ I avoided **meeting** him.
4. ✘ Would you mind to close the door? ✔ Would you mind **closing** the door?
5. ✘ He enjoys to swim. ✔ He enjoys **swimming**.
6. ✘ She made me to cry. ✔ She made me **cry**.
7. ✘ Let him to go. ✔ Let him **go**.
8. ✘ You had better to leave. ✔ You had better **leave**.
9. ✘ He suggested me to see a doctor. ✔ He suggested **that I see / should see** a doctor.
10. ✘ He insisted to pay the bill. ✔ He insisted **on paying** the bill.
11. ✘ He succeeded to win the race. ✔ He succeeded **in winning** the race.
12. ✘ She is capable to do it. ✔ She is capable **of doing** it.
13. ✘ It is no use to cry. ✔ It is no use **crying**.
14. ✘ This book is worth to read. ✔ This book is worth **reading**.
15. ✘ He went to Dhaka with a view to get a job. ✔ … with a view to **getting** a job.
16. ✘ I can’t help to laugh. ✔ I can’t help **laughing**.
17. ✘ He is too weak that he cannot walk. ✔ He is **too weak to walk**.
18. ✘ He prevented me to go. ✔ He prevented me **from going**.
19. ✘ Excuse me being late. ✔ Excuse **my** being late.
20. ✘ He stopped to smoke last year. (meaning *gave up*) ✔ He stopped **smoking** last year.
21. ✘ I remember to see him last year. ✔ I remember **seeing** him last year.
22. ✘ Being a rainy day, we stayed at home. ✔ **It being** a rainy day, we stayed at home.
23. ✘ The writing letters is easy. ✔ **Writing** letters is easy. / **The writing of** letters …
24. ✘ He was made work. ✔ He was made **to work**.
25. ✘ I saw him to go out. ✔ I saw him **go / going** out.
26. ✘ The room needs to clean. ✔ The room needs **cleaning / to be cleaned**.
27. ✘ He is busy to prepare for the exam. ✔ He is busy **preparing** for the exam.
28. ✘ I have no objection to sign it. ✔ I have no objection to **signing** it.
29. ✘ They decided going. ✔ They decided **to go**.
30. ✘ I am looking forward to meet you. ✔ I am looking forward to **meeting** you.

14.8 Gerunds and Infinitives in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

GMAT Idioms with infinitives and gerunds — memorise the correct pattern:

Correct (✔)	Wrong (✘)
ability **to** do	ability **of** doing
attempt **to** do	attempt **at** doing (in most contexts)
capable **of** doing	capable **to** do
consider X Y	consider X **as** Y / consider X **to be** Y (GMAT prefers no *as*)
credit X **with** doing	credit X **for** doing / **as** doing
decide **to** do	decide **on** doing (in GMAT)
forbid X **to** do	forbid X **from** doing
prohibit X **from** doing	prohibit X **to** do
require X **to** do	require X **doing**
encourage / persuade / enable X **to** do	encourage X **in** doing
responsible **for** doing	responsible **to** do
insist **on** doing / insist **that** X do	insist **to** do
be dedicated / devoted / committed **to** doing	dedicated **to** do
in order **to** do	in order **for** doing
so as **to** do	so as **for** doing
a means **of** doing	a means **to** doing
the effect **of** X **on** Y	the effect **of** X **to** Y

- **Parallelism:** gerunds must be parallel with gerunds, infinitives with infinitives: ✘ *She likes **swimming**, **to jog** and **riding**.* ✔ *She likes **swimming**, **jogging** and **riding**.*
- **Action noun vs gerund (GMAT):** prefer *the **development** of* to *the **developing** of*.
- **Dangling participles** — see Chapter 29; one of GMAT's most frequent errors.

CHAPTER 15

Adverb

Part A · Grammar

15.1 What Is an Adverb?

An **adverb** is a word that **modifies** (adds to the meaning of) a **verb**, an **adjective**, or **another adverb**. It may also modify a preposition, a conjunction, a phrase, or a whole sentence. The name means "added to a verb" (*ad + verb*), because modifying verbs is its most common job.

- She sings **beautifully**. (modifies the verb *sings* — how?)
- He is **very** tall. (modifies the adjective *tall*)
- He ran **quite** fast. (modifies the adverb *fast*)
- The bird flew **right** over my head. (modifies the preposition *over*)
- I like him **simply** because he is honest. (modifies the conjunction *because*)
- **Unfortunately**, the train was late. (modifies the whole sentence)

Adverbs answer the questions ***how? when? where? how often? how much / to what extent? why?***

15.2 Kinds of Adverbs (by Meaning)

Kind	Question	Examples
Manner	How?	quickly, slowly, well, badly, carefully, happily, so, thus, hard, fast
Time	When?	now, then, today, tomorrow, yesterday, soon, already, yet, still, lately, recently, before, ago, since, early, late
Place	Where?	here, there, everywhere, nowhere, up, down, in, out, near, far, above, below, away, abroad, inside, outside
Frequency	How often?	always, usually, generally, often, frequently, sometimes, occasionally, seldom, rarely, hardly ever, never, once, twice, again, daily
Degree / Quantity	How much? To what extent?	very, too, quite, rather, fairly, pretty, almost, nearly, enough, so, much, little, hardly, scarcely, barely, fully, entirely, extremely, partly
Affirmation & Negation	—	yes, no, not, certainly, surely, indeed, of course, never, by no means
Reason / Result	Why?	therefore, hence, consequently, thus, so, accordingly
Interrogative	(asks a question)	when? where? why? how? how much? how long?
Relative	(joins clauses, refers to an antecedent)	when, where, why, how (*This is the place **where** I was born.*)
Sentence / Comment	(comments on the whole sentence)	fortunately, luckily, clearly, obviously, frankly, honestly, surely, perhaps, certainly

15.3 Formation of Adverbs

15.3.1 Adding *-ly* to Adjectives

Rule	Examples
Most adjectives + ***-ly***	quick → quickly, careful → carefully, bad → badly, sad → sadly, beautiful → beautifully
Consonant + *y* → ***-ily***	happy → happily, easy → easily, busy → busily, angry → angrily, heavy → heavily
Final ***-le*** → ***-ly***	simple → simply, gentle → gently, terrible → terribly, possible → possibly, able → ably
Final ***-ic*** → ***-ically***	basic → basically, tragic → tragically, scientific → scientifically, dramatic → dramatically (exception: public → publicly)
Final ***-ue*** drops *e*	true → truly, due → duly
Final ***-ll*** adds only *-y*	full → fully, dull → dully
Exceptions	whole → wholly, shy → shyly, sly → slyly, dry → drily / dryly, day → daily, gay → gaily

15.3.2 Adverbs with the Same Form as Adjectives

fast, hard, late, early, high, low, long, near, far, straight, right, wrong, deep, daily, weekly, monthly, yearly, enough, well, ill, little, much, more, most, less, least, still, kindly, only, pretty, direct, free, clean, loud, sharp, tight, wide

- He is a **hard** worker. (adj) / He works **hard**. (adv)
- The train was **late**. (adj) / The train arrived **late**. (adv)
- a **fast** car (adj) / drives **fast** (adv) — ✘ *fastly* does not exist.
- a **straight** line (adj) / Go **straight**. (adv)

15.3.3 Pairs with Different Meanings

Some adverbs have two forms, **with and without *-ly***, which mean **different things**. This is a frequently tested area.

Without *-ly*	With *-ly*
hard = with effort: *He works **hard**.*	**hardly** = scarcely, almost not: *He **hardly** works.*
late = not early: *He came **late**.*	**lately** = recently: *I haven't seen him **lately**.*
near = close by: *Come **near**.*	**nearly** = almost: *I **nearly** fell.*
high = at a height: *The kite flew **high**.*	**highly** = very, greatly: *He is **highly** educated / **highly** respected.*
short = suddenly: *He stopped **short**.*	**shortly** = soon: *He will come **shortly**.*
free = without payment: *Children travel **free**.*	**freely** = without restriction: *Speak **freely**.*
deep = far down: *They dug **deep**.*	**deeply** = greatly: *I am **deeply** grateful.*
wide = fully: *The door was **wide** open.*	**widely** = in many places: *He has travelled **widely**.*

Without *-ly*	With *-ly*
pretty = fairly: *It's **pretty** good.*	**prettily** = in a pretty way: *She was dressed **prettily**.*
most = superlative of *much*: *What I value **most** is honesty.*	**mostly** = mainly: *The audience were **mostly** students.*
close = near: *He sat **close** to me.*	**closely** = carefully: *Watch **closely**.*
direct = without stopping: *The plane flies **direct** to London.*	**directly** = immediately; straight: *He'll come **directly**.*
right = correctly, straight: *Turn **right**. You guessed **right**.*	**rightly** = justly, with good reason: *He was **rightly** punished.*
wrong = incorrectly: *You spelt it **wrong**.*	**wrongly** = unjustly, mistakenly: *He was **wrongly** accused.*
just = exactly, a moment ago: *He has **just** left.*	**justly** = fairly: *He was **justly** rewarded.*
sharp = exactly (time): *at 9 o'clock **sharp***	**sharply** = suddenly, severely: *Prices rose **sharply**.*

15.3.4 Other Ways of Forming Adverbs

- **Compound adverbs:** *somewhere, anywhere, nowhere, everywhere, sometimes, meanwhile, nevertheless, however, therefore, moreover, beforehand, afterwards, hereafter, whereby.*
- **With *a-*:** *abroad, ahead, aloud, asleep, away, afoot, aside, apart, alike, anew, ashore.*
- **With *-ward(s)*, *-wise*:** *homeward(s), backward(s), forward(s), upward(s), clockwise, otherwise, likewise, lengthwise.*
- **Phrases used as adverbs (adverb phrases):** *now and then, again and again, by and by, at last, at once, in vain, of course, in short, by heart, on foot, all of a sudden, by no means.*

15.4 Comparison of Adverbs

Type	Positive	Comparative	Superlative
One-syllable (and *early*)	fast, hard, soon, late, early	faster, harder, sooner, later, earlier	fastest, hardest, soonest, latest, earliest
-ly adverbs	carefully, quickly, beautifully	more carefully, more quickly	most carefully, most quickly
Irregular	well	better	best
	badly, ill	worse	worst
	much	more	most
	little	less	least
	far	farther / further	farthest / furthest

- She sings **better** than her sister. (✘ more well)
- He works **harder** than anyone else.
- Drive **more carefully**. (✘ carefullier)
- Of all the students, Rina writes **most neatly**.

15.5 Position of Adverbs

The position of an adverb affects both **grammar** and **meaning**. These are the general rules:

15.5.1 Adverbs of Manner, Place and Time — After the Verb (or Object)

Usually placed **after the verb**, or **after the object** if there is one. Never put an adverb between a verb and its direct object.

- He did the work **carefully**. (✘ He did carefully the work.)
- She speaks English **fluently**. (✘ She speaks fluently English.)
- I met him **yesterday**.

Order when several come together — M P T (Manner → Place → Time):

- He spoke **eloquently** (M) **at the meeting** (P) **last night** (T).
- She went **to school** (P) **early** (T) **yesterday** (T).
- After verbs of movement, **Place** often comes first: *He went **home** (P) **quickly** (M) **after the class** (T).*

15.5.2 Adverbs of Frequency — Before the Main Verb, After *be* and Auxiliaries

always, usually, often, sometimes, seldom, rarely, never, ever, hardly, scarcely, generally, frequently, just, already, almost, also, only, still:

- He **always** comes on time. (before the main verb)
- He is **always** punctual. (after *be*)
- I have **never** seen a tiger. (after the first auxiliary)
- You can **always** call me. (after the modal)
- Do you **often** go there? (questions: after the subject)
- ✘ He comes always late. ✔ He **always** comes late.
- ✘ I never have been there. ✔ I have **never** been there.

Sometimes, usually, often can also begin or end a sentence: ***Sometimes** I walk to work. / I walk to work **sometimes**.*

15.5.3 Adverbs of Degree — Before the Word They Modify

- He is **very** clever. / She is **too** tired. / It is **quite** good. / It's **almost** finished.
- Exception: ***enough*** comes **after** the adjective or adverb: *He is **old enough**. She sings **well enough**.* (✘ enough old)

15.5.4 Position of *Only*, *Even*, *Just*, *Also*, *Almost*

Only should be placed **immediately before** the word it modifies. Moving it changes the meaning:

- **Only** I met him yesterday. (No one else met him.)
- I **only** met him yesterday. (I didn't speak to him / do anything else.)
- I met **only** him yesterday. (I met no one else.)
- I met him **only** yesterday. (It was as recent as yesterday.)
- ✘ He only spent ten taka. (if you mean the amount) ✔ He spent **only** ten taka.

The same is true of *even, just, almost, nearly, merely, scarcely, hardly*: *I **nearly** lost all my money* (I did not lose it) vs *I lost **nearly** all my money* (I lost most of it). Always put the word next to what it limits.

15.5.5 Sentence Adverbs

Adverbs that comment on the whole statement usually come **first**, followed by a comma: ***Fortunately**, nobody was hurt. **Frankly**, I don't like him. **Obviously**, he was lying.*

15.6 Correct Use of Some Important Adverbs

15.6.1 *Very* and *Much*

very	*much*
with positive adjectives/adverbs: *very good, very fast*	with comparatives: *much better, much faster*
with present participles used as adjectives: *very interesting, very boring*	with past participles in passive sense: *much admired, much obliged, much talked of*
with past participles used as pure adjectives: *very tired, very pleased, very worried*	before *too*: *much too heavy* (✘ very too heavy)
with superlatives in the pattern *the very best*	before *the* + superlative: *much the best*

- ✘ He is very stronger than me. ✔ He is **much** stronger than I.
- ✘ The film was much interesting. ✔ The film was **very** interesting.
- ✘ This box is very too heavy. ✔ This box is **much / far** too heavy.
- ✔ I am **very much** obliged to you.

15.6.2 *Too* and *Very*

Very = to a high degree (no problem implied). ***Too*** = **more than enough / more than desirable**; it implies a **negative result**, often with *to*-infinitive.

- It is **very** hot today. (just a statement)
- It is **too** hot to go out. (so we cannot go out)
- ✘ I am too glad to see you. ✔ I am **very** glad to see you. (*too* gives a negative sense — wrong for a pleasant meaning)
- *Too* = *also* at the end: *I like it **too**.*
- ✘ He is too much intelligent. ✔ He is **very** intelligent. (*too much* modifies nouns or verbs: *He talks **too much**.*)

15.6.3 *Enough*

- After adjectives/adverbs: *He is **tall enough** to reach the shelf. She didn't run **fast enough**.*
- Before nouns (as an adjective): *We have **enough time / enough money**.*

15.6.4 *Already*, *Yet*, *Still*

Adverb	Used in	Example
already	positive statements (and surprise questions) — something happened earlier than expected	*He has **already** left. Have you finished **already**?*
yet	negatives and questions — something expected has not happened	*He hasn't come **yet**. Has he come **yet**?*
still	continuation — something is continuing longer than expected	*He is **still** sleeping. He **still** hasn't paid me.*

15.6.5 *Ago*, *Before*, *Since*

- ***ago*** = back from **now**; used with the **past simple**: *He left two years **ago**.* (✘ has left two years ago; ✘ ago since)
- ***before*** = back from a **past time**, or "at any time in the past": *He told me that he had left two years **before**. I have seen him **before**.*
- ***since*** = from a point of time until now; used with **perfect tenses**: *I have known him **since** 2015.*

- ✘ He has come two days ago. ✔ He **came** two days ago.
- ✘ It is two years ago since I saw him. ✔ It is two years **since** I saw him. / I saw him two years **ago**.

15.6.6 *Hardly*, *Scarcely*, *Barely*, *Seldom*, *Rarely*

These adverbs are **negative in meaning**, so they must **not** be used with another negative (*not, no, never, nothing*).

- ✘ I can't hardly hear you. ✔ I can **hardly** hear you.
- ✘ He hardly never comes. ✔ He **hardly ever** comes.
- ✘ There was scarcely no food. ✔ There was **scarcely any** food.
- *Hardly … when* (✘ than): ***Hardly** had he arrived **when** it began to rain.* (Chapter 16)

15.6.7 *So*, *Such*, *So … that*, *Too … to*

- He is **so** weak **that** he cannot walk. = He is **too** weak **to** walk.
- She is **such** a kind lady **that** everyone loves her. = She is **so** kind a lady **that** …
- ✘ He is so weak to walk. ✔ He is **too** weak to walk / **so** weak **that** he cannot walk.
- ✘ It was such hot that we stayed in. ✔ It was **so** hot that we stayed in.

15.6.8 *Else* and *Otherwise*

Else follows *anybody, somebody, nobody, everybody, what, who, where, little, nothing*: *Ask **somebody else**. What **else** do you want?* — and is followed by ***but*** (✘ than): *It is nothing **else but** pride. **Or else*** = otherwise: *Hurry up, **or else** you'll miss the bus.*

15.6.9 *Fairly* and *Rather*

Fairly is used with "good/positive" qualities; ***rather*** usually with "bad/negative" ones (or to express surprise): *The test was **fairly** easy. The test was **rather** difficult. He is **fairly** clever but **rather** lazy.*

15.6.10 *Ever* and *Never*

Ever = at any time (questions, negatives, comparisons, superlatives); ***never*** = at no time: *Have you **ever** been to Nepal? This is the best film I have **ever** seen. I have **never** told a lie. ✘ I have not never seen …*

15.6.11 *Also*, *Too*, *As well*, *Either*

In **positive** sentences use *also / too / as well*; in **negative** sentences use ***either***: *He likes tea; I like it **too**. / He doesn't like tea; I don't like it **either**.* (✘ I don't like it too)

15.6.12 *Yes* and *No* in Answers to Negative Questions

English answers the **fact**, not the question: *"Didn't you go?" — "**Yes**, I did." / "**No**, I didn't."* (Bangla speakers often reverse these.)

15.7 Adjective or Adverb?

Use an **adjective** after **linking verbs** (*be, seem, look, feel, smell, taste, sound, become, grow, turn, remain, keep, prove*) because the word describes the subject. Use an **adverb** to describe **how an action is done** (Chapter 09.6).

- The soup tastes **good**. (adj) / She cooks **well**. (adv)
- He looks **angry**. (adj) / He looked **angrily** at me. (adv)
- Keep **quiet**. (adj) / Work **quietly**. (adv)
- I feel **bad**. (adj) / He behaved **badly**. (adv)
- *Good* is an adjective; *well* is the adverb (and also an adjective meaning "healthy"): *He plays **well**. I am **well**, thank you.*

15.8 Adverbs and Adverbial Conjunctions (Conjunctive Adverbs)

Words like ***however, therefore, moreover, furthermore, nevertheless, consequently, otherwise, besides, hence, thus, accordingly, meanwhile, instead, still*** are **adverbs**, not conjunctions. They cannot join two independent clauses with only a comma; use a **semicolon** or a **full stop**, or add a real conjunction.

- ✘ He was ill, therefore he did not come. (comma splice)
- ✔ He was ill; **therefore**, he did not come.
- ✔ He was ill. **Therefore**, he did not come.
- ✔ He was ill, **and therefore** he did not come.
- ✔ He was ill, **so** he did not come. (*so* is a conjunction)

15.9 Common Errors with Adverbs

1. ✘ He speaks fluently English. ✔ He speaks English **fluently**.
2. ✘ He always is late. ✔ He is **always** late.
3. ✘ She sings very good. ✔ She sings very **well**.

4. ✘ The flower smells sweetly. ✔ The flower smells **sweet**.
5. ✘ He works very hardly. ✔ He works very **hard**.
6. ✘ He came lately to the office. ✔ He came **late** to the office.
7. ✘ He is very stronger than his brother. ✔ He is **much** stronger than his brother.
8. ✘ I am too happy to meet you. ✔ I am **very** happy to meet you.
9. ✘ He is enough strong. ✔ He is **strong enough**.
10. ✘ He hardly never goes out. ✔ He **hardly ever** goes out.
11. ✘ I can't scarcely believe it. ✔ I can **scarcely** believe it.
12. ✘ He has come two days ago. ✔ He **came** two days ago.
13. ✘ He has not finished his work already. ✔ He has not finished his work **yet**.
14. ✘ I don't like coffee too. ✔ I don't like coffee **either**.
15. ✘ He drives very fastly. ✔ He drives very **fast**.
16. ✘ She dresses beautiful. ✔ She dresses **beautifully**.
17. ✘ He did the sum easily and correct. ✔ … easily and **correctly**.
18. ✘ He is so weak to walk. ✔ He is **too** weak to walk.
19. ✘ It is nothing else than pride. ✔ It is nothing else **but** pride.
20. ✘ I only have five taka. (strict exam style) ✔ I have **only** five taka.
21. ✘ The old man walked slow. ✔ The old man walked **slowly**.
22. ✘ He returned back home. ✔ He **returned** home. (redundant *back*)
23. ✘ Seldom he comes here. ✔ **Seldom does** he come here. (Chapter 16)
24. ✘ He is much intelligent. ✔ He is **very** intelligent.
25. ✘ Nowadays, prices are going very high. ✔ Nowadays, prices are **rising** steeply. (better collocation)

15.10 Adverbs in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Adjective/adverb confusion (SAT):** ✘ *The new policy was implemented quick.* ✔ *… **quickly**.* ✘ *a surprising low score* ✔ *a **surprisingly** low score*.
- **Comma splice with conjunctive adverbs (SAT):** ✘ *The data were incomplete, however, the study was published.* ✔ *The data were incomplete; **however**, the study was published.*
- **Misplaced *only* (GMAT):** place limiting modifiers next to the word they limit.
- **GRE Text Completion:** signal adverbs show the logic of a sentence — ***however, nevertheless, yet, still*** (contrast); ***moreover, furthermore, indeed*** (support/extension); ***therefore, hence, thus, consequently*** (result); ***ironically, paradoxically*** (unexpected contrast). Identifying these "trigger words" is the single most powerful strategy for text completion.

CHAPTER 16

Inversion

Part A · Grammar

16.1 What Is Inversion?

The normal word order of an English statement is **Subject + Verb** (*He came*). **Inversion** means **reversing** this order so that the **verb (or an auxiliary) comes before the subject**. It happens in questions, after certain negative or restrictive words placed at the beginning, in conditional sentences without *if*, after adverbs of place, and in some literary or emphatic structures.

There are two kinds of inversion:

1. **Subject–auxiliary inversion** — only the **auxiliary** (*do, does, did, have, has, had, be, can, will* …) moves before the subject; the main verb stays after it:
   - *He **has** never seen a tiger.* → ***Never has** he seen a tiger.*
   - *He **came** late.* → ***Seldom did** he come late.* (if there is no auxiliary, add *do/does/did*)
2. **Full (subject–verb) inversion** — the **whole verb** comes before the subject (mostly with intransitive verbs of place and movement):
   - *A bus **comes** here.* → *Here **comes** a bus.*
   - *An old temple **stands** on the hill.* → *On the hill **stands** an old temple.*

Inversion is tested in BCS, Bank and admission tests through **error detection** (*Never I have seen* ✘), **fill in the gaps** (*No sooner had he … than*) and **sentence transformation**. GRE and SAT reading passages use it constantly for emphasis, and GMAT tests it with *not only … but also* and *nor*.

16.2 Inversion in Questions

The basic case of subject–auxiliary inversion:

- **Are** you ready? / **Is** she a doctor?
- **Have** you finished? / **Can** he swim?
- **Do** you know him? / **Did** she call? (*do/does/did* added)
- Where **does** he live? / Why **were** you late?
- **Who** broke the glass? → no inversion when the question word is the **subject**
- **What** happened? → no inversion (*what* is the subject) — ✘ *What did happen?* (only for emphasis)

> **No inversion in indirect (embedded) questions:** ✘ *I don't know where does he live.* ✔ *I don't know where **he lives**.* ✘ *Tell me what is your name.* ✔ *Tell me what **your name is**.* (Chapter 37)

16.3 Inversion after Negative and Restrictive Expressions

When a **negative** or **restrictive** adverb or phrase is placed at the **beginning** of a sentence for emphasis, the subject and auxiliary are **inverted**. This is the most frequently tested type of inversion.

16.3.1 The Words and Phrases

Group	Expressions
Negative adverbs	never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, barely, little, nowhere, neither, nor
Time sequence	hardly … when, scarcely … when, barely … when, no sooner … than
Negative phrases	at no time, in no way, on no account, under no circumstances, in no case, by no means, not once, not a single (word / person), not for a moment, not until / not till, not only … but also
Only phrases	only then, only when, only after, only by, only if, only in this way, only once, only later
Others	so + adjective/adverb … that; such … that; little did …

16.3.2 Examples

- **Never have I** seen such a beautiful place. (✘ Never I have seen)
- **Seldom does he** come to the office late.
- **Rarely do we** find such honest people today.
- **Little did I** know that he was a thief. (*little* = not at all)
- **Nowhere else will you** find such hospitality.
- **At no time did she** complain.
- **Under no circumstances should you** open this door.
- **On no account must you** tell him the secret.
- **In no way was he** responsible for the accident.
- **By no means is this** the end of the matter.
- **Not once did he** look back.
- **Not a single word did he** utter.
- **Not until** he came back **did I** realise the truth. (inversion in the **main** clause)
- **Only then did I** understand the problem.
- **Only after** the meeting **did he** tell us the news.
- **Only by** working hard **can you** succeed.
- **Only when** the rain stopped **did we** go out.

> **Exam Tip — Where does the inversion go?** With ***not until***, ***only after***, ***only when***, ***only if***, ***only by*** the inversion comes in the **main clause**, not in the clause or phrase that follows these words: *Only **when the rain stopped** (no inversion) **did we go** (inversion) out.*

16.3.3 *Hardly / Scarcely / Barely … when* and *No sooner … than*

These correlatives express that **one past action followed another immediately**. They are usually used with the **past perfect** in the first clause and the **past simple** in the second.

> ***Hardly / Scarcely / Barely** + had + subject + V3 + **when / before** + past simple. **No sooner** + had + subject + V3 + **than** + past simple.*

- **Hardly had** he reached the station **when** the train left. (✘ than)
- **Scarcely had** we sat down **when** the lights went out.
- **Barely had** she finished **when** the bell rang.
- **No sooner had** he arrived **than** it began to rain. (✘ when / then)

- **No sooner did** the teacher enter **than** the boys stood up. (past simple form, also correct)
- Without inversion (less formal): *He had **hardly** reached the station **when** the train left. He had **no sooner** arrived **than** it began to rain.*

> **Pairing rule:** *No sooner* is a comparative (*sooner*), so it pairs with ***than***. *Hardly, scarcely, barely* are not comparatives, so they pair with ***when*** (or *before*). ✘ *Hardly had he left than …* ✘ *No sooner had he left when …* — these are the classic exam errors.

16.3.4 *Not only … but also*

When ***not only*** begins a sentence (and joins clauses), the **first** clause is inverted:

- **Not only did he** steal the money, **but he also** beat the guard.
- **Not only is she** beautiful, **but she is also** intelligent.
- Without inversion: *He **not only** stole the money **but also** beat the guard.* (parallel verbs — Chapter 39)

16.3.5 *Neither*, *Nor* and *So* (Short Answers and Additions)

To say that the same thing is true of another person, use ***so*** (positive) and ***neither / nor*** (negative) + **auxiliary** + **subject**:

- I like tea. — **So do I**. (✘ So I do — that means "Yes, it's true, I do")
- She can swim. — **So can her brother**.
- He has finished. — **So have we**.
- I don't smoke. — **Neither / Nor do I**. (✘ Neither I do; ✘ I don't too)
- He wasn't there. — **Neither was she**.
- He did not come, **nor did he** send a message. (✘ nor he sent)
- I have never seen it, **and neither has she**.

> ***So I do* vs *So do I*:** *So do I = I do too* (agreement). *So I do = Yes, indeed I do* (confirming a fact that someone has noticed): *"You look tired." — "**So I am**."*

16.3.6 *So … that* and *Such … that* (Emphatic Fronting)

- **So beautiful was** the scene **that** we could not take our eyes off it. (= The scene was so beautiful that …)
- **So fast did** he run **that** nobody could catch him.
- **Such was** his anger **that** he could not speak. (= His anger was such that …)
- **Such is** life!

16.4 Inversion in Conditional Sentences (Omitting *If*)

In formal English, ***if*** can be dropped from a conditional clause beginning with ***had, were*** or ***should***, and the auxiliary is placed before the subject (Chapter 25).

- If I had known → **Had I known**, I would have helped you.
- If I were you → **Were I you**, I would not go.
- If he were to come → **Were he to come**, we would welcome him.
- If you should need help → **Should you need** help, call me.
- If it had not been for your help → **Had it not been for** your help, I would have failed. (✘ Hadn't it been for)

> **Negative inverted conditionals** do not use the contracted form: ✘ *Hadn't I known* / ✘ *Weren't it for* → ✔ ***Had I not known*** / ✔ ***Were it not for***.

16.5 Full Inversion after Adverbs of Place and Direction

With **intransitive verbs of movement or position** (*come, go, stand, lie, sit, run, fly, live, rise, fall*), a sentence can begin with an **adverb of place or direction**, and then the **whole verb** comes before a **noun** subject:

- **Here comes** the bus. (✘ Here the bus comes — less natural)
- **There goes** the last train.
- **Down came** the rain.
- **Away flew** the birds.
- **In came** the headmaster.
- **Out rushed** the children.
- **Up went** the prices.
- **Off went** the soldiers.

> **No inversion when the subject is a pronoun:** *Here **it** comes.* (✘ Here comes it) *There **she** goes. Away **they** flew. Down **it** came.*

16.5.1 After Prepositional Phrases of Place

- **On the hill stands** an old temple.
- **In the middle of the room was** a large table.
- **Among the guests were** two ministers.
- **Under the tree sat** an old beggar.
- **Beside the river lies** a small village.
- **At the top of the list is** Rahim's name.

Remember that the verb agrees with the **subject that follows**: *On the hill **stand two temples**.* (Chapter 23)

16.6 Inversion with Participles, Adjectives and Complements

For emphasis or in literary style, a **participle**, an **adjective** or a **complement** can be placed first, followed by the verb and then the subject:

- **Gone are** the days when a family could live on a small income.
- **Blessed are** the meek, for they shall inherit the earth.
- **Present at the meeting were** the Mayor and the Commissioner.
- **Attached is** a copy of my CV. / **Enclosed are** the documents.
- **Great was** our joy when we heard the news.
- **Lucky is** the man who has a good wife.
- **Standing at the gate was** a tall stranger.

16.7 Inversion in Wishes, Exclamations and Literary Language

- **May you live** long! **May Allah bless** you! (wish/prayer)
- **Long live** Bangladesh! (subjunctive)
- **How sweet is** the song of the cuckoo! (literary; normal: *How sweet the song of the cuckoo is!*)
- **Come** what may, I will stand by you. (= Whatever happens)
- **Be** that as it may, … (= Even if that is true)
- **Try as he might**, he could not open the door. (concessive)
- **Much as I** like him, I cannot support him. (= Although I like him very much)

- **Strange as it may seem**, he refused the offer.

> ***Adjective/adverb + as + subject + verb*** (*Strange as it may seem; Tired as he was; Much as I admire him*) expresses **concession** (= *although*). There is no inversion of subject and verb here; the adjective is fronted. ✘ *As strange as it may seem* is common informally but the exam form is ***Strange as it may seem***.

16.8 Inversion after *As* and *Than* (Formal Comparison)

In formal writing, after ***as*** and ***than***, the auxiliary may come before a **noun** subject:

- She is very hard-working, **as are** her sisters.
- Rahim scored higher than **did** Karim.
- Bangladesh exports more garments than **does** Vietnam (in some years).

16.9 Inversion in Reporting Direct Speech

In stories, the **reporting verb** may come before a **noun** subject after a quotation:

- "I am tired," **said the boy**. (also: *the boy said*)
- "Come in," **replied the teacher**.
- With pronouns, normal order is preferred: *"I am tired," **he said***. (*said he* is old-fashioned)

16.10 Summary Table of Inversion Patterns

Pattern	Example
Negative adverb + aux + S + V	*Never **have I** seen it.*
Hardly/Scarcely + had + S + V3 + *when*	*Hardly **had he** left **when** she came.*
No sooner + had + S + V3 + *than*	*No sooner **had he** left **than** she came.*
Only + phrase/clause + aux + S + V	*Only then **did he** agree.*
Not until + clause, aux + S + V	*Not until he left **did I** relax.*
Not only + aux + S + V, *but* S *also* V	*Not only **did he** sing, but he also danced.*
So / Neither / Nor + aux + S	*So **do I**. Nor **can he**.*
So + adj + V + S + *that*	*So great **was the noise** that …*
Had / Were / Should + S (conditional)	***Had I** known, …*
Adverb of place + V + noun S	*Here **comes the bus**.*
Prepositional phrase of place + V + S	*On the hill **stands a temple**.*
Participle/adjective + *be* + S	*Gone **are the days** …*
May + S + V (wish)	***May you** succeed!*

16.11 Common Errors with Inversion

1. ✘ Never I have seen such a sight. ✔ Never **have I** seen such a sight.
2. ✘ Seldom he comes here. ✔ Seldom **does he** come here.
3. ✘ Hardly he had reached when it rained. ✔ Hardly **had he** reached **when** it rained.
4. ✘ Hardly had he gone than she came. ✔ Hardly had he gone **when** she came.
5. ✘ No sooner had he come when the bell rang. ✔ No sooner had he come **than** the bell rang.
6. ✘ No sooner he had come than the bell rang. ✔ No sooner **had he** come than the bell rang.
7. ✘ Not only he is clever but also honest. ✔ **Not only is he** clever, **but he is also** honest. / He is **not only** clever **but also** honest.
8. ✘ Little he knew about the danger. ✔ Little **did he** know about the danger.
9. ✘ Only then I understood. ✔ Only then **did I** understand.
10. ✘ Not until he left I relaxed. ✔ Not until he left **did I** relax.
11. ✘ I don't like tea. — Neither I do. ✔ **Neither do I.**
12. ✘ He can't swim and I can't too. ✔ He can't swim, and **neither can I**.
13. ✘ He did not come, nor he sent a letter. ✔ … **nor did he** send a letter.
14. ✘ Here comes he. ✔ Here **he comes**.
15. ✘ Hadn't he helped me, I would have failed. ✔ **Had he not** helped me, I would have failed.
16. ✘ Were I knew the truth, I would tell you. ✔ **Had I known** / **If I knew** the truth, …
17. ✘ Under no circumstances you should go there. ✔ Under no circumstances **should you** go there.
18. ✘ So loud the music was that we couldn't sleep. ✔ So loud **was the music** that we couldn't sleep.
19. ✘ On the table were lying a book. ✔ On the table **was lying a book**.
20. ✘ I don't know where does he live. ✔ I don't know where **he lives**. (no inversion in embedded questions)

16.12 Inversion in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Agreement in inverted sentences (SAT/GMAT):** find the subject **after** the verb: ✘ *Among the most important factors **is** cost and quality.* ✔ *Among the most important factors **are** cost and quality.*
- **GMAT *nor*:** ✘ *The policy did not reduce costs, nor it improved quality.* ✔ *… **nor did it** improve quality.*
- **GMAT *not only … but also*** must be **parallel**: ✘ *not only in Asia but also Africa* ✔ *not only **in Asia** but also **in Africa***.
- **GRE/SAT Reading:** inverted sentences (*Only recently have scientists discovered …; Rarely has a theory provoked such debate …*) signal **emphasis** and often contain the author's main point; read them carefully when answering "primary purpose" questions.

CHAPTER 17

Preposition

Part A · Grammar

17.1 What Is a Preposition?

A **preposition** is a word placed **before** a noun or pronoun (or a noun-equivalent) to show its **relation** to some other word in the sentence — a relation of **place, time, direction, cause, manner, means, possession** and so on. *Pre-position* means "placed before".

- The book is **on** the table. (place)
- We met **at** six o'clock. (time)
- He walked **towards** the river. (direction)
- He died **of** cholera. (cause)
- She cut the cake **with** a knife. (instrument)
- He went **by** bus. (means)

The noun or pronoun after a preposition is its **object**, and a pronoun object is always in the **objective case**: *with **him**, for **us**, between you and **me**, except **her**.*

The object of a preposition may be:

- a **noun / pronoun**: *in **the room**, for **them***
- a **gerund**: *fond **of reading**, without **saying** a word*
- an **adverb**: *from **here**, till **now**, since **then***
- a **phrase**: *from **behind the curtain**, until **after the exam***
- a **clause**: *Listen to **what he says**.*

17.2 Kinds of Prepositions

Kind	Description	Examples
Simple	single, short words	at, by, for, from, in, of, off, on, out, over, through, till, to, up, with
Compound	formed by joining a preposition to another word (often *a-* or *be-*)	about, above, across, against, along, amid(st), among(st), around, before, behind, below, beneath, beside, between, beyond, inside, into, onto, outside, throughout, towards, underneath, upon, within, without
Phrase (complex)	a group of words used as one preposition	according to, along with, apart from, as for, because of, by means of, by dint of, by virtue of, by way of, due to, for the sake of, in accordance with, in addition to, in case of, in front of, in lieu of, in order to (infinitive marker), in place of, in spite of, instead of, in view of, on account of, on behalf of, owing to, with a view to, with reference to, with regard to, in the event of, in comparison with
Participle	present/past participles used as prepositions	barring, concerning, considering, during, excepting, notwithstanding, pending, regarding, respecting, touching, given, provided
Disguised	shortened forms	*a-* (= on): *He went **a-**fishing.* / *o'* (= of): *five **o'**clock*
Double	two prepositions together	from behind, from under, from among, till after, over against

- **According to** the report, prices will rise.
- The match was cancelled **because of** rain.
- He succeeded **by dint of** hard work.
- **In spite of** his illness, he attended the meeting.
- **Considering** his age, he is very active.
- **Pending** the inquiry, the officer was suspended.
- The cat jumped out **from under** the bed.

17.3 Position of the Preposition

A preposition normally comes **before** its object. But it is placed at the **end** in these cases:

1. **Questions with *who, what, which, where*:** *What are you looking **at**? Who are you talking **to**? Where do you come **from**?*
2. **Relative clauses** (especially with *that* or an omitted relative): *This is the house (that) I live **in**. The man (whom) you spoke **to** is my uncle.* (Formal: *the house **in which** I live; the man **to whom** you spoke*.)
3. **Passive sentences:** *He was laughed **at**. The matter will be looked **into**. The child was taken care **of**.*
4. **Infinitive phrases:** *I need a chair to sit **on**. She has no one to talk **to**. Give me a pen to write **with**.*
5. **Exclamations:** *What a mess you are **in**!*

> The old rule "Never end a sentence with a preposition" is **not** a real rule of English; the end position is natural and often the only correct choice (*What are you afraid of?*). But **don't** add an unnecessary preposition at the end: ✘ *Where are you going **to**?* ✘ *Where is he **at**?* → ✔ *Where are you going?* ✔ *Where is he?*

17.4 Prepositions of Time

17.4.1 *At*, *On*, *In* (Time)

Preposition	Used with	Examples
at	a **point** of time; clock time; festivals; short holiday periods; *night, noon, midnight, dawn, sunrise, sunset*	*at 6 o'clock, at noon, at night, at midnight, at dawn, at sunset, at lunchtime, at Eid, at Christmas, at the weekend (BrE), at present, at the moment, at the age of ten*

Preposition	Used with	Examples
on	**days** and **dates**; a particular part of a particular day	*on Friday, on 26 March, on Independence Day, on my birthday, on Monday morning, on a cold night, on the morning of 16 December*
in	**longer periods**: parts of the day, months, seasons, years, decades, centuries	*in the morning, in the afternoon, in the evening, in May, in summer, in 1971, in the 1990s, in the 21st century, in a week*

- We wake up **at** six **in** the morning.
- He was born **on** 5 June 2000. / He was born **in** June / **in** 2000.
- We met **on** a rainy evening. (*evening* made particular → *on*)
- **At** night (✘ in night) / **in** the night (= during one particular night: *I woke up in the night*).

> **No preposition** before *this, that, next, last, every, each, some, any, one, all, today, tomorrow, yesterday*: *I'll see you **next** Friday.* (✘ on next Friday) *He came **last** year.* (✘ in last year) *We meet **every** day. I'll do it **tomorrow** morning.*

17.4.2 *Since, For, From*

Preposition	Meaning	Example
since	from a **point** of time in the past until now (perfect tenses)	*I have lived here **since** 2010 / **since** Monday / **since** childhood.*
for	a **period** (length) of time	*I have lived here **for** ten years / **for** three days.*
from	the **starting point**, usually with *to/till/until* (any tense)	*The shop is open **from** 9 **to** 5. He worked **from** morning **till** night.*

- ✘ I have been waiting since two hours. ✔ … **for** two hours.
- ✘ He has been ill from Monday. ✔ He has been ill **since** Monday.
- ✘ I am living here since 2015. ✔ I **have been living** here since 2015. (Chapter 21)

17.4.3 *In, Within, After* (Time)

- ***in*** = at the end of a period (future): *I'll be back **in** an hour.* (= after one hour from now)
- ***within*** = before the end of a period: *Finish it **within** an hour.* (= not later than one hour)
- ***after*** = later than (mainly past, or with a definite time): *He returned **after** two days. Come **after** 5 p.m.* (✘ *I'll come after an hour* — prefer *in an hour*)

17.4.4 *By, Till / Until, Before*

- ***by*** = **not later than** (a deadline; the action happens once, at or before that time): *Submit the form **by** Friday. I'll be home **by** 10.*
- ***till / until*** = **up to** that time (the action continues): *Wait here **till** I return. The shop stays open **until** 9 p.m.* (✘ Wait here by 5)
- ***before*** = earlier than: *Come **before** sunset.*

17.4.5 *During, For, While*

- ***during*** + noun = **when** something happens (within a period): ***During** the war, many people died. He slept **during** the lecture.*
- ***for*** + period = **how long**: *He slept **for** two hours.*
- ***while*** is a **conjunction** + clause: ***While** I was reading, the light went out.* (✘ during I was reading)

17.4.6 *On time / In time; At the end / In the end*

- ***on time*** = punctually, at the planned time: *The train arrived **on time**.*
- ***in time*** = early enough (before the last moment): *We reached the station **in time** to catch the train.*
- ***at the end (of)*** = at the final point: ***at the end of** the month / **at the end of** the film.*
- ***in the end*** = finally, after a long time or many difficulties: ***In the end**, he agreed.*
- ***at last*** = finally (after impatience); ***at least*** = not less than.

17.5 Prepositions of Place and Position

17.5.1 *At, On, In* (Place)

Preposition	Used for	Examples
at	a **point**, a specific location; addresses with numbers; events; small towns and villages (traditional rule)	*at the door, at the bus stop, at the station, at the corner, at home, at school, at work, at the meeting, at a party, at 25 Green Road, at Savar*
on	a **surface**; a line (street, river, coast); public transport; floors; pages; electronic media	*on the table, on the wall, on the floor, on the road, on the bank of the Padma, on the coast, on the bus/train/plane/ship, on a bicycle, on the second floor, on page 10, on TV, on the radio, on the Internet, on the left/right*
in	an **enclosed space** or an **area**; big cities, countries, continents; cars and taxis; water, sky; books and newspapers	*in the room, in the box, in the garden, in Dhaka, in Bangladesh, in Asia, in a car, in a taxi, in the sea, in the sky, in the newspaper, in bed, in hospital, in prison, in the picture, in a queue, in a row*

- He lives **at** Mohammadpur **in** Dhaka. (small locality → *at*; large city → *in*)
- She is **at** school. (as a student) / She is **in** the school building.
- The picture is **on** the wall. / The nail is **in** the wall.
- He is **in** the car. / He is **on** the bus. (✘ in the bus — common in Bangladesh, but standard English says *on the bus*)
- Sit **at** the table (for a meal/work) / Put it **on** the table.
- I read it **in** the newspaper (✘ on the newspaper) / I saw it **on** the Internet.

17.5.2 Other Prepositions of Place

Preposition	Meaning	Example
above	higher than (not directly, no contact)	*The plane flew **above** the clouds. His rank is **above** mine.*
over	directly above / covering / across	*He held an umbrella **over** her head. Spread a sheet **over** the bed. a bridge **over** the river*
below	lower than (not directly)	*The temperature is **below** zero. Write your name **below** the line.*
under	directly beneath / covered by / less than	*The cat is **under** the table. children **under** five*

Preposition	Meaning	Example
beneath	under (formal, literary)	***beneath*** *the surface;* ***beneath*** *his dignity*
underneath	directly under, hidden	*a note* ***underneath*** *the door*
beside	by the side of, next to	*Sit* ***beside*** *me.*
besides	in addition to	***Besides*** *English, he speaks French.*
between	two persons/things (or more, considered individually)	*Divide it* ***between*** *you and me. a treaty* ***between*** *three nations*
among	more than two, as a group	*Divide the sweets* ***among*** *the children.*
behind	at the back of	*The garden is* ***behind*** *the house.*
in front of	facing, ahead of	*There is a tree* ***in front of*** *our house.*
opposite	facing, on the other side	*The bank is* ***opposite*** *the post office.*
near / near to / close to / next to / by	at a short distance	*The school is* ***near*** *our house. Sit* ***by*** *me.*
against	touching and pressing; in opposition	*He leaned* ***against*** *the wall. We fought* ***against*** *injustice.*
amid / amidst	in the middle of (formal)	***amid*** *cheers;* ***amid*** *the confusion*
around / round	surrounding, in a circle	*They sat* ***around*** *the fire. The earth moves* ***round*** *the sun.*
beyond	farther than, outside the limits of	*a village* ***beyond*** *the hills;* ***beyond*** *my control*
within	inside the limits of	***within*** *the city;* ***within*** *reach*
throughout	in every part of	***throughout*** *the country / the year*

17.6 Prepositions of Direction and Movement

Pair / Preposition	Difference	Examples
in / into	*in* = position (no movement); *into* = movement from outside to inside	*He is* ***in*** *the room. / He went* ***into*** *the room.* (*jump into the river, fall into the trap*)
on / onto	*on* = position; *onto* = movement to a surface	*The cat is* ***on*** *the roof. / The cat jumped* ***onto*** *the roof.*
to / towards	*to* = destination reached; *towards* = in the direction of	*He went* ***to*** *Chattogram. / He walked* ***towards*** *the river.*
at / to	*at* = target, often aggressive; *to* = recipient	*He threw a stone* ***at*** *the dog* (to hit it) / *He threw the ball* ***to*** *me* (for me to catch). *Shout* ***at*** *someone* (anger) / *shout* ***to*** *someone* (to be heard).
across	from one side to the other (surface)	*He swam* ***across*** *the river. a bridge* ***across*** *the Jamuna*
through	from one end to the other (inside something)	*The train passed* ***through*** *a tunnel. walk* ***through*** *the forest*
along	following the length of	*We walked* ***along*** *the river bank.*
up / down	to a higher / lower place	*He climbed* ***up*** *the tree. She ran* ***down*** *the stairs.*
out of	from inside to outside	*He came* ***out of*** *the room.*
off	away from a surface/position	*He fell* ***off*** *the horse. Keep* ***off*** *the grass.*
from	starting point	*He came* ***from*** *Rajshahi.*
past	going by	*He walked* ***past*** *my house.*

17.7 Prepositions of Means, Cause, Agent and Manner

17.7.1 *By* and *With*

- ***by*** = the **agent** (doer) in the passive, and the **means** of transport/communication: *The book was written* ***by*** *Tagore. He came* ***by*** *train. I sent it* ***by*** *post /* ***by*** *email.*
- ***with*** = the **instrument** (tool) used by an agent: *He killed the snake* ***with*** *a stick. She writes* ***with*** *a pen.*

› The letter was written **by** Rahim **with** a pen.
› He was killed **with** a knife **by** a robber.
› The glass was broken **by** the ball. (the ball as a cause/agent — no human holding it)

17.7.2 Transport: *By*, *On*, *In*

- ***by*** + means (no article): *by bus, by train, by car, by plane, by air, by sea, by rickshaw, by bicycle.*
- ***on*** + specific public transport / riding: *on the bus, on the 8 o'clock train, on a ship, on a bicycle, on horseback*; ***on foot*** (✘ by foot).
- ***in*** + private vehicle: *in my car, in a taxi, in a CNG.*

17.7.3 Cause: *Of*, *From*, *For*, *With*, *Through*

› He died **of** cholera / **of** cancer / **of** hunger. (illness, direct cause)
› He died **from** a wound / **from** overwork / **from** an accident. (external or indirect cause)
› He was punished **for** stealing. (reason)
› She was trembling **with** fear / shivering **with** cold / mad **with** anger. (emotion or physical state)
› He failed **through** negligence.

17.7.4 Material: *Made of / Made from / Made out of / Made with / Made into*

- ***made of*** — the material is still recognisable: *This table is* ***made of*** *wood.*
- ***made from*** — the material is changed in the process: *Paper is* ***made from*** *wood. Wine is* ***made from*** *grapes.*
- ***made out of*** — something unusual or re-used: *a lamp* ***made out of*** *a bottle.*
- ***made with*** — ingredients: *a cake* ***made with*** *eggs and flour.*
- ***made into*** — the product: *Wood is* ***made into*** *paper.*

17.8 Some Important Distinctions

Pair	Rule	Examples
between / among	two (or more seen individually) / more than two as a group	*between the two brothers; among the five brothers*
beside / besides	next to / in addition to	*He sat* ***beside*** *me.* ***Besides*** *money, he wants fame.*

Pair	Rule	Examples
except / besides	excluding / including also	*All came **except** Rahim (he did not come). **Besides** Rahim, three others came (he also came).*
but (= except)	after negatives and *all, every-, any-, no-*	*Nobody **but** him knew the answer. All **but** one passed.*
like / as	*like* + noun (similarity); *as* + noun (role, function)	*He worked **like** a slave* (but he was not a slave). *He worked **as** a clerk* (he was a clerk).
due to / owing to / because of	*due to* = adjective (after *be*); *owing to / because of* = adverbial (beginning or after a verb)	*His absence was **due to** illness.* / ***Owing to** illness, he was absent.* (✘ Due to illness, he was absent — traditional rule)
of / off	possession, part / away from	*a cup **of** tea* / *Get **off** the bus.*
in / at (arrival)	*arrive in* (city, country) / *arrive at* (building, small place)	*We arrived **in** Dhaka **at** the airport.* (✘ arrived to)
above / over	higher (no contact) / directly over, covering	*above sea level; a blanket over the bed*
under / below	directly beneath / lower level	*under the bed; below the knee; below average*
across / through	surface / inside a space	*across the road; through the jungle*
since / for / from	point / period / starting point	See 17.4.2
by / until	deadline / continuing	See 17.4.4
in / within	end of period / before the end	See 17.4.3

17.9 Verbs That Do Not Take a Preposition

Many Bangladeshi learners add a preposition after transitive verbs that take a **direct object**. In the following, **no preposition** is used:

✘ Wrong	✔ Right
discuss about the matter	**discuss** the matter
enter into the room	**enter** the room (*enter into* an agreement ✔)
reach at the station	**reach** the station (*arrive at* ✔)
resemble with his father	**resemble** his father
attack on the enemy	**attack** the enemy (*make an attack on* ✔)
marry with her	**marry** her (*get married to* her ✔)
approach to the manager	**approach** the manager
accompany with me	**accompany** me
comprise of five parts	**comprise** five parts (*consist of / be composed of* ✔)
emphasise on the point	**emphasise** the point (*lay emphasis on* ✔)
stress on	**stress** the point
request for help	**request** help (*make a request for* ✔)
order for books	**order** books (*place an order for* ✔)
answer to the question	**answer** the question (*the answer to* ✔)
obey to the rules	**obey** the rules
join with the party	**join** the party
lack in courage	**lack** courage (*be lacking in* courage ✔)
investigate into the case	**investigate** the case (*inquire into* ✔)
return back	**return**
describe about	**describe**
demand for	**demand** (*a demand for* ✔)
mention about	**mention**
order him to	✔ correct
tell to him	**tell** him
affect on	**affect** (*have an effect on* ✔)

> **Exam Tip — Noun takes the preposition, verb does not:** *discuss* (v) but *a discussion **about/on*** (n); *attack* (v) but *an attack **on***; *request* (v) but *a request **for***; *emphasise* (v) but *emphasis **on***; *answer* (v) but *the answer **to***; *demand* (v) but *a demand **for***; *reply* (v) **to** and *a reply **to*** (both take *to*).

17.10 Words That Can Be Prepositions, Adverbs or Conjunctions

A preposition **must have an object**. If the same word has no object, it is an **adverb**; if it introduces a clause, it is a **conjunction** (Chapter 01.4.3).

- He stood **before** the gate. (preposition)
- I have seen him **before**. (adverb)
- Come **before** it gets dark. (conjunction)
- The ball rolled **down** the hill. (preposition) / Sit **down**. (adverb)
- He has been ill **since** Monday. (preposition) / **Since** you insist, I'll go. (conjunction)

17.11 Common Errors with Prepositions

1. ✘ He was born in 16 December. ✔ He was born **on** 16 December.
2. ✘ I will meet you on next Monday. ✔ I will meet you **next Monday**.
3. ✘ He has been absent from Sunday. ✔ He has been absent **since** Sunday.
4. ✘ I have been waiting since an hour. ✔ … **for** an hour.
5. ✘ We discussed about the problem. ✔ We **discussed** the problem.
6. ✘ He entered into the room. ✔ He **entered** the room.
7. ✘ She resembles with her mother. ✔ She **resembles** her mother.
8. ✘ He reached at Dhaka. ✔ He **reached** Dhaka / **arrived in** Dhaka.
9. ✘ Divide the mangoes between the four boys. ✔ … **among** the four boys.
10. ✘ He died from cholera. ✔ He died **of** cholera.
11. ✘ He is angry upon me. ✔ He is angry **with** me. (*angry at* a thing)
12. ✘ He killed the bird by a stone. ✔ He killed the bird **with** a stone.
13. ✘ He came by foot. ✔ He came **on** foot.
14. ✘ He jumped in the river. (movement) ✔ He jumped **into** the river.
15. ✘ The table is made from wood. ✔ The table is made **of** wood.
16. ✘ Besides Rahim, no one came. ✔ **Except** Rahim / **But** Rahim, no one came.
17. ✘ He sat besides me. ✔ He sat **beside** me.
18. ✘ Due to rain, the match was cancelled. (traditional) ✔ **Owing to** rain, … / The cancellation was **due to** rain.
19. ✘ Wait here by I return. ✔ Wait here **till/until** I return.
20. ✘ Finish it till Friday. ✔ Finish it **by** Friday.
21. ✘ He works like a manager in this company. (if he is the manager) ✔ He works **as** a manager.

22. ✘ I prefer tea than coffee. ✔ I prefer tea **to** coffee.
23. ✘ He is married with a doctor. ✔ He is married **to** a doctor.
24. ✘ Where are you going to? ✔ Where are you going?
25. ✘ She is good in English. ✔ She is good **at** English.
26. ✘ I am senior than him. ✔ I am senior **to** him.
27. ✘ He comprises of good qualities. ✔ He **has** many good qualities. / The book **comprises** ten chapters.
28. ✘ I congratulate you for your success. ✔ I congratulate you **on** your success.
29. ✘ He insisted to go. ✔ He insisted **on going**.
30. ✘ We arrived to Dhaka at night. ✔ We arrived **in** Dhaka at night.

17.12 Prepositions in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Prepositions are the backbone of **idioms**, a major category in GMAT Sentence Correction and SAT Writing. Some high-frequency idioms (more in Chapter 18):

- *differ **from*** (be unlike) / *differ **with*** (disagree with a person)
- *distinguish **between** X **and** Y* / *distinguish X **from** Y*
- *a debate / dispute **over*** (a topic); *a debate **between** X **and** Y*
- *responsible **for***; *contribute **to***; *consist **of***; *derive **from***; *depend **on***
- *the effect **of** X **on** Y*; *an impact **on***; *an increase **in*** (amount) vs *an increase **of*** (size: *an increase of 10%*)
- *in contrast **to/with***; *as opposed **to***; *compared **with/to***
- *regard X **as** Y*; *view X **as** Y*; *think of X **as** Y*
- *between X **and** Y* (✘ between X **to** Y); *from X **to** Y* (✘ from X **and** Y)
- ***Between** + **two objects joined by** **and***: ✘ *between each house* ✔ *between **the houses*** / *between **each house and the next***.

CHAPTER 18

Appropriate Preposition

Part A · Grammar

18.1 Why “Appropriate Prepositions” Matter

Certain **verbs, nouns, adjectives and participles** are always followed by a **particular preposition**. There is often no logical reason for the choice — it is a matter of **usage (idiom)**. *We are **fond of** music* but *interested **in** music* and *keen **on** music*; we *depend **on*** someone but are *independent **of*** them. Such combinations must be **learnt by heart**.

“Use appropriate prepositions” is a standard question in BCS Preliminary and Written, Bank recruitment tests, university admission tests and HSC/SSC examinations, and in GMAT Sentence Correction it appears as **idiom** questions. This chapter gives:

1. words that take **different prepositions with different meanings** (the most tested items);
2. an **alphabetical master list** of words and their appropriate prepositions with examples;
3. common **prepositional phrases** (*at random, by heart, in vain* …).

How to learn this chapter: (1) Read each entry aloud with its example — the ear remembers phrases better than rules. (2) Notice families: words of **feeling towards a person** often take ***with*** (*angry with, pleased with, disgusted with*) while the **thing** takes ***at*** or ***about*** (*angry at/about the delay*). (3) Notice that **related words share prepositions**: *depend on – dependent on – dependence on*; but *independent **of*** is the opposite. (4) After any preposition, a verb must be in the **-ing** form: *insist **on going**, fond **of reading***.

18.2 Same Word, Different Prepositions, Different Meanings

Word	Preposition and meaning	Example
Agree	*with* a person / an opinion	*I agree **with** you.*
	to a proposal / plan / suggestion	*He agreed **to** my proposal.*
	on / about a point / matter	*They agreed **on** the date.*
Angry	*with* a person	*Father was angry **with** me.*
	at / about a thing or action	*He was angry **at** the delay / **about** the result.*
Annoyed	*with* a person; *at / about* a thing	*annoyed **with** him; annoyed **at** his remarks*
Anxious	*about / for* = worried	*anxious **about** her health; anxious **for** his safety*
	for = eager to have	*anxious **for** success*
	to + verb = eager	*anxious **to** succeed*
Apply	*to* a person / authority	*Apply **to** the Principal.*
	for a thing (job, leave)	*He applied **for** the post.*
Answer	*to* a person (be answerable)	*You will answer **to** me for this.*
	for an action	*He must answer **for** his crime.*
Attend	(no prep.) = be present at	*He attended the meeting.*
	to = pay attention to / deal with	*Attend **to** your studies. The doctor attended **to** the patient.*
	on / upon = serve	*The nurse attended **on** the patient.*
Call	*on* a person = visit	*I called **on** my uncle.*
	at a place = visit	*I called **at** his house.*
	for = demand / need	*The situation calls **for** action.*
	off = cancel	*The strike was called **off**.*
Compare	*to* = liken (show similarity)	*Life is compared **to** a journey.*
	with = examine differences	*Compare your answer **with** mine.*
Compensate	*for* a loss; *by* means	*He was compensated **for** the loss.*
Concerned	*about / for* = worried	*concerned **about** the future*
	with / in = involved in, about	*The book is concerned **with** history. All those concerned **in** the crime …*
Consist	*of* = be made up of	*The book consists **of** ten chapters.*
	in = have as its essence	*Happiness consists **in** contentment.*
Correspond	*with* a person = exchange letters	*I correspond **with** my pen friend.*
	to / with a thing = match	*His words do not correspond **to** his actions.*
Deal	*in* = trade in	*He deals **in** jute.*
	with = handle / treat / be about	*Deal **with** the problem. This book deals **with** grammar.*
Die	*of* a disease	*He died **of** malaria.*
	from a cause / wound	*He died **from** overwork / a wound.*
	by violence / weapon	*He died **by** the sword / **by** his own hand.*
	for a cause / country	*Our martyrs died **for** the mother tongue.*
	in an accident / battle	*He died **in** a road accident.*
	through neglect	*The plant died **through** neglect.*
Differ	*from* = be unlike	*My views differ **from** yours.*
	with a person = disagree	*I differ **with** you on this point.*

Word	Preposition and meaning	Example
Disappointed	*in / with* a person	*I am disappointed **in** you.*
	at / about / with a thing	*disappointed **at** the result*
	of = not getting	*disappointed **of** his hopes*
Entrust	*a person with a thing / a thing to a person*	*I entrusted him **with** the money. I entrusted the money **to** him.*
Fight	*with / against* an enemy	*They fought **with** / **against** the enemy.*
	for a cause	*We fought **for** freedom.*
Glad	*of* a thing (= grateful for)	*I would be glad **of** your help.*
	about / at news, event	*glad **about** the news*
Grateful	*to* a person	*I am grateful **to** you.*
	for a favour / thing	*I am grateful to you **for** your help.*
Indebted	*to* a person; *for* a favour	*I am indebted **to** him **for** my success.*
Interfere	*with* = hinder / meddle with a thing or person	*Don't interfere **with** my work.*
	in = intervene in affairs	*Don't interfere **in** others' affairs.*
Live	*on* food / money	*Cows live **on** grass. He lives **on** his salary.*
	by a means / work	*He lives **by** fishing.*
	for an aim	*He lives **for** his children.*
	within means	*Live **within** your means.*
Look	*at* = see, observe	*Look **at** the board.*
	for = search	*I am looking **for** my pen.*
	after = take care of	*She looks **after** her old parents.*
	into = investigate	*The police will look **into** the matter.*
	forward to = anticipate with pleasure	*I look forward **to** meeting you.*
	down on / up to = despise / respect	*Don't look down **on** the poor. We look up **to** our teachers.*
Part	*from* a person	*He parted **from** his friends.*
	with a thing	*He would not part **with** his money.*
Responsible	*to* a person / authority	*The minister is responsible **to** Parliament.*
	for a thing / action	*He is responsible **for** the loss.*
Smile	*at* = look with a smile	*She smiled **at** the baby.*
	on / upon = favour	*Fortune smiled **on** him.*
Suffer	*from* an illness / problem	*He suffers **from** asthma.*
	for one's actions	*He suffered **for** his sins.*
Tired	*of* = bored with	*I am tired **of** waiting.*
	from / with = exhausted by	*tired **from** the long walk*
Warn	*of / about* a danger	*He warned me **of** the danger.*
	against doing something	*He warned me **against** going there.*
Wait	*for* a person / thing	*Wait **for** me.*
	on / upon = serve	*The waiter waited **on** us.*

18.3 The Master List: A – L

Key: each entry gives the word, its appropriate preposition and a model sentence. Learn the sentence, not just the pair.

A

Abide by (obey) — *Every citizen must abide **by** the law.*

Abound in / with — *The rivers of Bangladesh abound **in** fish. The forest abounds **with** wild animals.*

Absent from — *He was absent **from** the class.*

Absorbed in — *She was absorbed **in** her studies.*

Abstain from — *Muslims abstain **from** food during fasting.*

Accede to (agree to) — *The authority acceded **to** the students' demands.*

Access to — *Every child should have access **to** education.*

Accompanied by (a person) / **with** (a thing) — *He was accompanied **by** his wife. The rain was accompanied **with** thunder.*

Accomplished in — *She is accomplished **in** music.*

Accord with (agree) — *His words do not accord **with** his actions.*

According to — *According **to** the weather report, it will rain.*

Account for (explain) — *He could not account **for** the missing money.*

Accountable to a person, **for** a thing — *A government is accountable **to** the people **for** its actions.*

Accuse of — *He was accused **of** theft.* (✘ accused for)

Accustomed to — *I am accustomed **to** getting up early.*

Acquaint with — *Acquaint yourself **with** the rules. / I am acquainted **with** him.*

Acquit of — *The court acquitted him **of** the charge.*

Adapt to — *We must adapt **to** new conditions.*

Add to — *This adds **to** our difficulties.*

Addicted to — *He is addicted **to** drugs / gambling.*

Adequate for / to — *The supply is adequate **for** our needs.*

Adhere to — *Adhere **to** your principles.*

Adjacent to — *The school is adjacent **to** the mosque.*

Admit to / into (a place, institution); **admit of** (allow) — *He was admitted **to / into** the hospital. The matter admits **of** no delay.*

Advantage over / of — *He has an advantage **over** me. Take advantage **of** the opportunity.*

Afflicted with — *He is afflicted **with** gout.*

Afraid of — *She is afraid **of** dogs.*

Agree with / to / on — see 18.2.

Aim at — *He aimed **at** the target.*

Alarmed at — *We were alarmed **at** the news.*

Alien to (foreign to, contrary to) — *Cruelty is alien **to** his nature.*

Alight from — *He alighted **from** the bus.*

Allot to — *A room was allotted **to** each student.*

Allude to (refer indirectly) — *He alluded **to** his past mistakes.*

Aloof from — *He keeps aloof **from** politics.*

Amazed at — *I was amazed **at** his courage.*

Ambitious of / for — *He is ambitious **of** fame / **for** power.*

Amenable to (willing to accept) — *He is amenable **to** reason.*

Amused at / by / with — *We were amused **at** his jokes.*

Angry with / at — see 18.2.

Answer to / for — see 18.2.

Antidote to / for / against — *Laughter is an antidote **to** stress.*

Antipathy to / towards / against — *He has an antipathy **to** cats.*

Anxious about / for / to — see 18.2.

Apologise to a person, **for** a fault — *He apologised **to** the teacher **for** his rudeness.*

Appeal to a person, **for** a thing — *He appealed **to** the public **for** help.*

Appetite for — *He has a good appetite **for** books.*

Applicable to — *This rule is applicable **to** all.*

Apply to / for — see 18.2.

Appoint to a post — *He was appointed **to** the post of manager.*

Approve of — *My father does not approve **of** my plan.*

Apt at (clever) / **to** (likely) — *He is apt **at** learning languages. Children are apt **to** be careless.*

Arrive at (a small place) / **in** (a city, country) — *We arrived **at** the station. We arrived **in** Dhaka.* (✘ arrived to)

Ashamed of — *He is ashamed **of** his conduct.*

Aspire to / after — *He aspires **to** the position of chairman.*

Assent to — *The President gave his assent **to** the bill.*

Assist in — *He assisted me **in** my work.*

Associate with — *Do not associate **with** bad boys.*

Assure of — *I assure you **of** my support.*

Astonished at — *I was astonished **at** his rudeness.*

Atone for — *He atoned **for** his sins.*

Attached to — *He is deeply attached **to** his mother.*

Attack on (noun) — *The enemy made an attack **on** the town.* (but *attack* (verb) the town)

Attend to / on — see 18.2.

Attentive to — *Be attentive **to** your studies.*

Attribute to — *He attributed his success **to** hard work.*

Available to a person, **for** a purpose — *The book is available **to** all students.*

Averse to (opposed to) — *He is averse **to** hard work.*

Avail oneself of — *Avail yourself **of** this opportunity.*

Aware of — *Are you aware **of** the danger?*

B

Backed by / up by — *The plan was backed **by** the government.*

Bad at — *He is bad **at** mathematics.*

Ban on — *There is a ban **on** smoking in public places.*

Bank on (rely on) — *Don't bank **on** his help.*

Bare of — *The trees were bare **of** leaves.*

Bargain with a person, **for** a thing — *He bargained **with** the shopkeeper **for** a lower price.*

Base on — *The film is based **on** a true story.*

Bear with (be patient with) — *Please bear **with** me for a moment.*

Beg of a person, **for** a thing — *I beg **of** you to forgive him. He begged **for** mercy.*

Begin with / at — *Let us begin **with** a prayer. Begin **at** page five.*

Believe in (trust, have faith) — *I believe **in** God / in democracy.*

Belong to — *This book belongs **to** me.*

Beneficial to — *Exercise is beneficial **to** health.*

Bent on (determined) — *He is bent **on** mischief / on going abroad.*

Bereft of (deprived of) — *He was bereft **of** all hope.*

Beset with / by — *The plan was beset **with** difficulties.*

Beware of — *Beware **of** pickpockets.*

Biased against / towards / in favour of — *The judge was biased **against** the accused.*

Blame for (a fault) / **on** (a person) — *He blamed me **for** the accident. He blamed the accident **on** me.*

Blessed with — *She is blessed **with** good health.*

Blind to (unaware) / **in** (one eye) — *He is blind **to** his son's faults. He is blind **in** one eye.*

Blush at / with — *She blushed **at** the compliment / **with** shame.*

Boast of / about — *He boasts **of** his wealth.*

Born of (parents) / **in** (place, year) / **on** (date) — *He was born **of** poor parents **in** Barishal **on** 2 March 1990.*

Borrow from — *He borrowed money **from** a friend.*

Bound for (heading for) / **to** (obliged) — *The ship is bound **for** Chattogram. You are bound **to** obey.*

Brood over / on — *Do not brood **over** your failure.*

Burst into (tears, laughter) / **out** — *She burst **into** tears.*

Busy with / in / at (+ noun) / **busy** + -ing — *He is busy **with** his work. She is busy cooking.*

C

Callous to / towards — *He is callous **to** the suffering of others.*

Capable of — *He is capable **of** doing the job.* (✘ capable to do)

Capacity for — *He has a great capacity **for** work.*

Care for (like, look after) / **about** (be concerned) — *She cares **for** her sick mother. I don't care **about** money.*

Careful of / about / with — *Be careful **of** your health. Be careful **with** the glasses.*

Careless of / about — *He is careless **about** his dress.*

Cater for / to (provide for) — *This shop caters **for** children.*

Caution against — *I cautioned him **against** smoking.*

Certain of / about — *I am certain **of** his success.*

Charge with (a crime) / **for** (a price) — *He was charged **with** murder. They charged me 500 taka **for** the repair.*

Charitable to / towards — *Be charitable **to** the poor.*

Cheat of / out of — *They cheated him **of / out of** his property.*

Clear of (free from) — *He is clear **of** all debts.*

Cling to — *The child clung **to** its mother.*

Close to — *Our house is close **to** the school.*

Coincide with — *His holiday coincided **with** mine.*

Collide with — *The bus collided **with** a truck.*

Comment on / upon — *He commented **on** my essay.*

Commit to (prison, memory) — *He was committed **to** prison. Commit this poem **to** memory.*

Committed to + -ing — *We are committed **to** improving education.*

Common to — *These features are common **to** all mammals.*

Communicate with a person, **to** (a thing to a person) — *I communicated the news **to** him.*

Compare to / with — see 18.2.

Compatible with — *His views are not compatible **with** mine.*

Compensate for — *Nothing can compensate **for** the loss of a mother.*

Compete with / against a person, **for** a thing — *Ten students competed **for** the prize.*

Competent for / in / at / to — *He is competent **for** the post.*

Complain to a person, **of / about** a thing — *He complained **to** the police **about** the noise. She complained **of** a headache.*

Complement to (makes complete) / **compliment on** (praise) — *Wine is a complement **to** food. He complimented me **on** my success.*

Comply with — *You must comply **with** the rules.*

Composed of — *Water is composed **of** hydrogen and oxygen.*

Conceal from — *He concealed the fact **from** me.*

Conceited about / of — *He is conceited **about** his looks.*

Concentrate on — *Concentrate **on** your studies.*

Concerned about / with / in — see 18.2.

Condemn to (a punishment) / **for** (an act) — *He was condemned **to** death **for** murder.*

Condole with a person **on** a loss — *I condoled **with** him **on** the death of his father.*

Conducive to — *Fresh air is conducive **to** good health.*

Confer on / upon (give) / **with** (discuss) — *A degree was conferred **on** him. I conferred **with** my lawyer.*

Confess to — *He confessed **to** the crime / **to** stealing.*

Confide in (trust) / **to** (tell a secret to) — *You can confide **in** me. He confided his secret **to** me.*

Confident of — *I am confident **of** success.*

Confined to — *He is confined **to** bed with fever.*

Conform to — *We must conform **to** the rules.*

Congenial to — *The climate is congenial **to** health.*

Congratulate on — *I congratulate you **on** your success.* (✘ for)

Connive at (ignore wrongdoing) — *The police connived **at** the crime.*

Conscious of — *He is conscious **of** his weakness.*

Consent to — *He consented **to** the proposal.*

Consist of / in — see 18.2.

Consistent with — *His actions are consistent **with** his words.*

Contemporary with (of the same time) — *Shakespeare was contemporary **with** Ben Jonson.*

Content with — *Be content **with** what you have.*

Contrary to — *Contrary **to** expectations, he passed.*

Contribute to — *Everyone contributed **to** the fund.*

Convenient to / for — *Is Monday convenient **for** you?*

Conversant with (familiar with) — *He is conversant **with** computers.*

Convict of — *He was convicted **of** theft.*

Convince of — *I convinced him **of** my honesty.*

Cope with — *She could not cope **with** the pressure.*

Correspond with / to — see 18.2.

Covetous of — *He is covetous **of** wealth.*

Crave for — *Children crave **for** affection.*

Credit with (an achievement) — *Newton is credited **with** discovering gravity.*

Cure of (a disease) — *The medicine cured him **of** fever.*

Curious about — *Children are curious **about** everything.*

D

Deal in / with — see 18.2.

Debar from — *He was debarred **from** the examination.*

Decide on / upon (choose) / **against** — *We decided **on** a new plan.*

Dedicated to — *He dedicated his life **to** the service of the poor.*

Defend against / from — *They defended the town **against** the enemy.*

Deficient in — *The food is deficient **in** vitamins.*

Delight in — *He delights **in** helping others.*

Deprive of — *He was deprived **of** his rights.*

Derive from — *Many English words are derived **from** Latin.*

Descended from — *He is descended **from** a noble family.*

Deserving of — *He is deserving **of** praise.*

Desirous of — *He is desirous **of** fame.*

Despair of — *Do not despair **of** success.*

Destined for / to — *He was destined **for** greatness.*

Detrimental to — *Smoking is detrimental **to** health.*

Deviate from — *Never deviate **from** the path of truth.*

Devoid of — *He is devoid **of** common sense.*

Devote to — *She devoted her life **to** teaching.*

Die of / from / by / for / in — see 18.2.

Differ from / with — see 18.2.

Different from — *My book is different **from** yours.*

Disagree with — *I disagree **with** you.*

Disappointed in / at / with — see 18.2.

Discontented with — *He is discontented **with** his job.*

Disgusted with / at — *I am disgusted **with** his behaviour.*

Dispense with (do without) — *We cannot dispense **with** his services.*

Dispose of (get rid of) — *He disposed **of** his old car.*

Distinguish between / from — *Distinguish **between** right and wrong. Distinguish right **from** wrong.*

Distrust of — *He has a distrust **of** strangers.*

Divert from — *He diverted the river **from** its course.*

Divide into / among / between — *Divide the cake **into** four parts. Divide it **among** the boys.*

Dote on / upon (love too much) — *She dotes **on** her only son.*

Doubtful of / about — *I am doubtful **of** his honesty.*

Dwell on / upon (speak or think at length) / **in** (live) — *Don't dwell **on** the past. They dwell **in** the forest.*

E

Eager for (a thing) / **to** (do) — *He is eager **for** knowledge / eager **to** learn.*

Eligible for — *He is eligible **for** the post.*

Embark on / upon — *He embarked **on** a new career.*

Emerge from — *The sun emerged **from** behind the clouds.*

Encroach on / upon — *Do not encroach **on** others' rights.*

Endowed with — *She is endowed **with** great talent.*

Engaged in (busy) / **to** (betrothed) / **with** (occupied) — *He is engaged **in** research. She is engaged **to** a doctor.*

Enter into (an agreement, discussion) — *They entered **into** an agreement.* (but *enter the room*)

Entitled to — *Every citizen is entitled **to** vote.*

Entrust with / to — see 18.2.

Envious of — *He is envious **of** my success.*

Equal to — *He is not equal **to** the task.*

Equivalent to — *A dollar is equivalent **to** about 120 taka.*

Escape from — *The prisoner escaped **from** jail.*

Essential to / for — *Water is essential **to** life.*

Exception to — *There is an exception **to** every rule.*

Excuse for — *There is no excuse **for** your rudeness.*

Exempt from — *He was exempted **from** paying tax.*

Expert in / at — *He is an expert **in** economics.*

Exposed to — *The house is exposed **to** the wind.*

F

Fail in (a subject, an effort) — *He failed **in** English.* (*fail an exam* is also correct)

Faith in — *I have faith **in** you.*

Faithful to — *A dog is faithful **to** its master.*

Familiar to (a person) / **with** (a thing) — *This song is familiar **to** me. I am familiar **with** this song.*

Famous for — *Sylhet is famous **for** tea.*

Fatal to — *The disease proved fatal **to** him.*

Fed up with — *I am fed up **with** his excuses.*

Feel for (sympathise) — *I feel **for** the flood victims.*

Fight with / against / for — see 18.2.

Fit for — *He is not fit **for** the job.*

Fond of — *She is fond **of** music.*

Foreign to — *Lying is foreign **to** his nature.*

Free from (troubles) / **of** (charge, cost) — *free **from** anxiety; free **of** cost*

Friendly with / to — *He is friendly **with** everybody.*

Frightened of / at / by — *The child was frightened **of** the dog.*

Full of — *The glass is full **of** water.*

G

Generous to / towards — *He is generous **to** the poor.*

Gifted with — *She is gifted **with** a sweet voice.*

Glad of / about / at — see 18.2.

Good at (skill) / **for** (benefit) / **to** (kind) — *He is good **at** maths. Milk is good **for** health. Be good **to** your parents.*

Grateful to / for — see 18.2.

Grieve at / over / for — *She grieved **over** her son's death.*

Guard against — *Guard **against** bad habits.*

Guilty of — *He was found guilty **of** murder.*

H

Habituated to — *He is habituated **to** hard work.*

Hanker after / for (crave) — *He hankers **after** wealth.*

Harmful to — *Smoking is harmful **to** health.*

Hatred for / of — *He has a hatred **for** injustice.*

Heir to — *He is heir **to** a large fortune.*

Hinder from — *The rain hindered us **from** going out.*

Hope for — *We hope **for** the best.*

Hostile to — *He is hostile **to** new ideas.*

Hungry for — *The child is hungry **for** love.*

I

Identical with / to — *His signature is identical **with** mine.*

Ignorant of — *He is ignorant **of** the rules.*

Ill with (an illness) — *He is ill **with** fever.*

Immune to / from — *He is immune **to** malaria.*

Impatient of (intolerant) / **with** (a person) / **for** (eager) — *impatient **of** delay; impatient **with** children*

Important to / for — *Exercise is important **for** health.*

Impose on / upon — *Tax was imposed **on** luxury goods.*

Indebted to / for — see 18.2.

Independent of — *He is independent **of** his parents.* (✘ independent from — traditional)

Indifferent to — *He is indifferent **to** praise or blame.*

Indispensable to / for — *Water is indispensable **to** life.*

Indulge in — *Do not indulge **in** bad habits.*

Infected with — *He was infected **with** cholera.*

Inferior to — *This cloth is inferior **to** that.* (Chapter 10)

Inform of / about — *Inform me **of** your arrival.*

Inherit from — *He inherited the house **from** his father.*

Injurious to — *Smoking is injurious **to** health.*

Inquire of (a person) / **about** (a thing) / **into** (investigate) / **after** (health) — *He inquired **of** me **about** the train. The police inquired **into** the case. He inquired **after** my health.*

Insist on / upon — *He insisted **on** going.*

Intent on / upon (determined) — *He is intent **on** winning.*

Interested in — *She is interested **in** painting.*

Interfere with / in — see 18.2.

Introduce to — *He introduced me **to** his friend.*

Invest in — *He invested **in** shares.*

Involved in — *He was involved **in** the crime.*

Irrelevant to — *Your question is irrelevant **to** the topic.*

J · K · L

Jealous of — *He is jealous **of** his brother's success.*

Jeer at — *Don't jeer **at** the poor.*

Join in (an activity) / **with** (a person) — *Everybody joined **in** the singing.*

Judge by / from — *Don't judge a man **by** his appearance.*

Junior to — *She is junior **to** me.* (Chapter 10)

Justify in — *You are justified **in** demanding a refund.*

Keen on — *He is keen **on** cricket.*

Kind to — *Be kind **to** animals.*

Knock at / on — *Someone is knocking **at** the door.*

Known to (a person) / **for** (a quality) / **as** (a name) — *He is known **to** everybody. He is known **for** his honesty. Dhaka is known **as** the city of mosques.*

Lack of (noun) — *There is a lack **of** water.* (but *lack* (verb) *water*; *be lacking **in** courage*)

Lame in — *He is lame **in** one leg.*

Laugh at — *Don't laugh **at** others' misfortune.*

Lean against / on — *He leaned **against** the wall.*

Liable to (likely) / **for** (legally responsible) — *He is liable **to** catch cold. You are liable **for** the debt.*

Listen to — *Listen **to** me.*

Live on / by / for / within — see 18.2.

Long for — *He longs **for** home.*

Look at / for / after / into — see 18.2.

Loyal to — *Be loyal **to** your country.*

Lust for — *He has a lust **for** power.*

18.4 The Master List: M – Z

M

Made of / from / into / out of — see Chapter 17.7.4.

Married to — *She is married **to** a doctor.* (✘ married with)

Marvel at — *We marvelled **at** his skill.*

Match for (equal in strength) — *He is no match **for** the champion.*

Meddle with / in — *Don't meddle **in** my affairs.*

Mediate between — *He mediated **between** the two parties.*

Mindful of — *Be mindful **of** your duties.*

Mistake for — *I mistook him **for** his brother.*

Mix with — *Don't mix **with** bad company.*

Mourn for / over — *They mourned **for** the dead.*

N · O

Necessary for / to — *Food is necessary **for** life.*

Need for / of — *There is no need **for** haste. I am in need **of** money.*

Neglectful of — *He is neglectful **of** his duties.*

Negotiate with — *The union negotiated **with** the management.*

Notorious for — *He is notorious **for** his cruelty.*

Obedient to — *Be obedient **to** your parents.*

Object to — *I object **to** your remarks / **to** being treated like this.*

Objection to / against — *I have no objection **to** your plan.*

Obliged to (a person) **for** (a favour) — *I am obliged **to** you **for** your help.*

Oblivious of / to — *He was oblivious **of** the danger.*

Occupied with / in — *He is occupied **with** his work.*

Offend against (a rule) — *He offended **against** the law.*

Opposed to — *I am opposed **to** this plan.*

Opposite to — *His views are opposite **to** mine.*

Overcome by / with — *She was overcome **with** grief.*

P

Parallel to / with — *The road runs parallel **to** the river.*

Part from / with — see 18.2.

Partial to (biased in favour of; fond of) — *The judge was partial **to** the rich. He is partial **to** sweets.*

Participate in — *He participated **in** the debate.*

Patient with a person / **of** (trouble) — *Be patient **with** children.*

Peculiar to — *This custom is peculiar **to** Bangladesh.*

Persist in — *He persisted **in** asking questions.*

Pertain to — *These documents pertain **to** the case.*

Pity for / on — *Have pity **on** the poor. I feel pity **for** him.*

Pleased with (a person or thing) / **at** (an event) — *I am pleased **with** your work.*

Polite to — *Be polite **to** everyone.*

Popular with / among — *He is popular **with** his students.*

Possessed of (having a quality) / **by** / **with** (controlled by) — *He is possessed **of** great wealth. He is possessed **by** a demon.*

Pray to (God) **for** (a thing) — *We pray **to** God **for** peace.*

Precaution against — *Take precautions **against** dengue.*

Prefer to — *I prefer tea **to** coffee.* (Chapter 10)

Prejudice against / in favour of — *He has a prejudice **against** foreigners.*

Prepare for — *Prepare **for** the examination.*

Preside over / at — *The Principal presided **over** the meeting.*

Prevent from — *The rain prevented us **from** going out.*

Prior to — *Prior **to** the meeting, he met the press.*

Proficient in — *She is proficient **in** English.*

Profit by / from — *Profit **by** your mistakes.*

Prohibit from — *Smoking is prohibited **in** public places. He was prohibited **from** entering.*

Prone to — *He is prone **to** anger.*

Proud of — *We are proud **of** our heritage.*

Provide for (a family) / **with** (a thing) — *He provides **for** a large family. They provided us **with** food.*

Punish for — *He was punished **for** stealing.*

Pursuit of — *He went abroad in pursuit **of** knowledge.*

Q · R

Qualified for (a post) / **in** (a subject) — *He is qualified **for** the post.*

Quarrel with a person, **about / over** a thing — *He quarrelled **with** his brother **over** the land.*

Quick at / of — *He is quick **at** figures. She is quick **of** understanding.*

React to / against — *How did he react **to** the news?*

Ready for — *Are you ready **for** the journey?*

Reason with (a person) / **for** (cause) — *I reasoned **with** him. What is the reason **for** your absence?*

Recover from — *He has recovered **from** his illness.*

Reconcile with / to — *He was reconciled **with** his brother. He reconciled himself **to** his fate.*

Refer to — *Refer **to** the dictionary.*

Refrain from — *Refrain **from** smoking.*

Rejoice at / in — *We rejoiced **at** the victory.*

Related to — *He is related **to** me.*

Relevant to — *Your answer is not relevant **to** the question.*

Relieve of — *He was relieved **of** his duties.*

Rely on / upon — *You can rely **on** me.*

Remedy for — *There is no remedy **for** this disease.*

Remind of — *This picture reminds me **of** my childhood.*

Repent of — *He repented **of** his sins.*

Reply to — *He did not reply **to** my letter.*

Resign from (a post) / **to** (accept) — *He resigned **from** the committee. He resigned himself **to** his fate.*

Resort to — *They resorted **to** violence.*

Respect for — *We have great respect **for** our teachers.*

Responsible to / for — see 18.2.

Restore to — *He was restored **to** health.*

Result in (cause) / **from** (be caused by) — *Carelessness results **in** accidents. Accidents result **from** carelessness.*

Retire from — *He retired **from** service.*

Revenge on / upon (a person) / **for** (a wrong) — *He took revenge **on** his enemy **for** the insult.*

Rich in — *Bangladesh is rich **in** natural resources.*

Rid of — *Get rid **of** bad habits.*

Rob of — *The robbers robbed him **of** his money.*

Rooted in — *Our culture is rooted **in** our history.*

Rude to — *Don't be rude **to** elders.*

S

Sanguine of / about (hopeful) — *He is sanguine **of** success.*

Satisfied with — *I am satisfied **with** your work.*

Search for / in — *They searched **for** the missing child.* (*search a place* — no preposition: *The police searched the house*)

Secure from / against — *The fort is secure **from** attack.*

Sensitive to — *Her skin is sensitive **to** the sun.*

Sentenced to — *He was sentenced **to** death.*

Sick of (tired of) — *I am sick **of** his complaints.*

Similar to — *My shirt is similar **to** yours.*

Slave to — *He is a slave **to** his habits.*

Smile at / on — see 18.2.

Sorry for (a person, an action) / **about** (a situation) — *I feel sorry **for** him. I'm sorry **about** the mess.*

Stare at — *Don't stare **at** strangers.*

Strive for — *We must strive **for** peace.*

Subject to — *The plan is subject **to** approval.*

Submit to — *We will not submit **to** injustice.*

Subscribe to — *I subscribe **to** two newspapers.*

Substitute for — *There is no substitute **for** hard work.*

Succeed in (an effort) / **to** (a throne, property) — *He succeeded **in** passing. He succeeded **to** the throne.*

Suffer from / for — see 18.2.

Sufficient for — *This food is sufficient **for** ten persons.*

Suitable for / to — *This dress is suitable **for** the occasion.*

Superior to — *This tea is superior **to** that.*

Supply with / to — *They supplied us **with** food. They supplied food **to** us.*

Sure of — *I am sure **of** his honesty.*

Surprised at / by — *I was surprised **at** his behaviour.*

Suspect of — *I suspect him **of** stealing.*

Suspicious of — *He is suspicious **of** strangers.*

Sympathise with — *I sympathise **with** you in your sorrow.*

Sympathy for / with — *I have great sympathy **for** the victims.*

T · U

Taste for (liking) / **of** (experience) — *He has a taste **for** music. He had a taste **of** prison life.*

Tolerant of / towards — *Be tolerant **of** others' views.*

Translate into / from — *Translate this **from** Bangla **into** English.*

Tremble with / at — *He trembled **with** fear / **at** the sight.*

True to — *He is true **to** his word.*

Trust in (have faith) / **with** (give responsibility) — *Trust **in** God. I trusted him **with** my money.*

Unaware of — *He was unaware **of** the danger.*

Unequal to — *He is unequal **to** the task.*

Unfit for — *He is unfit **for** the job.*

Unite with / against — *The parties united **against** the enemy.*

Urge on / upon — *I urged **on** him the need for caution.*

Use for (a purpose) / **of** (a thing) — *What is the use **of** this tool? I have no use **for** it.*

Useful to (a person) / **for** (a purpose) — *This book is useful **to** students / **for** reference.*

V · W · Y · Z

Vain of / about — *She is vain **of** her beauty.*

Versed in (skilled) — *He is well versed **in** law.*

Vexed with (a person) / **at** (a thing) — *He was vexed **with** me / **at** my remarks.*

Victim of / to — *He fell a victim **to** cholera. He is the victim **of** a fraud.*

Vie with a person **for** a thing — *The two companies vied **with** each other **for** the contract.*

Void of — *His speech was void **of** meaning.*

Vote for / against — *I voted **for** the candidate.*

Wait for / on — see 18.2.

Want of (noun = lack) — *He died **for** want **of** food.*

Warn of / about / against — see 18.2.

Weary of (tired of) — *I am weary **of** his complaints.*

Wish for — *He wishes **for** a long life.*

Wonder at — *We wondered **at** his courage.*

Worthy of — *He is worthy **of** praise.*

Yearn for — *She yearned **for** her son's return.*

Yield to — *He yielded **to** temptation.*

Zeal for — *He has great zeal **for** social work.*

Zest for — *She has a zest **for** life.*

18.5 Common Prepositional Phrases

These phrases begin with a preposition and function as adverbs or adjectives. They appear often in fill-in-the-blank questions where the preposition is removed.

18.5.1 With *At*

Phrase	Meaning	Example
at a loss	puzzled	*I was **at a loss** what to do.*
at all costs	whatever happens	*We must win **at all costs**.*
at any rate	in any case	***At any rate**, we tried.*
at ease	relaxed	*She felt **at ease** in the new school.*
at fault	to blame	*The driver was **at fault**.*
at first sight	at the first look	*love **at first sight***
at hand	near; soon	*The exam is **at hand**.*
at large	free (criminal); in general	*The murderer is still **at large**. the public **at large***
at last	finally	***At last** he came.*
at least	not less than	*It will cost **at least** 500 taka.*
at length	in detail; finally	*He spoke **at length**.*
at one's wits' end	completely puzzled	*I am **at my wits' end**.*
at random	without plan	*He picked a card **at random**.*
at stake	at risk	*Our honour is **at stake**.*
at the cost of	sacrificing	*He worked **at the cost of** his health.*
at the eleventh hour	at the last moment	*He came **at the eleventh hour**.*
at the mercy of	in the power of	*The boat was **at the mercy of** the waves.*
at times	sometimes	***At times** I feel lonely.*
at variance	in disagreement	*His words are **at variance** with his deeds.*

18.5.2 With *By*

Phrase	Meaning	Example
by accident / by chance	accidentally	*I met him **by chance**.*
by all means	certainly	*"May I come?" — "**By all means**."*
by and by	gradually, soon	***By and by** he recovered.*
by and large	on the whole	***By and large**, the plan worked.*
by dint of	by means of	*He succeeded **by dint of** hard work.*
by fair means or foul	by any method	*He wants to win **by fair means or foul**.*
by heart	from memory	*Learn the poem **by heart**.*
by hook or by crook	by any means	*He wants money **by hook or by crook**.*
by leaps and bounds	very rapidly	*Our economy is growing **by leaps and bounds**.*
by mistake	in error	*I took his umbrella **by mistake**.*
by no means	not at all	*He is **by no means** a fool.*
by the way	incidentally	***By the way**, have you seen Rahim?*
by virtue of	because of	***By virtue of** his position, he has power.*
by way of	as a form of; via	*He said it **by way of** a joke.*

18.5.3 With *In*

Phrase	Meaning	Example
in a nutshell	briefly	***In a nutshell**, we failed.*
in accordance with	in agreement with	***In accordance with** the law …*
in brief / in short	briefly	***In short**, he is a liar.*
in charge of	responsible for	*He is **in charge of** the office.*
in common	shared	*We have nothing **in common**.*
in consequence of	as a result of	***In consequence of** the flood, crops were destroyed.*
in debt	owing money	*He is deeply **in debt**.*
in detail	fully	*Explain it **in detail**.*
in fact	actually	***In fact**, he is very poor.*
in favour of	supporting	*I am **in favour of** the plan.*
in full swing	at its peak	*The party was **in full swing**.*
in lieu of	instead of	*He got money **in lieu of** leave.*
in no time	very quickly	*He finished it **in no time**.*
in order	arranged; allowed	*Everything is **in order**.*
in person	personally	*Please come **in person**.*

Phrase	Meaning	Example
in spite of	despite	***In spite of*** *the rain, we went out.*
in the long run	eventually	*Honesty pays* ***in the long run****.*
in the nick of time	just in time	*He arrived* ***in the nick of time****.*
in vain	uselessly	*All our efforts were* ***in vain****.*
in view of	considering	***In view of*** *the situation, the exam was postponed.*

18.5.4 With *On*, *Out of*, *Under*, *Of*, *Without*, *With*

Phrase	Meaning	Example
on account of	because of	*He was absent* ***on account of*** *illness.*
on behalf of	representing	*I thank you* ***on behalf of*** *the school.*
on duty / off duty	working / not working	*The guard is* ***on duty****.*
on no account	never	***On no account*** *should you go.*
on purpose	intentionally	*He broke it* ***on purpose****.*
on the contrary	the opposite is true	*He is not lazy;* ***on the contrary****, he is very active.*
on the eve of	just before	***on the eve of*** *the election*
on the whole	generally	***On the whole****, it was a success.*
out of date	old-fashioned	*This dictionary is* ***out of date****.*
out of order	not working	*The lift is* ***out of order****.*
out of question / out of the question	impossible	*A holiday is* ***out of the question****.*
out of sorts	unwell, upset	*He is* ***out of sorts*** *today.*
out of the blue	unexpectedly	*He arrived* ***out of the blue****.*
under consideration	being considered	*The matter is* ***under consideration****.*
under no circumstances	never	***Under no circumstances*** *will I agree.*
under pressure	stressed, forced	*He works well* ***under pressure****.*
of late	recently	*I haven't seen him* ***of late****.*
of one's own accord	voluntarily	*He came* ***of his own accord****.*
without fail	certainly	*Come tomorrow* ***without fail****.*
with a view to	with the intention of	*He went abroad* ***with a view to*** *studying medicine.*
with regard to / with reference to	concerning	***With reference to*** *your letter, …*
for good	permanently	*He left Bangladesh* ***for good****.*
for the sake of	for the benefit of	*He did it* ***for the sake of*** *his children.*

18.6 Common Errors with Appropriate Prepositions

1. ✘ He is fond for music. ✔ He is fond **of** music.
2. ✘ She is married with an engineer. ✔ She is married **to** an engineer.
3. ✘ I congratulate you for your success. ✔ I congratulate you **on** your success.
4. ✘ He was accused for theft. ✔ He was accused **of** theft.
5. ✘ He is independent from his parents. ✔ He is independent **of** his parents.
6. ✘ He died for cholera. ✔ He died **of** cholera.
7. ✘ He is good in English. ✔ He is good **at** English.
8. ✘ I am angry on you. ✔ I am angry **with** you.
9. ✘ He insisted to go. ✔ He insisted **on going**.
10. ✘ He prevented me to go. ✔ He prevented me **from going**.
11. ✘ She is interested on music. ✔ She is interested **in** music.
12. ✘ He is capable to do it. ✔ He is capable **of doing** it.
13. ✘ I have no objection in your going. ✔ I have no objection **to** your going.
14. ✘ The book is divided in five chapters. ✔ … divided **into** five chapters.
15. ✘ He was sentenced for death. ✔ He was sentenced **to** death.
16. ✘ Smoking is injurious for health. ✔ Smoking is injurious **to** health.
17. ✘ I am confident about success. (acceptable) ✔ I am confident **of** success. (exam answer)
18. ✘ He was deprived from his rights. ✔ He was deprived **of** his rights.
19. ✘ She is jealous on her sister. ✔ She is jealous **of** her sister.
20. ✘ He complained against the noise. ✔ He complained **about** / **of** the noise.
21. ✘ He is suffering with fever. ✔ He is suffering **from** fever.
22. ✘ He is senior than me. ✔ He is senior **to** me.
23. ✘ Translate this in English. ✔ Translate this **into** English.
24. ✘ We should abide with the law. ✔ We should abide **by** the law.
25. ✘ This custom is peculiar with our country. ✔ … peculiar **to** our country.
26. ✘ I am indebted for him. ✔ I am indebted **to** him.
27. ✘ He is addicted with smoking. ✔ He is addicted **to** smoking.
28. ✘ He was absent in the class. ✔ He was absent **from** the class.
29. ✘ He takes pride on his work. ✔ He takes pride **in** his work. / He prides himself **on** his work.
30. ✘ He is proficient at English. ✔ He is proficient **in** English.

18.7 Idiomatic Prepositions in the GMAT

GMAT Sentence Correction lists dozens of “preposition idioms”. The most frequently tested:

✔ Correct idiom	Typical wrong version
*attribute X **to** Y*	attribute X *as* / *for* Y
*based **on***	based *upon* (acceptable) / based *in* (✘)
*believe X **to be** Y*	believe X *as* Y
*compared **with** / **to***	compared *against*
*consistent **with***	consistent *to*
*contrast X **with** Y*	contrast X *to* Y (less preferred)
*depend **on** / **upon***	depend *of*
*differ **from***	differ *than*
*distinguish X **from** Y / **between** X **and** Y*	distinguish *between* X *from* Y
*estimated **to be***	estimated *at being*
*the same **as***	the same *to*
*native **to*** (plant, animal)	native *of* (for people: *a native of Sylhet* ✔)
*prefer X **to** Y*	prefer X *than* Y
*a responsibility **to*** + verb / **for** + noun	
*resistance **to***	resistance *against*
*a tendency **to***	a tendency *of*
*think of X **as** Y*	think of X *to be* Y

CHAPTER 19

Conjunction

Part A · Grammar

19.1 What Is a Conjunction?

A **conjunction** is a word that **joins** words, phrases, clauses or sentences. (*Con* = together, *junction* = joining.)

- Rahim **and** Karim are brothers. (joins two words)
- He is poor **but** honest. (joins two adjectives)
- You can go by bus **or** by train. (joins two phrases)
- I stayed at home **because** it was raining. (joins two clauses)
- She worked hard; **however**, she failed. (*however* links ideas but is a conjunctive **adverb** — see 19.6)

A conjunction differs from a **relative pronoun** (*who, which*) and a **relative adverb** (*where, when*), which also join clauses but have an additional job. It also differs from a **preposition**, which takes a noun/pronoun object, not a clause: *He came **because of** the rain* (preposition phrase) / *He came **because** it was raining* (conjunction).

19.2 Kinds of Conjunctions

There are three structural kinds:

1. **Coordinating conjunctions** — join elements of **equal rank** (two words, two phrases, two independent clauses).
2. **Subordinating conjunctions** — join a **dependent (subordinate) clause** to a **main clause**.
3. **Correlative conjunctions** — **pairs** of conjunctions used together.

19.3 Coordinating Conjunctions

The seven basic coordinating conjunctions can be remembered as **FANBOYS**: ***For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So***. Traditional grammar classifies coordinators by meaning into four groups:

Kind	Meaning	Conjunctions	Example
Cumulative / Copulative	adds one fact to another	and, both … and, as well as, not only … but also, also, too, moreover, furthermore	*He is clever **and** hard-working. **Both** Rina **and** Mina came. He **as well as** his brother is guilty.*
Adversative	contrasts two facts	but, yet, still, however, nevertheless, whereas, while, only	*He is rich, **but** he is unhappy. He is poor, **yet** he is honest. You may go, **only** come back soon.*
Alternative / Disjunctive	gives a choice between alternatives	or, either … or, neither … nor, otherwise, else, or else, nor	*Work hard, **or** you will fail. **Either** you **or** he must go. Hurry up, **otherwise** you will miss the bus.*
Illative / Causal	shows inference, result or reason	so, therefore, hence, consequently, for, thus	*He was ill, **so** he did not come. He must be ill, **for** he is absent.*

> ***For*** as a conjunction means *because* but is **coordinating** and formal; it introduces a reason **as an afterthought** and cannot begin a sentence: *He felt no fear, **for** he was a brave man.* ✘ *For he was brave, he felt no fear.* (Use *As/Because/Since* at the beginning.)

19.4 Subordinating Conjunctions

Subordinating conjunctions introduce **adverb clauses** (and *that, whether, if* introduce **noun clauses**). They are classified by meaning:

Meaning	Conjunctions	Example
Time	when, whenever, while, as, before, after, till, until, since, as soon as, as long as, once, by the time, now that, the moment	*I will wait **till** you come. **As soon as** he saw me, he ran away. It is five years **since** he died.*
Place	where, wherever	*Go **wherever** you like.*
Cause / Reason	because, since, as, now that, seeing that, inasmuch as, in that	***As** it was raining, we stayed home. **Since** you are tired, you may rest.*
Purpose	that, so that, in order that, lest	*He works hard **so that** he may succeed. Walk fast **lest** you should miss the train.*
Result / Consequence	so … that, such … that, so that (result)	*He is **so** weak **that** he cannot walk. It was **such** a hot day **that** we stayed in.*
Condition	if, unless, provided (that), providing, on condition that, in case, as long as, so long as, supposing, suppose, whether … or, but that, once	*I will go **if** he invites me. You will fail **unless** you work hard. You can go **provided** you return early.*
Concession / Contrast	though, although, even though, even if, while, whereas, however, no matter how/what, whatever, much as, as (in *Rich as he is*)	***Though** he is poor, he is honest. **Even if** it rains, I will go.*
Comparison	than, as … as, so … as, the … the	*He is taller **than** I. She is **as** clever **as** her sister. **The** more, **the** merrier.*
Manner	as, as if, as though, the way	*Do **as** I tell you. He talks **as if** he knew everything.*
Noun clause	that, whether, if	*I know **that** he is honest. I doubt **whether** he will come.*

19.5 Correlative Conjunctions

Correlative conjunctions are used **in pairs**. The two elements they join must be **grammatically parallel** (Chapter 39).

Pair	Example
either … or	***Either** you **or** I must go.*
neither … nor	*He is **neither** rich **nor** handsome.* (✘ neither … or)

Pair	Example
both … and	***Both** Rahim **and** Karim passed.* (✘ both … as well as)
not only … but also	*She is **not only** beautiful **but also** intelligent.*
whether … or	*I don't know **whether** he will come **or** not.*
though / although … yet	***Though** he is poor, **yet** he is honest.* (traditional; *yet* is optional; ✘ though … but)
so … that	*He ran **so** fast **that** he won.*
such … that	*It was **such** a good film **that** we saw it twice.*
such … as	***Such** men **as** are honest are respected.*
so … as	*He is not **so** tall **as** his brother.*
as … as	*She is **as** wise **as** her mother.*
the same … as	*This is **the same** pen **as** I lost.*
no sooner … than	***No sooner** had he come **than** it rained.*
hardly / scarcely … when	***Hardly** had he come **when** it rained.*
lest … should	*Work hard **lest** you **should** fail.*
rather … than	*I would **rather** die **than** beg.*
if … then	***If** x = 2, **then** 2x = 4.*
not … but	*It is **not** you **but** I who am to blame.*
not so much … as	*He is **not so much** a scholar **as** a teacher.*
whether … or (no)	***Whether** you like it **or not**, you must go.*

> **Parallel placement:** Put each half of a correlative **immediately before** the matching elements: ✘ *He **not only** lost his money **but also** his reputation.* ✔ *He lost **not only** his money **but also** his reputation.* ✘ *She **either** will go by bus **or** by train.* ✔ *She will go **either** by bus **or** by train.*

19.6 Conjunctions vs Conjunctive Adverbs

Words such as ***however, therefore, moreover, furthermore, nevertheless, nonetheless, consequently, hence, thus, besides, otherwise, accordingly, still, also, then*** connect ideas but are grammatically **adverbs**. They cannot join two independent clauses with only a comma.

- ✘ He studied hard, however he failed. (comma splice)
- ✔ He studied hard; **however**, he failed.
- ✔ He studied hard. **However**, he failed.
- ✔ He studied hard, **but** he failed. (real conjunction with a comma)

19.7 Important Rules and Usage Points

19.7.1 *Both … and*, *As well as*

Both pairs only with ***and***. ***As well as*** is not a correlative of *both*, and the verb agrees with the **first** subject (Chapter 23).

- ✘ **Both** Rahim **as well as** Karim came. ✔ **Both** Rahim **and** Karim came.
- Rahim, **as well as** his brothers, **is** coming. (verb agrees with *Rahim*)
- ✘ Both of them are not present. (ambiguous) ✔ **Neither** of them is present. / **Only one** of them is present.

19.7.2 *Either … or*, *Neither … nor*

- ✘ **Neither** he **or** his friend came. ✔ **Neither** he **nor** his friend came.
- ✘ He did not come **nor** write. → ✔ He **neither** came **nor** wrote. / He did not come **or** write.
- The verb agrees with the **nearer** subject: ***Either** the teacher **or** the students **are** responsible. **Neither** the students **nor** the teacher **is** responsible.*

19.7.3 *Though / Although* — Never with *But*

Though/Although already shows contrast; adding ***but*** is a double conjunction error. *Yet* or *still* may be used for emphasis (traditional style).

- ✘ **Though** he is rich, **but** he is not happy.
- ✔ **Though** he is rich, he is not happy.
- ✔ **Though** he is rich, **yet** he is not happy. (traditional)
- ✔ He is rich, **but** he is not happy.
- ***Although*** is slightly more formal and normally begins a sentence; ***though*** can also come at the end as an adverb: *He is rich. He is not happy, **though**.*

19.7.4 *Lest … should*

Lest means "*for fear that / so that … not*". It is followed by ***should*** + base form (or the bare subjunctive in American English) and **never by *not***:

- Walk carefully **lest** you **should** fall. (✘ lest you should not fall; ✘ lest you will fall; ✘ lest you fall not)
- He ran fast **lest** he **should** miss the train.

19.7.5 *Unless* and *Until* — Already Negative

Unless = *if … not*; ***until*** = *up to the time when*. They must **not** be followed by *not* (in the sense of double negation).

- ✘ **Unless** you do **not** work hard, you will fail. ✔ **Unless** you work hard, you will fail. (= If you do not work hard …)
- ✘ Wait here **until** I do **not** return. ✔ Wait here **until** I return.
- ***Until / till*** concerns **time**; ***unless*** concerns **condition**: ✘ *Don't go until he permits you* (acceptable) / ✔ *You can't go **unless** he permits you.*

19.7.6 *Since*, *Because*, *As*, *For*

Conjunction	Use	Example
because	the **strongest**, gives the **direct cause**; answers *why?*; usually after the main clause	*He failed **because** he was lazy. — Why did he fail? **Because** he was lazy.*
since	a **known or obvious** reason; often at the start	***Since** you are busy, I will come later.*
as	a reason that is **less important** or already known	***As** it was late, we went home.*
for	an **afterthought** reason (formal, never first)	*He must be poor, **for** he wears torn clothes.*
because of	**preposition** — followed by a noun, not a clause	*He was absent **because of** illness.* (✘ because of he was ill)

> ***Since*** also expresses **time** (*It is ten years **since** he left*). With the "time" meaning, the main clause normally takes the **present perfect** or *It is …*: *I **have** known him **since** he **was** a child.*

19.7.7 *The reason … is that* (not *because*)

The reason already means *because*, so ***the reason … because*** is redundant:

- ✘ **The reason** he failed is **because** he was lazy.

- ✔ **The reason** he failed is **that** he was lazy.
- ✔ He failed **because** he was lazy.
- ✘ The reason why … is because … ✔ The reason why … is that …

19.7.8 *Than* — after Comparatives Only

Than follows a **comparative** (*-er / more / less*) and *other, else, rather, sooner*:

- ✘ He is more cleverer **than** his brother. ✔ He is cleverer **than** his brother.
- ✘ He is senior **than** me. ✔ He is senior **to** me. (Latin comparatives — Chapter 10)
- ✘ He has no other friend **but** you. ✔ He has no other friend **than** you. (*other … than*)
- ✘ He prefers to die **than** beg. ✔ He would **rather** die **than** beg.
- ✘ Scarcely had he left **than** … ✔ … **when** … (Chapter 16)

19.7.9 *As … as*, *So … as*

As … as is used in **positive** comparisons; ***so … as*** (or *as … as*) in **negative** ones (traditional rule):

- He is **as** tall **as** his father.
- He is not **so** tall **as** his father. (also *not as tall as*)
- ✘ He is so tall as his father. ✔ He is **as** tall **as** his father.

19.7.10 *If* vs *Whether*

Both introduce indirect yes/no questions (*I don't know **if/whether** he will come*), but only ***whether*** can be used:

1. **after a preposition:** *It depends **on whether** he agrees.* (✘ on if)
2. **before a *to*-infinitive:** *I can't decide **whether to** go.* (✘ if to go)
3. **at the beginning of a sentence (as subject):** ***Whether** he will come is uncertain.* (✘ If he will come is uncertain)
4. **with *or not* immediately after it:** *I don't know **whether or not** he will come.* (✘ if or not)
5. **after *the question, the issue, discuss*:** *We discussed **whether** to go.*

19.7.11 *As if* / *As though*

These conjunctions introduce an **unreal comparison** and take the **past subjunctive** (*were*) or past perfect:

- He talks **as if** he **were** a king. (✘ as if he is a king — in exams)
- She behaved **as though** nothing **had happened**.
- He looks **as if** he **is** ill. (here it may be true — real possibility; present tense acceptable)

19.7.12 *That* (Noun Clause and Purpose)

That introduces **noun clauses** and can often be **omitted** after common reporting verbs (*say, think, know, believe, hope*): *I think (**that**) he is right.* It cannot be omitted when the clause is the **subject**: ***That** he is honest is clear.* (✘ He is honest is clear.)

- ✘ He said **that** "I am ill." (direct speech has no *that*) ✔ He said, "I am ill." / ✔ He said **that** he was ill.
- ✘ I asked him **that** where he lived. ✔ I asked him **where** he lived. (*that* is not used before a question word)

19.7.13 *While* and *Whereas*

While = (1) *during the time that* (*He arrived **while** I was eating*), (2) *although / whereas* (contrast): ***While** I like the colour, I don't like the design.* ***Whereas*** = in contrast (comparing two facts): *Rahim is tall, **whereas** Karim is short.*

19.7.14 *In case*, *Provided*, *As long as*, *Now that*, *Once*

- Take an umbrella **in case** it rains. (as a precaution; ✘ in case it will rain)
- You can go **provided (that)** you finish your work. (= only if)
- You may stay **as long as** you keep quiet. (condition) / I'll remember it **as long as** I live. (time)
- ***As far as*** = to the extent that / distance: ***As far as** I know, he is honest.*
- **Now that** the exams are over, we can relax. (= because now)
- **Once** you learn to ride a bicycle, you never forget. (= as soon as / after)

19.7.15 *So that* (purpose) vs *So* (result)

- He studied hard **so that** he **could** pass. (purpose — usually with *can/could/may/might/will/would*)
- He studied hard, **so** he passed. (result — comma, no modal needed)

19.7.16 *Such … that* vs *So … that*

So + adjective/adverb + *that*; ***such*** + (a/an) + adjective + noun + *that*:

- It was **so** cold **that** we stayed inside.
- It was **such** a cold day **that** we stayed inside.
- They are **such** good friends **that** they never quarrel.
- ✘ It was such cold that … ✘ It was so cold day that …

19.7.17 Some Fixed Conjunctive Expressions

Seldom or never (✘ seldom or ever), ***little or nothing***, ***few if any***: *He **seldom or never** goes to the cinema. He knows **little or nothing** about it.*

19.8 Beginning a Sentence with *And* or *But*

Traditional grammar says a sentence should not begin with *And* or *But*. Modern writers do it for emphasis, and it is grammatically acceptable. In formal exam answers, prefer *Moreover / Furthermore* and *However* at the beginning: ***However**, the plan failed.*

19.9 Common Errors with Conjunctions

1. ✘ Though he is poor but he is honest. ✔ Though he is poor, he is honest.
2. ✘ Both Rahim as well as Karim came. ✔ Both Rahim **and** Karim came.
3. ✘ Neither he or I was there. ✔ Neither he **nor** I was there.
4. ✘ Unless you do not work hard, you will fail. ✔ Unless you work hard, you will fail.
5. ✘ Wait until I do not come. ✔ Wait until I come.
6. ✘ Walk carefully lest you should not fall. ✔ Walk carefully lest you **should fall**.
7. ✘ No sooner had he arrived when the rain started. ✔ … **than** the rain started.
8. ✘ Hardly had I left than he came. ✔ … **when** he came.
9. ✘ The reason he was late is because he missed the bus. ✔ … is **that** he missed the bus.
10. ✘ He is so weak that he cannot to walk. ✔ He is so weak that he cannot walk.
11. ✘ It was so a good film that … ✔ It was **such** a good film that …
12. ✘ I doubt if or not he will come. ✔ I doubt **whether or not** he will come.
13. ✘ If he will come or not is uncertain. ✔ **Whether** he will come or not is uncertain.

14. ✘ He not only lost his watch but also his bag. ✔ He lost **not only** his watch **but also** his bag.
15. ✘ He was absent because of he was ill. ✔ He was absent **because** he was ill / **because of** illness.
16. ✘ He talks as if he is the boss. (unreal) ✔ He talks as if he **were** the boss.
17. ✘ Scarcely I had reached when it rained. ✔ Scarcely **had I** reached when it rained.
18. ✘ He asked me that what my name was. ✔ He asked me **what** my name was.
19. ✘ He said that, “I am busy.” ✔ He said, “I am busy.” / He said **that** he was busy.
20. ✘ He was so tired as he slept at once. ✔ He was **so** tired **that** he slept at once.
21. ✘ He is not as tall like his brother. ✔ He is not **as / so** tall **as** his brother.
22. ✘ He has no other friend but you. ✔ He has no other friend **than** you.
23. ✘ Since he was ill, so he did not come. ✔ **Since** he was ill, he did not come. / He was ill, **so** he did not come.
24. ✘ Take your umbrella in case it will rain. ✔ … in case it **rains**.
25. ✘ He seldom or ever comes here. ✔ He **seldom or never** comes here.
26. ✘ I would rather die than to beg. ✔ I would rather die than **beg**.
27. ✘ Because he was ill, therefore he did not come. ✔ **Because** he was ill, he did not come.
28. ✘ He worked hard so that he passed. (meaning result) ✔ He worked hard, **so** he passed.
29. ✘ He is both a good teacher and writes well. ✔ He is **both** a good teacher **and** a good writer.
30. ✘ Either you can stay or go. ✔ You can **either** stay **or** go.

19.10 Conjunctions in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Correlative parallelism (GMAT):** *both X **and** Y, either X **or** Y, neither X **nor** Y, not only X **but also** Y, not X **but** Y, X rather than Y, whether X or Y* — X and Y must have the **same grammatical form**. ✘ *The plan was not only expensive but also took too long.* ✔ *The plan **not only was** expensive **but also took** too long / was not only **expensive** but also **slow**.*
- ***Whether* vs *if*** — GMAT prefers ***whether*** for alternatives: *He asked **whether** the report was finished.*
- ***The reason … is that*** — GMAT marks *the reason … is because* as redundant.
- ***So … as to* / *so … that***: *The noise was **so** loud **as to** be unbearable / so loud **that** it was unbearable.* ✘ *so loud **as** it was unbearable.*
- **GRE Text Completion — logic words:** contrast (*but, yet, although, however, whereas, while, despite*); continuation (*and, moreover, furthermore, indeed, in fact*); cause/effect (*because, since, therefore, thus, hence, consequently*). Spotting the conjunction first tells you whether the blank should **agree with** or **oppose** the other half of the sentence.

CHAPTER 20

Interjection

Part A · Grammar

20.1 What Is an Interjection?

An **interjection** is a word or phrase that expresses a **sudden feeling or emotion** — joy, sorrow, surprise, pain, approval, disgust, fear, and so on. The word comes from Latin *interjectio*, "something thrown in between", because an interjection is *thrown into* speech without any grammatical connection with the rest of the sentence.

- **Alas!** Our leader is no more.
- **Hurrah!** We have won the match.
- **Oh!** What a beautiful sight!
- **Ouch!** That hurts.
- **Bravo!** You have done well.

Because it has no grammatical relation to the other words, an interjection does not change the structure of a sentence. Remove it, and the sentence is still complete: *(Alas!) Our leader is no more.*

20.2 Features of Interjections

1. They are usually **followed by an exclamation mark (!)** when the feeling is strong: *Wow!* With a mild feeling, a **comma** is used: *Oh, I see.* / *Well, let me think.*
2. They usually come at the **beginning** of a sentence, but can also come in the middle or at the end: *I won the prize, **hurrah**!*
3. They are common in **speech** and informal writing, rare in formal academic writing.
4. In **narration** (Chapter 27), interjections are removed and their feeling is expressed through the reporting verb and an adverb or phrase: *He said, "Alas! I am ruined." → He **exclaimed with sorrow** that he was ruined.*

20.3 Interjections Classified by Feeling

Feeling	Interjections	Example
Joy / Delight	Hurrah! Hurray! Huzza! Yippee! Wow! Hooray! Aha!	***Hurrah!** We have got a holiday.*
Sorrow / Grief	Alas! Ah! Oh! Woe! Alack! Ah me!	***Alas!** He has failed again.*
Surprise / Wonder	Oh! Ah! What! Wow! Indeed! Really! Good heavens! My God! Goodness! Gosh! Whoa!	***What!** You have passed!*
Approval / Praise	Bravo! Well done! Excellent! Splendid! Good! Hear, hear!	***Bravo!** You played well.*
Disapproval / Contempt	Fie! Pooh! Pshaw! Tut! Tut-tut! Shame! Ugh! Boo!	***Fie!** You have told a lie.*
Disgust	Ugh! Yuck! Phew! Bah!	***Ugh!** What a bad smell.*
Pain	Ouch! Ow! Oh! Ah!	***Ouch!** I hurt my finger.*
Calling / Attention	Hello! Hey! Hi! Ho! Lo! Look!	***Hello!** Is anybody there?*
Silence	Hush! Sh! Shh!	***Hush!** The baby is sleeping.*
Relief	Phew! Whew! Thank God! At last!	***Phew!** That was close.*
Hesitation	Er! Um! Hmm! Well!	***Well**, I'm not sure.*
Warning	Look out! Watch out! Careful! Beware!	***Look out!** A car is coming.*
Farewell / Greeting	Goodbye! Bye! Welcome! Hello!	***Welcome!** Please come in.*
Prayer / Wish	God bless you! Amen! Heaven forbid!	***God bless** you!*

20.4 Phrases and Other Words Used as Interjections

Interjection phrases (groups of words used as interjections):

Good heavens! Good gracious! Oh dear! Dear me! My goodness! Thank God! For God's sake! What a pity! Well done! Hear, hear! Ah me! Alas the day! Woe is me! Thank goodness! Oh my God! Bless me!

Other parts of speech used as interjections when spoken with emotion:

Word	Usual class	As interjection
What	pronoun / determiner	***What!** You failed again?*
Well	adverb / adjective	***Well**, what do you want?*
Indeed	adverb	***Indeed!** I never knew that.*
Silence	noun	***Silence!** The judge is speaking.*
Shame	noun	***Shame!** How could you do that?*
Nonsense	noun	***Nonsense!** That's not true.*
Help	verb	***Help!** I'm drowning.*
Fire	noun	***Fire!** Run!*
Look	verb	***Look!** A rainbow.*
Heavens	noun	***Heavens!** It's late.*

20.5 Some Interjections in Detail

- ***Alas*** expresses grief, pity or regret — the most commonly tested interjection: ***Alas!** The poor boy died.* In narration: *He said, "Alas! I am undone." → He **exclaimed sorrowfully / with sorrow** that he was undone.*
- ***Hurrah / Hurray / Hooray*** expresses joy and triumph: *The boys said, "Hurrah! We have won." → The boys **exclaimed with joy** that they had won.*
- ***Bravo*** (Italian origin) praises a fine performance: *The audience said, "Bravo!" → The audience **applauded** him / **praised** him.*
- ***Fie*** (old-fashioned) shows contempt or disgust for a shameful act: ***Fie** on you! You are a coward. → He **exclaimed with contempt** that I was a coward.*
- ***Pshaw / Pooh*** shows contempt, impatience or disbelief.
- ***Hush*** demands silence.
- ***Lo*** (archaic) = look, see: ***Lo!** The king comes.* (*Lo and behold* = surprisingly)
- ***Hear, hear!*** expresses agreement with a speaker (in Parliament and meetings).
- ***Eureka!*** (Greek: "I have found it!") expresses triumph at a discovery — said by Archimedes.

- ***Amen*** = “so be it”, said at the end of a prayer.

20.6 Punctuation with Interjections

- Strong feeling — exclamation mark: ***Wow!*** *That’s amazing.* / ***Oh!*** *I forgot my keys.*
- Mild feeling — comma: ***Oh***, *is that you?* ***Well***, *I’ll think about it.* ***Yes***, *I agree.*
- Inside a sentence — commas around it: *It was,* ***alas***, *too late.*
- *O* (capital, no punctuation directly after it) is used in **direct address**, especially in poetry and prayers: ***O*** *God, help us!* ***O*** *Captain! my Captain! Oh* is the ordinary interjection: ***Oh***, *how beautiful!*

> ***O* vs *Oh*:** ***O*** is always capitalised, is used before a **name in direct address** (vocative), and is not followed directly by a comma or exclamation mark: *O Lord!* is the whole phrase. ***Oh*** expresses surprise, pain or emotion and is followed by a comma or an exclamation mark: *Oh! / Oh, no.*

20.7 Interjections and Exclamatory Sentences

An interjection is a **word**; an **exclamatory sentence** is a **sentence** that expresses strong feeling (Chapter 32). They often occur together:

- **Alas!** (interjection) / **How sad the news is!** (exclamatory sentence)
- **Hurrah! What a victory!**
- Exclamatory sentences often begin with ***What*** or ***How*** without any interjection: ***What*** *a lovely garden!* ***How*** *fast he runs!*

20.8 Common Errors with Interjections

1. ✘ Alas! We have won the match. ✔ **Hurrah!** We have won the match. (*alas* = sorrow)
2. ✘ Hurrah! His father died yesterday. ✔ **Alas!** His father died yesterday.
3. ✘ Bravo! You have failed again. ✔ **Fie!** / **Shame!** You have failed again.
4. ✘ Hush! What a beautiful scene! ✔ **Oh!** / **Wow!** What a beautiful scene!
5. ✘ Oh God, help me. (vocative, formal/poetic) ✔ **O** God, help me.
6. ✘ He said that alas he was ruined. (indirect) ✔ He **exclaimed with sorrow** that he was ruined.

20.9 Interjections in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Interjections are not tested directly in international exams, since the SAT, GRE and GMAT use formal academic English. However:

- In **SAT Reading**, literary passages (fiction, speeches) use interjections and exclamations to show **tone** — joy, despair, irony. Questions on “the tone of the passage” or “the narrator’s attitude” may depend on them.
- In **formal writing tasks** (GRE Analytical Writing, GMAT essay — if taken), avoid interjections entirely.
- **GRE vocabulary** includes words describing exclamations: *ejaculation* (an old word for a sudden cry), *exclamation*, *outburst*, *paean* (a song of praise), *lament / elegy* (expression of grief), *execration* (a curse), *expletive* (an oath or swear word; also a “filler” word like *there* in *There is* …).

CHAPTER 21

Tense

Part A · Grammar

21.1 What Is Tense?

Tense is the form of a verb that shows the **time** of an action or state, and also its **aspect** — whether the action is simple, in progress, or completed. The word comes from Latin *tempus*, "time".

There are **three times**: **present**, **past** and **future**. Each has **four aspects**:

1. **Indefinite (Simple)** — the action as a simple fact: *I write.*
2. **Continuous (Progressive)** — the action in progress: *I am writing.*
3. **Perfect** — the action completed (before a point of time): *I have written.*
4. **Perfect Continuous** — the action continuing over a period up to a point: *I have been writing.*

This gives the **twelve tenses** of English.

	Indefinite	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	I write / He writes	I am writing	I have written	I have been writing
Past	I wrote	I was writing	I had written	I had been writing
Future	I shall/will write	I shall/will be writing	I shall/will have written	I shall/will have been writing

21.1.1 Structures (Active Voice)

Tense	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
Present Indefinite	S + V1 (+s/es)	S + do/does not + V1	Do/Does + S + V1?
Present Continuous	S + am/is/are + V-ing	S + am/is/are not + V-ing	Am/Is/Are + S + V-ing?
Present Perfect	S + have/has + V3	S + have/has not + V3	Have/Has + S + V3?
Present Perfect Cont.	S + have/has been + V-ing	S + have/has not been + V-ing	Have/Has + S + been + V-ing?
Past Indefinite	S + V2	S + did not + V1	Did + S + V1?
Past Continuous	S + was/were + V-ing	S + was/were not + V-ing	Was/Were + S + V-ing?
Past Perfect	S + had + V3	S + had not + V3	Had + S + V3?
Past Perfect Cont.	S + had been + V-ing	S + had not been + V-ing	Had + S + been + V-ing?
Future Indefinite	S + shall/will + V1	S + shall/will not + V1	Shall/Will + S + V1?
Future Continuous	S + shall/will be + V-ing	S + shall/will not be + V-ing	Shall/Will + S + be + V-ing?
Future Perfect	S + shall/will have + V3	S + shall/will not have + V3	Shall/Will + S + have + V3?
Future Perfect Cont.	S + shall/will have been + V-ing	S + shall/will not have been + V-ing	Shall/Will + S + have been + V-ing?

> **Time is not the same as tense.** English has only two *inflected* tenses (present *write/writes* and past *wrote*); "future" is expressed with *will/shall*, *be going to*, the present continuous, etc. The present tense can refer to the future (*The train **leaves** at 6 tomorrow*) and the past tense can refer to unreal present (*If I **were** rich …*). Traditional grammar's twelve-tense system is used in our exams, but always think about **meaning**.

21.2 Present Indefinite (Simple Present) Tense

21.2.1 Uses

1. **Habitual or repeated actions** (with *always, usually, often, sometimes, never, every day, daily*): *I **get** up at six every day. She **goes** to school by bus.*
2. **Universal / general truths and facts:** *The sun **rises** in the east. Water **boils** at 100 °C. Honesty **is** the best policy.*
3. **Permanent situations:** *He **lives** in Dhaka. My father **works** in a bank.*
4. **Fixed future events (timetables, schedules):** *The train **leaves** at 7 p.m. The exam **begins** next Monday.*
5. **In clauses of time and condition referring to the future** (after *when, before, after, as soon as, until, if, unless, in case*): *I will call you **when** he **comes**. (✘ when he will come) **If** it **rains**, we will stay home.*
6. **Vivid narration (historic present) and newspaper headlines:** *Napoleon now **marches** on Moscow. "PM **inaugurates** Padma Bridge."*
7. **Quotations and what books say:** *Shakespeare **says**, "Frailty, thy name is woman." The Quran **says** …*
8. **Exclamatory sentences beginning with *Here* and *There*:** *Here **comes** the bus!*
9. **With stative verbs** (*know, believe, love, want, own, seem*) for present states: *I **know** him. She **wants** a new phone.*
10. **Instructions and demonstrations:** *First you **take** the flour, then you **add** water.*

> **Exam Tip — Universal truth in a past-tense sentence:** A universal truth stays in the **present** even after a past reporting verb: *The teacher said that the earth **moves** round the sun.* (✘ moved) *Galileo proved that the earth **is** round.*

21.3 Present Continuous (Progressive) Tense

21.3.1 Uses

1. **An action happening now** (*now, at present, at the moment, right now, Look!, Listen!*): *He **is reading** now. Look! The baby **is sleeping**.*
2. **A temporary action around the present period:** *I **am reading** a novel these days. She **is staying** with her aunt this month.*
3. **Definite future arrangements:** *I **am meeting** him tomorrow. We **are going** to Cox's Bazar next week.*
4. **Changing or developing situations:** *Prices **are rising**. The climate **is getting** warmer.*

5. **Annoying repeated actions** (with *always, constantly, forever*): *He **is always complaining**. She **is constantly losing** her keys.*

> **Stative verbs** (Chapter 11.9) are not normally used in the continuous: ✘ *I am knowing* ✔ *I know*; ✘ *She is having a car* ✔ *She has a car*; ✘ *This is belonging to me* ✔ *This belongs to me*.

21.4 Present Perfect Tense

The present perfect connects the **past with the present**. The action happened at an **unspecified time** before now, and its **result or relevance** continues now.

21.4.1 Uses

1. **Recently completed actions (with *just, already, yet, recently, lately*):** *He **has just left**. I **have** already **finished** my homework. **Have** you **eaten** yet?*
2. **Past actions with present results:** *I **have lost** my key* (I don't have it now). *She **has broken** her leg* (it is still broken).
3. **Experiences up to now (with *ever, never, before, once, twice, so far, up to now*): *Have** you **ever been** to Nepal? I **have never seen** a tiger. He **has visited** Sylhet three times.*
4. **States or actions continuing from the past up to now (with *since* and *for*):** *I **have known** him **since** 2010. She **has lived** here **for** ten years.*
5. **With *this morning / today / this week / this year* (when the period is not over):** *I **have drunk** three cups of tea today.*
6. **After *It is the first / second / best … time*:** *This is **the first time** I **have been** here.*

> **Never use the present perfect with a definite past-time expression** (*yesterday, last week, ago, in 2010, when I was young, just now, the other day*). Use the **past indefinite** instead.
>
> - ✘ I have seen him yesterday. ✔ I **saw** him yesterday.
> - ✘ He has come two days ago. ✔ He **came** two days ago.
> - ✘ She has graduated in 2020. ✔ She **graduated** in 2020.
> - ✘ He has gone just now. ✔ He **went** just now. / ✔ He **has just gone**.

21.4.2 *Have gone* vs *Have been*

- *He **has gone** to Dhaka.* = He is in Dhaka now (or on the way); he has not come back.
- *He **has been** to Dhaka.* = He visited Dhaka at some time and has come back.

21.5 Present Perfect Continuous Tense

21.5.1 Uses

1. **An action that began in the past and is still continuing** (emphasis on duration), with *since* and *for*: *I **have been waiting** for you **for** two hours. It **has been raining since** morning.*
2. **An action that has just stopped, with present evidence:** *Why are your eyes red? — I **have been crying**. You look tired. **Have** you **been working**?*

› ✘ I am waiting here since morning. ✔ I **have been waiting** here since morning.

› ✘ He is living in this house for ten years. ✔ He **has been living** in this house for ten years. (or *has lived*)

› ✘ She is learning English since 2020. ✔ She **has been learning** English since 2020.

> **Present Perfect vs Present Perfect Continuous:** The perfect emphasises the **result / completion** (*I have written three letters* — the number is known); the perfect continuous emphasises the **activity / duration** (*I have been writing letters all morning*). With stative verbs, use the perfect: *I **have known** him for years.* (✘ have been knowing)

21.6 Past Indefinite (Simple Past) Tense

21.6.1 Uses

1. **A completed action at a definite past time** (*yesterday, last year, ago, in 1971, then, when …*): *I **met** him yesterday. Bangladesh **became** independent in 1971.*
2. **A series of past actions** (in a story): *He **opened** the door, **entered** the room and **sat** down.*
3. **Past habits** (also *used to / would*): *He **walked** five miles every day when he was young.*
4. **Past states:** *He **was** a teacher. She **lived** in Khulna.*
5. **Unreal situations (subjunctive) after *if, wish, as if, it's time, would rather*:** *If I **had** money, I would buy it. I wish I **knew** the answer. It's time we **left**.*

› **When** did you come? (✘ When have you come?) — a *when*-question asks for a definite time → past simple.

› ✘ Did he went? ✔ Did he **go**? (after *did*, use V1)

› ✘ He did not came. ✔ He did not **come**.

21.7 Past Continuous Tense

21.7.1 Uses

1. **An action in progress at a particular time in the past:** *At 9 p.m. yesterday I **was reading**.*
2. **A longer action interrupted by a shorter one** (*when / while*): *I **was reading** when the light **went** out. While she **was cooking**, the phone **rang**.*
3. **Two actions in progress at the same time:** *While I **was reading**, my brother **was watching** TV.*
4. **Background description in stories:** *The sun **was shining** and the birds **were singing**.*
5. **Annoying past habits with *always*:** *He **was always borrowing** money.*

> **Exam Tip — *When* + past simple, *While* + past continuous:** *I was sleeping **when** he **came**. / **While** I **was sleeping**, he came.* (Both actions as simple facts in sequence: *When he came, I **opened** the door.*)

21.8 Past Perfect Tense

21.8.1 Uses

1. **The earlier of two past actions** — to show that one action was completed **before** another past action: *The train **had left** before we **reached** the station. When I arrived, he **had gone** home.*
2. **With *before, after, when, as soon as, until, by the time*:** *After he **had finished** his work, he went out. By the time the police arrived, the thief **had escaped**.*
3. **With *hardly / scarcely … when, no sooner … than*:** *Hardly **had** he **arrived** when it began to rain.* (Chapter 16)
4. **In reported speech** (past simple / present perfect → past perfect): *He said, "I saw him." → He said that he **had seen** him.*

5. **In unreal past conditions and wishes:** *If I **had known**, I would have helped. I wish I **had studied** harder.*

> **Sequence rule:** Of two past actions, use the **past perfect** for the **earlier** and the **past simple** for the **later**. ✘ *The patient died before the doctor had come.* ✔ *The patient **had died** before the doctor **came**.*
>
> But if the time relation is already clear from *before/after*, the past simple for both is acceptable in modern English: *He left **before** I arrived.* In exam questions, apply the sequence rule.

21.9 Past Perfect Continuous Tense

An action that had been continuing for some time before another past action or time:

- He **had been waiting** for two hours when I arrived.
- It **had been raining** since morning, so the roads were wet.
- They **had been living** in Rajshahi for ten years before they moved to Dhaka.
- ✘ I was waiting for an hour when he came. ✔ I **had been waiting** for an hour when he came.

21.10 Future Indefinite Tense and Other Ways of Expressing the Future

21.10.1 *Will / Shall* + V1

1. **Simple future predictions:** *It **will** rain tomorrow. He **will** be twenty next year.*
2. **Instant decisions:** *I'm thirsty. — I **will** get you some water.*
3. **Promises, offers, threats, requests:** *I **will** help you. **Shall** I carry your bag? **Will** you open the door?*
4. **Traditional *shall/will* rule** (Chapter 13.6.1): *I/we **shall*** for simple future; *I/we **will*** for determination; *you/he/they **will*** for simple future; *you/he/they **shall*** for command/promise.

21.10.2 Other Future Forms

Form	Use	Example
be going to + V1	intention / plan already made; prediction from present evidence	*I **am going to** buy a car. Look at the clouds — it **is going to** rain.*
Present continuous	fixed personal arrangements	*I **am flying** to Sylhet on Friday.*
Present simple	timetables, schedules	*The flight **leaves** at 10.*
be about to + V1	immediate future	*The train **is about to** leave.* (✘ is about to leaving)
be on the point of + V-ing	very immediate future	*He **was on the point of leaving** when I arrived.*
be to + V1	official plans, orders	*The President **is to** visit Japan.*
be likely to / be bound to / be sure to	probability / certainty	*He **is sure to** pass.*

21.11 Future Continuous Tense

1. **An action that will be in progress at a certain future time:** *This time tomorrow I **shall be travelling** to Cox's Bazar. At 8 p.m. she **will be watching** TV.*
2. **Planned future events, as a matter of course:** *I **will be seeing** him at the office anyway.*
3. **Polite enquiries about plans:** ***Will** you **be using** the car tonight?*

21.12 Future Perfect Tense

An action that will be completed before a certain future time (often with *by, by then, by the time, before*):

- I **shall have finished** the work **by** Friday.
- **By** the end of this year, they **will have built** the bridge.
- **By the time** you arrive, the train **will have left**.
- He **will have reached** home **before** it gets dark.

21.13 Future Perfect Continuous Tense

An action that will have been continuing for a period of time up to a future point:

- **By** next June, I **shall have been teaching** here **for** ten years.
- **By** 6 p.m., she **will have been working** for twelve hours.

21.14 Time Expressions and the Tenses They Take

Expression	Usual tense	Example
every day, usually, always, often, generally, sometimes, never, seldom	Present Indefinite	*He **often** visits us.*
now, at present, at the moment, Look!, Listen!, these days	Present Continuous	*Look! It **is snowing**.*
just, already, yet, ever, never, so far, up to now, recently, lately, since, for, this week/year (unfinished)	Present Perfect	*I **have** never **seen** it.*
since / for (with continuing activity)	Present Perfect Continuous	*It **has been raining** for hours.*
yesterday, last night/week/year, ago, in 2010, the other day, just now	Past Indefinite	*I **saw** him **last week**.*
while, when (+ interrupting action), at that time	Past Continuous	*I **was sleeping** when he called.*
before, after, by the time, already (in the past), hardly … when, no sooner … than	Past Perfect	*He **had left** before I came.*
tomorrow, next week, in future, soon, tonight	Future Indefinite	*He **will come** tomorrow.*
this time tomorrow, at this time next week	Future Continuous	*I **will be sleeping** at this time tomorrow.*
by tomorrow, by next year, by the time	Future Perfect	*I **will have finished** by noon.*

21.15 Sequence of Tenses

Sequence of tenses is the principle by which the tense of the verb in a **subordinate clause** follows (agrees with) the tense of the verb in the **main clause**.

21.15.1 Rule 1 — Past Main Clause → Past Subordinate Clause

If the verb in the main clause is in the **past**, the verb in the subordinate (especially noun) clause is normally in a **past** form.

- He **said** that he **was** ill. (✘ is ill — in exam style)
- I **knew** that she **would** come. (✘ will come)
- She **thought** that I **had told** a lie.

› He **worked** hard so that he **might** pass. (✘ may pass)
› I **asked** him what he **wanted**.

21.15.2 Rule 2 — Present or Future Main Clause → Any Tense in the Subordinate Clause

If the main verb is in the present or future, the subordinate verb may be in **any tense** the sense requires.

› He **says** that he **is** ill / **was** ill / **will be** ill / **has been** ill.
› I **will tell** you what he **did** yesterday.

21.15.3 Exceptions to Rule 1

1. **Universal truths and habitual facts** stay in the present: *He said that the sun **rises** in the east. The teacher said that honesty **is** the best policy.*
2. **After *than* (comparison)**, any tense: *He **liked** you more than he **likes** me.*
3. **Clauses of place or reason** may take any tense the sense requires: *He **lived** where his father **lives** now.*
4. **Historical facts** are often kept in the past: *The teacher said that Bangladesh **became** independent in 1971.*
5. **With *must* and *ought to*** (no past form): *He said that we **must** go.*

21.15.4 Purpose Clauses: *May / Might*

The modal in a purpose clause follows the main verb: *He **works** hard so that he **may** succeed. / He **worked** hard so that he **might** succeed.*

21.16 Special Structures with Tense

Structure	Rule	Example
It is time / It is high time + past simple	the action is already late	*It is high time we **started**.* (✘ start)
I wish + past simple (present wish) / past perfect (past wish)	unreal	*I wish I **were** rich. I wish I **had seen** it.*
As if / As though + past / past perfect	unreal comparison	*He talks as if he **knew** everything.*
Would rather + subject + past	preference about another person	*I'd rather you **went** now.*
Since + past simple (main: present perfect or *It is*)	point of time	*It is five years since he **died**.* (✘ has died) / *I have known him since I **was** a child.*
Before / until / when / as soon as / if + present (for future)	no *will* in time/condition clause	*I will wait until he **comes**.*
It is the first time + present perfect		*It's the first time I **have flown**.*
It was the first time + past perfect		*It was the first time I **had flown**.*
Hardly … when / No sooner … than	past perfect + past simple	*No sooner **had** he **left** than she **arrived**.*
Lest + should + V1		*… lest he **should** fall.*

21.17 Common Errors in Tense

1. ✘ I have seen him yesterday. ✔ I **saw** him yesterday.
2. ✘ He has died two years ago. ✔ He **died** two years ago.
3. ✘ I am living here since 2015. ✔ I **have been living** here since 2015.
4. ✘ She is knowing the answer. ✔ She **knows** the answer.
5. ✘ When will he come, I will tell him. ✔ When he **comes**, I will tell him.
6. ✘ If it will rain, we will not go. ✔ If it **rains**, we will not go.
7. ✘ The patient died before the doctor came. (exam) ✔ The patient **had died** before the doctor came.
8. ✘ He said that he is busy. ✔ He said that he **was** busy.
9. ✘ The teacher said that the earth moved round the sun. ✔ … the earth **moves** round the sun.
10. ✘ It is time we go home. ✔ It is time we **went** home.
11. ✘ It is two years since he has gone. ✔ It is two years since he **went**.
12. ✘ I am waiting for you for two hours. ✔ I **have been waiting** for you for two hours.
13. ✘ Did you went to school? ✔ Did you **go** to school?
14. ✘ He did not came yesterday. ✔ He did not **come** yesterday.
15. ✘ When have you come? ✔ When **did** you **come**?
16. ✘ He was reading when I was entering. ✔ He was reading when I **entered**.
17. ✘ By next year, I will complete my degree. ✔ By next year, I **will have completed** my degree.
18. ✘ I had seen him yesterday. ✔ I **saw** him yesterday.
19. ✘ He worked hard so that he may pass. ✔ … so that he **might** pass.
20. ✘ Hardly he had reached when the train left. ✔ Hardly **had he** reached when the train left.
21. ✘ I am going to market every day. ✔ I **go** to market every day.
22. ✘ He has been ill since three days. ✔ He has been ill **for** three days.
23. ✘ The train will leave before we will reach. ✔ The train will leave before we **reach**.
24. ✘ She is going to school yesterday. ✔ She **went** to school yesterday.
25. ✘ We are knowing each other for years. ✔ We **have known** each other for years.
26. ✘ He will have finished the work tomorrow. ✔ He will have finished the work **by** tomorrow.
27. ✘ I wish I am a bird. ✔ I wish I **were** a bird.
28. ✘ He is about to leaving. ✔ He is about to **leave**.
29. ✘ This is the first time I see the sea. ✔ This is the first time I **have seen** the sea.
30. ✘ The sun rose in the east. (general truth) ✔ The sun **rises** in the east.

21.18 Tense in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Logical sequence (GMAT/SAT):** Tenses within a sentence must reflect the real order of events. ✘ *By the time the rescue team arrived, the fire **destroyed** the building.* ✔ *… the fire **had destroyed** the building.*
- **Unnecessary tense shifts (SAT):** In a passage written in the past, a sudden switch to the present (or vice versa) without reason is wrong.
- **Present perfect with *since*:** ✘ *Since 2010, the company **increased** its exports.* ✔ *… **has increased** …*
- **Past perfect only when needed:** GMAT does not reward the past perfect if there is no earlier past action to contrast: ✘ *The company **had announced** its results yesterday.* ✔ *… **announced** …*
- **Conditionals:** *If* + present → *will*; *if* + past → *would*; *if* + past perfect → *would have* (Chapter 25). ✘ *If he had studied, he would pass.* ✔ *… would have passed.*
- **GRE Reading:** The tense of an author's statement (*scientists believed* vs *scientists believe*) often signals a **contrast between an old view and a new one** — a common structure of GRE passages.

CHAPTER 22

Right Form of Verbs

Part A · Grammar

22.1 What Is “Right Form of Verbs”?

In a **Right Form of Verbs** question, a verb is given in its base form in brackets and you must put it into the **correct form** — tense, number, voice, mood, or a non-finite form (infinitive, gerund, participle):

- He (go) to school every day. → He **goes** to school every day.
- I (see) him yesterday. → I **saw** him yesterday.
- He insisted on (go) there. → He insisted on **going** there.
- The letter (write) by Rina. → The letter **was written** by Rina.

This item appears in SSC, HSC, university admission tests, BCS Written and Bank written exams, and in MCQ form in BCS Preliminary and Bank tests. It is really a **test of everything** in Chapters 11–14, 21, 23, 25 and 26. The method is simple:

> **The Five-Question Method**
>
> 1. **Is a finite verb needed?** (Does the clause already have a finite verb? Is the word after a preposition, a modal, *to*, *let/make*?) — If not finite → choose infinitive, gerund or participle.
> 2. **What is the time?** Look for **time words** (*yesterday, now, since, by the time* …) and the **tense of the other verb** (sequence of tenses).
> 3. **Who/what is the subject, and is it singular or plural?** (agreement)
> 4. **Is the subject doing the action or receiving it?** (active or passive)
> 5. **Is there a special structure?** (*if, wish, as if, it’s time, lest, suggest that, hardly … when, would rather*, etc.)

The rest of this chapter lists the **rules** with examples, grouped for easy learning.

22.2 Rules Based on Subject and Time (Tense)

Rule 1 — Present Indefinite for habits, routines and general facts: third-person singular subject → V1 + *s/es*.

- He (read) the newspaper every morning. → **reads**
- The earth (move) round the sun. → **moves**
- Rice (grow) in wet land. → **grows**
- Cats (catch) mice. → **catch**

Rule 2 — Universal truths stay in the present, even after a past reporting verb.

- The teacher said that the sun (rise) in the east. → **rises**
- He knew that honesty (be) the best policy. → **is**

Rule 3 — *Now, at present, at this moment, Look!, Listen!, still, day by day* → Present Continuous.

- Look! The boy (climb) the tree. → **is climbing**
- Listen! Someone (knock) at the door. → **is knocking**
- Prices (rise) day by day. → **are rising**

Rule 4 — *Just, already, yet, ever, never, recently, lately, so far, this week, this year* → Present Perfect.

- He just (leave) the room. → **has just left**
- I never (see) a tiger. → **have never seen**
- Have you (finish) your work yet? → **finished**

Rule 5 — *Since* / *for* + continuing action up to now → Present Perfect Continuous (or Present Perfect for stative verbs).

- I (wait) for you for an hour. → **have been waiting**
- It (rain) since morning. → **has been raining**
- I (know) him since my childhood. → **have known**

Rule 6 — *Yesterday, last, ago, in + past year, the other day, just now* → Past Indefinite.

- He (come) home yesterday. → **came**
- I (meet) him two days ago. → **met**
- She (finish) the work just now. → **finished** (but *has just finished* ✔)

Rule 7 — *It is / It has been* + time + *since* + Past Indefinite.

- It is ten years since he (die). → **died**
- It is long since I (see) you last. → **saw**

Rule 8 — Present Perfect / *It is* in the main clause + *since* + Past Indefinite in the *since*-clause.

- I have known him since he (be) a child. → **was**
- Many years have passed since he (leave) the village. → **left**

Rule 9 — *While* + Past Continuous; *when* + Past Indefinite (interruption).

- While he (read), the light went out. → **was reading**
- I was sleeping when he (come). → **came**
- When I reached the station, the train (leave). → **had left** (earlier action — Rule 10)

Rule 10 — Two past actions: earlier → Past Perfect; later → Past Indefinite (with *before, after, when, by the time, till*).

- The patient (die) before the doctor came. → **had died**
- After he (finish) his work, he went out. → **had finished**
- The train had left before we (reach) the station. → **reached**
- By the time the fire brigade arrived, the house (burn) down. → **had burnt**

Rule 11 — *Hardly / Scarcely … when* and *No sooner … than*: Past Perfect + Past Indefinite.

- No sooner had he (arrive) than it began to rain. → **arrived** (had arrived)
- Hardly had we sat down when the bell (ring). → **rang**

Rule 12 — Future time words (*tomorrow, next, soon, in future*) → Future Indefinite in the main clause.

- He (come) tomorrow. → **will come**
- We (visit) Sylhet next month. → **shall/will visit**

Rule 13 — In time and condition clauses (*when, before, after, until, as soon as, if, unless, in case*) about the future, use the

present (not *will*).

- I will wait until he (return). → **returns**
- If it (rain), we shall not go out. → **rains**
- Call me as soon as you (reach) Dhaka. → **reach**

Rule 14 — *By* + future time / *by the time* + present → Future Perfect.

- By next year, he (complete) his studies. → **will have completed**
- By the time you come, I (finish) the work. → **shall/will have finished**

Rule 15 — Sequence of tenses: past main verb → past form in the noun clause.

- He said that he (be) ill. → **was**
- I thought that he (will) come. → **would**
- She told me that she (see) the film. → **had seen**

22.3 Rules Based on Non-Finite Forms

Rule 16 — After modals (*can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must*) → V1.

- He can (swim). → **swim**
- You must (obey) your parents. → **obey**
- It may (rain) today. → **rain**

Rule 17 — After *to* (infinitive marker) → V1.

- I want to (go) home. → **go**
- He decided to (leave) the job. → **leave**

Rule 18 — After *let, make, bid, help, see, hear, watch, feel, notice* + object → bare V1 (for a complete action).

- Let him (go). → **go**
- She made me (laugh). → **laugh**
- I saw him (cross) the road. → **cross**
- Help me (lift) the box. → **lift / to lift**

Rule 19 — After *had better, would rather, would sooner, cannot but, do nothing but, rather than* → V1.

- You had better (consult) a doctor. → **consult**
- I would rather (die) than (beg). → **die … beg**
- I cannot but (laugh). → **laugh**
- He did nothing but (sleep). → **sleep**

Rule 20 — After a preposition → V-*ing* (gerund).

- He is fond of (read). → **reading**
- She left without (say) goodbye. → **saying**
- He insisted on (pay) the bill. → **paying**
- I am tired of (wait). → **waiting**
- Instead of (study), he played. → **studying**

Rule 21 — *To* as a preposition → V-*ing*: *look forward to, be used to, be accustomed to, with a view to, object to, in addition to, be devoted to, confess to, be addicted to, prefer … to.*

- I look forward to (hear) from you. → **hearing**
- He is used to (work) at night. → **working**
- He went to Dhaka with a view to (get) a job. → **getting**

Rule 22 — After certain verbs → V-*ing*: *avoid, enjoy, mind, finish, deny, admit, postpone, consider, keep, give up, can't help, practise, risk, miss, suggest, stop (= end).*

- Would you mind (open) the window? → **opening**
- He avoided (meet) me. → **meeting**
- I couldn't help (laugh). → **laughing**
- He gave up (smoke). → **smoking**

Rule 23 — After certain verbs → *to* + V1: *want, wish, hope, decide, agree, refuse, promise, plan, expect, afford, fail, manage, pretend, learn, seem, tend, offer, threaten.*

- He refused (help) me. → **to help**
- She promised (come) early. → **to come**
- We cannot afford (buy) a car. → **to buy**

Rule 24 — Fixed expressions → V-*ing*: *It is no use, It is no good, It is worth, There is no point in, be busy, spend time, feel like, have difficulty (in).*

- It is no use (cry) over spilt milk. → **crying**
- This book is worth (read). → **reading**
- He is busy (prepare) for the exam. → **preparing**
- I don't feel like (eat). → **eating**

Rule 25 — Perfect participle (*Having* + V3) for the earlier of two actions with the same subject.

- (Finish) his work, he went to bed. → **Having finished**
- (Take) his breakfast, he went to school. → **Having taken**

Rule 26 — Present participle (V-*ing*) for a simultaneous action or a reason; past participle (V3) for a passive sense.

- (Walk) along the road, I saw a snake. → **Walking**
- (Be) ill, he could not come. → **Being**
- (Write) in simple language, the book is popular. → **Written**
- The man (stand) at the gate is my uncle. → **standing**
- The goods (order) last week have arrived. → **ordered**

Rule 27 — Absolute construction: a noun/pronoun + participle (independent subject).

- The sun (set), we went home. → **having set**
- The weather (be) fine, we went out. → **being**
- God (will), we shall meet again. → **willing**

Rule 28 — Causative *have / get* + object + V3 (someone else does it).

- I had my hair (cut). → **cut**
- She got her watch (repair). → **repaired**
- He had the house (paint). → **painted**

Rule 29 — *-ing* vs *-ed* adjectives (cause vs feeling).

- The film was very (bore). → **boring**
- I was (bore) by the film. → **bored**
- It was an (excite) match. → **exciting**

Rule 30 — *Used to* + V1 (past habit); *be/get used to* + V-*ing*.

- He used to (smoke) a lot. → **smoke**
- I am used to (walk) long distances. → **walking**

22.4 Rules Based on Voice (Active/Passive)

Rule 31 — When the subject receives the action, use the passive: *be* + V3.

- The thief (catch) yesterday. → **was caught**
- English (speak) all over the world. → **is spoken**
- The bridge (build) now. → **is being built**
- The work (finish) by tomorrow. → **will have been finished**
- The letter must (post) today. → **be posted**

Rule 32 — Passive infinitive and gerund.

- This work is to (do) at once. → **be done**
- There is no time to (lose). → **lose / be lost** (*to lose* is idiomatic)
- He hates (insult). → **being insulted**
- The room needs (clean). → **cleaning / to be cleaned**

Rule 33 — *Born*: always passive in the sense of birth.

- He (bear) in 1971. → **was born**
- She has (bear) three children. → **borne**

22.5 Rules Based on Mood and Special Structures

Rule 34 — *If* conditionals (Chapter 25).

- If he comes, I (go). → **shall/will go** (First)
- If I were a king, I (help) the poor. → **would help** (Second)
- If he had worked hard, he (pass). → **would have passed** (Third)
- If I (be) you, I would not do it. → **were**
- (Have) I known, I would have come. → **Had**

Rule 35 — *Wish* + past (present wish) / past perfect (past wish).

- I wish I (be) a bird. → **were**
- I wish I (see) the match yesterday. → **had seen**
- I wish you (stop) talking. → **would stop**

Rule 36 — *As if / as though* + past subjunctive / past perfect.

- He talks as if he (be) a king. → **were**
- He looked as if he (see) a ghost. → **had seen**

Rule 37 — *It is time / It is high time* + past simple.

- It is time we (start). → **started**
- It is high time you (change) your habits. → **changed**
- (But: *It is time* ***to start***.)

Rule 38 — *Would rather* + subject + past simple.

- I would rather you (come) tomorrow. → **came**
- I would rather he (not tell) anyone. → **didn't tell**

Rule 39 — Subjunctive after *suggest, propose, recommend, insist, demand, order, request, urge* + *that*; and after *It is essential / necessary / important that* → base form (or *should* + V1).

- I suggest that he (see) a doctor. → **see / should see**
- The court ordered that he (be) released. → **be**
- It is necessary that every student (attend) the class. → **attend**

Rule 40 — Optative (wish/prayer): *May* + subject + V1; *Long live*; *God bless*.

- May you (live) long! → **live**
- Long (live) Bangladesh! → **live**
- God (bless) you! → **bless**

Rule 41 — *Lest* + *should* + V1.

- Walk fast lest you (miss) the train. → **should miss**

Rule 42 — Purpose: *so that / in order that* + *may* (present) / *might* (past).

- He works hard so that he (prosper). → **may prosper**
- He worked hard so that he (succeed). → **might succeed**

Rule 43 — Imperative: base form; *Let* + object + V1.

- (Shut) the door. → **Shut**
- Let us (go) out. → **go**
- Don't (make) a noise. → **make**

22.6 Rules Based on Agreement

Rule 44 — Each / every / either / neither / everyone / nobody + singular verb.

- Each of the boys (have) a pen. → **has**
- Every man and woman (be) present. → **was**
- Neither of them (be) guilty. → **is**

Rule 45 — *One of* + plural noun + singular verb; *one of the … who* + plural verb.

- One of the students (be) absent. → **is**
- He is one of the best players who (have) ever played. → **have**

Rule 46 — *As well as / along with / with / together with / besides*: verb agrees with the first subject.

- The captain, as well as the players, (be) happy. → **is**
- Rahim with his friends (be) coming. → **is**

Rule 47 — *Either … or / neither … nor / not only … but also / or*: verb agrees with the nearer subject.

- Neither the teacher nor the students (be) present. → **were**
- Either you or he (be) wrong. → **is**

Rule 48 — Collective nouns (unit → singular; members → plural); special plural nouns (*people, police, cattle*) → plural; uncountables and *-ics* subjects → singular.

- The jury (be) divided in their opinion. → **were**
- The police (have) arrested the thief. → **have**
- The news (be) good. → **is**
- Mathematics (be) my favourite subject. → **is**

Rule 49 — *A number of* + plural verb; *The number of* + singular verb.

- A number of students (be) absent. → **were / are**
- The number of students (be) increasing. → **is**

Rule 50 — Relative pronoun: verb agrees with the antecedent.

- I, who (be) your friend, will help you. → **am**
- It is you who (be) to blame. → **are**

22.7 Rules for Stative Verbs, Need and Dare

Rule 51 — Stative verbs (*know, believe, love, like, want, own, belong, seem, understand*) do not take the continuous form.

- I (know) him for years. → **have known** (✘ have been knowing)
- This book (belong) to me. → **belongs**
- I (understand) the problem now. → **understand**

Rule 52 — *Need / dare* as modals (negative/question) → V1; as main verbs → *to* + V1.

- You need not (worry). → **worry**
- He needs (go) now. → **to go**
- How dare you (speak) like that? → **speak**

22.8 Worked Examples with Reasons

The following sentences are typical of BCS, Bank and admission tests. Read the reason for each answer.

1. Many years (pass) since I last saw him. → **have passed** — present perfect + *since*.
2. He (not come) yet. → **has not come** — *yet* → present perfect.

3. The sun (set) before we reached home. → **had set** — earlier past action.
4. I (do) it when I get time. → **shall/will do** — main clause future; *get* is in a time clause.
5. He talks as if he (know) everything. → **knew** — unreal comparison.
6. It is high time you (go) to bed. → **went** — *it is high time* + past.
7. I wish I (can) help you. → **could** — present wish.
8. The boy (punish) by the teacher yesterday. → **was punished** — passive, past.
9. He is one of those who (believe) in hard work. → **believe** — *who* refers to *those*.
10. Neither he nor his friends (come) yesterday. → **came** — past simple (agreement doesn't show in V2).
11. If you had come, you (see) the fun. → **would have seen** — third conditional.
12. Would you mind (lend) me your pen? → **lending** — *mind* + gerund.
13. (Be) a rainy day, we stayed indoors. → **It being** — absolute construction needs its own subject.
14. The old man (walk) for an hour when it began to rain. → **had been walking** — past perfect continuous.
15. My father (return) home before I woke up. → **had returned** — earlier action.
16. Let him (do) whatever he likes. → **do** — after *let*.
17. He suggested that I (take) rest. → **take / should take** — subjunctive.
18. Every boy and every girl (be) given a prize. → **was** — *every … and every* → singular.
19. Bread and butter (be) his only food. → **is** — one dish.
20. The cattle (graze) in the field. → **are grazing** — *cattle* is plural.
21. The number of girls in the class (be) twenty. → **is** — *the number of* → singular.
22. Ten miles (be) a long distance. → **is** — distance as one sum.
23. I am looking forward to (see) you. → **seeing** — *to* is a preposition.
24. She is used to (live) alone. → **living** — *be used to* + V-ing.
25. He used to (go) for a walk every morning. → **go** — *used to* + V1.
26. (See) the police, the thief ran away. → **Seeing** — simultaneous action.
27. (Defeat) in the election, he left politics. → **Defeated / Having been defeated** — passive participle.
28. No sooner had the teacher entered the class than the students (stand) up. → **stood**
29. The man who (steal) the money has been arrested. → **stole / had stolen**
30. Walk carefully lest you (fall). → **should fall**
31. Two-thirds of the land (be) flooded. → **was / is** — verb agrees with *land*.
32. Two-thirds of the people (be) poor. → **are** — agrees with *people*.
33. He (be) ill for a week. → **has been** — duration up to now.
34. He (die) of cholera in 1990. → **died**
35. He said that he (will) help me. → **would**
36. The child (cry) since morning. → **has been crying**
37. Water (freeze) at 0 °C. → **freezes** — scientific fact.
38. What (happen) to him yesterday? → **happened**
39. (Had) I wings, I would fly. → **Had** (= If I had)
40. The poor (be) not always unhappy. → **are** — *the* + *adjective* = plural.
41. He can't help (sing) when he is happy. → **singing**
42. I saw him (go) out. → **go / going**
43. She has her clothes (wash) every week. → **washed**
44. He made me (do) the work. → **do**
45. He was made (do) the work. → **to do** — passive of *make* takes *to*.
46. There is no point in (argue) with him. → **arguing**
47. I prefer reading to (write). → **writing**
48. By this time next year, I (graduate). → **will have graduated**
49. Long (live) our motherland! → **live**
50. It is no use (try) to persuade him. → **trying**

Final Strategy: Underline every **clue word** before you decide: time words (*since, ago, yet, while, by the time*), structure words (*if, wish, lest, as if, it's time, suggest that, hardly … when*), position words (a preposition, a modal, *to*, *let/make*) and the **true subject**. Then apply the matching rule. With practice, 90% of these questions can be solved in seconds.

22.9 Right Form of Verbs in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

International tests do not give "(verb)" in brackets, but **every Sentence Correction question tests the same skill**: choosing between verb forms such as *is/are, has/had, would/will, to do/doing, is done/does*. The most common verb-form errors in GMAT and SAT are:

1. **Agreement across long distances** (*The list of candidates **has**…*).
2. **Wrong tense sequence** (*By 2020 the company **had** grown* vs *has grown*).
3. **Conditional mix-ups** (*If it **were** … would*).
4. **Subjunctive** (*require that he **be***).
5. **Infinitive vs gerund idioms** (*capable **of doing**, ability **to do***).
6. **Participle/dangling modifiers** (*Having finished the report, **the manager** …*).

CHAPTER 23

Subject-Verb Agreement

Part A · Grammar

23.1 What Is Subject-Verb Agreement?

Every complete sentence has a **subject** (the person or thing we are talking about) and a **verb** (what the subject does or is). *Subject-verb agreement* means that **the verb must match its subject in number and person.**

- **Number** means *singular* (one) or *plural* (more than one).
- **Person** means *first person* (I, we), *second person* (you) or *third person* (he, she, it, they, Rahim, the book, the students).

So, a singular subject needs a singular verb, and a plural subject needs a plural verb. This sounds very easy, and in short sentences it is. The difficulty appears when the subject is hidden, long, compound, collective, or separated from its verb by many words. Almost every competitive exam in Bangladesh — BCS Preliminary, Bank (Officer, Senior Officer, AD of Bangladesh Bank), university admission tests (DU, JU, RU, CU) and international exams like the SAT, GRE and GMAT — tests this topic every year, mainly through *Error Detection*, *Sentence Correction*, *Right Form of Verbs* and *Fill in the Blanks*.

- The boy **plays** football. (singular subject → singular verb)
- The boys **play** football. (plural subject → plural verb)
- She **is** a doctor. / They **are** doctors.
- I **am** ready. / We **are** ready.

23.1.1 Why the "s" Confuses Learners

In English, an **-s/-es** at the end of a **noun** usually makes it *plural* (book → books). But an **-s/-es** at the end of a **present-tense verb** makes it *singular* (they play → he play**s**). So in a correct present simple sentence, the "s" usually appears **only once** — either on the noun or on the verb, not on both.

- The dog bark**s**. (s on the verb → singular)
- The dog**s** bark. (s on the noun → plural)
- ✘ The dogs barks. ✔ The dogs bark.

> **Exam Tip — The "one s" trick:** In a simple present sentence with a normal noun subject, if both the subject and the verb end in -s, check again — one of them is probably wrong. (This trick does not work for nouns like *news, physics, police, people, children*, so learn those rules below.)

23.1.2 Where Agreement Matters

Agreement only shows in a few places in English, so you must know exactly where to look:

1. **Present simple tense** — *he works / they work.*
2. **The verb *be*** — *am / is / are* (present) and *was / were* (past).
3. **The verb *have*** — *has / have*.
4. **The verb *do*** — *does / do*.
5. **Present perfect and present continuous** — *has gone / have gone; is going / are going.*
6. **Past continuous** — *was going / were going*.

Modal auxiliaries (*can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to*) **never change** with the subject: *He can swim. They can swim.* The **past simple** of ordinary verbs also does not change: *He went. They went.*

Subject	be (present)	be (past)	have	do	Main verb (present)
I	am	was	have	do	write
We / You / They	are	were	have	do	write
He / She / It	is	was	has	does	writes
Singular noun (Rahim, the book)	is	was	has	does	writes
Plural noun (the boys)	are	were	have	do	write

> **Remember:** *You* always takes a plural verb even when it refers to one person: *You **are** my friend* (✘ You is). *I* takes *am* in the present but *was* in the past: *I **was** there* (✘ I were there — except in the subjunctive: *If I **were** you*).

23.2 Step One: Find the True Subject

Most agreement errors happen because the learner matches the verb with the wrong word. So before applying any rule, **find the real (head) subject**. Ask: *"Who or what is doing the action / being described?"* Then strip away everything that only describes it.

23.2.1 Words That Are Never the Subject

The subject of a sentence is **never** inside:

- a **prepositional phrase** (of the students, in the box, with his friends, for the poor);
- an **appositive** set off by commas (*Mr. Karim, our teachers' leader, …*);
- a **relative clause** (*who live next door, which were damaged*);
- a **participial phrase** (*sitting under the trees, written by Tagore*).

Cross these out mentally and look at what is left.

- The quality of the mangoes **is** (✘ are) excellent. → *quality* is the subject; *of the mangoes* is a prepositional phrase.
- The box of chocolates **was** (✘ were) stolen.
- The boys in the last bench **are** talking.
- The cost of all these books **has** (✘ have) risen.
- One of my friends **lives** (✘ live) in Sylhet.
- The leader of the workers, together with his followers, **was** (✘ were) arrested.
- A list of the successful candidates **has** (✘ have) been published.
- The use of mobile phones in classrooms **is** (✘ are) prohibited.
- The houses that stand beside the river **are** (✘ is) old.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — The "Long-Distance" Trap:** Standardised tests love to put 10–20 words between the subject and the verb so that a plural noun sits right before a singular verb (or vice versa). Example (GMAT style): *"The rise in the prices of essential commodities such as rice, lentils and edible oils **have** hurt low-income families."* The subject is *rise* (singular), so the correct verb is **has hurt**. Always ask: *What exactly has hurt the families? — The rise.*

23.2.2 Subject After the Verb (Inverted Order)

In some sentences the verb comes **before** the subject. You must look **after** the verb to find the subject.

(a) Sentences beginning with *There* or *Here*. *There* and *here* are never subjects; the real subject comes after the verb.

- There **is** a book on the table.
- There **are** many books on the table.
- There **was** a lot of noise.
- There **were** a lot of people.
- Here **is** your ticket. / Here **are** your tickets.
- ✘ There's three reasons for this. ✔ There **are** three reasons for this.

(b) Questions. The subject usually follows the auxiliary.

- Where **is** the key? / Where **are** the keys?
- **Does** your brother live here? / **Do** your brothers live here?
- **Has** any of the guests arrived? / **Have** all the guests arrived?
- What **are** the causes of the war? (subject = *the causes*)

(c) Inversion after adverbs or adverbial phrases of place (literary style, common in SAT/GRE reading).

- On the hill **stands** an old temple. (subject = *an old temple*)
- On the hill **stand** two old temples.
- Among the guests **was** the Prime Minister.
- In the middle of the room **were** a table and two chairs.
- Down **came** the rain. / Away **flew** the birds.

(d) Inversion after negative adverbs (*never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, no sooner, not only, nor, little*). The auxiliary still agrees with the subject that follows it.

- Never **has** he told a lie. / Never **have** they told a lie.
- Not only **does** she sing, but she also dances.
- Seldom **do** we see such honesty nowadays.

23.2.3 Long Subjects (Phrases and Clauses as Subjects)

When a **gerund phrase**, an **infinitive phrase** or a **noun clause** is the subject, it is treated as **one idea**, so the verb is **singular**.

- Swimming in rivers **is** good exercise.
- Reading books **makes** a man perfect.
- Taking long walks in the evening **helps** her relax.
- To err **is** human; to forgive **is** divine.
- To read many books **is** useful.
- What he says **is** true.
- That he is honest **is** known to all.
- Whether they will come **is** uncertain.
- Who stole the money **remains** a mystery.

> **Two gerunds joined by *and*** usually take a plural verb because they are two different activities: *Reading and writing **are** essential skills.* But if they form one combined activity, use singular: *Eating and drinking too much **is** harmful.* (Both are accepted in modern usage; in exams the plural is safer for two clearly separate activities.)

Special case — *What*-clauses with plural complements. When a *what*-clause is followed by a plural noun complement, many grammarians accept a plural verb: *What we need **are** more teachers.* The traditional (safe) answer for BCS is singular: *What we need **is** more teachers.* Both are seen in good writing; SAT and GMAT avoid testing this.

23.3 Rules for Compound Subjects

A **compound subject** has two or more nouns/pronouns joined by *and, or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also*, etc.

Rule 1: Subjects joined by *and* → plural verb

> **Rule 1.** Two or more subjects joined by **and** generally take a **plural verb**.

- Rahim and Karim **are** friends.
- My father and my uncle **were** present.
- He and I **are** classmates.
- Honesty and hard work **are** the keys to success.
- Bangladesh and Nepal **are** neighbouring countries.
- The teacher and the students **have** gone to the museum.

There are several important **exceptions** to Rule 1. These are among the most frequently tested points in BCS and Bank exams.

Rule 2: Two nouns, one person → singular

> **Rule 2.** If two nouns joined by *and* refer to the **same person or thing**, the verb is **singular**. The sign: **the article (a/an/the) or possessive is used only once**, before the first noun.

- The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one man who is both a poet and a philosopher)
- The poet and the philosopher **are** dead. (two different men)
- The Headmaster and Secretary **is** present. (one person)
- The Headmaster and the Secretary **are** present. (two persons)
- My friend and benefactor **has** come.
- A black and white cow **is** grazing. (one cow with two colours)
- A black and a white cow **are** grazing. (two cows)
- The writer and director of the film **was** awarded.

Rule 3: One idea or one dish → singular

> **Rule 3.** When two nouns joined by *and* express **one idea**, **one unit**, or **one combined thing** (often a dish, a pair or a proverb), the verb is **singular**.

- Bread and butter **is** his usual breakfast.
- Rice and curry **is** my favourite food.
- Bread and milk **is** good for children.
- Slow and steady **wins** the race.
- Fish and chips **is** popular in England.
- Law and order **has** deteriorated.
- The horse and carriage **is** at the door. (one vehicle)
- The long and the short of the matter **is** this.
- Gin and tonic **is** a common drink.
- Ups and downs **are** part of life. (*ups and downs* is plural in form and meaning)

> **Traditional proverb exception:** *Time and tide **wait** for none.* Here *time* and *tide* are treated as two separate things, so the verb is plural. Learn it as it is, since it appears often in BCS papers.

Bread and butter in its idiomatic sense *(means of livelihood)* is also singular: *Teaching **is** my bread and butter.*

Rule 4: *Each / Every / No* before *and*-subjects → singular

Rule 4. If **each, every, many a** or **no** comes before singular subjects joined by *and*, the verb is **singular**.

- Every man and woman **is** equal before the law.
- Each boy and each girl **has** a book.
- Every teacher and every student **was** present.
- No man and no woman **was** spared.
- Every house and every shop **was** searched.
- Each day and each night **brings** its own problems.

Rule 5: *As well as, with, along with* etc. → verb follows the FIRST subject

Rule 5. When two subjects are joined by **as well as, with, along with, together with, accompanied by, in addition to, besides, including, like, unlike, rather than, more than, no less than, and not, but not, except, but, plus**, the verb agrees with the **first subject**. The second part is only extra information and is usually set off by commas.

- The teacher, as well as the students, **was** present. (✘ were)
- The students, as well as the teacher, **were** present.
- The captain, along with his players, **has** arrived.
- The minister, with his secretaries, **is** coming.
- Rina, together with her sisters, **is** going to Cox's Bazar.
- He, and not you, **is** to blame.
- You, and not he, **are** to blame.
- The ship, with its crew, **was** lost.
- Mr. Hasan, accompanied by his wife, **was** at the party.
- The house, including its furniture, **was** sold.
- Karim, like his brothers, **is** a doctor.
- Gold, no less than silver, **has** fallen in price.
- He, rather than his friends, **deserves** punishment.
- The President, in addition to his ministers, **was** present.
- Nobody except the guards **was** allowed inside.

SAT / GMAT Corner — The "False Compound" trap: Testmakers use *along with, as well as, in addition to, together with* to make a singular subject *look* plural. E.g. *"The CEO, in addition to several board members, **were** accused of fraud."* ✘ → **was** accused. Only **and** can create a true compound (plural) subject. GMAT often uses this with long intervening phrases.

Rule 6: *Or, nor, either…or, neither…nor* → nearer subject (Proximity Rule)

Rule 6. When two subjects are joined by **or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also, not…but**, the verb agrees with the subject **nearer (closer) to it**. This is called the **Law of Proximity**.

- Either Rahim or Karim **has** done it. (both singular → singular)
- Either the boys or their father **has** done it. (nearer = father)
- Either the father or his sons **have** done it. (nearer = sons)
- Neither he nor I **am** guilty. (nearer = I)
- Neither you nor he **is** responsible.
- Neither he nor you **are** responsible.
- Not only the students but also the teacher **was** surprised.
- Not only the teacher but also the students **were** surprised.
- Not the principal but the teachers **are** responsible.
- Either you or your brother **has** to go.
- **Has** either Rahim or Karim seen this? (In a question the auxiliary stands nearest to the *first* subject, so if one subject is plural, rewrite: *Have his friends or Rahim seen this?*)
- Ali or his brothers **are** coming.
- My brothers or Ali **is** coming.

Exam Tip — Placing the plural subject last: When one subject is singular and the other plural, good style puts the **plural subject nearer the verb** and uses a **plural verb**: *Neither the captain nor the players **were** happy.* This sounds more natural than *Neither the players nor the captain was happy*, though both are grammatically correct.

Person problem. When the subjects joined by *or/nor* are of different persons (*you* and *I*, *he* and *I*), the verb still agrees with the nearer subject. But because such sentences sound awkward, it is better to repeat the verb:

- Either you or I **am** wrong. → Better: Either you **are** wrong, or I **am**.
- Neither he nor you **are** to blame. → Better: He **is** not to blame, nor **are** you.

Order of persons with *and*. When pronouns of different persons are joined by *and*, the polite order in good English is **231** for ordinary/positive sentences: second person first, then third, then first (*You, he and I*). When admitting a fault or in negative sense, the order is **123** (*I, you and he are to blame*). The verb is always plural.

- You, he and I **are** good friends.
- I, you and he **are** guilty.

Rule 7: *Both…and* → plural

Both…and always joins two subjects firmly, so the verb is always **plural**.

- Both Rahim and Karim **are** absent.
- Both the cat and the dog **were** hungry.

23.4 Indefinite Pronouns and Distributive Words

Indefinite pronouns refer to people or things in a general way. Some are always singular, some always plural, and some can be either.

Rule 8: Always singular indefinite pronouns

Rule 8. The following words are **always singular** and take a **singular verb**: **each, every, either, neither, one, everyone, everybody, everything, someone, somebody, something, anyone, anybody, anything, no one, nobody, nothing, another, much, many a, more than one, little (amount).**

- Everybody **knows** the answer.
- Everyone **was** happy.
- Somebody **has** taken my pen.
- Nobody **likes** to be insulted.
- Nothing **is** impossible.
- Anyone **is** allowed to apply.
- Something **is** wrong with the engine.
- Much **has** been said about the matter.
- Each of the boys **was** given a prize.
- Every one of the students **has** passed.

- Either of the two roads **leads** to the station.
- Neither of the answers **is** correct.
- One of the girls **is** absent.
- One of the most important problems **is** unemployment.

> **Exam Tip — "One of the + plural noun + singular verb":** *One of the boys **is*** (✘ one of the boy is / ✘ one of the boys are). Note two things: (i) the noun after *one of the* must be **plural**; (ii) the verb must be **singular** because the subject is *one*. Both errors are tested regularly.

Either / Neither are used for **two** persons or things only. For more than two, use *any one / none*.

- Either of the two brothers **is** suitable.
- Any one of the five candidates **is** suitable. (✘ Either of the five)
- Neither of the two sisters **sings** well.
- None of the ten students **has/have** passed. (✘ Neither of the ten)

> In informal English, *neither of* + plural noun with a plural verb is common (*Neither of them **are** coming*). In BCS, Bank and admission exams, always use the **singular** verb: *Neither of them **is** coming.*

Rule 9: *Each* after a plural subject

When *each* comes **after** a plural subject (as an appositive), the verb is **plural**, because the subject is still plural. When *each* comes **before** (as the subject), the verb is singular.

- They each **have** a car. (subject = *they*)
- Each of them **has** a car. (subject = *each*)
- The students each **have** their own computers.
- We each **have** a different opinion.
- Each student **has** a different opinion.

Rule 10: Always plural indefinite pronouns

> **Rule 10. Both, few, a few, many, several, others** are always **plural**.

- Both **are** guilty.
- Few **were** present at the meeting.
- Many **have** come, but a few **have** gone back.
- Several of the books **are** missing.
- Others **think** differently.

Rule 11: SANAM pronouns — singular or plural

> **Rule 11 (The SANAM Rule). S**ome, **A**ny, **N**one, **A**ll, **M**ost (and also *half, part, rest, enough, more, lot, plenty, majority, percent, fractions*) can be singular or plural. Look at the noun **after *of*** (or the noun they refer to): if it is **uncountable or singular → singular verb**; if it is **countable plural → plural verb**.

- Some of the milk **is** sour. / Some of the mangoes **are** sour.
- All of the money **was** stolen. / All of the books **were** stolen.
- Most of the work **is** done. / Most of the workers **are** absent.
- Any of the food **is** fine. / Are any of the boys here?
- Half of the cake **has** been eaten. / Half of the cakes **have** been eaten.
- Part of the building **was** damaged. / Part of the walls **were** damaged.
- The rest of the story **is** boring. / The rest of the students **are** in the hall.
- A lot of water **is** wasted. / A lot of people **are** waiting.
- Plenty of time **is** left. / Plenty of seats **are** available.
- All that glitters **is** not gold. (*all* = everything → singular)
- All **are** not thieves that dogs bark at. (*all* = all persons → plural)
- All is well. / All are well.

Rule 12: *None*

None means *not one* or *not any*. Traditional grammar treated it as singular, but modern usage (and most Bangladeshi exam keys) follows the SANAM rule:

- None of the information **was** useful. (uncountable → singular)
- None of the money **is** mine.
- None of the students **were/was** present. (countable plural → both accepted; plural is more common, singular is more formal)
- None **were** present. (= no persons)
- None but the brave **deserves** the fair. (famous line of Dryden — learn as it is)
- None of these two answers… ✘ → Neither of these two answers **is** correct.

> **Exam Tip on *none*:** If an option says *"None of the boys were present"* or *"None of the boys was present"*, both can be correct. Look for another clear error in the sentence. If you must choose, the singular is the "classic" formal answer, while the plural matches modern usage (SAT/GRE accept both). With an uncountable noun, only the singular is correct.

Rule 13: *Many a* → singular verb and singular noun

> **Rule 13. Many a / many an** is followed by a **singular noun** and a **singular verb** (and a singular pronoun), though its meaning is "many".

- Many a man **has** lost his life in this war.
- Many a student **was** absent yesterday.
- Many a flower **is** born to blush unseen. (Thomas Gray)
- Many an opportunity **has** been lost.
- ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a boy **was** present.

Compare: **A great many / a good many** take a **plural noun** and **plural verb**: *A great many students **were** present.* And **many** alone is plural: *Many students **were** present.*

Rule 14: *More than one* → singular; *More + plural noun + than one* → plural

- More than one boy **was** absent. (✘ More than one boys were)
- More than one student **has** failed.
- More boys than one **were** absent. (the subject is *boys*)
- More than two boys **were** absent. (*two* is plural)

Rule 15: *A number of* vs *The number of*

> **Rule 15. A number of** (= many) + plural noun → **plural verb**. **The number of** (= the total figure) + plural noun → **singular verb**.

- A number of students **are** absent today.
- The number of students **is** increasing day by day.
- A number of accidents **have** occurred on this road.
- The number of road accidents **has** risen sharply.

- A large number of people **were** killed.
- The number of unemployed youths **is** alarming.

The same logic applies to similar expressions:

- A variety of fruits **are** sold here. / The variety of fruits **is** amazing.
- A total of fifty people **were** injured. / The total **is** fifty.
- A majority of voters **support** him. / The majority **is** in favour.
- A couple of days **have** passed.
- A pair of shoes **is** under the bed. (a pair = one unit; see Rule 22)

23.5 Relative Pronouns (who, which, that)

A relative pronoun has no number of its own. The verb in a relative clause agrees with the **antecedent** (the noun or pronoun the relative pronoun refers to).

Rule 16: Verb agrees with the antecedent of *who/which/that*

> **Rule 16.** In a relative clause, the verb agrees in number **and person** with the antecedent of the relative pronoun.

- I, who **am** your friend, will help you. (✘ who is)
- You, who **are** my friend, should help me.
- He, who **is** my friend, will help me.
- It is I who **am** to blame. (✘ It is I who is to blame)
- It is you who **are** to blame.
- It is he who **is** responsible.
- It is they who **have** done this.
- The girl who **sings** well is my sister.
- The girls who **sing** well are my sisters.
- This is the book that **was** missing.
- These are the books that **were** missing.

Rule 17: *One of those who* → plural; *The only one of those who* → singular

This is a favourite trap of BCS, Bank and GMAT.

> **Rule 17.** In "**one of the + plural noun + who/that/which**", the antecedent of *who* is the **plural noun**, so the verb in the relative clause is **plural**. But in "**the only one of the + plural noun + who**", the antecedent is **one**, so the verb is **singular**.

- He is one of the best players who **have** ever played for Bangladesh. (many players have played; he is one of them)
- She is one of those women who **work** hard.
- This is one of the books that **are** worth reading.
- He is one of the boys who **are** always late.
- He is the only one of the boys who **is** always late. (only he is late)
- She is the only one of the applicants who **has** a driving licence.
- Rahim is the only one of my friends who **lives** in Dhaka.

> **Quick test:** Turn the sentence around: *"Of the boys who **are** always late, he is one."* — the plural is clearly correct. But for *the only one*: *"Of the boys, he is the only one who **is** always late."* — clearly singular.

23.6 Collective Nouns

A **collective noun** names a group of persons or things: *family, team, class, committee, jury, crowd, audience, army, crew, staff, government, council, public, board, company, flock, herd, fleet, mob, parliament, party, majority, enemy, union, orchestra, band, gang, association.*

Rule 18: Collective noun as a unit → singular; as individuals → plural

> **Rule 18.** If the group acts **as one unit**, use a **singular verb** (and singular pronoun *it/its*). If the members act **separately or disagree**, use a **plural verb** (and plural pronoun *they/their*).

- The jury **has** given its verdict. (one decision)
- The jury **were** divided in their opinions. (members disagree)
- The committee **has** submitted its report.
- The committee **are** arguing among themselves.
- The team **is** playing well this season.
- The team **are** taking their seats on the bus.
- My family **is** a large one.
- My family **are** all early risers.
- The class **was** dismissed at noon.
- The class **were** busy with their own work.
- The army **is** marching forward.
- The audience **was** enormous. / The audience **were** clapping their hands.
- The crowd **has** dispersed. / The crowd **were** shouting slogans.
- The staff **is** small. / The staff **are** on leave.
- The public **is** requested not to litter. (unit) / The public **are** divided on this issue.

> **Consistency matters:** Never mix singular and plural for the same collective noun in one sentence. ✘ *The committee **has** made **their** decision.* ✔ *The committee **has** made **its** decision.* This "verb–pronoun consistency" is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT.

> **British vs American English:** In American English (the standard of the SAT, GRE and GMAT), collective nouns are **almost always singular**: *The government **is** …, The team **is** …* In British English, plural is common when we think of members: *The government **are** …, The team **are** …* Bangladeshi exams mostly follow the traditional British "unit vs individuals" rule. In international tests, choose the **singular** unless the sentence clearly shows separate action (like *disagree among themselves*).

Rule 19: Nouns that look singular but are always plural

> **Rule 19.** Some collective nouns are **always plural**, even though they have no -s: **people (= persons), police, cattle, poultry, gentry, clergy, peasantry, vermin, swine, folk, militia, livestock (often)**. They never take *a/an* and never add -s in this sense.

- The people **are** happy. (✘ The people is happy)
- Many people **were** killed.
- The police **have** arrested the thief. (✘ The police has)
- The police **are** investigating the case.
- The cattle **are** grazing in the field. (✘ cattles)
- Poultry **are** kept on this farm.
- The gentry **were** invited.
- The clergy **are** against the move.
- Vermin **are** destroying the crops.

People meaning "a nation / an ethnic group" is countable and has a plural ***peoples***: *The Bengalis **are** a brave people. The peoples of Asia **are** diverse.* ***A policeman / a police officer*** is the singular of *police*: ✘ *A police came.* ✔ *A policeman came.*

23.7 Nouns with Tricky Forms

Rule 20: Plural in form, singular in meaning

Rule 20. Some nouns end in **-s** but are **singular** in meaning and take a **singular verb**.

(a) Names of subjects / sciences: *mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, statistics, phonetics, linguistics, civics, electronics, genetics, athletics, gymnastics.*

(b) Names of diseases: *measles, mumps, rickets, diabetes, shingles, rabies, herpes.*

(c) Names of games: *billiards, darts, draughts, dominoes, cards (as a game).*

(d) Other words: *news, innings, gallows, summons, means (method), wages (in some idioms), amends.*

- Mathematics **is** my favourite subject.
- Economics **is** a social science.
- Physics **deals** with matter and energy.
- Measles **is** an infectious disease.
- Diabetes **is** common in Bangladesh.
- Billiards **is** an indoor game.
- The news **is** true. (✘ The news are true) — *a piece of news*, not *a news*.
- No news **is** good news.
- Bangladesh's first innings **was** good. / An innings **lasts** for hours.
- The gallows **was** set up.
- A summons **has** been issued. (plural: *summonses*)

Subject words used in other senses take a plural verb: *His politics **are** confusing.* (his political views) *The statistics **show** a rise in crime.* (a set of figures) *The economics of the project **are** not clear.* (financial aspects) *His mathematics **are** weak.* (his calculations — some books accept). But as subjects of study: *Politics **is** a dirty game. Statistics **is** an important subject.*

Rule 21: Plural-only nouns (summation plurals)

Rule 21. Some nouns are used **only in the plural** and always take a **plural verb**: **scissors, trousers, pants, pyjamas, jeans, shorts, spectacles, glasses (eyeglasses), binoculars, tongs, pliers, bellows, shears, thanks, riches, alms, proceeds, premises, surroundings, outskirts, environs, arrears, savings, belongings, clothes, goods, contents, assets, annals, archives, credentials, earnings, remains, dregs, eaves, lodgings, odds, tidings, valuables, congratulations.**

- My trousers **are** new. (✘ my trouser is)
- Your spectacles **are** on the table.
- The scissors **are** sharp.
- Riches **do** not bring happiness.
- Alms **are** given to the poor.
- The proceeds of the show **were** donated.
- The premises **are** guarded.
- The surroundings of the lake **are** beautiful.
- His clothes **are** dirty.
- The goods **have** been dispatched.
- Thanks **are** due to the organisers.
- The contents of the letter **were** secret.

Rule 22: *A pair of* + plural noun → singular

- A pair of scissors **is** on the table.
- This pair of trousers **is** expensive.
- Two pairs of shoes **are** needed.
- My pair of spectacles **was** broken.

Rule 23: Same form in singular and plural

Some nouns have **the same form** in both numbers: *sheep, deer, swine, fish (usually), aircraft, spacecraft, series, species, means, headquarters, crossroads, works (factory), offspring, salmon, trout, cod, corps.* The determiner or context tells us the number.

- A sheep **is** grazing. / Ten sheep **are** grazing. (✘ sheeps)
- A deer **was** killed. / Many deer **were** killed.
- A series of lectures **was** arranged. / Two series of stamps **have** been issued.
- This species of bird **is** rare. / These species **are** endangered.
- Every means **has** been tried. / All means **have** been tried.
- The headquarters of the company **is/are** in Dhaka. (both accepted)
- An aircraft **was** missing. / Three aircraft **were** missing.

Rule 24: Uncountable (mass) nouns → always singular

Rule 24. Uncountable nouns take a **singular verb** and never take *a/an* or a plural ending: **information, advice, furniture, luggage, baggage, equipment, machinery, scenery, poetry, jewellery, knowledge, homework, work (= labour), stationery, traffic, weather, bread, money, evidence, mischief, damage (harm), news, hair (on the head), dust, rubbish, grass, offspring (sometimes), crockery, cutlery, business (affairs), progress, research, behaviour, wealth, health, music, fun, patience, permission.**

- The information **is** correct. (✘ The informations are)
- His advice **was** helpful. (✘ advices)
- The furniture **is** new. (✘ furnitures) → *a piece of furniture / pieces of furniture*
- My luggage **has** been lost.
- The scenery of Rangamati **is** charming. (✘ sceneries)
- The machinery **was** imported from Japan.
- Her hair **is** long and black. (✘ hairs are) — but *There are two grey hairs on his head* (individual strands)
- Poetry **is** the music of the soul.
- The evidence **is** strong.
- Much progress **has** been made.
- The traffic **is** heavy today.

The British-sense **plural of measurement** follows the countable unit: *Two pieces of advice **were** given. Three items of furniture **were** sold.*

Rule 25: Foreign (Latin / Greek) plurals → plural verb

Rule 25. Many nouns borrowed from Latin and Greek keep their foreign plurals, and those plurals take a **plural verb** in formal English.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
datum	data	syllabus	syllabi / syllabuses
criterion	criteria	crisis	crises
phenomenon	phenomena	analysis	analyses
medium	media	thesis	theses
curriculum	curricula	hypothesis	hypotheses
memorandum	memoranda	basis	bases
bacterium	bacteria	oasis	oases
stratum	strata	axis	axes
alumnus	alumni	formula	formulae / formulas
stimulus	stimuli	index	indices / indexes
radius	radii	appendix	appendices
nucleus	nuclei	bureau	bureaux / bureaus
fungus	fungi		

- These data **are** reliable. (formal) / This data **is** reliable. (accepted in modern and computing English)
- The criteria for selection **are** strict. (✘ The criteria is)
- This criterion **is** important.
- These phenomena **are** rare. / This phenomenon **is** rare.
- The bacteria **multiply** quickly.
- The media **have** a great influence. (formal) / The media **has** … (modern, accepted)
- The crises **were** handled well.
- The alumni of DU **are** meeting today.

GRE / GMAT note: *Criteria* and *phenomena* are **always plural** — a common trap. *Data* and *media* are accepted with both, but the GMAT tends to treat *data* as plural in formal contexts. If an answer choice says *"the criteria is"*, it is wrong.

23.8 Quantities, Amounts and Numbers

Rule 26: Amount of time, money, distance, weight as one sum → singular

Rule 26. When a plural noun of **time, money, distance, weight, volume, or measurement** is thought of as **one total amount**, the verb is **singular**.

- Ten miles **is** a long distance.
- Five hundred taka **is** too much for this shirt.
- Two thousand dollars **is** a big sum.
- Five years **is** a long time.
- Fifty kilograms **is** too heavy for a child to carry.
- Two hours **is** enough to finish the exam.
- Twenty litres of water **is** required every day.
- Three-fourths of the distance **has** been covered.

But when the units are thought of **separately (one by one)**, the verb is **plural**:

- Five years **have** passed since his death. (years passing one after another)
- Ten taka coins **were** scattered on the floor.
- Many miles **were** walked by the pilgrims.
- Two hours **have** passed since he left.

Rule 27: Arithmetic

In addition and multiplication, both singular and plural verbs are used; in subtraction and division, the singular is used.

- Two and two **make/makes** four. (both accepted; *make* is more common in BCS keys)
- Five times six **is/are** thirty.
- Ten minus four **is** six.
- Twenty divided by five **is** four.
- Six multiplied by two **is** twelve.

Rule 28: Fractions and percentages → follow the noun after *of*

Rule 28. With **fractions, percentages, proportions** (two-thirds of, half of, 50 percent of, a quarter of, a proportion of, a part of), the verb agrees with the **noun after *of***.

- Two-thirds of the land **is** under water.
- Two-thirds of the people **are** illiterate.
- Fifty percent of the work **has** been completed.
- Fifty percent of the workers **have** joined the strike.
- A quarter of the cake **was** eaten.
- Three-quarters of the students **were** present.
- One-third of the mangoes **are** rotten.
- Forty percent of the population **lives/live** in villages. (*population* is collective; singular is preferred, plural acceptable)
- What percentage of students **were** successful?

Rule 29: *One and a half* and decimal numbers

Expressions like *one and a half* refer to more than one but traditional grammar treats the head (*one*) as decisive: **one and a half + plural noun + singular verb** when seen as an amount. Many modern grammars accept a plural verb. The safest exam answer:

- One and a half hours **is** enough. (amount → singular)
- One and a half years **has** passed since then. (traditional) / **have** passed (modern)
- 1.5 kilograms **is** the weight of the parcel.
- 0.5 percent **is** a small amount.

Rule 30: Numbers as names, titles, words, letters

When a number, word, letter or phrase is mentioned **as a word**, it is singular.

- "Seven" **is** a lucky number for some people.
- "Ps and Qs" **is** an idiom meaning manners.
- Two **is** an even number.
- "Mice" **is** the plural of "mouse".

23.9 Titles, Names and Special Subjects

Rule 31: Titles of books, films, newspapers, songs → singular

Rule 31. The **title** of a book, film, play, newspaper, magazine, song or painting is **singular** even if it is plural in form — because it is the name of **one** work.

- *The Arabian Nights* **is** an interesting book. (✘ are)
- *Gulliver's Travels* **was** written by Jonathan Swift.
- *Great Expectations* **is** a novel by Charles Dickens.
- *The Canterbury Tales* **was** written by Chaucer.
- *Sons and Lovers* **is** a novel by D. H. Lawrence.
- *The Daily Star* **is** a popular English daily.
- *Romeo and Juliet* **is** a tragedy by Shakespeare.
- *The Three Musketeers* **is** an adventure novel.

- *The Times* **has** published the report.

Rule 32: Names of countries, organisations, firms

Names of countries, states, organisations and companies that look plural are **singular** because each is one unit.

- The United States **is** a powerful country.
- The Netherlands **is** famous for tulips.
- The Philippines **is** an island nation.
- The United Nations **was** founded in 1945.
- Ahmed and Sons **is** a well-known firm.
- General Motors **has** opened a new plant.
- The Maldives **is** a beautiful tourist destination.

Note: When we mean the islands themselves, plural is possible: *The Maldives **are** a chain of coral islands.*

Rule 33: *The + adjective* → plural verb (when it means a class of people)

> **Rule 33.** When an adjective is used with *the* to mean a **group/class of people**, it is **plural**: **the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the blind, the deaf, the dead, the wounded, the unemployed, the educated, the honest, the brave, the wise, the injured.**

- The rich **are** not always happy.
- The poor **are** getting poorer.
- The wounded **were** taken to hospital.
- The young **have** a duty to the old.
- The honest **are** respected everywhere.
- The brave **deserve** the fair.

But when *the + adjective* refers to an **abstract quality** or a **single person**, use a **singular** verb:

- The beautiful **is** not always good. (abstract quality, *beauty*)
- The unknown **is** always frightening.
- The impossible **has** happened.
- The accused **was** acquitted. (one person; *the accused were* if more than one)
- The deceased **was** a teacher.

Nationalities ending in *-sh, -ch, -ese, -ss* (*the English, the French, the Dutch, the Chinese, the Japanese, the Swiss*) are plural: *The English **are** a practical people. The Japanese **are** hard-working.*

23.10 Subject and Complement

Rule 34: The verb agrees with the subject, not the complement

> **Rule 34.** A **linking verb** (*be, become, seem, remain*) agrees with its **subject** (the word before it in a normal statement), **not** with the complement (the word after it).

- Our only hope **is** your sons. (subject = *hope*)
- Your sons **are** our only hope. (subject = *sons*)
- The main problem **was** the floods.
- The floods **were** the main problem.
- His greatest strength **is** his teammates.
- Bad roads **are** the main cause of accidents.
- The main cause of accidents **is** bad roads.
- Books **are** my best friend.
- My best friend **is** books.

Rule 35: "It" as a dummy (anticipatory) subject → always singular

- It **is** the students who **are** protesting. (*It is* singular; *who are* agrees with *students*)
- It **was** the floods that **destroyed** the crops.
- It **is** they who **are** responsible.

23.11 Distributive, Partitive and Comparative Structures

Rule 36: *Kind of / sort of / type of*

> **Rule 36. This/That + kind (sort, type) of + singular noun + singular verb**; **These/Those + kinds (sorts, types) of + plural noun + plural verb**.

- This kind of book **is** useful. (✘ These kind of books are)
- These kinds of books **are** useful.
- That type of man **is** dangerous.
- Those types of men **are** dangerous.
- What sort of people **are** they?

In informal speech, "*these kind of things*" is common, but it is **wrong** in exams.

Rule 37: Comparisons do not change the subject

Words introduced by *than* or *as…as* do not affect the verb.

- My brother, more than my sisters, **likes** music.
- She is taller than her sisters **are**. (verb agrees with *sisters*)
- Rahim works harder than his friends **do**.
- He sings better than I **do**. (✘ better than me do)

Rule 38: *A great deal of / A large amount of / Much / Little / Less* → singular

- A great deal of money **has** been spent.
- A large amount of rice **is** wasted every year.
- Much water **has** flowed under the bridge.
- Little knowledge **is** a dangerous thing.
- Less work **is** required now.

Compare: *A large number of trees **were** cut down.* (countable → plural)

Rule 39: *Enough / Plenty / Lots / Heaps* → follow the noun

- Lots of food **is** available. / Lots of people **are** coming.
- Plenty of money **is** needed. / Plenty of jobs **are** available.
- Enough rice **is** stored. / Enough chairs **are** available.

23.12 Special Verb Forms Affecting Agreement

Rule 40: The subjunctive breaks the normal agreement

The **subjunctive mood** uses the **base form** of the verb (no -s) and **were** for all persons in unreal conditions. It is tested in GMAT, GRE and BCS.

(a) Unreal / hypothetical *were*:

- If I **were** a bird, I would fly. (✘ If I was a bird — informal)
- If he **were** rich, he would help the poor.
- I wish I **were** a king.
- He talks as if he **were** the owner.
- Suppose she **were** here, what would you say?

(b) Mandative (formal) subjunctive after verbs and expressions of demand, suggestion, order, necessity — *suggest, recommend, insist, demand, require, propose, request, order, urge, it is essential/necessary/important/vital/imperative that*:

- The teacher suggested that he **attend** the class regularly. (✘ attends)
- The doctor recommended that she **take** rest.
- It is essential that every student **submit** the form today.
- The court ordered that the prisoner **be** released.
- They demanded that the manager **resign**.
- I insist that he **leave** at once.
- It is important that she **be** present.

> **GMAT Corner:** After *require, demand, insist, recommend, suggest, request*, the GMAT expects the **bare subjunctive**: *"The law requires that every driver **carry** a licence"* — **not** *carries*, **not** *should carry* (often marked wordy) and **not** *to carry* after *that*. Also remember: *"require X to do"* (infinitive) is fine without *that*.

(c) Formulaic subjunctive in fixed wishes and prayers:

- God **bless** you. (✘ blesses)
- Long **live** Bangladesh! (✘ lives)
- God **save** the King.
- Heaven **help** us.
- Be that as it **may**…

Rule 41: Verb after *Let's / Let him* etc.

After *let*, the verb is in the bare form: *Let him **go**. Let them **come**. Let us **work** hard.* (✘ Let him goes.)

Rule 42: Verb after "*Who / What / Which*" as subjects in questions

Who and *what* used as subjects generally take a **singular** verb unless the answer is clearly expected to be plural.

- Who **is** there? (✘ Who are there — unless you know there are several persons)
- Who **are** those people?
- What **is** the matter?
- What **are** your plans? (subject = *your plans*)
- Which of these books **is** yours? (one book expected)
- Which of these books **are** yours? (more than one expected)

23.13 Pronoun–Antecedent Agreement

Agreement is not only between subject and verb. **A pronoun must also agree with the noun it refers to (its antecedent)** in number, person and gender. This topic is closely related and is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT, and in BCS "error detection" items.

Rule 43: Singular antecedent → singular pronoun

- Every student must bring **his or her** own pen. (formal)
- Each of the boys has done **his** duty. (✘ their duty in formal exams)
- Everyone should love **his** country. (traditional) / **their** country (modern, gender-neutral; accepted by SAT style rules today)
- Neither of the girls has finished **her** homework.
- Many a man has lost **his** life.
- One should do **one's** duty. (✘ one should do his duty in strict British usage; American English accepts *his*)

> **Singular "they":** Modern English (and the College Board/SAT) accepts *they/their* for an indefinite person: *Someone left **their** umbrella.* But a **collective noun used as a unit** or a **named thing** must not take *they*: ✘ *The company announced **their** profits.* ✔ *The company announced **its** profits.* In BCS and Bank exams, prefer the traditional *his / his or her* with *each, every, everyone, everybody, anybody, nobody*.

Rule 44: Compound antecedents

- Joined by *and* → plural pronoun: *Rahim and Karim did **their** best.*
- Joined by *or/nor* → nearest antecedent: *Neither the teacher nor the students raised **their** hands. Neither the students nor the teacher raised **his** hand.*
- *As well as / with* → first antecedent: *The captain, as well as the players, did **his** best.*

Rule 45: Collective antecedents

The pronoun must follow the same logic as the verb: *The jury **has** given **its** verdict. / The jury **are** divided in **their** opinions.* (Never: *The jury has given their verdict.*)

23.14 Agreement in Sentences with *There* and Compound Subjects

Rule 46: *There is / There are* with compound subjects

When a compound subject follows *there*, formal grammar uses a **plural** verb. However, many grammars and native speakers use a **singular** verb when the **first noun is singular** (proximity). For exam purposes:

- There **are** a pen and two pencils in the box. (formal / safest with *and*)
- There **is** a pen and two pencils in the box. (accepted informally — proximity)
- There **are** two pencils and a pen in the box. (first noun plural → plural, no debate)
- There **is** a lot of work to do.
- There **are** a lot of mistakes.
- There **is** no one in the room.
- There **is** no water in the bottle. / There **are** no books on the shelf.
- There **is** more than one reason. (*more than one* → singular)

Rule 47: Agreement in correlative sentences with *as well as* at the start

When *as well as* begins the sentence, the subject after it is still the main one:

- As well as his brother, Rahim **is** coming.
- Along with his friends, the boy **was** arrested.
- In addition to the manager, the clerks **were** absent.

23.15 Agreement of Tense and Number in Complex Sentences

Rule 48: Each clause has its own subject

In complex and compound sentences, **each verb agrees with its own subject**, not with the main subject of the sentence.

- The boy who **plays** the guitar **lives** next door.
- The man whose sons **are** doctors **is** my uncle.
- I know that the students **are** ready and that the teacher **is** coming.
- The book I gave to the girls **was** expensive.
- The girls I gave the book to **were** happy.

- Everyone thinks that the questions **were** difficult.

Rule 49: Parallel verbs share the same subject

When one subject has two or more verbs, **all** must agree.

- She **reads**, **writes** and **speaks** English fluently. (✘ She reads, write and speaks)
- The students **have** completed the work and **are** waiting for the results.
- He neither **drinks** nor **smokes**.

23.16 Miscellaneous Rules Frequently Tested in Bangladesh

Rule 50: *Each other / one another* do not affect agreement

They love each other. We help one another. The verb agrees with *they/we*.

Rule 51: *Nobody but / No one except / Nothing but* → singular

- Nobody but the teachers **was** present. (✘ were)
- No one except his parents **knows** the truth.
- Nothing but leaves **was** found on the tree.
- Nothing but trees **is** seen here.

Rule 52: *Not one of / Not a single* → singular

- Not one of the students **has** done the homework.
- Not a single tree **was** left standing.

Rule 53: Infinitive or bare verb after certain verbs

Verbs after *to* never change: *He wants **to go**.* (✘ to goes) After auxiliaries *do/does/did*, use the base form: *He **does not know**.* (✘ does not knows) *Did she **come**?* (✘ did she came) These are "agreement" errors frequently placed in Right-Form-of-Verb items.

Rule 54: *The* + *superlative* + plural noun + relative clause

*He is the best of all the players who **have** played here.* The relative clause refers to *players* (plural).

Rule 55: *Either / Neither* as determiners

Either and *neither* before a noun take a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**: *Neither answer **is** correct. Either side **is** acceptable.* (✘ Neither answers are correct.)

Rule 56: "*A* + adjective + *number / few / many*"

A good many / a great many / a few / a large number → plural. *A great deal / a large amount / a little / a good deal* → singular.

Rule 57: Distributive *every* with numbers

Every can be followed by a number and a plural noun to show regular intervals: *every two days, every three hours, every five years.* Here the time expression is usually an adverbial, not the subject, so the verb agrees with the real subject: *Every three hours, a bus **leaves** the terminal. The census **is** held every ten years.*

Rule 58: Double subjects with *and* in negative form

Not only… but also follows proximity (Rule 6). But "*X, and not Y*" follows **X** (Rule 5): *The students, and not the teacher, **are** responsible.*

Rule 59: Hyphenated compound adjectives do not take plural

A number used as part of a compound adjective before a noun stays singular: *a five-year plan* (✘ five-years plan), *a ten-taka note* (✘ ten-takas note), *a two-mile walk*, *a three-day tour*. This is closely related to agreement and is a very common BCS error item.

- He made a ten-minute speech. (✘ ten-minutes speech)
- She has a five-year-old son. (✘ five-years-old son)
- Bangladesh launched its first five-year plan in 1973.

Rule 60: Nouns of number after a numeral: *dozen, score, hundred, thousand, million, pair, stone, head (of cattle), gross*

When these words follow a definite number, they take **no -s**: *two dozen eggs, three hundred people, five thousand taka, four score years, ten head of cattle.* (✘ two dozens eggs). With *of* and no number, -s is used: *dozens of eggs, hundreds of people, thousands of taka.*

- Two dozen pens **were** bought.
- Three hundred students **are** taking the test.
- Dozens of people **were** injured.
- Millions of people **live** in Dhaka.

23.17 Common Error Patterns: Incorrect vs Correct

The following sentences show the errors that appear most often in Bangladeshi competitive exams and in the error-identification sections of the SAT and GMAT. Study the reason for each correction.

1. ✘ The news are very sad. ✔ The news **is** very sad. — *news* is singular.
2. ✘ Each of the students have a book. ✔ Each of the students **has** a book. — *each* is singular.
3. ✘ Neither of the two boys were present. ✔ Neither of the two boys **was** present.
4. ✘ One of my friend is a doctor. ✔ One of my **friends** is a doctor.
5. ✘ The number of students are increasing. ✔ The number of students **is** increasing.
6. ✘ A number of boys was absent. ✔ A number of boys **were** absent.
7. ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a **boy** **was** present.
8. ✘ The police has arrested the thief. ✔ The police **have** arrested the thief.
9. ✘ The cattle is grazing. ✔ The cattle **are** grazing.
10. ✘ Mathematics are a difficult subject. ✔ Mathematics **is** a difficult subject.
11. ✘ The teacher as well as his students were present. ✔ … **was** present.
12. ✘ Either Rahim or his brothers has done it. ✔ … **have** done it.
13. ✘ Neither he nor I are guilty. ✔ Neither he nor I **am** guilty.
14. ✘ It is I who is to blame. ✔ It is I who **am** to blame.
15. ✘ He is one of the best boys who has ever studied here. ✔ … who **have** ever studied here.
16. ✘ He is the only one of the boys who have passed. ✔ … who **has** passed.
17. ✘ Bread and butter are his daily food. ✔ Bread and butter **is** his daily food.
18. ✘ Slow and steady win the race. ✔ Slow and steady **wins** the race.
19. ✘ The poet and the philosopher is dead. ✔ … **are** dead. (two persons) / The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one person)

20. ✘ Every boy and girl were present. ✔ Every boy and girl **was** present.
21. ✘ Ten miles are a long distance. ✔ Ten miles **is** a long distance.
22. ✘ The Arabian Nights are a famous book. ✔ The Arabian Nights **is** a famous book.
23. ✘ The rich is not always happy. ✔ The rich **are** not always happy.
24. ✘ My trouser is torn. ✔ My **trousers are** torn.
25. ✘ A pair of shoes were bought. ✔ A pair of shoes **was** bought.
26. ✘ The furnitures are expensive. ✔ The **furniture is** expensive.
27. ✘ He gave me many advices. ✔ He gave me **much advice / many pieces of advice**.
28. ✘ The criteria is unclear. ✔ The criteria **are** unclear.
29. ✘ These kind of books are useful. ✔ **This kind of book is** useful. / **These kinds of books are** useful.
30. ✘ Everybody have done their duty. ✔ Everybody **has** done **his/his or her** duty.
31. ✘ More than one boys were absent. ✔ More than one **boy was** absent.
32. ✘ Two-thirds of the city are flooded. ✔ Two-thirds of the city **is** flooded.
33. ✘ Most of the milk have gone bad. ✔ Most of the milk **has** gone bad.
34. ✘ There is many mistakes in the letter. ✔ There **are** many mistakes in the letter.
35. ✘ Where is my glasses? ✔ Where **are** my glasses?
36. ✘ The quality of the products are poor. ✔ The quality of the products **is** poor.
37. ✘ The committee have submitted its report. ✔ The committee **has** submitted its report.
38. ✘ If I was a king, I would help the poor. ✔ If I **were** a king, …
39. ✘ I suggested that he goes home. ✔ I suggested that he **go** home.
40. ✘ He has a ten-years-old son. ✔ He has a **ten-year-old** son.
41. ✘ Two dozens eggs were bought. ✔ Two **dozen** eggs were bought.
42. ✘ The people is happy. ✔ The people **are** happy.
43. ✘ Either of these five roads lead to the city. ✔ **Any one** of these five roads **leads** to the city.
44. ✘ Nobody but the boys were punished. ✔ Nobody but the boys **was** punished.
45. ✘ What he says are true. ✔ What he says **is** true.
46. ✘ Long lives Bangladesh! ✔ Long **live** Bangladesh!
47. ✘ The leader, with his followers, were arrested. ✔ … **was** arrested.
48. ✘ Physics are my favourite subject. ✔ Physics **is** my favourite subject.
49. ✘ The sheeps are grazing. ✔ The **sheep** are grazing.
50. ✘ Measles are a contagious disease. ✔ Measles **is** a contagious disease.

23.18 A Step-by-Step Method for Any Agreement Question

When you face any agreement item in an exam, follow these steps in order:

1. **Find the verb(s)** in the sentence. Underline every finite verb (*is, are, was, were, has, have, does, do* and present-tense main verbs).
2. **Find the true subject** of each verb. Cross out prepositional phrases (*of…, in…, with…*), appositives and relative clauses. Look *after* the verb in sentences beginning with *There/Here*, in questions and in inverted sentences.
3. **Check the joining words.** *And* → usually plural (but check Rules 2, 3, 4). *Or/nor/either…or/neither…nor/not only…but also* → nearer subject. *As well as/with/along with/together with/besides* → first subject.
4. **Check special words.** Is the subject an indefinite pronoun (each, every, either, neither, everyone, none, all, some, most)? A collective noun? A noun of the *news/mathematics/measles* type? An uncountable noun? A *people/police/cattle* type noun? A Latin plural?
5. **Check amounts and titles.** Money, time, distance and weight as one sum → singular. Titles of books and names of countries → singular. Fractions → follow the noun after *of*.
6. **Check the relative clause.** *Who/which/that* → agrees with its antecedent (and in person: *I who am, you who are*). *One of the … who* → plural; *the only one of the … who* → singular.
7. **Check the mood.** *If I were / I wish I were*; mandative *that he go / that she be*; *Long live, God bless*.
8. **Check the pronouns.** A pronoun referring back to the subject must match it (*the committee … its; each … his*).

> **Final Advice:** Read the sentence **aloud in your mind without the extra words**. *"The box ~~of old and rusty iron nails~~ is heavy."* Once the "noise" is removed, the correct agreement becomes obvious. This single habit will solve more than half of all agreement questions in BCS, Bank, admission, SAT, GRE and GMAT papers.

CHAPTER 24

Comparison & Degree of Comparison

Part A · Grammar

24.1 Degrees of Comparison

Adjectives and adverbs change their form to show **how much** of a quality something has compared with something else. These forms are called **degrees of comparison**. There are three:

Degree	Use	Example
Positive	the simple quality; or equality between two (*as … as*)	*Rahim is **tall**. Rahim is **as tall as** Karim.*
Comparative	a higher (or lower) degree between **two** persons/things or groups	*Rahim is **taller than** Karim.*
Superlative	the highest (or lowest) degree among **three or more**	*Rahim is **the tallest** boy in the class.*

24.2 Formation of Comparatives and Superlatives

24.2.1 Regular Comparison

Rule	Positive → Comparative → Superlative
One-syllable words: add ***-er / -est***	tall → taller → tallest; great → greater → greatest; small → smaller → smallest
Ending in *-e*: add ***-r / -st***	wise → wiser → wisest; large → larger → largest; brave → braver → bravest
Short vowel + one consonant: **double** the consonant	big → bigger → biggest; hot → hotter → hottest; thin → thinner → thinnest; sad → sadder → saddest; fat → fatter → fattest
Consonant + *y*: change *y* to ***i***	happy → happier → happiest; easy → easier → easiest; heavy → heavier → heaviest; dry → drier → driest
Vowel + *y*: keep *y*	gay → gayer → gayest; grey → greyer → greyest
Two-syllable words ending in *-y, -ow, -le, -er, -et*: usually ***-er / -est***	narrow → narrower; simple → simpler; clever → cleverer; quiet → quieter; gentle → gentler; humble → humbler
Most other two-syllable words and all longer words: ***more / most***	careful → more careful → most careful; beautiful → more beautiful → most beautiful; intelligent → more intelligent → most intelligent; famous → more famous → most famous
Adverbs in *-ly*: ***more / most***	quickly → more quickly → most quickly; carefully → more carefully
Lower degree: ***less / least***	important → less important → least important

> Some two-syllable words take either form: *common – commoner / more common; polite – politer / more polite; pleasant – pleasanter / more pleasant; stupid – stupider / more stupid*. Adjectives ending in *-ed, -ing, -ful, -less, -ous, -ish, -ive* always take *more/most*: *more tired, more boring, more useful, more famous, more active*. (✘ tireder, ✘ usefuller)

24.2.2 Irregular Comparison

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Notes
good / well	better	best	
bad / ill / badly	worse	worst	
much / many	more	most	*much* (uncountable), *many* (countable)
little	less / lesser	least	*lesser* = smaller in importance (*the lesser evil*)
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest	*farther* = distance; *further* = additional (and distance)
old	older / elder	oldest / eldest	*elder/eldest* for family members, attributive only
late	later / latter	latest / last	*later/latest* = time; *latter/last* = order
near	nearer	nearest / next	*nearest* = distance; *next* = order
fore	former	foremost / first	
in	inner	innermost / inmost	
out	outer / utter	outermost / utmost / uttermost	
up	upper	uppermost / upmost	
hind	hinder	hindmost	
top	—	topmost	

24.3 Rules for the Positive Degree

Rule 1 — Equality: *as* + *positive* + *as*.

- Karim is **as tall as** Rahim.
- She sings **as sweetly as** a nightingale.
- This book is **as interesting as** that one.

Rule 2 — Inequality in the negative: *not so / not as* + *positive* + *as*. Traditional grammar prefers ***so*** in the negative.

- Karim is **not so tall as** Rahim. (also *not as tall as*)
- ✘ Karim is so tall as Rahim. (positive sentence must use *as … as*)

Rule 3 — Multiples and fractions: *twice / three times / half* + *as … as*.

- This road is **twice as long as** that one.
- My house is **half as big as** yours.
- ✘ twice longer than (avoid in formal tests)

Rule 4 — *As many as / as much as* (countable / uncountable).

- He has **as many** books **as** I (have).
- She earns **as much** money **as** her husband.

24.4 Rules for the Comparative Degree

Rule 5 — Comparative + *than*.

- Gold is **heavier than** silver.
- Rina is **more intelligent than** Mina.
- He works **harder than** I (do).

Rule 6 — Never use a double comparative.

- ✘ He is **more taller** than me. ✔ He is **taller** than I.
- ✘ This is **more better**. ✔ This is **better**.
- ✘ **more worse**, ✘ **more easier**, ✘ **more cleverer**

Rule 7 — To intensify a comparative, use *much, far, still, even, a lot, a little, rather, considerably, a great deal, by far* — not *very*.

- He is **much better** today. (✘ very better)
- This is **far more expensive**.
- She is tall, but her sister is **even taller**.

Rule 8 — *Than any other* + singular / *than all other* + plural, when the subject belongs to the same group.

The subject must be **excluded** from the group it is compared with; otherwise it is compared with itself.

- ✘ Rahim is taller than any boy in the class. (Rahim is also a boy in the class!)
- ✔ Rahim is taller than **any other boy** in the class.
- ✔ Rahim is taller than **all other boys** in the class.
- ✔ Dhaka is bigger than **any other city** in Bangladesh.
- ✔ Dhaka is bigger than **any city** in India. (different group → no *other*)

Rule 9 — Comparison between two: *the* + comparative + *of the two*.

- Rahim is **the taller of the two** brothers. (✘ the tallest of the two)
- Which is **the better of the two** books?

Rule 10 — Parallel increase: *the* + comparative …, *the* + comparative.

- **The more** you read, **the more** you learn.
- **The higher** you climb, **the colder** it becomes.
- **The sooner, the better. The more, the merrier.**

Rule 11 — Gradual change: comparative + *and* + comparative.

- It is getting **colder and colder**.
- The situation is becoming **more and more** serious. (✘ more serious and more serious)

Rule 12 — Compare like with like (logical comparison). Use *that of / those of* or a possessive.

- ✘ The climate of Sylhet is cooler than Dhaka. ✔ … cooler than **that of** Dhaka.
- ✘ The streets of Dhaka are busier than Rajshahi. ✔ … busier than **those of** Rajshahi.
- ✘ My pen is better than Rahim. ✔ My pen is better than **Rahim's**.

Rule 13 — Case after *than* and *as*: subjective if a verb is understood.

- He is taller than **I** (am). (✘ than me — in exams)
- I like you more than **him**. (= more than I like him) / I like you more than **he** (does).

Rule 14 — Latin comparatives take *to*, not *than* (Chapter 10): *superior to, inferior to, senior to, junior to, prior to, preferable to; prefer … to.*

Rule 15 — *Less* with uncountables, *fewer* with plurals (Chapter 03): *less sugar, fewer mistakes*.

Rule 16 — Comparatives with *other than, else than, rather than*.

- He has no other friend **than** you.
- I would **rather** walk **than** take a rickshaw.

Rule 17 — *More of a* + noun (degree of a quality expressed by a noun): *He is **more of a** poet **than** a scientist.*

24.5 Rules for the Superlative Degree

Rule 18 — *The* + superlative + *of / in* (three or more).

- Rahim is **the tallest** boy **in** the class. (*in* + place/group)
- He is **the best of** all the players. (*of* + plural)
- This is **the most interesting** book I have ever read.

Rule 19 — *One of the* + superlative + plural noun.

- Dhaka is **one of the most crowded cities** in the world. (✘ city)
- He is **one of the best students** in the class.

Rule 20 — *A most* = very (not a real superlative).

- She is **a most** beautiful lady. (= a very beautiful lady)
- It was **a most** interesting story.

Rule 21 — No double superlatives.

- ✘ the **most** cleverest ✔ the **cleverest**
- ✘ the **most** best ✔ the **best**

Rule 22 — Superlative with ordinals: *the second / third largest*.

- Chattogram is **the second largest** city in Bangladesh.

Rule 23 — Absolute (non-gradable) adjectives are not compared. *Unique, perfect, complete, round, square, empty, full, dead, ideal, infinite, eternal, universal, supreme, extreme, chief, matchless, impossible, entire, total, final, absolute.*

- ✘ This is the **most unique** painting. ✔ This is a **unique** painting.
- ✘ more perfect, ✘ most perfect → ✔ perfect, nearly perfect
- ✘ The earth is rounder than … ✔ The earth is **round** / more nearly round …
- ✘ It was the most fatal accident of the year. ✔ It was the **worst** accident of the year / a **fatal** accident.

Rule 24 — Superlatives can be used without a comparison for emphasis, sometimes with *ever*: *This is **the best** day **ever**. With **the greatest** pleasure.*

24.6 Transformation of Degree (Changing One Degree to Another)

This is a regular question in SSC, HSC, admission and BCS Written. The **meaning must stay the same**.

24.6.1 Superlative → Comparative → Positive (Single Highest)

Degree	Pattern	Example
Superlative	X is **the + superlative** + noun **in/of** …	*Rahim is **the tallest** boy in the class.*
Comparative	X is **comparative than any other** + singular noun … / **than all other** + plural	*Rahim is **taller than any other** boy in the class.*

Degree	Pattern	Example
Positive	**No other** + singular noun … is **so / as** + positive **as** X	***No other*** *boy in the class is* ***as tall as*** *Rahim.*

- Superlative: *Dhaka is the largest city in Bangladesh.*
- Comparative: *Dhaka is larger than any other city in Bangladesh.*
- Positive: *No other city in Bangladesh is as large as Dhaka.*
- Superlative: *Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.*
- Comparative: *Mount Everest is higher than any other peak in the world.*
- Positive: *No other peak in the world is as high as Mount Everest.*
- Superlative: *Honesty is the best policy.*
- Comparative: *Honesty is better than any other policy.*
- Positive: *No other policy is as good as honesty.*

24.6.2 *One of the* + Superlative

Degree	Pattern	Example
Superlative	X is **one of the** + superlative + plural	*Nazrul is* ***one of the greatest*** *poets of Bangladesh.*
Comparative	X is **comparative than most other** + plural	*Nazrul is* ***greater than most other*** *poets of Bangladesh.*
Positive	**Very few** + plural … are **so / as** + positive **as** X	***Very few*** *poets of Bangladesh are* ***as great as*** *Nazrul.*

- Superlative: *Shakespeare is one of the greatest dramatists in the world.*
- Comparative: *Shakespeare is greater than most other dramatists in the world.*
- Positive: *Very few dramatists in the world are as great as Shakespeare.*

24.6.3 Comparative ↔ Positive (Two Things)

Comparative	Positive
Rahim is ***taller than*** *Karim.*	*Karim is* ***not so / as tall as*** *Rahim.*
Gold is ***more precious than*** *silver.*	*Silver is* ***not so precious as*** *gold.*
I am ***older than*** *you.*	*You are* ***not so old as*** *I.*
He is ***not taller than*** *his brother.*	*His brother is* ***at least as tall as*** *he.*

24.6.4 Positive *as … as* ↔ Comparative *no / not less … than*

- Positive: *Rina is* ***as beautiful as*** *Mina.*
- Comparative: *Mina is* ***not more beautiful than*** *Rina.* / *Rina is* ***no less beautiful than*** *Mina.*
- Positive: *He is* ***as wise as*** *Solomon.*
- Comparative: *Solomon is* ***not wiser than*** *he.*

24.6.5 Superlative with *Not* or Negative Meaning

- Superlative: *He is* ***not the best*** *student in the class.*
- Comparative: *Some students in the class are* ***better than*** *he.*
- Positive: *He is* ***not so good as*** *some other students in the class.*
- Superlative: *Iron is the most useful of all metals.*
- Comparative: *Iron is more useful than any other metal.*
- Positive: *No other metal is as useful as iron.*

24.6.6 Using *Few / Some* and Groups

- Superlative: *Kolkata is one of the oldest cities in India.*
- Comparative: *Kolkata is older than most other cities in India.*
- Positive: *Very few cities in India are as old as Kolkata.*

> **Exam Tip — Check three things after transformation:** (1) Did you add ***other*** in the comparative and positive forms when the subject belongs to the group? (2) Did you change the noun to **singular** after *any other* and *no other*, and to **plural** after *all other, most other, very few*? (3) Is the **meaning** unchanged?

24.7 Some Special Points

24.7.1 *Elder / Older, Eldest / Oldest*

- *elder / eldest* — used for members of the **same family**, attributively, and **not followed by *than***: *my* ***elder*** *brother, my* ***eldest*** *son.*
- *older / oldest* — used for persons and things in general, and with *than*: *He is* ***older than*** *I. This is the* ***oldest*** *building in Dhaka.*

24.7.2 *Later / Latter, Latest / Last*

- *later / latest* = time: *I will come* ***later****. What is the* ***latest*** *news?*
- *latter / last* = order: *Of tea and coffee, I prefer the* ***latter****. This is the* ***last*** *chapter.*

24.7.3 *Farther / Further, Nearest / Next*

- *farther* = distance; *further* = additional (and distance): *Dhaka is* ***farther*** *than Gazipur. I need* ***further*** *information.*
- *nearest* = distance; *next* = order: *the* ***nearest*** *hospital; the* ***next*** *bus.*

24.7.4 *Less / Lesser*

- *less* = smaller amount (comparative of *little*): *less money.*
- *lesser* = smaller in importance (attributive only): *the* ***lesser*** *of two evils; a* ***lesser*** *poet.*

24.7.5 *Comparative* Adjectives Without *Than*

Some comparatives are used without any comparison: *the* ***upper*** *class, the* ***lower*** *court,* ***higher*** *education, the* ***younger*** *generation,* ***inner*** *meaning, the* ***former*** *prime minister,* ***further*** *studies.*

24.8 Common Errors in Comparison

1. ✘ He is more stronger than me. ✔ He is **stronger** than I.
2. ✘ She is the most cleverest girl. ✔ She is the **cleverest** girl.
3. ✘ He is the tallest of the two brothers. ✔ He is the **taller** of the two brothers.
4. ✘ Rahim is taller than any boy in the class. ✔ … than any **other** boy in the class.
5. ✘ No boy in the class is as tall as Rahim. (Rahim is in the class) ✔ **No other** boy in the class …
6. ✘ He is one of the best student. ✔ He is one of the best **students**.
7. ✘ The population of Dhaka is larger than Khulna. ✔ … larger than **that of** Khulna.
8. ✘ He is very taller than his brother. ✔ He is **much** taller than his brother.
9. ✘ He is elder than me. ✔ He is **older** than I.
10. ✘ This is the most unique design. ✔ This is a **unique** design.
11. ✘ He is so tall as his father. ✔ He is **as** tall **as** his father.
12. ✘ He is superior than me. ✔ He is superior **to** me.
13. ✘ The more you earn, more you spend. ✔ **The** more you earn, **the** more you spend.

14. ✘ What is the last news? ✔ What is the **latest** news?
15. ✘ I have less friends than you. ✔ I have **fewer** friends than you.
16. ✘ He is better than all students. ✔ He is better than **all other** students.
17. ✘ It is getting more cold and more cold. ✔ It is getting **colder and colder**.
18. ✘ Iron is more useful than any metal. ✔ … than any **other** metal.
19. ✘ This road is twice longer than that. ✔ This road is **twice as long as** that.
20. ✘ My house is bigger than Karim. ✔ My house is bigger than **Karim's**.
21. ✘ He is more cleverer than wise. ✔ He is **more clever than wise**. (comparing two qualities of the same person → *more* + positive)
22. ✘ She is wiser than beautiful. ✔ She is **more wise than beautiful**.
23. ✘ He is the most perfect gentleman. ✔ He is a **perfect** gentleman.
24. ✘ Chattogram is the second large city. ✔ Chattogram is the **second largest** city.
25. ✘ He is taller than me. (exam style) ✔ He is taller than **I**.

> **Comparing two qualities of the same person (Rule in errors 21–22):** When two qualities of **one** thing are compared, use ***more* + positive** for both, even for short adjectives: *He is **more brave than wise***. (✘ braver than wise)

24.9 Comparison in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Comparison is one of the **top three error types** in GMAT Sentence Correction and appears regularly in SAT Writing.

1. **Illogical comparison (apples vs oranges):** ✘ *The salary of a doctor is higher than a teacher.* ✔ *… higher than **that of** a teacher* / *than **a teacher's***. ✘ *Like many developing nations, Bangladesh's economy relies on exports.* ✔ *Like **those of** many developing nations, Bangladesh's economy relies on exports* / *Like many developing nations, **Bangladesh** relies on exports.*
2. **Like vs as:** *like* + noun (*Like her mother, she is a doctor*); *as* + clause (*She practises medicine, **as** her mother did*).
3. **Comparison words must be complete:** *as … as, more … than, less … than.* ✘ *as good or better than* ✔ *as good **as** or better than.*
4. **Superlatives for three or more, comparatives for two:** ✘ *the most efficient of the two plans* ✔ *the **more** efficient of the two plans.*
5. **Quantity comparisons:** *more / fewer* (countable), *more / less* (uncountable); *as many as* (countable), *as much as* (uncountable). ✘ *a greater number of water* ✔ *a greater **amount** of water*; ✘ *less cars* ✔ ***fewer** cars.*
6. **Different from (✔) / different than (avoid in GMAT)**.
7. **"Than" with complete parallel structure:** ✘ *She likes reading more than to write.* ✔ *She likes **reading** more than **writing**.*

CHAPTER 25

Conditional

Part A · Grammar

25.1 What Is a Conditional Sentence?

A **conditional sentence** says that **one thing depends on another**. It has two parts:

1. the **if-clause** (the **condition**, also called the *protasis*), and
2. the **main clause** (the **result**, also called the *apodosis*).

- **If it rains**, *we will stay at home.* (condition → result)
- *We will stay at home* **if it rains**. (the order can change; use a comma only when the *if*-clause comes first)

The **tense** used in each clause shows **how real or unreal** the condition is and **what time** it refers to. This is why conditionals are tested in Right Form of Verbs, error detection, sentence completion and transformation in all our exams, and are a favourite of GMAT Sentence Correction.

25.2 The Main Types of Conditionals

Type	Meaning	*If*-clause	Main clause	Example
Zero	general truth, always true	Present simple	Present simple	*If you heat ice, it **melts**.*
First	real / likely future	Present simple	*will / shall / can / may* + V1	*If it **rains**, we **will stay** home.*
Second	unreal present / unlikely future	Past simple (*were* for *be*)	*would / could / might* + V1	*If I **were** rich, I **would buy** a car.*
Third	unreal past (impossible now)	Past perfect	*would / could / might + have* + V3	*If he **had worked** hard, he **would have passed**.*
Mixed	past condition → present result, or vice versa	Past perfect / Past	*would* + V1 / *would have* + V3	*If I **had taken** the medicine, I **would be** well now.*

25.3 Zero Conditional — General Truths

***If* + present simple, present simple.** The result **always** follows the condition. *If* can be replaced by *when / whenever*.

- If you heat water to 100 °C, it **boils**.
- If you mix red and yellow, you **get** orange.
- If people don't eat, they **die**.
- If I **drink** coffee at night, I **can't** sleep. (personal habit)
- If you **press** this button, the machine **stops**.

25.4 First Conditional — Real or Likely Future

***If* + present simple, *will / shall / can / may / must* + V1** (or an imperative).

- If you **work** hard, you **will pass**.
- If it **rains** tomorrow, the match **will be** cancelled.
- If he **comes**, I **shall tell** him. (traditional *shall* with *I*)
- If you **need** help, **call** me. (imperative result)
- If you **are** tired, you **may** go home.
- If you **want** to succeed, you **must** work hard.

> **No *will* in the *if*-clause.** The *if*-clause uses the **present** even though it refers to the future. ✘ *If it will rain, we will stay home.* ✔ *If it **rains**, we will stay home.*
>
> **Exceptions:** *will* is possible in the *if*-clause when it means **willingness** or **insistence**: *If you **will** help me, I'll be grateful* (= if you are willing to). *If you **will** keep eating junk food, of course you'll get fat* (= if you insist on).

25.4.1 *Unless = If … not*

Unless means *if … not* and is used mainly in **first** (and zero) conditionals. It must not be followed by another *not*.

- **Unless** you work hard, you will fail. = **If** you do **not** work hard, you will fail.
- **Unless** it rains, the crops will die.
- ✘ Unless you do not hurry, you will miss the bus. ✔ **Unless** you hurry, you will miss the bus.

25.5 Second Conditional — Unreal Present or Unlikely Future

***If* + past simple, *would / could / might* + V1.** The past tense here does **not** refer to the past; it shows that the situation is **imaginary** (contrary to present fact) or **unlikely** in the future.

- If I **had** wings, I **would fly**. (I don't have wings.)
- If I **were** a king, I **would help** the poor. (I am not a king.)
- If he **knew** her address, he **would write** to her. (He doesn't know it.)
- If I **won** the lottery, I **would travel** round the world. (unlikely)
- If you **studied** harder, you **could get** a scholarship.

> ***Were* for all persons:** In the second conditional, the formal form of *be* is ***were*** for **all** subjects: *If I **were** you … If he **were** here … If it **were** possible …* (*If I was* is common in informal speech, but in exams and GMAT choose ***were***.)

25.5.1 *If I were you* — Giving Advice

- **If I were you**, I would accept the offer.
- **If I were in your place**, I would not go.

25.5.2 *Were to* — Hypothetical Future

***If* + subject + *were to* + V1** makes a future event seem **very unlikely or imaginary**:

- If the sun **were to** rise in the west, I would not change my mind.
- If war **were to** break out, millions would suffer.

25.6 Third Conditional — Unreal Past

***If* + past perfect, *would / could / might + have* + V3.** It describes an **imaginary past** — what would have happened if the past had been different. It often expresses **regret** or **criticism**.

- If he **had worked** hard, he **would have passed**. (He did not work hard; he failed.)
- If I **had known** your address, I **would have visited** you.
- If you **had left** earlier, you **could have caught** the train.

- If it **had not rained**, we **might have won** the match.
- If the doctor **had come** in time, the patient **would not have died**.

> **No *would have* in the *if*-clause.** ✘ *If I would have known, I would have come.* ✔ *If I **had known**, I would have come.* ✘ *If he would have studied …* ✔ *If he **had studied** …*

25.7 Mixed Conditionals

Sometimes the condition and the result refer to **different times**.

(a) Past condition → present result: *If* + past perfect, *would* + V1.

- If I **had taken** the medicine yesterday, I **would be** well now.
- If he **had studied** medicine, he **would be** a doctor today.
- If we **had left** earlier, we **would be** there by now.

(b) Present (permanent) condition → past result: *If* + past simple, *would have* + V3.

- If I **were** not afraid of flying, I **would have gone** to London last year.
- If he **were** more careful, he **would not have had** that accident.
- If she **spoke** English, she **would have got** the job.

25.8 Conditionals without *If*: Inversion

In formal English, ***if*** can be omitted and the auxiliary ***had, were*** or ***should*** placed before the subject (Chapter 16.4).

With *if*	Inverted (without *if*)
If I **had** known …	**Had** I known …
If I **were** you …	**Were** I you …
If he **were to** come …	**Were** he **to** come …
If you **should** need help …	**Should** you need help …
If it **had not been** for you …	**Had** it **not** been for you …
If it **were not** for his help …	**Were** it **not** for his help …

- **Had** you told me, I would have helped you.
- **Were** I in your position, I would resign.
- **Should** you see him, give him my regards.
- ✘ Hadn't he helped me, I would have failed. ✔ **Had he not** helped me, I would have failed.

25.9 Other Words and Expressions That Introduce Conditions

Expression	Meaning	Example
unless	if … not	*Unless you hurry, you'll miss the bus.*
provided (that) / providing (that)	only if	*You can go **provided** you finish your homework.*
on condition that	only if (formal)	*He agreed **on condition that** his name would not be published.*
as long as / so long as	only if; while	*You can borrow it **as long as** you return it tomorrow.*
in case	as a precaution against the possibility that	*Take an umbrella **in case** it rains.* (✘ in case it will rain)
suppose / supposing	imagine that	***Suppose** you won the lottery, what would you do?*
assuming (that) / given (that)	if we accept that	***Assuming** that the train is on time, we'll arrive at noon.*
in the event that / in the event of	if (formal)	***In the event of** fire, use the stairs.*
even if	whether or not	***Even if** it rains, I will go.*
only if	in that one case	*I will go **only if** you come with me.* (inversion if fronted: ***Only if** you come **will I** go.*)
if only	strong wish / regret	***If only** I had listened to you!*
but for + noun	if it were not for / if it had not been for	***But for** your help, I would have failed.*
without + noun	if there were not / had not been	***Without** water, no one could live.*
otherwise / or (else)	if not	*Work hard; **otherwise** you will fail.*
whether … or not	in either case	*I'll go **whether** it rains **or not**.*

25.9.1 *But for* and *Without*

But for + **noun** (never a clause) replaces an *if*-clause in the **second** or **third** conditional:

- **But for** your help, I **would have failed**. = If you **had not helped** me, I would have failed. = **Had it not been for** your help, I would have failed.
- **But for** the sun, there **would be** no life on earth. = If it **were not for** the sun, …
- ✘ But for you helped me … ✔ But for **your help** …

25.9.2 *In case* vs *If*

If = the result happens **only** when the condition happens. ***In case*** = we do something **now, as a precaution**, because the condition **might** happen.

- I'll buy food **if** guests come. (I'll buy only when they come.)
- I'll buy food **in case** guests come. (I'll buy now, just in case.)

25.10 Implied Conditionals

Sometimes the condition is **not stated** as a clause but is **implied** by a phrase, an imperative, an infinitive or the context.

- **Work hard, and** you will succeed. (= If you work hard, you will succeed.)
- **Hurry up, or** you will miss the train. (= If you don't hurry …)
- **With a little more money**, we could buy a house. (= If we had a little more money …)
- **To hear him speak**, you would think he was a king. (= If you heard him speak …)
- I would have helped him, **but** he didn't ask me. (= If he had asked me …)
- **A true friend** would not desert you. (= If he were a true friend …)

25.11 *Wish* and *If only*

Wish and ***if only*** use the same "backshifted" tenses as unreal conditionals:

Wish about	Form	Example
the present (unreal)	*wish / if only* + past simple (*were*)	*I wish I **knew** his number. If only I **were** taller!*
the past (regret)	*wish / if only* + past perfect	*I wish I **had studied** harder. If only he **had listened**!*
the future / annoying habit / someone else's action	*wish / if only* + *would* + V1	*I wish it **would** stop raining. I wish you **would** stop talking.*
ability	*wish* + *could*	*I wish I **could** swim.*

- ✘ I wish I am rich. ✔ I wish I **were** rich.
- ✘ I wish I studied harder last year. ✔ I wish I **had studied** harder last year.
- ✘ I wish I would be a doctor. ✔ I wish I **were / could be** a doctor. (*would* after *wish* is not used for the subject's own state)

25.12 Modal Verbs in Conditionals

The main clause can contain modals other than *will/would* to add meaning:

- If you finish early, you **can** go home. (permission)
- If it rains, the match **may** be postponed. (possibility)
- If you want to pass, you **must** study. (necessity)
- If I had a car, I **could** drive you home. (ability — unreal)
- If he had run faster, he **might have** won. (possibility — unreal past)
- If you are ill, you **should** see a doctor. (advice)

25.13 Transformation of Conditional Sentences

Original	Transformed
If you do not work hard, you will fail.	***Unless** you work hard, you will fail. / Work hard, **or** you will fail. / Work hard; **otherwise**, you will fail.*
If I were rich, I would help the poor.	***Were** I rich, I would help the poor. / I am not rich, **so** I cannot help the poor.*
If he had come, I would have met him.	***Had** he come, I would have met him. / He did not come, **so** I did not meet him.*
If it had not been for your advice, I would have failed.	***But for** your advice, I would have failed. / **Without** your advice, I would have failed.*
As he was ill, he could not attend.	*If he **had not been** ill, he **could have** attended.*
Should you need help, call me.	***If** you need help, call me.*

25.14 Common Errors in Conditionals

1. ✘ If it will rain, we shall stay home. ✔ If it **rains**, we shall stay home.
2. ✘ If I was a bird, I would fly. ✔ If I **were** a bird, I would fly.
3. ✘ If he would come, I would be happy. ✔ If he **came**, I would be happy.
4. ✘ If I would have known, I would have come. ✔ If I **had known**, I would have come.
5. ✘ If he had worked hard, he would pass. ✔ … he **would have passed**.
6. ✘ If you will work hard, you will succeed. ✔ If you **work** hard, you will succeed.
7. ✘ Unless you do not study, you will fail. ✔ **Unless** you study, you will fail.
8. ✘ Had I know it, I would have told you. ✔ Had I **known** it, …
9. ✘ Hadn't he come, we would have lost. ✔ **Had he not** come, we would have lost.
10. ✘ But for he helped me, I would have died. ✔ But for **his help**, I would have died.
11. ✘ If I am you, I would not go. ✔ If I **were** you, I would not go.
12. ✘ If he studied hard last year, he would have passed. ✔ If he **had studied** hard last year, …
13. ✘ Take your umbrella in case it will rain. ✔ … in case it **rains**.
14. ✘ I wish I was a doctor. ✔ I wish I **were** a doctor.
15. ✘ If you heat ice, it will melt. (general truth) ✔ If you heat ice, it **melts**. (zero conditional preferred for scientific facts; *will melt* is acceptable as a prediction)
16. ✘ Were I knew the answer, I would tell you. ✔ **If I knew** the answer, I would tell you.
17. ✘ Should you will need money, ask me. ✔ **Should you need** money, ask me.
18. ✘ If I had been rich, I would buy a car now. ✔ If I **were** rich, I **would buy** a car now. / If I had been rich last year, I would have bought a car.
19. ✘ Work hard, otherwise you fail. ✔ Work hard; otherwise you **will** fail.
20. ✘ If only I have listened to my father! ✔ If only I **had listened** to my father!

25.15 Conditionals in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **GMAT's conditional rules:**
  - *If* + present → *will* + V1 (✘ *would*).
  - *If* + past → *would* + V1 (✘ *will*).
  - *If* + past perfect → *would have* + V3.
  - **Never** *would* in the *if*-clause: ✘ *If the government would lower taxes, investment would rise.* ✔ *If the government **lowered** taxes, …*
- ***If* vs *whether*:** *If* introduces conditions; *whether* introduces alternatives. ✘ *The analysts are unsure if the merger will succeed.* GMAT prefers ✔ *… unsure **whether** the merger will succeed.*
- **Subjunctive *were*:** GMAT accepts only ***were*** in hypothetical *if*-clauses (*If the company **were** to …*).
- **GRE Critical Reasoning / GMAT CR:** Conditional logic — *if A then B* does **not** mean *if B then A*. *Only if A, B* means *B → A*. *Unless A, B* means *if not A, then B*. Mastering these is essential for "must be true" and "assumption" questions.

CHAPTER 26

Voice

Part A · Grammar

26.1 What Is Voice?

Voice is the form of a verb that shows whether the **subject does the action** or **receives the action**.

- **Active voice:** the subject **acts** (is the doer). *Rahim **wrote** a letter.*
- **Passive voice:** the subject **is acted upon** (is the receiver). *A letter **was written** by Rahim.*

› **Active:** The cat killed the rat.
› **Passive:** The rat was killed by the cat.
› **Active:** People speak English all over the world.
› **Passive:** English is spoken all over the world.

26.1.1 When Is the Passive Used?

1. When the **doer is unknown**: *My bicycle **has been stolen**.*
2. When the **doer is obvious or unimportant**: *The thief **was arrested**.* (by the police — obvious)
3. When we want to **focus on the action or the receiver**: *The Padma Bridge **was opened** in 2022.*
4. In **formal, scientific and official writing**: *The solution **was heated** to 80 °C. Applications **are invited** for the post …*
5. To **avoid blame** or sound impersonal: *Mistakes **were made**.*

26.2 Basic Rules for Changing Active into Passive

1. The **object** of the active sentence becomes the **subject** of the passive.
2. The **verb** becomes **be (in the correct tense) + past participle (V3)**.
3. The **subject** of the active sentence becomes the **agent**, usually after ***by*** — and a pronoun changes to the **objective case**.
4. **Only transitive verbs** (verbs with an object) can be changed into the passive.

26.2.1 Pronoun Changes

Active (subjective)	Passive (objective, after *by*)	Active (objective)	Passive (subjective)
I	by me	me	I
we	by us	us	we
you	by you	you	you
he	by him	him	he
she	by her	her	she
they	by them	them	they
it	by it	it	it
who	by whom	whom	who

26.3 Passive Forms in All Tenses

Tense	Active	Passive
Present Indefinite	He **writes** a letter.	A letter **is written** by him.
Present Continuous	He **is writing** a letter.	A letter **is being written** by him.
Present Perfect	He **has written** a letter.	A letter **has been written** by him.
Past Indefinite	He **wrote** a letter.	A letter **was written** by him.
Past Continuous	He **was writing** a letter.	A letter **was being written** by him.
Past Perfect	He **had written** a letter.	A letter **had been written** by him.
Future Indefinite	He **will write** a letter.	A letter **will be written** by him.
Future Perfect	He **will have written** a letter.	A letter **will have been written** by him.
Be going to	He **is going to write** a letter.	A letter **is going to be written** by him.
Modals	He **can / may / must / should write** a letter.	A letter **can / may / must / should be written** by him.
Modal + perfect	He **must have written** the letter.	The letter **must have been written** by him.
Used to	He **used to write** letters.	Letters **used to be written** by him.
Have to	He **has to write** a letter.	A letter **has to be written** by him.

The **perfect continuous** tenses (present, past, future) and the **future continuous** are not normally used in the passive (✘ *has been being written*, ✘ *will be being written*). If such a sentence must be made passive, change the tense meaningfully or say that it has no passive form.

› They **are building** a new bridge. → A new bridge **is being built** (by them).
› She **has cooked** the rice. → The rice **has been cooked** by her.
› The police **had arrested** the thief. → The thief **had been arrested** by the police.
› We **shall finish** the work tomorrow. → The work **will be finished** by us tomorrow.
› You **must obey** the rules. → The rules **must be obeyed** (by you).

26.4 Verbs with Two Objects

When a verb has an **indirect object** (person) and a **direct object** (thing), either can become the subject of the passive. Using the **person** as subject is more common.

› **Active:** He gave **me a book**.
› **Passive 1: I** was given a book by him. (more common)
› **Passive 2: A book** was given **to** me by him.
› **Active:** The teacher taught **us English**.
› **Passive: We** were taught English by the teacher. / **English** was taught **to** us by the teacher.
› **Active:** They offered **her a job**.

- **Passive: She** was offered a job. / **A job** was offered **to** her.

26.5 Verbs with Object + Complement

When the active verb has an object and an **objective complement**, the complement remains after the passive verb:

- They **elected** him **chairman**. → He **was elected chairman**.
- We **made** her **captain**. → She **was made captain**.
- They **called** him **a liar**. → He **was called a liar**.
- The news **made** her **sad**. → She **was made sad** by the news.
- They **painted** the house **red**. → The house **was painted red**.

26.6 Passive of Interrogative Sentences

26.6.1 Yes/No Questions (Beginning with an Auxiliary)

Change to the passive in the normal way, keeping the **auxiliary at the beginning**.

Active	Passive
Did he write the letter?	**Was** the letter written by him?
Does she sing a song?	**Is** a song sung by her?
Do you know him?	**Is** he known **to** you?
Have you finished the work?	**Has** the work been finished by you?
Is he doing the sum?	**Is** the sum being done by him?
Will you help me?	**Shall** I be helped by you?
Can you solve this problem?	**Can** this problem be solved by you?
Did they not invite you?	**Were** you not invited by them?

26.6.2 *Wh*-Questions

Active	Passive
Who wrote this book?	**By whom** was this book written? / Who was this book written by?
Whom did you see?	**Who** was seen by you? (*whom → who*)
What did he say?	**What** was said by him?
Which book do you want?	**Which** book is wanted by you?
Why did he beat the dog?	**Why** was the dog beaten by him?
When will you finish the work?	**When** will the work be finished by you?
Where did you buy this pen?	**Where** was this pen bought by you?
How did he solve the problem?	**How** was the problem solved by him?
How many books have you read?	**How many** books have been read by you?

26.7 Passive of Imperative Sentences

(a) Commands with an object: *Let* + object + *be* + V3.

- Shut the door. → **Let** the door **be shut**.
- Open the window. → **Let** the window **be opened**.
- Do it at once. → **Let** it **be done** at once.
- Don't touch the wire. → **Let** the wire **not be touched**. / **Let not** the wire **be touched**.
- Never tell a lie. → **Let** a lie **never be told**.

(b) Requests, advice, orders — using *You are requested / advised / ordered / asked / forbidden to*.

- Please help me. → **You are requested to help** me. / Let me be helped.
- Please give me a glass of water. → **You are requested to give** me a glass of water.
- Obey your parents. → **You are advised to obey** your parents. / Let your parents be obeyed.
- Get out. → **You are ordered to get** out.
- Don't smoke here. → **You are forbidden to smoke** here. / Smoking is prohibited here.
- Go home. (intransitive) → **You are ordered to go** home.

(c) Imperatives with *Let*:

- Let him do the work. → Let the work **be done by him**.
- Let us play football. → Let football **be played by us**.
- Let me help you. → Let you **be helped by me**.

26.8 Passive of Infinitives and Gerunds

Active	Passive
I want **to write** a letter.	I want a letter **to be written**.
There is much work **to do**.	There is much work **to be done**.
He is said **to have written** fifty books.	Fifty books are said **to have been written** by him.
I hate people **cheating** me.	I hate **being cheated** (by people).
I remember **them taking** me to the zoo.	I remember **being taken** to the zoo (by them).
He insisted on **beating** the boy.	He insisted on the boy **being beaten**.

- She likes people to praise her. → She likes **to be praised**.
- I don't like people to laugh at me. → I don't like **to be laughed at**. / I don't like **being laughed at**.
- The house needs painting. = The house needs **to be painted**.

26.9 Passive of Prepositional and Phrasal Verbs

When a verb is followed by a preposition (forming one meaning unit), the **preposition stays with the verb** in the passive.

- They **laughed at** the beggar. → The beggar **was laughed at** (by them).
- She **looks after** her mother. → Her mother **is looked after** by her.
- The doctor **sent for** the nurse. → The nurse **was sent for** by the doctor.
- A truck **ran over** the dog. → The dog **was run over** by a truck.
- We must **look into** the matter. → The matter must **be looked into**.
- They **put off** the meeting. → The meeting **was put off**.
- You must **take care of** your health. → Your health must **be taken care of**. / **Care** must be taken **of** your health.
- He **made use of** the money. → The money **was made use of** by him. / **Use** was made **of** the money.
- They **paid attention to** his speech. → His speech **was paid attention to**. / **Attention was paid to** his speech.

> **Don't drop the preposition:** ✘ *The beggar was laughed by them.* ✔ *The beggar was laughed **at** by them.* ✘ *The child was taken care by her.* ✔ *The child was taken care **of** by her.*

26.10 Passive with Reporting Verbs (*say, think, believe, know, report, expect, consider*)

There are two passive patterns for sentences such as *People say that he is rich*:

Active	Passive 1 (*It* + passive + *that*)	Passive 2 (Subject + passive + *to*-infinitive)
People **say** that he **is** rich.	**It is said** that he is rich.	He **is said to be** rich.
People **believe** that he **was** a spy.	**It is believed** that he was a spy.	He **is believed to have been** a spy.
They **think** that she **is working** abroad.	**It is thought** that she is working abroad.	She **is thought to be working** abroad.
They **reported** that the minister **had resigned**.	**It was reported** that the minister had resigned.	The minister **was reported to have resigned**.
We **know** that the earth **is** round.	**It is known** that the earth is round.	The earth **is known to be** round.

Exam Tip — Choose the right infinitive: If the action in the *that*-clause happens **at the same time** as the reporting verb, use ***to* + V1** (*is said **to be***). If it happened **earlier**, use ***to have* + V3** (*is said **to have been***).

26.11 Passive Agents: *By* and Other Prepositions

The agent is usually introduced by ***by***, but after many past participles expressing **feelings, states and results**, a **different preposition** is used:

Active	Passive
His conduct **pleased** me.	I was pleased **with** his conduct.
The result **satisfied** us.	We were satisfied **with** the result.
The news **surprised** me.	I was surprised **at** the news.
His behaviour **shocked** us.	We were shocked **at / by** his behaviour.
Music **interests** her.	She is interested **in** music.
Everybody **knows** him.	He is known **to** everybody. (✘ by everybody)
Water **filled** the jar.	The jar was filled **with** water.
Snow **covered** the hills.	The hills were covered **with** snow.
The box **contains** books.	Books are contained **in** the box.
Her rudeness **annoyed** me.	I was annoyed **with / at** her rudeness.
The work **tired** him.	He was tired **of / from** the work.
The dog **frightened** the child.	The child was frightened **of / by** the dog.
The result **disappointed** him.	He was disappointed **at / with** the result.
Everyone **loves** her.	She is loved **by** everyone.

26.12 When the Agent Is Omitted

The agent (*by* + doer) is **omitted** when it is a general word (*people, someone, they, we, one, you*), unknown, or obvious:

- **Someone** has stolen my pen. → My pen **has been stolen**. (✘ by someone)
- **People** speak English everywhere. → English **is spoken** everywhere.
- **They** grow rice in Bangladesh. → Rice **is grown** in Bangladesh.
- **The police** arrested the thief. → The thief **was arrested**. (police obvious; including it is also correct)

26.13 Verbs That Cannot Be Made Passive

1. **Intransitive verbs** (no object): *He sleeps. The baby cried. The sun rises.* — no passive.
2. **Certain stative transitive verbs:** *have* (= possess), *resemble, lack, suit, fit, become* (= suit), *hold* (= contain), *equal, mean, cost, weigh*: ✘ *A car is had by him.* ✘ *His father is resembled by him.* ✘ *Good manners are lacked by him.* ✘ *This dress is suited by her.*
3. **Verbs with a reflexive object:** *He hurt himself.* (✘ Himself was hurt by him.)
4. **Verbs with a cognate object** are rarely made passive: *He lived a happy life* → (*A happy life was lived by him* is awkward).

26.14 Quasi-Passive Verbs

Some verbs are **active in form but passive in meaning**. They are called **quasi-passive** verbs. Exams sometimes ask to change them into the "passive":

Quasi-passive (active form)	Passive meaning
The rose **smells** sweet.	The rose **is** sweet **when it is smelt**.
Honey **tastes** sweet.	Honey **is** sweet **when it is tasted**.
The cloth **feels** soft.	The cloth **is** soft **when it is felt**.
This book **sells** well.	This book **is sold** well.
The house **is building**. (old)	The house **is being built**.
The milk **looks** sour.	The milk **is** sour **when it is looked at**.
These shirts **wash** easily.	These shirts **are washed** easily.

26.15 Passive of Complex Sentences

In a complex sentence, the **main clause** and/or the **subordinate clause** may be changed:

- **Active:** I know that he wrote the letter.
- **Passive: It is known to me** that **the letter was written** by him.
- **Active:** We expect that he will win the prize.
- **Passive: It is expected** (by us) that **the prize will be won** by him.
- **Active:** He said that he had seen the film.
- **Passive: It was said** by him that **the film had been seen** by him.

26.16 The Causative Passive and *Get*-Passive

- **Causative (*have* / *get* + object + V3)** — someone else does the action for us: *I **had** my car **repaired**. She **got** her hair **cut**.* (Active idea: *A mechanic repaired my car.*)
- **Get-passive** — informal, often for unexpected or unpleasant events: *He **got hurt** in the accident. The window **got broken**. They **got married** last year.*

26.17 Special Cases

(a) *Make, see, hear, let, help* + bare infinitive → *to* + infinitive in the passive:

- They **made** him **work** hard. → He **was made to work** hard.
- I **saw** him **enter** the house. → He **was seen to enter** the house.
- We **heard** her **sing**. → She **was heard to sing**.
- They **let** him **go**. → He **was allowed to go**. (*let* has no direct passive)

(b) *Born, drowned, killed* in accidents — passive in meaning:

- He **was born** in 1971. (✘ He born in 1971.)
- Many people **were drowned / were killed** in the flood.

(c) Passive with *by* + reflexive is not used: ✘ *The letter was written by himself.* ✔ *He wrote the letter himself.*

(d) Sentences beginning with *There*: *There is no time to lose* (active infinitive, idiomatic) / *There is much work to be done* (passive infinitive).

26.18 Changing Passive into Active

Reverse the process: the **agent** after *by* becomes the subject; the passive subject becomes the object; *be* + V3 becomes the active verb in the same tense. If there is no agent, supply a suitable general subject (*someone, people, they, we*).

- The thief was caught by the police. → **The police caught** the thief.
- The letter has been posted. → **Someone has posted** the letter.
- English is spoken all over the world. → **People speak** English all over the world.
- By whom was this book written? → **Who wrote** this book?
- Let the door be closed. → **Close** the door.
- You are requested to sign here. → **Please sign** here.

26.19 Common Errors in Voice

1. ✘ The letter was wrote by him. ✔ The letter was **written** by him.
2. ✘ The work is being did. ✔ The work is being **done**.
3. ✘ He was born at 1990. ✔ He was born **in** 1990.
4. ✘ The thief was caught by they. ✔ The thief was caught by **them**.
5. ✘ The beggar was laughed by the boys. ✔ The beggar was laughed **at** by the boys.
6. ✘ He is known by everybody. ✔ He is known **to** everybody.
7. ✘ I was surprised by his conduct. (exam) ✔ I was surprised **at** his conduct.
8. ✘ The jar is filled by water. ✔ The jar is filled **with** water.
9. ✘ A pen was bought to me. ✔ A pen was bought **for** me. / I was bought a pen.
10. ✘ He was made work hard. ✔ He was made **to work** hard.
11. ✘ By whom this book was written? ✔ By whom **was this book** written?
12. ✘ Who was this book written? ✔ **By whom** was this book written?
13. ✘ Let the door be shutted. ✔ Let the door be **shut**.
14. ✘ The baby is cried. (intransitive) ✔ The baby **cries / is crying**.
15. ✘ A car is had by him. ✔ He **has** a car. (no passive)
16. ✘ He is said to be written a novel. ✔ He is said **to have written** a novel.
17. ✘ My watch has stolen. ✔ My watch **has been stolen**.
18. ✘ The child was taken care by the nurse. ✔ … was taken care **of** by the nurse.
19. ✘ The meeting will be held on Monday by us. ✔ The meeting **will be held** on Monday. (omit obvious agent)
20. ✘ Rice is growing in Bangladesh. (meaning: is cultivated) ✔ Rice **is grown** in Bangladesh.

26.20 Voice in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Prefer the active voice:** GMAT and SAT reward **concise, direct** sentences. When a choice uses the passive without good reason (*The decision was made by the board to …*), the active version (*The board decided to …*) is usually better. The passive is **not wrong**, however; if all options are passive, judge on other grounds.
- **Passive with dangling modifiers:** ✘ *Having reviewed the data, a decision was made.* (Who reviewed?) ✔ *Having reviewed the data, **the committee** made a decision.*
- **Correct passive forms:** ✘ *has been rose*, ✘ *was began* — check past participles.
- **GRE Reading:** passive constructions like *"it has been argued that …"* or *"it is widely believed that …"* often introduce a view the **author will challenge** — a useful signal for main-idea questions.

CHAPTER 27

Narration

Part A · Grammar

27.1 Direct and Indirect Speech

Narration means reporting what someone said. There are two ways to do it:

- **Direct speech:** the **exact words** of the speaker are given inside **inverted commas** (quotation marks). *He said, "**I am ill.**"*
- **Indirect (reported) speech:** the **substance** of the speaker's words is reported **in our own words**, without inverted commas, with the necessary changes in pronouns, tenses and other words. *He said **that he was ill**.*

Every narration has two parts:

Part	Example: *He said to me, "I am ill."*
Reporting verb (and its subject/object)	*He **said** to me*
Reported speech (the words reported)	*"I am ill."*

Narration is tested in SSC, HSC, admission tests and BCS Written (change into indirect/direct), and in MCQ form in BCS Preliminary and Bank tests.

27.2 General Rules for Changing Direct into Indirect Speech

To change any sentence, three things must be handled:

1. the **reporting verb** (change *said to* into *told, asked, ordered, wished, exclaimed*, etc., according to the kind of sentence);
2. the **linking word** (*that, if/whether, wh-word, to*);
3. the **reported speech** — changes of **person**, **tense** and **words of nearness/time**.

27.2.1 Change of Person — the "SON" Rule

Person in reported speech	Changes according to	Memory
1st person (*I, me, my, we, us, our*)	the **Subject** of the reporting verb	**S**
2nd person (*you, your*)	the **Object** of the reporting verb	**O**
3rd person (*he, she, it, they*)	**No** change	**N**

- **He** said to **me**, "**I** will help **you**." → He told me that **he** would help **me**. (*I* → subject *he*; *you* → object *me*)
- **She** said to **him**, "**You** are **my** friend." → She told him that **he** was **her** friend.
- **They** said to **us**, "**We** know **him**." → They told us that **they** knew **him**. (*him* — 3rd person — unchanged)
- **I** said to **her**, "**You** are late." → I told her that **she** was late.

27.2.2 Change of Tense

> If the **reporting verb is in the past tense**, the tense of the reported speech is changed to the corresponding **past** form. If the reporting verb is in the **present or future**, the tense of the reported speech does **not** change.

Direct speech	Indirect speech
Present Indefinite: *"I **write**."*	Past Indefinite: *he **wrote***
Present Continuous: *"I **am writing**."*	Past Continuous: *he **was writing***
Present Perfect: *"I **have written**."*	Past Perfect: *he **had written***
Present Perfect Continuous: *"I **have been writing**."*	Past Perfect Continuous: *he **had been writing***
Past Indefinite: *"I **wrote**."*	Past Perfect: *he **had written***
Past Continuous: *"I **was writing**."*	Past Perfect Continuous: *he **had been writing***
Past Perfect: *"I **had written**."*	No change: *he **had written***
will / shall	*would / should* (*shall* → *would* when the new subject is 2nd/3rd person)
can	*could*
may	*might*
must	*must* / *had to* (obligation)
could, would, should, might, ought to, used to	No change

- He **says**, "I am busy." → He **says** that he **is** busy. (present reporting verb — no tense change)
- He **will say**, "I am busy." → He will say that he **is** busy.
- He **said**, "I am busy." → He said that he **was** busy.
- She said, "I **have finished** my work." → She said that she **had finished** her work.
- He said, "I **saw** a tiger." → He said that he **had seen** a tiger.
- He said, "I **will** go." → He said that he **would** go.
- She said, "I **can** swim." → She said that she **could** swim.
- He said, "You **must** obey the rules." → He said that I **must / had to** obey the rules.

27.2.3 Exceptions: When the Tense Does Not Change

1. **Universal truths, scientific facts, proverbs:** *The teacher said, "The earth **moves** round the sun." → The teacher said that the earth **moves** round the sun.*
2. **Habitual facts still true:** *He said, "I **get** up at six every day." → He said that he **gets / got** up at six every day.*
3. **Historical facts:** *The teacher said, "Bangladesh **became** independent in 1971." → The teacher said that Bangladesh **became** independent in 1971.*
4. **Unreal conditions and wishes (*if*-clauses, *wish, as if, it's time*):** *He said, "If I **were** a bird, I **would** fly." → He said that if he **were** a bird, he **would** fly.*
5. **Past perfect** and modals *could, would, should, might, ought to*: no change.
6. **When the reporting verb is in the present or future** (see above).

27.2.4 Change of Words Showing Nearness and Time

Direct	Indirect
now	then
today	that day
tonight	that night
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
yesterday	the previous day / the day before
last night	the previous night / the night before
next week / month / year	the following week / month / year
ago	before
this	that
these	those
here	there
hence	thence
hither	thither
thus	so / in that way
come	go (when the place is no longer near)

- He said, "I came here **yesterday**." → He said that he had gone there **the previous day**.
- She said, "I will do it **tomorrow**." → She said that she would do it **the next day**.
- He said, "I bought **this** book two days **ago**." → He said that he had bought **that** book two days **before**.

> These words change only when the time or place of reporting is **different** from the time or place of speaking. If the report is made on the same day and in the same place, *today, here, this* may remain unchanged: *He said this morning that he would come **today***.

27.3 Assertive (Statement) Sentences

Rules: *said → said* (no object) or *told* (with an object); join with ***that***; remove inverted commas; change person, tense and words.

- He said, "I am happy." → He said **that** he was happy.
- He said to me, "I am happy." → He **told** me **that** he was happy.
- Rina said to her mother, "I have passed the exam." → Rina told her mother that she had passed the exam.
- The boy said, "I shall go to Chattogram tomorrow." → The boy said that he **would** go to Chattogram **the next day**.
- He said, "I was reading a book." → He said that he **had been reading** a book.
- My father said to me, "Honesty is the best policy." → My father told me that honesty **is** the best policy. (universal truth)
- He said, "I may go home." → He said that he **might** go home.

> ***Said* vs *told*:** *said* is used **without** a personal object or with *to*: *He said (to me) that ….* *Told* must have a **personal object**: *He told **me** that …* (✘ He told that … / ✘ He said me that …).

27.4 Interrogative Sentences

Rules:

1. Change *said / said to* into ***asked, enquired of, wanted to know, demanded of***.
2. For **yes/no questions** (beginning with an auxiliary: *Is, Are, Do, Does, Did, Have, Can, Will …*), use ***if*** or ***whether***.
3. For **wh-questions** (*who, what, where, when, why, how, which*), the **wh-word itself** is the linker — **no *that***.
4. Change the **question form** into **statement order** (subject before verb) — **remove *do/does/did*** and the question mark.

- He said to me, "**Are** you ill?" → He **asked** me **if / whether** I **was** ill.
- She said to him, "**Do** you know me?" → She asked him if he **knew** her.
- I said to her, "**Did** you go to school?" → I asked her whether she **had gone** to school.
- He said to me, "**Can** you help me?" → He asked me if I **could** help him.
- He said to me, "**Where do you live**?" → He asked me **where I lived**. (✘ where did I live)
- The teacher said to the boy, "**What is your name**?" → The teacher asked the boy **what his name was**.
- She said to me, "**Why are you** crying?" → She asked me **why I was** crying.
- He said, "**Who** broke the glass?" → He asked **who had broken** the glass. (*who* is the subject — normal order)
- I said to him, "**How** did you do it?" → I asked him how he **had done** it.
- He said to me, "**Will you** lend me your pen?" → He asked me **if I would** lend him my pen.

> **Exam Tip — The two most common mistakes:** (1) keeping question word order (✘ *He asked me where did I live*), and (2) using *that* before *if/whether/wh-word* (✘ *He asked me that where I lived*). The indirect question is a **statement** in form.

27.5 Imperative Sentences

Rules:

1. Change *said / said to* into a verb that shows the **mood** of the speaker: ***told, ordered, commanded*** (command); ***requested, begged, entreated, implored*** (request); ***advised*** (advice); ***forbade*** (prohibition); ***urged, warned, asked, reminded, invited, proposed, suggested***.
2. Use ***to* + V1** for positive commands and ***not to* + V1** for negative commands (or *forbade … to*).
3. Remove *please / kindly* (expressed through *requested*).

- He said to me, "**Go** home." → He **told / ordered** me **to go** home.
- The teacher said to the boys, "**Don't make** a noise." → The teacher **told** the boys **not to make** a noise. / The teacher **forbade** the boys **to make** a noise.
- She said to me, "**Please** give me a pen." → She **requested** me **to give** her a pen.
- The doctor said to the patient, "**Take** rest." → The doctor **advised** the patient **to take** rest.
- The captain said to the soldiers, "**Fire**!" → The captain **commanded** the soldiers **to fire**.
- He said to me, "**Be** careful." → He **warned / advised** me **to be** careful.
- The beggar said, "**Have mercy** on me, sir." → The beggar **respectfully implored** the gentleman **to have** mercy on him.
- He said to me, "**Never tell** a lie." → He **advised** me **never to tell** a lie.

27.5.1 Imperatives with *Let*

(a) *Let us* (proposal / suggestion): *proposed / suggested* + ***that*** + subject + ***should***:

- He said to me, "**Let us** go out for a walk." → He **proposed / suggested to** me **that we should** go out for a walk.
- She said, "Let us play." → She proposed that they should play.

(b) *Let me / let him* (permission or wish): *requested / asked* + ***to let / allow***, or *wished that* + *might*:

- He said to me, "**Let me** go." → He **requested** me **to let** him go.
- She said, "**Let him** do the work." → She said that he **might** do the work. / She **asked** them **to let** him do the work.

27.6 Optative Sentences (Wishes and Prayers)

Rules: *said* → ***wished*** or ***prayed*** (with *that*); ***May*** + subject + V1 → subject + ***might*** + V1.

- He said to me, "**May** you **be** happy." → He **wished that** I **might be** happy.
- My mother said to me, "**May** Allah **bless** you." → My mother **prayed that** Allah **might bless** me.
- The people said, "**Long live** the President." → The people **prayed that** the President **might live long**.
- She said, "**Would that** I were young again!" → She **wished that** she were young again.
- He said to me, "**Good morning**." → He **wished** me good morning.
- He said to me, "**Good bye**." → He **bade** me goodbye.
- They said to me, "**Congratulations**!" → They **congratulated** me.
- He said, "**Thank you**." → He **thanked** me.

27.7 Exclamatory Sentences

Rules:

1. Change *said* into ***exclaimed*** + a phrase showing the emotion: ***with joy, with sorrow, with surprise, with wonder, with regret, with disgust, with contempt***; or ***cried out, applauded, praised***.
2. Remove the **interjection** (*Alas, Hurrah, Oh, Bravo, What, How*) and express its meaning through the phrase above.
3. Join with ***that***; change the exclamation into a statement, often replacing ***What / How*** with ***very / great / very great***.

Interjection	Change *said* into
Hurrah!	exclaimed **with joy / delight**
Alas!	exclaimed **with sorrow / grief**
Oh! / What! / Wow!	exclaimed **with surprise / wonder**
Bravo!	**applauded / praised** / exclaimed with approval
Fie! / Pooh! / Pshaw!	exclaimed **with contempt / disgust**
Ah!	exclaimed **with regret / sorrow**

- He said, "**Hurrah!** We have won the match." → He **exclaimed with joy** that they had won the match.
- She said, "**Alas!** My son is dead." → She **exclaimed with sorrow** that her son was dead.
- He said, "**What a** beautiful scene it is!" → He **exclaimed with wonder** that it was **a very** beautiful scene.
- They said, "**How** clever the boy is!" → They **exclaimed** that the boy was **very** clever.
- The teacher said to me, "**Bravo!** You have done well." → The teacher **applauded** me, saying that I had done well.
- He said, "**Fie!** You are a coward." → He **exclaimed with contempt** that I was a coward.
- He said, "**What a** fool I am!" → He **exclaimed** that he was **a great** fool.
- She said, "**Oh!** I have lost my purse." → She **exclaimed with sorrow** that she had lost her purse.

27.8 Mixed and Multiple Sentences

When the direct speech contains **more than one sentence**, each is reported according to its own type, and they are joined with ***and said that, and added that, and asked, as, but, so*** etc.

- He said, "**I am tired. Let me rest.**" → He said that he was tired **and** requested to be allowed to rest.
- She said to me, "**You are late. Where have you been?**" → She told me that I was late **and asked** where I had been.
- The teacher said, "**Boys, you have done well. Go home now.**" → The teacher told the boys that they had done well **and asked** them to go home **then**.
- He said, "**Alas! I am undone. What shall I do now?**" → He **exclaimed with sorrow** that he was undone **and asked** what he would do **then**.
- He said to me, "**I have lost my pen. Will you lend me yours?**" → He told me that he had lost his pen **and asked** me if I would lend him mine.

27.9 Special Cases

27.9.1 Vocatives (Words of Address)

A name or word of address in direct speech becomes the **object** of the reporting verb or is expressed with *addressing … as*:

- He said, "**Rahim**, come here." → He **told Rahim** to come there.
- He said, "**Friends**, help me." → He **requested his friends** to help him. / **Addressing them as friends**, he requested them to help him.
- He said, "**Sir**, I need your help." → He **respectfully told** the gentleman/teacher that he needed his help.

27.9.2 *Yes* and *No* in Answers

Yes / No are expressed by ***replied in the affirmative / in the negative***, or by repeating the auxiliary:

- I said to him, "Will you come?" He said, "**Yes**." → I asked him if he would come. He **replied in the affirmative**. / He replied that he would.
- She said, "**No**, I can't." → She **replied in the negative** / She replied that she could not.

27.9.3 *Must*

- *Must* expressing **obligation** → ***had to*** (or *must*): *He said, "I must go." → He said that he **had to** go.*
- *Must* expressing **certainty / deduction / permanent rule** → **must** (no change): *He said, "She must be ill." → He said that she **must** be ill.*
- *Mustn't* (prohibition) → ***mustn't / was not to***.

27.9.4 *Shall* in Questions

"Shall I …?" (asking for advice/offer) → ***should***: *He said, "Shall I open the door?" → He asked if he **should** open the door. "Shall we …?"* (proposal) → ***proposed / suggested that … should***.

27.10 Changing Indirect Speech into Direct Speech

Reverse the steps:

1. Use ***said*** or ***said to*** + object, followed by a comma and inverted commas.
2. Restore the **kind of sentence** (question, command, wish, exclamation) with the proper punctuation.
3. Change persons back (the speaker becomes *I*; the listener becomes *you*).
4. Change tenses **one step forward** (past → present, past perfect → past/present perfect, *would* → *will*, *could* → *can*, *might* → *may*).
5. Restore words of nearness (*that day* → *today*, *there* → *here*, *the next day* → *tomorrow*).
6. Insert interjections where the indirect form shows emotion.

- He told me that he was ill. → He said to me, "**I am** ill."
- She asked me whether I would go there. → She said to me, "**Will you go** there?"
- The teacher ordered the boys not to make a noise. → The teacher said to the boys, "**Don't make** a noise."
- He prayed that I might be happy. → He said to me, "**May you be** happy!"
- She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her purse. → She said, "**Alas! I have lost** my purse."
- He proposed that they should go for a walk. → He said, "**Let us go** for a walk."
- He asked me where I had been the previous day. → He said to me, "**Where were you yesterday**?"

27.11 Reporting a Conversation

When a whole conversation is reported, vary the reporting verbs (*asked, replied, added, enquired, exclaimed, agreed, admitted, explained, suggested, insisted*) to make the narrative natural.

Direct: "Where are you going?" said the policeman to the boy. "I am going to the market," replied the boy. "Why are you running?" asked the policeman. "My mother is ill. I must buy some medicine," said the boy.

Indirect: The policeman **asked** the boy where he was going. The boy **replied** that he was going to the market. The policeman then **enquired** why he was running. The boy **explained** that his mother was ill and that he **had to** buy some medicine.

27.12 Common Errors in Narration

1. ✘ He said me that he was ill. ✔ He **told** me that he was ill. / He **said to** me that he was ill.
2. ✘ He told that he was busy. ✔ He **said** that he was busy. / He told **me** that he was busy.
3. ✘ He asked me that where I lived. ✔ He asked me **where I lived**.
4. ✘ He asked me where did I live. ✔ He asked me where **I lived**.
5. ✘ She asked me that if I was ill. ✔ She asked me **if** I was ill.
6. ✘ He said that he will come tomorrow. ✔ He said that he **would** come **the next day**.
7. ✘ The teacher said that the sun rose in the east. ✔ … the sun **rises** in the east.
8. ✘ He ordered me that go away. ✔ He ordered me **to go** away.
9. ✘ He told me don't go there. ✔ He told me **not to go** there.
10. ✘ He requested me that please help him. ✔ He requested me **to help** him.
11. ✘ He wished that I may be happy. ✔ He **prayed / wished** that I **might** be happy.
12. ✘ He exclaimed with sorrow that alas he had failed. ✔ He exclaimed with sorrow that he **had failed**.
13. ✘ She said that she has seen the film. ✔ She said that she **had seen** the film.
14. ✘ He asked me what is my name. ✔ He asked me what **my name was**.
15. ✘ He proposed me to go for a walk. ✔ He **proposed that we should** go for a walk.
16. ✘ He said that he came here yesterday. ✔ He said that he **had gone there the previous day**.
17. ✘ He asked whether I will help him. ✔ He asked whether I **would** help him.
18. ✘ He said that "I am busy". ✔ He said, "I am busy." / He said that he was busy.
19. ✘ He asked me, Do I know him. ✔ He asked me **if I knew** him.
20. ✘ He forbade me not to go. ✔ He **forbade** me **to go**. (*forbade* is already negative)

27.13 Reported Speech in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Tense agreement after past reporting verbs (GMAT/SAT):** ✘ *The spokesman said that the company **will** expand next year.* — GMAT may prefer ***would*** when the whole context is past; however, if the event is still in the future at the time of writing, *will* can be acceptable. Look at what the other answer choices do and choose the **logically consistent** one.
- **Indirect questions keep statement order:** ✘ *Researchers asked how much did people spend.* ✔ *… how much people **spent**.*
- ***That* + clause after reporting verbs:** GMAT occasionally tests *claim that, report that, announce that* (✘ *claimed to be that*).
- **GRE/SAT Reading — reported views:** Authors often report others' opinions (*Critics argued that …; Some historians contend that …*) before giving their own; distinguishing **reported view** from **author's view** is essential in reading questions.

CHAPTER 28

Tag Question

Part A · Grammar

28.1 What Is a Tag Question?

A **tag question** (question tag) is a **short question added at the end of a statement**. Speakers use it to **check information** or to **ask for agreement**. It is very common in spoken English.

- You are a student, **aren't you?**
- He doesn't smoke, **does he?**
- They went to Sylhet, **didn't they?**
- She can swim, **can't she?**

The meaning depends on **intonation**:

- **Falling intonation** ↘ — the speaker is fairly sure and expects agreement: *It's a lovely day, isn't it?* ↘
- **Rising intonation** ↗ — a real question; the speaker is not sure: *You are coming tomorrow, aren't you?* ↗

28.2 The Basic Rules

1. **Positive statement → negative tag**; **negative statement → positive tag.**
2. The tag uses the **same auxiliary** (or *be* / modal) as the statement.
3. If the statement has **no auxiliary**, use ***do* / *does* / *did*** in the tag, according to tense and subject.
4. The subject of the tag is always a **pronoun** that refers to the subject of the statement.
5. A negative tag is **contracted**: *isn't, aren't, don't, doesn't, didn't, haven't, can't, won't, shouldn't* …
6. A comma comes before the tag, and a **question mark** after it.

Statement	Tag
He **is** a doctor,	**isn't he?**
He **isn't** a doctor,	**is he?**
They **were** late,	**weren't they?**
You **have** finished,	**haven't you?**
She **can** sing,	**can't she?**
He **will** come,	**won't he?**
You **should** go,	**shouldn't you?**
He **plays** cricket,	**doesn't he?** (no auxiliary → *does*)
They **play** cricket,	**don't they?**
She **went** home,	**didn't she?**
He **doesn't** play,	**does he?**
She **didn't** go,	**did she?**
Rina **has been** working,	**hasn't she?**
The book **was written** by Tagore,	**wasn't it?**

28.3 Special Rules

28.3.1 *I am* → *aren't I?*

The negative tag for *I am* is ***aren't I?*** (✘ amn't I? — not standard; *am I not?* is formal).

- I am right, **aren't I?**
- I am not late, **am I?**

28.3.2 Imperative Sentences

Statement	Tag	Use
Open the door,	**will you? / won't you? / would you? / can you? / could you?**	request / order
Shut up,	**will you?**	impatient order
Don't make a noise,	**will you?**	negative imperative → *will you* only
Have some tea,	**won't you?**	invitation
Please help me,	**will you?**	request

28.3.3 *Let's* and *Let me / him*

- **Let's** go for a walk, **shall we?** (suggestion including the speaker)
- **Let us** go, **shall we?** (= let's)
- **Let me** help you, **will you?** (asking permission)
- **Let him** go, **will you?** (request to the listener)
- **Let's not** quarrel, **shall we?**

28.3.4 *There is / There are*

The tag uses ***there***:

- There **is** a book on the table, **isn't there?**
- There **are** many students in the hall, **aren't there?**
- There **was** no one at home, **was there?**

28.3.5 *This / That / These / Those* and *Everything / Nothing*

- **This** is your pen, **isn't it?**
- **That** was a good film, **wasn't it?**
- **These** are your books, **aren't they?**
- **Those** were happy days, **weren't they?**
- **Everything** is ready, **isn't it?**
- **Nothing** happened, **did it?** (*nothing* is negative → positive tag)

28.3.6 *Everybody, Somebody, Nobody, Everyone, Anyone, No one*

The tag uses ***they*** (with a plural verb):

- **Everybody** was present, **weren't they?**
- **Somebody** called me, **didn't they?**
- **Nobody** knows the answer, **do they?**
- **No one** came, **did they?**
- **Neither** of them came, **did they?**

28.3.7 Negative and Semi-Negative Words

A statement containing ***never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, barely, few, little, no, none, nobody, nothing, nowhere, neither*** is **negative in meaning**, so it takes a **positive tag**:

- He **never** tells a lie, **does he?**
- She **seldom** comes here, **does she?**
- He can **hardly** walk, **can he?**
- **Few** people came, **did they?**
- There is **little** water in the jar, **is there?**

- He has **no** money, **has he?** (BrE) / **does he?** (AmE)

> ***A few* and *a little*** are **positive** in meaning, so they take a **negative** tag: *There are **a few** mangoes, **aren't there?** He has **a little** money, **hasn't he / doesn't he?***

28.3.8 *Have* as a Main Verb

When ***have*** means **possess**, British English can use *have* in the tag; American English (and modern usage) uses ***do***. When *have* means **take / eat / experience**, use ***do***.

- He **has** a car, **hasn't he?** (BrE) / **doesn't he?** (AmE and modern)
- You **have got** a pen, **haven't you?**
- She **has** breakfast at 8, **doesn't she?** (*have* = eat)
- They **had** a good time, **didn't they?** (*have* = experience)

28.3.9 Other Special Verbs

Statement	Tag
He **used to** live here,	**didn't he?** (✘ usedn't he — old)
You **ought to** go,	**oughtn't you?** / **shouldn't you?**
You **had better** go,	**hadn't you?**
You **'d better** hurry,	**hadn't you?**
He **'d rather** stay,	**wouldn't he?** (*'d = would*)
She **'d** finished,	**hadn't she?** (*'d = had*, followed by V3)
You **must** come,	**mustn't you?** (obligation)
He **must** be ill,	**isn't he?** (deduction → tag follows the main verb *be*)
He **must** have left,	**hasn't he?** (deduction about the past)
You **needn't** go,	**need you?**
He **dare not** go,	**dare he?**
One should be careful,	**shouldn't one?**

28.3.10 Complex Sentences

The tag normally agrees with the **main clause**:

- He said that he was ill, **didn't he?**
- You know where he lives, **don't you?**
- I know that he is honest, **don't I?**

But when the main clause is ***I think / I believe / I suppose / I am sure / I feel / I guess*** (expressing an opinion), the tag agrees with the **subordinate clause**:

- **I think** he is honest, **isn't he?** (✘ don't I?)
- **I believe** she will come, **won't she?**
- **I don't think** he is right, **is he?** (the negative is transferred)
- **I am sure** you know her, **don't you?**

28.3.11 Exclamatory and Optative Sentences

- **What** a beautiful day, **isn't it?**
- **How** clever the boy is, **isn't he?**
- **May** you live long! (Optative sentences normally take no tag.)

28.3.12 Compound Sentences

In compound sentences, the tag normally agrees with the **nearer (last) clause**:

- He is poor, but he is honest, **isn't he?**
- I called him, but he didn't answer, **did he?**

28.4 Same-Way (Positive–Positive) Tags

A **positive statement with a positive tag** is used to show **interest, surprise, doubt, sarcasm or a conclusion** — not to ask for agreement:

- So you are leaving, **are you?** (surprise/interest)
- Oh, you've passed, **have you?** Congratulations!
- You think you're clever, **do you?** (sarcasm)

28.5 Answering Tag Questions

Answer according to the **facts**, not the form of the question. (Bangla speakers often reverse *Yes* and *No* here.)

- "You aren't a teacher, are you?" — "**No, I'm not.**" (I am not a teacher.) / "**Yes, I am.**" (I am a teacher.)
- "He didn't come, did he?" — "**No, he didn't.**" (He did not come.)
- "She can swim, can't she?" — "**Yes, she can.**"

28.6 Common Errors in Tag Questions

1. ✘ He is a doctor, is he? ✔ He is a doctor, **isn't he?**
2. ✘ She plays well, isn't she? ✔ She plays well, **doesn't she?**
3. ✘ They went home, don't they? ✔ They went home, **didn't they?**
4. ✘ I am right, am not I? ✔ I am right, **aren't I?**
5. ✘ Let's go, will we? ✔ Let's go, **shall we?**
6. ✘ Don't do it, won't you? ✔ Don't do it, **will you?**
7. ✘ He never smokes, doesn't he? ✔ He never smokes, **does he?**
8. ✘ Nobody came, didn't they? ✔ Nobody came, **did they?**
9. ✘ Everyone was happy, wasn't he? ✔ Everyone was happy, **weren't they?**
10. ✘ There is a pen, isn't it? ✔ There is a pen, **isn't there?**
11. ✘ Rahim is a good boy, isn't Rahim? ✔ … **isn't he?** (pronoun in tag)
12. ✘ Few people know it, don't they? ✔ Few people know it, **do they?**
13. ✘ He used to smoke, usedn't he? ✔ He used to smoke, **didn't he?**
14. ✘ You had better go, didn't you? ✔ You had better go, **hadn't you?**
15. ✘ I think he is honest, don't I? ✔ I think he is honest, **isn't he?**
16. ✘ This is your bag, isn't this? ✔ This is your bag, **isn't it?**
17. ✘ He can hardly walk, can't he? ✔ He can hardly walk, **can he?**
18. ✘ Nothing is impossible, isn't it? ✔ Nothing is impossible, **is it?**
19. ✘ She has finished her work, didn't she? ✔ She has finished her work, **hasn't she?**
20. ✘ Shut the door, do you? ✔ Shut the door, **will you?**

28.7 Tag Questions in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

> Tag questions belong to **spoken** English and are not tested in GMAT or GRE. They may appear in **SAT Reading** literary passages and dialogues, where a tag (*"You knew all along, didn't you?"*) reveals the speaker's **attitude** (certainty, accusation, sarcasm). In formal writing, avoid tag questions altogether.

CHAPTER 29

Dangling Modifier

Part A · Grammar

29.1 What Is a Modifier?

A **modifier** is a word, phrase or clause that **describes** or **gives more information** about another word in the sentence. Adjectives, adverbs, participial phrases, infinitive phrases, prepositional phrases and relative clauses are all modifiers.

- The **tired** boy slept. (*tired* modifies *boy*)
- **Running fast**, Rahim caught the bus. (*Running fast* modifies *Rahim*)
- The book **on the table** is mine. (*on the table* modifies *book*)
- The man **who lives next door** is a doctor.

> **The Modifier Rule:** A modifier must be placed **as close as possible** to the word it modifies, and that word must actually **appear in the sentence**. An introductory modifying phrase (especially one with a participle) automatically refers to the **subject of the main clause** that follows the comma.

When this rule is broken, two kinds of errors occur: **dangling modifiers** and **misplaced modifiers**. Both are among the most frequently tested errors in GMAT and SAT, and they appear in BCS and admission tests as "Correct the sentence" and error detection items.

29.2 Dangling Modifiers

A **dangling modifier** is a modifier whose intended **doer is missing** from the sentence. The phrase "dangles" because it has nothing logical to attach to, so it attaches to the wrong noun — usually the subject — often with **absurd** results.

- ✘ **Walking along the road**, a snake bit him. (Was the snake walking?)
- ✔ **Walking along the road**, **he** was bitten by a snake.
- ✔ **While he was walking** along the road, a snake bit him.

29.2.1 Dangling Participle (the Most Common Type)

- ✘ **Having finished the work**, the television was switched on. (Did the television finish the work?)
- ✔ **Having finished the work**, **I** switched on the television.
- ✘ **Reaching the station**, the train had left. (Did the train reach the station?)
- ✔ **Reaching the station**, **we** found that the train had left.
- ✔ **When we reached** the station, the train had left.
- ✘ **Being a rainy day**, we stayed at home. (We were not a rainy day!)
- ✔ **It being a rainy day**, we stayed at home. (absolute construction)
- ✔ **As it was a rainy day**, we stayed at home.
- ✘ **Written in simple English**, students can understand the book easily. (Were the students written?)
- ✔ **Written in simple English**, **the book** is easy for students to understand.
- ✘ **Opening the door**, a strange sight met my eyes.
- ✔ **Opening the door**, **I** saw a strange sight.
- ✘ **Being very poor**, the school fee could not be paid.
- ✔ **Being very poor**, **he** could not pay the school fee.
- ✘ **Hurrying to school**, his books fell from his hand.
- ✔ **Hurrying to school**, **he** dropped his books.

29.2.2 Dangling Gerund (Preposition + *-ing*)

- ✘ **After finishing the exam**, the hall was left quietly. (Who finished?)
- ✔ **After finishing the exam**, **the students** left the hall quietly.
- ✘ **On entering the room**, the light was switched off.
- ✔ **On entering the room**, **she** switched off the light.
- ✘ **By working hard**, success can be achieved.
- ✔ **By working hard**, **you** can achieve success.
- ✘ **Before going to bed**, the doors should be locked.
- ✔ **Before going to bed**, **you** should lock the doors.

29.2.3 Dangling Infinitive

- ✘ **To pass the exam**, hard work is necessary. (Who wants to pass?)
- ✔ **To pass the exam**, **you** must work hard.
- ✘ **To get a good job**, a degree is required.
- ✔ **To get a good job**, **one** needs a degree.
- ✘ **To make tea**, the water must be boiled first.
- ✔ **To make tea**, **you** must boil the water first.

29.2.4 Dangling Elliptical Clause

An **elliptical clause** is a shortened clause (*while/when/if/though* + participle or adjective) with its subject and verb omitted. The omitted subject must be the same as the subject of the main clause.

- ✘ **While cooking dinner**, the phone rang. (Was the phone cooking?)
- ✔ **While I was cooking dinner**, the phone rang.
- ✔ **While cooking dinner**, **I** heard the phone ring.
- ✘ **When only six years old**, my father died.
- ✔ **When I was only six years old**, my father died.
- ✘ **Though very tired**, the work had to be finished.
- ✔ **Though very tired**, **we** had to finish the work.
- ✘ **If found guilty**, the court will punish him heavily.
- ✔ **If found guilty**, **he** will be punished heavily (by the court).

29.2.5 Dangling Appositive or Adjective Phrase

- ✘ **A brilliant student**, the scholarship was given to Rina. (The scholarship was not a brilliant student.)
- ✔ **A brilliant student**, **Rina** was given the scholarship.
- ✘ **Old and sick**, the doctor examined the patient.
- ✔ The doctor examined the **old and sick** patient.
- ✘ **The capital of Bangladesh**, many people migrate to it every year.

- ✔ **The capital of Bangladesh, Dhaka** attracts many migrants every year.

29.2.6 The Possessive Trap

A possessive noun (*Rahim's*) **cannot** be the word that an introductory modifier refers to, because the real subject is the noun after it.

- ✘ **Walking down the street**, **Rahim's** wallet was stolen. (The subject is *wallet* — the wallet was not walking.)
- ✔ **Walking down the street**, **Rahim** had his wallet stolen.
- ✔ **While Rahim was walking** down the street, his wallet was stolen.
- ✘ **A great poet**, **Nazrul's** songs are loved by all.
- ✔ **A great poet**, **Nazrul** wrote songs that are loved by all.

29.3 How to Correct a Dangling Modifier

There are two methods:

> **Method 1 — Change the main clause:** Make the **doer** of the modifier the **subject** of the main clause, right after the comma.
>
> ✘ *Having eaten lunch, the dishes were washed.* → ✔ *Having eaten lunch, **we** washed the dishes.*
>
> **Method 2 — Change the modifier:** Turn the phrase into a **full clause** with its own subject and verb.
>
> ✘ *Having eaten lunch, the dishes were washed.* → ✔ ***After we had eaten lunch**, the dishes were washed.*

29.4 Acceptable Constructions That Look Like Dangling Modifiers

29.4.1 Absolute Phrases

An **absolute phrase** contains its **own subject**, so it does not dangle (Chapter 14.5.2):

- ✔ **The sun having set**, we returned home.
- ✔ **The rain having stopped**, the match resumed.
- ✔ **Weather permitting**, we will go on a picnic.

29.4.2 Fixed Participle Expressions

Some participial expressions are accepted idioms and do not need a subject:

generally speaking, strictly speaking, frankly speaking, considering, judging by/from, taking everything into account, given, provided (that), supposing, assuming, regarding, concerning, including, excluding, according to, owing to

- ✔ **Generally speaking**, Bangladeshi people are hospitable.
- ✔ **Considering** the circumstances, the result was good.
- ✔ **Judging from** his accent, he is from Sylhet.

29.5 Misplaced Modifiers

A **misplaced modifier** is present in the sentence with its correct "target", but it is placed **too far** from it or next to the **wrong word**, so the meaning becomes unclear or funny.

29.5.1 Misplaced Phrases

- ✘ I saw a dead snake **riding my bicycle**. (Was the snake riding?)
- ✔ **Riding my bicycle**, I saw a dead snake.
- ✘ He bought a horse for his son **called Lightning**.
- ✔ He bought a horse **called Lightning** for his son.
- ✘ We saw the Shaheed Minar **driving through the city**. (Was the Minar driving?)
- ✔ **Driving through the city**, we saw the Shaheed Minar.
- ✘ For sale: a piano **by a lady with carved legs**.
- ✔ For sale: a piano **with carved legs**, by a lady.

29.5.2 Misplaced Relative Clauses

- ✘ I have a cow for my brother **which gives good milk**.
- ✔ For my brother, I have a cow **which gives good milk**.
- ✘ The boy was punished by the teacher **who broke the window**. (Did the teacher break it?)
- ✔ The boy **who broke the window** was punished by the teacher.

29.5.3 Misplaced Limiting Adverbs (*only, just, nearly, almost, even, hardly, merely, scarcely*)

These words modify the word **immediately after** them (Chapter 15.5.4).

- ✘ He **only** has five taka. ✔ He has **only** five taka.
- ✘ I **nearly** earned 10,000 taka last month. (= I almost earned, but earned nothing?) ✔ I earned **nearly** 10,000 taka last month.
- ✘ He **almost** spent all his salary on books. ✔ He spent **almost** all his salary on books.
- ✘ He **just** finished half of the work. ✔ He finished **just** half of the work.

29.5.4 Squinting Modifiers

A **squinting modifier** is placed **between two words** so that it could modify either one:

- ✘ Students who study **regularly** succeed. (study regularly or regularly succeed?)
- ✔ Students who **regularly** study succeed. / Students who study succeed **regularly**.
- ✘ He said **on Monday** he would visit us. (said on Monday or visit on Monday?)
- ✔ **On Monday** he said he would visit us. / He said he would visit us **on Monday**.

29.5.5 Split Infinitive and Separated Subject–Verb

Long modifiers that split a subject from its verb or a verb from its object make sentences hard to follow:

- ✘ The minister, **after hearing the complaints of the villagers about the broken road for more than two hours**, promised to repair it.
- ✔ **After hearing the villagers' complaints about the broken road for more than two hours**, the minister promised to repair it.

29.6 *Like / Unlike* and Comparison Modifiers

Like and ***unlike*** phrases at the start of a sentence are modifiers too; they must compare **similar things** and refer to the subject.

- ✘ **Like** Dhaka, the traffic in Chattogram is heavy. (Dhaka vs traffic)
- ✔ **Like** Dhaka, **Chattogram** has heavy traffic.
- ✔ **Like that in** Dhaka, **the traffic** in Chattogram is heavy.
- ✘ **Unlike** most poets, Nazrul's poems were written for the common people.
- ✔ **Unlike** most poets, **Nazrul** wrote poems for the common people.

29.7 More Examples for Practice in Recognition

1. ✘ Being a hot day, I switched on the fan. ✔ **It being** a hot day, I switched on the fan.
2. ✘ Running to catch the bus, my bag fell. ✔ Running to catch the bus, **I dropped my bag**.
3. ✘ Having lost his money, the police were informed. ✔ Having lost his money, **he informed the police**.
4. ✘ On reaching home, the gate was found locked. ✔ On reaching home, **I found the gate locked**.
5. ✘ To win the match, practice is needed. ✔ To win the match, **the team** needs practice.
6. ✘ While sleeping, a mosquito bit me. ✔ While **I was** sleeping, a mosquito bit me.
7. ✘ After reading the novel, the film seemed boring. ✔ After reading the novel, **I found** the film boring.
8. ✘ Born in a poor family, education was difficult for him. ✔ Born in a poor family, **he** found education difficult.
9. ✘ Flying over the city, the buildings looked tiny. ✔ Flying over the city, **we** saw that the buildings looked tiny.
10. ✘ Tired of waiting, the meeting was cancelled. ✔ Tired of waiting, **the members** cancelled the meeting.
11. ✘ Covered with mud, his mother washed the child. ✔ His mother washed the child, **who was covered with mud**.
12. ✘ At the age of five, my grandfather taught me to read. ✔ **When I was five**, my grandfather taught me to read.
13. ✘ Driving carefully, the accident was avoided. ✔ Driving carefully, **she** avoided the accident.
14. ✘ Rushing out of the house, the door was left open. ✔ Rushing out of the house, **he** left the door open.
15. ✘ Hoping to get a good result, the exam was taken seriously. ✔ Hoping to get a good result, **Rina** took the exam seriously.

29.8 Modifiers in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Modifier errors are among the five most tested GMAT Sentence Correction topics. Apply these checks to every answer choice:

1. **Introductory modifier → subject.** Whatever comes right after the comma must be the doer. ✘ *Developed in the 1990s, many companies now use this software.* ✔ *Developed in the 1990s, **this software** is now used by many companies.*
2. **"Touch rule" for noun modifiers:** a modifier beginning with *which, who, that,* or a noun phrase must **touch** the noun it describes. ✘ *She bought a house from a builder, which has five bedrooms.* (Does the builder have five bedrooms?) ✔ *From a builder, she bought a house **that** has five bedrooms.*
3. ***-ing* modifiers after a comma (GMAT):** a comma + *-ing* phrase modifies the **whole preceding clause** (its subject and action), so it is acceptable when it describes a result: ✔ *The river flooded the village, **destroying** many homes.*
4. ***Which* after a comma** must refer to the **nearest noun**, not the whole clause (Chapter 08.12).
5. **Possessives cannot be antecedents** of introductory modifiers (29.2.6).

In **SAT Writing**, dangling modifiers usually appear as an introductory phrase followed by four versions of the main clause; the correct one begins with the **logical doer**.

CHAPTER 30

Identification of Phrase

Part A · Grammar

30.1 What Is a Phrase?

A **phrase** is a **group of words** that makes sense but **not complete sense**, and that **does not contain a subject and a finite verb** of its own. It works as **a single part of speech** within a sentence.

- **in the morning** — no subject, no finite verb
- **a very beautiful garden**
- **to learn English**
- **having finished the work**
- **at the top of the hill**

30.1.1 Phrase vs Clause vs Sentence

Unit	Subject + finite verb?	Complete sense?	Example
Phrase	No	No	*in the garden*
Clause	Yes	Not always (dependent clause: no)	*when he came / he came*
Sentence	Yes (at least one main clause)	Yes	*He came in the morning.*

Exam Tip — The finite-verb test: If a group of words contains a **subject + finite verb**, it is a **clause**. If it does not (even if it contains an infinitive, gerund or participle), it is a **phrase**. *Having finished the work* — *having finished* is a participle, not a finite verb → **phrase**. *When he had finished the work* — subject *he* + finite *had finished* → **clause**.

30.2 Kinds of Phrases (by Function)

Traditional grammar classifies phrases by the **part of speech** they act as. Modern grammar classifies them by their **head word** (noun phrase, verb phrase, etc.). Both systems are useful; exam questions in Bangladesh usually follow the first.

Kind (traditional)	Works as	Example
Noun phrase	a noun	***To tell lies*** *is a sin.*
Adjective phrase	an adjective	*He is a man* ***of great wealth****.*
Adverb phrase	an adverb	*He spoke* ***in a loud voice****.*
Prepositional phrase	adjective or adverb (by function)	*The book* ***on the table*** *is mine. / He sat* ***on the table****.*
Verb phrase	a verb	*He* ***has been working****.*
Phrasal preposition	a preposition	*He failed* ***on account of*** *illness.*
Phrasal conjunction	a conjunction	*I will wait* ***as long as*** *you want.*
Interjectional phrase	an interjection	***Good heavens!*** *What happened?*

30.3 The Noun Phrase

A **noun phrase** does the work of a **noun**: it can be a **subject, object, complement** or **object of a preposition**. Test: replace it with *it / this / something* — if the sentence still works, it is a noun phrase.

Structure	Example	Function
Infinitive phrase	***To err*** *is human.*	subject
	He wants ***to become a doctor****.*	object
	My aim is ***to serve the poor****.*	complement
Gerund phrase	***Reading good books*** *improves the mind.*	subject
	I enjoy ***watching cricket****.*	object
	He is fond of ***playing chess****.*	object of preposition
Determiner + adjective + noun	***The old man in the corner*** *is my uncle.*	subject
Wh-word + infinitive	*I don't know* ***how to swim****.*	object
	Tell me ***what to do****.*	object

- **Climbing the hill** was difficult. (= *It* was difficult)
- I like **to read detective stories**.
- He tried **to solve the problem**.
- Her hobby is **collecting stamps**.
- **The capital of Bangladesh** is Dhaka.

30.4 The Adjective Phrase

An **adjective phrase** does the work of an **adjective**: it **qualifies a noun or pronoun**. Usually it comes **after** the noun. Test: replace it with a single adjective — *a man of wisdom = a* ***wise*** *man*.

Structure	Example	One-word equivalent
Prepositional phrase	*He is a man* ***of great courage****.*	courageous
	She wore a dress ***of silk****.*	silk
	The house ***on the hill*** *is ours.*	(identifies which house)
Participial phrase	*The man* ***standing at the gate*** *is my father.*	—
	A letter ***written in red ink*** *came today.*	—
Infinitive phrase	*I have* ***no money to spend****. (to spend* qualifies *money)*	—
	He is the right man ***to do the job****.*	—
Adjective + complement	*He is a man* ***proud of his wealth****.*	proud
Compound adjective	*a* ***ten-year-old*** *boy*	—

- A man **of honesty** is respected everywhere. (= an honest man)
- He wore a cap **made of wool**. (= a woollen cap)
- The girl **with long hair** is my sister.
- The road **to the village** is muddy.
- The boy **sitting next to me** is very clever.
- Give me something **to eat**.

- A house **built of bricks** lasts long.
- The guest **from Japan** spoke Bangla.

30.5 The Adverb Phrase

An **adverb phrase** does the work of an **adverb**: it modifies a verb, adjective or adverb, telling ***how, when, where, why*** or ***to what extent***. Test: replace with a one-word adverb — *with care = carefully*.

Meaning	Example	One-word equivalent
Manner (how?)	*He did the work **with great care**.*	carefully
	*She spoke **in a low voice**.*	softly
Time (when?)	*He came **in the evening**.*	—
	*I will see you **after the class**.*	later
Place (where?)	*The cat is sleeping **under the bed**.*	—
	*He lives **at the foot of the hill**.*	—
Reason / purpose (why?)	*He went to Dhaka **to get a job**.*	—
	*He came **for help**.*	—
Degree	*He was angry **to a great extent**.*	very
Frequency	*He visits us **every now and then**.*	occasionally

- He fought **with great courage**. (= courageously)
- The sun sets **in the west**.
- She sang **in a sweet voice**. (= sweetly)
- He went abroad **for higher studies**.
- They came **at last**. (= finally)
- **To my surprise**, he passed.
- He returned home **all of a sudden**. (= suddenly)
- She works **day and night**.

> **Prepositional phrase — adjective or adverb?** A prepositional phrase is an **adjective phrase** if it qualifies a **noun** and an **adverb phrase** if it modifies a **verb**. *The man **in the car** is my uncle* (which man? → adjective). *He sat **in the car*** (where did he sit? → adverb). Always ask: **which word does it describe?**

30.6 The Verb Phrase

A **verb phrase** is a group of words that works as the **verb** of a sentence: **auxiliary/modal + main verb**.

- He **has been working** since morning.
- The bridge **is being built**.
- You **should have told** me.
- She **will be leaving** tomorrow.
- They **might have been sleeping**.

In modern grammar, "verb phrase" also includes **phrasal verbs** (*give up, look after, put off*) — see Chapter 47.

30.7 Phrasal Prepositions and Phrasal Conjunctions

Phrasal (phrase) prepositions are groups of words that work as a single **preposition**:

according to, along with, apart from, as for, because of, by dint of, by means of, by virtue of, by way of, due to, for the sake of, in accordance with, in addition to, in case of, in front of, in lieu of, in order to, in place of, in spite of, instead of, in view of, on account of, on behalf of, owing to, with a view to, with reference to, with regard to, in the event of, in comparison with, in favour of, by reason of, for want of, in consequence of

- **In spite of** the rain, the match continued.
- He was absent **on account of** illness.
- I am speaking **on behalf of** my colleagues.

Phrasal conjunctions work as a single **conjunction**:

as if, as though, as soon as, as long as, as well as, so that, in order that, even if, even though, provided that, in case, as far as, now that, so as, no sooner … than, the moment, by the time

- He talks **as if** he were a king.
- I will help you **as long as** I live.
- Leave **as soon as** you can.

30.8 Interjectional Phrases

Good heavens! Oh dear! Dear me! Thank God! For God's sake! Well done! What a pity! Hear, hear! Alas the day! My goodness!

30.9 Modern Classification by Head Word

International grammars (and SAT/GMAT discussions) classify phrases by their **head** (main word):

Phrase	Head	Example
Noun phrase (NP)	noun / pronoun	***the tall old building*** *near the park*
Verb phrase (VP)	verb	***has been working*** *hard*
Adjective phrase (AdjP)	adjective	***very proud of his son***
Adverb phrase (AdvP)	adverb	***quite slowly***
Prepositional phrase (PP)	preposition	***in the morning***
Infinitive phrase	infinitive	***to learn English quickly***
Gerund phrase	gerund	***swimming in the river***
Participial phrase	participle	***having finished his work***
Absolute phrase	noun + participle	***the sun having set***
Appositive phrase	noun	*Dhaka,* ***the capital of Bangladesh****, …*

30.9.1 Appositive Phrases

An **appositive phrase** is a noun phrase placed **beside** another noun to **rename or explain** it. It is usually set off with commas.

- Rabindranath Tagore, **the first Asian Nobel laureate**, wrote *Gitanjali*.
- My friend, **a doctor in Sylhet**, is coming tomorrow.
- Dhaka, **the capital of Bangladesh**, is very crowded.

30.9.2 Absolute Phrases

An **absolute phrase** (noun/pronoun + participle) modifies the **whole sentence** (Chapter 14.5.2).

- **The weather being fine**, we went out.
- **His work finished**, he went to bed.
- **God willing**, we shall succeed.

30.10 How to Identify a Phrase in an Exam

Step 1: Check that the group has **no subject + finite verb** (otherwise it is a clause). **Step 2:** Find the **word the phrase is attached to** or the **job it does**:

- Is it the **subject / object / complement / object of a preposition**? → **Noun phrase**.
- Does it **describe a noun** (answer *which? what kind?*)? → **Adjective phrase**.
- Does it tell **how / when / where / why** about a verb? → **Adverb phrase**.
- Is it **auxiliary + main verb**? → **Verb phrase**.
- Does it **replace a preposition / conjunction**? → **Phrasal preposition / conjunction**.

Step 3: Try the **one-word substitution test**: *it* (noun), *wise/rich* etc. (adjective), *carefully/there/then* (adverb).

30.11 Worked Examples: Identify the Phrase

1. **To forgive** is divine. → *Noun phrase* (subject).
2. I want **to go home**. → *Noun phrase* (object of *want*).
3. He is a man **of strong character**. → *Adjective phrase* (qualifies *man*).
4. He did it **in a hurry**. → *Adverb phrase* (manner — hastily).
5. **Taking a walk in the morning** is good for health. → *Noun phrase* (gerund phrase, subject).
6. The girl **in the red dress** is my cousin. → *Adjective phrase* (which girl?).
7. She lives **in the red house**. → *Adverb phrase* (where?).
8. **Having finished his homework**, he went out to play. → *Adjective (participial) phrase* (qualifies *he*).
9. He arrived **at the eleventh hour**. → *Adverb phrase* (time).
10. Don't forget **to post the letter**. → *Noun phrase* (object).
11. I have a lot of work **to do**. → *Adjective phrase* (qualifies *work*).
12. He went to the market **to buy vegetables**. → *Adverb phrase* (purpose).
13. **In spite of** his illness, he came. → *Phrasal preposition*.
14. **As soon as** he saw me, he ran away. → *Phrasal conjunction*.
15. **The sun having risen**, we started. → *Absolute phrase* (adverbial — time).
16. Nobody knows **how to solve it**. → *Noun phrase* (object).
17. A friend **in need** is a friend indeed. → *Adjective phrase* (qualifies *friend*).
18. He was **at a loss** what to do. → *Adjective phrase* (complement — = puzzled).
19. He **has been sleeping** for hours. → *Verb phrase*.
20. My hobby is **gardening on the roof**. → *Noun phrase* (complement).

30.12 Phrases in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Sentence fragments (SAT):** A phrase cannot stand alone as a sentence: ✘ *Hoping to win the scholarship.* ✘ *A city known for its rickshaws.* Attach the phrase to a main clause.
- **Modifier placement (GMAT):** Participial, prepositional and appositive phrases must sit next to the noun they describe (Chapter 29).
- **Parallelism (GMAT/SAT):** Phrases in a list must have the same form — all infinitive phrases, all gerund phrases, or all prepositional phrases (Chapter 39).
- **Concision (GMAT):** Prefer a one-word modifier to a wordy phrase when meaning is unchanged: *in a careful manner → carefully*; *at this point in time → now*.

CHAPTER 31

Identification of Clause

Part A · Grammar

31.1 What Is a Clause?

A **clause** is a group of words that contains a **subject** and a **finite verb** and forms **part of a sentence** (or a whole simple sentence).

- **He came** when **I was sleeping**. → two clauses: *He came + when I was sleeping*
- **I know** that **he is honest**. → two clauses
- **The man who lives next door** is a doctor. → *The man … is a doctor + who lives next door*

31.2 Kinds of Clauses

Kind	Description	Example
Independent (Main / Principal) clause	makes complete sense by itself; can stand alone as a sentence	***I know*** that he is honest.
Dependent (Subordinate) clause	does not make complete sense by itself; depends on a main clause; begins with a subordinator	I know **that he is honest**.
Coordinate clause	one of two or more **equal** independent clauses joined by a co-ordinating conjunction	***He is poor***, *but* ***he is honest***.

Subordinate clauses are of **three kinds**, according to the work they do:

1. **Noun clause** — does the work of a **noun**.
2. **Adjective (Relative) clause** — does the work of an **adjective**.
3. **Adverb clause** — does the work of an **adverb**.

31.3 The Noun Clause

A **noun clause** is a subordinate clause that does the work of a **noun**. It can be a **subject, object, complement, object of a preposition** or **in apposition** to a noun.

Common introducers: *that, whether, if, what, who, whom, whose, which, when, where, why, how, whoever, whatever, whichever*

Function	Example
Subject of a verb	***What he said*** *is true.* ***That he is honest*** *is known to all.* ***Whether he will come*** *is doubtful.*
Object of a verb	*I know* ***that he is honest****. Tell me* ***where you live****. I wonder* ***if it will rain****.*
Object of a preposition	*Pay attention to* ***what the teacher says****. It depends on* ***how hard you work****.*
Complement of a verb	*My belief is* ***that he will succeed****. This is* ***what I want****.*
In apposition to a noun	*The news* ***that he had passed*** *pleased us. The fact* ***that she is ill*** *worries me.*
Object of an infinitive / participle	*I want to know* ***why he left****. Knowing* ***that he was ill****, I visited him.*
Subject of a sentence with *It* (anticipatory *it*)	*It is certain* ***that he will win****. (= That he will win is certain.)*

- **Who stole the money** is still a mystery. (subject)
- I don't know **whose book this is**. (object)
- The question is **whether he will agree**. (complement)
- He came back to **where he had started**. (object of preposition)
- The rumour **that the minister had resigned** was false. (apposition to *rumour*)
- **Whatever you do**, do well. — careful: here it is an **adverb clause** of concession (= *No matter what you do*); but in ***Whatever you do*** *will be appreciated* it is a **noun clause** (subject).

> **Exam Tip — Test for a noun clause:** Replace the clause with ***it*** or ***something***. If the sentence still makes sense, it is a noun clause. *I know* ***that he is honest*** → *I know* ***it*** ✔ → noun clause.

31.4 The Adjective (Relative) Clause

An **adjective clause** qualifies a **noun or pronoun** (its **antecedent**) that comes just before it. It answers ***which one? what kind?***

Introducers:

- **Relative pronouns:** *who, whom, whose, which, that, as, but*
- **Relative adverbs:** *where, when, why* (and *wherein, whereby*)
- The relative may be **omitted** when it is the object: *the book (that) I bought*

- The man **who came here yesterday** is my uncle. (qualifies *man*)
- I have lost the pen **which you gave me**. (qualifies *pen*)
- This is the boy **whose father is a doctor**.
- The house **where I was born** is now a school. (*where* = in which; qualifies *house*)
- I remember the day **when we first met**. (qualifies *day*)
- Tell me the reason **why you are late**. (qualifies *reason*)
- He is not the man **(that) I thought he was**.
- Such men **as are honest** are respected. (*as* after *such*)
- There is no one **but loves his country**. (*but* = who … not)

31.4.1 Defining and Non-Defining Adjective Clauses

- **Defining (restrictive):** tells us **which** person/thing; **no commas**; essential to the meaning. *The students* ***who passed*** *were rewarded.*
- **Non-defining (non-restrictive):** gives **extra** information about an already identified noun; **commas** used; *that* cannot be used. *My father,* ***who is a doctor****, lives in Sylhet.* (Chapter 08.9.5)

> **Exam Tip — Test for an adjective clause:** Find the **noun just before** the clause. If the clause **describes that noun** (and the introducer can be replaced by *which / who / in which / at which*), it is an adjective clause. *This is the place* ***where*** *he lives* → *the place* ***in which*** *he lives* ✔ → adjective clause.

31.5 The Adverb Clause

An **adverb clause** modifies a **verb, adjective or adverb** in the main clause, telling **when, where, why, how, with what purpose, with what result, under what condition, in spite of what,** or **to what degree**.

Kind	Introducers	Example
Time	when, whenever, while, as, before, after, till, until, since, as soon as, as long as, once, by the time, now that, the moment	*I will wait **till you come**. **When the cat is away**, the mice will play.*
Place	where, wherever, whence, whither	*Sit **where you like**. **Wherever he goes**, he makes friends.*
Reason / Cause	because, since, as, now that, seeing that, inasmuch as	*He failed **because he was lazy**. **As it was raining**, we stayed home.*
Purpose	that, so that, in order that, lest	*He works hard **so that he may succeed**. Walk carefully **lest you should fall**.*
Result / Consequence	so … that, such … that, that	*He is **so** weak **that he cannot walk**. It was **such** a cold night **that we could not sleep**.*
Condition	if, unless, provided (that), on condition that, in case, supposing, as long as, whether … or	***If you work hard**, you will succeed. **Unless you hurry**, you will miss the bus.*
Concession / Contrast	though, although, even though, even if, while, whereas, however, whatever, no matter how, as (*Rich as he is*)	***Though he is poor**, he is honest. **Whatever you may say**, I will not go.*
Comparison / Degree	than, as … as, so … as, the … the	*He is taller **than I am**. She is **as** clever **as her sister is**. **The more you read**, the more you learn.*
Manner	as, as if, as though, the way	*Do **as I tell you**. He talks **as if he were mad**.*

Exam Tip — Test for an adverb clause: Ask a **when / where / why / how / on what condition / in spite of what** question about the main verb. If the clause answers it, it is an adverb clause. An adverb clause can usually **move** to the front or back of the sentence: ***When he came**, I was sleeping = I was sleeping **when he came**.*

31.6 The Same Introducer in Different Clauses

Many introducers (*that, when, where, why, how, if, whether, what, as*) can begin **any** of the three kinds of clause. The **function** decides the kind — this is the most frequently tested point in clause identification.

31.6.1 *When*

- I know **when he will come**. → **Noun clause** (object of *know* → "I know *it*").
- I remember the day **when he came**. → **Adjective clause** (qualifies *day*).
- I will go **when he comes**. → **Adverb clause** of time (modifies *will go*).
- **When he will come** is not known. → **Noun clause** (subject).

31.6.2 *Where*

- I don't know **where he lives**. → **Noun clause** (object).
- This is the village **where he lives**. → **Adjective clause** (qualifies *village*).
- Sit **where you like**. → **Adverb clause** of place.

31.6.3 *That*

- I know **that he is honest**. → **Noun clause** (object).
- This is the book **that I bought**. → **Adjective clause** (qualifies *book*; *that* = which).
- He works hard **so that he may prosper**. → **Adverb clause** of purpose.
- He is so weak **that he cannot walk**. → **Adverb clause** of result.
- The news **that he has passed** is true. → **Noun clause** in apposition to *news* (*that* cannot be replaced by *which* — compare with the adjective clause: *The news **that he brought** is true → which he brought* ✔ → adjective clause).

Appositive noun clause vs adjective clause after *the fact / the news / the idea / the belief*: If *that* can be replaced by ***which*** and the clause has a "gap" (a missing object), it is an **adjective clause**: *The news **that he told me** was false* (he told me *the news → which*). If the clause is **complete in itself** and explains the content of the noun, it is a **noun clause in apposition**: *The news **that he had died** was false* (he had died — complete; content of the news).

31.6.4 *Why* and *How*

- I don't know **why he left**. → **Noun clause**.
- Tell me the reason **why he left**. → **Adjective clause** (qualifies *reason*).
- I know **how he did it**. → **Noun clause**.
- Do it **as I told you**. → **Adverb clause** of manner.

31.6.5 *If* and *Whether*

- I asked him **if he would help me**. → **Noun clause** (object — indirect question).
- **If you help me**, I shall be grateful. → **Adverb clause** of condition.
- **Whether he will come** is uncertain. → **Noun clause** (subject).
- **Whether he comes or not**, I will go. → **Adverb clause** of condition/concession.

31.6.6 *What*, *Whatever*, *Whoever*

- **What he said** is true. → **Noun clause**.
- **Whatever he says** is true. → **Noun clause** (subject).
- **Whatever he says**, I will not believe him. → **Adverb clause** of concession.
- **Whoever comes** will be welcome. → **Noun clause** (subject).
- **Whoever comes**, don't open the door. → **Adverb clause** of concession.

31.6.7 *As*

- **As he was ill**, he could not come. → **Adverb clause** of reason.
- He came **as I was leaving**. → **Adverb clause** of time.
- Do **as I say**. → **Adverb clause** of manner.
- He is as tall **as his brother is**. → **Adverb clause** of comparison.
- **Rich as he is**, he is not happy. → **Adverb clause** of concession.
- Such men **as are honest** are respected. → **Adjective clause** (*as* = who).

31.6.8 *Since*, *Before*, *After*, *Till*

- It is ten years **since he died**. → **Adverb clause** of time.
- **Since you are tired**, you may rest. → **Adverb clause** of reason.
- Finish it **before he comes**. → **Adverb clause** of time.

31.7 Analysis of Complex Sentences (Clause Analysis)

Clause analysis means breaking a sentence into its clauses and stating the **kind** and **function** of each. This is asked in admission tests and BCS Written.

Steps:

1. Find all the **finite verbs** — there are as many clauses as finite verbs.
2. Find the **main clause** (the one that makes sense alone and does not begin with a subordinator).
3. Separate each **subordinate clause** with its introducer.
4. State the **kind** (noun / adjective / adverb) and the **function** (subject, object, qualifies X, modifies Y — time, reason …).

Example 1: *When I reached the station, I found that the train had left.*

Clause	Kind	Function
I found	Main clause	—
When I reached the station	Subordinate adverb clause of time	modifies *found*
that the train had left	Subordinate noun clause	object of *found*

Example 2: *The man who was injured in the accident says that he will go to court if he does not get compensation.*

Clause	Kind	Function
The man … says	Main clause	—
who was injured in the accident	Adjective clause	qualifies *man*
that he will go to court	Noun clause	object of *says*
if he does not get compensation	Adverb clause of condition	modifies *will go*

Example 3: *Tell me where you have kept the book that I gave you.*

Clause	Kind	Function
(You) tell me	Main clause	—
where you have kept the book	Noun clause	object of *tell*
that I gave you	Adjective clause	qualifies *book*

31.8 Reducing Clauses to Phrases

Many clauses can be **shortened into phrases** (useful in transformation questions and for concise GMAT style).

Clause	Reduced phrase
*The man **who is standing** at the gate* (adjective clause)	*The man **standing** at the gate* (participial phrase)
*The book **which was written** by him*	*The book **written** by him*
***When he saw** the police, he ran away.* (adverb clause)	***Seeing** the police, he ran away.* / ***On seeing** the police …*
***As he was** ill, he could not come.*	***Being** ill, he could not come.*
***After he had finished**, he went out.*	***Having finished**, he went out.*
*He works hard **so that he may succeed**.*	*He works hard **to succeed**.*
*I know **that he is honest**.* (noun clause)	*I know him **to be honest**.* / *I know **of his honesty**.*
*He is so weak **that he cannot walk**.*	*He is too weak **to walk**.*
***If you work hard**, you will succeed.*	***By working hard**, you will succeed.*
***Though he is rich**, he is unhappy.*	***In spite of** being rich, he is unhappy.*

31.9 Worked Examples: Identify the Clause

1. I believe **that he is innocent**. → *Noun clause* (object of *believe*).
2. The boy **who stood first** got a prize. → *Adjective clause* (qualifies *boy*).
3. **If it rains**, the match will be cancelled. → *Adverb clause* of condition.
4. **Why he did it** is a mystery. → *Noun clause* (subject).
5. This is the house **where Nazrul lived**. → *Adjective clause* (qualifies *house*).
6. He ran **so fast that he won the race**. → *Adverb clause* of result (*that he won the race*).
7. I shall wait **until you return**. → *Adverb clause* of time.
8. He spoke **as if he were angry**. → *Adverb clause* of manner.
9. The fact **that he lied** is clear. → *Noun clause* in apposition to *fact*.
10. **Though he worked hard**, he failed. → *Adverb clause* of concession.
11. Do you know **who wrote *Agnibeena***? → *Noun clause* (object).
12. He did not come **because he was ill**. → *Adverb clause* of reason.
13. You may go **wherever you like**. → *Adverb clause* of place.
14. I have a friend **whose brother is a pilot**. → *Adjective clause*.
15. He is older **than I am**. → *Adverb clause* of comparison.
16. He saved money **so that he might buy a house**. → *Adverb clause* of purpose.
17. My fear is **that he will not come**. → *Noun clause* (complement).
18. Listen to **what the teacher says**. → *Noun clause* (object of preposition *to*).
19. There is no reason **why you should worry**. → *Adjective clause* (qualifies *reason*).
20. **Whatever you may do**, do it well. → *Adverb clause* of concession.

31.10 Common Errors with Clauses

1. ✘ I know where does he live. ✔ I know where **he lives**. (no inversion in noun clauses)
2. ✘ What he said it is true. ✔ What he said **is** true. (no extra subject)
3. ✘ The man who he came here is my uncle. ✔ The man **who came** here is my uncle.
4. ✘ The book which I bought it is interesting. ✔ The book which I bought is interesting.
5. ✘ This is the place where I was born there. ✔ This is the place where I was born.
6. ✘ Because he was ill. (fragment) ✔ He was absent **because he was ill**.
7. ✘ That he is honest everybody knows it. ✔ **That he is honest** everybody knows. / Everybody knows **that he is honest**.
8. ✘ I asked him that what he wanted. ✔ I asked him **what he wanted**.
9. ✘ The reason why he failed is because he was lazy. ✔ … is **that** he was lazy.
10. ✘ He is the man which helped me. ✔ He is the man **who** helped me.

31.11 Clauses in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Fragments and run-ons (SAT):** a dependent clause alone is a **fragment** (✘ *Although the plan was good.*); two independent clauses joined only by a comma are a **comma splice** (✘ *The plan was good, it failed.*). Fix with a conjunction, semicolon or full stop.
- **Relative clause placement (GMAT):** *which / who / that* must follow the noun it modifies directly (“touch rule”).
- **Noun clauses after reporting verbs (GMAT):** use ***that***: ✘ *Scientists claim the discovery as significant.* ✔ *Scientists claim **that** the discovery is significant.* Many GMAT answers that drop *that* after *claim, hypothesise, argue* are marked less clear.
- **GRE Reading:** long sentences with multiple embedded clauses are typical; identifying the **main clause** quickly reveals the author’s central claim.

CHAPTER 32

Sentence & Its Classification (By Meaning)

Part A · Grammar

32.1 What Is a Sentence?

A **sentence** is a group of words that expresses a **complete thought**. It begins with a **capital letter** and ends with a **full stop (.)**, a **question mark (?)** or an **exclamation mark (!)**. Grammatically, a sentence must have at least one **subject** and one **finite verb** (the subject may be understood, as in commands).

- The sun rises in the east.
- Where do you live?
- Shut the door. (subject *you* understood)
- What a beautiful flower it is!
- ✘ *In the morning.* / ✘ *Because he was ill.* — not sentences (fragments)

32.1.1 Subject and Predicate

Every sentence has two parts:

- **Subject** — the person or thing **about which** something is said.
- **Predicate** — what is **said about** the subject (it always contains the **finite verb**).

Subject	Predicate
The little boy	is crying.
My elder brother	works in a bank in Chattogram.
Honesty	is the best policy.
(You)	Shut the door.
Where	do you live? (*you* = subject; *do … live* *where* = predicate)

The **simple subject** is the main noun/pronoun (*boy*); the **complete subject** includes its modifiers (*The little boy*). The **simple predicate** is the verb (*is crying*); the **complete predicate** includes objects, complements and modifiers.

32.1.2 The Elements of a Sentence and Basic Patterns

A clause can contain five kinds of elements: **Subject (S), Verb (V), Object (O — direct Od / indirect Oi), Complement (C — subjective Cs / objective Co)** and **Adverbial (A)**. They combine into seven basic patterns:

Pattern	Example
S + V	*Birds **fly**. / The baby **is sleeping**.*
S + V + O	*She **wrote** a letter.*
S + V + C	*He **is** a doctor. She **looks** tired.*
S + V + A	*He **lives** in Dhaka. The meeting **is** at five.*
S + V + Oi + Od	*He **gave** me a book.*
S + V + O + C	*They **elected** him captain. The news **made** her sad.*
S + V + O + A	*She **put** the book on the table.*

Understanding these patterns helps with voice change (Chapter 26), word-order errors and sentence building.

32.2 Classification of Sentences by Meaning (Function)

According to **meaning or purpose**, sentences are of **five** kinds:

Kind	Purpose	Ends with	Example
Assertive (Declarative)	states a fact or opinion	.	*Dhaka is the capital of Bangladesh.*
Interrogative	asks a question	?	*Where do you live?*
Imperative	gives a command, request, advice or prohibition	. (or !)	*Please sit down.*
Optative	expresses a wish or prayer	! (or .)	*May you live long!*
Exclamatory	expresses strong feeling	!	*What a lovely day it is!*

32.3 Assertive (Declarative) Sentences

An **assertive sentence** makes a **statement** — it states a fact, an opinion or a belief. It may be **affirmative** (positive) or **negative**.

Structure: Subject + Verb + (Object / Complement / Adverbial). Normal word order.

- **Affirmative:** *The earth moves round the sun. I like mangoes. He has finished his work.*
- **Negative:** *He does not smoke. I have never seen a tiger. Nobody came. He can hardly walk.*

> A sentence with ***hardly, scarcely, seldom, rarely, never, no, nobody, nothing, neither, none, few, little*** is **negative in meaning** even if it has no *not* (important for tag questions and transformation).

32.4 Interrogative Sentences

An **interrogative sentence** asks a **question** and ends with a **question mark**.

Type	Structure	Example
Yes/No question	Auxiliary + S + V …?	***Are** you ready? **Did** he come? **Can** you swim?*
Wh-question	Wh-word + auxiliary + S + V …?	***Where do** you live? **Why are** you late? **What did** he say?*
Wh-question (wh-word as subject)	Wh-word + V …? (no inversion)	***Who broke** the glass? **What happened**?*
Alternative question	… or …?	*Do you want tea **or** coffee?*
Tag question	statement + tag?	*You are a student, **aren't you?*** (Chapter 28)
Negative question	Auxiliary + n't + S …? (surprise, expected *yes*)	***Isn't** it a beautiful day? **Didn't** I tell you?*
Statement question (spoken)	statement form + ? (rising tone)	*You are leaving already?*

32.4.1 Rhetorical Questions

A **rhetorical question** is a question that **does not expect an answer**; it is used for **effect**, and it really makes an **assertion**. A positive rhetorical question means a **negative** statement, and vice versa.

- **Who** does not love his country? (= *Everybody loves his country.*)
- **What** is the use of crying? (= *It is no use crying.*)
- **Can** the leopard change its spots? (= *The leopard cannot change its spots.*)
- **Is** this the way to treat a guest? (= *This is not the way to treat a guest.*)
- **Who** can tell what will happen tomorrow? (= *Nobody can tell …*)

32.4.2 Indirect (Embedded) Questions

A question **inside a statement** is not an interrogative sentence; it has **statement word order** and **no question mark**: *I wonder **where he lives**. Tell me **what your name is**.* (Chapter 37)

32.5 Imperative Sentences

An **imperative sentence** expresses a **command, order, request, advice, suggestion, warning, invitation or prohibition**. The subject *you* is usually **understood**, and the verb is in the **base form**.

Meaning	Example
Command / order	*Shut the door. Stand up. Get out.*
Request	***Please** help me. **Kindly** lend me your pen. Open the window, **will you?***
Advice	*Work hard. Take care of your health. Never tell a lie.*
Prohibition	***Don't** smoke here. **Do not** make a noise. **Never** do it again.*
Warning	*Look out! Beware of dogs. Mind your step.*
Invitation	*Come and have dinner with us. Have some tea.*
Suggestion / proposal (*Let us*)	***Let us** go for a walk. **Let's** play.*
Permission (*Let me / him*)	***Let me** go. **Let him** do it.*
Emphatic	***Do** sit down. **Do** come again.*
With subject (contrast or emphasis)	***You** stay here; I'll go. **Somebody** answer the phone.*

> ***Would you mind …? / Could you please …? / Will you …?*** are **interrogative** in form but **imperative (request)** in meaning. In exams, classify by **form** unless the question asks for meaning: *"Will you open the door?"* — interrogative sentence (expressing a request).

32.6 Optative Sentences

An **optative sentence** expresses a **wish, prayer, blessing or curse**. It usually begins with ***May***, or uses a subjunctive form (*Long live, God bless*), *Would that, If only, Wish*.

- **May** you live long!
- **May** Allah bless you!
- **May** you be happy in your new life!
- **Long live** Bangladesh!
- **God save** the Queen!
- **Would that** I were young again!
- **If only** I could see her once more!
- **Wish** you a happy journey!
- **Good luck** to you! / **Happy** birthday!

> **Exam Tip — *May* in two kinds of sentences:** *May I come in?* — an **interrogative** sentence (asking permission; ends with ?). *May you prosper!* — an **optative** sentence (expressing a wish; ends with !). The word order differs: *May **I** come* (question) vs *May **you** prosper* (wish to someone).

32.7 Exclamatory Sentences

An **exclamatory sentence** expresses a **sudden or strong feeling** — joy, sorrow, surprise, anger, wonder, praise — and ends with an **exclamation mark**.

Common structures:

Structure	Example
***What** + a/an + (adjective) + singular noun + S + V!*	***What a** beautiful garden it is!*
***What** + (adjective) + plural/uncountable noun + S + V!*	***What** lovely flowers they are! **What** fine weather it is!*
***How** + adjective/adverb + S + V!*	***How** beautiful the garden is! **How** fast he runs!*
Interjection + sentence	***Alas!** He is dead. **Hurrah!** We have won.*
If only / Oh that …!	***If only** I were rich!*
Short exclamations	*What a pity! How sad! Good heavens!*

- **What a** fool he is!
- **How** sweetly she sings!
- **What** a wonderful scene!
- **How** kind of you!
- **Alas!** We have lost the match.
- **Bravo!** Well done!

> In an exclamatory sentence, the **subject comes before the verb** (statement order): *How beautiful **the garden is**!* (✘ How beautiful is the garden! — this is literary/poetic only.)

32.8 Identifying the Kind of Sentence: Tricky Cases

1. *Who can tell what will happen?* → **Interrogative** in form (rhetorical; assertive in meaning: *Nobody can tell …*).
2. *Will you please help me?* → **Interrogative** in form (request in meaning).
3. *May you be happy!* → **Optative**.
4. *May I come in?* → **Interrogative**.
5. *Let us go out.* → **Imperative** (proposal).
6. *How do you do?* → **Interrogative** in form (a formal greeting).
7. *How happy he is!* → **Exclamatory**.
8. *How happy is he?* → **Interrogative** (asking the degree of happiness).
9. *I wonder where he is.* → **Assertive** (contains an indirect question).
10. *Never tell a lie.* → **Imperative** (advice).
11. *He never tells a lie.* → **Assertive** (negative).
12. *Long live our motherland!* → **Optative**.
13. *What a pity!* → **Exclamatory**.
14. *What is your name?* → **Interrogative**.
15. *Don't you know him?* → **Interrogative** (negative question).

32.9 Sentence Types in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Fragments (SAT):** Every sentence needs a subject and a finite verb in an independent clause. Watch out for "sentences" that are really long phrases or dependent clauses: ✘ *The new library, which opened last year and has thousands of books.* (no main verb for *library*) ✔ *The new library, which opened last year,* ***has*** *thousands of books.*
- **Rhetorical questions in GRE/SAT Reading** often signal the author's **position** — the expected answer is the author's point.
- **GMAT Sentence Correction** uses only **declarative** sentences; imperatives and questions do not appear in answer choices.

CHAPTER 33

Classification of Sentence (By Structure)

Part A · Grammar

33.1 Four Kinds of Sentences by Structure

According to **structure** — that is, the **number and kind of clauses** they contain — sentences are of four kinds:

Kind	Structure	Example
Simple	**one** independent clause (one subject–finite verb unit)	*He is poor but honest.*
Complex	**one** independent clause + **one or more** dependent clauses	*Though he is poor, he is honest.*
Compound	**two or more** independent clauses joined by coordinating conjunctions (or a semicolon)	*He is poor, but he is honest.*
Compound-Complex (Mixed)	**two or more** independent clauses + **at least one** dependent clause	*He is poor, but he is honest because his parents taught him well.*

The counting method: (1) Count the **finite verbs** — each finite verb (with its subject) makes a clause. (2) Decide whether each clause is **independent** or **dependent** (does it begin with a subordinator such as *when, because, if, that, who, which, though*?). (3) Apply the table above.

33.2 The Simple Sentence

A **simple sentence** has **only one finite verb** (one subject–predicate unit). It may have a **compound subject**, a **compound verb**, and any number of **phrases**, but **no subordinate clause**.

- The sun rises in the east.
- Rahim **and** Karim are brothers. (compound subject — still one clause)
- He **came, saw and conquered**. (compound predicate with one subject — traditionally treated as simple)
- **Having finished his work**, he went out to play. (participial phrase — not a clause)
- He is **too** weak **to walk**. (infinitive phrase)
- **In spite of** being poor, he is honest. (prepositional phrase)
- **The sun having set**, we went home. (absolute phrase)
- I want **to know the truth**.
- **On seeing the police**, the thief ran away.

Exam Tip — Non-finite verbs don't count. Infinitives (*to walk*), gerunds (*walking*) and participles (*having finished, written*) are **not finite verbs**, so they do not create clauses. *Seeing the police, he ran away* has one finite verb (*ran*) → **simple**.

33.3 The Complex Sentence

A **complex sentence** has **one main (independent) clause** and **one or more subordinate (dependent) clauses**. The subordinate clauses may be noun, adjective or adverb clauses (Chapter 31).

Subordinators: *that, if, whether, who, whom, whose, which, what, when, where, why, how, because, since, as, though, although, unless, until, till, before, after, so that, lest, as soon as, as if, than, while, whereas …*

- **When the sun sets**, the birds return to their nests. (adverb clause)
- I know **that he is honest**. (noun clause)
- The man **who came here** is my uncle. (adjective clause)
- **If you work hard**, you will succeed.
- **Though he is rich**, he is not happy.
- He is so weak **that he cannot walk**.
- This is the house **where I was born**.
- Tell me **what you want**.
- He said **that he would come if he got time**. (one main + two subordinate clauses)

33.4 The Compound Sentence

A **compound sentence** has **two or more independent (coordinate) clauses**. Each could stand alone as a sentence. They are joined by:

- **Coordinating conjunctions:** *and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet* (FANBOYS);
- **Correlative conjunctions:** *either … or, neither … nor, not only … but also, both … and*;
- **Conjunctive adverbs** with a semicolon: *; however, ; therefore, ; otherwise, ; moreover, ; still, ; nevertheless*;
- A **semicolon** alone.

- He is poor, **but** he is honest.
- Work hard, **or** you will fail.
- He came, **and** he left at once.
- She is ill, **so** she can't come.
- He **not only** wrote the letter **but also** posted it. (one subject; compound predicate — usually counted as compound in exams when the correlative joins two predicates)
- **Either** you go, **or** I go.
- He was tired; **nevertheless**, he worked till midnight.
- The sun set; the stars appeared.

33.4.1 Kinds of Coordinate Connection

Relationship	Conjunctions	Example
Cumulative (addition)	and, both … and, not only … but also, as well as, moreover	*He is clever **and** he is hard-working.*
Adversative (contrast)	but, yet, still, however, nevertheless, whereas, while	*He is rich, **yet** he is unhappy.*
Alternative (choice)	or, either … or, neither … nor, otherwise, else	*Hurry up, **or** you will be late.*
Illative (result/inference)	so, therefore, hence, consequently, for	*It was raining, **so** we stayed home.*

33.5 The Compound-Complex (Mixed) Sentence

A **compound-complex sentence** has **at least two independent clauses** and **at least one dependent clause**.

- He is poor, **but** he is honest **because** his parents taught him well.

- **When** the bell rang, the students went out, **and** the teacher locked the door.
- I know **that** he is clever, **but** he is lazy.
- She said **that** she would come, **but** she did not.

33.6 Identifying Sentence Structure: Worked Examples

1. *I saw a man walking along the road.* → **Simple** (one finite verb *saw*; *walking* is a participle).
2. *I saw a man who was walking along the road.* → **Complex** (*who was walking* — adjective clause).
3. *I saw a man, and he was walking along the road.* → **Compound**.
4. *He confessed his guilt.* → **Simple**.
5. *He confessed that he was guilty.* → **Complex** (noun clause).
6. *He was guilty, and he confessed it.* → **Compound**.
7. *Being tired, he went to bed.* → **Simple**.
8. *As he was tired, he went to bed.* → **Complex**.
9. *He was tired, so he went to bed.* → **Compound**.
10. *He is too old to work.* → **Simple**.
11. *He is so old that he cannot work.* → **Complex**.
12. *He is very old, and so he cannot work.* → **Compound**.
13. *In spite of his poverty, he is happy.* → **Simple**.
14. *Though he is poor, he is happy.* → **Complex**.
15. *He is poor, but he is happy.* → **Compound**.
16. *Tell me where you live and what you do.* → **Complex** (main clause *Tell me* + two noun clauses joined by *and*; still one independent clause).
17. *He came when I was sleeping, but I did not wake up.* → **Compound-complex**.
18. *Rahim, Karim and Jamal went to Sylhet and visited the tea gardens.* → **Simple** (compound subject and compound predicate, one clause).
19. *The sun having set, we went home.* → **Simple** (absolute phrase).
20. *Hardly had he left when it began to rain.* → **Complex** (*when it began to rain* — adverb clause).

33.7 Synthesis of Sentences (Combining Simple Sentences)

Synthesis means **combining two or more simple sentences into one** — simple, complex or compound — without changing the meaning. It is the reverse of analysis and a common transformation task.

33.7.1 Combining into a Simple Sentence

Method	Separate sentences	Combined (simple)
Present participle	*He saw the police. He ran away.*	***Seeing** the police, he ran away.*
Perfect participle	*He finished his work. He went home.*	***Having finished** his work, he went home.*
Past participle	*The book is written in simple English. It is popular.*	***Written** in simple English, the book is popular.*
Infinitive	*He went to Dhaka. He wanted to find a job.*	*He went to Dhaka **to find** a job.*
Too … to	*He is very weak. He cannot walk.*	*He is **too** weak **to walk**.*
Preposition + gerund/noun	*He was ill. He could not attend the meeting.*	***Because of** his illness, he could not attend the meeting.* / ***Owing to** illness, …*
Apposition	*Dhaka is the capital of Bangladesh. It is a busy city.*	*Dhaka, **the capital of Bangladesh**, is a busy city.*
Absolute phrase	*The sun set. We returned home.*	***The sun having set**, we returned home.*
Adverb / phrase	*He failed. It was unfortunate.*	***Unfortunately**, he failed.*
In spite of	*He is rich. He is not happy.*	***In spite of** his wealth, he is not happy.*

33.7.2 Combining into a Complex Sentence

Method	Separate sentences	Combined (complex)
Noun clause	*He is honest. Everybody knows it.*	*Everybody knows **that** he is honest.*
Adjective clause	*This is the man. He helped me.*	*This is the man **who** helped me.*
Adverb clause (time)	*The bell rang. The students went out.*	***When** the bell rang, the students went out.*
Adverb clause (reason)	*He was ill. He did not come.*	***As** he was ill, he did not come.*
Adverb clause (concession)	*He is poor. He is honest.*	***Though** he is poor, he is honest.*
Adverb clause (condition)	*Work hard. You will succeed.*	***If** you work hard, you will succeed.*
Adverb clause (result)	*He is very weak. He cannot walk.*	*He is **so** weak **that** he cannot walk.*

33.7.3 Combining into a Compound Sentence

Method	Separate sentences	Combined (compound)
and	*He came. He saw the house.*	*He came **and** saw the house.*
but	*He is rich. He is unhappy.*	*He is rich, **but** he is unhappy.*
or / otherwise	*Work hard. You will fail.*	*Work hard, **or** you will fail.*
so / therefore	*He was ill. He did not come.*	*He was ill, **so** he did not come.*
not only … but also	*He is a poet. He is a painter.*	*He is **not only** a poet **but also** a painter.*
either … or / neither … nor	*He is not rich. He is not poor.*	*He is **neither** rich **nor** poor.*

33.8 Sentence Structure in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Run-on sentences and comma splices (SAT):** two independent clauses must be joined by **a comma + coordinating conjunction**, a **semicolon**, a **colon** (when the second explains the first), or separated by a **full stop**. ✘ *The rain stopped, we went out.* ✔ *The rain stopped, **and** we went out.* / *The rain stopped; we went out.*
- **Subordination for logic (GMAT):** GMAT often prefers a **complex** sentence that shows the logical relation (*Because …, although …*) over a loose compound sentence joined by *and*.
- **Sentence variety:** In GRE/GMAT essays (Analytical Writing), mixing simple, complex and compound sentences shows mastery; strings of short simple sentences look immature.

CHAPTER 34

Transformation of Sentence

Part A · Grammar

34.1 What Is Transformation?

Transformation of sentences means changing the **form** of a sentence **without changing its meaning**. A sentence can be transformed from one **kind** to another (assertive ↔ interrogative ↔ imperative ↔ exclamatory ↔ optative), from one **structure** to another (simple ↔ complex ↔ compound), from **affirmative to negative**, from one **degree of comparison** to another, from **active to passive** and from **direct to indirect** speech.

Transformation is a standard question in SSC, HSC, university admission tests and BCS Written, and it trains the flexibility needed for GMAT Sentence Correction and SAT Writing, where the same idea must be recognised in different forms.

> **Golden rule:** The **meaning and the tense** must remain the same. Only the **form** changes.

34.2 Affirmative into Negative (and Vice Versa)

The basic method is to **negate the opposite**: *He is rich → He is **not poor***. Learn the following patterns.

Rule	Affirmative	Negative
Use an **antonym** + *not*	*He is honest.*	*He is **not dishonest**.*
	I remember you.	*I do **not forget** you.*
	He was present.	*He was **not absent**.*
	She is always punctual.	*She is **never late**.*
Only / alone (person) → ***none but***	*Only Rahim can do it.*	***None but** Rahim can do it.*
Only (thing) → ***nothing but***	*He drinks only milk.*	*He drinks **nothing but** milk.*
Only (number/age) → ***not more than / not above***	*He is only ten.*	*He is **not more than** ten.*
Must → cannot but / cannot help + -ing	*We must obey our parents.*	*We **cannot but** obey our parents. / We **cannot help obeying** …*
Every / everybody / all → There is no … but / not … any	*Everybody loves flowers.*	***There is no one who does not** love flowers. / **There is nobody but** loves flowers.*
	Every mother loves her child.	***There is no mother who does not** love her child.*
All → none … not / not … any	*All the boys were present.*	***None** of the boys was absent.*
Always → never	*He always speaks the truth.*	*He **never** tells a lie.*
Sometimes → not always	*Sometimes he comes.*	*He does **not always** come.*
As … as → not less … than	*Rahim is as tall as Karim.*	*Rahim is **not less** tall **than** Karim. / Karim is **not taller than** Rahim.*
Too … to → so … that … cannot	*He is too weak to walk.*	*He is **so** weak **that** he **cannot** walk.*
Both … and → not only … but also	*Both Rahim and Karim came.*	***Not only** Rahim **but also** Karim came.*

Rule	Affirmative	Negative
Many → not a few	*He has many friends.*	*He has **not a few** friends.*
Much → not a little	*He has much money.*	*He has **not a little** money.*
A few / a little → not many / not much (reverse)	*He has a few books.*	*He does **not** have **many** books.*
Few / little → not many / not much	*Few people are honest.*	***Not many** people are honest.*
As soon as → no sooner … than	*As soon as he came, the bell rang.*	***No sooner had** he come **than** the bell rang.*
Superlative → *No other … so/as … as*	*He is the best boy in the class.*	***No other** boy in the class is **as good as** he.*
Comparative → *not so … as*	*Rahim is taller than Karim.*	*Karim is **not so tall as** Rahim.*
Doubt → not sure	*I doubt whether he will come.*	*I am **not sure** whether he will come.*
Hate → not like / not love	*I hate liars.*	*I **do not like** liars.*
Fail → not succeed	*He failed in the exam.*	*He **did not succeed** in the exam.*
Sometimes … sometimes	*He was sometimes kind.*	*He was **not always** cruel.*
Universal truth	*Man is mortal.*	*Man is **not immortal**.*
Love → not hate	*I love my country.*	*I do **not hate** my country.*

34.2.1 Negative into Affirmative

Reverse the rules above:

- *He is not dishonest. → He is **honest**.*
- *None but the brave deserves the fair. → **Only** the brave deserve the fair.*
- *There is no rose without a thorn. → **Every** rose has a thorn.*
- *I cannot but laugh. → I **must** laugh.*
- *He never fails to do his duty. → He **always** does his duty.*
- *No sooner had he seen me than he ran away. → **As soon as** he saw me, he ran away.*
- *There is no one but loves his country. → **Everybody** loves his country.*
- *Not a few people attended. → **Many** people attended.*

34.3 Assertive into Interrogative (and Vice Versa)

An assertive sentence is changed into a **rhetorical question**. **Affirmative** assertive → **negative** interrogative; **negative** assertive → **affirmative** interrogative.

Assertive	Interrogative
He is honest.	***Isn't** he honest?*
He is not honest.	***Is** he honest?*
I can do it.	***Can't** I do it?*
It is no use crying.	***What is the use of** crying?*
There is no use crying over spilt milk.	***What is the use of** crying over spilt milk?*
Everybody loves his country.	***Who does not** love his country?*

Assertive	Interrogative
Nobody can do this.	***Who can** do this?*
I never saw such a sight.	***Did** I **ever** see such a sight?*
He never tells a lie.	***Does** he **ever** tell a lie?*
Nothing can please him.	***What** can please him?*
There is none so foolish.	***Who** is so foolish?*
I shall never forget you.	***Shall** I **ever** forget you?*
It does not matter if we fail.	***What does it matter** if we fail?*
All are mortal.	***Who** is not mortal?*
There is no need to hurry.	***Is there any need** to hurry?*

> **Exam Tip — Word pairs for this transformation:** *everybody / everyone / all → **who … not**; nobody / no one / none → **who**; never → **ever**; nothing → **what**; it is no use → **what is the use of**; there is no → **is there any**; it does not matter → **what does it matter**.*

34.4 Assertive into Exclamatory (and Vice Versa)

Assertive sentences with ***very, great, a matter of joy/sorrow, I wish*** can be turned into exclamatory sentences with ***What, How, Hurrah, Alas, Would that, If only***.

Assertive	Exclamatory
It is a very beautiful scene.	***What a** beautiful scene it is!*
The scene is very beautiful.	***How** beautiful the scene is!*
He is a great fool.	***What a** fool he is!*
She sings very sweetly.	***How** sweetly she sings!*
They are very lovely flowers.	***What** lovely flowers they are!*
It is a matter of joy that we have won.	***Hurrah!** We have won.*
It is a matter of sorrow that he has failed.	***Alas!** He has failed.*
I wish I were a bird.	***Would that** I were a bird! / **If only** I were a bird!*
It is very kind of you.	***How kind of you!***
I wish I could be young again.	***Oh, that** I could be young again!*

Exclamatory into assertive — the reverse:

- *What a nice dress it is! → It is a **very** nice dress.*
- *How happy we are! → We are **very** happy.*
- *Alas! I am undone. → It is **a matter of sorrow** that I am undone.*
- *Bravo! You have done well. → It is **praiseworthy** that you have done well.*

34.5 Assertive into Imperative (and Vice Versa)

Assertive	Imperative
You should obey your parents.	***Obey** your parents.*
You must not smoke here.	***Don't smoke** here.*
I request you to help me.	***Please help** me.*
I order you to leave.	***Leave**.*
You should never tell a lie.	***Never tell** a lie.*
I propose that we should go for a walk.	***Let us go** for a walk.*
It is wrong to waste time.	***Don't waste** time.*
Everybody should do his duty.	***Let everybody do** his duty. / **Do** your duty.*
If you work hard, you will succeed.	***Work hard, and** you will succeed.*
If you do not work hard, you will fail.	***Work hard, or** you will fail.*

Imperative into assertive:

- *Shut the door. → You **are ordered to** shut the door. / I **order you to** shut the door.*
- *Please give me a pen. → I **request you to** give me a pen.*
- *Never do it again. → You **should never** do it again.*
- *Let us start. → I **propose that we should** start.*

34.6 Assertive into Optative (and Vice Versa)

Assertive	Optative
I wish that you may live long.	***May** you live long!*
I pray that Allah may bless you.	***May** Allah bless you!*
We wish our country long life.	***Long live** our country!*
I wish you a happy journey.	***Have a** happy journey! / **Wish** you a happy journey!*

34.7 Interrogative into Assertive

Reverse 34.3: a **positive** rhetorical question → **negative** statement; a **negative** question → **positive** statement.

- *Who does not love flowers? → **Everybody** loves flowers.*
- *Can the leopard change its spots? → The leopard **cannot** change its spots.*
- *Is there any man who does not love his country? → There is **no** man who does not love his country.*
- *What is the use of studying without understanding? → **It is no use** studying without understanding.*
- *Didn't he help you? → He **helped** you.*
- *When can we forget those days? → We can **never** forget those days.*

34.8 Simple, Complex and Compound: Inter-Transformation

This is the largest and most frequently tested area of transformation. The tables show the **same idea** in all three structures.

34.8.1 Time

Simple	Complex	Compound
***Seeing** the police, the thief ran away.*	***When** the thief saw the police, he ran away.*	*The thief saw the police **and** ran away.*
***On hearing** the news, she fainted.*	***As soon as** she heard the news, she fainted.*	*She heard the news **and** (immediately) fainted.*
***Having finished** his work, he went home.*	***After** he had finished his work, he went home.*	*He finished his work **and** went home.*
***At the time of** my arrival, he was sleeping.*	***When** I arrived, he was sleeping.*	*I arrived, **and** at that time he was sleeping.*
***Before** his death, he made a will.*	***Before** he died, he made a will.*	*He made a will **and** then died.*

34.8.2 Reason / Cause

Simple	Complex	Compound
***Being** ill, he could not come.*	***As / Since / Because** he was ill, he could not come.*	*He was ill, **so** he could not come.*
***Because of / Owing to** illness, he could not come.*	***Because** he was ill, he could not come.*	*He was ill **and therefore** could not come.*
*He was punished **for his laziness**.*	*He was punished **because he was lazy**.*	*He was lazy, **and so** he was punished.*

34.8.3 Condition

Simple	Complex	Compound
***By working hard**, you will succeed.*	***If** you work hard, you will succeed.*	*Work hard, **and** you will succeed.*
***Without working hard**, you will fail.*	***If** you do **not** work hard / **Unless** you work hard, you will fail.*	*Work hard, **or** you will fail.*
***In case of** rain, the match will be cancelled.*	***If** it rains, the match will be cancelled.*	*It may rain, **and then** the match will be cancelled.*
***But for** his help, I would have failed.*	***If** he **had not** helped me, I would have failed.*	*He helped me, **or else** I would have failed.*

34.8.4 Concession / Contrast

Simple	Complex	Compound
***In spite of / Despite** his poverty, he is honest.*	***Though / Although** he is poor, he is honest.*	*He is poor, **but** he is honest. / He is poor, **yet** he is honest.*
***Notwithstanding** his efforts, he failed.*	***Though** he tried hard, he failed.*	*He tried hard, **but** he failed.*
*He is poor **but** honest.* (one clause)	***Although** he is poor, he is honest.*	*He is poor, **nevertheless** he is honest.*

34.8.5 Purpose

Simple	Complex	Compound
*He works hard **to pass** the exam.*	*He works hard **so that he may pass** the exam.*	*He wants to pass the exam, **and so** he works hard.*
*He came here **for help**.*	*He came here **so that he might get help**.*	*He wanted help, **and so** he came here.*
*Walk fast **to catch** the bus.*	*Walk fast **so that you may catch** the bus.*	*Walk fast, **or** you will miss the bus.*

34.8.6 Result

Simple	Complex	Compound
*He is **too** weak **to walk**.*	*He is **so** weak **that** he cannot walk.*	*He is very weak, **and so** he cannot walk.*
*He is **strong enough to lift** the box.*	*He is **so** strong **that** he can lift the box.*	*He is very strong, **and so** he can lift the box.*
*The tea is **too hot to drink**.*	*The tea is **so** hot **that** it cannot be drunk / that we cannot drink it.*	*The tea is very hot, **so** we cannot drink it.*

34.8.7 Noun Phrase ↔ Noun Clause

Simple	Complex	Compound
*I know **his address**.*	*I know **where he lives**.*	*He lives somewhere, **and** I know the place.*
*He confessed **his guilt**.*	*He confessed **that he was guilty**.*	*He was guilty, **and** he confessed it.*
*I believe **him to be honest**.*	*I believe **that he is honest**.*	*He is honest, **and** I believe it.*
*His **success** is certain.*	*It is certain **that he will succeed**.*	*He will succeed, **and** this is certain.*
*Tell me **the time of his arrival**.*	*Tell me **when he will arrive**.*	*He will arrive at a certain time; tell me that time.*

34.8.8 Adjective Phrase ↔ Adjective Clause

Simple	Complex	Compound
*I saw a **wounded** soldier.*	*I saw a soldier **who was wounded**.*	*I saw a soldier, **and** he was wounded.*
*The man **standing at the gate** is my uncle.*	*The man **who is standing at the gate** is my uncle.*	*A man is standing at the gate, **and** he is my uncle.*
*A **rich** man is not always happy.*	*A man **who is rich** is not always happy.*	*A man may be rich, **but** he is not always happy.*
*This is **the house of my birth**.*	*This is the house **where I was born**.*	*I was born in a house, **and** this is that house.*

34.8.9 *Not only … but also* and *Both … and*

- **Simple:** *Besides being a poet, he was a painter.*
- **Complex:** *He was a poet **who was also** a painter.*
- **Compound:** *He was **not only** a poet **but also** a painter.*

34.9 Transformation Using Other Structures

34.9.1 *Too … to / So … that / Enough*

- *He is too short to reach the shelf. = He is so short that he cannot reach the shelf. = He is not tall enough to reach the shelf.*
- *The question is so easy that anyone can answer it. = The question is easy enough for anyone to answer.*

34.9.2 *As soon as / No sooner … than / Hardly … when*

- *As soon as he saw me, he left. = No sooner had he seen me than he left. = Hardly had he seen me when he left. = On seeing me, he left.*

34.9.3 *Unless / If … not / Or / Otherwise*

- *Unless you hurry, you will be late. = If you do not hurry, you will be late. = Hurry, or you will be late. = Hurry; otherwise you will be late.*

34.9.4 Changing Parts of Speech (Noun ↔ Adjective ↔ Adverb ↔ Verb)

- *He is very **honest**. → His **honesty** is great.* (adjective → noun)
- *She sang **sweetly**. → Her singing was **sweet**.* (adverb → adjective)
- *He **succeeded** in life. → He achieved **success** in life. / He was **successful** in life.*
- *He **decided** to leave. → He took a **decision** to leave.*
- *She **behaved** politely. → Her **behaviour** was polite.*
- *He spoke **angrily**. → He spoke **in anger**. / He was **angry** when he spoke.*

34.9.5 Emphatic Transformation (*It is … that*)

- *Rahim broke the glass. → **It was Rahim who** broke the glass. / **It was the glass that** Rahim broke.*
- *We need peace. → **It is peace that** we need. / **What we need is** peace.*

34.9.6 Degree, Voice and Narration

These are also transformations; see **Chapter 24** (degree), **Chapter 26** (voice) and **Chapter 27** (narration).

34.10 Model Transformations: Mixed Practice Examples

1. *Only a fool can say so.* → (Negative) *None but a fool can say so.*
2. *Everyone admires a good man.* → (Interrogative) *Who does not admire a good man?*
3. *What a beautiful bird it is!* → (Assertive) *It is a very beautiful bird.*
4. *Never tell a lie.* → (Assertive) *You should never tell a lie.*
5. *May Allah bless you!* → (Assertive) *I pray that Allah may bless you.*
6. *In spite of his wealth, he is unhappy.* → (Complex) *Though he is wealthy, he is unhappy.* → (Compound) *He is wealthy, but he is unhappy.*

7. *He is too proud to beg.* → (Complex) *He is so proud that he will not beg.*
8. *Being tired, she went to bed.* → (Complex) *As she was tired, she went to bed.* → (Compound) *She was tired and went to bed.*
9. *I know the man who is sitting there.* → (Simple) *I know the man sitting there.*
10. *If you do not run, you will miss the train.* → (Simple) *Without running, you will miss the train.* → (Compound) *Run, or you will miss the train.*
11. *As soon as he reached home, it started raining.* → (Negative) *No sooner had he reached home than it started raining.*
12. *He must admit his fault.* → (Negative) *He cannot but admit his fault.*
13. *There is no man but loves his motherland.* → (Affirmative) *Every man loves his motherland.*
14. *He confessed his guilt.* → (Complex) *He confessed that he was guilty.*
15. *Who can bear such an insult?* → (Assertive) *No one can bear such an insult.*
16. *It is a matter of great joy that you have passed.* → (Exclamatory) *Hurrah! You have passed.*
17. *The boy is very clever.* → (Exclamatory) *How clever the boy is!*
18. *He was poor, but he was honest.* → (Simple) *In spite of his poverty, he was honest.*
19. *Work hard to shine in life.* → (Complex) *Work hard so that you may shine in life.*
20. *I am sure of his success.* → (Complex) *I am sure that he will succeed.*

34.11 Common Errors in Transformation

1. ✘ *Only Rahim can do it → Nobody but Rahim cannot do it.* ✔ *None but Rahim **can** do it.* (no double negative)
2. ✘ *Though he is poor, but he is honest.* ✔ *Though he is poor, he is honest.*
3. ✘ *He is too weak that he cannot walk.* ✔ *He is **so** weak that he cannot walk.*
4. ✘ *No sooner he came than …* ✔ *No sooner **did he come** / **had he come** than …*
5. ✘ *Who does not loves his country?* ✔ *Who does not **love** his country?*
6. ✘ *What a beautiful bird is it!* ✔ *What a beautiful bird **it is**!*
7. ✘ *Unless you do not work …* ✔ *Unless you work …*
8. ✘ *Seeing the police, the thief was ran away.* ✔ *Seeing the police, the thief **ran** away.*
9. ✘ Changing the tense: *He worked hard to pass → He worked hard so that he **may** pass.* ✔ … so that he **might** pass.
10. ✘ Changing the meaning: *Few people came → Many people did not come.* ✔ *Not many people came.*

34.12 Transformation in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

Transformation skill is exactly what **GMAT Sentence Correction** demands: five answer choices express the same meaning in different structures, and you must recognise which one is **grammatical, logical and concise**. Typical "transformations" between choices include:

- clause ↔ participial phrase (*because it was built in 1900 ↔ built in 1900*);
- active ↔ passive;
- *so … that ↔ too … to ↔ enough … to*;
- *although ↔ despite ↔ but*;
- noun ↔ verb forms (*the decision to expand ↔ decided to expand*).

The **meaning must not change**: GMAT often includes an answer that is grammatically perfect but **changes the meaning** of the original — that answer is wrong. In **GRE Sentence Equivalence**, two different words must produce sentences of the **same meaning** — another form of meaning-preserving transformation.

CHAPTER 35

Pin Point Error

Part A · Grammar

35.1 What Is “Pin Point Error”?

In a **Pin Point Error** (also called **Error Detection** or **Spotting the Error**) question, a sentence is divided into **underlined parts** (usually A, B, C, D, and sometimes E = “No error”). You must find the **one part** that contains a grammatical, idiomatic or usage error.

- *The number of students (A) / in our college (B) / are increasing (C) / day by day. (D)* → Error in **(C)**: *The number of* + singular → ***is*** *increasing*.
- *He is one of the best (A) / player (B) / that our country (C) / has ever produced. (D)* → Error in **(B)**: *one of the best* ***players***.

This item appears in nearly every **BCS Preliminary**, **Bank** (officer, senior officer, AD), **university admission** and **job** recruitment test in Bangladesh, and it is the core of **SAT Writing** (“Identifying Sentence Errors” in the older SAT) and **GMAT Sentence Correction**. Pin point errors draw on **every chapter** of Part A; this chapter gives a systematic **checklist** and a classified bank of typical errors.

35.2 A Ten-Point Checklist for Spotting Errors

Read the sentence once for meaning, then check these points **in order**. Most errors are found in the first five.

1. **Subject–verb agreement** (Chapter 23): find the true subject; check *is/are, has/have, was/were, -s* verbs.
2. **Tense** (Chapter 21): time words (*since, ago, yesterday, by the time*), sequence of tenses, *if*-clauses.
3. **Pronoun** (Chapter 08): case (*I/me*), agreement (*each … his*), reference (ambiguous *it/they*), *who/whom, one … one’s*.
4. **Verb form** (Chapters 12–14, 22): V2/V3, gerund vs infinitive, modals + V1, *to* as preposition, *suggest that he go*.
5. **Preposition and idiom** (Chapters 17–18): *married* ***to***, *congratulate* ***on***, *discuss* (no preposition), *prefer … **to***.
6. **Article and determiner** (Chapters 04–05): *a/an/the, each/every, few/a few, much/many, less/fewer*.
7. **Adjective/adverb and comparison** (Chapters 09, 15, 24): double comparatives, *than any other, -ed/-ing, hard/hardly*.
8. **Nouns and number** (Chapters 02–03, 06): *informations, sceneries, two dozens, one of the best player*.
9. **Word order, conjunctions, inversion** (Chapters 16, 19): *though … but, no sooner … than, hardly … when, lest … should, scarcely had he*.
10. **Parallelism, redundancy, modifiers** (Chapters 29, 38, 39): *not only … but also* placement, *return back*, dangling *-ing* phrases.

Exam Tip — Read the whole sentence, then read each part separately. Many errors are visible only when you connect two parts (subject in A, verb in C). If you cannot find any error after checking all ten points, the answer may be “No error” — but in Bangladeshi MCQs “No error” is the correct answer much less often than in the SAT.

35.3 Error Bank: Subject–Verb Agreement

1. ✘ The quality of the mangoes **are** good. ✔ … **is** good.
2. ✘ Each of the boys **have** a pen. ✔ … **has** a pen.
3. ✘ Neither of the two sisters **are** married. ✔ … **is** married.
4. ✘ The news **are** true. ✔ The news **is** true.
5. ✘ Bread and butter **are** my breakfast. ✔ … **is** my breakfast.
6. ✘ The Prime Minister, along with his ministers, **are** coming. ✔ … **is** coming.
7. ✘ Either the teacher or the students **is** responsible. ✔ … **are** responsible.
8. ✘ A number of students **was** absent. ✔ … **were** absent.
9. ✘ The number of accidents **are** rising. ✔ … **is** rising.
10. ✘ Ten kilometres **are** a long distance. ✔ … **is** a long distance.
11. ✘ Physics **are** a difficult subject. ✔ … **is** …
12. ✘ The cattle **is** grazing. ✔ The cattle **are** grazing.
13. ✘ Everyone of the students **were** present. ✔ Every one of the students **was** present.
14. ✘ There **is** many books on the shelf. ✔ There **are** many books …
15. ✘ He is one of those who **has** succeeded. ✔ … who **have** succeeded.
16. ✘ The committee **have** submitted its report. ✔ The committee **has** submitted its report.
17. ✘ Many a man **have** died. ✔ Many a man **has** died.
18. ✘ Mathematics and physics **is** my favourite subjects. ✔ … **are** my favourite subjects.

35.4 Error Bank: Tense and Verb Form

1. ✘ I **have seen** him yesterday. ✔ I **saw** him yesterday.
2. ✘ He **is living** here since 2010. ✔ He **has been living** here since 2010.
3. ✘ If he **will come**, I will go. ✔ If he **comes**, I will go.
4. ✘ The patient **died** before the doctor came. ✔ The patient **had died** before the doctor came.
5. ✘ It is time we **go** home. ✔ It is time we **went** home.
6. ✘ He said that he **will** come. ✔ He said that he **would** come.
7. ✘ I wish I **was** a bird. ✔ I wish I **were** a bird.
8. ✘ He **has went** home. ✔ He **has gone** home.
9. ✘ The bell **has rang**. ✔ The bell **has rung**.
10. ✘ He **did not came**. ✔ He **did not come**.
11. ✘ It is ten years since he **has died**. ✔ … since he **died**.
12. ✘ He **is knowing** me. ✔ He **knows** me.
13. ✘ I look forward to **meet** you. ✔ … to **meeting** you.
14. ✘ He avoided **to meet** me. ✔ He avoided **meeting** me.
15. ✘ She made me **to cry**. ✔ She made me **cry**.
16. ✘ You had better **to go**. ✔ You had better **go**.
17. ✘ I suggest that he **goes**. ✔ I suggest that he **go / should go**.
18. ✘ Hardly **he had** reached when … ✔ Hardly **had he** reached when …
19. ✘ He **laid** on the bed. ✔ He **lay** on the bed.
20. ✘ The thief was **hung**. ✔ The thief was **hanged**.

35.5 Error Bank: Pronouns

1. ✘ Between you and **I** ✔ between you and **me**
2. ✘ He is taller than **me**. (exam) ✔ … than **I**.
3. ✘ **Myself** and Rahim went. ✔ **Rahim and I** went.
4. ✘ **I and you** will go. ✔ **You and I** will go.
5. ✘ Everyone must do **their** duty. (traditional) ✔ … **his** duty.
6. ✘ One must respect **his** elders. ✔ … **one's** elders.
7. ✘ The man **whom** I think is guilty ✔ The man **who** I think is guilty
8. ✘ This is the book **what** I bought. ✔ … the book **that** I bought.
9. ✘ He is the best man **who** I know. ✔ … **that** I know.
10. ✘ The dog wagged **it's** tail. ✔ … **its** tail.
11. ✘ He **availed of** the chance. ✔ He **availed himself of** the chance.
12. ✘ Is this book **your's**? ✔ … **yours**?
13. ✘ **Us** students protested. ✔ **We** students protested.
14. ✘ Let **he and I** go. ✔ Let **him and me** go.
15. ✘ The jury gave **their** verdict. ✔ … **its** verdict.

35.6 Error Bank: Prepositions and Idioms

1. ✘ He is married **with** a doctor. ✔ … married **to** a doctor.
2. ✘ We discussed **about** the matter. ✔ We discussed the matter.
3. ✘ I congratulate you **for** your success. ✔ … **on** your success.
4. ✘ He died **from** cholera. ✔ … died **of** cholera.
5. ✘ He is senior **than** me. ✔ … senior **to** me.
6. ✘ I prefer tea **than** coffee. ✔ … tea **to** coffee.
7. ✘ He is fond **for** music. ✔ … fond **of** music.
8. ✘ She resembles **with** her mother. ✔ She resembles her mother.
9. ✘ He entered **into** the room. ✔ He entered the room.
10. ✘ He insisted **to go**. ✔ He insisted **on going**.
11. ✘ He is good **in** English. ✔ … good **at** English.
12. ✘ I have been waiting **since** two hours. ✔ … **for** two hours.
13. ✘ He was accused **for** theft. ✔ … accused **of** theft.
14. ✘ Divide it **between** the three boys. ✔ … **among** the three boys.
15. ✘ He sat **besides** me. ✔ He sat **beside** me.
16. ✘ He comprises **of** many qualities. ✔ He **has** many qualities.
17. ✘ He is angry **on** me. ✔ … angry **with** me.
18. ✘ She is independent **from** her husband. ✔ … independent **of** …

35.7 Error Bank: Articles, Determiners and Quantifiers

1. ✘ He is **an** university teacher. ✔ … **a** university teacher.
2. ✘ I waited for **a** hour. ✔ … for **an** hour.
3. ✘ **The** honesty is the best policy. ✔ Honesty is …
4. ✘ **Sun** rises in the east. ✔ **The** sun rises in **the** east.
5. ✘ He is **best** boy in the class. ✔ He is **the best** boy …
6. ✘ **My all** friends came. ✔ **All my** friends came.
7. ✘ He gave me **an** advice. ✔ He gave me **some** advice.
8. ✘ **Less** people came. ✔ **Fewer** people came.
9. ✘ The **amount** of students ✔ The **number** of students
10. ✘ I have **a few** money. ✔ I have **a little** money.
11. ✘ **Every** students passed. ✔ **Every student** passed.
12. ✘ **Either** of the five roads ✔ **Any** of the five roads
13. ✘ He spent **the whole** money. ✔ … **all the** money.
14. ✘ **Many a** boys ✔ **Many a** boy
15. ✘ He plays **the** cricket. ✔ He plays cricket.

35.8 Error Bank: Nouns and Number

1. ✘ The **sceneries** of Sylhet are beautiful. ✔ The **scenery** of Sylhet is beautiful.
2. ✘ He bought new **furnitures**. ✔ … new **furniture**.
3. ✘ I have many **informations**. ✔ … **a lot of information**.
4. ✘ Two **dozens** eggs ✔ two **dozen** eggs
5. ✘ He is one of the best **player**. ✔ … **players**.
6. ✘ A ten-**years**-old boy ✔ a ten-**year**-old boy
7. ✘ The **datas** are correct. ✔ The **data** are correct.
8. ✘ This **criteria** is important. ✔ This **criterion** is important.
9. ✘ My **sons-in-laws** ✔ My **sons-in-law**
10. ✘ I had my **hairs** cut. ✔ … my **hair** cut.
11. ✘ The **poors** are suffering. ✔ **The poor** are suffering.
12. ✘ The **cattles** are grazing. ✔ The **cattle** are grazing.

35.9 Error Bank: Adjectives, Adverbs and Comparison

1. ✘ He is **more stronger** than me. ✔ He is **stronger** than I.
2. ✘ He is the **tallest** of the two. ✔ He is the **taller** of the two.
3. ✘ He is taller than **any boy** in the class. ✔ … than **any other boy** …
4. ✘ The climate of Sylhet is better than **Dhaka**. ✔ … than **that of** Dhaka.
5. ✘ He is **very** better now. ✔ He is **much** better now.
6. ✘ She sings **good**. ✔ She sings **well**.
7. ✘ The rose smells **sweetly**. ✔ … smells **sweet**.
8. ✘ I am very **boring** in the class. ✔ … very **bored** …
9. ✘ He is **elder** than me. ✔ He is **older** than I.
10. ✘ He works **hardly**. ✔ He works **hard**.
11. ✘ This is the **most unique** design. ✔ This is a **unique** design.
12. ✘ He is **enough strong**. ✔ He is **strong enough**.
13. ✘ It is **too** hot today (meaning just "very"). ✔ It is **very** hot today.
14. ✘ He speaks **fluently English**. ✔ He speaks **English fluently**.
15. ✘ I can't **hardly** hear. ✔ I can **hardly** hear.

35.10 Error Bank: Conjunctions, Inversion and Structure

1. ✘ **Though** he is poor, **but** he is honest. ✔ Though he is poor, he is honest.
2. ✘ **No sooner** had he come **when** it rained. ✔ … **than** it rained.
3. ✘ **Hardly** had he come **than** it rained. ✔ … **when** it rained.
4. ✘ **Never I have** seen it. ✔ **Never have I** seen it.
5. ✘ **Unless** you do **not** work hard, you will fail. ✔ Unless you work hard, …
6. ✘ Walk fast **lest** you **will** miss the bus. ✔ … lest you **should** miss the bus.
7. ✘ **Both** Rahim **as well as** Karim came. ✔ Both Rahim **and** Karim came.
8. ✘ **Neither** he **or** I ✔ Neither he **nor** I
9. ✘ The reason he failed is **because** he was lazy. ✔ … is **that** he was lazy.
10. ✘ He asked me **that where** I lived. ✔ He asked me **where** I lived.
11. ✘ I don't know where **does he live**. ✔ … where **he lives**.
12. ✘ He **not only** lost his money **but also** his reputation. ✔ He lost **not only** his money **but also** his reputation.
13. ✘ He is **so** weak **to walk**. ✔ He is **too** weak to walk.

14. ✘ **Scarcely** I had reached when … ✔ **Scarcely had I** reached when …

35.11 Error Bank: Redundancy, Modifiers and Word Choice

1. ✘ He **returned back** home. ✔ He **returned** home.
2. ✘ Please **repeat** it **again**. ✔ Please **repeat** it.
3. ✘ The **reason why** he failed is **because** … ✔ The reason he failed is **that** …
4. ✘ **Walking** in the garden, **a snake bit** him. ✔ Walking in the garden, **he was bitten** by a snake.
5. ✘ He is a **ten years** old boy. ✔ He is a **ten-year-old** boy.
6. ✘ **Each and every** students ✔ Each and every **student**
7. ✘ The **cousin brother** ✔ my **cousin**
8. ✘ He **said me** that … ✔ He **told me** that …
9. ✘ **Explain me** the rule. ✔ **Explain** the rule **to me**.
10. ✘ He is **too much** intelligent. ✔ He is **very** intelligent.
11. ✘ I **besides** the others went there. ✔ I, **along with** the others, went there.
12. ✘ The **principle** of the college ✔ the **principal** of the college
13. *He has a **dearth** of knowledge.* — **No error** (*dearth* = shortage).
14. *He is **senior to** me **by** two years.* — **No error**.
15. ✘ She **lended** me her book. ✔ She **lent** me her book.

> Items 13 and 14 above are **correct** sentences: exam papers deliberately include sentences that look wrong but are right. Always check against a rule before deciding.

35.12 Pin Point Errors in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **SAT (Writing & Language / earlier "Identifying Sentence Errors"):** the most frequent errors are subject–verb agreement, pronoun agreement and case, verb tense, idiom, comparison, parallelism, adjective/adverb confusion, and redundancy. About one in five old-SAT items was "No error".
- **GMAT Sentence Correction** is a "pin point error" test in reverse: the error is somewhere in the underlined part, and you must pick the version that removes it **without introducing a new error or changing the meaning**. Learn to **"split"** answer choices: compare the first words of each choice (*is/are*, *which/that*, *like/as*) to eliminate several at once.
- **GRE** has no grammar section, but recognising grammatical structure helps parse complex Reading Comprehension sentences.

CHAPTER 36

Identifying the Missing Word

Part A · Grammar

36.1 What Is a “Missing Word” Question?

In this type of question, a sentence has a **word left out** — sometimes marked with a blank, sometimes not marked at all — and you must find **which word is missing** and **where**. The missing word is usually a **function word** (article, preposition, auxiliary, conjunction, pronoun, *to*, *that*, *than*), but it can also be a **content word** that the context makes clear.

- *He is fond ___ reading.* → missing **of**.
- *I have been waiting you for an hour.* → missing **for** (*waiting **for** you*).
- *She is taller her sister.* → missing **than**.
- *Neither he his brother came.* → missing **nor**.

In BCS, Bank and admission tests this appears as **fill in the gaps**, **“supply the missing word”**, and as a hidden form of **error detection** (an omission is an error). In **GRE Text Completion** and **SAT Sentence Completion**, the “missing word” is a **content word** that must be predicted from context clues (36.6).

36.2 A Method for Finding the Missing Word

1. **Read for meaning.** Where does the sentence “break”? The gap is usually right there.
2. **Check the skeleton:** Is there a **subject**? a **finite verb**? Does a transitive verb have its **object**?
3. **Check pairs:** Does every *not only* have *but also*, every *neither* a *nor*, every *as* an *as*, every comparative a *than*, every *the more* a *the* …?
4. **Check idioms:** Does a word need a fixed **preposition** (*afraid **of**, depend **on***)?
5. **Check determiners:** Does a singular countable noun have *a/an/the/my*?
6. **Check verb groups:** Does a continuous tense have *be*? a perfect tense *have*? a passive *be*? a question/negative *do*?

36.3 The Most Frequently Missing Words

36.3.1 Missing Article

- He is ___ honest man. → **an**
- ___ sun rises in ___ east. → **The … the**
- She is ___ best student in the class. → **the**
- I have ___ headache. → **a**
- It is ___ pity that he failed. → **a**
- He is such ___ fool! → **a**
- ___ Padma is a mighty river. → **The**
- Half ___ hour has passed. → **an**

36.3.2 Missing Preposition

- He is afraid ___ dogs. → **of**
- She depends ___ her father. → **on**
- I congratulate you ___ your success. → **on**
- He was born ___ 1990. → **in**
- I will meet you ___ Friday. → **on**
- He has been ill ___ Monday. → **since**
- We listened ___ the speech. → **to**
- She is good ___ mathematics. → **at**
- He prefers tea ___ coffee. → **to**
- Look ___ the board. → **at**
- He insisted ___ paying. → **on**
- He came ___ foot. → **on**

36.3.3 Missing Auxiliary or Part of the Verb

- He ___ reading a book now. → **is**
- They ___ finished their work. → **have**
- ___ you know him? → **Do**
- He ___ not come yesterday. → **did**
- The letter ___ written by Rina. → **was**
- The bridge is ___ built now. → **being**
- He has ___ working since morning. → **been**
- No sooner ___ he arrived than it rained. → **had**
- Never ___ I seen such a sight. → **have**
- Seldom ___ he come late. → **does**

36.3.4 Missing *To* (Infinitive) — or Unwanted *To*

- He wants ___ go home. → **to**
- I am going ___ see the doctor. → **to**
- He is too weak ___ walk. → **to**
- You ought ___ respect your elders. → **to**
- He used ___ live here. → **to**
- *But:* Let him ___ go. → **nothing** (✘ to); You must ___ go → **nothing**.

36.3.5 Missing Conjunction or Correlative Partner

- He is not only intelligent ___ also hard-working. → **but**
- Neither Rahim ___ Karim came. → **nor**
- Either you ___ I must go. → **or**
- Both Rina ___ Mina passed. → **and**
- He is as tall ___ his father. → **as**
- She is taller ___ her sister. → **than**
- No sooner had he left ___ she arrived. → **than**
- Hardly had he left ___ she arrived. → **when**
- He is so weak ___ he cannot walk. → **that**
- Walk carefully ___ you should fall. → **lest**
- I will wait ___ you come. → **till / until**
- The more you read, ___ more you learn. → **the**

36.3.6 Missing Relative Pronoun or *That*

- The man ___ came here is my uncle. → **who** (subject relative — cannot be omitted)
- This is the house ___ I was born. → **where / in which**
- I know ___ he is honest. → **that** (optional after *know*)
- ___ he is honest is known to all. → **That** (required when the clause is a subject)
- He is the best man ___ I have ever met. → **that**

- Such men ___ are honest are respected. → **as**

36.3.7 Missing Pronoun, *It* or *There*

- He absented ___ from the class. → **himself**
- ___ is raining. → **It**
- ___ is a book on the table. → **There**
- ___ is easy to learn English. → **It**
- I find ___ difficult to believe him. → **it**
- He hurt ___ while playing. → **himself**

36.3.8 Missing *Of* after Determiners and Quantifiers

- All ___ us were present. → **of** (✘ all us)
- Both ___ them came. → **of**
- One ___ the boys is absent. → **of**
- Each ___ the students has a book. → **of**
- A number ___ students were absent. → **of**
- Most ___ the people agreed. → **of**

36.3.9 Missing Object or Complement

- We enjoyed ___ very much. → **ourselves** / **the party**
- He gave ___ a book. → **me / her**
- They elected him ___. → **captain / chairman**
- He made her ___. → **happy / sad** (object complement)

36.3.10 Missing Words in Fixed Expressions

- In spite ___ the rain → **of**
- On account ___ illness → **of**
- With a view ___ getting a job → **to**
- As soon ___ he came → **as**
- By dint ___ hard work → **of**
- At the eleventh ___ → **hour**
- Once in a blue ___ → **moon**
- A blessing in ___ → **disguise**

36.4 Missing Words That Change the Meaning

Some omissions do not make the sentence ungrammatical but change its meaning — exam questions ask you to restore the intended meaning:

- *He has few friends.* (almost none) vs *He has **a** few friends.* (some) — the missing ***a***.
- *He is the only one of the boys who **has** passed.* vs *He is one of the boys who **have** passed.* — missing ***only*** changes agreement.
- *She is taller than any girl in the class.* → missing ***other*** makes the comparison illogical.
- *I don't like tea or coffee.* vs *I don't like tea **and** coffee.* (together)

36.5 Worked Examples: Find the Missing Word

1. *He is senior me by two years.* → **to** (*senior **to** me*)
2. *She is fond music.* → **of**
3. *He is one the best players.* → **of**
4. *I have been living here 2015.* → **since**
5. *He did not come school yesterday.* → **to**
6. *Not only he but his brother came.* → **also** (*but **also***)
7. *He is cleverer his brother.* → **than**
8. *The more you work, more you earn.* → **the** (*the more*)
9. *What a beautiful scene!* → no word missing (*it is* may be added but is optional)
10. *He made me do work.* → **the** (*the work*) or **my** (*my work*)
11. *It is no use crying spilt milk.* → **over**
12. *Neither the teacher the students were present.* → **nor**
13. *He is good English.* → **at**
14. *She is married a doctor.* → **to**
15. *Let us go for walk.* → **a**
16. *He has gone Dhaka.* → **to**
17. *I prefer reading playing.* → **to**
18. *He was absent the meeting.* → **from**
19. *Hardly had I reached the station the train left.* → **when**
20. *Which the two do you like better?* → **of** (*Which **of** the two*)

36.6 Missing Content Words: SAT and GRE Sentence Completion

In **GRE Text Completion**, **GRE Sentence Equivalence** and **SAT** vocabulary-in-context questions, the missing word is a **content word** (noun, verb, adjective, adverb). It cannot be found by grammar alone; it must be **predicted from context**.

36.6.1 Strategy

1. **Cover the options.** Read the sentence and find the **clue** — the part that tells you what the blank means.
2. **Find the trigger (signal) words** that show the relationship between the clue and the blank:
   - **Same direction (support):** *and, also, moreover, indeed, in fact, because, since, thus, so, as a result, ; (semicolon), : (colon).*
   - **Opposite direction (contrast):** *but, yet, however, although, though, despite, while, whereas, rather than, instead of, unlike, surprisingly, ironically, paradoxically.*
3. **Predict your own word** for the blank before looking at the options.
4. **Match** your prediction with the options; check that the chosen word fits **grammatically** and **logically**.
5. In **two- and three-blank** GRE questions, start with the **easiest** blank and use it to unlock the others.
6. In **Sentence Equivalence**, choose **two** options that give sentences of the **same meaning** — usually two near-synonyms.

36.6.2 Examples

- *Although the lecture was supposed to be **lively**, most students found it _____.* — contrast (*although*) → predict "boring" → *tedious, monotonous, soporific.*
- *The scientist's claims were _____; every experiment confirmed them.* — support (semicolon, explanation) → predict "proven" → *corroborated, substantiated, vindicated.*
- *Far from being _____, the new manager was surprisingly generous with praise.* — *far from being* = opposite of *generous with praise* → *stingy, parsimonious, niggardly* (with praise: *grudging*).
- *His _____ remarks offended many, though he insisted he had meant no harm.* — offensive remarks → *caustic, acerbic, tactless, derogatory.*
- *The novel's plot is so _____ that readers often lose track of who is who.* — result (*so … that*) → *convoluted, labyrinthine, intricate.*
- *Rather than _____ the new policy, the committee chose to praise it publicly.* — opposite of *praise* → *criticise, censure, denounce, disparage.*

Exam Tip — Positive or negative? Even if you don't know the exact word, decide whether the blank needs a **positive (+)** or **negative (−)** word. This alone often eliminates half the options. Learn the vocabulary in Chapter 45 by its **"charge"** as well as its meaning.

36.7 Missing Words in GMAT Sentence Correction

GMAT frequently tests **omitted words** that cause ambiguity or illogic:

- **Omitted *that*** after verbs like *claim, say, believe, hypothesise*: ✘ *Scientists believe the rising temperatures will continue.* is acceptable; but ✘ *Analysts reported last year sales fell* is ambiguous (*last year* modifies *reported* or *fell*?). ✔ *Analysts reported **that** last year sales fell.*
- **Omitted verb in comparisons** (ellipsis) that causes ambiguity: ✘ *She likes him more than her brother.* → ✔ *… more than her brother **does** / … more than she likes her brother.*
- **Omitted *as* in *as … as***: ✘ *as good or better than* → ✔ *as good **as** or better than.*
- **Omitted preposition or article in parallel lists** when they differ: *interested **in** art and **in** music* (repeat only if needed for clarity).
- **Omitted verb form** that leaves an incomplete verb: ✘ *The company has and will continue to expand.* ✔ *The company has **expanded** and will continue to expand.*

CHAPTER 37

Embedded Question

Part A · Grammar

37.1 What Is an Embedded Question?

An **embedded question** (also called an **indirect question** or **included question**) is a question that is placed **inside another sentence** — inside a statement or inside another question. It works as a **noun clause** (usually the object of a verb).

- Direct question: *Where does he live?*
- Embedded: *I don't know **where he lives**.*
- Embedded: *Can you tell me **where he lives**?*

Embedded questions are polite and very common in spoken and written English (*Could you tell me where the station is?*). They are tested in BCS, Bank and admission exams through **error detection** (the classic error is keeping question word order: ✘ *I don't know where does he live*), and they appear in SAT and GMAT as part of noun-clause structure.

37.2 Common Introductory Expressions

Statements	Questions
I don't know …	Do you know …?
I wonder …	Can / Could you tell me …?
I'd like to know …	Would you mind telling me …?
I'm not sure …	Have you any idea …?
Nobody knows …	Do you remember …?
I can't remember …	Is it true …?
Please tell me …	Did he say …?
The question is …	Who knows …?
It is not clear …	Could you explain …?
I asked him … / He wanted to know …	

37.3 The Rules

1. **Use statement word order** (subject + verb) in the embedded question — **no inversion**.
2. **Remove *do / does / did*** and put the main verb in the correct tense form.
3. For **yes/no questions**, introduce the embedded question with ***if*** or ***whether***.
4. For **wh-questions**, keep the **wh-word** (*what, where, when, why, how, who, which, whose, how much, how many*) as the linker.
5. **Punctuation** follows the **main sentence**: a full stop if the main sentence is a statement, a question mark if the main sentence is a question.
6. If the main verb is in the **past**, the embedded verb usually shifts into the past (sequence of tenses).

37.3.1 Wh-Questions

Direct question	Embedded question
Where **does he live**?	I don't know where **he lives**.
What **is her name**?	Can you tell me what **her name is**?
Why **was she** crying?	I wonder why **she was** crying.
When **will the train** arrive?	Do you know when **the train will** arrive?
How **did you solve** it?	Please tell me how **you solved** it.
How much **does it cost**?	Could you tell me how much **it costs**?
Which bus **should I** take?	I'm not sure which bus **I should** take.
Whose bag **is this**?	I don't know whose bag **this is**.
Where **is the station**?	Excuse me, could you tell me where **the station is**?
What time **is it**?	Do you know what time **it is**?

37.3.2 Yes/No Questions → *If / Whether*

Direct question	Embedded question
Is he at home?	I wonder **if / whether he is** at home.
Does she speak English?	Do you know **if she speaks** English?
Did they win the match?	I don't know **whether they won** the match.
Can you swim?	He asked me **if I could** swim.
Will it rain tomorrow?	Nobody knows **whether it will** rain tomorrow.
Have you finished?	Could you tell me **if you have** finished?

37.3.3 When the Wh-Word Is the Subject

If the wh-word itself is the **subject** of the question, the word order does **not change** (it is already subject + verb):

- *Who **broke** the window? → I don't know **who broke** the window.*
- *What **happened** last night? → Can you tell me **what happened** last night?*
- *Which team **won**? → Do you know **which team won**?*

> ***Who is … / What is …* questions:** Decide whether the wh-word is the subject or the complement. *Who **is that man**? → Do you know **who that man is**?* (*that man* is the subject; *who* is the complement). *What **is the matter**? → Tell me **what the matter is*** (also commonly *what is the matter*, because *what* can be the subject).

37.4 Punctuation

The final punctuation mark belongs to the **main sentence**, not to the embedded question:

- I wonder where he is**.** (statement → full stop; ✘ I wonder where he is?)
- Do you know where he is**?** (question → question mark)
- Please tell me what time it is**.** (request in imperative form → full stop)
- Could you tell me what time it is**?** (question form → question mark)

37.5 Embedded Questions with Infinitives

A wh-word (or *whether*) + ***to*-infinitive** is a short embedded question used when the subject is the same as the main subject or is general:

- I don't know **what to do**. (= what I should do)
- She asked me **how to solve** the problem.
- Tell me **where to go**.
- He couldn't decide **whether to stay or go**. (✘ if to stay)
- The question is **which one to choose**.

37.6 Tense in Embedded Questions (Sequence of Tenses)

When the introductory verb is in the **past**, the embedded verb normally moves one step back (Chapter 27):

- *Where **is** he?* → He asked me where he **was**.
- *What **are** you doing?* → She wanted to know what I **was** doing.
- *Did you **see** the film?* → He asked if I **had seen** the film.
- *When **will** you come?* → They asked when I **would** come.

37.7 Embedded Questions as Subjects and Complements

An embedded question can also be the **subject** or **complement** of a sentence:

- **Where he went** is a mystery. (subject)
- **Whether he will come** is uncertain. (subject — *whether*, not *if*)
- The question is **how we can save money**. (complement)
- It is not clear **why she resigned**. (anticipatory *it*; the embedded question is the real subject)

37.8 Common Errors with Embedded Questions

1. ✘ I don't know where does he live. ✔ I don't know where **he lives**.
2. ✘ Can you tell me what time is it? ✔ Can you tell me what time **it is**?
3. ✘ I wonder why is she crying. ✔ I wonder why **she is** crying.
4. ✘ Do you know where is the post office? ✔ Do you know where **the post office is**?
5. ✘ I asked him that where he lived. ✔ I asked him **where** he lived.
6. ✘ Tell me how much does it cost. ✔ Tell me how much **it costs**.
7. ✘ I don't know did he come. ✔ I don't know **if / whether** he came.
8. ✘ I wonder where he is? ✔ I wonder where he is**.**
9. ✘ He asked me what was I doing. ✔ He asked me what **I was** doing.
10. ✘ Nobody knows when will the exam start. ✔ Nobody knows when **the exam will** start.
11. ✘ If he will come is not certain. ✔ **Whether** he will come is not certain.
12. ✘ I can't decide if to go or not. ✔ I can't decide **whether** to go or not.
13. ✘ Could you tell me where can I find a bank? ✔ … where **I can** find a bank?
14. ✘ I want to know who is that girl. ✔ I want to know **who that girl is**.
15. ✘ Please tell me what did he say. ✔ Please tell me what **he said**.

37.9 Embedded Questions in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **SAT Writing** tests embedded questions as an **inversion error**: ✘ *Historians debate why did the empire collapse.* ✔ … *why **the empire collapsed***.
- **GMAT:** embedded questions introduced by ***whether*** (not *if*) are preferred: *The study examines **whether** diet affects memory.* Also watch for the wordy ***the question as to whether*** — GMAT prefers ***whether*** alone.
- **Punctuation (SAT):** a statement containing an embedded question ends with a **full stop**, not a question mark.

CHAPTER 38

Redundancy

Part A · Grammar

38.1 What Is Redundancy?

Redundancy means using **more words than necessary** — repeating an idea that is **already expressed** by another word in the sentence. It is also called **tautology** (saying the same thing twice) or **pleonasm** (using extra words).

- ✘ He **returned back** home. → *Return* already means *come back*. ✔ He **returned** home.
- ✘ Please **repeat** it **again**. → *Repeat* = *say again*. ✔ Please **repeat** it.
- ✘ This is a **new innovation**. → An innovation is always new. ✔ This is an **innovation**.

Redundancy is tested in BCS, Bank and admission tests as **error detection** and **"choose the correct sentence"**. In the **SAT** and especially the **GMAT**, it is part of **concision**: the best answer is the one that says everything needed **in the fewest clear words**.

38.2 Why Redundancy Happens

1. **The meaning is already in the word** (Latin prefixes such as *re-* = back/again, *pre-* = before, *co-* = together).
2. **Translating literally** from Bangla (*ফিরে আসা* → "return back"; *একসাথে মিলিত হওয়া* → "meet together").
3. **Mixing two constructions** (*the reason … because*, *though … but*).
4. **Habit and emphasis** in speech that is not acceptable in formal writing.

38.3 Redundant Verbs with *Back, Again, Together, Up, Down*

✘ Redundant	✔ Correct	Reason
return back	return	*re-* = back
revert back	revert	*revert* = go back
reply back	reply	*reply* = answer back
refer back	refer	
recede back	recede	
retreat back	retreat	
repeat again	repeat	*repeat* = do/say again
recur again	recur	*recur* = happen again
reiterate again	reiterate	
restart again / resume again	restart / resume	
revise again	revise	
retire back	retire	
meet together	meet	*meet* implies together
join together	join	
combine together / merge together / mix together	combine / merge / mix	
assemble together / gather together	assemble / gather	
unite together / connect together	unite / connect	
cooperate together / collaborate together	cooperate / collaborate	*co-* = together
rise up / ascend up / lift up / raise up	rise / ascend / lift / raise	*up* is implied
descend down / fall down (formal) / sink down	descend / fall / sink	*down* is implied
enter into (a room)	enter	(*enter into an agreement* ✔)
follow after	follow	
proceed forward / advance forward	proceed / advance	
continue on / still continue	continue	
circle around / surround on all sides	circle / surround	
postpone until later / delay until later	postpone / delay	
plan ahead / plan in advance / warn in advance	plan / warn	
pre-plan / pre-book (in formal style)	plan / book	
over-exaggerate	exaggerate	
emphasise on / stress on / discuss about / order for / request for / reach at / resemble with / comprise of / investigate into / attack on / describe about / mention about	emphasise / stress / discuss / order / request / reach / resemble / comprise / investigate / attack / describe / mention	the verb already takes a direct object (Chapter 17.9)

38.4 Redundant Adjective–Noun and Adverb–Verb Pairs

✘ Redundant	✔ Correct
new innovation / new invention	innovation / invention
free gift	gift
true facts	facts
past history / past experience / past memories	history / experience / memories
future plans / future prospects	plans / prospects
advance planning / advance warning	planning / warning
end result / final outcome / final completion	result / outcome / completion
unexpected surprise / sudden surprise	surprise
added bonus	bonus
close proximity	proximity
basic fundamentals / basic essentials	fundamentals / essentials
exact same / same identical	same / identical
brief summary / short summary	summary
consensus of opinion / general consensus	consensus

✘ Redundant	✔ Correct
mutual cooperation / mutual agreement of both	cooperation / mutual agreement
personal opinion / my own personal view	opinion / my view
foreign imports	imports
frozen ice	ice
two twins / a pair of twins	twins
sum total / totally complete	total / complete
usual custom / usual habit	custom / habit
old adage / old proverb (often)	adage / proverb
original source / original founder	source / founder
unintentional mistake	mistake
completely unanimous / totally unanimous	unanimous
absolutely essential / absolutely necessary	essential / necessary
very unique / most unique / more perfect	unique / perfect (Chapter 24)
alternative choice	alternative / choice
various different / different varieties	various / varieties
visible to the eye / audible to the ear	visible / audible
small in size / red in colour / round in shape / heavy in weight / tall in height	small / red / round / heavy / tall
period of time / time period	period / time
at this point in time / at the present time	now / at present
in the year 2024	in 2024
10 a.m. in the morning / 9 p.m. at night	10 a.m. / 9 p.m.
twelve noon / twelve midnight	noon / midnight
each and every (formal writing)	each / every
first and foremost	first
cash money	cash
ATM machine / PIN number / LCD display / HIV virus / ISBN number	ATM / PIN / LCD / HIV / ISBN (the last letter already stands for the noun)
a new beginning / a fresh start (fine in speech)	a beginning
empty space / empty hole	space / hole
one and the same	the same
the both	both
equally as good	as good / equally good
seldom ever / seldom or ever	seldom / seldom if ever

38.5 Grammatical Redundancy

38.5.1 Double Negatives

- ✘ I **don't** have **no** money. ✔ I don't have **any** money. / I have **no** money.
- ✘ He can't **hardly** walk. ✔ He can **hardly** walk.
- ✘ **Unless** you do **not** work hard … ✔ **Unless** you work hard …
- ✘ Walk carefully **lest** you should **not** fall. ✔ … lest you should fall.
- ✘ He **forbade** me **not** to go. ✔ He forbade me to go.
- ✘ Nobody **cannot** do it. ✔ Nobody **can** do it.

38.5.2 Double Comparatives and Superlatives

- ✘ **more better**, **more stronger**, **most cleverest** ✔ **better**, **stronger**, **cleverest**
- ✘ **more superior**, **more preferable**, **more senior** ✔ **superior**, **preferable**, **senior** (Chapter 10)

38.5.3 Double Conjunctions

- ✘ **Though** he is poor, **but** he is honest. ✔ Though he is poor, he is honest.
- ✘ **Because** he was ill, **so** he did not come. ✔ Because he was ill, he did not come.
- ✘ **As** he was late, **therefore** he was punished. ✔ As he was late, he was punished.
- ✘ **Since** it rained, **hence** we stayed home. ✔ Since it rained, we stayed home.
- ✘ **Both** Rahim **as well as** Karim ✔ Both Rahim **and** Karim
- ✘ The **reason** (**why**) he failed is **because** … ✔ The reason he failed is **that** …
- ✘ **Although** … **yet** — acceptable in traditional style, but *yet* is unnecessary in modern English.

38.5.4 Double Subjects and Objects

- ✘ My father **he** is a doctor. ✔ My father is a doctor.
- ✘ The book which I bought **it** is useful. ✔ The book which I bought is useful.
- ✘ This is the house where I live **there**. ✔ This is the house where I live.
- ✘ The man whom I met **him** yesterday … ✔ The man whom I met yesterday …

38.5.5 Double Prepositions and Unnecessary Prepositions

- ✘ He fell **off of** the roof. ✔ He fell **off** the roof.
- ✘ Where are you going **to**? ✔ Where are you going?
- ✘ Where is he **at**? ✔ Where is he?
- ✘ I will meet you **on** next Friday. ✔ I will meet you next Friday.
- ✘ Inside **of** the house ✔ inside the house
- ✘ He comprises **of** … ✔ He comprises …

38.5.6 Redundant Articles and Determiners

- ✘ **The** both brothers ✔ **Both** brothers / both **the** brothers
- ✘ **A** my friend ✔ **a friend of mine**
- ✘ The **my** book ✔ my book

38.6 Bangladeshi and South Asian English Redundancies

These forms are common in local speech but are **non-standard** in international English:

✘ Local form	✔ Standard English
cousin brother / cousin sister	cousin
co-brother (husband of wife's sister)	brother-in-law
pin-drop silence	complete silence
revert back (= reply)	reply
prepone (opposite of postpone)	bring forward
return back	return
discuss about	discuss
order for	order
out of station	out of town / away
passed out (= graduated)	graduated
do the needful	do what is necessary
good name (= name)	name

✘ Local form	✔ Standard English
kindly do the needful	please do what is necessary
he is having a car	he has a car
my all friends	all my friends
each and every students	each student / every student

38.7 When Repetition Is Acceptable

Not every repetition is an error. Repetition is acceptable:

1. **For emphasis or rhetoric:** *We shall fight, we shall never surrender. Government of the people, by the people, for the people.*
2. **In fixed idioms (binomials):** *safe and sound, null and void, each and every (in speeches), first and foremost (in speeches), hale and hearty, ways and means, rules and regulations, terms and conditions, peace and quiet, by and large*.
3. **Where the extra word adds a real distinction:** *She **completely** destroyed the file* (adds certainty) is normally accepted; *a **true** friend* is fine (not every friend is true).

In exams, however, if a sentence offers a **shorter version with the same meaning**, the shorter version is usually the correct answer.

38.8 Wordiness: Concise Alternatives (GMAT Style)

Wordiness is a close relative of redundancy. Replace long phrases with short ones:

✘ Wordy	✔ Concise
due to the fact that / owing to the fact that / in view of the fact that	because / since
in spite of the fact that / despite the fact that	although
at this point in time / at the present time	now
in the event that	if
in order to	to
for the purpose of	to / for
has the ability to / is able to	can
in close proximity to	near
a large number of	many
a majority of	most
on a daily basis	daily
in a careful manner	carefully
made a decision to	decided to
gave consideration to	considered
conducted an investigation of	investigated
is in agreement with	agrees with
with regard to / with reference to / in relation to	about / regarding
until such time as	until
prior to	before
subsequent to	after
in the near future	soon
it is clear that	clearly
there are many people who think	many people think
the fact that he had not succeeded	his failure
the question as to whether	whether

38.9 Common Redundancy Errors (Exam Style)

1. ✘ He returned back to his village. ✔ He **returned** to his village.
2. ✘ The two friends met together after many years. ✔ The two friends **met** after many years.
3. ✘ Let us cooperate together. ✔ Let us **cooperate**.
4. ✘ The reason why he left is because he was ill. ✔ The reason he left is **that** he was ill.
5. ✘ He is more superior to me. ✔ He is **superior** to me.
6. ✘ Though he tried hard, but he failed. ✔ Though he tried hard, he failed.
7. ✘ She gave me a free gift. ✔ She gave me a **gift**.
8. ✘ Please repeat it again. ✔ Please **repeat** it.
9. ✘ The meeting was postponed until later. ✔ The meeting was **postponed**.
10. ✘ This is a true fact. ✔ This is a **fact**.
11. ✘ He is my cousin brother. ✔ He is my **cousin**.
12. ✘ The final outcome was good. ✔ The **outcome** was good.
13. ✘ We discussed about the problem. ✔ We **discussed** the problem.
14. ✘ The sky is blue in colour. ✔ The sky is **blue**.
15. ✘ He is the most unique person. ✔ He is a **unique** person.
16. ✘ I don't have no time. ✔ I don't have **any** time.
17. ✘ I'll see you at 10 a.m. in the morning. ✔ I'll see you at **10 a.m.**
18. ✘ Both of them were equally as guilty. ✔ Both of them were **equally guilty**.
19. ✘ My brother he lives in London. ✔ My brother lives in London.
20. ✘ He has the ability to speak five languages. ✔ He **can** speak five languages.

38.10 Redundancy in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **SAT Writing** has a whole question type on concision: among four choices that are all grammatical, the **shortest one that keeps the meaning** is usually correct. Delete words that repeat ideas (*annual … every year; reason … because; and also; the end result*).
- **GMAT Sentence Correction** treats redundancy as a **real error**, not just a style issue: ✘ *The two companies merged together.* ✘ *The reason is because …* ✘ *Prices rose upward.* ✘ *… the duration of the period of time …* But GMAT's **first priority is meaning and grammar**; never choose a shorter answer that changes the meaning or creates a grammatical error.
- **GRE vocabulary:** *tautology, pleonasm, verbose, prolix, redundant, circumlocution, periphrasis, garrulous, laconic, terse, succinct, pithy, concise* — words about wordiness and brevity are common in text completion.

CHAPTER 39

Parallel Construction

Part A · Grammar

39.1 What Is Parallel Construction?

Parallel construction (parallelism) means that **similar ideas** in a sentence are expressed in **similar grammatical forms**. When two or more items are joined by *and, or, but, not only … but also, either … or*, or appear in a list or comparison, they should be of the **same type**: noun with noun, adjective with adjective, infinitive with infinitive, gerund with gerund, clause with clause.

- ✘ She likes **swimming**, **to read** and **painting**.
- ✔ She likes **swimming**, **reading** and **painting**. (all gerunds)
- ✔ She likes **to swim**, **to read** and **to paint**. (all infinitives)
- ✘ He is **honest**, **hard-working** and **a man of intelligence**.
- ✔ He is **honest**, **hard-working** and **intelligent**. (all adjectives)

Parallelism makes writing **clear, balanced and elegant**. It is one of the **most heavily tested** topics in **GMAT Sentence Correction** and **SAT Writing**, and it appears in BCS, Bank and admission error detection, especially with correlative conjunctions.

39.2 Where Parallelism Is Required

1. **Items in a list or series** joined by *and / or*.
2. **Pairs joined by coordinating conjunctions** (*and, but, or, nor, yet*).
3. **Correlative conjunctions** (*both … and, either … or, neither … nor, not only … but also, whether … or, not … but, rather than*).
4. **Comparisons** (*than, as … as, like, unlike, more than, less than, prefer … to*).
5. **Certain idiomatic structures** (*from … to, between … and, the more … the more*).

39.3 Parallelism in Lists and Series

- ✘ The job requires **typing**, **filing** and **to answer** the phone.
- ✔ The job requires **typing**, **filing** and **answering** the phone.
- ✘ He came, **he saw** and **conquered**.
- ✔ He **came**, **saw** and **conquered**.
- ✘ The student was **intelligent**, **diligent** and **had a lot of discipline**.
- ✔ The student was **intelligent**, **diligent** and **disciplined**.
- ✘ We should eat fresh fruit, **do exercise** and **getting** enough sleep.
- ✔ We should **eat** fresh fruit, **do** exercise and **get** enough sleep.
- ✘ The report was **long**, **boring**, and **it had many errors**.
- ✔ The report was **long**, **boring** and **full of errors**.

39.4 Parallelism with Correlative Conjunctions

Each half of a correlative pair must be followed by the **same grammatical structure**, and each half must be placed **immediately before** the element it joins.

Correlative	✘ Not parallel	✔ Parallel
both … and	*She is **both** intelligent **and** a hard worker.*	*She is **both** intelligent **and** hard-working.*
either … or	*You can **either** pay **in** cash **or** a cheque.*	*You can pay **either in** cash **or by** cheque.*
neither … nor	*He **neither** wanted money **nor** to be famous.*	*He wanted **neither** money **nor** fame.*
not only … but also	*He **not only** lost his job **but also** his house.*	*He lost **not only** his job **but also** his house.*
whether … or	*I can't decide **whether** to stay **or** going.*	*I can't decide **whether** to stay **or** to go.*
not … but	*The problem is **not** money **but** that we lack time.*	*The problem is **not** money **but** time.*
rather than	*She decided to walk **rather than** taking a bus.*	*She decided **to walk rather than (to) take** a bus.*

Exam Tip — The "cover-up" test: Cover the correlative words and compare what comes directly after each one. *not only **lost his job** / but also **his house*** → verb phrase vs noun → ✘. *lost not only **his job** / but also **his house*** → noun vs noun → ✔.

39.5 Parallelism in Comparisons

Things being compared must be **grammatically and logically parallel** (Chapter 24):

- ✘ I like **reading** more than **to watch** TV.
- ✔ I like **reading** more than **watching** TV.
- ✘ **To err** is human; **forgiving** is divine.
- ✔ **To err** is human; **to forgive** is divine.
- ✘ **Walking** is better for you than **to drive**.
- ✔ **Walking** is better for you than **driving**.
- ✘ The climate of Sylhet is cooler than **Dhaka**.
- ✔ The climate of Sylhet is cooler than **that of Dhaka**. (climate vs climate)
- ✘ He prefers **to work** at night **to working** in the day.
- ✔ He prefers **working** at night **to working** in the day. / He prefers **to work** at night **rather than** in the day.

39.6 Parallelism of Clauses

When clauses are joined, use the **same kind** of clause:

- ✘ I know **that he is honest** and **his hard work**.
- ✔ I know **that he is honest** and **that he works hard**.
- ✘ The teacher told us **to read the chapter** and **that we should answer the questions**.
- ✔ The teacher told us **to read the chapter** and **(to) answer the questions**.
- ✔ The teacher told us **that we should read the chapter** and **(that we should) answer the questions**.

- ✔ He said **that he was tired** and **that he wanted** to go home. (repeating *that* makes the two reported clauses clearly parallel)

39.7 Parallelism of Verb Forms and Tenses

- ✘ She **was cooking** while he **watches** TV. (tense shift)
- ✔ She **was cooking** while he **was watching** TV.
- ✘ He **has finished** the report and **sent** it yesterday.
- ✔ He **finished** the report and **sent** it yesterday.
- ✘ The company **will hire** new staff and **is opening** a new branch.
- ✔ The company **will hire** new staff and **open** a new branch.

39.8 Parallelism of Prepositions, Articles and *To*

A word that applies to **all** items in a series may be written **once** (before the first item) or **repeated before every item** — but not repeated for only some of them.

- ✘ He is interested **in** music, art and **in** literature.
- ✔ He is interested **in** music, art and literature. / ✔ … **in** music, **in** art and **in** literature.
- ✘ I want **to** sing, dance and **to** play.
- ✔ I want **to** sing, dance and play. / ✔ I want **to** sing, **to** dance and **to** play.
- ✘ **The** teacher, principal and **the** chairman were present. (three persons)
- ✔ **The** teacher, **the** principal and **the** chairman were present.

> **When the preposition differs, it must be repeated:** ✘ *He is interested and good at music.* ✔ *He is interested **in** and good **at** music.* ✘ *She was fond and proud of her son.* ✔ *She was fond **of** and proud **of** her son* / *She was fond of her son and proud of him.*

39.9 Parallelism in Idioms: *From … to*, *Between … and*

- ✘ The shop is open **from** 9 a.m. **till** 5 p.m. — acceptable; ✔ **from** 9 a.m. **to** 5 p.m.
- ✘ **Between** 2010 **to** 2020 ✔ **Between** 2010 **and** 2020 / **From** 2010 **to** 2020
- ✘ The difference **between** the rich **with** the poor ✔ The difference **between** the rich **and** the poor

39.10 Parallelism and Balance in Style

Parallel structure gives **rhythm and force** to famous sayings and speeches:

- *Government **of the people, by the people, for the people**.* — Abraham Lincoln
- *I **came**, I **saw**, I **conquered**.* — Julius Caesar
- *Ask **not what your country can do for you**; ask **what you can do for your country**.* — J. F. Kennedy
- *Reading maketh **a full man**; conference **a ready man**; and writing **an exact man**.* — Francis Bacon
- *This time the struggle is **the struggle for our emancipation**; this time the struggle is **the struggle for our independence**.* — Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, 7 March 1971
- *To be or not to be.* — Shakespeare

39.11 Common Errors in Parallelism

1. ✘ He likes reading, writing and to sing. ✔ He likes reading, writing and **singing**.
2. ✘ She is beautiful, intelligent and has kindness. ✔ She is beautiful, intelligent and **kind**.
3. ✘ He not only plays football but also cricket. ✔ He plays **not only** football **but also** cricket.
4. ✘ Either you must pay now or later. ✔ You must pay **either** now **or** later.
5. ✘ The course teaches students how to write, read and speaking clearly. ✔ … how to write, read and **speak** clearly.
6. ✘ He wanted neither money nor to be famous. ✔ He wanted **neither** money **nor** fame.
7. ✘ I prefer walking to drive. ✔ I prefer walking to **driving**.
8. ✘ She sings sweetly and with grace. ✔ She sings sweetly and **gracefully**.
9. ✘ He was asked to stand up and that he should introduce himself. ✔ He was asked to stand up and **(to) introduce** himself.
10. ✘ The manager was rude, careless, and showed no interest. ✔ The manager was rude, careless and **uninterested**.
11. ✘ To succeed you need patience, working hard and luck. ✔ … patience, **hard work** and luck.
12. ✘ He is both a good singer and dances well. ✔ He is **both** a good singer **and** a good dancer.
13. ✘ The old woman was poor, sick and had nobody to help. ✔ … poor, sick and **helpless**.
14. ✘ Swimming is more enjoyable than to run. ✔ Swimming is more enjoyable than **running**.
15. ✘ He spoke clearly, loudly and with confidence. ✔ He spoke clearly, loudly and **confidently**.

39.12 Parallelism in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

GMAT tests parallelism in nearly every set of Sentence Correction questions. Key points:

1. **Identify the parallel markers:** *and, or, but, both … and, either … or, neither … nor, not only … but also, not X but Y, X rather than Y, more X than Y, as X as Y, from X to Y, between X and Y, whether X or Y, like X, unlike X, compare X with Y.*
2. **Match the form** of X and Y: noun ↔ noun, verb ↔ verb (same tense), clause ↔ clause, infinitive ↔ infinitive, *-ing* ↔ *-ing*.
3. **Logical parallelism:** the items must also be **logically comparable** (*the GDP of Bangladesh ↔ that of Vietnam*, not *Vietnam*).
4. **Action nouns vs gerunds:** GMAT prefers parallel **action nouns** (*the **construction** of roads and the **expansion** of ports*) over mixed forms (*the construction of roads and **expanding** ports*).
5. **"Shared" words** (*to, that, the, in*) may be written once or repeated, but consistently.

SAT Writing tests parallelism mainly in lists and with correlatives. **GRE Analytical Writing** rewards parallel structure as a mark of mature style.

CHAPTER 40

Prefix and Suffix

Part A · Grammar

40.1 Roots, Prefixes and Suffixes

Most long English words are built from smaller meaningful parts:

- **Root (base):** the core part that carries the main meaning — *port* (carry), *dict* (say), *happy*.
- **Prefix:** a part added at the **beginning** of a word; it **changes the meaning** but usually **not the part of speech** — *un**happy***, ***re**write*, ***im**port*.
- **Suffix:** a part added at the **end** of a word; it usually **changes the part of speech** (and sometimes the meaning) — *happi**ness***, *port**able***, *dict**ate***.

Prefixes and suffixes together are called **affixes**.

› *un* + *happy* + *ness* → **unhappiness** (prefix *un-* = not; suffix *-ness* = noun)

› *trans* + *port* + *ation* → **transportation** (across + carry + noun)

› *in* + *dict* + *ment* → **indictment**

› *pre* + *dict* + *able* → **predictable**

Knowing affixes and roots helps you **(1)** form opposites and different parts of speech (common BCS/admission questions), **(2)** spell correctly, and **(3)** guess the meaning of **unknown words** — the single most powerful vocabulary strategy for the **GRE, SAT and GMAT**.

40.2 Negative Prefixes (Forming Opposites)

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
un-	not, opposite of	unable, unhappy, unkind, unknown, unfair, unusual, untidy, unlock, undo, unveil
in-	not	inactive, incorrect, incomplete, independent, inefficient, insane, invisible, inaccurate
im- (before *b, m, p*)	not	imbalance, immature, immortal, impatient, impolite, impossible, impure, imperfect
il- (before *l*)	not	illegal, illegible, illiterate, illogical, illegitimate, illiberal
ir- (before *r*)	not	irregular, irrelevant, irresponsible, irrational, irreversible, irresistible, irreparable
dis-	not, opposite, remove	disagree, dishonest, dislike, disobey, disorder, disappear, disconnect, discomfort
non-	not	nonsense, non-violent, non-existent, non-stop, nonchalant, non-fiction
mis-	wrongly, badly	misunderstand, misuse, mislead, misbehave, misfortune, misprint, misspell
mal-	badly, ill	malfunction, malnutrition, maltreat, malpractice, malcontent, malevolent
a- / an-	without, not	amoral, atypical, apolitical, asymmetry, anarchy, anaemia, anonymous
anti-	against	antisocial, antibiotic, antiseptic, anticlockwise, antidote, antipathy
counter-	against, opposite	counteract, counterattack, counterpart, counterproductive
de-	reverse, remove, down	decode, defrost, deforestation, devalue, degrade, decentralise
contra-	against	contradict, contraband, contraception, contravene
ab-	away from	abnormal, absent, abduct, abstain

Which negative prefix? There is no complete rule, but: ***im-*** before *b, m, p*; ***il-*** before *l*; ***ir-*** before *r*; ***in-*** before most other Latin-origin words; ***un-*** mostly before native English words and words ending in *-ed, -ing, -able, -ful*. Some words take two different prefixes with different meanings: *unarmed* (without weapons) vs *disarmed* (weapons taken away); *uninterested* (not interested) vs *disinterested* (impartial); *unable* vs *disable(d)*; *unorganised* (not organised yet) vs *disorganised* (badly organised).

Careful — *in-* does not always mean "not": *inflammable* = easily set on fire (= *flammable*); *invaluable* = extremely valuable; *inhabit* = live in; *intend, insist, include, income, inside* — here *in-* means "in, into". Similarly *ravel* and *unravel* both mean "to untangle"; *loosen* and *unloosen* mean the same.

40.3 Prefixes of Number and Quantity

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
uni-, mono-	one	uniform, unique, unite, universe, unilateral, monologue, monopoly, monotonous, monarchy, monogamy
bi-, di-, du-	two	bicycle, bilingual, biannual, biennial, bisect, dialogue (*dia-* = through, not two), dioxide, dilemma, dual, duplicate
tri-	three	triangle, tricycle, trilogy, trio, triple, tripartite
quadr-, quart-, tetra-	four	quadrilateral, quarter, quartet, tetrahedron
pent(a)-, quint-	five	pentagon, pentathlon, quintet

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
hex(a)-, sex-	six	hexagon, sextet
hept(a)-, sept-	seven	heptagon, September (originally the 7th month)
oct(a/o)-	eight	octagon, octopus, octave, October
non-, nona-	nine	nonagon, November
dec(a)-, deci-	ten / tenth	decade, decimal, decimate, December, decilitre
cent(i)-, hect(o)-	hundred / hundredth	century, centenary, centimetre, centipede, hectare
kilo-, milli-	thousand / thousandth	kilogram, kilometre, millimetre, millennium
mega-, giga-	million / billion; huge	megabyte, megacity, gigabyte, gigantic
micro-	very small	microscope, microphone, microbe, microcosm
macro-	large	macroeconomics, macrocosm
multi-, poly-	many	multinational, multiply, multitude, polygon, polytechnic, polygamy, polyglot
semi-, hemi-, demi-	half	semicircle, semifinal, hemisphere, demigod
omni-, pan-	all	omnipotent, omniscient, omnipresent, omnivorous, panorama, pandemic, panacea, pan-Islamic
ambi-, amphi-	both	ambiguous, ambidextrous, ambivalent, amphibian, amphitheatre

40.4 Prefixes of Time, Place and Position

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
pre-, ante-, fore-	before	predict, prehistoric, prepare, antedate, antecedent, ante-room, forecast, foresee, forefather
post-	after	postpone, postwar, postgraduate, postscript (P.S.), posthumous
re-	again, back	rewrite, rebuild, return, recall, reconsider, rejoin, revive
retro-	backwards	retrospect, retroactive, retrograde
ex-	out of; former	exit, export, exclude, extract; ex-president, ex-wife
e-	out	emit, evade, emigrate, eject
in-, im- (= into)	in, into	import, include, inhale, immigrate, insert
intra-, intro-	within, inside	intranet, intravenous, introvert, introduce
inter-	between, among	international, interval, interact, interrupt, intervene
trans-	across, beyond	transport, transfer, translate, transatlantic, transparent, transform
sub-	under, below	submarine, subway, subtitle, subordinate, submerge, subconscious
super-, sur-, supra-	above, over	supervise, superior, supernatural, surpass, surcharge, supranational
hyper-	over, excessive	hypertension, hyperactive, hyperbole
hypo-	under, below normal	hypodermic, hypothesis, hypocrisy
infra-	below	infrastructure, infrared
ultra-	beyond, extremely	ultraviolet, ultrasonic, ultramodern
extra-	outside, beyond	extraordinary, extracurricular, extraterrestrial
circum-	around	circumference, circumstance, circumnavigate, circumspect
peri-	around	perimeter, periscope, peripheral
para-	beside; against	paragraph, parallel, paramedic; paradox, parasol
dia-	through, across	diameter, diagonal, dialogue, diagnosis
ad- (ac-, af-, ag-, al-, an-, ap-, ar-, as-, at-)	to, towards	adhere, accept, affix, aggravate, allot, annex, approve, arrive, assist, attract
com-, con-, col-, cor-, co-	with, together	combine, connect, collect, correspond, cooperate, coexist, colleague
syn-, sym-	together, same	synonym, synthesis, sympathy, symphony, symmetry
out-	surpass; outside	outrun, outnumber, outlive, outdoor, outskirts
over-	too much; above	overeat, overload, overcome, overlook
under-	too little; below	underpay, underestimate, underground, undergo
up-	upwards	upgrade, uplift, uproot, update
with-	against, back	withdraw, withhold, withstand

40.5 Other Common Prefixes

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
auto-	self	autobiography, automatic, autonomy, autocrat, autograph
bene-, bon-	good, well	benefit, benevolent, benefactor, benediction, bonus, bona fide
mal-, male-	bad	malevolent, malefactor, malice, malaria
eu-	good, well	euphemism, euphony, euthanasia, eulogy, euphoria
dys-	bad, difficult	dysfunction, dyslexia, dystopia, dysentery
bio-	life	biology, biography, biodiversity, antibiotic
geo-	earth	geography, geology, geometry, geopolitics

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
hydro-	water	hydroelectric, hydrogen, dehydrate, hydrophobia
photo-	light	photograph, photosynthesis, photocopy
tele-	far	telephone, television, telescope, telegram, telepathy
phil-, philo-	love	philosophy, philanthropy, philology, Philadelphia
psych(o)-	mind	psychology, psychiatry, psychic
theo-	god	theology, theocracy, atheist, monotheism
therm(o)-	heat	thermometer, thermal, thermostat
neo-	new	neonatal, neologism, neoclassical
pseudo-	false	pseudonym, pseudoscience
proto-	first	prototype, protocol, protagonist
arch-	chief	archbishop, archangel, arch-enemy
vice-	deputy	vice-president, vice-chancellor, viceroy
homo-	same	homogeneous, homonym, homophone
hetero-	different	heterogeneous, heterodox
en-, em-	put into, make	enable, enlarge, enrich, endanger, encourage, empower, embitter, embody
be-	make, treat as	befriend, belittle, bewitch, becalm, behead
for-	away, against	forbid, forgive, forsake, forgo

40.6 Important Greek and Latin Roots

Learning about sixty roots unlocks thousands of English words — an essential GRE/SAT tool.

Root	Meaning	Examples
ann, enn	year	annual, anniversary, annals, biennial, perennial, centennial
aud	hear	audio, audience, audible, auditorium, audition
bell	war	rebel, bellicose, belligerent, antebellum
cap, capt, cept, ceive	take, seize	capture, captive, accept, intercept, receive, perceive, capable
ced, cede, ceed, cess	go, yield	precede, proceed, exceed, recede, concede, access, process, recession
chron	time	chronic, chronology, chronicle, synchronise, anachronism
cide, cis	kill, cut	homicide, suicide, genocide, pesticide, incision, precise, concise
clud, clus, clos	close, shut	include, exclude, conclude, seclusion, enclose
cred	believe	credit, credible, credulous, incredible, creed, credentials
cur, curs	run	current, occur, recur, cursor, excursion, precursor
dict	say, speak	dictate, predict, contradict, verdict, diction, dictionary, edict
duc, duct	lead	conduct, produce, educate, induce, deduce, abduct, aqueduct
fac, fact, fect, fic	make, do	factory, manufacture, affect, effect, perfect, sufficient, efficient, facile
fer	carry, bear	transfer, refer, infer, confer, fertile, ferry, defer
fid	faith	confide, fidelity, infidel, bona fide, diffident, perfidious
flect, flex	bend	reflect, deflect, flexible, inflexible, genuflect
fract, frag	break	fracture, fraction, fragile, fragment, refract
gen	birth, kind	generate, genetics, genesis, gender, generous, progeny, indigenous, homogeneous
grad, gress	step, go	gradual, graduate, upgrade, progress, regress, aggression, digress, transgress
graph, gram	write	autograph, biography, paragraph, telegram, grammar, diagram
ject	throw	eject, inject, project, reject, object, subject, dejected
jud, jur, jus	law, judge	judge, judicial, prejudice, jury, jurisdiction, justice, perjury
lect, leg, lig	choose, read	collect, select, elect, lecture, legible, eligible, intelligent, diligent
loc	place	local, locate, location, dislocate, locomotive
log, logy	word, study	dialogue, monologue, logic, biology, apology, eulogy
loqu, locu	speak	eloquent, loquacious, soliloquy, colloquial, circumlocution, elocution
luc, lum	light	lucid, elucidate, translucent, luminous, illuminate
man, manu	hand	manual, manufacture, manuscript, manipulate, emancipate, manicure
mit, miss	send	transmit, submit, admit, permit, mission, dismiss, emissary, remiss

Root	Meaning	Examples
mort	death	mortal, immortal, mortality, mortuary, mortgage, mortify
mot, mov, mob	move	motion, motive, promote, remove, movement, mobile
nom, nym, onym	name	nominate, nominal, synonym, antonym, pseudonym, anonymous, misnomer
path, pathy	feeling, suffering	sympathy, empathy, apathy, pathetic, antipathy, telepathy, pathology
ped, pod	foot	pedal, pedestrian, pedestal, expedite, impede, tripod, podium
pel, puls	drive, push	compel, expel, repel, propel, impulse, compulsory, repulsive
pend, pens	hang, weigh, pay	pendant, depend, suspend, pending, compensate, expensive, pension
phon	sound	telephone, phonetics, symphony, cacophony, euphony, microphone
port	carry	transport, import, export, portable, report, support, porter
pos, pon	put, place	position, deposit, compose, oppose, postpone, component, proponent
rupt	break	erupt, interrupt, rupture, bankrupt, corrupt, disrupt, abrupt
scrib, script	write	describe, prescribe, subscribe, inscription, manuscript, scripture
sect, sec	cut	section, sector, dissect, intersect, insect, bisect
sent, sens	feel	sensitive, sensation, consent, resent, sentiment, dissent, sensible
sequ, secu	follow	sequence, consequence, subsequent, sequel, consecutive, persecute
spec, spect, spic	look, see	spectator, inspect, respect, prospect, spectacle, conspicuous, perspective, specimen
spir	breathe	inspire, expire, respiration, aspire, conspire, perspire
struct	build	construct, structure, destruction, instruct, obstruct, infrastructure
tact, tang	touch	contact, tactile, intact, tangible, tangent
ten, tain, tent	hold	tenant, tenacious, retain, contain, maintain, detain, tenure, content
terr	earth, land	territory, terrestrial, terrain, Mediterranean, subterranean
tort	twist	distort, contort, torture, retort, extort, tortuous
tract	pull, drag	attract, distract, extract, subtract, tractor, contract, retract
ven, vent	come	convene, intervene, venue, event, prevent, invent, advent, souvenir
ver	true	verify, verdict, veracity, verily, aver
vers, vert	turn	reverse, convert, divert, introvert, extrovert, versatile, adversary, avert
vid, vis	see	video, evident, provide, vision, visible, revise, supervise, visual
viv, vit	life	vivid, revive, survive, vital, vitamin, vivacious
voc, vok	call, voice	vocal, vocabulary, advocate, invoke, provoke, revoke, equivocal
volv, volu	roll, turn	revolve, involve, evolve, revolution, voluble

40.7 Suffixes

40.7.1 Noun-Forming Suffixes

Suffix	Meaning / Use	Examples
-tion, -sion, -ation, -ition	act, state, result	action, decision, information, competition, admission
-ment	act, result, state	movement, government, agreement, achievement, punishment
-ness	state, quality	happiness, kindness, darkness, weakness, carelessness
-ity, -ty	state, quality	ability, equality, reality, cruelty, safety, loyalty
-ance, -ence, -ancy, -ency	state, quality	importance, patience, independence, vacancy, emergency
-age	action, collection, place	marriage, passage, baggage, village, orphanage
-al	act of	arrival, refusal, approval, denial, proposal, survival
-dom	state, domain	freedom, wisdom, kingdom, boredom, martyrdom
-hood	state, time	childhood, motherhood, neighbourhood, falsehood
-ship	state, skill, position	friendship, leadership, scholarship, citizenship
-ism	belief, system, practice	patriotism, heroism, socialism, terrorism, criticism
-ist	person who practises/believes	artist, scientist, novelist, socialist, dentist
-er, -or, -ar	doer	teacher, writer, actor, inventor, beggar, liar
-ee	receiver of action	employee, trainee, payee, referee, absentee, refugee
-eer	person engaged in	engineer, volunteer, mountaineer, auctioneer

Suffix	Meaning / Use	Examples
-ant, -ent	agent	assistant, servant, applicant, student, president
-ian, -an	person of / skilled in	musician, librarian, historian, physician, Indian, Asian
-ess	female	actress, hostess, princess (Chapter 07)
-ure	act, result	failure, pressure, departure, closure
-th	state	growth, truth, depth, width, health, wealth
-ry, -ery	place, practice, collection	bakery, slavery, bravery, machinery, jewellery
-cy	state, quality	accuracy, privacy, democracy, infancy, bankruptcy
-ing	action, result	building, meeting, painting, feeling
-ology	study of	biology, psychology, geology, sociology
-cracy / -crat	rule / ruler	democracy, bureaucracy, autocrat, aristocrat
-archy / -arch	rule / ruler	monarchy, anarchy, patriarch, matriarch
-phobia	fear of	hydrophobia, claustrophobia, xenophobia
-cide	killing	homicide, genocide, pesticide, fratricide
-let, -ling, -ette, -kin, -ock, -ie/-y, -ule, -cule (diminutives)	small	booklet, piglet, duckling, kitchenette, cigarette, lambkin, hillock, doggie, globule, molecule

40.7.2 Adjective-Forming Suffixes

Suffix	Meaning	Examples
-able, -ible	capable of, worthy of	readable, comfortable, reliable, visible, possible, edible
-al, -ial	relating to	national, natural, personal, financial, presidential
-ic, -ical	relating to	heroic, poetic, historic, historical, economic, economical
-ish	somewhat; like; nationality	reddish, childish, foolish, selfish, English, Turkish
-ive, -ative	tending to	active, creative, talkative, attractive, informative
-ous, -ious, -eous	full of	famous, dangerous, curious, glorious, courageous, gorgeous
-ful	full of	beautiful, careful, helpful, useful, peaceful
-less	without	careless, homeless, useless, hopeless, priceless (= very valuable!)
-y	full of, like	rainy, cloudy, dirty, healthy, sleepy
-ly	like, having the quality of	friendly, lovely, manly, cowardly, costly
-ary, -ory	relating to	necessary, imaginary, ordinary, compulsory, satisfactory
-ant, -ent	having the quality of	important, pleasant, different, independent, silent
-some	tending to	troublesome, handsome, lonesome, wholesome, tiresome
-en	made of	wooden, golden, woollen, earthen
-ward	in the direction of	backward, forward, upward, eastward
-esque	in the style of	picturesque, Kafkaesque, grotesque
-like	like	childlike, lifelike, warlike, businesslike
-ese, -an, -i	nationality	Chinese, Japanese, Indian, Bangladeshi, Pakistani

40.7.3 Verb-Forming Suffixes

Suffix	Meaning	Examples
-ize / -ise	make, cause to be	modernise, realise, organise, criticise, popularise, apologise
-ify / -fy	make	beautify, simplify, purify, clarify, satisfy, justify, glorify
-en	make, become	strengthen, widen, shorten, sharpen, darken, lengthen
-ate	make, act	activate, motivate, educate, regulate, liberate

40.7.4 Adverb-Forming Suffixes

Suffix	Examples
-ly	quickly, happily, carefully, simply
-ward(s)	homeward(s), backward(s), afterwards
-wise	clockwise, otherwise, likewise, lengthwise
-way(s)	always, sideways, anyway

40.8 Spelling Rules When Adding Affixes

1. **Prefixes do not change the spelling of the root:** *un + necessary = **unn**ecessary; mis + spell = mi**ss**pell; dis + satisfy = di**ss**atisfy; il + legal = i**ll**egal; im + mortal = i**mm**ortal; ir + regular = i**rr**egular; over + run = overrun.*
2. **Drop the silent *-e* before a suffix beginning with a vowel:** *hope → hoping, love → lovable, write → writing, use → usage, fame → famous.* **Keep** it before a consonant suffix: *hope → hopeful, care → careful, move → movement* (exceptions: *argue → argument, true → truly, nine → ninth, judge → judgment* (also *judgement*), *awe → awful, whole → wholly*).
3. **Keep the *-e* after *c* or *g* before *-able* / *-ous*** to keep the soft sound: *notice → notic**e**able, change → chang**e**able, courage → courag**e**ous, manage → manag**e**able, outrage → outrag**e**ous.*
4. **Consonant + *y* → *i*** before most suffixes: *happy → happiness, beauty → beautiful, carry → carriage, easy → easily, pity → pitiful* (but keep *y* before *-ing*: *carrying, studying*).
5. **Double the final consonant** of a one-syllable word or a stressed final syllable before a vowel suffix: *run → runner, begin → beginning, occur → occurrence, forget → forgettable, regret → regrettable, commit → committee.* (No doubling when the stress is not final: *benefit → benefited, offer → offering.*)

6. **-able vs -ible:** *-able* usually follows a **complete word** (*accept**able**, comfort**able**, depend**able***); *-ible* usually follows a **Latin root that is not a complete word** (*poss**ible**, vis**ible**, ed**ible**, aud**ible**, terr**ible***). Exceptions exist (*flex**ible**, collect**ible***).
7. **-ance / -ence, -ant / -ent:** no fixed rule; learn by family: *import**ant** – import**ance***; *differ**ent** – differ**ence***; *independ**ent** – independ**ence***; *relev**ant** – relev**ance***; *exist**ent** – exist**ence***.
8. **-ise / -ize:** British English accepts both (*organise/organize*); American English uses *-ize*. Some words are always *-ise*: *advertise, advise, comprise, compromise, despise, devise, exercise, revise, supervise, surprise, televise*. *Analyse/paralyse* (BrE) vs *analyze/paralyze* (AmE).

40.9 Exam Applications

(a) Forming opposites with prefixes:

- *legal → **il**legal; regular → **ir**regular; patient → **im**patient; honest → **dis**honest; understand → **mis**understand; sense → **non**sense; kind → **un**kind; possible → **im**possible; literate → **il**literate; responsible → **ir**responsible; appear → **dis**appear; fortune → **mis**fortune; function → **mal**function; violent → **non**-violent*

(b) Forming nouns/adjectives/verbs with suffixes (full lists in Chapter 41):

- *wide → widen (v), width (n); strong → strengthen (v), strength (n); beauty → beautify (v), beautiful (adj); able → enable (v), ability (n); real → realise (v), reality (n); simple → simplify (v), simplicity (n); danger → endanger (v), dangerous (adj)*

(c) Guessing word meaning from parts:

- ***circumnavigate*** = *circum* (around) + *navigate* (sail) → to sail around.
- ***benevolent*** = *bene* (good) + *vol* (wish) + *-ent* → wishing good, kind.
- ***incredulous*** = *in* (not) + *cred* (believe) + *-ulous* → not believing, sceptical.
- ***retrospective*** = *retro* (back) + *spect* (look) + *-ive* → looking back.
- ***omnivorous*** = *omni* (all) + *vor* (eat) + *-ous* → eating all kinds of food.
- ***philanthropist*** = *phil* (love) + *anthrop* (mankind) + *-ist* → a lover of mankind, one who gives to charity.

40.10 Prefixes and Suffixes in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **GRE/SAT vocabulary decoding:** When you meet an unfamiliar word in Text Completion or Reading, break it into parts: *in-defatig-able* (not + tire + able = tireless), *mal-ediction* (bad + saying = curse), *equi-voc-al* (equal + voice = ambiguous), *circum-spect* (around + look = cautious), *e-locution* (out + speak = art of speaking).
- **Beware of false analysis:** roots give **clues, not proof**. *Inflammable* means *flammable*; *pedagogue* (teacher) has nothing to do with feet (*ped* here is Greek *paid* = child); *noisome* means foul-smelling, not noisy.
- **GMAT:** word-form errors (*a similarity* vs *similar*, *economic* vs *economical*) are tested indirectly; knowing suffixes helps you choose the right part of speech.

CHAPTER 41

Change of Parts of Speech

Part A · Grammar

41.1 What Is Meant by “Change of Parts of Speech”?

Most English words belong to **word families**: one root appears as a **noun**, a **verb**, an **adjective** and an **adverb** with different endings.

- *beauty* (n) — *beautify* (v) — *beautiful* (adj) — *beautifully* (adv)
- *success* (n) — *succeed* (v) — *successful* (adj) — *successfully* (adv)
- *decision* (n) — *decide* (v) — *decisive* (adj) — *decisively* (adv)

Questions on this topic are very common in BCS, Bank and admission tests: “*What is the noun form of …?*”, “*Change the part of speech of the underlined word*”, or “*Use the correct form of the word in brackets*” (*He was praised for his (honest) → honesty*). In GMAT and SAT, choosing the wrong word form (*economic* vs *economical*, *a dependence* vs *dependent*) is a common error.

How to choose the right form in a sentence: (1) after *a/an/the/his/this* → **noun** (or adjective + noun); (2) after *to* or a modal → **verb**; (3) after *very / too / so / be / seem / become* → **adjective**; (4) describing a verb → **adverb**. Then use the tables below to find the correct spelling.

41.2 Word Families: The Master Tables

A dash (—) means there is no common form in that class.

41.2.1 A – C

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
ability	enable	able	ably
abolition	abolish	abolished	—
absence	absent (oneself)	absent	absently
abundance	abound	abundant	abundantly
acceptance	accept	acceptable	acceptably
accident	—	accidental	accidentally
accuracy	—	accurate	accurately
achievement	achieve	achievable	—
action / act	act	active	actively
addition	add	additional	additionally
admiration	admire	admirable	admirably
admission	admit	admissible	—
advantage	advantage	advantageous	advantageously
advice	advise	advisable / advisory	advisedly
anger	anger	angry	angrily
anxiety	—	anxious	anxiously
appearance	appear	apparent	apparently
application	apply	applicable	—
appreciation	appreciate	appreciable / appreciative	appreciably
attraction	attract	attractive	attractively
authority	authorise	authoritative	authoritatively
beauty	beautify	beautiful	beautifully
belief	believe	believable	believably
birth	bear	born / borne	—
blood	bleed	bloody	—
boldness	embolden	bold	boldly
bravery	brave	brave	bravely
breadth	broaden	broad	broadly
brevity	abbreviate	brief	briefly
calculation	calculate	calculable	—
calm	calm	calm	calmly
care	care	careful / careless	carefully
caution	caution	cautious	cautiously
centre	centralise	central	centrally
certainty	ascertain	certain	certainly
child / childhood	—	childish / child-like	childishly
choice	choose	choosy	—
civilisation	civilise	civil / civilised	civilly
clarity	clarify	clear	clearly
collection	collect	collective	collectively
comfort	comfort	comfortable	comfortably
commerce	commercialise	commercial	commercially
comparison	compare	comparative / comparable	comparatively
competition	compete	competitive	competitively
completion	complete	complete	completely
conclusion	conclude	conclusive	conclusively
confidence	confide	confident / confidential	confidently
confusion	confuse	confusing / confused	confusedly
consciousness	—	conscious	consciously
continuation	continue	continuous / continual	continuously / continually
courage	encourage	courageous	courageously
creation	create	creative	creatively
crime	criminalise	criminal	criminally
critic / criticism	criticise	critical	critically
cruelty	—	cruel	cruelly
culture	cultivate	cultural	culturally
curiosity	—	curious	curiously

41.2.2 D – F

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
danger	endanger	dangerous	dangerously
darkness	darken	dark	darkly
death	die	dead / deadly / dying	—
deception / deceit	deceive	deceptive / deceitful	deceptively
decision	decide	decisive	decisively

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
decoration	decorate	decorative	decoratively
defence	defend	defensive / defence-less	defensively
definition	define	definite / definitive	definitely
delight	delight	delightful	delightfully
democracy	democratise	democratic	democratic-ally
depth	deepen	deep	deeply
description	describe	descriptive	descriptively
destruction	destroy	destructive	destructively
development	develop	developed / develop-ing	—
difference	differ / differenti-ate	different	differently
difficulty	—	difficult	—
diligence	—	diligent	diligently
direction	direct	direct	directly
distance	distance	distant	distantly
doubt	doubt	doubtful	doubtfully
economy	economise	economic / economic-al	economically
education	educate	educational / educated	educationally
effect	effect	effective	effectively
efficiency	—	efficient	efficiently
emphasis	emphasise	emphatic	emphatically
encouragement	encourage	encouraging	encouragingly
energy	energise	energetic	energetically
enjoyment	enjoy	enjoyable	enjoyably
enmity / enemy	—	inimical	—
entrance	enter	—	—
envy	envy	envious	enviously
equality	equalise	equal	equally
existence	exist	existent / existing	—
expansion	expand	expansive	expansively
expectation	expect	expectant	expectantly
experience	experience	experienced	—
explanation	explain	explanatory / explic-able	—
expression	express	expressive	expressively
failure	fail	failing	—
faith	—	faithful	faithfully
falsehood	falsify	false	falsely
fame	—	famous	famously
familiarity	familiarise	familiar	familiarly
fashion	fashion	fashionable	fashionably
fear	fear / frighten	fearful / fearless	fearfully
finance	finance	financial	financially
flight	fly / flee	flying	—
force	force	forceful / forcible	forcefully
foolishness / folly	fool	foolish	foolishly
forgetfulness	forget	forgetful	forgetfully
freedom	free	free	freely
friend / friend-ship	befriend	friendly	—
fullness	fill	full	fully

41.2.3 G – L

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
generosity	—	generous	generously
glory	glorify	glorious	gloriously
gold	gild	golden	—
goodness	—	good	well
grace	grace	graceful / gracious	gracefully
gratitude	—	grateful	gratefully
greatness	—	great	greatly
grief	grieve	grievous	grievously
growth	grow	growing / grown	—
habit	habituate	habitual	habitually
happiness	—	happy	happily
harm	harm	harmful / harmless	harmfully
hate / hatred	hate	hateful	hatefully
health	heal	healthy	healthily
heat	heat	hot	hotly
height	heighten	high	highly
help	help	helpful / helpless	helpfully
hero / heroism	—	heroic	heroically
history	—	historic / historical	historically
honesty	—	honest	honestly
honour	honour	honourable / honor-ary	honourably
hope	hope	hopeful / hopeless	hopefully
horror	horrify	horrible / horrific	horribly
humanity	humanise	human / humane	humanly / hu-manely
humility	humble	humble	humbly
hunger	hunger	hungry	hungrily
identity / identifica-tion	identify	identical	identically
imagination	imagine	imaginary / imaginat-ive	imaginatively
imitation	imitate	imitative	—
importance	—	important	importantly
impression	impress	impressive	impressively
improvement	improve	improved	—
independence	—	independent	independently
industry	industrial-ise	industrial / industri-ous	industriously
information	inform	informative	informatively
injury	injure	injurious	—
innocence	—	innocent	innocently
intelligence	—	intelligent	intelligently
intention	intend	intentional	intentionally
interest	interest	interesting / inter-ested	interestingly
invention	invent	inventive	—
joy	enjoy	joyful / joyous	joyfully
judgement	judge	judicious / judicial	judiciously
justice	justify	just	justly
kindness	—	kind	kindly

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
knowledge	know	knowledgeable / known	knowingly
law	legalise	lawful / legal	lawfully / legally
laughter	laugh	laughable	laughably
length	lengthen	long / lengthy	—
liberty	liberate	liberal	liberally
life	live	live / living / lively	—
loss	lose	lost	—
love	love	lovely / loving	lovingly
loyalty	—	loyal	loyally

41.2.4 M – P

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
madness	madden	mad	madly
majority	—	major	—
management	manage	manageable / managerial	—
marriage	marry	marital / married	—
memory	memorise	memorable	memorably
mercy	—	merciful / merciless	mercifully
minority	—	minor	—
misery	—	miserable	miserably
modernity	modernise	modern	—
moisture	moisten	moist	—
morality	moralise	moral	morally
motion / movement	move	moving / movable	movingly
nation	nationalise	national	nationally
nature	naturalise	natural	naturally
necessity	necessitate	necessary	necessarily
neglect	neglect	negligent / neglectful	negligently
nobility	ennoble	noble	nobly
obedience	obey	obedient	obediently
obligation	oblige	obligatory	—
observation	observe	observant	observantly
occupation	occupy	occupational	—
offence	offend	offensive	offensively
opposition	oppose	opposite	—
order	order	orderly	—
origin	originate	original	originally
pain	pain	painful	painfully
patience	—	patient	patiently
peace	pacify	peaceful	peacefully
perfection	perfect	perfect	perfectly
permission	permit	permissible / permissive	—
person / personality	personify	personal	personally
persuasion	persuade	persuasive	persuasively
pity	pity	pitiful / pitiable / piteous	pitifully
pleasure	please	pleasant / pleasing	pleasantly
poetry / poem / poet	—	poetic	poetically
politeness	—	polite	politely
politics	politicise	political	politically
popularity	popularise	popular	popularly
possession	possess	possessive	possessively
possibility	—	possible	possibly
poverty	impoverish	poor	poorly
power	empower	powerful	powerfully
practice	practise	practical	practically
praise	praise	praiseworthy	—
preference	prefer	preferable	preferably
preparation	prepare	preparatory	—
presence	present	present	presently
pride	pride (oneself)	proud	proudly
probability	—	probable	probably
production / product	produce	productive	productively
profession	profess	professional	professionally
profit	profit	profitable	profitably
progress	progress	progressive	progressively
prohibition	prohibit	prohibitive	—
proof	prove	—	—
prosperity	prosper	prosperous	prosperously
protection	protect	protective	protectively
punctuality	—	punctual	punctually
punishment	punish	punitive	—
purity	purify	pure	purely

41.2.5 Q – Z

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
quality	qualify	qualitative	qualitatively
quickness	quicken	quick	quickly
reality	realise	real / realistic	really
reason	reason	reasonable	reasonably
receipt / reception	receive	receptive	—
recognition	recognise	recognisable	—
reduction	reduce	reducible	—
refusal	refuse	—	—
relation	relate	relative	relatively
relief	relieve	relieved	—
religion	—	religious	religiously
reputation	repute	reputable / reputed	reputedly
resistance	resist	resistant	—
respect	respect	respectable / respectful / respective	respectfully / respectively
responsibility	—	responsible	responsibly
revolution	revolutionise	revolutionary	—
richness / riches	enrich	rich	richly
safety	save	safe	safely
satisfaction	satisfy	satisfactory / satisfied	satisfactorily
science	—	scientific	scientifically
security	secure	secure	securely
sense / sensation	sense	sensible / sensitive / sensual	sensibly / sensitively

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
service	serve	serviceable	—
shortage / shortness	shorten	short	shortly
silence	silence	silent	silently
simplicity	simplify	simple	simply
sincerity	—	sincere	sincerely
society	socialise	social / sociable	socially
solution	solve	soluble / solvable	—
speech	speak	speechless	—
strength	strengthen	strong	strongly
success	succeed	successful	successfully
succession	succeed	successive	successively
suggestion	suggest	suggestive	—
supposition	suppose	supposed	supposedly
surprise	surprise	surprising	surprisingly
sweetness	sweeten	sweet	sweetly
sympathy	sympathise	sympathetic	sympathetically
terror	terrify / terrorise	terrible / terrific	terribly
theft / thief	thieve	thievish	—
thought	think	thoughtful	thoughtfully
tolerance	tolerate	tolerant / tolerable	tolerably
tradition	—	traditional	traditionally
truth	—	true / truthful	truly / truthfully
use / usage	use	useful / useless	usefully
validity	validate	valid	validly
value	value	valuable / invaluable	—
vanity	—	vain	vainly
variety / variation	vary	various / variable	variously
victory / victor	—	victorious	victoriously
violence	—	violent	violently
warmth	warm	warm	warmly
weakness	weaken	weak	weakly
wealth	—	wealthy	—
weight	weigh	weighty	—
width	widen	wide	widely
wisdom	—	wise	wisely
wonder	wonder	wonderful	wonderfully
worth	—	worthy / worthwhile	—
youth	—	young / youthful	youthfully
zeal	—	zealous	zealously

41.3 Some Special Cases

41.3.1 One Word, Two Noun Forms

Root	Noun 1	Noun 2
succeed	**success** (achievement)	**succession** (following in order)
respect	**respect** (honour)	**respectability** (being respectable)
sense	**sensibility** (sensitivity, feeling)	**sensitivity / sensation**
judge	**judgement** (opinion, verdict)	**judiciary** (system of courts)
industry	**industry** (manufacturing; diligence)	**industriousness** (diligence)
economy	**economy** (financial system; thrift)	**economics** (the subject)
history	**history**	**historian** (person)
person	**personality** (character)	**personnel** (staff)

41.3.2 Adjective Pairs with Different Meanings

Both are formed from the same root, but they mean different things (see Chapter 09.10 and Chapter 52):

economic / economical; historic / historical; industrial / industrious; respectable / respectful / respective; sensible / sensitive; childish / childlike; imaginary / imaginative; continual / continuous; credible / credulous / creditable; luxurious / luxuriant; momentary / momentous; official / officious; ingenious / ingenuous; human / humane; honorary / honourable; comprehensible / comprehensive; contemptible / contemptuous; judicial / judicious; politic / political.

41.3.3 Noun and Verb Pairs Differing in One Letter (Spelling Traps)

Noun	Verb
advice	advise
device	devise
practice	practise (BrE)
licence	license (BrE)
prophecy	prophesy
belief	believe
relief	relieve
proof	prove
grief	grieve
life	live
breath	breathe
bath	bathe
cloth	clothe
loss	lose
choice	choose

41.4 Using the Correct Form in a Sentence: Examples

1. He was praised for his **(honest)**. → **honesty** (after *his* → noun)
2. She sang **(beautiful)**. → **beautifully** (modifies *sang* → adverb)
3. We should **(strong)** our economy. → **strengthen** (after *should* → verb)
4. The **(poor)** of the villagers is shocking. → **poverty**
5. He is a **(success)** businessman. → **successful** (before noun → adjective)
6. His **(arrive)** was delayed. → **arrival**
7. The book is very **(use)**. → **useful**
8. He gave a **(describe)** of the accident. → **description**
9. She has the **(able)** to solve it. → **ability**
10. I **(real)** my mistake at once. → **realised**
11. Please **(simple)** the explanation. → **simplify**
12. He spoke **(angry)**. → **angrily**
13. Dhaka is a **(crowd)** city. → **crowded**
14. The film was **(interest)**. → **interesting**
15. We must show **(respect)** to our elders. → **respect**

16. He is **(respect)** to his teachers. → **respectful**
17. He comes from a **(respect)** family. → **respectable**
18. They went to their **(respect)** homes. → **respective**
19. Smoking is **(injury)** to health. → **injurious**
20. Her **(proud)** was hurt. → **pride**
21. The **(long)** of the river is 200 km. → **length**
22. The road was **(wide)** last year. → **widened**
23. He acted **(wise)**. → **wisely**
24. The **(child)** of Nazrul was full of hardship. → **childhood**
25. Bangladesh became **(depend)** in 1971. → **independent**

41.5 Change of Parts of Speech in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **Word-form errors (SAT/GMAT):** ✘ *The company's economic plan saved money.* — if the meaning is "thrifty", ✔ *economical*. ✘ *Her ability of solving* → ✔ *ability* ***to solve***. ✘ *The research showed a significant improve* → ✔ *improvement.*
- **Noun vs verb concision (GMAT):** GMAT favours **verbs** over long noun phrases: ✘ *made an improvement in* → ✔ *improved*; ✘ *the reduction of* → ✔ *reducing* (when parallel with verbs).
- **GRE vocabulary families:** learning a word with its family multiplies your vocabulary: *obdurate / obduracy, laconic / laconically, ephemeral / ephemerality, pragmatic / pragmatism, enervate / enervation, venerate / veneration / venerable, mitigate / mitigation / unmitigated*.

CHAPTER 42

Same Word Used as Different Parts of Speech

Part A · Grammar

42.1 One Form, Many Functions

English allows a single word to work as **different parts of speech without any change in form** — a process called **conversion** or **functional shift**. *Water* is a noun (*a glass of water*), a verb (*water the plants*) and an adjective (*a water tank*). The part of speech is decided by the **function in the sentence** (Chapter 01).

This chapter gives a large reference list of such words with model sentences. Exams ask: "*Use the word X as a noun and as a verb*" or "*Identify the part of speech of the underlined word.*"

> **Identification reminders:** after *a/an/the/my* → noun; after *to* or a modal, or carrying tense → verb; before a noun or after *be/seem* → adjective; modifying a verb/adjective → adverb; followed by a noun/pronoun object showing relation → preposition; joining clauses → conjunction.

42.2 Words Used as Noun and Verb

Word	As a noun	As a verb
answer	*Your **answer** is correct.*	*Please **answer** the question.*
attack	*The **attack** was sudden.*	*They **attacked** the camp.*
book	*I bought a **book**.*	***Book** two seats for me.*
call	*I got a **call** from him.*	***Call** the doctor.*
change	*We need a **change**.*	*Times **change**.*
cook	*She is a good **cook**.*	*She **cooks** well.*
cost	*The **cost** is high.*	*It **costs** 500 taka.*
crowd	*A **crowd** gathered.*	*People **crowded** the street.*
cut	*He has a **cut** on his finger.*	*He **cut** the cake.*
dance	*She performed a **dance**.*	*They **dance** well.*
dream	*I had a strange **dream**.*	*I **dream** of a better world.*
drink	*Have a cold **drink**.*	*Don't **drink** dirty water.*
end	*This is the **end**.*	*The war **ended** in 1971.*
experience	*He has long **experience**.*	*We **experienced** a storm.*
eye	*She has blue **eyes**.*	*He **eyed** me suspiciously.*
face	*Her **face** is round.*	*We must **face** the problem.*
fish	*We ate **fish**.*	*They **fish** in the river.*
floor	*The **floor** is wet.*	*The news **floored** him.* (= shocked)
hand	*Raise your **hand**.*	***Hand** me the book.*
head	*My **head** aches.*	*She **heads** the department.*
help	*Thanks for your **help**.*	*Please **help** me.*
hope	*There is no **hope**.*	*I **hope** you'll come.*
iron	*Iron is a metal. / Use the **iron**.*	***Iron** your shirt.*
love	*Her **love** is pure.*	*Mothers **love** their children.*
man	*He is a brave **man**.*	***Man** the boats.* (= put people on)
name	*What is your **name**?*	*They **named** the child Rahim.*
object	*What is that **object**?*	*I **object** to this.*
paint	*The **paint** is wet.*	***Paint** the door.*
plan	*We have a **plan**.*	*We **plan** to go.*
play	*We saw a **play**.*	*Children **play** in the park.*
present	*I gave him a **present**.*	*He **presented** a report.*
promise	*Keep your **promise**.*	*I **promise** to help.*
rain	*The **rain** stopped.*	*It **rained** all day.*
record	*He broke the **record**.*	***Record** the lecture.*
report	*Read the **report**.*	***Report** the matter to the police.*
rest	*Take some **rest**.*	*Let him **rest**.*
ring	*She wears a gold **ring**.*	***Ring** the bell.*
run	*He went for a **run**.*	*He **runs** fast.*
smile	*She has a sweet **smile**.*	*She **smiled** at me.*
step	*Take one **step** forward.*	*Don't **step** on the grass.*
stone	*He threw a **stone**.*	*They **stoned** the thief.*
table	*Sit at the **table**.*	*The bill was **tabled** in Parliament.*
taste	*It has a sweet **taste**.*	*Taste the soup.*
time	*Time is money.*	*He **timed** the race.*
visit	*Thanks for your **visit**.*	*Please **visit** us.*
walk	*Let's go for a **walk**.*	*We **walk** every morning.*
water	*Drink pure **water**.*	***Water** the plants.*
work	*I have a lot of **work**.*	*He **works** in a bank.*

42.3 Words Used as Noun, Verb and Adjective

Word	Noun	Verb	Adjective
back	*My **back** aches.*	*They **backed** the plan.*	*the **back** door*
clean	—	***Clean** the room.*	*a **clean** room*
cold	*I have a **cold**.*	—	*a **cold** day*
dry	—	***Dry** your hair.*	*a **dry** season*
empty	*Return the **empties**.*	***Empty** the bucket.*	*an **empty** box*
equal	*He has no **equal**.*	*Two and two **equals** four.*	*an **equal** share*
express	*the Subarna **Express***	***Express** your feelings.*	*an **express** train*
free	—	***Free** the prisoners.*	*a **free** country*
gold	***Gold** is costly.*	—	*a **gold** ring*
light	*Turn on the **light**.*	***Light** the lamp.*	*a **light** bag*
open	*in the **open***	***Open** the door.*	*an **open** door*
paper	*a sheet of **paper***	*They **papered** the walls.*	*a **paper** boat*

Word	Noun	Verb	Adjective
round	*the first **round***	*The ship **rounded** the cape.*	*a **round** table*
silver	***Silver** is a metal.*	*Age **silvered** his hair.*	*a **silver** plate*
slow	—	***Slow** down.*	*a **slow** train*
sound	*a loud **sound***	*It **sounds** good.*	*a **sound** sleep* (= deep)
still	*the **still** of the night*	*He **stilled** the crowd.*	*The water is **still**.*
total	*The **total** is 100.*	*The costs **totalled** 500 taka.*	*a **total** failure*
warm	—	***Warm** the milk.*	*a **warm** welcome*
wrong	*Know right from **wrong**.*	*You have **wronged** him.*	*a **wrong** answer*

42.4 Words Used as Adjective and Adverb

Word	Adjective	Adverb
daily	*a **daily** newspaper*	*It is published **daily**.*
early	*an **early** riser*	*He gets up **early**.*
enough	***enough** money*	*old **enough***
far	*a **far** country*	*He went **far**.*
fast	*a **fast** horse*	*He runs **fast**.*
hard	*a **hard** task*	*He works **hard**.*
high	*a **high** wall*	*The kite flew **high**.*
late	*a **late** train*	*He came **late**.*
little	*a **little** girl / **little** water*	*He is **little** known.*
long	*a **long** road*	*I can't stay **long**.*
low	*a **low** wall*	*He bowed **low**.*
much	***much** time*	*He is **much** better.*
near	*a **near** relative*	*Come **near**.*
only	*an **only** child*	*I **only** wanted to help.*
pretty	*a **pretty** girl*	*It's **pretty** good.*
right	*the **right** answer*	*Turn **right**.*
straight	*a **straight** line*	*Go **straight** ahead.*
well	*I am **well** now.*	*He sings **well**.*
wide	*a **wide** road*	*Open your mouth **wide**.*

42.5 Words Used as Preposition, Adverb and Conjunction (and More)

Word	Preposition	Adverb	Conjunction	Other
after	*after lunch*	*soon after*	*after he left*	adj: *in after years*
before	*before noon*	*I have seen him before.*	*before it rains*	—
since	*since Monday*	*I haven't seen him since.*	*since you are tired*	—
till / until	*till evening*	—	*till he comes*	—
but	*all but one*	*He is but a child.*	*poor but honest*	noun: *no ifs or buts*
for	*for you*	—	*He was glad, for he had passed.*	—
as	*He worked as a clerk.*	*as tall as*	*as it was late*	rel. pronoun: *such as are honest*
like	*He runs like a deer.*	—	(informal) *like I said*	verb: *I like it*; noun: *his likes and dislikes*; adj: *of like mind*
above	*above the clouds*	*the sky above*	—	adj: *the above statement*
down	*down the hill*	*Sit down.*	—	adj: *the down train*; verb: *down tools*; noun: *ups and downs*
up	*up the stairs*	*Stand up.*	—	adj: *the up train*; noun: *ups and downs*
off	*off the road*	*Turn it off.*	—	adj: *an off day*
near	*near the school*	*Come near.*	—	adj: *a near relation*; verb: *The ship neared the port.*
round	*round the sun*	*turn round*	—	noun, verb, adj (42.3)
past	*past the gate*	*He walked past.*	—	noun: *forget the past*; adj: *past events*
opposite	*opposite the bank*	*He lives opposite.*	—	noun: *the opposite of good*; adj: *the opposite side*
inside / outside	*inside the room*	*Come inside.*	—	noun: *the inside of the box*; adj: *the outside wall*
that	—	*not that bad*	*I know that he is ill.*	pronoun: *That is mine*; determiner: *that book*; relative: *the book that I read*
what	—	*What with illness …*	—	pronoun: *What is it?*; determiner: *What book?*; interjection: *What!*
either	—	*I don't like it either.*	*either … or*	pronoun / determiner
yet	—	*not yet*	*poor, yet honest*	—
still	—	*He is still here.*	(= nevertheless)	noun, verb, adj (42.3)
so	—	*so beautiful*	*It rained, so we stayed.*	pronoun: *I think so.*
only	—	*only once*	*I'd come, only I'm busy.*	adj: *an only child*

42.6 Words Used as Many Parts of Speech: Detailed Examples

42.6.1 *Fast*

- He is a **fast** runner. (adjective)
- He runs **fast**. (adverb)
- Muslims **fast** during Ramadan. (verb)

- He broke his **fast** at sunset. (noun)
- The boat is held **fast** by the rope. (adverb = firmly)

42.6.2 *Light*

- The **light** is too bright. (noun)
- Please **light** the candle. (verb)
- This box is **light**. (adjective = not heavy) / a **light** blue shirt (adjective = pale)
- He travels **light**. (adverb)

42.6.3 *Last*

- This is the **last** chance. (adjective)
- He came **last**. (adverb)
- He was the **last** to leave. (noun/pronoun)
- The rain will not **last** long. (verb)
- The shoemaker put the shoe on the **last**. (noun = a foot-shaped block)

42.6.4 *Right*

- Education is a basic **right**. (noun)
- He gave the **right** answer. (adjective)
- Turn **right**. (adverb)
- The government should **right** this wrong. (verb)

42.6.5 *Even*

- Two is an **even** number. (adjective)
- **Even** a child can do it. (adverb)
- They **evened** the score. (verb)
- the **even** (noun, poetic = evening)

42.6.6 *Better*

- This book is **better**. (adjective)
- She sings **better** than her sister. (adverb)
- He **bettered** the world record. (verb)
- Respect your **betters**. (noun = superiors)
- He got the **better** of his rival. (noun = advantage)

42.6.7 *Round*

- The earth is **round**. (adjective)
- He won the first **round**. (noun)
- The car **rounded** the corner. (verb)
- The earth moves **round** the sun. (preposition)
- Turn **round**. (adverb)

42.6.8 *Since*

- I have been here **since** morning. (preposition)
- **Since** he is ill, he cannot come. (conjunction — reason)
- It is ten years **since** he died. (conjunction — time)
- I have not seen him **since**. (adverb)

42.6.9 *Over*

- The bird flew **over** the house. (preposition)
- The game is **over**. (adverb/adjective)
- He bowled six **overs**. (noun — cricket)
- The children are **over**-excited. (prefix)

42.6.10 *Present*

- He gave me a **present**. (noun = gift)
- Live in the **present**. (noun = now)
- All the students were **present**. (adjective)
- The **present** government (adjective = current)
- The Principal will **present** the prizes. (verb)

42.7 Common Errors from Functional Confusion

1. ✘ He runs very fastly. ✔ He runs very **fast**. (*fast* is already an adverb)
2. ✘ He works hardly. (= with effort) ✔ He works **hard**.
3. ✘ She sings very good. ✔ She sings very **well**.
4. ✘ He came lately. (= not on time) ✔ He came **late**.
5. ✘ This is a friendly behaviour of him. ✔ This is **friendly** behaviour on his part. (*friendly* is an adjective; use *in a friendly way* as adverb)
6. ✘ The water of the lake is very stilly. ✔ The water of the lake is very **still**.
7. ✘ He did nothing like I told him. ✔ He did nothing **as** I told him. (formal: *like* is a preposition)
8. ✘ Please light on the lamp. ✔ Please **light** the lamp. / Please **switch on** the light.

42.8 Functional Shift in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **GRE vocabulary:** many words have a **less common secondary meaning** as a different part of speech, and the GRE loves them: *temper* (v. moderate), *qualify* (v. limit a statement), *champion* (v. support), *table* (v. postpone in AmE / present in BrE), *check* (v. restrain), *flag* (v. weaken), *wanting* (adj. lacking), *wax* (v. grow), *wane* (v. decline), *bent* (n. inclination), *list* (v. lean to one side), *ferret* (v. search out), *badger* (v. pester), *dog* (v. follow persistently), *hound* (v. harass), *parrot* (v. repeat mechanically), *steep* (v. soak; *steeped in tradition*).
- **SAT Words in Context** often tests exactly this: "*the senator's* ***proposal*** *was* ***tabled***" — here *tabled* means postponed (AmE).
- **GMAT:** ✘ *like* as a conjunction before a clause; ✔ *as*.

CHAPTER 43

Correction

Part A · Grammar

43.1 About “Correction” Questions

“**Correct the following sentences**” is one of the oldest and most common questions in Bangladeshi examinations — SSC, HSC, university admission tests, BCS Written and Preliminary, Bank written tests and other job tests. Unlike *Pin Point Error* (Chapter 35), where you only **identify** the faulty part, here you must **rewrite** the sentence correctly.

How to answer a correction question

1. **Read the whole sentence** and find the intended **meaning**.
2. **Locate the error(s)** using the ten-point checklist (Chapter 35.2): agreement, tense, pronoun, verb form, preposition, article, adjective/adverb, noun number, conjunction/order, redundancy/modifier.
3. **Change only what is wrong.** Do not rewrite the whole sentence or change its meaning.
4. **Write the full corrected sentence** neatly; in written exams, **underline** the corrected part.
5. A sentence may contain **more than one error** — check it again after correcting.

The rest of this chapter presents **typical exam sentences**, grouped by error type, with the correction and the reason. Many are taken from patterns that appear repeatedly in BCS, Bank and admission papers.

43.2 Nouns and Number

1. ✘ The sceneries of Cox’s Bazar are very charming. ✔ The **scenery** of Cox’s Bazar **is** very charming. — *scenery* is uncountable.
2. ✘ He gave me many good advices. ✔ He gave me **a lot of good advice**. — *advice* is uncountable.
3. ✘ I have bought three dozens pencils. ✔ I have bought three **dozen** pencils. — no *-s* after a number.
4. ✘ The informations he gave were false. ✔ The **information** he gave **was** false.
5. ✘ He has two sister-in-laws. ✔ He has two **sisters-in-law**.
6. ✘ There are many furnitures in the room. ✔ There **is a lot of furniture** in the room.
7. ✘ The cattles are grazing in the field. ✔ The **cattle** are grazing in the field.
8. ✘ All his family members came. ✔ **All the members of his family** came.
9. ✘ She has long black hairs. ✔ She has long black **hair**.
10. ✘ My luggages have been stolen. ✔ My **luggage has** been stolen.
11. ✘ He is one of the greatest poet of Bangladesh. ✔ … one of the greatest **poets** …
12. ✘ He drew a ten-miles line. ✔ He drew a **ten-mile** line.
13. ✘ These datas are not reliable. ✔ These **data** are not reliable.
14. ✘ The police has caught the thieves. ✔ The police **have** caught the thieves.
15. ✘ He has many machineries. ✔ He has **a lot of machinery / many machines**.
16. ✘ The poors are honest. ✔ **The poor** are honest.
17. ✘ I have no more works to do. ✔ I have no more **work** to do.
18. ✘ Her jewelleries are costly. ✔ Her **jewellery is** costly.

43.3 Pronouns

1. ✘ It is me who am to blame. ✔ It is **I** who am to blame.
2. ✘ He and myself are friends. ✔ He and **I** are friends.
3. ✘ Every student must bring their own book. ✔ Every student must bring **his / his or her** own book.
4. ✘ One should do his duty. ✔ One should do **one’s** duty.
5. ✘ Between you and I, he is not honest. ✔ Between you and **me**, …
6. ✘ Whom do you think is the best player? ✔ **Who** do you think is the best player?
7. ✘ This is the boy whom I think stole the pen. ✔ This is the boy **who** I think stole the pen.
8. ✘ He enjoyed during the holiday. ✔ He **enjoyed himself** during the holiday.
9. ✘ He availed of the opportunity. ✔ He **availed himself of** the opportunity.
10. ✘ I and Rahim went to the cinema. ✔ **Rahim and I** went to the cinema.
11. ✘ He, you and I are to blame. ✔ **I, you and he** are to blame.
12. ✘ All what you said is false. ✔ **All that** you said is false.
13. ✘ He is the only one who can help us, isn’t it? ✔ … **isn’t he?**
14. ✘ Each of the girls have their own room. ✔ Each of the girls **has her** own room.
15. ✘ Is this pen your’s? ✔ Is this pen **yours**?
16. ✘ Who’s book is this? ✔ **Whose** book is this?
17. ✘ None of them were present. (traditional) ✔ None of them **was** present.
18. ✘ My teacher, that teaches English, is kind. ✔ My teacher, **who** teaches English, is kind.

43.4 Articles

1. ✘ He is honest man. ✔ He is **an** honest man.
2. ✘ He is a M.A. ✔ He is **an** M.A.
3. ✘ She is an university student. ✔ She is **a** university student.
4. ✘ The honesty is the best policy. ✔ **Honesty** is the best policy.
5. ✘ Moon shines at night. ✔ **The** moon shines at night.
6. ✘ Meghna is a big river. ✔ **The** Meghna is a big river.
7. ✘ He goes to the school daily. (as a student) ✔ He goes to **school** daily.
8. ✘ He plays the cricket well. ✔ He plays **cricket** well.
9. ✘ The gold is a precious metal. ✔ **Gold** is a precious metal.
10. ✘ He is best player in the team. ✔ He is **the** best player in the team.
11. ✘ I have headache. ✔ I have **a** headache.
12. ✘ What a lovely weather! ✔ **What lovely weather!**
13. ✘ He was elected the President. ✔ He was elected **President**.
14. ✘ He came by the train. ✔ He came **by train**.
15. ✘ The Mount Everest is the highest peak. ✔ **Mount** Everest is the highest peak.

43.5 Adjectives, Adverbs and Comparison

1. ✘ He is more wiser than his brother. ✔ He is **wiser** than his brother.
2. ✘ Rahim is the tallest of the two brothers. ✔ Rahim is the **taller** of the two brothers.
3. ✘ He is senior than me. ✔ He is senior **to** me.
4. ✘ She is elder than her husband. ✔ She is **older** than her husband.
5. ✘ He is better than any boy in the class. ✔ … than any **other** boy in the class.
6. ✘ The weather of Sylhet is cooler than Dhaka. ✔ … cooler than **that of** Dhaka.
7. ✘ This is the most unique book. ✔ This is a **unique** book.
8. ✘ He is very stronger than me. ✔ He is **much** stronger than I.
9. ✘ The rose smells sweetly. ✔ The rose smells **sweet**.
10. ✘ She looks beautifully. ✔ She looks **beautiful**.
11. ✘ He speaks English very good. ✔ He speaks English very **well**.
12. ✘ He is enough clever to understand. ✔ He is **clever enough** to understand.
13. ✘ I am too glad to see you. ✔ I am **very** glad to see you.
14. ✘ He reads hardly to pass. ✔ He reads **hard** to pass.
15. ✘ I am very interesting in music. ✔ I am very **interested** in music.
16. ✘ The film was very bored. ✔ The film was very **boring**.
17. ✘ He has less friends than I. ✔ He has **fewer** friends than I.
18. ✘ This is a ten years old building. ✔ This is a **ten-year-old** building.
19. ✘ He is so weak to walk. ✔ He is **too** weak to walk.
20. ✘ He always is late. ✔ He is **always** late.

> Item 8: *very much* + comparative is acceptable (*very much stronger*), but *very* + comparative alone is not. Correction questions sometimes include such "trick" sentences; check the rule before changing anything.

43.6 Verbs and Tenses

1. ✘ I am knowing him for ten years. ✔ I **have known** him for ten years.
2. ✘ He has come yesterday. ✔ He **came** yesterday.
3. ✘ I did not saw him. ✔ I did not **see** him.
4. ✘ He is ill since Monday. ✔ He **has been** ill since Monday.
5. ✘ If he will come, I will go. ✔ If he **comes**, I will go.
6. ✘ It is time we start. ✔ It is time we **started**.
7. ✘ I wish I was rich. ✔ I wish I **were** rich.
8. ✘ He said that he will come. ✔ He said that he **would** come.
9. ✘ The teacher said that the earth moved round the sun. ✔ … the earth **moves** round the sun.
10. ✘ The train left before we had reached the station. ✔ The train **had left** before we **reached** the station.
11. ✘ He has went to Dhaka. ✔ He has **gone** to Dhaka.
12. ✘ The boy has drank the milk. ✔ The boy has **drunk** the milk.
13. ✘ He hanged the picture on the wall. ✔ He **hung** the picture on the wall.
14. ✘ The prices of rice have raised. ✔ The prices of rice have **risen**.
15. ✘ He laid down on the grass. ✔ He **lay** down on the grass.
16. ✘ I look forward to see you. ✔ I look forward to **seeing** you.
17. ✘ He suggested me to go. ✔ He suggested **that I (should) go**.
18. ✘ Would you mind to open the door? ✔ Would you mind **opening** the door?
19. ✘ He made me to work hard. ✔ He made me **work** hard.
20. ✘ You had better to consult a doctor. ✔ You had better **consult** a doctor.
21. ✘ Let him to go. ✔ Let him **go**.
22. ✘ He is used to get up early. ✔ He is used to **getting** up early.
23. ✘ Walk fast lest you will miss the bus. ✔ Walk fast lest you **should miss** the bus.
24. ✘ I have seen the film last week. ✔ I **saw** the film last week.
25. ✘ He was born at 2000. ✔ He was born **in** 2000.
26. ✘ We are going to market every day. ✔ We **go** to market every day.
27. ✘ It is long since I have seen you. ✔ It is long since I **saw** you.
28. ✘ The patient died before the doctor came. ✔ The patient **had died** before the doctor came.
29. ✘ He did not came to school. ✔ He did not **come** to school.
30. ✘ I am hearing a noise. ✔ I **hear** a noise.

43.7 Subject–Verb Agreement

1. ✘ Each of the boys were given a prize. ✔ Each of the boys **was** given a prize.
2. ✘ The quality of these goods are not good. ✔ The quality of these goods **is** not good.
3. ✘ Bread and butter are his favourite food. ✔ Bread and butter **is** his favourite food.
4. ✘ The news are very good. ✔ The news **is** very good.
5. ✘ Neither he nor his friends was present. ✔ Neither he nor his friends **were** present.
6. ✘ The Headmaster, with his teachers, are coming. ✔ … **is** coming.
7. ✘ Mathematics are a difficult subject. ✔ Mathematics **is** …
8. ✘ A number of boys was absent. ✔ A number of boys **were** absent.
9. ✘ The number of students are increasing. ✔ The number of students **is** increasing.
10. ✘ Ten thousand taka are a big amount. ✔ Ten thousand taka **is** a big amount.
11. ✘ Every man and every woman were present. ✔ … **was** present.
12. ✘ There is many reasons for this. ✔ There **are** many reasons for this.
13. ✘ He is one of those men who always speaks the truth. ✔ … who always **speak** the truth.
14. ✘ The jury were unanimous in its verdict. ✔ The jury **was** unanimous in its verdict.
15. ✘ Physics and chemistry is my favourite subjects. ✔ … **are** my favourite subjects.

43.8 Prepositions and Idioms

1. ✘ He is married with my cousin. ✔ He is married **to** my cousin.
2. ✘ I congratulate you for your success. ✔ I congratulate you **on** your success.
3. ✘ We discussed about the problem. ✔ We **discussed** the problem.
4. ✘ He entered into the room. ✔ He **entered** the room.
5. ✘ He resembles to his father. ✔ He **resembles** his father.
6. ✘ He died from cholera. ✔ He died **of** cholera.
7. ✘ I prefer milk than tea. ✔ I prefer milk **to** tea.
8. ✘ He is good in mathematics. ✔ He is good **at** mathematics.
9. ✘ He is angry upon me. ✔ He is angry **with** me.
10. ✘ He is fond for sweets. ✔ He is fond **of** sweets.
11. ✘ I have been waiting here since two hours. ✔ … **for** two hours.
12. ✘ Divide the mangoes between the five boys. ✔ … **among** the five boys.
13. ✘ He is independent from his father. ✔ He is independent **of** his father.

14. ✘ He insisted to go there. ✔ He insisted **on going** there.
15. ✘ He was accused for murder. ✔ He was accused **of** murder.
16. ✘ The book is divided in ten chapters. ✔ … divided **into** ten chapters.
17. ✘ He came by foot. ✔ He came **on foot**.
18. ✘ He jumped in the river (from the bank). ✔ He jumped **into** the river.
19. ✘ He was absent in the class. ✔ He was absent **from** the class.
20. ✘ She is suffering with fever. ✔ She is suffering **from** fever.
21. ✘ He comprises of good qualities. ✔ He **possesses** many good qualities.
22. ✘ I am senior to him by two years than. ✔ I am senior **to** him **by** two years.
23. ✘ Please reply my letter. ✔ Please reply **to** my letter.
24. ✘ He requested for help. ✔ He **requested** help / He made a request **for** help.
25. ✘ He reached at the station late. ✔ He **reached** the station late.

43.9 Conjunctions, Inversion and Sentence Structure

1. ✘ Though he is rich but he is unhappy. ✔ Though he is rich, he is unhappy.
2. ✘ No sooner had I reached the station when the train left. ✔ … **than** the train left.
3. ✘ Hardly had he gone than she came. ✔ … **when** she came.
4. ✘ Scarcely he had arrived when it rained. ✔ Scarcely **had he** arrived when it rained.
5. ✘ Unless you do not work hard, you will fail. ✔ Unless you work hard, you will fail.
6. ✘ Both Rina as well as Mina came. ✔ Both Rina **and** Mina came.
7. ✘ Neither Rahim or Karim came. ✔ Neither Rahim **nor** Karim came.
8. ✘ The reason of his failure is because he was lazy. ✔ The reason **for** his failure is **that** he was lazy.
9. ✘ He asked me that where I lived. ✔ He asked me **where** I lived.
10. ✘ I don't know what is his name. ✔ I don't know what **his name is**.
11. ✘ Never I have seen such a thing. ✔ Never **have I** seen such a thing.
12. ✘ Not only he is clever but also honest. ✔ He is not only clever but also honest.
13. ✘ Since he was ill, so he could not come. ✔ Since he was ill, he could not come.
14. ✘ He was so tired that he cannot walk. ✔ He was so tired that he **could not** walk.
15. ✘ He is such a weak that he cannot walk. ✔ He is **so** weak that he cannot walk.

43.10 Usage, Vocabulary and "Banglish"

These sentences reflect literal translation from Bangla or local usage.

1. ✘ He is my cousin brother. ✔ He is my **cousin**.
2. ✘ I am having a car. ✔ I **have** a car.
3. ✘ Please do the needful. ✔ Please **do what is necessary**.
4. ✘ He told me to come at evening. ✔ He told me to come **in the evening**.
5. ✘ My all friends are good. ✔ **All my** friends are good.
6. ✘ I am going to office. ✔ I am going to **the** office / **to work**.
7. ✘ She gave an exam. ✔ She **took / sat (for)** an exam. (*give an exam* = set it, as a teacher)
8. ✘ He is out of station. ✔ He is **out of town / away**.
9. ✘ He passed out from Dhaka University. ✔ He **graduated** from Dhaka University.
10. ✘ The meeting is preponed. ✔ The meeting **has been brought forward**.
11. ✘ Kindly revert back. ✔ Kindly **reply**.
12. ✘ He loves me too much. (= very much) ✔ He loves me **very much**.
13. ✘ I have done my B.A. last year. ✔ I **completed** my B.A. last year.
14. ✘ He said me a story. ✔ He **told** me a story.
15. ✘ Open the light. ✔ **Switch / Turn on** the light.
16. ✘ Close the fan. ✔ **Switch / Turn off** the fan.
17. ✘ He is a good cricketer and he plays good. ✔ … and he plays **well**.
18. ✘ What is your good name? ✔ What is your **name**? / May I know your name?
19. ✘ I shall come within Monday. ✔ I shall come **by** Monday.
20. ✘ He is staying in the hostel since 2023. ✔ He **has been staying** in the hostel since 2023.
21. ✘ I am in tension. ✔ I am **worried / tense**.
22. ✘ The light is cut off due to load shedding. ✔ **There is a power cut** due to load-shedding.
23. ✘ He is a very much honest man. ✔ He is a **very** honest man.
24. ✘ Let us discuss over the matter. ✔ Let us **discuss** the matter.
25. ✘ He returned back from London. ✔ He **returned** from London.

43.11 Frequently Repeated Exam Sentences

The following sentences (or close variants) have appeared again and again in BCS, Bank and university admission papers.

1. ✘ He has no less than fifty books. ✔ He has **no fewer than** fifty books. (*fewer* with countable nouns in formal English)
2. ✘ He is a man of less words. ✔ He is a man of **few** words. (idiom)
3. ✘ The man is too old that he cannot walk. ✔ The man is **so** old that he cannot walk.
4. ✘ Each of the students are present. ✔ Each of the students **is** present.
5. ✘ I am waiting for you since morning. ✔ I **have been waiting** for you since morning.
6. ✘ He is more cleverer than his brother. ✔ He is **cleverer** than his brother.
7. ✘ I shall be glad if you will help me. ✔ I shall be glad if you **help** me / **would** help me.
8. ✘ He is one of the best boy in the class. ✔ … best **boys** …
9. ✘ My father is a teacher of a high school. ✔ My father **teaches at** a high school / is a **high-school teacher**.
10. ✘ Give me a few milk. ✔ Give me **a little** milk.
11. ✘ He gave me a five-takas note. ✔ … a **five-taka** note.
12. ✘ Ten miles are a long distance. ✔ … **is** a long distance.
13. ✘ I have read the book which you gave me it. ✔ I have read the book which you gave me.
14. ✘ The boy is suffering from fever for a week. ✔ … **has been suffering** from fever for a week.
15. ✘ The beggar was laughed by the boys. ✔ … was laughed **at** by the boys.
16. ✘ It is I who is wrong. ✔ It is I who **am** wrong.
17. ✘ Many a students have failed. ✔ Many a **student has** failed.
18. ✘ The Prime Minister and the President is coming. ✔ … **are** coming.
19. ✘ If I were you, I will not go. ✔ If I were you, I **would** not go.
20. ✘ The Padma bridge was opened at 25 June 2022. ✔ The **Padma Bridge** was opened **on** 25 June 2022.

> Exam papers sometimes include sentences that are already correct to test your confidence. **Do not change a correct sentence**; change only what breaks a rule, and keep the original meaning.

43.12 Correction in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

- **GMAT Sentence Correction** is "correction" in multiple-choice form: one underlined portion and five versions. Use the same checklist, but remember GMAT's priorities: **(1) grammar and idiom, (2) logic and meaning, (3) concision and clarity**.
- **SAT Writing & Language** asks you to choose the best revision — very similar to correction questions, but including **punctuation**, **transitions** and **concision**.
- A common strategy for both: **identify the error first**, then eliminate every choice that keeps it; compare the remaining choices for **new errors**.

CHAPTER 44

Punctuations

Part A · Grammar

44.1 Why Punctuation Matters

Punctuation means the use of **marks** to separate sentences and their parts and to make the meaning clear. In speech we use pauses and intonation; in writing we use punctuation. Wrong punctuation can change the meaning completely:

- *Let's eat, Grandma!* (inviting Grandma to eat) vs *Let's eat Grandma!* (a horrible meaning)
- *A woman, without her man, is nothing.* vs *A woman: without her, man is nothing.*
- *The teacher said, "The student is a fool."* vs *"The teacher," said the student, "is a fool."*

"**Punctuate the following passage / sentences**" (with capital letters) is a standard question in SSC, HSC, admission tests and BCS Written. The **SAT** now tests punctuation directly in about a fifth of its Writing questions.

44.2 The Main Punctuation Marks

Mark	Name	Main use
.	Full stop (BrE) / Period (AmE)	ends a statement; abbreviations
,	Comma	short pause; separates items, clauses, phrases
;	Semicolon	joins closely related independent clauses; separates complex list items
:	Colon	introduces a list, explanation, quotation or example
?	Question mark	ends a direct question
!	Exclamation mark	ends an exclamation
'	Apostrophe	possession; contraction
" " / ' '	Quotation marks (inverted commas)	direct speech; quotations; titles
-	Hyphen	joins words (compound words)
– —	Dash (en dash / em dash)	sudden break; extra information; range
( )	Parentheses (round brackets)	extra, less important information
[ ]	Square brackets	editorial additions inside quotations
…	Ellipsis	omitted words; trailing off
/	Slash (oblique)	alternatives; fractions; dates

44.3 Capital Letters

Use a **capital letter** for:

1. The **first word of a sentence**: ***T**he sun rises.*
2. The **first word of direct speech**: *He said, "**W**here are you going?"*
3. The pronoun ***I*** and the interjection ***O***: *I know, O Lord.*
4. **Proper nouns** — names of people, places, rivers, mountains, countries, institutions, days, months, festivals, languages, nationalities, religions, holy books: *Rahim, Dhaka, the Padma, Bangladesh, Dhaka University, Friday, March, Eid, Bangla, Bangladeshi, Islam, the Quran*. (Seasons are not capitalised: *summer, winter*.)
5. **Proper adjectives**: *English literature, a Chinese dish*.
6. **Titles** before names: *President Lincoln, Doctor Rahman, Professor Ali, Uncle Karim* (but *my uncle*).
7. **Main words in titles** of books, films, newspapers: *The Old Man and the Sea, The Daily Star*.
8. **God** and pronouns referring to God (traditional): *God is merciful; trust in **H**im.*
9. **Abbreviations** of names and organisations: *UN, BBC, NGO, BCS*.
10. The first word of **each line of traditional poetry** and of a **letter's greeting and closing**: *Dear Sir, Yours faithfully*.

44.4 The Full Stop (Period)

1. At the end of an **assertive** or **imperative** sentence: *He is a doctor. Shut the door.*
2. After **indirect questions**: *He asked me where I lived.* (✘ ?)
3. In **abbreviations** (more common in AmE; BrE often omits it when the abbreviation ends with the last letter of the word): *e.g., i.e., etc., a.m., p.m., Prof., Dr / Dr. , Mr / Mr.*
4. In **decimals** and **money**: *3.14; Tk 25.50*.
5. **Only one full stop** at the end, even if the sentence ends with an abbreviation: *He came at 9 a.m.* (✘ a.m..)

44.5 The Comma

The comma is the most frequently used — and misused — mark. Learn its main uses:

1. **To separate items in a list** (three or more): *I bought rice, fish, vegetables and fruit.* (The **serial / Oxford comma** before *and* is optional in BrE, common in AmE: *rice, fish, vegetables, and fruit*.)
2. **Between coordinate adjectives**: *a long, boring speech* (but not *a big red ball* — Chapter 09.5.4).
3. **Before a coordinating conjunction joining two independent clauses**: *He is poor, but he is honest. Work hard, or you will fail.* (No comma when the clauses are very short: *He came and he went.*)
4. **After an introductory adverb clause, phrase or word**: *When the bell rang, the students left. In the morning, we went out. However, he did not come. Yes, I agree.*
5. **To set off non-defining (non-essential) clauses and phrases**: *My brother, who lives in London, is a doctor. Dhaka, the capital of Bangladesh, is crowded.* (No commas for defining clauses: *The man who came here is my uncle.*)
6. **To set off parenthetical expressions and conjunctive adverbs**: *He is, in fact, very rich. The plan, however, failed.*
7. **Before and after a nominative of address (vocative)**: *Rahim, come here. Listen, my friends, to what I say.*

8. **To introduce or close direct speech**: *He said, "I am busy." / "I am busy," he said.*
9. **In dates, addresses and numbers**: *26 March, 1971* / *March 26, 1971* (AmE); *Mirpur, Dhaka, Bangladesh*; *1,000,000*.
10. **With absolute phrases and participial phrases**: *The sun having set, we went home. Tired of waiting, he left.*
11. **Before a tag question**: *You are coming, aren't you?*
12. **To show omission of a word**: *Rahim likes tea; Karim, coffee.*
13. **After the greeting and before the closing of an informal letter**: *Dear Mother, … Your loving son,*
14. **To avoid confusion**: *Inside, the room was dark.* (without the comma: *Inside the room was dark* — momentarily confusing)

Where NOT to put a comma:

- ✘ between the **subject and its verb**: *The man who came yesterday, is my uncle.*
- ✘ between a **verb and its object**: *He said, that he was ill.* (✔ *He said that he was ill.*)
- ✘ before ***that*** introducing a noun clause: *I know, that he is honest.*
- ✘ to join two independent clauses **without a conjunction** (comma splice): *It was late, we went home.* (✔ *It was late, so we went home* / *It was late; we went home.*)
- ✘ before the first item or after the last item of a list.
- ✘ in a **defining** relative clause.

44.6 The Semicolon

1. **To join two closely related independent clauses** without a conjunction: *The sun set; the stars appeared. Some people like tea; others prefer coffee.*
2. **Before conjunctive adverbs** (*however, therefore, moreover, nevertheless, otherwise, consequently, besides, thus*) that join two clauses: *He worked hard; **however**, he failed.*
3. **To separate items in a list when the items already contain commas**: *The committee included Dr Rahman, a physician; Mr Karim, a lawyer; and Ms Rina, an engineer.*

Semicolon test: A semicolon has a **complete sentence on both sides** (except in complex lists). If either side cannot stand alone, use a comma or a colon instead. ✘ *Although he tried; he failed.* ✔ *Although he tried, he failed.*

44.7 The Colon

1. **To introduce a list** (after a complete clause): *You need three things: patience, hard work and luck.* (✘ *You need: patience …* — the part before a colon must be a complete sentence.)
2. **To introduce an explanation, example or result**: *He had one ambition: to become a doctor. The reason was clear: he had not studied.*
3. **To introduce a long or formal quotation**: *The Prime Minister said: "…"*
4. **In time, ratios, titles and references**: *10:30 a.m.; 3:1; Grammar: A Guide; Surah 2:255.*
5. **After the salutation in formal letters (AmE)**: *Dear Sir:* (BrE uses a comma).

44.8 Question Mark and Exclamation Mark

Question mark (?):

- After a **direct question**: *Where do you live?*
- After a **tag question**: *It's hot, isn't it?*
- **Not** after an **indirect question**: *He asked where I lived.* (✘ ?)
- After a statement used as a question in speech: *You're leaving?*

Exclamation mark (!):

- After **interjections** and **exclamatory sentences**: *Alas! What a pity! How beautiful the sky is!*
- After **strong commands** and **wishes**: *Get out! May you live long!*
- Do not overuse it, and use only one in formal writing (✘ !!!).

44.9 The Apostrophe

1. **Possession** (Chapter 02.6): *Rahim's book; the boys' hostel; the children's park; James's car / James' car; my sister-in-law's house; Rahim and Karim's shop (joint).*
2. **Contraction** (omitted letters): *don't (do not), can't (cannot), won't (will not), it's (it is / it has), I'm, they're, who's, o'clock (of the clock), '71 (1971).*
3. **Plurals of small letters and some symbols** for clarity: *Mind your p's and q's. Dot the i's.*

Never use an apostrophe:

- in **possessive pronouns**: *its, yours, hers, ours, theirs, whose* (✘ it's, your's, her's, their's, who's as possessive);
- to make an **ordinary plural**: ✘ *mango's for sale*, ✘ *the 1990's* (preferred: *the 1990s*), ✘ *two MP's* (preferred: *two MPs*).

Confused pair	Meaning
its / it's	possessive / *it is, it has*
your / you're	possessive / *you are*
their / they're / there	possessive / *they are* / place
whose / who's	possessive / *who is, who has*

44.10 Quotation Marks (Inverted Commas)

1. **Direct speech**: *He said, "I am hungry."*
2. **Quoted words** from a writer: *Nazrul wrote, "I am the rebel …"*
3. **Titles of short works** (poems, articles, chapters, songs, short stories): *"The Rebel"*, *"Amar Sonar Bangla"* — titles of books, newspapers and films are written in *italics* (or underlined in handwriting).
4. **Words used in a special sense or ironically**: *His "help" made things worse.*
5. **Quotation within a quotation**: British style uses single marks outside, double inside (*'He said, "Wait."'*); American style uses double outside, single inside (*"He said, 'Wait.'"*). Be consistent.

44.10.1 Punctuating Direct Speech

- He said, "I am busy." (comma before the quotation; full stop inside)
- "I am busy," he said. (comma inside before the closing mark)
- "I am busy," he said, "but I will help you." (the sentence continues — small letter for *but*)
- "I am busy," he said. "Come tomorrow." (a new sentence — capital *C*)
- She asked, "Where are you going?" (question mark inside)
- Did he say, "I am busy"? (the whole sentence is a question — mark outside)
- "Hurrah!" shouted the boys. "We have won!"

44.11 Hyphen and Dash

Hyphen (-) — joins words or parts of words (no spaces):

- **Compound adjectives before a noun**: *a well-known writer, a ten-year-old boy, a five-year plan, up-to-date information* (but *The writer is well known*).
- **Compound nouns**: *mother-in-law, passer-by, editor-in-chief.*
- **Numbers and fractions**: *twenty-one, ninety-nine, two-thirds*.
- **Some prefixes**: *ex-president, self-respect, all-round, anti-American, re-enter, co-operate* (also *cooperate*).
- **Word division** at the end of a line (between syllables).

Dash (– or —) — longer than a hyphen:

- **En dash (–)** for **ranges**: *pages 10–20; 1971–1975; the Dhaka–Chattogram highway*.
- **Em dash (—)** for a **sudden break** or **emphasis**, or to set off **extra information** more strongly than commas: *He was — I am sure of it — a liar. Three things matter — honesty, courage and kindness.*

44.12 Brackets, Ellipsis and Slash

- **Parentheses ( )** enclose extra information that is less important: *Kazi Nazrul Islam (1899–1976) is our national poet.* A sentence must be grammatically complete without the bracketed words.
- **Square brackets [ ]** show the writer's own additions inside a quotation: *He said, "They [the students] are ready."*
- **Ellipsis (…)** shows omitted words in a quotation or an unfinished thought: *"I have a dream … that one day …"*; *Well, I thought …*
- **Slash (/)** shows alternatives, ratios or dates: *and/or; he/she; 60 km/h; 26/03/1971*.

44.13 Punctuating a Passage: Worked Examples

Example 1 (unpunctuated):

one day a fox was very hungry he went out in search of food he saw a crow sitting on a branch of a tree with a piece of meat in its beak the fox said to the crow my dear crow how sweet your voice is will you sing a song for me

Punctuated:

One day a fox was very hungry. He went out in search of food. He saw a crow sitting on a branch of a tree with a piece of meat in its beak. The fox said to the crow, "My dear crow, how sweet your voice is! Will you sing a song for me?"

Example 2 (unpunctuated):

the teacher asked the boy what is your name the boy replied my name is rahim sir where do you live asked the teacher i live at mirpur in dhaka said the boy

Punctuated:

The teacher asked the boy, "What is your name?" The boy replied, "My name is Rahim, sir." "Where do you live?" asked the teacher. "I live at Mirpur in Dhaka," said the boy.

Example 3 (unpunctuated):

alas said the old man i have lost everything my house my land and my cattle what shall i do now

Punctuated:

"Alas!" said the old man. "I have lost everything — my house, my land and my cattle. What shall I do now?"

> **Steps to punctuate a passage:** (1) Find where each **sentence** ends (subject + finite verb + complete thought) and put a full stop, question mark or exclamation mark. (2) Capitalise the **first word** of each sentence, the pronoun ***I*** and all **proper nouns**. (3) Mark **direct speech** with inverted commas and a comma/colon before it. (4) Add **commas** for lists, vocatives, introductory words and *yes/no*. (5) Add **apostrophes** for possessives and contractions.

44.14 Common Punctuation Errors

1. ✘ It was raining, we stayed at home. (comma splice) ✔ It was raining, **so** we stayed at home. / It was raining**;** we stayed at home.
2. ✘ He asked me where I lived? ✔ He asked me where I lived**.**
3. ✘ The dog wagged it's tail. ✔ The dog wagged **its** tail.
4. ✘ Mango's for sale. ✔ **Mangoes** for sale.
5. ✘ My brother who lives in Sylhet is a doctor. (if you have only one brother) ✔ My brother**,** who lives in Sylhet**,** is a doctor.
6. ✘ The man, who came here, is my uncle. (defining) ✔ The man who came here is my uncle.
7. ✘ He said that, "I am ill." ✔ He said, "I am ill." / He said that he was ill.
8. ✘ I know, that he is honest. ✔ I know that he is honest.
9. ✘ You need: a pen and a pencil. ✔ You need a pen and a pencil. / You need two things: a pen and a pencil.
10. ✘ Although he tried; he failed. ✔ Although he tried**,** he failed.
11. ✘ He is a well known writer. ✔ He is a **well-known** writer.
12. ✘ "I am tired." He said. ✔ "I am tired**,**" **h**e said.
13. ✘ i went to dhaka on friday. ✔ **I** went to **D**haka on **F**riday.
14. ✘ The childrens' park is closed. ✔ The **children's** park is closed.
15. ✘ He studied hard, however, he failed. ✔ He studied hard**;** however, he failed.
16. ✘ Rahim come here. ✔ Rahim**,** come here.
17. ✘ Its a lovely day. ✔ **It's** a lovely day.
18. ✘ The 1990's were good years. ✔ The **1990s** were good years.
19. ✘ He bought apples oranges and bananas. ✔ He bought apples**,** oranges and bananas.
20. ✘ What a beautiful scene it is. ✔ What a beautiful scene it is**!**

44.15 Punctuation in the SAT, GRE and GMAT

The SAT (Standard English Conventions) tests punctuation heavily:

- **Independent clauses:** join with **comma + FANBOYS**, a **semicolon**, a **colon** (if the second explains the first), or a **period** — never with a comma alone.
- **Non-essential elements** must be set off by a **matching pair** of commas, dashes or parentheses — don't mix a comma with a dash: ✘ *The book — which I bought yesterday, is interesting.*
- **Colons** must follow a **complete independent clause**.
- **No punctuation** between a subject and its verb, a verb and its object, or a preposition and its object.
- **Apostrophes** for singular/plural possessives (*the company's / the companies'*) and *its/it's*.

GMAT uses punctuation mainly to signal structure: a comma before *which* signals a non-essential modifier; a semicolon must join two independent clauses. **GRE** does not test punctuation, but reading sentences with dashes and colons correctly helps comprehension.

PART B

Vocabulary & Usage

Chapters 45 – 53

Synonyms and antonyms, spelling, phrasal verbs, idioms, foreign phrases, one-word substitution, analogy, confusable words and proverbs.

CHAPTER 45

Vocabulary with Synonyms & Antonyms

Part B · Vocabulary

45.1 What Are Synonyms and Antonyms?

A **synonym** is a word that has the **same or nearly the same meaning** as another word in a particular context. *Big* and *large*, *begin* and *commence*, *brave* and *courageous* are synonyms.

An **antonym** is a word that has the **opposite meaning** of another word. *Big* and *small*, *begin* and *end*, *brave* and *cowardly* are antonyms.

In the Preliminary tests of BCS, in Bank recruitment tests (Officer, Senior Officer, Cash, AD of Bangladesh Bank), in university admission tests and in the verbal sections of the SAT, GRE and GMAT, vocabulary is tested directly (*"Choose the word closest in meaning to …"* or *"The antonym of … is"*) and indirectly through sentence completion, reading comprehension, analogy and one-word substitution. A strong vocabulary therefore pays off across many sections at once.

45.1.1 Perfect Synonyms Are Rare

Very few words mean **exactly** the same thing in every context. Most synonyms differ in **degree**, **tone (connotation)**, **formality** or **usage**:

- **Degree:** *dislike → hate → abhor → loathe* (each is stronger than the last). *Happy → glad → elated → ecstatic.*
- **Connotation (positive / negative feeling):** *thrifty* (good: careful with money) vs *stingy / miserly* (bad: unwilling to spend). *Confident* (good) vs *arrogant* (bad). *Curious* (neutral/good) vs *nosy* (bad).
- **Formality:** *buy* (everyday) vs *purchase* (formal); *begin* vs *commence*; *end* vs *terminate*.
- **Usage / collocation:** We say *a large amount* but *a big mistake*; *heavy rain*, not *strong rain*; *strong tea*, not *powerful tea*.

So, in an exam, you are not looking for a "perfect" synonym — you are looking for the option that is **closest** in meaning **in that context**.

45.1.2 Kinds of Antonyms

1. **Complementary (absolute) antonyms** — one excludes the other: *alive / dead, true / false, pass / fail, present / absent.*
2. **Gradable antonyms** — two ends of a scale with middle points: *hot / cold* (warm, cool in between), *rich / poor, young / old, large / small.*
3. **Relational (converse) antonyms** — one implies the other: *buy / sell, teacher / student, give / receive, husband / wife, above / below.*
4. **Antonyms made with prefixes** — *happy / unhappy, legal / illegal, possible / impossible, regular / irregular, honest / dishonest, sense / nonsense, understand / misunderstand.*

45.2 How to Solve Synonym and Antonym Questions

45.2.1 Ten Golden Strategies

1. **Know the part of speech.** A synonym must be the same part of speech as the question word. If the word is a verb (*abate*), the answer must be a verb (*diminish*), not a noun (*diminution*).
2. **Make a sentence.** Put the word into a short sentence of your own, then replace it with each option. The one that keeps the meaning is right. *The storm **abated**.* → *The storm **subsided**.* ✔
3. **Use roots, prefixes and suffixes.** *Bene-* = good (benevolent, benefactor); *mal-* = bad (malevolent, malice); *-cide* = killing (homicide); *omni-* = all (omnipotent); *loqu/locu* = speak (loquacious, eloquent); *chron* = time (chronic, chronology). (See Chapter 40 for a full list.)
4. **Decide the "charge".** Is the word positive (+) or negative (−)? A positive word cannot have a negative synonym, and its antonym must be negative. *Laudable* (+) → synonym *praiseworthy* (+); antonym *contemptible* (−).
5. **Eliminate wrong options.** Remove options that are unrelated, that are the wrong part of speech, or that are synonyms when the question asks for antonyms (a very common trap: test-makers deliberately place a synonym among the antonym options).
6. **Watch the "related but not equal" trap.** For *frugal*, the option *poor* is related but wrong; *thrifty* is correct. For *verbose*, the option *verbal* is a look-alike trap; *wordy* is correct.
7. **Look-alike (homonym) traps.** *Eminent* (famous) vs *imminent* (about to happen); *elicit* (draw out) vs *illicit* (illegal); *complement* vs *compliment*; *venal* (corrupt) vs *venial* (forgivable). (See Chapter 52.)
8. **Multiple meanings.** *Grave* = serious (adj) or tomb (n); *Fair* = just / light-coloured / an exhibition; *Sound* = healthy / noise / a narrow sea channel. Choose the meaning that matches the options.
9. **Know common "false friends".** Some words look as if they mean one thing but mean another (see 45.2.3).
10. **Read widely and revise often.** Reading an English daily (editorials), magazines and good novels, and revising word lists in small daily doses, is the only long-term solution.

> **Exam Tip — The "opposite" options trick:** In an MCQ for antonyms, if two options are opposites of each other (e.g. *praise* and *criticise*), the answer is very often one of them. In a synonym question, if two options mean the same thing as each other, usually **neither** is the answer (because only one answer can be right).

45.2.2 Contronyms (Words That Are Their Own Opposites)

Some English words have two meanings that are opposite to each other. The GRE and SAT love them.

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Sanction	to approve / permit	a penalty / to punish
Cleave	to split apart	to stick closely to
Oversight	supervision	a mistake of not noticing
Dust	to remove dust	to sprinkle powder on
Left	departed	remaining
Fast	moving quickly	fixed firmly, not moving
Bolt	to fasten / lock	to run away suddenly
Screen	to show (a film)	to hide / shield
Weather	to wear away	to come through safely
Trim	to cut off	to add decorations

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Garnish	to decorate food	to take money (wages) by law
Fine	excellent	a penalty
Overlook	to supervise / look over	to fail to notice
Temper	to soften / moderate	to harden (steel) / anger

45.2.3 False Friends (Commonly Misunderstood Words)

Word	It does NOT mean	It actually means
Enervate	energise	weaken, drain of energy
Noisome	noisy	offensive, foul-smelling
Restive	restful	restless, impatient
Fulsome	full, plentiful	excessive and insincere (praise)
Nonplussed	calm, unbothered	puzzled, confused
Disinterested	uninterested	impartial, unbiased
Enormity	enormousness	great wickedness
Peruse	skim quickly	read carefully
Ingenuous	ingenious	innocent, frank, naive
Prodigal	prodigy	wasteful, extravagant
Sanguine	bloody	optimistic, hopeful
Inflammable	not flammable	easily set on fire
Bemused	amused	bewildered, confused
Notorious	famous (good)	famous for something bad
Presently	(always) now	soon, shortly (BrE); now (AmE)
Officious	official	too eager to give orders/advice
Pristine	old	spotless, in original condition
Plethora	small amount	excess, too much
Temerity	timidity	reckless boldness
Factious	factual	causing disagreement
Fortuitous	fortunate	happening by chance
Histrionic	historic	overly dramatic
Penury	penalty	extreme poverty
Ravenous	ravishing	extremely hungry
Tortuous	torturous	twisting, winding

45.2.4 Forming Antonyms with Prefixes and Suffixes

Prefix / Suffix	Examples
un-	able–unable, fair–unfair, kind–unkind, known–unknown
in-	active–inactive, correct–incorrect, sane–insane, visible–invisible
im- (before b, m, p)	balance–imbalance, mature–immature, polite–impolite, possible–impossible
il- (before l)	legal–illegal, legible–illegible, literate–illiterate, logical–illogical
ir- (before r)	rational–irrational, regular–irregular, relevant–irrelevant, responsible–irresponsible
dis-	agree–disagree, honest–dishonest, obey–disobey, order–disorder
mis-	fortune–misfortune, understand–misunderstand, use–misuse
non-	sense–nonsense, violent–nonviolent, existent–nonexistent
anti- / counter-	social–antisocial, clockwise–anticlockwise, act–counteract
mal-	function–malfunction, nutrition–malnutrition, treat–maltreat
-ful / -less	careful–careless, useful–useless, hopeful–hopeless, meaningful–meaningless

> **Careful:** Not every *in-* word is negative. *Inflammable* = flammable; *invaluable* = extremely valuable (✘ not "without value"); *inhabit* = live in. And *valuable / invaluable* are near-synonyms, not antonyms — the antonym of *valuable* is *worthless*.

45.3 The Master Word List

How to use this list. Each entry gives: the **word**, its **part of speech** — *(n)* noun, *(v)* verb, *(adj)* adjective, *(adv)* adverb — its **Bangla meaning**, a simple **English meaning**, **SYN** (synonyms), **ANT** (antonyms) and an **example** sentence. A star ★ marks words that appear **very frequently** in Bangladeshi competitive exams. A GRE tag marks advanced words especially common in the SAT, GRE and GMAT. Learn the example sentence along with the word: words are remembered best in context.

A

Abandon ★ *(v)* পরিত্যাগ করা — to leave completely and for ever. SYN desert, forsake, quit, relinquish, renounce. ANT keep, retain, maintain, adopt, cherish. *Ex:* The crew abandoned the sinking ship.

Abase *(v)* হেয় করা, মর্যাদা হ্রাস করা — to lower in rank or dignity. SYN degrade, humiliate, demean, belittle. ANT elevate, exalt, honour, dignify. *Ex:* He would not abase himself by begging for favours.

Abate ★ *(v)* কমা, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to become less strong or intense. SYN subside, diminish, decrease, wane, ebb, lessen. ANT increase, intensify, aggravate, augment. *Ex:* The storm abated by evening.

Abdicate *(v)* সিংহাসন বা পদ ত্যাগ করা — to give up a throne, power or responsibility. SYN renounce, resign, relinquish, abandon. ANT assume, usurp, claim, retain. *Ex:* Edward VIII abdicated the British throne in 1936.

Aberration GRE *(n)* বিচ্যুতি, স্বাভাবিকতা থেকে সরে যাওয়া — a departure from what is normal. SYN deviation, anomaly, irregularity, abnormality. ANT norm, regularity, conformity. *Ex:* His rude remark was an aberration from his usual polite behaviour.

Abeyance *(n)* স্থগিত অবস্থা — a state of temporary suspension. SYN suspension, dormancy, pause, latency. ANT operation, continuation, activity. *Ex:* The project is in abeyance until funds are found.

Abhor ★ *(v)* ঘৃণা করা — to hate very strongly. SYN detest, loathe, abominate, despise, execrate. ANT love, adore, admire, cherish. *Ex:* Every civilised person abhors cruelty.

Abject *(adj)* হীন, শোচনীয় — extremely bad, miserable or humiliating. SYN wretched, miserable, pitiful, degraded, base. ANT dignified, proud, noble, exalted. *Ex:* The refugees lived in abject poverty.

Abjure GRE *(v)* শপথপূর্বক ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up a belief or claim. SYN renounce, recant, forswear, repudiate. ANT affirm, embrace, uphold, espouse. *Ex:* He abjured his former political views.

Abolish ★ *(v)* বিলোপ করা — to end a law, system or custom officially. SYN eradicate, annul, abrogate, repeal, revoke. ANT establish, institute, create, found. *Ex:* Slavery was abolished in the British Empire in 1833.

Abominable *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য, জঘন্য — causing disgust or hatred. SYN detestable, loathsome, odious, atrocious, vile. ANT admirable, delightful, pleasant, lovable. *Ex:* The prisoners were kept in abominable conditions.

Abortive *(adj)* ব্যর্থ, নিষ্ফল — failing to produce the intended result. SYN unsuccessful, futile, fruitless, vain. ANT successful, fruitful, effective. *Ex:* They made an abortive attempt to escape.

Abound *(v)* প্রচুর পরিমাণে থাকা — to exist in large numbers. SYN teem, overflow, proliferate, swarm. ANT lack, be scarce, dwindle. *Ex:* Fish abound in the rivers of Bangladesh.

Abridge ★ *(v)* সংক্ষেপ করা — to shorten a text without losing its sense. SYN shorten, condense, abbreviate, curtail, truncate. ANT expand, lengthen, elaborate, amplify. *Ex:* This is an abridged edition of the novel.

Abrogate GRE *(v)* বাতিল করা, রদ করা — to cancel a law or agreement formally. SYN repeal, revoke, annul, nullify, rescind. ANT enact, ratify, establish, uphold. *Ex:* The new government abrogated the treaty.

Abrupt *(adj)* আকস্মিক; রূঢ় — sudden and unexpected; rude and short in manner. SYN sudden, unexpected, hasty; curt, brusque. ANT gradual, expected; polite, courteous. *Ex:* The meeting came to an abrupt end.

Absolve *(v)* দায়মুক্ত করা, ক্ষমা করা — to declare free from guilt or blame. SYN acquit, exonerate, pardon, forgive, exculpate. ANT condemn, convict, blame, accuse. *Ex:* The court absolved him of all charges.

Abstain ★ *(v)* বিরত থাকা — to keep oneself from doing something. SYN refrain, desist, forgo, avoid, eschew. ANT indulge, participate, partake. *Ex:* Muslims abstain from food and drink while fasting.

Abstruse GRE *(adj)* দুর্বোধ্য — very difficult to understand. SYN obscure, esoteric, recondite, arcane, incomprehensible. ANT clear, simple, lucid, obvious. *Ex:* The lecture on quantum theory was too abstruse for us.

Absurd *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক, হাস্যকর — completely unreasonable or silly. SYN ridiculous, preposterous, ludicrous, irrational, senseless. ANT sensible, logical, reasonable, rational. *Ex:* It is absurd to blame the weather for your laziness.

Abundant ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর — existing in large quantities. SYN plentiful, ample, copious, profuse, bountiful, plenteous. ANT scarce, scanty, meagre, sparse, deficient. *Ex:* Bangladesh has abundant water resources.

Abysmal *(adj)* অতি নিকৃষ্ট; অতল — extremely bad; immeasurably deep. SYN dreadful, appalling, awful; bottomless. ANT excellent, superb; shallow. *Ex:* The team's performance was abysmal.

Accede *(v)* সম্মত হওয়া; পদে আসীন হওয়া — to agree to a demand; to take office. SYN consent, assent, comply, acquiesce. ANT refuse, reject, deny, dissent. *Ex:* The authority acceded to the students' demands.

Acclaim *(v/n)* প্রশংসা করা; প্রশংসা — to praise publicly and enthusiastically. SYN applaud, hail, laud, commend, extol. ANT criticise, condemn, censure, denounce. *Ex:* The film was acclaimed by critics.

Accolade *(n)* সম্মাননা, প্রশংসা — an award or expression of praise. SYN honour, tribute, award, praise, distinction. ANT criticism, condemnation, censure. *Ex:* Winning the Nobel Prize is the highest accolade for a writer.

Accord *(n/v)* সম্মতি, ঐক্য; প্রদান করা — agreement; to give or grant. SYN agreement, harmony, concord, treaty; grant. ANT disagreement, discord, conflict; deny. *Ex:* The two parties signed a peace accord.

Acerbic GRE *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, কটু — sharp and bitter in speech or tone. SYN caustic, acrid, sarcastic, biting, trenchant. ANT mild, gentle, kind, sweet. *Ex:* The columnist is known for his acerbic wit.

Acme *(n)* শীর্ষবিন্দু, চূড়া — the highest point of achievement. SYN peak, pinnacle, zenith, apex, summit, culmination. ANT nadir, bottom, base, low point. *Ex:* He was at the acme of his career.

Acquiesce GRE *(v)* নীরবে মেনে নেওয়া — to accept something reluctantly without protest. SYN consent, comply, submit, accede, yield. ANT resist, protest, object, oppose. *Ex:* She acquiesced in her parents' decision.

Acquit ★ *(v)* খালাস দেওয়া — to declare someone not guilty. SYN absolve, exonerate, discharge, free, clear. ANT convict, condemn, sentence, punish. *Ex:* The jury acquitted the accused.

Acrimony *(n)* তিক্ততা — bitterness or ill feeling. SYN rancour, bitterness, animosity, hostility, resentment. ANT goodwill, harmony, friendliness, amity. *Ex:* The divorce was settled without acrimony.

Acumen *(n)* বিচক্ষণতা, তীক্ষ্ণবুদ্ধি — the ability to make good judgements quickly. SYN shrewdness, astuteness, insight, sagacity, keenness. ANT stupidity, ignorance, obtuseness. *Ex:* She has great business acumen.

Adamant ★ *(adj)* অনমনীয়, একগুঁয়ে — refusing to change one's mind. SYN unyielding, inflexible, obstinate, resolute, firm. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, pliant. *Ex:* He was adamant that he would not resign.

Adept *(adj)* দক্ষ — very skilled. SYN expert, proficient, skilful, adroit, accomplished. ANT inept, clumsy, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is adept at solving puzzles.

Adhere *(v)* লেগে থাকা, মেনে চলা — to stick to; to follow a rule or belief. SYN stick, cling; obey, follow, observe. ANT detach; disobey, violate, defy. *Ex:* All players must adhere to the rules.

Adjourn ★ *(v)* মুলতবি করা — to stop a meeting for a time. SYN postpone, suspend, defer, put off, prorogue. ANT continue, resume, convene. *Ex:* The court adjourned the hearing till Monday.

Admonish *(v)* মৃদু ভর্ৎসনা করা, সতর্ক করা — to warn or scold gently. SYN reprimand, rebuke, reprove, caution, chide. ANT praise, commend, approve, applaud. *Ex:* The teacher admonished the boy for being late.

Adroit *(adj)* চতুর, নিপুণ — clever or skilful in using hands or mind. SYN deft, dexterous, adept, skilful, nimble. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* He is an adroit negotiator.

Adulation *(n)* অতিরিক্ত প্রশংসা, তোষামোদ — excessive admiration or praise. SYN flattery, adoration, worship, fawning. ANT criticism, contempt, censure, disdain. *Ex:* The singer enjoyed the adulation of her fans.

Adversary *(n)* প্রতিপক্ষ, শত্রু — an opponent in a contest or conflict. SYN enemy, foe, opponent, rival, antagonist. ANT ally, friend, supporter, partner. *Ex:* He defeated his adversary in the election.

Adverse ★ *(adj)* প্রতিকূল — harmful or unfavourable. SYN unfavourable, hostile, detrimental, harmful, contrary. ANT favourable, beneficial, advantageous, propitious. *Ex:* The drug has no adverse effects.

Advocate *(v/n)* সমর্থন করা; উকিল — to support publicly; a supporter or lawyer. SYN support, champion, endorse, recommend; proponent. ANT oppose, discourage, criticise; opponent. *Ex:* She advocates free education for girls.

Affable *(adj)* অমায়িক, সদালাপী — friendly and easy to talk to. SYN amiable, genial, cordial, sociable, courteous. ANT unfriendly, surly, aloof, hostile. *Ex:* Our new manager is an affable man.

Affluent ★ *(adj)* ধনী, সচ্ছল — wealthy. SYN rich, prosperous, wealthy, well-off, opulent. ANT poor, needy, impoverished, indigent, destitute. *Ex:* Gulshan is an affluent area of Dhaka.

Aggravate ★ *(v)* আরও খারাপ করা — to make a problem worse; (informal) to annoy. SYN worsen, intensify, exacerbate, compound; irritate. ANT alleviate, ease, mitigate, improve; soothe. *Ex:* Smoking aggravated his illness.

Agile *(adj)* চটপটে — able to move quickly and easily. SYN nimble, quick, sprightly, lithe, spry. ANT clumsy, sluggish, stiff, awkward. *Ex:* The goalkeeper was remarkably agile.

Alacrity GRE *(n)* তৎপরতা, উৎসাহপূর্ণ দ্রুততা — eager and cheerful readiness. SYN eagerness, readiness, promptness, enthusiasm, zeal. ANT reluctance, apathy, slowness, sluggishness. *Ex:* She accepted the invitation with alacrity.

Alleviate ★ *(v)* লাঘব করা, উপশম করা — to make pain or a problem less severe. SYN relieve, ease, mitigate, allay, assuage, lessen. ANT aggravate, worsen, intensify, exacerbate. *Ex:* The government took steps to alleviate poverty.

Allure *(n/v)* আকর্ষণ; প্রলুব্ধ করা — attractiveness; to attract or tempt. SYN charm, attraction, appeal; entice, tempt, lure. ANT repulsion; repel, deter, disgust. *Ex:* The allure of city life draws many villagers to Dhaka.

Aloof *(adj)* নির্লিপ্ত, দূরত্ব বজায় রাখা — not friendly; keeping at a distance. SYN distant, detached, reserved, unsociable, remote. ANT friendly, sociable, warm, approachable. *Ex:* He remained aloof from party politics.

Altruistic *(adj)* পরার্থপর, পরহিতৈষী — caring unselfishly for others. SYN selfless, unselfish, philanthropic, benevolent, humane. ANT selfish, egoistic, self-centred, mean. *Ex:* Her altruistic work in the slums is admired.

Amalgamate *(v)* একত্রিত করা, মিশ্রিত করা — to combine into one. SYN merge, unite, combine, integrate, fuse. ANT separate, divide, split, disunite. *Ex:* The two banks amalgamated last year.

Ambiguous ★ *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থক, অস্পষ্ট — having more than one possible meaning. SYN equivocal, vague, unclear, obscure, cryptic. ANT clear, explicit, definite, unequivocal, lucid. *Ex:* His answer was deliberately ambiguous.

Ameliorate ★ GRE *(v)* উন্নত করা — to make something bad better. SYN improve, better, enhance, amend, reform. ANT worsen, deteriorate, aggravate, impair. *Ex:* Steps were taken to ameliorate the condition of the workers.

Amenable *(adj)* বাধ্য, সহজে রাজি — willing to accept or be influenced. SYN agreeable, compliant, cooperative, tractable, docile. ANT stubborn, obstinate, intractable, resistant. *Ex:* He is amenable to reason.

Amiable *(adj)* বন্ধুভাবাপন্ন, অমায়িক — friendly and pleasant (of a person). SYN affable, genial, friendly, good-natured, likeable. ANT unfriendly, hostile, disagreeable, surly. *Ex:* She is an amiable girl liked by all.

Amicable *(adj)* সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — friendly and without disagreement (of relations or agreements). SYN friendly, cordial, harmonious, peaceable. ANT hostile, antagonistic, unfriendly, acrimonious. *Ex:* The dispute was settled amicably.

Ample *(adj)* পর্যাপ্ত — more than enough. SYN plentiful, abundant, sufficient, copious, generous. ANT insufficient, scanty, meagre, inadequate. *Ex:* There is ample time to finish the work.

Anarchy *(n)* নৈরাজ্য — total lack of government or order. SYN lawlessness, chaos, disorder, turmoil, mayhem. ANT order, law, government, discipline. *Ex:* The country fell into anarchy after the coup.

Animosity *(n)* শত্রুতা, বিদ্বেষ — strong hostility. SYN enmity, hostility, hatred, antagonism, rancour. ANT friendship, goodwill, amity, sympathy. *Ex:* There is no personal animosity between the two leaders.

Annihilate *(v)* ধ্বংস করা, নিশ্চিহ্ন করা — to destroy completely. SYN destroy, obliterate, exterminate, eradicate, wipe out. ANT create, build, preserve, protect. *Ex:* The enemy forces were annihilated.

Anomaly GRE *(n)* অসংগতি, ব্যতিক্রম — something unusual or not expected. SYN irregularity, aberration, deviation, oddity, exception. ANT norm, rule, regularity, standard. *Ex:* The auditor found several anomalies in the accounts.

Antipathy *(n)* বিতৃষ্ণা, বিরাগ — a strong feeling of dislike. SYN aversion, hostility, dislike, repugnance, animosity. ANT sympathy, affection, liking, fondness. *Ex:* He has an antipathy to modern art.

Antiquated *(adj)* সেকেলে — old-fashioned or outdated. SYN obsolete, outdated, archaic, outmoded, old-fashioned. ANT modern, new, up-to-date, contemporary. *Ex:* The office still uses antiquated machines.

Apathy ★ *(n)* উদাসীনতা — lack of interest or concern. SYN indifference, unconcern, passivity, lethargy, listlessness. ANT interest, enthusiasm, concern, zeal, passion. *Ex:* Voter apathy led to a low turnout.

Appease *(v)* শান্ত করা, তুষ্ট করা — to calm someone by giving what they want. SYN pacify, placate, mollify, conciliate, soothe. ANT provoke, enrage, incite, antagonise. *Ex:* The ruler tried to appease the angry mob.

Apprehensive *(adj)* শঙ্কিত — anxious that something bad may happen. SYN anxious, worried, uneasy, fearful, nervous. ANT confident, calm, assured, carefree. *Ex:* She was apprehensive about the interview.

Arbitrary ★ *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছাচারী, খেয়ালখুশিমতো — based on personal whim, not reason or rule. SYN random, capricious, whimsical, despotic, unreasoned. ANT rational, reasoned, logical, systematic, lawful. *Ex:* The arbitrary arrest of journalists was condemned.

Arduous ★ *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, দুরূহ — requiring great effort. SYN laborious, strenuous, difficult, onerous, gruelling. ANT easy, effortless, simple, facile. *Ex:* Climbing Everest is an arduous task.

Arrogant ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — having an exaggerated sense of one's importance. SYN haughty, proud, conceited, overbearing, insolent. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* His arrogant behaviour annoyed everyone.

Articulate *(adj/v)* স্পষ্টভাষী; স্পষ্ট করে বলা — able to express ideas clearly; to express clearly. SYN eloquent, fluent, lucid; express, voice. ANT inarticulate, tongue-tied, incoherent. *Ex:* She is an articulate speaker.

Ascend *(v)* আরোহণ করা — to go up. SYN climb, rise, mount, soar, scale. ANT descend, fall, drop, sink. *Ex:* The plane ascended into the clouds.

Ascetic *(adj/n)* তপস্বী, সংযমী — practising severe self-discipline and avoiding pleasure. SYN austere, abstinent, self-denying; hermit, monk. ANT self-indulgent, hedonistic, sensual; hedonist. *Ex:* The monk led an ascetic life.

Assiduous GRE *(adj)* অধ্যবসায়ী, পরিশ্রমী — showing great care and persistence. SYN diligent, industrious, sedulous, painstaking, persevering. ANT lazy, negligent, careless, indolent. *Ex:* Assiduous study helped him top the exam.

Astute *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — clever at understanding situations and people. SYN shrewd, sharp, perceptive, sagacious, canny. ANT stupid, naive, foolish, obtuse. *Ex:* He is an astute politician.

Atrocious *(adj)* নৃশংস, জঘন্য — extremely cruel or very bad. SYN brutal, barbaric, heinous, monstrous, abominable. ANT kind, humane, admirable, pleasant. *Ex:* The army committed atrocious crimes in 1971.

Audacious *(adj)* দুঃসাহসী — very bold; willing to take risks (sometimes rudely bold). SYN daring, bold, fearless, intrepid; impudent. ANT timid, cautious, cowardly, meek. *Ex:* It was an audacious plan to cross the ocean on a raft.

Augment ★ *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা — to make larger or greater. SYN increase, enlarge, expand, boost, amplify, supplement. ANT decrease, reduce, diminish, curtail. *Ex:* He took a part-time job to augment his income.

Auspicious ★ *(adj)* শুভ, মাঙ্গলিক — showing signs of future success. SYN favourable, promising, propitious, fortunate, lucky. ANT inauspicious, ominous, unfavourable, sinister. *Ex:* Pahela Baishakh is an auspicious day for Bengalis.

Austere *(adj)* কঠোর, আড়ম্বরহীন — severe; simple and without comfort. SYN strict, stern, harsh; plain, spartan, frugal. ANT lenient, mild; luxurious, ornate, lavish. *Ex:* He lived an austere life in a small room.

Authentic *(adj)* প্রামাণিক, খাঁটি — genuine; real. SYN genuine, real, bona fide, true, reliable. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, bogus. *Ex:* This is an authentic painting by Zainul Abedin.

Avarice ★ *(n)* লোভ, অর্থলিপ্সা — extreme greed for wealth. SYN greed, cupidity, covetousness, rapacity, acquisitiveness. ANT generosity, liberality, charity, munificence. *Ex:* Avarice is the root of many evils.

Averse *(adj)* বিরূপ, অনিচ্ছুক — strongly disliking or opposed (to). SYN opposed, reluctant, unwilling, hostile, loath. ANT eager, keen, willing, inclined. *Ex:* He is not averse to hard work.

Avid *(adj)* আগ্রহী, উৎসুক — very enthusiastic. SYN keen, eager, ardent, passionate, zealous. ANT indifferent, apathetic, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* She is an avid reader of detective novels.

B

Baffle *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা, হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse completely. SYN puzzle, perplex, bewilder, confound, mystify. ANT clarify, enlighten, explain, elucidate. *Ex:* The magician's trick baffled the audience.

Banal GRE *(adj)* গতানুগতিক, মামুলি — so ordinary as to be boring. SYN trite, commonplace, hackneyed, clichéd, platitudinous, insipid. ANT original, novel, fresh, innovative, striking. *Ex:* The speech was full of banal remarks.

Baneful *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, অনিষ্টকর — harmful or destructive. SYN harmful, pernicious, deleterious, injurious, noxious. ANT beneficial, wholesome, salutary, harmless. *Ex:* Drugs have a baneful effect on the youth.

Barbarous *(adj)* বর্বর — extremely cruel; uncivilised. SYN savage, brutal, cruel, barbaric, uncivilised. ANT civilised, humane, cultured, gentle. *Ex:* It was a barbarous act of terrorism.

Barren ★ *(adj)* অনুর্বর, বন্ধ্যা — unable to produce crops or offspring. SYN infertile, sterile, arid, unproductive, desolate. ANT fertile, fruitful, productive, fecund, lush. *Ex:* The desert is a barren land.

Belie GRE *(v)* মিথ্যা প্রতিপন্ন করা, ভুল ধারণা দেওয়া — to give a false impression of; to show to be false. SYN contradict, disguise, misrepresent, refute. ANT reveal, confirm, attest, prove. *Ex:* His cheerful face belied his sorrow.

Belligerent ★ *(adj)* যুদ্ধংদেহী, কলহপ্রিয় — hostile and aggressive; engaged in war. SYN aggressive, hostile, bellicose, combative, pugnacious. ANT peaceful, friendly, conciliatory, pacific. *Ex:* The belligerent nations agreed to a ceasefire.

Benevolent ★ *(adj)* দয়ালু, পরোপকারী — kind and generous. SYN kind, charitable, generous, philanthropic, humane. ANT malevolent, cruel, unkind, spiteful. *Ex:* The benevolent man built a school for poor children.

Benign *(adj)* সদয়; নিরীহ (রোগ) — gentle and kind; (of disease) not harmful. SYN kind, gentle, benevolent; harmless, non-cancerous. ANT malign, hostile; malignant, harmful. *Ex:* Fortunately, the tumour was benign.

Berate *(v)* কঠোরভাবে তিরস্কার করা — to scold angrily. SYN scold, rebuke, reprimand, castigate, upbraid. ANT praise, commend, laud, compliment. *Ex:* The coach berated the players for their poor performance.

Bewilder *(v)* হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse. SYN baffle, puzzle, confuse, perplex, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The complex rules bewildered the new students.

Bias *(n)* পক্ষপাত — an unfair preference for or against someone. SYN prejudice, partiality, favouritism, partisanship, leaning. ANT impartiality, fairness, neutrality, objectivity. *Ex:* A judge must decide without bias.

Blatant *(adj)* নির্লজ্জ, স্পষ্ট — done openly and shamelessly. SYN flagrant, obvious, glaring, brazen, overt. ANT hidden, subtle, covert, inconspicuous. *Ex:* It was a blatant lie.

Bleak *(adj)* অন্ধকারাচ্ছন্ন, নিরানন্দ — cold and empty; without hope. SYN desolate, grim, dismal, gloomy, hopeless. ANT bright, promising, hopeful, cheerful. *Ex:* The future looks bleak for the industry.

Blithe *(adj)* উৎফুল্ল; উদাসীন — happy and carefree; casually indifferent. SYN cheerful, carefree, light-hearted; casual, heedless. ANT gloomy, sad; careful, concerned. *Ex:* He showed blithe disregard for the rules.

Bliss *(n)* পরম আনন্দ — perfect happiness. SYN joy, ecstasy, rapture, delight, euphoria. ANT misery, sorrow, woe, agony, despair. *Ex:* Ignorance is bliss.

Boisterous *(adj)* হৈচৈপূর্ণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — noisy, lively and energetic. SYN rowdy, noisy, unruly, exuberant, clamorous. ANT quiet, calm, restrained, sedate. *Ex:* The children were boisterous at the picnic.

Bold ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — brave and confident. SYN brave, daring, courageous, fearless, audacious. ANT timid, shy, cowardly, fearful, meek. *Ex:* It was a bold decision to start a business.

Bolster *(v)* সমর্থন জোগানো, শক্তিশালী করা — to support or strengthen. SYN strengthen, reinforce, support, boost, buttress. ANT weaken, undermine, sabotage, impair. *Ex:* The new evidence bolstered his claim.

Bombastic GRE *(adj)* আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ (ভাষা), দম্ভপূর্ণ — using high-sounding but empty language. SYN pompous, grandiloquent, pretentious, inflated, turgid. ANT simple, plain, modest, unpretentious. *Ex:* The politician gave a bombastic speech.

Boon ★ *(n)* আশীর্বাদ, বর — something helpful or beneficial. SYN blessing, benefit, advantage, godsend, gift. ANT bane, curse, disadvantage, blight. *Ex:* Mobile banking is a boon for rural people.

Boorish *(adj)* অভদ্র, গেঁয়ো — rough and bad-mannered. SYN rude, uncouth, coarse, vulgar, loutish. ANT refined, polite, cultured, courteous. *Ex:* His boorish behaviour embarrassed his hosts.

Brave ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — ready to face danger or pain. SYN courageous, valiant, gallant, intrepid, heroic, dauntless. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The brave freedom fighters sacrificed their lives.

Brevity *(n)* সংক্ষিপ্ততা — shortness, especially of speech or writing. SYN conciseness, briefness, succinctness, terseness. ANT verbosity, wordiness, prolixity, length. *Ex:* Brevity is the soul of wit.

Brittle *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — hard but easily broken. SYN fragile, breakable, frail, delicate, crisp. ANT flexible, durable, tough, sturdy, elastic. *Ex:* Old bones become brittle.

Brusque *(adj)* রূঢ়, কাটখোট্টা — abrupt and rude in speech or manner. SYN curt, blunt, abrupt, gruff, terse. ANT polite, courteous, gracious, gentle. *Ex:* The officer gave a brusque reply.

Bucolic GRE *(adj)* গ্রাম্য, রাখালিয়া — related to pleasant country life. SYN rural, pastoral, rustic, idyllic. ANT urban, metropolitan, industrial. *Ex:* Jasimuddin painted bucolic scenes in his poems.

Burgeon GRE *(v)* দ্রুত বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া — to grow or develop rapidly. SYN flourish, boom, mushroom, expand, thrive. ANT decline, wither, shrink, dwindle. *Ex:* The garment industry burgeoned in the 1990s.

Buoyant *(adj)* ভাসমান; প্রফুল্ল — able to float; cheerful and optimistic. SYN floating; cheerful, optimistic, lively, upbeat. ANT sinking; depressed, gloomy, despondent. *Ex:* The market remained buoyant this year.

C

Cajole *(v)* তোষামোদ করে রাজি করানো — to persuade by flattery or gentle urging. SYN coax, wheedle, persuade, entice, inveigle. ANT force, compel, coerce, bully. *Ex:* She cajoled her father into buying her a phone.

Callous ★ *(adj)* নির্দয়, অনুভূতিহীন — not caring about others' suffering. SYN heartless, unfeeling, cruel, insensitive, hard-hearted. ANT kind, compassionate, sympathetic, caring, tender. *Ex:* His callous remark hurt the widow.

Calm *(adj)* শান্ত — peaceful and quiet; not excited. SYN tranquil, serene, placid, composed, peaceful. ANT agitated, stormy, excited, turbulent, anxious. *Ex:* The sea was calm in the morning.

Candid ★ *(adj)* অকপট, স্পষ্টবাদী — honest and direct. SYN frank, open, outspoken, forthright, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* I want your candid opinion of my essay.

Candour *(n)* স্পষ্টবাদিতা, সরলতা — the quality of being honest and open. SYN frankness, honesty, openness, sincerity, directness. ANT deceit, evasiveness, secrecy, duplicity. *Ex:* He spoke with refreshing candour.

Capitulate *(v)* আত্মসমর্পণ করা — to surrender; to stop resisting. SYN surrender, yield, submit, give in, concede. ANT resist, fight, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The Pakistani forces capitulated on 16 December 1971.

Capricious ★ GRE *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — changing mood or behaviour suddenly. SYN fickle, whimsical, erratic, volatile, mercurial, unpredictable. ANT steady, stable, consistent, constant, reliable. *Ex:* The weather in April is capricious.

Captivate *(v)* মুগ্ধ করা — to attract and hold the attention of. SYN charm, enchant, fascinate, enthral, bewitch. ANT repel, bore, disgust, alienate. *Ex:* Her voice captivated the audience.

Castigate *(v)* কঠোর সমালোচনা করা, শাস্তি দেওয়া — to criticise or punish severely. SYN chastise, rebuke, reprimand, berate, censure. ANT praise, commend, reward, laud. *Ex:* The report castigated the officials for negligence.

Catastrophe *(n)* মহাবিপর্যয় — a sudden great disaster. SYN disaster, calamity, cataclysm, tragedy, debacle. ANT blessing, success, boon, fortune, triumph. *Ex:* The cyclone of 1970 was a national catastrophe.

Caustic *(adj)* ক্ষয়কারক; তীব্র ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — able to burn chemically; bitterly sarcastic. SYN corrosive; sarcastic, acerbic, biting, scathing. ANT mild, soothing; kind, gentle. *Ex:* She made a caustic comment about his work.

Cautious *(adj)* সতর্ক — careful to avoid danger. SYN careful, wary, prudent, circumspect, vigilant. ANT careless, reckless, rash, heedless, imprudent. *Ex:* Be cautious while crossing the road.

Celebrated *(adj)* বিখ্যাত — famous and praised. SYN famous, renowned, eminent, illustrious, acclaimed. ANT unknown, obscure, unsung, notorious. *Ex:* Lalon is a celebrated mystic poet.

Censure ★ *(v/n)* নিন্দা করা; নিন্দা — to express strong formal disapproval. SYN condemn, criticise, denounce, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, approve, commend, endorse, applaud. *Ex:* Parliament passed a motion of censure against the minister.

Chaos *(n)* বিশৃঙ্খলা — complete disorder and confusion. SYN disorder, confusion, mayhem, turmoil, anarchy, pandemonium. ANT order, peace, calm, organisation, system. *Ex:* The power failure caused chaos at the airport.

Charlatan GRE *(n)* ভণ্ড, প্রতারক — a person who falsely claims special knowledge or skill. SYN fraud, quack, impostor, swindler, mountebank. ANT expert, professional, genuine article. *Ex:* The "doctor" turned out to be a charlatan.

Chaste *(adj)* সতী, পবিত্র; সরল — morally pure; simple in style. SYN pure, virtuous, modest, innocent; plain, simple. ANT impure, immoral, lewd; ornate, gaudy. *Ex:* Her prose style is chaste and elegant.

Chastise *(v)* শাস্তি দেওয়া, তিরস্কার করা — to scold or punish severely. SYN punish, discipline, castigate, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, reward, commend, compliment. *Ex:* The father chastised his son for lying.

Cherish *(v)* লালন করা, সযত্নে রাখা — to love and protect; to keep a memory or hope. SYN treasure, value, prize, adore, nurture, harbour. ANT neglect, abandon, despise, disregard. *Ex:* We cherish the memories of our childhood.

Chicanery GRE *(n)* প্রবঞ্চনা, কূটকৌশল — the use of tricks to deceive. SYN trickery, deception, deceit, subterfuge, sophistry. ANT honesty, candour, fairness, probity. *Ex:* The election was won through chicanery.

Circumspect GRE *(adj)* সতর্ক, বিবেচক — careful to consider all risks before acting. SYN cautious, wary, prudent, careful, discreet. ANT rash, reckless, careless, imprudent, heedless. *Ex:* Diplomats must be circumspect in what they say.

Clandestine ★ *(adj)* গোপন — done secretly, often illegally. SYN secret, covert, surreptitious, furtive, hidden, underground. ANT open, public, overt, legal, above-board. *Ex:* They held clandestine meetings at night.

Clemency *(n)* ক্ষমা, দয়া — mercy shown in punishment. SYN mercy, leniency, forgiveness, compassion, pardon. ANT severity, cruelty, harshness, ruthlessness. *Ex:* The prisoner appealed to the President for clemency.

Coerce *(v)* বলপ্রয়োগ করা — to force someone to do something by threats. SYN force, compel, pressure, intimidate, bully. ANT persuade, coax, induce, allow. *Ex:* He was coerced into signing the document.

Cogent GRE *(adj)* যুক্তিযুক্ত, জোরালো — clear, logical and convincing. SYN convincing, compelling, persuasive, forceful, sound. ANT weak, unconvincing, flimsy, illogical. *Ex:* She presented a cogent argument.

Coherent *(adj)* সুসংগত — logical and consistent; clear. SYN logical, consistent, rational, lucid, orderly. ANT incoherent, confused, illogical, rambling. *Ex:* The report lacks a coherent structure.

Colossal *(adj)* বিশাল — extremely large. SYN huge, enormous, gigantic, immense, mammoth, massive. ANT tiny, minute, small, minuscule. *Ex:* The Padma Bridge is a colossal project.

Commence *(v)* শুরু করা — to begin. SYN begin, start, initiate, launch, inaugurate. ANT end, finish, conclude, terminate, cease. *Ex:* The examination will commence at 10 a.m.

Compassion ★ *(n)* সহানুভূতি, করুণা — sympathy and concern for others' suffering. SYN sympathy, pity, kindness, mercy, empathy. ANT cruelty, indifference, callousness, mercilessness. *Ex:* Doctors should treat patients with compassion.

Compatible *(adj)* সামঞ্জস্যপূর্ণ — able to exist or work together. SYN consistent, harmonious, congruous, suited, in tune. ANT incompatible, contradictory, discordant, conflicting. *Ex:* This software is compatible with all computers.

Complacent ★ *(adj)* আত্মতুষ্ট — too satisfied with oneself and unaware of danger. SYN smug, self-satisfied, contented, unconcerned. ANT concerned, dissatisfied, vigilant, alert. *Ex:* We cannot afford to be complacent about dengue.

Comply *(v)* মেনে চলা — to act according to a request or rule. SYN obey, follow, conform, adhere, observe. ANT disobey, defy, violate, resist. *Ex:* All factories must comply with safety laws.

Concise ★ *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত — giving information clearly in few words. SYN brief, succinct, terse, compact, pithy, laconic. ANT verbose, wordy, lengthy, prolix, long-winded. *Ex:* Write a concise summary of the passage.

Conciliate *(v)* মীমাংসা করা, শান্ত করা — to stop someone being angry; to reconcile. SYN pacify, placate, appease, reconcile, mollify. ANT antagonise, provoke, alienate, anger. *Ex:* The manager tried to conciliate the striking workers.

Condemn *(v)* নিন্দা করা; দণ্ড দেওয়া — to express strong disapproval; to sentence. SYN denounce, censure, deplore; convict, sentence. ANT praise, approve, commend; acquit, pardon. *Ex:* The world condemned the genocide.

Condone ★ *(v)* উপেক্ষা করা, মার্জনা করা — to accept or allow wrong behaviour. SYN overlook, excuse, pardon, forgive, disregard. ANT condemn, punish, censure, denounce. *Ex:* We cannot condone violence in any form.

Confident *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসী — sure of oneself or of something. SYN self-assured, certain, sure, positive, poised. ANT diffident, unsure, doubtful, timid, insecure. *Ex:* She felt confident about the viva.

Confiscate *(v)* বাজেয়াপ্ত করা — to take property officially as a penalty. SYN seize, impound, appropriate, sequester. ANT return, restore, release, give back. *Ex:* Customs officers confiscated the smuggled gold.

Conspicuous ★ *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট, দৃষ্টিগোচর — clearly visible; attracting attention. SYN noticeable, prominent, obvious, striking, evident, salient. ANT inconspicuous, hidden, invisible, unnoticeable. *Ex:* He was conspicuous by his absence.

Contemplate *(v)* গভীরভাবে চিন্তা করা — to think deeply about; to consider doing. SYN consider, ponder, reflect, meditate, deliberate. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect, overlook. *Ex:* He is contemplating a career change.

Contempt *(n)* ঘৃণা, অবজ্ঞা — the feeling that someone is worthless. SYN scorn, disdain, disrespect, derision, disregard. ANT respect, admiration, esteem, regard, reverence. *Ex:* He looked at the traitor with contempt.

Contemptible *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য — deserving contempt. SYN despicable, shameful, base, mean, detestable. ANT admirable, laudable, honourable, praiseworthy. *Ex:* Cheating the poor is a contemptible act.

Contentious *(adj)* বিতর্কিত; কলহপ্রিয় — causing disagreement; fond of arguing. SYN controversial, disputed, debatable; quarrelsome. ANT uncontroversial, agreed; peaceable, agreeable. *Ex:* Water-sharing is a contentious issue.

Contradict *(v)* বিরোধিতা করা, খণ্ডন করা — to state the opposite of. SYN deny, refute, dispute, oppose, gainsay. ANT confirm, agree, endorse, corroborate, support. *Ex:* The witness contradicted his earlier statement.

Convene *(v)* সভা আহ্বান করা — to call people together for a meeting. SYN assemble, summon, convoke, call, gather. ANT dismiss, adjourn, disperse, disband. *Ex:* The Speaker convened a special session.

Copious *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant in supply. SYN abundant, plentiful, profuse, ample, lavish. ANT scarce, meagre, sparse, scanty. *Ex:* She took copious notes during the lecture.

Cordial *(adj)* আন্তরিক, সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — warm and friendly. SYN friendly, warm, affable, genial, hearty. ANT hostile, cold, unfriendly, frosty. *Ex:* The two leaders had a cordial meeting.

Corroborate GRE *(v)* সমর্থন করা, প্রমাণ দৃঢ় করা — to confirm with evidence. SYN confirm, verify, substantiate, support, validate. ANT contradict, refute, deny, disprove. *Ex:* Two witnesses corroborated her story.

Covert *(adj)* গোপন — not openly shown; secret. SYN secret, hidden, clandestine, surreptitious, veiled. ANT overt, open, public, manifest. *Ex:* The agency ran a covert operation.

Covet *(v)* লোভ করা — to want eagerly something belonging to another. SYN desire, crave, envy, hanker after, lust after. ANT renounce, disdain, reject, spurn. *Ex:* Do not covet your neighbour's property.

Cowardly *(adj)* ভীরু, কাপুরুষোচিত — lacking courage. SYN fearful, timid, craven, faint-hearted, pusillanimous. ANT brave, bold, courageous, valiant, heroic. *Ex:* Attacking unarmed people is a cowardly act.

Credible *(adj)* বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — able to be believed. SYN believable, plausible, reliable, trustworthy, convincing. ANT incredible, unbelievable, implausible, dubious. *Ex:* We need a credible witness.

Credulous GRE *(adj)* সহজে বিশ্বাসকারী — too ready to believe things. SYN gullible, naive, trusting, unsuspecting. ANT sceptical, suspicious, wary, incredulous. *Ex:* Credulous villagers were cheated by the fraudster.

Cryptic *(adj)* রহস্যময়, দুর্বোধ্য — mysterious or obscure in meaning. SYN enigmatic, mysterious, obscure, puzzling, arcane. ANT clear, plain, obvious, explicit. *Ex:* He left a cryptic message on the door.

Culpable *(adj)* দোষী, নিন্দনীয় — deserving blame. SYN guilty, blameworthy, responsible, at fault. ANT innocent, blameless, guiltless. *Ex:* The officials were held culpable for the fire.

Cumbersome *(adj)* ভারী ও অসুবিধাজনক — large, heavy and difficult to use; slow and complicated. SYN unwieldy, bulky, awkward, clumsy; complicated. ANT manageable, handy, convenient; simple, efficient. *Ex:* The old procedure was cumbersome.

Curb *(v)* দমন করা, নিয়ন্ত্রণ করা — to control or limit. SYN restrain, check, control, limit, suppress. ANT encourage, free, release, foster, unleash. *Ex:* The government is trying to curb inflation.

Curt *(adj)* রূঢ়, সংক্ষিপ্ত — rudely brief. SYN brusque, abrupt, terse, blunt, short. ANT polite, courteous, expansive, gracious. *Ex:* She gave a curt nod and left.

Cynical *(adj)* মানুষের সদিচ্ছায় অবিশ্বাসী — believing that people act only in self-interest. SYN sceptical, distrustful, pessimistic, sardonic. ANT trusting, optimistic, idealistic, naive. *Ex:* Many voters have grown cynical about politics.

D

Daunt *(v)* ভীত করা, দমিয়ে দেওয়া — to make someone feel afraid or discouraged. SYN intimidate, discourage, dismay, frighten, cow. ANT encourage, embolden, hearten, inspire. *Ex:* Nothing could daunt her spirit.

Dauntless *(adj)* নির্ভীক — showing fearlessness. SYN fearless, intrepid, bold, valiant, undaunted. ANT timid, fearful, cowardly, faint-hearted. *Ex:* The dauntless soldiers held their position.

Dearth ★ *(n)* অভাব, ঘাটতি — a scarcity or lack of something. SYN scarcity, shortage, lack, paucity, deficiency, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus, glut. *Ex:* There is a dearth of skilled nurses in the country.

Debacle *(n)* চরম ব্যর্থতা, বিপর্যয় — a sudden and complete failure. SYN fiasco, disaster, failure, collapse, catastrophe. ANT success, triumph, victory, achievement. *Ex:* The launch of the product was a debacle.

Debilitate *(v)* দুর্বল করা — to make very weak. SYN weaken, enfeeble, enervate, sap, exhaust. ANT strengthen, invigorate, fortify, energise. *Ex:* The long illness debilitated him.

Decadence *(n)* অবক্ষয়, পতন — moral or cultural decline. SYN decline, decay, degeneration, corruption, debauchery. ANT rise, growth, flourishing, virtue, morality. *Ex:* The decadence of the Roman Empire led to its fall.

Deceit *(n)* প্রতারণা — dishonest behaviour meant to trick. SYN deception, fraud, trickery, duplicity, guile. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, frankness. *Ex:* He won the election through deceit.

Decipher *(v)* পাঠোদ্ধার করা — to work out the meaning of something difficult. SYN decode, interpret, unravel, decrypt, solve. ANT encode, encipher, garble, confuse. *Ex:* Scholars deciphered the ancient inscription.

Decorum *(n)* শিষ্টাচার, শালীনতা — polite and correct behaviour. SYN propriety, decency, etiquette, dignity, good manners. ANT impropriety, indecorum, rudeness, vulgarity. *Ex:* Members must maintain decorum in Parliament.

Decry *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise publicly. SYN denounce, condemn, criticise, disparage, belittle. ANT praise, extol, laud, acclaim. *Ex:* Many decried the decision to cut trees for the road.

Defer *(v)* স্থগিত করা; মেনে নেওয়া — to postpone; to yield respectfully to another's opinion. SYN postpone, delay, put off, adjourn; submit, yield. ANT advance, expedite, hasten; resist, defy. *Ex:* The decision was deferred until next week.

Deference *(n)* শ্রদ্ধা, সম্মান প্রদর্শন — polite respect. SYN respect, regard, esteem, reverence, submission. ANT disrespect, contempt, disregard, defiance. *Ex:* In deference to his wishes, we kept quiet.

Defiant *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবাধ্য — openly resisting or challenging. SYN rebellious, disobedient, insubordinate, recalcitrant. ANT obedient, submissive, compliant, docile. *Ex:* The defiant prisoner refused to answer.

Deft *(adj)* দক্ষ, নিপুণ — quick and skilful. SYN adroit, dexterous, nimble, skilful, adept. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* With a deft touch, he fixed the watch.

Defunct *(adj)* অচল, বিলুপ্ত — no longer existing or working. SYN extinct, obsolete, dead, inoperative, discontinued. ANT active, alive, working, functioning, extant. *Ex:* The defunct jute mill is now a warehouse.

Delectable *(adj)* সুস্বাদু, মনোরম — delicious; delightful. SYN delicious, tasty, appetising, scrumptious, delightful. ANT unappetising, distasteful, unpleasant, revolting. *Ex:* She served a delectable plate of biryani.

Deleterious GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — causing harm. SYN harmful, detrimental, damaging, injurious, pernicious. ANT beneficial, harmless, salutary, advantageous. *Ex:* Air pollution has deleterious effects on health.

Deliberate *(adj/v)* ইচ্ছাকৃত; চিন্তা করা — done on purpose; to think carefully. SYN intentional, planned, calculated; consider, ponder. ANT accidental, unintentional, spontaneous. *Ex:* It was a deliberate attempt to mislead us.

Delineate *(v)* বর্ণনা করা, রূপরেখা দেওয়া — to describe or outline precisely. SYN outline, describe, depict, portray, sketch. ANT obscure, confuse, blur. *Ex:* The report delineates the main problems.

Demolish *(v)* ভেঙে ফেলা — to pull down; to destroy. SYN destroy, raze, tear down, wreck, level. ANT build, construct, erect, create. *Ex:* The illegal building was demolished.

Denounce *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise strongly in public. SYN condemn, censure, decry, criticise, castigate. ANT praise, commend, support, endorse. *Ex:* The UN denounced the attack.

Deplete *(v)* নিঃশেষ করা — to use up or reduce greatly. SYN exhaust, drain, consume, reduce, use up. ANT replenish, refill, restore, increase. *Ex:* Overfishing has depleted the hilsa stock.

Deplore *(v)* দুঃখ প্রকাশ করা, নিন্দা করা — to feel or express strong disapproval. SYN condemn, regret, lament, denounce, deprecate. ANT praise, approve, celebrate, applaud. *Ex:* We deplore all acts of violence.

Depravity *(n)* নৈতিক অধঃপতন — moral corruption. SYN wickedness, corruption, immorality, vice, degeneracy. ANT virtue, morality, goodness, purity. *Ex:* The crime showed the depth of his depravity.

Derelict *(adj)* পরিত্যক্ত; কর্তব্যে অবহেলাকারী — abandoned and in poor condition; negligent. SYN abandoned, deserted, dilapidated; negligent, remiss. ANT occupied, maintained; dutiful, conscientious. *Ex:* The derelict house is said to be haunted.

Deride *(v)* উপহাস করা — to mock. SYN ridicule, mock, scoff, jeer, taunt, belittle. ANT praise, respect, admire, flatter. *Ex:* His ideas were derided at first but later accepted.

Derogatory *(adj)* অবমাননাকর — showing a critical or disrespectful attitude. SYN disparaging, insulting, offensive, pejorative, defamatory. ANT complimentary, flattering, laudatory, respectful. *Ex:* He made derogatory remarks about women.

Desecrate *(v)* অপবিত্র করা — to treat a sacred place or thing with violent disrespect. SYN profane, defile, violate, pollute, vandalise. ANT sanctify, consecrate, hallow, revere. *Ex:* Vandals desecrated the graves.

Despondent *(adj)* হতাশ, বিষণ্ণ — in low spirits from loss of hope. SYN dejected, hopeless, downcast, disheartened, gloomy. ANT hopeful, cheerful, optimistic, buoyant. *Ex:* He became despondent after failing the exam.

Despot *(n)* স্বৈরশাসক — a ruler who uses power cruelly. SYN tyrant, dictator, autocrat, oppressor. ANT democrat, liberal ruler. *Ex:* The despot crushed every protest.

Destitute ★ *(adj)* নিঃস্ব, অসহায় — extremely poor and lacking basic needs. SYN penniless, impoverished, indigent, needy, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous, opulent. *Ex:* The flood left thousands destitute.

Deter *(v)* নিবৃত্ত করা, বাধা দেওয়া — to discourage someone from doing something. SYN discourage, dissuade, prevent, hinder, restrain. ANT encourage, persuade, induce, motivate. *Ex:* Strict punishment may deter crime.

Detrimental *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — tending to cause harm. SYN harmful, damaging, deleterious, injurious, adverse. ANT beneficial, advantageous, helpful, favourable. *Ex:* Smoking is detrimental to health.

Devious *(adj)* কুটিল, বাঁকা — dishonestly clever; not straightforward. SYN deceitful, cunning, sly, wily, crafty, tortuous. ANT honest, frank, straightforward, direct. *Ex:* He used devious means to get the job.

Devout *(adj)* ধার্মিক, নিষ্ঠাবান — deeply religious; sincere. SYN pious, religious, godly, devoted, faithful. ANT irreligious, impious, sceptical, insincere. *Ex:* His mother is a devout Muslim.

Dexterity *(n)* দক্ষতা, নৈপুণ্য — skill, especially with the hands. SYN skill, deftness, adroitness, agility, finesse. ANT clumsiness, awkwardness, ineptitude. *Ex:* The surgeon operated with great dexterity.

Diatribe GRE *(n)* তীব্র নিন্দাবাদ — a bitter verbal attack. SYN tirade, harangue, invective, denunciation, philippic. ANT praise, eulogy, panegyric, compliment. *Ex:* He launched into a diatribe against the press.

Didactic GRE *(adj)* শিক্ষামূলক; উপদেশমূলক — intended to teach, often in a moralising way. SYN instructive, educational, pedagogic, preachy, moralistic. ANT entertaining, uninstructive, amusing. *Ex:* Aesop's fables are didactic stories.

Diffident ★ *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসহীন, লাজুক — shy and lacking self-confidence. SYN shy, timid, modest, bashful, reserved, unassertive. ANT confident, bold, assertive, self-assured. *Ex:* The diffident student never spoke in class.

Dilapidated *(adj)* জরাজীর্ণ — in a state of disrepair because of age or neglect. SYN ruined, decrepit, ramshackle, crumbling, run-down. ANT well-kept, sound, renovated, new. *Ex:* The school building is dilapidated.

Dilatory GRE *(adj)* দীর্ঘসূত্রী, বিলম্বকারী — slow to act; intended to cause delay. SYN slow, tardy, sluggish, procrastinating, lax. ANT prompt, quick, punctual, diligent, expeditious. *Ex:* The office is known for its dilatory tactics.

Dilemma *(n)* উভয়সংকট — a situation requiring a choice between two difficult options. SYN quandary, predicament, plight, problem. ANT solution, certainty, resolution. *Ex:* She was in a dilemma whether to study abroad or stay.

Diligent ★ *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী, অধ্যবসায়ী — careful and hard-working. SYN industrious, assiduous, hard-working, conscientious, sedulous. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, negligent, slothful. *Ex:* Diligent students rarely fail.

Diminish *(v)* হ্রাস পাওয়া — to make or become less. SYN decrease, lessen, reduce, dwindle, wane, abate. ANT increase, augment, enlarge, magnify. *Ex:* His popularity has diminished.

Discern *(v)* উপলব্ধি করা, পার্থক্য বোঝা — to perceive or recognise. SYN perceive, detect, distinguish, recognise, notice. ANT overlook, miss, confuse, ignore. *Ex:* It is hard to discern truth from rumour on social media.

Discord *(n)* বিরোধ, অনৈক্য — disagreement; lack of harmony. SYN conflict, dissension, strife, disagreement, friction. ANT harmony, accord, concord, agreement, peace. *Ex:* There was discord among the party members.

Discreet *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, সাবধানী — careful not to cause offence or reveal secrets. SYN tactful, prudent, careful, cautious, diplomatic. ANT indiscreet, tactless, careless, imprudent. *Ex:* Please be discreet about this matter.

Disdain *(n/v)* ঘৃণা, তাচ্ছিল্য — the feeling that someone is unworthy; to scorn. SYN contempt, scorn, derision, disregard; spurn. ANT respect, admiration, esteem; admire. *Ex:* She looked at the shabby room with disdain.

Disparage *(v)* হেয় করা — to speak of as having little value. SYN belittle, deprecate, denigrate, decry, underrate. ANT praise, extol, laud, commend, acclaim. *Ex:* Never disparage the efforts of others.

Disparity *(n)* বৈষম্য, পার্থক্য — a great difference. SYN inequality, difference, gap, discrepancy, imbalance. ANT equality, parity, similarity, uniformity. *Ex:* There is a huge disparity between the rich and the poor.

Disseminate GRE *(v)* প্রচার করা, ছড়িয়ে দেওয়া — to spread information widely. SYN spread, circulate, propagate, broadcast, distribute. ANT suppress, conceal, withhold, contain. *Ex:* The media disseminates news quickly.

Distinct *(adj)* স্বতন্ত্র; স্পষ্ট — clearly different; easy to see or hear. SYN different, separate, discrete; clear, evident, obvious. ANT similar, identical; vague, indistinct, blurred. *Ex:* Bangla and Assamese are related but distinct languages.

Docile *(adj)* বাধ্য, শান্ত স্বভাব — quiet and easy to control. SYN obedient, submissive, compliant, tame, meek, tractable. ANT unruly, rebellious, defiant, wild, obstinate. *Ex:* The cow is a docile animal.

Dogmatic *(adj)* গোঁড়া, মতান্ধ — insisting that one's beliefs are certainly right. SYN opinionated, doctrinaire, rigid, dictatorial, bigoted. ANT open-minded, flexible, tolerant, undogmatic. *Ex:* A good scientist is never dogmatic.

Dormant *(adj)* সুপ্ত, নিষ্ক্রিয় — temporarily inactive. SYN inactive, latent, sleeping, quiescent, inert. ANT active, awake, alive, operative. *Ex:* The volcano has been dormant for centuries.

Dubious *(adj)* সন্দেহজনক — doubtful; not to be relied on. SYN doubtful, suspicious, questionable, uncertain, shady. ANT certain, reliable, trustworthy, definite. *Ex:* He made his money by dubious means.

Durable *(adj)* টেকসই — able to last long. SYN lasting, long-lasting, enduring, sturdy, robust. ANT fragile, flimsy, perishable, brittle. *Ex:* Jute bags are cheap and durable.

E

Eccentric *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি, অদ্ভুত — unusual and slightly strange. SYN odd, peculiar, strange, quirky, idiosyncratic, bizarre. ANT normal, ordinary, conventional, typical. *Ex:* The eccentric professor wore two watches.

Eclectic GRE *(adj)* বিভিন্ন উৎস থেকে নির্বাচিত — drawing ideas or styles from many sources. SYN diverse, varied, wide-ranging, broad, heterogeneous. ANT narrow, uniform, limited, homogeneous. *Ex:* She has an eclectic taste in music.

Ecstasy *(n)* পরমানন্দ — overwhelming happiness. SYN rapture, bliss, euphoria, elation, joy. ANT misery, despair, agony, sorrow. *Ex:* The fans were in ecstasy after the victory.

Edify *(v)* নৈতিক বা বুদ্ধিবৃত্তিক উন্নতি সাধন করা — to instruct or improve morally or intellectually. SYN enlighten, educate, instruct, uplift, inform. ANT corrupt, mislead, degrade. *Ex:* The lectures were meant to edify the youth.

Efface *(v)* মুছে ফেলা — to erase a mark or memory. SYN erase, obliterate, wipe out, eradicate, delete. ANT preserve, retain, restore, create. *Ex:* Time cannot efface the memory of 1971.

Effervescent *(adj)* বুদবুদপূর্ণ; প্রাণবন্ত — bubbly; lively and enthusiastic. SYN bubbly, fizzy; lively, vivacious, exuberant, sparkling. ANT flat; dull, lifeless, apathetic. *Ex:* Her effervescent personality made her popular.

Efficacy *(n)* কার্যকারিতা — the ability to produce the intended result. SYN effectiveness, efficiency, potency, power, success. ANT inefficacy, uselessness, ineffectiveness, futility. *Ex:* The efficacy of the vaccine has been proved.

Egalitarian *(adj)* সমতাবাদী — believing that all people are equal. SYN equal, democratic, fair, impartial, unbiased. ANT elitist, hierarchical, unequal, discriminatory. *Ex:* We dream of an egalitarian society.

Egregious GRE *(adj)* চরম খারাপ, জঘন্য — outstandingly bad; shocking. SYN flagrant, glaring, outrageous, shocking, atrocious. ANT minor, trivial, slight, insignificant. *Ex:* It was an egregious error to delete the files.

Elated *(adj)* উল্লসিত — extremely happy. SYN overjoyed, jubilant, ecstatic, thrilled, euphoric. ANT dejected, depressed, sad, despondent. *Ex:* She was elated at her success.

Elegant *(adj)* মার্জিত, সুরুচিসম্পন্ন — graceful and stylish. SYN graceful, stylish, refined, polished, tasteful. ANT clumsy, crude, inelegant, gaudy, tasteless. *Ex:* She wore an elegant Jamdani sari.

Elicit *(v)* বের করে আনা — to draw out a response or information. SYN evoke, extract, draw out, obtain, provoke. ANT suppress, repress, withhold. *Ex:* The question elicited no response. (Do not confuse with *illicit* = illegal.)

Eloquent ★ *(adj)* বাগ্মী, সুবক্তা — fluent and persuasive in speaking or writing. SYN articulate, fluent, expressive, persuasive, silver-tongued. ANT inarticulate, halting, tongue-tied, faltering. *Ex:* Bangabandhu's speech of 7 March was eloquent and inspiring.

Elusive *(adj)* অধরা, ধরা-ছোঁয়ার বাইরে — difficult to find, catch or achieve. SYN evasive, slippery, fleeting, intangible, baffling. ANT obtainable, attainable, catchable, clear. *Ex:* Success remained elusive for the team.

Emaciated *(adj)* কৃশকায়, শীর্ণ — abnormally thin and weak. SYN gaunt, skinny, scrawny, haggard, wasted. ANT plump, fat, stout, well-fed, chubby. *Ex:* The famine victims were emaciated.

Emancipate *(v)* মুক্ত করা — to set free from legal, social or political restrictions. SYN liberate, free, release, deliver, unshackle. ANT enslave, subjugate, confine, oppress. *Ex:* Lincoln emancipated the slaves.

Embellish *(v)* অলংকৃত করা; রং চড়ানো — to decorate; to add untrue details to a story. SYN decorate, adorn, ornament; exaggerate, embroider. ANT simplify, strip, mar; understate. *Ex:* He embellished the story to make it exciting.

Embezzle *(v)* আত্মসাৎ করা — to steal money one has been trusted with. SYN misappropriate, steal, defraud, peculate, pilfer. ANT return, restore, safeguard. *Ex:* The cashier embezzled bank funds.

Eminent ★ *(adj)* বিশিষ্ট, প্রখ্যাত — famous and respected. SYN distinguished, renowned, prominent, illustrious, celebrated. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, insignificant. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Yunus is an eminent economist. (Do not confuse with *imminent* = about to happen.)

Empathy *(n)* সমানুভূতি — the ability to understand and share another's feelings. SYN understanding, compassion, sympathy, sensitivity, rapport. ANT indifference, apathy, callousness, insensitivity. *Ex:* A good teacher shows empathy towards weak students.

Emulate *(v)* অনুকরণ করা, সমকক্ষ হতে চেষ্টা করা — to try to equal or excel by imitating. SYN imitate, copy, follow, match, mirror. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect. *Ex:* Young cricketers try to emulate Shakib Al Hasan.

Encomium GRE *(n)* প্রশস্তি — a speech or piece of writing praising someone highly. SYN eulogy, tribute, panegyric, praise, accolade. ANT criticism, condemnation, diatribe, invective. *Ex:* The poet wrote an encomium on the national hero.

Encourage *(v)* উৎসাহ দেওয়া — to give support or hope. SYN hearten, inspire, motivate, embolden, foster, promote. ANT discourage, deter, dishearten, dissuade. *Ex:* Parents should encourage children to read.

Endorse *(v)* সমর্থন করা, অনুমোদন করা — to declare public approval of. SYN support, approve, back, sanction, champion. ANT oppose, reject, disapprove, condemn. *Ex:* The committee endorsed the proposal.

Enervate GRE *(v)* দুর্বল করা, নিস্তেজ করা — to make weak or drained of energy (NOT "energise"). SYN weaken, exhaust, debilitate, sap, enfeeble. ANT invigorate, energise, strengthen, vitalise. *Ex:* The hot, humid weather enervated us.

Enhance *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা, উন্নত করা — to improve the quality or value. SYN improve, increase, boost, heighten, augment. ANT reduce, diminish, decrease, impair, worsen. *Ex:* The new road will enhance trade.

Enigma *(n)* রহস্য, ধাঁধা — a mysterious person or thing. SYN mystery, puzzle, riddle, conundrum, paradox. ANT certainty, explanation, solution, clarity. *Ex:* How the pyramids were built is still an enigma.

Enmity *(n)* শত্রুতা — the state of being an enemy. SYN hostility, animosity, antagonism, hatred, rancour. ANT friendship, amity, goodwill, harmony. *Ex:* There was long-standing enmity between the two families.

Enormous *(adj)* বিশাল — very large. SYN huge, vast, immense, gigantic, colossal, massive. ANT tiny, small, minute, little, minuscule. *Ex:* The project costs an enormous amount of money.

Ephemeral ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting for a very short time. SYN transient, transitory, fleeting, momentary, evanescent, short-lived. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, eternal, perennial. *Ex:* Fame on social media is often ephemeral.

Equanimity GRE *(n)* মানসিক স্থিরতা — calmness in a difficult situation. SYN composure, calmness, serenity, poise, self-possession. ANT agitation, anxiety, panic, discomposure. *Ex:* She accepted the loss with equanimity.

Equivocal GRE *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থবোধক — deliberately unclear; ambiguous. SYN ambiguous, vague, evasive, unclear, cryptic. ANT unequivocal, clear, definite, explicit. *Ex:* The minister gave an equivocal answer.

Eradicate ★ *(v)* নির্মূল করা — to destroy completely. SYN eliminate, wipe out, uproot, abolish, exterminate, extirpate. ANT create, establish, plant, foster, nurture. *Ex:* We must eradicate corruption from society.

Erratic *(adj)* অনিয়মিত, অস্থির — not even or regular. SYN irregular, inconsistent, unpredictable, unstable, capricious. ANT regular, consistent, steady, stable, predictable. *Ex:* The power supply here is erratic.

Erudite ★ GRE *(adj)* পণ্ডিত, বিদ্বান — having great knowledge from study. SYN learned, scholarly, knowledgeable, well-read, cultured. ANT ignorant, illiterate, uneducated, unlettered. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Shahidullah was an erudite scholar.

Eschew GRE *(v)* পরিহার করা — to deliberately avoid. SYN avoid, shun, abstain from, forgo, renounce. ANT embrace, seek, welcome, adopt, indulge in. *Ex:* Good writers eschew unnecessary jargon.

Esoteric GRE *(adj)* গূঢ়, স্বল্পজ্ঞাত — understood only by a small group. SYN obscure, arcane, abstruse, recondite, mysterious. ANT common, popular, familiar, simple, exoteric. *Ex:* The book is full of esoteric terms.

Euphemism *(n)* কোমল শব্দের ব্যবহার — a mild word used instead of a harsh one. SYN polite term, understatement, softened expression. ANT dysphemism, blunt term. *Ex:* "Passed away" is a euphemism for "died".

Evade *(v)* এড়িয়ে যাওয়া, ফাঁকি দেওয়া — to escape or avoid, often by trickery. SYN avoid, elude, dodge, escape, sidestep. ANT face, confront, meet, encounter. *Ex:* He was jailed for evading tax.

Evanescent GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী, মিলিয়ে যাওয়া — quickly fading or disappearing. SYN fleeting, ephemeral, transient, momentary, vanishing. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth is evanescent.

Exacerbate GRE *(v)* তীব্রতর করা — to make a problem worse. SYN aggravate, worsen, intensify, inflame, compound. ANT alleviate, mitigate, soothe, improve, relieve. *Ex:* Unplanned building exacerbates waterlogging in Dhaka.

Exalt *(v)* উন্নীত করা; প্রশংসা করা — to raise in rank; to praise highly. SYN elevate, promote; glorify, extol, praise. ANT degrade, demote; criticise, debase, humble. *Ex:* Poets exalt the beauty of Bengal.

Exasperate *(v)* অতিশয় বিরক্ত করা — to irritate intensely. SYN annoy, infuriate, irritate, provoke, vex. ANT soothe, calm, please, pacify. *Ex:* The constant delays exasperated passengers.

Exemplary *(adj)* দৃষ্টান্তমূলক, অনুকরণীয় — serving as a good example; (of punishment) serving as a warning. SYN ideal, model, perfect, commendable; deterrent. ANT deplorable, imperfect, poor, unworthy. *Ex:* The court awarded exemplary punishment.

Exonerate ★ *(v)* দোষমুক্ত করা — to clear someone from blame. SYN acquit, absolve, clear, vindicate, exculpate. ANT accuse, blame, convict, incriminate. *Ex:* The inquiry exonerated the officer.

Exorbitant ★ *(adj)* অত্যধিক, মাত্রাতিরিক্ত — (of price) unreasonably high. SYN excessive, extortionate, outrageous, inflated, unreasonable. ANT reasonable, moderate, fair, cheap, modest. *Ex:* Hotels charge exorbitant rates during Eid.

Expedite *(v)* ত্বরান্বিত করা — to make something happen sooner. SYN hasten, accelerate, speed up, hurry, quicken. ANT delay, hinder, slow down, impede, obstruct. *Ex:* Please expedite the delivery of the goods.

Explicit *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট — stated clearly and in detail. SYN clear, plain, specific, unambiguous, definite. ANT implicit, vague, ambiguous, hidden, tacit. *Ex:* He gave explicit instructions.

Extol ★ *(v)* উচ্চ প্রশংসা করা — to praise enthusiastically. SYN praise, laud, acclaim, glorify, eulogise, exalt. ANT criticise, condemn, belittle, disparage, denigrate. *Ex:* The critics extolled the novel.

Extravagant ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — spending too much; excessive. SYN wasteful, lavish, spendthrift, profligate, prodigal. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, parsimonious. *Ex:* An extravagant man soon becomes poor.

F

Fabricate *(v)* বানানো (মিথ্যা); নির্মাণ করা — to invent something false; to manufacture. SYN invent, concoct, forge, falsify; construct, make. ANT tell the truth, verify; destroy, dismantle. *Ex:* The story was fabricated by the tabloid.

Facetious *(adj)* ঠাট্টাপূর্ণ (অসময়ে) — treating serious issues with inappropriate humour. SYN flippant, joking, frivolous, jocular, glib. ANT serious, solemn, earnest, grave. *Ex:* His facetious remarks at the funeral offended people.

Facile GRE *(adj)* সহজসাধ্য; অগভীর — too simple, showing little thought; easily achieved. SYN superficial, simplistic, glib, shallow; easy, effortless. ANT profound, thoughtful, complex; difficult, laborious. *Ex:* He offered a facile solution to a complex problem.

Fallacy *(n)* ভ্রান্ত ধারণা — a mistaken belief; a false argument. SYN misconception, delusion, error, myth, illusion. ANT truth, fact, reality, certainty. *Ex:* It is a fallacy that money brings happiness.

Fastidious GRE *(adj)* খুঁতখুঁতে — very attentive to detail; hard to please. SYN fussy, meticulous, particular, finicky, punctilious. ANT careless, easy-going, sloppy, undemanding. *Ex:* He is fastidious about his clothes.

Fatigue *(n)* ক্লান্তি — extreme tiredness. SYN tiredness, weariness, exhaustion, lethargy, lassitude. ANT energy, vigour, freshness, liveliness. *Ex:* He collapsed from fatigue after the march.

Feasible *(adj)* সম্ভবপর, বাস্তবায়নযোগ্য — possible to do easily or conveniently. SYN practicable, viable, achievable, workable, possible. ANT impractical, unfeasible, impossible, unworkable. *Ex:* A metro rail was found feasible for Dhaka.

Feeble ★ *(adj)* দুর্বল — lacking strength. SYN weak, frail, infirm, delicate, puny, debilitated. ANT strong, robust, sturdy, vigorous, powerful. *Ex:* The old man's voice was feeble.

Felicity *(n)* পরম সুখ; উপযুক্ততা — great happiness; the ability to find suitable words. SYN bliss, joy, happiness; aptness, appropriateness. ANT misery, sorrow; inappropriateness. *Ex:* He writes with great felicity of expression.

Ferocious *(adj)* হিংস্র — savagely fierce. SYN fierce, savage, vicious, brutal, wild. ANT gentle, tame, mild, docile. *Ex:* The Royal Bengal Tiger is a ferocious animal.

Fertile *(adj)* উর্বর — able to produce many crops or ideas. SYN fruitful, productive, rich, fecund, prolific. ANT barren, sterile, infertile, arid, unproductive. *Ex:* The land of Bangladesh is very fertile.

Fervent *(adj)* উৎসাহী, আবেগপূর্ণ — having or showing intense feeling. SYN passionate, ardent, zealous, fervid, intense. ANT apathetic, indifferent, cool, lukewarm. *Ex:* He is a fervent supporter of the national team.

Fickle ★ *(adj)* চঞ্চল, অস্থির চিত্ত — changing frequently in loyalty or interest. SYN capricious, inconstant, changeable, mercurial, volatile. ANT constant, steadfast, loyal, faithful, stable. *Ex:* Fortune is fickle.

Fictitious *(adj)* কাল্পনিক, মিথ্যা — not real or true. SYN imaginary, invented, false, fabricated, made-up, bogus. ANT real, true, genuine, factual, authentic. *Ex:* He gave a fictitious name to the police.

Flagrant *(adj)* স্পষ্ট ও নির্লজ্জ — (of wrongdoing) obvious and shocking. SYN blatant, glaring, egregious, outrageous, open. ANT hidden, subtle, concealed, minor. *Ex:* It was a flagrant violation of human rights.

Flamboyant *(adj)* জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — attracting attention by confidence and style. SYN showy, ostentatious, flashy, colourful, extravagant. ANT modest, restrained, plain, sober, understated. *Ex:* The singer is famous for his flamboyant costumes.

Flaw *(n)* ত্রুটি — a mark, fault or weakness. SYN defect, fault, imperfection, blemish, shortcoming. ANT perfection, merit, strength, virtue. *Ex:* There is a flaw in your argument.

Flimsy *(adj)* ঠুনকো, দুর্বল — weak and easily damaged; (of an excuse) unconvincing. SYN fragile, frail, weak; feeble, unconvincing, thin. ANT sturdy, strong, solid; convincing, sound. *Ex:* He gave a flimsy excuse for his absence.

Florid *(adj)* অতিরিক্ত অলংকৃত; রক্তিম — excessively decorated; reddish (complexion). SYN ornate, flowery, elaborate, baroque; ruddy, flushed. ANT plain, simple, austere; pale, pallid. *Ex:* His florid writing style is hard to follow.

Flourish ★ *(v)* সমৃদ্ধ হওয়া — to grow or develop well. SYN thrive, prosper, bloom, boom, burgeon. ANT decline, wither, fade, languish, decay. *Ex:* Trade flourished under the Mughals.

Fluctuate *(v)* ওঠানামা করা — to rise and fall irregularly. SYN vary, oscillate, swing, waver, change. ANT stabilise, remain constant, steady. *Ex:* Onion prices fluctuate every season.

Forbearance *(n)* ধৈর্য, সহিষ্ণুতা — patient self-control. SYN patience, tolerance, restraint, endurance, leniency. ANT impatience, intolerance, anger, severity. *Ex:* She showed great forbearance with her difficult neighbours.

Forlorn *(adj)* নিঃসঙ্গ, হতাশ — pitifully sad and lonely. SYN lonely, desolate, abandoned, wretched, hopeless. ANT cheerful, happy, hopeful, cared-for. *Ex:* A forlorn child stood at the station.

Formidable *(adj)* ভয়ংকর, দুর্দমনীয় — inspiring fear or respect through power; very difficult. SYN daunting, intimidating, powerful, redoubtable; arduous. ANT weak, easy, harmless, trivial. *Ex:* India posed a formidable target of 350 runs.

Fortitude *(n)* মনোবল, সহিষ্ণুতা — courage in pain or difficulty. SYN courage, endurance, resilience, grit, bravery. ANT cowardice, weakness, timidity, faint-heartedness. *Ex:* She bore her illness with fortitude.

Fragile *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — easily broken or damaged. SYN breakable, delicate, brittle, frail, flimsy. ANT strong, sturdy, durable, robust, tough. *Ex:* Handle the glassware carefully; it is fragile.

Frail *(adj)* দুর্বল, ক্ষীণ — weak and delicate. SYN weak, feeble, infirm, delicate, fragile. ANT strong, robust, healthy, sturdy. *Ex:* My grandmother has become frail.

Frank ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্টবাদী, অকপট — honest and direct. SYN candid, open, outspoken, straightforward, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* To be frank, I did not like the film.

Frenzy *(n)* উন্মত্ততা — a state of wild excitement. SYN hysteria, madness, mania, fury, agitation. ANT calm, composure, serenity, tranquillity. *Ex:* The crowd was whipped into a frenzy.

Frivolous *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, লঘুচিত্ত — not serious; silly. SYN trivial, petty, flippant, silly, superficial. ANT serious, important, earnest, grave, sensible. *Ex:* Don't waste time on frivolous matters.

Frugal ★ *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful and economical with money or food. SYN thrifty, economical, sparing, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, lavish, prodigal, spendthrift. *Ex:* He lived a frugal life and saved money.

Furtive GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চোরাগোপ্তা — attempting to avoid notice; secretive. SYN secret, stealthy, sly, surreptitious, clandestine. ANT open, overt, candid, forthright. *Ex:* He cast a furtive glance at the answer sheet.

Futile ★ *(adj)* নিষ্ফল, বৃথা — producing no useful result. SYN useless, vain, fruitless, pointless, abortive, ineffectual. ANT useful, fruitful, effective, productive, worthwhile. *Ex:* It is futile to argue with a fool.

G

Gallant *(adj)* সাহসী; ভদ্র — brave; polite and attentive to women. SYN brave, valiant, heroic, courageous; chivalrous, courteous. ANT cowardly, craven; rude, discourteous. *Ex:* The gallant freedom fighters are our national heroes.

Garish *(adj)* চোখ-ধাঁধানো, অতি উজ্জ্বল — unpleasantly bright and showy. SYN gaudy, flashy, loud, lurid, tawdry. ANT sober, tasteful, subdued, muted, elegant. *Ex:* The room was painted in garish colours.

Garrulous ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — talking too much about unimportant things. SYN talkative, loquacious, verbose, chatty, voluble. ANT taciturn, reticent, silent, reserved, laconic. *Ex:* The garrulous old man told us his life story.

Generous *(adj)* উদার — willing to give more than expected. SYN liberal, charitable, munificent, magnanimous, bountiful. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, selfish, parsimonious. *Ex:* He made a generous donation to the hospital.

Genial *(adj)* অমায়িক, হাসিখুশি — friendly and cheerful. SYN affable, amiable, cordial, warm, friendly. ANT unfriendly, cold, hostile, surly. *Ex:* Our genial host welcomed us warmly.

Genuine ★ *(adj)* খাঁটি, আসল — truly what it is said to be. SYN real, authentic, true, bona fide, sincere. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, sham. *Ex:* Is this a genuine diamond?

Gloomy *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ; অন্ধকার — dark; sad and without hope. SYN dark, dim, dismal; sad, melancholy, depressed, despondent. ANT bright, sunny; cheerful, happy, hopeful. *Ex:* The economic outlook is gloomy.

Glorious *(adj)* গৌরবময় — having or bringing great fame; magnificent. SYN illustrious, celebrated, splendid, magnificent, triumphant. ANT shameful, inglorious, ignominious, dishonourable. *Ex:* 1971 is the most glorious chapter of our history.

Glut *(n)* অতিরিক্ত সরবরাহ — an excessive supply. SYN surplus, excess, surfeit, oversupply, plethora. ANT scarcity, shortage, dearth, lack. *Ex:* A glut of potatoes caused prices to fall.

Gracious *(adj)* সদয়, ভদ্র — courteous, kind and pleasant. SYN courteous, kind, polite, cordial, benevolent. ANT rude, ungracious, impolite, discourteous. *Ex:* She was gracious in defeat.

Gratuitous GRE *(adj)* অহেতুক; বিনামূল্যে — uncalled for, lacking good reason; free of charge. SYN unjustified, unwarranted, needless, unprovoked; free. ANT justified, warranted, necessary; paid. *Ex:* The film contains gratuitous violence.

Gregarious ★ GRE *(adj)* দলপ্রিয়, মিশুক — fond of company; sociable; (of animals) living in groups. SYN sociable, outgoing, convivial, friendly, companionable. ANT unsociable, reclusive, introverted, solitary, aloof. *Ex:* Man is a gregarious animal.

Grievous *(adj)* গুরুতর, মারাত্মক — very serious or severe. SYN serious, severe, grave, dreadful, heinous. ANT slight, minor, trivial, trifling. *Ex:* He suffered grievous injuries in the accident.

Grim *(adj)* ভয়াবহ, কঠোর — very serious, gloomy or forbidding. SYN stern, forbidding, harsh; bleak, dismal, dreadful. ANT cheerful, pleasant, genial; hopeful, bright. *Ex:* The report presents a grim picture of child labour.

Guile *(n)* ছলনা — clever but dishonest intelligence. SYN cunning, craftiness, deceit, trickery, wiliness. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, ingenuousness. *Ex:* He used guile to win their trust.

Gullible *(adj)* সহজে প্রতারিত হয় এমন — easily deceived. SYN credulous, naive, trusting, unsuspecting, ingenuous. ANT sceptical, suspicious, shrewd, astute, wary. *Ex:* Gullible people fall for online scams.

H

Hackneyed ★ *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, গতানুগতিক — (of a phrase or idea) overused and unoriginal. SYN trite, banal, clichéd, stale, stereotyped, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, new, innovative. *Ex:* Avoid hackneyed expressions in your essay.

Haggard *(adj)* ক্লান্ত ও শীর্ণ — looking exhausted and unwell. SYN gaunt, drawn, worn, wan, careworn. ANT fresh, healthy, robust, hale. *Ex:* After days without sleep, he looked haggard.

Halcyon GRE *(adj)* শান্তিপূর্ণ ও সুখময় (অতীত) — (of a past time) idyllically happy and peaceful. SYN peaceful, serene, idyllic, golden, tranquil. ANT turbulent, stormy, troubled, chaotic. *Ex:* He remembered the halcyon days of his youth.

Hamper *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to hinder the progress of. SYN hinder, impede, obstruct, hold back, encumber. ANT help, assist, aid, facilitate, expedite. *Ex:* Heavy rain hampered the rescue work.

Haphazard *(adj)* এলোমেলো — lacking order or plan. SYN random, disorganised, chaotic, unsystematic, careless. ANT orderly, systematic, methodical, planned. *Ex:* Haphazard urbanisation is a big problem.

Harass *(v)* হয়রানি করা — to subject to repeated pressure or intimidation. SYN torment, pester, harry, bully, persecute. ANT help, comfort, assist, soothe. *Ex:* It is a crime to harass women in public.

Harbinger *(n)* অগ্রদূত — a person or thing that signals the approach of another. SYN herald, forerunner, precursor, omen, sign. ANT successor, follower, aftermath. *Ex:* The cuckoo is the harbinger of spring.

Harmony *(n)* সম্প্রীতি, মিল — agreement; peaceful co-existence. SYN accord, concord, agreement, unity, peace. ANT discord, conflict, disagreement, strife. *Ex:* People of all religions live in harmony here.

Harsh *(adj)* কঠোর, রুক্ষ — cruel or severe; unpleasantly rough. SYN severe, cruel, stern, strict; rough, grating. ANT mild, gentle, lenient, kind; soft, smooth. *Ex:* The punishment was too harsh.

Haughty ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — arrogantly superior. SYN arrogant, proud, conceited, disdainful, supercilious. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* The haughty landlord ignored the poor tenants.

Hazardous *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ — risky; dangerous. SYN dangerous, risky, perilous, precarious, unsafe. ANT safe, secure, harmless, protected. *Ex:* Ship-breaking is a hazardous job.

Heinous ★ *(adj)* জঘন্য, ঘৃণ্য — (of a crime) utterly wicked. SYN atrocious, monstrous, abominable, odious, vile, nefarious. ANT admirable, good, noble, virtuous, commendable. *Ex:* Murder is a heinous crime.

Heresy *(n)* ধর্মদ্রোহিতা, প্রচলিত মতবিরোধী — a belief contrary to accepted religious or general opinion. SYN dissent, nonconformity, heterodoxy, apostasy, unorthodoxy. ANT orthodoxy, conformity, belief, doctrine. *Ex:* Galileo was accused of heresy.

Hesitate *(v)* ইতস্তত করা — to pause before acting. SYN pause, waver, falter, vacillate, dither. ANT decide, proceed, act promptly. *Ex:* Don't hesitate to ask questions.

Heterogeneous *(adj)* বিভিন্ন প্রকারের, বিষমসত্ত্ব — diverse in content. SYN diverse, varied, mixed, assorted, miscellaneous. ANT homogeneous, uniform, similar, alike. *Ex:* Dhaka has a heterogeneous population.

Hilarious *(adj)* অত্যন্ত হাস্যকর — extremely amusing. SYN very funny, comical, side-splitting, hysterical, uproarious. ANT sad, serious, solemn, tragic. *Ex:* The comedy show was hilarious.

Hinder *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to make it difficult for something to happen. SYN hamper, obstruct, impede, block, thwart. ANT help, aid, facilitate, assist, promote. *Ex:* Lack of funds hindered the project.

Holistic *(adj)* সামগ্রিক — dealing with the whole rather than parts. SYN comprehensive, integrated, overall, total. ANT partial, fragmentary, piecemeal. *Ex:* We need a holistic approach to education.

Homogeneous *(adj)* সমজাতীয়, সমসত্ত্ব — of the same kind; uniform. SYN uniform, alike, similar, identical, consistent. ANT heterogeneous, diverse, varied, different. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a largely homogeneous linguistic population.

Hostile ★ *(adj)* শত্রুভাবাপন্ন, বৈরী — unfriendly; antagonistic. SYN unfriendly, antagonistic, belligerent, inimical, adverse. ANT friendly, amicable, cordial, warm, favourable. *Ex:* The crowd was hostile to the speaker.

Humane *(adj)* মানবিক, দয়ালু — showing kindness and compassion. SYN kind, compassionate, merciful, benevolent, considerate. ANT inhumane, cruel, brutal, barbaric. *Ex:* Prisoners should be treated in a humane way.

Humble ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; নিম্ন — modest; low in rank. SYN modest, meek, unassuming; lowly, ordinary, simple. ANT proud, arrogant, haughty; noble, exalted. *Ex:* Despite his fame, he remained humble.

Hypocrisy *(n)* ভণ্ডামি — pretending to have higher standards than one actually has. SYN insincerity, pretence, duplicity, sanctimony, falseness. ANT sincerity, honesty, genuineness, candour. *Ex:* Preaching honesty while taking bribes is hypocrisy.

Hypothetical *(adj)* অনুমানভিত্তিক, কাল্পনিক — based on a suggested idea, not on facts. SYN theoretical, supposed, conjectural, speculative, assumed. ANT actual, real, factual, proven, concrete. *Ex:* Let's consider a hypothetical situation.

I

Iconoclast GRE *(n)* প্রচলিত বিশ্বাসবিরোধী ব্যক্তি — a person who attacks established beliefs. SYN rebel, dissenter, nonconformist, radical, heretic. ANT conformist, traditionalist, follower, believer. *Ex:* Nazrul was an iconoclast in Bengali literature.

Idle ★ *(adj)* অলস; অকেজো — lazy; not working; without purpose. SYN lazy, indolent, slothful; inactive, unused; pointless. ANT busy, diligent, industrious; active, employed. *Ex:* An idle brain is the devil's workshop.

Ignominy *(n)* অপমান, লজ্জা — public shame or disgrace. SYN disgrace, dishonour, shame, humiliation, infamy. ANT honour, glory, credit, esteem, dignity. *Ex:* The team suffered the ignominy of defeat.

Illicit *(adj)* অবৈধ — forbidden by law or custom. SYN illegal, unlawful, illegitimate, prohibited, criminal. ANT legal, lawful, legitimate, licit, permitted. *Ex:* Police seized illicit drugs.

Illustrious *(adj)* খ্যাতিমান, গৌরবময় — well known and respected because of past achievements. SYN famous, celebrated, distinguished, eminent, renowned. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, humble. *Ex:* Sher-e-Bangla came from an illustrious family.

Imbibe *(v)* শোষণ করা, গ্রহণ করা — to drink; to absorb ideas. SYN drink, consume; absorb, assimilate, take in, learn. ANT reject, discard, ignore. *Ex:* Children imbibe values from their parents.

Immaculate *(adj)* নিষ্কলঙ্ক, নিখুঁত — perfectly clean; without fault. SYN spotless, pristine, flawless, impeccable, unblemished. ANT dirty, filthy, stained, flawed, tarnished. *Ex:* Her uniform was immaculate.

Imminent ★ *(adj)* আসন্ন — about to happen. SYN impending, approaching, forthcoming, near, looming. ANT distant, remote, far-off, unlikely. *Ex:* A cyclone is imminent; fishermen should return to shore.

Impartial ★ *(adj)* নিরপেক্ষ — treating all equally; fair. SYN unbiased, neutral, fair, objective, disinterested, just. ANT biased, partial, prejudiced, partisan, one-sided. *Ex:* An election commission must be impartial.

Impeccable *(adj)* নিখুঁত, ত্রুটিহীন — in accordance with the highest standards. SYN flawless, faultless, perfect, immaculate, exemplary. ANT flawed, imperfect, faulty, defective. *Ex:* She speaks impeccable English.

Impede *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to delay or prevent by obstructing. SYN hinder, hamper, obstruct, block, thwart. ANT help, facilitate, expedite, assist, aid. *Ex:* Corruption impedes development.

Imperative *(adj)* অপরিহার্য; আদেশসূচক — of vital importance; giving a command. SYN vital, essential, crucial, necessary, urgent; mandatory. ANT unnecessary, optional, trivial, inessential. *Ex:* It is imperative that we act now.

Imperious *(adj)* আদেশপ্রবণ, কর্তৃত্বপরায়ণ — arrogant and domineering. SYN domineering, overbearing, bossy, dictatorial, haughty. ANT humble, meek, submissive, modest. *Ex:* The manager's imperious manner upset the staff.

Impetuous *(adj)* হঠকারী, আবেগপ্রবণ — acting quickly without thought. SYN rash, impulsive, hasty, reckless, headstrong. ANT cautious, careful, prudent, circumspect, deliberate. *Ex:* His impetuous decision cost him his job.

Implicit *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত; প্রশ্নাতীত — implied, not directly stated; absolute. SYN implied, tacit, unspoken, inherent; absolute, total. ANT explicit, stated, express; partial, qualified. *Ex:* There was an implicit threat in his words. / She has implicit faith in God.

Impromptu *(adj/adv)* উপস্থিত, তাৎক্ষণিক — done without preparation. SYN spontaneous, unrehearsed, improvised, extempore, ad-lib. ANT planned, prepared, rehearsed, premeditated. *Ex:* He gave an impromptu speech.

Imprudent *(adj)* অবিবেচক — not showing care for consequences. SYN unwise, rash, reckless, injudicious, careless. ANT prudent, wise, careful, sensible, judicious. *Ex:* It was imprudent to invest all your savings in one share.

Impudent *(adj)* ধৃষ্ট, বেয়াদব — not showing due respect. SYN insolent, rude, impertinent, cheeky, brazen. ANT respectful, polite, courteous, deferential. *Ex:* The impudent boy talked back to the teacher.

Inadvertent *(adj)* অনিচ্ছাকৃত, অসাবধানতাবশত — not intentional. SYN accidental, unintentional, involuntary, careless. ANT deliberate, intentional, conscious, planned. *Ex:* It was an inadvertent mistake.

Inane *(adj)* অর্থহীন, বোকা — silly; lacking sense. SYN silly, foolish, absurd, senseless, vacuous. ANT sensible, intelligent, meaningful, sound. *Ex:* Stop asking inane questions.

Incessant ★ *(adj)* অবিরাম — continuing without pause. SYN constant, ceaseless, unending, perpetual, continuous, relentless. ANT intermittent, occasional, sporadic, periodic. *Ex:* Incessant rain flooded the streets.

Incisive *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, সুস্পষ্ট — clear and sharp in thinking or expression. SYN penetrating, sharp, keen, acute, perceptive. ANT dull, vague, superficial, woolly. *Ex:* He gave an incisive analysis of the budget.

Incorrigible *(adj)* সংশোধনের অযোগ্য — not able to be corrected or reformed. SYN incurable, hopeless, inveterate, hardened, irredeemable. ANT reformable, correctable, manageable, curable. *Ex:* He is an incorrigible liar.

Indifferent *(adj)* উদাসীন; মাঝারি মানের — having no interest; mediocre. SYN apathetic, unconcerned, detached; mediocre, average. ANT interested, concerned, eager; excellent, superior. *Ex:* He is indifferent to politics.

Indigenous *(adj)* আদিবাসী, দেশীয় — native to a place. SYN native, aboriginal, local, original, endemic. ANT foreign, alien, imported, exotic. *Ex:* The Chakma are an indigenous people of the Chittagong Hill Tracts.

Indigent GRE *(adj)* দরিদ্র, অভাবী — poor; needy. SYN poor, needy, destitute, impoverished, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous. *Ex:* The trust gives scholarships to indigent students.

Indolent ★ *(adj)* অলস — wanting to avoid activity. SYN lazy, idle, slothful, sluggish, lethargic. ANT industrious, diligent, active, energetic, assiduous. *Ex:* An indolent student cannot expect good results.

Indomitable *(adj)* অদম্য — impossible to subdue or defeat. SYN invincible, unconquerable, unyielding, resolute, steadfast. ANT weak, submissive, defeatable, feeble. *Ex:* The Bengalis showed indomitable courage in 1952.

Industrious *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী — diligent and hard-working. SYN hard-working, diligent, assiduous, sedulous, busy. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, slothful. *Ex:* Bangladeshi farmers are very industrious.

Inevitable ★ *(adj)* অবশ্যম্ভাবী, অনিবার্য — certain to happen. SYN unavoidable, inescapable, certain, sure, inexorable. ANT avoidable, uncertain, preventable, doubtful. *Ex:* Death is inevitable.

Infamous *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — well known for a bad quality or deed. SYN notorious, disreputable, scandalous, ignominious. ANT famous, reputable, honourable, illustrious. *Ex:* He was an infamous smuggler. (Note: *infamous* is NOT the opposite of *famous* in the sense "unknown".)

Ingenious *(adj)* উদ্ভাবনী শক্তিসম্পন্ন — clever, original and inventive. SYN inventive, clever, creative, resourceful, original. ANT unimaginative, dull, stupid, uninventive. *Ex:* What an ingenious idea!

Ingenuous GRE *(adj)* সরল, অকপট — innocent and unsuspecting; frank. SYN naive, innocent, artless, guileless, frank. ANT sly, crafty, cunning, disingenuous, artful. *Ex:* The ingenuous girl believed every word.

Inherent *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত, সহজাত — existing as a natural, permanent part. SYN intrinsic, innate, built-in, essential, inborn. ANT extrinsic, acquired, external, incidental. *Ex:* There are risks inherent in every business.

Inhibit *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া, সংযত করা — to hinder or restrain. SYN restrain, hinder, check, curb, suppress. ANT encourage, promote, allow, foster. *Ex:* Fear inhibits creativity.

Innate *(adj)* সহজাত — inborn; natural. SYN inborn, inherent, natural, intrinsic, congenital. ANT acquired, learned, cultivated, extrinsic. *Ex:* She has an innate talent for music.

Innocuous GRE *(adj)* নিরীহ, ক্ষতিহীন — not harmful or offensive. SYN harmless, inoffensive, safe, benign, mild. ANT harmful, noxious, dangerous, offensive, pernicious. *Ex:* It was an innocuous joke.

Insipid *(adj)* স্বাদহীন; নীরস — lacking flavour; dull. SYN tasteless, bland, flavourless; dull, boring, uninteresting. ANT tasty, flavourful; interesting, lively, exciting. *Ex:* The hospital food was insipid.

Insolent ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবিনয়ী — rude and disrespectful. SYN rude, impertinent, impudent, insulting, arrogant. ANT polite, respectful, courteous, humble, civil. *Ex:* The insolent clerk was suspended.

Instigate *(v)* উসকানি দেওয়া — to bring about or provoke an action. SYN provoke, incite, initiate, foment, stir up. ANT stop, prevent, discourage, quell, suppress. *Ex:* He was arrested for instigating the riot.

Intrepid ★ *(adj)* নির্ভীক — fearless; adventurous. SYN fearless, brave, bold, daring, valiant, dauntless. ANT timid, cowardly, fearful, afraid, craven. *Ex:* The intrepid explorer reached the North Pole.

Intricate *(adj)* জটিল — very complicated or detailed. SYN complex, complicated, elaborate, involved, convoluted. ANT simple, plain, straightforward, easy. *Ex:* Nakshi kantha has intricate designs.

Inundate *(v)* প্লাবিত করা — to flood; to overwhelm. SYN flood, deluge, submerge, swamp, overwhelm. ANT drain, dry up, trickle. *Ex:* The office was inundated with complaints.

Invincible *(adj)* অজেয় — too powerful to be defeated. SYN unbeatable, unconquerable, indomitable, invulnerable. ANT beatable, vulnerable, weak, conquerable. *Ex:* The army thought it was invincible.

Irascible GRE *(adj)* বদমেজাজি, খিটখিটে — easily made angry. SYN irritable, short-tempered, testy, choleric, cantankerous. ANT calm, even-tempered, placid, good-natured. *Ex:* The irascible old man shouted at the children.

Irrational *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক — not logical or reasonable. SYN illogical, unreasonable, absurd, senseless, groundless. ANT rational, logical, reasonable, sensible. *Ex:* He has an irrational fear of cats.

Itinerant *(adj)* ভ্রাম্যমাণ, যাযাবর — travelling from place to place. SYN wandering, roving, nomadic, migrant, peripatetic. ANT settled, stationary, resident, sedentary. *Ex:* Baul singers were itinerant musicians.

J

Jaded *(adj)* ক্লান্ত, অবসন্ন — tired or lacking enthusiasm after too much of something. SYN weary, exhausted, bored, sated, world-weary. ANT fresh, eager, enthusiastic, refreshed. *Ex:* After years of routine work, he felt jaded.

Jeopardy *(n)* বিপদ, ঝুঁকি — danger of loss or harm. SYN danger, peril, risk, hazard, threat. ANT safety, security, protection. *Ex:* Many jobs are in jeopardy.

Jocular *(adj)* রসিক, কৌতুকপূর্ণ — fond of joking; humorous. SYN humorous, playful, witty, facetious, jovial. ANT serious, solemn, grave, sober. *Ex:* He was in a jocular mood.

Jovial *(adj)* হাসিখুশি, প্রাণবন্ত — cheerful and friendly. SYN cheerful, jolly, merry, genial, convivial. ANT gloomy, morose, sullen, sad. *Ex:* Our jovial uncle kept everyone laughing.

Jubilant *(adj)* উল্লসিত — feeling great happiness, especially at success. SYN joyful, elated, exultant, triumphant, overjoyed. ANT sad, dejected, despondent, depressed. *Ex:* Jubilant crowds celebrated the victory.

Judicious ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ — having good judgement. SYN wise, prudent, sensible, sagacious, discerning. ANT injudicious, foolish, rash, unwise, imprudent. *Ex:* A judicious use of resources is needed.

K

Keen *(adj)* আগ্রহী; তীক্ষ্ণ — eager; sharp. SYN eager, enthusiastic, avid; sharp, acute, piercing. ANT reluctant, indifferent; blunt, dull. *Ex:* She is keen on learning French.

Kindle *(v)* প্রজ্বলিত করা; জাগিয়ে তোলা — to light a fire; to arouse a feeling. SYN ignite, light; arouse, stir, inspire, provoke. ANT extinguish, quench, douse; dampen, suppress. *Ex:* The teacher kindled our interest in poetry.

Knave *(n)* দুর্বৃত্ত, প্রতারক — a dishonest man. SYN rogue, scoundrel, villain, rascal, cheat. ANT gentleman, hero, saint, honest man. *Ex:* The knave cheated the old woman.

Knack *(n)* দক্ষতা, কৌশল — a special skill or ability. SYN talent, skill, flair, gift, aptitude. ANT inability, ineptitude, incompetence. *Ex:* He has a knack for making friends.

L

Laconic ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, সংক্ষিপ্ত — using very few words. SYN brief, concise, terse, succinct, taciturn. ANT verbose, wordy, garrulous, loquacious, long-winded. *Ex:* His laconic reply was simply "No."

Lament *(v/n)* বিলাপ করা; শোক — to express deep sorrow. SYN mourn, grieve, bewail, deplore; elegy. ANT rejoice, celebrate, exult. *Ex:* The nation lamented the death of the poet.

Languid *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, অলস — slow and relaxed; lacking energy. SYN sluggish, lethargic, listless, lazy, weak. ANT energetic, lively, vigorous, active. *Ex:* The heat made everyone languid.

Lavish ★ *(adj/v)* প্রচুর, অমিতব্যয়ী; অকাতরে দেওয়া — rich and generous; to give freely. SYN sumptuous, luxurious, extravagant, generous; heap, shower. ANT meagre, frugal, simple, sparse; withhold. *Ex:* They held a lavish wedding party.

Lax *(adj)* শিথিল, ঢিলেঢালা — not strict or careful enough. SYN slack, careless, negligent, lenient, loose. ANT strict, rigorous, stringent, careful. *Ex:* Security at the airport was lax.

Legitimate *(adj)* বৈধ, ন্যায্য — lawful; reasonable. SYN legal, lawful, valid, rightful; justifiable, reasonable. ANT illegal, illegitimate, unlawful; unjustified. *Ex:* Workers have legitimate demands.

Lenient ★ *(adj)* নরম, উদার (শাস্তিতে) — merciful or tolerant in punishment. SYN merciful, tolerant, forgiving, clement, indulgent. ANT strict, severe, harsh, stern, rigorous. *Ex:* The judge was lenient with the first-time offender.

Lethargic *(adj)* অলস, নিস্তেজ — sluggish and apathetic. SYN sluggish, listless, lazy, languid, inert. ANT energetic, active, lively, vigorous, dynamic. *Ex:* I felt lethargic after a heavy lunch.

Liberal *(adj)* উদার; উদারপন্থী — generous; open to new ideas. SYN generous, bountiful; tolerant, broad-minded, progressive. ANT mean, stingy; conservative, bigoted, narrow-minded. *Ex:* He holds liberal views on education.

Linger *(v)* দীর্ঘক্ষণ থাকা, বিলম্ব করা — to stay longer than necessary. SYN remain, stay, loiter, dawdle, tarry, persist. ANT leave, depart, hurry, hasten. *Ex:* The smell of smoke lingered in the room.

Lofty *(adj)* সুউচ্চ; মহৎ; উদ্ধত — very tall; noble; haughty. SYN high, towering; noble, exalted, grand; arrogant, haughty. ANT low, short; base, ignoble; humble, modest. *Ex:* He has lofty ideals.

Loquacious ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — very talkative. SYN talkative, garrulous, voluble, chatty, verbose. ANT taciturn, reticent, quiet, laconic, silent. *Ex:* The loquacious taxi driver talked all the way.

Lucid ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্ট, প্রাঞ্জল — easy to understand; clear. SYN clear, intelligible, plain, transparent, comprehensible. ANT obscure, confusing, vague, unclear, ambiguous. *Ex:* The book explains grammar in lucid language.

Lucrative ★ *(adj)* লাভজনক — producing a great deal of profit. SYN profitable, gainful, remunerative, rewarding, fruitful. ANT unprofitable, unrewarding, loss-making. *Ex:* Shrimp farming is a lucrative business.

Ludicrous *(adj)* হাস্যকর — so foolish as to be amusing. SYN absurd, ridiculous, preposterous, laughable, farcical. ANT sensible, reasonable, logical, serious. *Ex:* It is ludicrous to charge 500 taka for a cup of tea.

Luminous *(adj)* উজ্জ্বল, দীপ্তিমান — giving off light; very bright. SYN bright, shining, radiant, glowing, brilliant. ANT dark, dim, dull, shadowy, gloomy. *Ex:* The watch has a luminous dial.

Lurid *(adj)* ভয়ংকর; অতি উজ্জ্বল — shocking and sensational; unpleasantly bright. SYN sensational, graphic, shocking; garish, glaring. ANT mild, restrained; pale, dull. *Ex:* The newspaper printed lurid details of the murder.

Luxuriant *(adj)* ঘন ও প্রচুর — (of vegetation or hair) rich and plentiful. SYN lush, abundant, profuse, dense, thick. ANT sparse, thin, scanty, barren. *Ex:* The forest has luxuriant vegetation. (Do not confuse with *luxurious* = expensive and comfortable.)

M

Magnanimous ★ *(adj)* মহানুভব, উদারচিত্ত — generous or forgiving, especially towards a rival. SYN generous, noble, big-hearted, charitable, benevolent. ANT mean, petty, selfish, vindictive, small-minded. *Ex:* He was magnanimous in victory.

Magnificent *(adj)* চমৎকার, জাঁকালো — impressively beautiful or grand. SYN splendid, grand, superb, majestic, glorious. ANT modest, ordinary, poor, unimpressive. *Ex:* The Taj Mahal is a magnificent monument.

Malevolent *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপূর্ণ — wishing evil to others. SYN malicious, spiteful, hostile, vindictive, malignant. ANT benevolent, kind, friendly, well-meaning. *Ex:* He gave me a malevolent stare.

Malicious *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপরায়ণ — intending to do harm. SYN spiteful, malevolent, vicious, hateful, mean. ANT kind, benevolent, friendly, good-natured. *Ex:* Spreading malicious rumours is a crime.

Malign *(v/adj)* নিন্দা করা; ক্ষতিকর — to speak badly of; harmful. SYN slander, defame, vilify, disparage; evil, harmful. ANT praise, defend, extol; benign, kind. *Ex:* Do not malign a person behind his back.

Malleable GRE *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — able to be shaped; easily influenced. SYN pliable, ductile, soft; impressionable, tractable, flexible. ANT rigid, hard, brittle; intractable, stubborn. *Ex:* Gold is a malleable metal.

Mammoth *(adj)* বিশাল — huge. SYN huge, giant, enormous, colossal, gigantic. ANT tiny, small, minute, minuscule. *Ex:* Building the Padma Bridge was a mammoth task.

Mandatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by law or rules. SYN compulsory, obligatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, discretionary, elective. *Ex:* Wearing a helmet is mandatory for motorcyclists.

Manifest *(adj/v)* স্পষ্ট; প্রকাশ করা — clear and obvious; to show. SYN obvious, clear, evident, apparent, patent; display, reveal. ANT hidden, latent, obscure; conceal, hide. *Ex:* His guilt was manifest.

Meagre ★ *(adj)* স্বল্প, অপর্যাপ্ত — lacking in quantity or quality. SYN scanty, insufficient, inadequate, paltry, sparse. ANT abundant, ample, plentiful, copious, generous. *Ex:* He lives on a meagre income.

Meek *(adj)* নম্র, শান্ত — quiet, gentle and easily imposed on. SYN humble, docile, submissive, mild, gentle. ANT assertive, bold, arrogant, aggressive. *Ex:* Blessed are the meek.

Mendacious GRE *(adj)* মিথ্যাবাদী — not telling the truth. SYN lying, untruthful, dishonest, deceitful, false. ANT truthful, honest, sincere, veracious. *Ex:* The mendacious advertisement misled buyers.

Mercenary *(adj/n)* অর্থলোভী; ভাড়াটে সৈন্য — working only for money; a hired soldier. SYN greedy, venal, grasping, money-minded. ANT altruistic, unselfish, generous, idealistic. *Ex:* His motives are purely mercenary.

Meticulous ★ *(adj)* অতি যত্নশীল, খুঁটিনাটি বিষয়ে মনোযোগী — showing great attention to detail. SYN careful, precise, painstaking, scrupulous, thorough. ANT careless, sloppy, slapdash, negligent. *Ex:* She keeps meticulous records.

Mitigate ★ *(v)* প্রশমিত করা — to make less severe. SYN alleviate, reduce, lessen, ease, allay, palliate. ANT aggravate, intensify, worsen, exacerbate. *Ex:* Planting trees helps mitigate climate change.

Modest ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; পরিমিত — not boastful; moderate. SYN humble, unassuming, unpretentious; moderate, limited. ANT arrogant, boastful, vain; excessive, lavish. *Ex:* She is modest about her achievements.

Mollify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN pacify, placate, appease, soothe, calm. ANT provoke, enrage, anger, incite. *Ex:* The apology mollified the angry customer.

Monotonous *(adj)* একঘেয়ে — dull because unchanging. SYN boring, tedious, dull, repetitive, humdrum. ANT interesting, varied, exciting, lively. *Ex:* Factory work can be monotonous.

Morose *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গোমড়ামুখো — sullen and ill-tempered. SYN sullen, gloomy, glum, sulky, moody. ANT cheerful, happy, jovial, genial. *Ex:* He became morose after losing his job.

Mundane *(adj)* জাগতিক; সাধারণ — ordinary and dull; worldly. SYN ordinary, routine, commonplace, humdrum; worldly, earthly. ANT extraordinary, exciting, unusual; spiritual, heavenly. *Ex:* She was tired of mundane household chores.

Munificent GRE *(adj)* অতি উদার, দানশীল — very generous. SYN generous, bountiful, liberal, lavish, philanthropic. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, parsimonious. *Ex:* The munificent donor funded the whole library.

Myriad *(adj/n)* অসংখ্য — countless; a very great number. SYN countless, innumerable, numerous, multitudinous. ANT few, limited, scant. *Ex:* The night sky has myriad stars.

N

Naive *(adj)* সরল, অনভিজ্ঞ — lacking experience or judgement. SYN innocent, ingenuous, gullible, credulous, unsophisticated. ANT sophisticated, worldly, experienced, shrewd. *Ex:* It is naive to believe every news on Facebook.

Nadir *(n)* নিম্নতম বিন্দু — the lowest point. SYN bottom, lowest point, depths, rock bottom. ANT zenith, peak, acme, summit, apex. *Ex:* His career reached its nadir after the scandal.

Nascent GRE *(adj)* নবজাত, উদীয়মান — just coming into existence. SYN emerging, budding, developing, incipient, embryonic. ANT mature, developed, established, dying. *Ex:* The nascent democracy faced many challenges.

Nefarious *(adj)* জঘন্য, দুষ্ট — wicked or criminal. SYN wicked, evil, villainous, heinous, iniquitous. ANT good, virtuous, honourable, noble. *Ex:* The gang was involved in nefarious activities.

Negligent *(adj)* অবহেলাকারী — failing to take proper care. SYN careless, neglectful, remiss, lax, heedless. ANT careful, attentive, diligent, conscientious. *Ex:* The negligent driver caused the accident.

Nimble *(adj)* চটপটে — quick and light in movement or thought. SYN agile, quick, deft, sprightly, alert. ANT clumsy, slow, sluggish, awkward. *Ex:* Her nimble fingers wove the mat quickly.

Nocturnal *(adj)* নিশাচর — active at night. SYN nightly, night-time, nighttime-active. ANT diurnal, daily, daytime. *Ex:* The owl is a nocturnal bird.

Notorious ★ *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — famous for something bad. SYN infamous, disreputable, scandalous, ill-famed. ANT reputable, honourable, respected, acclaimed. *Ex:* He is a notorious criminal.

Novice ★ *(n)* শিক্ষানবিশ, আনাড়ি — a beginner. SYN beginner, learner, apprentice, tyro, neophyte, novitiate. ANT expert, veteran, master, professional. *Ex:* This book is written for novices in grammar.

Noxious *(adj)* বিষাক্ত, ক্ষতিকর — harmful or poisonous. SYN poisonous, toxic, harmful, deadly, pernicious. ANT harmless, wholesome, beneficial, innocuous. *Ex:* The factory releases noxious fumes.

Nullify *(v)* বাতিল করা — to make legally void; to cancel out. SYN annul, cancel, invalidate, revoke, negate. ANT validate, confirm, enforce, ratify. *Ex:* The court nullified the election result.

O

Obdurate GRE *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে, কঠোরহৃদয় — stubbornly refusing to change. SYN stubborn, obstinate, unyielding, inflexible, intransigent. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, amenable. *Ex:* The obdurate official refused every request.

Obese *(adj)* স্থূলকায় — very fat. SYN fat, overweight, corpulent, portly, stout. ANT thin, slim, lean, skinny, emaciated. *Ex:* Fast food is making children obese.

Obligatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by rule or custom. SYN compulsory, mandatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, elective. *Ex:* Attendance at the seminar is obligatory.

Obscure ★ *(adj/v)* অস্পষ্ট; অখ্যাত; ঢেকে দেওয়া — not clear; not well known; to hide. SYN unclear, vague, cryptic; unknown, little-known; conceal, cloud. ANT clear, plain; famous, eminent; reveal, clarify. *Ex:* He was born in an obscure village.

Obsequious GRE *(adj)* চাটুকারপূর্ণ, তোষামুদে — too eager to please or obey. SYN servile, sycophantic, fawning, ingratiating, subservient. ANT domineering, assertive, arrogant, independent. *Ex:* The obsequious clerk bowed to every officer.

Obsolete ★ *(adj)* অপ্রচলিত, সেকেলে — no longer used; out of date. SYN outdated, outmoded, antiquated, archaic, defunct. ANT current, modern, contemporary, new, in use. *Ex:* Typewriters are now obsolete.

Obstinate ★ *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে — stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion. SYN stubborn, headstrong, obdurate, mulish, pig-headed, adamant. ANT flexible, compliant, docile, amenable, tractable. *Ex:* The obstinate child refused to eat.

Obstruct *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to block; to hinder. SYN block, impede, hinder, hamper, bar. ANT clear, open, assist, facilitate, help. *Ex:* Illegal shops obstruct the footpaths.

Obtuse *(adj)* স্থূলবুদ্ধি; স্থূল (কোণ) — slow to understand; (of an angle) more than 90°. SYN stupid, slow, dull, dense, imperceptive. ANT bright, sharp, acute, perceptive, astute. *Ex:* He was too obtuse to see the joke.

Ominous *(adj)* অশুভ — giving the impression that something bad will happen. SYN threatening, menacing, sinister, foreboding, inauspicious. ANT auspicious, promising, favourable, propitious. *Ex:* Ominous dark clouds gathered in the sky.

Omnipotent *(adj)* সর্বশক্তিমান — having unlimited power. SYN all-powerful, almighty, supreme, invincible. ANT powerless, impotent, weak, helpless. *Ex:* Muslims believe Allah is omnipotent.

Omniscient *(adj)* সর্বজ্ঞ — knowing everything. SYN all-knowing, all-seeing, all-wise. ANT ignorant, unknowing, uninformed. *Ex:* The novel has an omniscient narrator.

Onerous *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, ভারী (দায়িত্ব) — involving heavy effort or difficulty. SYN burdensome, arduous, laborious, heavy, taxing. ANT easy, light, effortless, simple, trivial. *Ex:* Running a big family is an onerous task.

Opaque *(adj)* অস্বচ্ছ; দুর্বোধ্য — not able to be seen through; hard to understand. SYN non-transparent, cloudy; obscure, unclear, impenetrable. ANT transparent, clear, translucent; lucid, plain. *Ex:* The decision-making process is opaque.

Optimistic *(adj)* আশাবাদী — hopeful about the future. SYN hopeful, positive, sanguine, confident, upbeat. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despairing, cynical. *Ex:* We are optimistic about our economic growth.

Opulent *(adj)* ঐশ্বর্যশালী, জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — rich and luxurious. SYN luxurious, lavish, sumptuous, affluent, wealthy. ANT poor, impoverished, humble, shabby, austere. *Ex:* The Nawab lived in an opulent palace.

Ostensible *(adj)* বাহ্যিক, আপাত — stated or appearing to be true, but not necessarily so. SYN apparent, outward, seeming, professed, supposed. ANT real, actual, genuine, true. *Ex:* The ostensible reason for the visit was trade.

Ostentatious ★ GRE *(adj)* জাঁকালো, লোক-দেখানো — showy, designed to impress. SYN showy, flamboyant, pretentious, flashy, extravagant. ANT modest, simple, unpretentious, restrained, plain. *Ex:* Their ostentatious wedding was criticised.

Ostracise *(v)* একঘরে করা — to exclude from a society or group. SYN exclude, banish, shun, boycott, exile. ANT include, accept, welcome, embrace. *Ex:* The villagers ostracised the family.

Outrageous *(adj)* অত্যন্ত আপত্তিকর — shockingly bad or excessive. SYN shocking, scandalous, atrocious, monstrous, exorbitant. ANT acceptable, reasonable, moderate, mild. *Ex:* The price of medicine is outrageous.

P

Pacify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN calm, soothe, appease, placate, mollify. ANT enrage, provoke, anger, agitate. *Ex:* The mother pacified the crying baby.

Palpable *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য; স্পষ্ট — able to be touched or felt; obvious. SYN tangible, touchable; obvious, evident, clear, manifest. ANT intangible, impalpable; unclear, hidden. *Ex:* There was palpable tension in the room.

Paltry *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — (of an amount) very small; worthless. SYN meagre, trifling, negligible, insignificant, petty. ANT considerable, substantial, large, significant. *Ex:* Workers are paid a paltry wage.

Panacea GRE *(n)* সর্বরোগহর ঔষধ — a solution for all problems. SYN cure-all, remedy, universal solution, elixir. ANT poison, bane, affliction. *Ex:* Education is not a panacea for all social ills.

Paradox *(n)* আপাতবিরোধী সত্য — a statement that seems absurd but may be true. SYN contradiction, anomaly, inconsistency, enigma, puzzle. ANT consistency, truism, certainty. *Ex:* "The child is father of the man" is a paradox.

Paragon *(n)* আদর্শ, উৎকৃষ্ট দৃষ্টান্ত — a perfect example of a quality. SYN model, ideal, epitome, exemplar, archetype. ANT failure, disgrace, mediocrity. *Ex:* He is a paragon of honesty.

Parsimonious GRE *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend money; extremely frugal. SYN stingy, miserly, mean, tight-fisted, niggardly, penurious. ANT generous, extravagant, lavish, munificent, liberal. *Ex:* The parsimonious man refused to buy new shoes.

Partisan *(adj/n)* পক্ষপাতদুষ্ট; দলীয় সমর্থক — strongly supporting a party; biased. SYN biased, partial, one-sided, prejudiced; supporter, adherent. ANT impartial, neutral, unbiased, objective. *Ex:* The media should not be partisan.

Paucity ★ *(n)* স্বল্পতা, অভাব — the presence of something in small quantities. SYN scarcity, dearth, shortage, lack, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus. *Ex:* The research was weak due to a paucity of data.

Peevish *(adj)* খিটখিটে — easily irritated. SYN irritable, petulant, cross, grumpy, testy. ANT good-natured, easy-going, cheerful, genial. *Ex:* The sick child was peevish all day.

Penitent *(adj)* অনুতপ্ত — feeling sorry for wrongdoing. SYN repentant, remorseful, contrite, regretful, apologetic. ANT unrepentant, impenitent, remorseless, defiant. *Ex:* The penitent thief returned the money.

Pensive *(adj)* চিন্তামগ্ন — engaged in deep, often sad, thought. SYN thoughtful, reflective, contemplative, meditative, wistful. ANT thoughtless, carefree, unthinking, shallow. *Ex:* She sat in a pensive mood by the river.

Penury *(n)* চরম দারিদ্র্য — extreme poverty. SYN poverty, destitution, indigence, want, need. ANT wealth, affluence, opulence, prosperity, luxury. *Ex:* The poet died in penury.

Perennial *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী; বহুবর্ষজীবী — lasting a very long time; (of plants) living several years. SYN lasting, enduring, perpetual, constant, everlasting. ANT temporary, ephemeral, transient, annual. *Ex:* Traffic jams are a perennial problem in Dhaka.

Perfidious GRE *(adj)* বিশ্বাসঘাতক — deceitful and untrustworthy. SYN treacherous, disloyal, faithless, traitorous, false. ANT loyal, faithful, trustworthy, true. *Ex:* Mir Jafar's perfidious act led to the fall of Bengal.

Perfunctory GRE *(adj)* দায়সারা — carried out with minimum effort or care. SYN cursory, superficial, careless, hasty, token. ANT thorough, careful, painstaking, meticulous. *Ex:* The guard gave our bags a perfunctory check.

Peripheral *(adj)* প্রান্তিক, গৌণ — on the edge; of minor importance. SYN marginal, outer, minor, secondary, incidental. ANT central, core, main, essential, crucial. *Ex:* These are peripheral issues; let us focus on the main one.

Pernicious ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, সর্বনাশা — having a harmful effect, especially gradually. SYN harmful, destructive, deleterious, damaging, baneful. ANT beneficial, harmless, benign, wholesome. *Ex:* Corruption has a pernicious effect on society.

Perpetual *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী, অবিরাম — never ending or changing. SYN everlasting, eternal, permanent, continual, unending. ANT temporary, momentary, transient, brief. *Ex:* The Permanent Settlement made zamindari perpetual.

Perplex *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা — to make someone confused. SYN puzzle, baffle, bewilder, confuse, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The question perplexed even the teacher.

Persevere *(v)* অধ্যবসায় চালিয়ে যাওয়া — to continue despite difficulty. SYN persist, continue, carry on, keep going, endure. ANT give up, quit, abandon, desist, falter. *Ex:* If you persevere, you will succeed.

Pertinent *(adj)* প্রাসঙ্গিক — relevant to the subject. SYN relevant, applicable, apposite, germane, apt. ANT irrelevant, inapplicable, unrelated, extraneous. *Ex:* She asked a very pertinent question.

Pessimistic *(adj)* নৈরাশ্যবাদী — expecting the worst. SYN gloomy, negative, cynical, despairing, defeatist. ANT optimistic, hopeful, positive, sanguine. *Ex:* Don't be so pessimistic about the result.

Philanthropist *(n)* জনহিতৈষী, মানবপ্রেমী — a person who helps others, especially by donating money. SYN benefactor, humanitarian, patron, donor, altruist. ANT misanthrope, miser, egoist. *Ex:* Haji Muhammad Mohsin was a great philanthropist.

Placid *(adj)* শান্ত, স্থির — calm and peaceful. SYN calm, tranquil, serene, peaceful, unruffled. ANT agitated, excitable, turbulent, stormy. *Ex:* The placid lake reflected the hills.

Plausible *(adj)* আপাতগ্রাহ্য, বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — seeming reasonable or probable. SYN credible, believable, reasonable, likely, convincing. ANT implausible, unlikely, improbable, unbelievable. *Ex:* He offered a plausible explanation.

Plethora GRE *(n)* প্রাচুর্য, আধিক্য — an excess of something. SYN excess, surplus, glut, surfeit, abundance. ANT shortage, lack, scarcity, dearth, paucity. *Ex:* There is a plethora of coaching centres in Dhaka.

Pliable *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — easily bent; easily influenced. SYN flexible, pliant, malleable, supple; docile, compliant. ANT rigid, stiff, inflexible; stubborn, obstinate. *Ex:* Cane is pliable and good for furniture.

Pompous *(adj)* দাম্ভিক, আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ — self-important; grand but solemn. SYN self-important, pretentious, arrogant, conceited, bombastic. ANT modest, humble, unpretentious, simple. *Ex:* The pompous officer liked to hear himself talk.

Ponderous *(adj)* ভারী; একঘেয়ে — slow and clumsy because of great weight; dull. SYN heavy, cumbersome, unwieldy; laboured, dull, tedious. ANT light, graceful; lively, interesting. *Ex:* The essay was written in a ponderous style.

Potent *(adj)* শক্তিশালী — having great power or effect. SYN powerful, strong, effective, forceful, mighty. ANT impotent, weak, ineffective, powerless. *Ex:* This is a potent medicine.

Pragmatic ★ *(adj)* বাস্তববাদী — dealing with things sensibly and realistically. SYN practical, realistic, sensible, matter-of-fact, down-to-earth. ANT idealistic, impractical, unrealistic, romantic. *Ex:* We need a pragmatic solution to the traffic problem.

Precarious *(adj)* অনিশ্চিত, বিপজ্জনক — not secure; dangerously likely to fall. SYN insecure, unstable, risky, perilous, shaky. ANT secure, stable, safe, steady. *Ex:* Many day labourers live a precarious life.

Precocious *(adj)* অকালপক্ব — (of a child) developed earlier than usual. SYN advanced, gifted, mature, forward, talented. ANT backward, slow, retarded, immature. *Ex:* The precocious child could read at three.

Prejudice *(n)* কুসংস্কার, পূর্বধারণা — an unfair opinion not based on reason. SYN bias, partiality, preconception, bigotry, intolerance. ANT fairness, impartiality, tolerance, objectivity. *Ex:* We must fight racial prejudice.

Prevalent *(adj)* প্রচলিত, ব্যাপক — widespread in a particular area or time. SYN widespread, common, prevailing, current, rampant. ANT rare, uncommon, infrequent, scarce. *Ex:* Dengue is prevalent during the monsoon.

Prodigal ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — wasteful with money. SYN wasteful, extravagant, spendthrift, profligate, improvident. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, careful, prudent. *Ex:* The prodigal son wasted his father's wealth.

Prodigious *(adj)* বিস্ময়কর, বিশাল — remarkably great in size or degree. SYN enormous, huge, colossal; amazing, phenomenal, extraordinary. ANT tiny, small; ordinary, unremarkable. *Ex:* She has a prodigious memory.

Profane *(adj/v)* অপবিত্র; অপবিত্র করা — not religious; disrespectful to sacred things. SYN secular, irreverent, blasphemous; desecrate, defile. ANT sacred, holy, religious; sanctify, consecrate. *Ex:* He was punished for using profane language.

Proficient *(adj)* দক্ষ — competent or skilled. SYN skilled, expert, adept, accomplished, competent. ANT incompetent, inept, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is proficient in three languages.

Profound ★ *(adj)* গভীর — very great; showing deep knowledge. SYN deep, intense, great; wise, learned, philosophical. ANT shallow, superficial, slight, trivial. *Ex:* Tagore's poems have profound meaning.

Profuse *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant; plentiful. SYN abundant, copious, plentiful, lavish, prolific. ANT scanty, meagre, sparse, scarce. *Ex:* He offered profuse apologies.

Prolific ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর সৃষ্টিশীল, উর্বর — producing much fruit or many works. SYN productive, fertile, fruitful, abundant, creative. ANT unproductive, barren, sterile, unfruitful. *Ex:* Humayun Ahmed was a prolific writer.

Prompt *(adj/v)* তৎপর; প্ররোচিত করা — done without delay; to cause or encourage. SYN quick, immediate, punctual, swift; prompt, induce, provoke. ANT late, slow, tardy, delayed; deter. *Ex:* Thank you for your prompt reply.

Propagate *(v)* প্রচার করা; বংশবিস্তার করা — to spread an idea; to breed. SYN spread, disseminate, promote, circulate; breed, reproduce. ANT suppress, restrict, conceal; kill, destroy. *Ex:* They tried to propagate false news.

Propitious GRE *(adj)* অনুকূল, শুভ — giving or indicating a good chance of success. SYN favourable, auspicious, promising, advantageous, opportune. ANT unfavourable, inauspicious, ominous, adverse. *Ex:* It is a propitious time to invest.

Prosaic *(adj)* নীরস, গদ্যময় — lacking imagination or poetic beauty. SYN dull, ordinary, unimaginative, mundane, humdrum. ANT imaginative, poetic, interesting, exciting. *Ex:* He gave a prosaic description of a beautiful sunset.

Prosperity *(n)* সমৃদ্ধি — the state of being successful, especially financially. SYN wealth, affluence, success, riches, opulence. ANT poverty, adversity, failure, misfortune, penury. *Ex:* We wish for peace and prosperity.

Prudent ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, বিবেচক — acting with care for the future. SYN wise, judicious, sensible, careful, circumspect, provident. ANT imprudent, rash, foolish, reckless, careless. *Ex:* It is prudent to save money for bad days.

Pugnacious GRE *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয়, ঝগড়াটে — eager to argue or fight. SYN combative, belligerent, aggressive, quarrelsome, bellicose. ANT peaceful, peaceable, conciliatory, mild. *Ex:* The pugnacious player was sent off.

Punctual *(adj)* সময়ানুবর্তী — happening or doing things at the agreed time. SYN on time, prompt, timely, regular. ANT late, tardy, unpunctual, delayed. *Ex:* Be punctual for the interview.

Pungent *(adj)* ঝাঁঝালো, তীক্ষ্ণ — having a sharp, strong taste or smell; biting. SYN strong, sharp, acrid, spicy; caustic, biting. ANT mild, bland, sweet; gentle. *Ex:* Mustard oil has a pungent smell.

Q

Quaint *(adj)* অদ্ভুত সুন্দর, সেকেলে আকর্ষণীয় — attractively unusual or old-fashioned. SYN charming, picturesque, old-fashioned, curious, unusual. ANT modern, ordinary, normal, commonplace. *Ex:* They stayed in a quaint old cottage.

Qualm *(n)* দ্বিধা, অস্বস্তি — an uneasy feeling of doubt or guilt. SYN misgiving, doubt, scruple, hesitation, unease. ANT confidence, certainty, assurance. *Ex:* He had no qualms about lying.

Quarrelsome *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয় — inclined to argue. SYN argumentative, belligerent, pugnacious, contentious, combative. ANT peaceful, peaceable, easy-going, friendly. *Ex:* The quarrelsome neighbour fought with everyone.

Quell *(v)* দমন করা — to put an end to a rebellion or disorder; to calm a fear. SYN suppress, crush, quash, subdue; allay, calm. ANT incite, provoke, encourage, foment, stir up. *Ex:* The police quelled the riot.

Querulous GRE *(adj)* খিটখিটে, অভিযোগপ্রবণ — complaining in a whining manner. SYN complaining, peevish, petulant, irritable, fretful. ANT contented, uncomplaining, cheerful, easy-going. *Ex:* The querulous patient annoyed the nurses.

Quiescent GRE *(adj)* নিষ্ক্রিয়, শান্ত — in a state of inactivity. SYN inactive, dormant, latent, passive, still. ANT active, busy, agitated, dynamic. *Ex:* The disease was quiescent for years.

Quixotic GRE *(adj)* অবাস্তব আদর্শবাদী — extremely idealistic and impractical. SYN idealistic, unrealistic, romantic, visionary, impractical. ANT practical, realistic, pragmatic, sensible. *Ex:* His plan to end poverty in a year was quixotic.

R

Rampant *(adj)* ব্যাপক, অনিয়ন্ত্রিত — (of something bad) flourishing and spreading unchecked. SYN widespread, unchecked, uncontrolled, rife, prevalent. ANT controlled, restrained, limited, rare. *Ex:* Corruption is rampant in some offices.

Rancour *(n)* বিদ্বেষ, তিক্ততা — bitterness or resentment, especially long-lasting. SYN bitterness, resentment, malice, animosity, spite. ANT goodwill, friendship, harmony, kindness. *Ex:* He spoke without rancour about his rivals.

Rapacious GRE *(adj)* লোভী, লুণ্ঠনপ্রবণ — aggressively greedy. SYN greedy, grasping, avaricious, predatory, voracious. ANT generous, unselfish, content, liberal. *Ex:* The rapacious landlord raised the rent again.

Rash *(adj)* হঠকারী — acting without careful thought. SYN reckless, hasty, impulsive, impetuous, foolhardy. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, considered. *Ex:* Don't take a rash decision.

Ravage *(v)* ধ্বংস করা — to cause severe damage. SYN devastate, destroy, ruin, wreck, despoil. ANT build, repair, restore, preserve. *Ex:* The cyclone ravaged the coastal area.

Rebuke *(v/n)* তিরস্কার করা — to express sharp disapproval. SYN reprimand, scold, reproach, admonish, chide. ANT praise, commend, compliment, approve. *Ex:* The boss rebuked him for being late.

Recalcitrant GRE *(adj)* অবাধ্য, একগুঁয়ে — uncooperative towards authority. SYN defiant, disobedient, intractable, unruly, refractory. ANT obedient, compliant, docile, amenable. *Ex:* The recalcitrant student refused to wear the uniform.

Reckless *(adj)* বেপরোয়া — without thinking about danger. SYN rash, careless, heedless, foolhardy, daredevil. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, wary. *Ex:* Reckless driving causes accidents.

Reconcile *(v)* মিলন ঘটানো, সামঞ্জস্য করা — to restore friendly relations; to make compatible. SYN reunite, conciliate, pacify; harmonise, square. ANT estrange, alienate, divide, separate. *Ex:* The brothers were finally reconciled.

Redundant *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাহুল্য — no longer needed; unnecessary. SYN superfluous, unnecessary, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, needed, required. *Ex:* Remove the redundant words from the sentence. (See Chapter 38.)

Refute *(v)* খণ্ডন করা — to prove a statement to be wrong. SYN disprove, rebut, deny, negate, invalidate. ANT prove, confirm, support, verify. *Ex:* The scientist refuted the old theory.

Relinquish ★ *(v)* ছেড়ে দেওয়া — to give up voluntarily. SYN give up, abandon, surrender, renounce, cede, waive. ANT retain, keep, hold, maintain, seize. *Ex:* He relinquished his claim to the property.

Remorse *(n)* অনুশোচনা — deep regret for a wrong committed. SYN regret, repentance, contrition, guilt, penitence. ANT indifference, satisfaction, pride, shamelessness. *Ex:* The killer showed no remorse.

Renounce *(v)* ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up. SYN give up, relinquish, abandon, forgo, abdicate. ANT claim, keep, retain, assert, embrace. *Ex:* Buddha renounced worldly pleasures.

Replenish *(v)* পুনরায় পূর্ণ করা — to fill up again. SYN refill, restock, top up, renew, restore. ANT empty, drain, deplete, exhaust. *Ex:* Rain replenishes the ponds.

Reprimand *(v/n)* ভর্ৎসনা করা — to rebuke formally. SYN rebuke, reproach, scold, admonish, censure. ANT praise, commend, applaud, compliment. *Ex:* The officer was reprimanded for negligence.

Repudiate *(v)* প্রত্যাখ্যান করা, অস্বীকার করা — to refuse to accept or be associated with. SYN reject, disown, renounce, deny, disavow. ANT accept, acknowledge, embrace, endorse. *Ex:* He repudiated the allegations.

Resilient *(adj)* স্থিতিস্থাপক, সহনশীল — able to recover quickly from difficulties. SYN tough, strong, hardy, buoyant, adaptable. ANT vulnerable, weak, fragile, delicate. *Ex:* The people of the coastal belt are resilient.

Reticent ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, চাপা স্বভাবের — not revealing one's thoughts readily. SYN reserved, taciturn, quiet, uncommunicative, restrained. ANT talkative, communicative, open, loquacious, garrulous. *Ex:* She was reticent about her personal life.

Revere *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to respect deeply. SYN respect, venerate, admire, honour, worship. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, disdain. *Ex:* Nazrul is revered as our national poet.

Robust ★ *(adj)* বলিষ্ঠ, শক্তিশালী — strong and healthy; strongly built. SYN strong, sturdy, vigorous, healthy, hardy. ANT weak, frail, feeble, delicate, sickly. *Ex:* The country needs a robust economy.

Rudimentary *(adj)* প্রাথমিক, মৌলিক — involving only basic matters; undeveloped. SYN basic, elementary, fundamental, primitive, crude. ANT advanced, sophisticated, developed, complex. *Ex:* He has only a rudimentary knowledge of computers.

Ruthless *(adj)* নির্দয় — without pity or compassion. SYN merciless, pitiless, cruel, heartless, brutal. ANT merciful, compassionate, kind, humane, lenient. *Ex:* The dictator was ruthless towards his opponents.

S

Sagacious GRE *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, প্রাজ্ঞ — having good judgement; wise. SYN wise, shrewd, astute, perceptive, judicious. ANT foolish, unwise, stupid, obtuse. *Ex:* We need a sagacious leader in times of crisis.

Salient *(adj)* প্রধান, উল্লেখযোগ্য — most noticeable or important. SYN main, chief, prominent, striking, principal, conspicuous. ANT minor, insignificant, inconspicuous, peripheral. *Ex:* Write the salient features of the budget.

Salubrious GRE *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর — health-giving; pleasant. SYN healthy, wholesome, beneficial, salutary, invigorating. ANT unhealthy, insalubrious, harmful, noxious. *Ex:* The hill tracts have a salubrious climate.

Sanguine GRE *(adj)* আশাবাদী — optimistic, especially in a bad situation. SYN optimistic, hopeful, confident, positive, buoyant. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despondent, hopeless. *Ex:* He is sanguine about his chances of winning.

Sarcastic *(adj)* ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — using irony to mock or show contempt. SYN ironic, sardonic, mocking, caustic, satirical. ANT sincere, kind, complimentary, respectful. *Ex:* His sarcastic comments hurt her.

Scanty ★ *(adj)* অপ্রতুল, অল্প — small or insufficient in quantity. SYN meagre, sparse, insufficient, inadequate, scant. ANT abundant, plentiful, ample, copious, sufficient. *Ex:* Rainfall was scanty this year.

Scrupulous *(adj)* নীতিনিষ্ঠ; অতি যত্নশীল — careful about doing what is right; very thorough. SYN honest, principled, conscientious; meticulous, careful. ANT unscrupulous, dishonest; careless, slapdash. *Ex:* She is scrupulous in her accounts.

Scrutinise *(v)* সূক্ষ্মভাবে পরীক্ষা করা — to examine closely. SYN examine, inspect, study, analyse, investigate. ANT ignore, overlook, glance at, skim. *Ex:* The examiner scrutinised the documents.

Sedate *(adj/v)* শান্ত, ধীরস্থির; ঘুমের ঔষধ দেওয়া — calm and unhurried; to calm with drugs. SYN calm, composed, serene, staid, dignified. ANT excited, agitated, wild, lively. *Ex:* We walked at a sedate pace.

Serene *(adj)* শান্ত, প্রশান্ত — calm, peaceful and untroubled. SYN calm, tranquil, peaceful, placid, composed. ANT agitated, turbulent, stormy, troubled, noisy. *Ex:* The village looked serene in the moonlight.

Servile *(adj)* দাসসুলভ, হীন — too willing to serve or please others. SYN obsequious, subservient, sycophantic, fawning, submissive. ANT independent, assertive, proud, domineering. *Ex:* His servile attitude towards the boss was disgusting.

Shrewd *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — having sharp judgement. SYN astute, sharp, clever, canny, perceptive. ANT foolish, naive, stupid, gullible. *Ex:* He is a shrewd businessman.

Sinister *(adj)* অশুভ, অমঙ্গলজনক — giving the impression that something harmful will happen. SYN menacing, threatening, ominous, evil, malevolent. ANT auspicious, benign, harmless, favourable. *Ex:* There was something sinister about the stranger.

Slander *(n/v)* অপবাদ, কুৎসা — a false spoken statement damaging a person's reputation. SYN defamation, calumny, libel, vilification; defame, malign. ANT praise, commendation; extol, eulogise. *Ex:* He sued the newspaper for slander.

Sluggish *(adj)* মন্থর, ধীর — slow-moving; inactive. SYN slow, lethargic, inactive, lazy, torpid. ANT quick, active, brisk, energetic, lively. *Ex:* Exports were sluggish last quarter.

Solace *(n)* সান্ত্বনা — comfort in distress. SYN comfort, consolation, relief, support, succour. ANT distress, misery, torment, agony. *Ex:* Music was his only solace.

Sombre *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গম্ভীর; গাঢ় — dark; serious and sad. SYN dark, dull, drab; gloomy, grave, solemn, melancholy. ANT bright, colourful; cheerful, happy, joyful. *Ex:* The mood at the funeral was sombre.

Soporific GRE *(adj)* ঘুম পাড়ানো — tending to cause sleep. SYN sleep-inducing, sedative, hypnotic; boring, tedious. ANT stimulating, invigorating, exciting. *Ex:* The lecture was soporific.

Spontaneous *(adj)* স্বতঃস্ফূর্ত — done without planning; natural. SYN unplanned, impromptu, natural, voluntary, instinctive. ANT planned, deliberate, forced, contrived. *Ex:* The crowd gave a spontaneous round of applause.

Sporadic ★ *(adj)* বিক্ষিপ্ত, মাঝে মাঝে ঘটে এমন — occurring at irregular intervals. SYN occasional, intermittent, scattered, irregular, infrequent. ANT constant, regular, continuous, frequent, incessant. *Ex:* There were sporadic clashes in the city.

Spurious *(adj)* জাল, নকল — false or fake. SYN fake, false, counterfeit, bogus, forged. ANT genuine, authentic, real, true. *Ex:* Spurious medicines are a threat to public health.

Squander ★ *(v)* অপচয় করা — to waste money or time carelessly. SYN waste, fritter away, misspend, dissipate, lavish. ANT save, conserve, hoard, economise, husband. *Ex:* He squandered his inheritance on gambling.

Stagnant *(adj)* বদ্ধ; স্থবির — not flowing; showing no activity. SYN still, motionless, standing; inactive, static, sluggish. ANT flowing, moving; active, growing, dynamic. *Ex:* Mosquitoes breed in stagnant water.

Steadfast *(adj)* অটল, স্থির — resolutely firm and unwavering. SYN firm, resolute, constant, loyal, unwavering. ANT wavering, fickle, inconstant, disloyal. *Ex:* She remained steadfast in her beliefs.

Stingy *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend or give. SYN miserly, mean, tight-fisted, parsimonious, niggardly. ANT generous, liberal, lavish, munificent. *Ex:* The stingy man never gave to charity.

Stoic *(adj)* সহিষ্ণু, নির্বিকার — enduring pain without complaint. SYN patient, uncomplaining, long-suffering, impassive, unflinching. ANT complaining, emotional, excitable, impatient. *Ex:* He remained stoic despite his injuries.

Stringent *(adj)* কঠোর — (of rules) strict and precise. SYN strict, rigorous, rigid, tough, severe. ANT lax, lenient, flexible, loose. *Ex:* Stringent laws are needed to stop food adulteration.

Subjugate *(v)* পরাধীন করা — to bring under control by force. SYN conquer, subdue, vanquish, enslave, oppress. ANT liberate, free, emancipate, release. *Ex:* The British subjugated the Indian subcontinent.

Substantial *(adj)* যথেষ্ট, উল্লেখযোগ্য — of considerable importance, size or worth. SYN considerable, significant, large, sizeable, ample. ANT insignificant, small, negligible, trivial. *Ex:* There has been a substantial increase in exports.

Succinct *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত ও সুস্পষ্ট — briefly and clearly expressed. SYN concise, brief, terse, compact, pithy. ANT verbose, wordy, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* Give a succinct answer.

Superficial ★ *(adj)* অগভীর, ভাসাভাসা — existing only on the surface; shallow. SYN shallow, surface, cursory, perfunctory, slight. ANT deep, profound, thorough, in-depth, comprehensive. *Ex:* He has only a superficial knowledge of history.

Superfluous ★ *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাড়তি — unnecessary, more than enough. SYN unnecessary, redundant, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, required, needed, vital. *Ex:* Cut out superfluous words from your writing.

Surreptitious GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চুপিসারে — kept secret because it would not be approved. SYN secret, clandestine, covert, furtive, stealthy. ANT open, overt, public, blatant. *Ex:* He took a surreptitious look at his phone in class.

Sycophant GRE *(n)* চাটুকার, তোষামোদকারী — a person who flatters powerful people for gain. SYN flatterer, toady, bootlicker, yes-man, lackey. ANT critic, detractor, rebel, independent. *Ex:* The king was surrounded by sycophants.

T

Taciturn ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী — saying very little. SYN reserved, silent, reticent, uncommunicative, laconic. ANT talkative, garrulous, loquacious, voluble, chatty. *Ex:* The taciturn farmer nodded but said nothing.

Tactful *(adj)* কৌশলী, বিচক্ষণ — careful not to offend people. SYN diplomatic, discreet, sensitive, considerate, politic. ANT tactless, indiscreet, blunt, insensitive. *Ex:* She gave a tactful reply to an awkward question.

Tangible *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য, বাস্তব — able to be touched; real and clear. SYN touchable, palpable, concrete, real, material. ANT intangible, abstract, imaginary, vague. *Ex:* We need tangible results, not promises.

Tardy *(adj)* দেরি করা, বিলম্বিত — slow; late. SYN late, slow, delayed, belated, dilatory. ANT punctual, prompt, early, quick. *Ex:* He was punished for his tardy arrival.

Tedious ★ *(adj)* ক্লান্তিকর, একঘেয়ে — too long, slow or dull. SYN boring, monotonous, tiresome, dull, wearisome. ANT interesting, exciting, stimulating, lively. *Ex:* Copying the register was a tedious job.

Temerity GRE *(n)* দুঃসাহস, ধৃষ্টতা — excessive boldness; audacity. SYN audacity, nerve, boldness, effrontery, impudence. ANT timidity, caution, shyness, prudence. *Ex:* He had the temerity to question the judge's honesty.

Temperate *(adj)* মৃদু, নাতিশীতোষ্ণ; সংযমী — mild; moderate; self-controlled. SYN mild, moderate, clement; self-restrained, sober. ANT extreme, harsh; intemperate, excessive. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a temperate winter.

Tenacious ★ *(adj)* দৃঢ়প্রতিজ্ঞ, নাছোড়বান্দা — holding firmly; persistent. SYN persistent, determined, resolute, dogged, steadfast. ANT irresolute, weak, yielding, wavering. *Ex:* Her tenacious efforts finally paid off.

Tentative *(adj)* অস্থায়ী, পরীক্ষামূলক — not certain or fixed; hesitant. SYN provisional, experimental, uncertain; hesitant, cautious. ANT definite, final, certain; confident, decisive. *Ex:* Here is the tentative schedule of the exam.

Terse *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত, রূঢ় — brief and abrupt. SYN curt, brusque, concise, laconic, short. ANT wordy, verbose, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* He sent a terse email refusing the offer.

Thrifty *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful with money. SYN frugal, economical, careful, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, spendthrift, prodigal. *Ex:* Thrifty housewives save for the future.

Timid ★ *(adj)* ভীরু, লাজুক — lacking courage or confidence. SYN shy, fearful, timorous, diffident, nervous. ANT bold, brave, confident, daring, audacious. *Ex:* The timid child hid behind his mother.

Torpid GRE *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, জড় — mentally or physically inactive. SYN lethargic, sluggish, inactive, inert, listless. ANT active, energetic, lively, vigorous. *Ex:* The heat made the animals torpid.

Tranquil ★ *(adj)* শান্ত, নিরুদ্বেগ — free from disturbance; calm. SYN calm, peaceful, serene, placid, quiet. ANT turbulent, agitated, noisy, chaotic, disturbed. *Ex:* We spent a tranquil weekend in Sreemangal.

Transient ★ *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting only for a short time. SYN temporary, fleeting, ephemeral, short-lived, transitory, momentary. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, perpetual, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth and beauty are transient.

Trepidation *(n)* উদ্বেগ, ভয় — a feeling of fear about something that may happen. SYN fear, anxiety, apprehension, dread, alarm. ANT calm, confidence, composure, courage. *Ex:* She entered the exam hall with trepidation.

Trite *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, মামুলি — overused and lacking originality. SYN banal, hackneyed, clichéd, stale, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, imaginative. *Ex:* The story ended with a trite moral.

Trivial *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — of little value or importance. SYN unimportant, insignificant, petty, trifling, negligible. ANT important, significant, serious, crucial. *Ex:* They quarrelled over a trivial matter.

Truculent GRE *(adj)* আগ্রাসী, যুদ্ধংদেহী — eager to argue or fight. SYN aggressive, belligerent, hostile, defiant, combative. ANT gentle, cooperative, amiable, docile. *Ex:* The truculent prisoner attacked a guard.

Turbulent *(adj)* অশান্ত, বিক্ষুব্ধ — characterised by conflict, disorder or confusion. SYN stormy, rough, violent; chaotic, unstable, tumultuous. ANT calm, peaceful, tranquil, stable. *Ex:* The 1960s were turbulent years in East Pakistan.

U

Ubiquitous ★ GRE *(adj)* সর্বব্যাপী, সর্বত্র বিরাজমান — present everywhere. SYN omnipresent, pervasive, universal, everywhere, widespread. ANT rare, scarce, uncommon, absent. *Ex:* Mobile phones are ubiquitous today.

Unanimous *(adj)* সর্বসম্মত — fully in agreement. SYN united, agreed, concordant, of one mind, uncontested. ANT divided, split, disputed, contested. *Ex:* The decision was unanimous.

Unkempt *(adj)* অপরিচ্ছন্ন, এলোমেলো — (of appearance) untidy. SYN untidy, messy, dishevelled, scruffy, slovenly. ANT neat, tidy, groomed, smart, trim. *Ex:* He came to the interview with unkempt hair.

Unscrupulous *(adj)* নীতিহীন — having no moral principles. SYN unprincipled, dishonest, corrupt, immoral, shameless. ANT scrupulous, honest, principled, ethical. *Ex:* Unscrupulous traders hoard goods before Ramadan.

Upbraid *(v)* তিরস্কার করা — to scold. SYN scold, reproach, rebuke, berate, reprimand. ANT praise, commend, compliment. *Ex:* She upbraided her son for coming home late.

Urbane *(adj)* মার্জিত, ভদ্র — (of a man) courteous and refined. SYN suave, sophisticated, polished, refined, cultivated. ANT boorish, crude, uncouth, rude. *Ex:* The urbane diplomat charmed the guests.

Usurp *(v)* জোর করে দখল করা — to take a position of power illegally or by force. SYN seize, take over, commandeer, appropriate, grab. ANT restore, return, give up, abdicate. *Ex:* The general usurped power in a coup.

Utopian *(adj)* কাল্পনিক আদর্শ — idealistic, perfect but impractical. SYN idealistic, visionary, perfect, fanciful, quixotic. ANT realistic, practical, pragmatic, dystopian. *Ex:* A society without crime is a utopian dream.

V

Vacillate ★ GRE *(v)* দোদুল্যমান থাকা — to waver between opinions. SYN waver, hesitate, dither, fluctuate, oscillate. ANT decide, resolve, persist, stand firm. *Ex:* He vacillated between law and medicine.

Vague *(adj)* অস্পষ্ট — not clear or definite. SYN unclear, indistinct, hazy, ambiguous, obscure. ANT clear, definite, precise, explicit, distinct. *Ex:* He gave a vague answer.

Valiant *(adj)* সাহসী, বীর — showing courage. SYN brave, courageous, heroic, gallant, valorous. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The valiant soldier saved his comrades.

Vanity *(n)* অহংকার; অসারতা — excessive pride; futility. SYN conceit, pride, arrogance, egotism; futility, emptiness. ANT modesty, humility; worth, usefulness. *Ex:* Her vanity made her spend hours before the mirror.

Vehement *(adj)* তীব্র, প্রবল — showing strong feeling. SYN forceful, passionate, intense, fervent, ardent. ANT mild, calm, half-hearted, feeble, subdued. *Ex:* The proposal met with vehement opposition.

Venal GRE *(adj)* ঘুষখোর, অর্থলোভী — open to bribery. SYN corrupt, bribable, mercenary, dishonest, crooked. ANT honest, incorruptible, upright, principled. *Ex:* Venal officials sold licences for money. (Do not confuse with *venial* = forgivable.)

Venerate *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to regard with great respect. SYN revere, respect, honour, worship, esteem. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, dishonour. *Ex:* We venerate the martyrs of 1952.

Verbose ★ *(adj)* শব্দবহুল — using more words than needed. SYN wordy, long-winded, prolix, garrulous, loquacious. ANT concise, brief, succinct, laconic, terse. *Ex:* The report was verbose and repetitive.

Versatile *(adj)* বহুমুখী প্রতিভাসম্পন্ন — able to adapt to many activities. SYN adaptable, all-round, flexible, multitalented, resourceful. ANT limited, inflexible, specialised, one-dimensional. *Ex:* Nazrul was a versatile genius.

Vex *(v)* বিরক্ত করা — to annoy or worry. SYN annoy, irritate, anger, trouble, exasperate. ANT please, soothe, calm, delight. *Ex:* It vexes me to see people littering.

Viable *(adj)* কার্যকর, টেকসই — capable of working successfully. SYN feasible, workable, practicable, sustainable, possible. ANT unworkable, impractical, unfeasible, impossible. *Ex:* Solar power is a viable alternative energy.

Vigilant ★ *(adj)* সতর্ক, সজাগ — watchful for possible danger. SYN watchful, alert, wary, attentive, observant. ANT careless, negligent, inattentive, heedless. *Ex:* Citizens must be vigilant against terrorism.

Vigorous *(adj)* তেজস্বী, জোরালো — strong, healthy and full of energy. SYN energetic, robust, strong, lively, dynamic. ANT weak, feeble, lethargic, frail, languid. *Ex:* Take vigorous exercise every day.

Vilify *(v)* কুৎসা রটানো — to speak or write about in an abusive way. SYN defame, malign, slander, denigrate, disparage. ANT praise, extol, laud, glorify. *Ex:* He was vilified by the press.

Vindicate *(v)* নির্দোষ প্রমাণ করা; সঠিক প্রমাণ করা — to clear of blame; to show to be right. SYN exonerate, acquit, clear; justify, support, confirm. ANT accuse, convict, blame; disprove, refute. *Ex:* The new evidence vindicated him.

Virtuous *(adj)* গুণী, সৎ — having high moral standards. SYN good, moral, righteous, upright, honourable. ANT wicked, immoral, corrupt, vicious, sinful. *Ex:* He was a virtuous ruler.

Vivacious *(adj)* প্রাণবন্ত — attractively lively and animated. SYN lively, animated, spirited, bubbly, sparkling. ANT dull, lifeless, listless, languid, boring. *Ex:* She is a vivacious young woman.

Vociferous *(adj)* উচ্চকণ্ঠ, সোচ্চার — expressing opinions loudly and forcefully. SYN loud, vocal, clamorous, outspoken, strident. ANT quiet, silent, reticent, soft-spoken. *Ex:* There were vociferous protests against price hikes.

Volatile *(adj)* উদ্বায়ী; অস্থির — evaporating easily; likely to change suddenly. SYN unstable, explosive, unpredictable, erratic, mercurial. ANT stable, calm, constant, steady. *Ex:* The political situation is volatile.

Voluntary *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছামূলক — done of one's own free will. SYN optional, willing, discretionary, unforced, spontaneous. ANT compulsory, mandatory, obligatory, forced. *Ex:* Blood donation is a voluntary service.

Voracious *(adj)* অতি ক্ষুধার্ত, পেটুক; অতি আগ্রহী — wanting great quantities of food; very eager. SYN ravenous, greedy, insatiable, gluttonous; avid, enthusiastic. ANT sated, satisfied; indifferent, apathetic. *Ex:* He is a voracious reader.

Vulnerable *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ, অরক্ষিত — exposed to harm or attack. SYN exposed, defenceless, susceptible, unprotected, weak. ANT invulnerable, protected, safe, secure, resilient. *Ex:* Bangladesh is vulnerable to climate change.

W

Wane *(v)* ক্ষয় পাওয়া, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to decrease in size, power or extent. SYN decrease, decline, diminish, ebb, fade. ANT wax, grow, increase, strengthen. *Ex:* His influence began to wane.

Wanton *(adj)* অকারণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — deliberate and unprovoked (of a cruel act); immoral. SYN wilful, gratuitous, malicious, senseless; dissolute. ANT justified, provoked; moral, chaste. *Ex:* The wanton destruction of trees must stop.

Wary *(adj)* সতর্ক, সাবধানী — cautious about possible dangers. (Do not confuse with *weary* = tired.) SYN cautious, careful, alert, vigilant, suspicious. ANT careless, unwary, trusting, reckless. *Ex:* Be wary of strangers offering free gifts.

Wax *(v)* বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া (বিশেষত চাঁদ) — to grow larger or stronger. *Wax* and *wane* are a classic antonym pair. SYN increase, grow, expand, swell, enlarge. ANT wane, decrease, diminish, shrink. *Ex:* The moon waxes and wanes every month.

Weary *(adj)* ক্লান্ত — very tired. SYN tired, exhausted, fatigued, worn out, jaded. ANT fresh, energetic, refreshed, lively. *Ex:* The weary traveller rested under a banyan tree.

Whimsical *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — playfully unusual; acting on sudden ideas. SYN fanciful, capricious, playful, quirky, fickle. ANT serious, sober, steady, predictable. *Ex:* The story has a whimsical charm.

Wholesome *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর; নৈতিকভাবে ভালো — good for health or morals. SYN healthy, nutritious, beneficial; moral, decent, clean. ANT unhealthy, unwholesome, harmful; immoral, corrupt. *Ex:* Children need wholesome food and entertainment.

Wicked *(adj)* দুষ্ট, পাপী — evil or morally wrong. SYN evil, sinful, vicious, villainous, nefarious. ANT good, virtuous, righteous, moral, kind. *Ex:* The wicked stepmother mistreated Cinderella.

Wily *(adj)* ধূর্ত — skilled at gaining an advantage by deceit. SYN cunning, crafty, sly, shrewd, artful. ANT naive, ingenuous, honest, simple. *Ex:* The wily fox tricked the crow.

Witty *(adj)* রসিক, বুদ্ধিদীপ্ত — showing quick and clever humour. SYN humorous, clever, amusing, droll, funny. ANT dull, boring, humourless, stupid. *Ex:* Syed Mujtaba Ali was a witty writer.

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Xenophobia *(n)* বিদেশিভীতি — dislike or fear of people from other countries. SYN racism, chauvinism, intolerance, nativism. ANT xenophilia, tolerance, hospitality, cosmopolitanism. *Ex:* Xenophobia is rising in some parts of Europe.

Yearn *(v)* আকুলভাবে কামনা করা — to have an intense longing for. SYN long, crave, pine, hanker, desire. ANT dislike, spurn, be indifferent to. *Ex:* Migrant workers yearn for home during Eid.

Yield *(v/n)* ফলন দেওয়া; নতি স্বীকার করা — to produce; to give way; the amount produced. SYN produce, generate; surrender, submit, give in; harvest, output. ANT withhold; resist, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The new rice variety yields more crops. / He refused to yield to pressure.

Zany *(adj)* হাস্যকর রকমের অদ্ভুত — amusingly unconventional. SYN eccentric, comical, wacky, crazy, madcap. ANT serious, sober, conventional, sensible. *Ex:* He is known for his zany sense of humour.

Zeal ★ *(n)* উদ্যম, উৎসাহ — great energy or enthusiasm for a cause. SYN enthusiasm, passion, fervour, ardour, eagerness. ANT apathy, indifference, lethargy, half-heartedness. *Ex:* She worked with great zeal for the poor.

Zealous *(adj)* উদ্যমী, উৎসাহী — having great zeal. SYN fervent, ardent, passionate, enthusiastic, eager. ANT apathetic, indifferent, lukewarm, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* He is a zealous supporter of environmental causes.

Zenith ★ *(n)* সর্বোচ্চ বিন্দু, শীর্ষ — the highest point. SYN peak, summit, acme, pinnacle, apex, climax. ANT nadir, bottom, base, lowest point. *Ex:* The Mughal Empire reached its zenith under Akbar.